

Contents

I	Posts by Logres	I
I.1	Transformational Possibilities	I
I.2	The Glory of God	6
I.3	Credo ut intelligam	13
I.4	Progenitors of Our Middle Earth	18
I.5	Exit the Cave	22
I.6	Two Gnosticisms	26
I.7	NeoPlatonism &the Faith	31
I.8	Gold, Jupiter, &Wine	35
I.9	Europe's Spirit in the North	39
I.10	A Way Out, Further In	44
I.11	Kind Hearts, &Norman Blood	53
I.12	Yahweh's Template	64
I.13	The Russian Turn	78
I.14	Through the Illusion, into the Dream	82
I.15	The Celestial &Super-Celestial	87

I.16	The Seven Steps of Esoteric Christianity	92
I.17	Lesser & Greater Mysteries	97
I.18	The Church that was Left Behind	103
I.19	True North	109
I.20	The Nous	116
I.21	New Birth, New Death	119
I.22	Fears of What May Be, Erring Popes & Councils . . .	125
I.23	The Guardian of the Threshold	139
I.24	Harmonics	145
I.25	Sun, Moon, & Stars	160
I.26	Deep Materiality	163
I.27	Remarks on Tomberg	168
I.28	Recapitulation	171
I.29	Middle Earth Once More	174
I.30	Making the Modern Mind	179
I.31	Reversing the Modern Spell	183
I.32	When the King Enjoys His Own Again	185
I.33	The Wisdom of God	191
I.34	Palamidessi reads Evola	196
I.35	The Path of Blue Flowers	202
I.36	The Soul of Jupiter	207
I.37	General Law	210
I.38	Liturgy and the Logos	215
I.39	The Bible of Amiens	226
I.40	Gothic Christianity	233
I.41	Sola Scriptura in the Middle Ages	240
I.42	The Word Remains Within	245
I.43	The Road to the true West	250
I.44	Putting a Rose Back on the Cross	260
I.45	Finishing What the Inklings Started	265
I.46	Poets of the Reunion	270

1.47	A Higher Imagination	273
1.48	Phantastes	276
1.49	The Philokalia's Martial Character	282
1.50	Never the Twain Shall Meet	293
1.51	The Trivium & Mystery	301
1.52	Esoteric Christianity & the Anti-Christ	305
1.53	Endgame	318
1.54	Restoration, Revival, Renaissance	323
1.55	The Christian Social Order & Pythagoras	326
1.56	Western Social Order	333
1.57	The Metalogikon	357
1.58	La Revolution Devore Ses Enfants	361
1.59	Tomberg's Labor	368
1.60	The Syllables of the Gods	373
1.61	Nature's Lessons on Interior Friction	378
1.62	Ecce Ancilla Domini	382
1.63	The Lutheran Reformation	385
1.64	The Emperor's Post	396
1.65	The Metaphysical Principles of the Infinitesimal Calculus	402
1.66	Order & Right versus The Cathedral	406
2	About the Tarot	415
2.1	Le Bateleur, or Thus Endeth the Lesson	415
2.2	The High Priestess	419
2.3	Unweaving the Web of God	423
2.4	Inner Meaning of Augustinianism	426
2.5	The Emperor	430
2.6	The Superstition of Reason	438
2.7	The Seven Sacred Liberal Arts	442

3	Clement's Initiation	453
3.1	Titus Flavius Clemens and the Golden Chain	453
3.2	The Golden Book & Saint Clement	462
3.3	Clement's Initiation: Peter and Shimon Magus debate	468
3.4	Christian Initiation in Clementine Literature	476
3.5	Petrine Initiation in the "Old World" of Pure Intellect	481
3.6	More Insight into Christian Initiation	491
4	The Theology of Arithmetic	499
4.1	Fortune's Fool by Numbers	499
4.2	The Meaning of Numbers	506
4.3	Numbers According to Iamblichus	509
4.4	The Dyad	511
4.5	Logos Tomeus	515
4.6	The Triad	518
4.7	The Tetrad	521
4.8	Pentad	524
4.9	Hexad	528
4.10	A Pause at the Hexad	533
4.11	Hebdomad	537
4.12	Heaven By Storm on the Number Seven	539
4.13	Octad	541
4.14	Ennead	544
5	The Labors of Hercules	549
5.1	The Labors of Hercules, Part One	549
5.2	Labors of Hercules, Part 2	562
5.3	The Labors of Hercules, Part 3	570
5.4	Labors of Hercules, Part 4	575
5.5	Hercules' Sixth Task: The Stymphalian Birds	580
5.6	Hercules' Seventh Triumph	583

5.7	The Eighth Victory of Hercules Over the Mares of Diomedes	594
5.8	Hercules' Ninth – The Girdle of Hippolyta	604
5.9	Call Down the Sun – Hercules X	612
5.10	The Apples of the Hesperides – Hercules' Eleventh Labor	618
5.11	The Twelfth and Final Labor	626
6	Persian Traditions in Spain	637
6.1	McClain in his own Words	637
6.2	Preface to Persian Traditions	640
6.3	John of the Cross, the Rumi of Spain	642
6.4	Karbala	644
6.5	Ridwan and Malik	658
6.6	The White Dove	680
6.7	Ashura	698
6.8	Persian Traditions Chap I – General, part a	707

I.I Transformational Possibilities

Gornahoor would like to welcome Logres who will be posting articles on Fridays for the next several weeks as I take time to pursue other interests.

COLOGERO

The default fundamentalism inherent in so much of contemporary American or even Western Christianity is a cause of some dismay for traditionalists who yearn to look into this tradition for inspiration and support. Watching modern Christians flail their way into movements like the emergent Church¹ or Radical Orthodoxy² is frustrating or even infuriating. How can so much well-meaning and almost-right energy be spent in ignoring the deeper cultural connections also inherent in the

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Emerging_church

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Radical_Orthodoxy

Faith? Any moment, now, one feels that the thrashing may re-ignite the genuine article almost by accident.

Many critics have argued persuasively that Christianity is inherently “Judaizing” and doomed to repeat the innate short-circuits infused within the various cultural patterns it assimilated on its path to ascendancy, and they are invariably helped on by some theologians who actually sing paeans of praise.

Specifically, the literalism of the Scriptures as a Holy Book seem to be a fundamental limiting pattern within dialogue on this subject, within and without the Faith. The supposedly perspicacious Writ is quoted against and for us, designedly to limit certain possibilities and force others, usually something compatible with a global universal political settlement.

To these, one might quote Luther, “The letter is poison.” (*Schrift ist gift*). Obviously, this dichotomy set up in the New Testament is a vehicle for higher purpose, and was a major complaint of Jews against Christians, not without reason. To the Biblical narrative, the traditionalist can bring a deeper awareness of unnoticed patterns heretofore ignored. There is, of course, the great solar tradition hidden within the Davidic dynasty, inaugurated when King David opened the inner sanctuary and ate of the shewbread upon the holy mount of peace, a holy site from very ancient times. Troy Southgate’s uneven website drew attention to this, in an article by Bill White³. It wasn’t as if King David was following the letter of the Law in piercing the veil, and he probably didn’t have a rope tied to his leg just in case a burial was needed. The order of Melchizedek was another ancient order connected with Salem, and there is also the strange episode of Namaan bowing down in the temple of Rimmon at the advice of Elijah.

Add to this the strange verses in Paul’s writings about “tutelary spirits” raising the consciousness of nations, baptism for the dead, and the theory of recapitulation of the All through the Kingship-Headship of Christ,

³<http://www.rosenoire.org/articles/aryan.php>

as well as parallelisms that exist between many of Christ's saying and the Vedantic⁴ tradition, as well as the imagery of Revelation, and the Scriptures could begin to look far more interesting. Ask most Christians what Christ meant when he said each little one had a guardian spirit that beholds the face of the Father directly, and you will be met with utter incomprehension or disbelief. We may dismiss their good opinion and proceed. Yet we need not concede them control over the vehicles, since to do so strips our effort of needful road signs or tools.

For example, the Christian Reconstructionist James Jordan⁵ has written an obscure but useful book about the hidden symbols of the Bible that are in plain sight, and Jonathan Edwards (had he lived) might have greatly developed his portrayal of the Platonic⁶ imagery of nature⁷. Is it an accident that men like Marsilio Ficino pop up within Western streams of thought and religion, *or is it wholly for our sake, for the Now, that they wrote what they wrote? To cleanse the doors of perception for the I which aspires in the Now for truth, but has lost its way?* In the dearth of a true tradition, Christians (and those who would use the vehicle as they may) are compelled to re-forge the sword which was broken – we cannot look to the official institutions themselves for confirmation, aid, or blessing.

To those false sons within the pale, and those who scorn the true Church as utterly bereft of real grace, we ought to reply with Isaac Penington, and apply this unction to the dying Faith:

Every truth is a shadow except the last. But every truth is substance in its own place, though it be but a shadow in another. And the shadow is a true shadow, as the substance is a true substance.

⁴http://www.biblicalstudies.org.uk/pdf/ijt/30-1_024.pdf

⁵<http://www.biblicalhorizons.com/pdf/jjne.pdf>

⁶<http://www.jesociety.org/2011/02/10/was-jonathan-edwards-a-gnostic/>

⁷<http://www.ts.mu.edu/content/65/65.1/65.1.3.pdf>

These fragments of truth which she has grasped, like some *de copia* of Erasmus, she has shored against her “ruin”. The work will begin. We will make our inheritance our own, and the letter shall be burned.

Posted on 2011-04-08 by Logres

* * *

Spock on 2011-04-08 at 09:13 said:

Biblical passages don't prove much of anything, only that the scribes or forgers could copy from other manuscripts.

Cologero on 2011-04-08 at 12:56 said:

There are some defects in the James Jordan text, particularly in his understanding of the “creation” of the world. He takes the position that God could have created any possible world, where by “possible” he means any world that James Jordan can conceive in his imagination. However, there is no reason to suppose that whatever James Jordan can imagine is actually realizable. That may be the Jewish interpretation, but it is not the Christian.

Christian understanding states that everything was created through the Logos: “All things were made by him Logos; and without him was not any thing made that was made.”

So when James Jordan wonders why the world is the way it is, that is because it conforms to a cosmic order, a topic we have addressed many times. As far as Mr. Jordan's objection to Plato, we can assure him that it was John himself who made the connection to the Logos of Greek philosophy. The Alexandrians and Augustine just noted it and drew out the consequences.

logres on 2011-04-08 at 20:58 said:

Thanks for pointing that out by articulating it clearly; that's the problem with many branches of Christian tradition, and one I know very personally – one has a naive faith, then it is “lost”, and/or one comes upon a writer like Jordan who does dip into the pool a little bit, leaving one with the general idea that all has been said. Whereupon, one shuts one's self off from any further development. In Jordan's case, he's just more interesting than the average theologian, and therefore more helpful and dangerous all at once. Such debates do represent a possible apologetic angle for traditionalists, as Cologero has outlined. And thanks for the welcome.

Ismo Meinander on 2011-04-09 at 05:29 said:

Cologero said: Christian understanding states that everything was created through the Logos: “All things were made by him Logos; and without him was not any thing made that was made.”

There is a very interesting passage in Wolfgang Smith's 'The Quantum Enigma' concerning this biblical quotation, in which he discusses the issue of causation and vertical causality in the context of art and creativity. I think it is best for me to quote him straight from the book:

"It emerges that there exists a primary causality which acts, not in some distant past, but in every here and now without exception. All things existing in space and time are not only brought into being, but held in existence, by this primary causation which derives from a single and indivisible Act. Unlike the kinds of causality with which modern science is concerned – which may be termed temporal or natural causation – this primary causality does not act from past to future by way of a temporary process, but acts directly, unmediated by any chain of temporal events. The question arises now whether this 'temporally unmediated' mode of action – which we shall designate by the adjective vertical – is the exclusive prerogative of primary causation, or whether perhaps there exist secondary modes of vertical causality. In answer to this question it can be said that the causation effected by an intelligent agent is perforce vertical. Take the case of art in the primitive sense of human making: the entire process hinges in fact upon such a vertical act. What stands at issue in authentic art is a veritable *imitatio Dei*: the human artist 'participates' to some degree in the creative process of the First Cause: 'All things were made by Him, and without Him not anything was made' (John 1: 13). But does this mean that all production – even the shoddiest artifact – is to be ascribed indiscriminately to God Himself? Assuredly not. It is interesting to note, in this connection, that according to the punctuation which became generally accepted in post-medieval times, John 1: 13 actually reads: 'All things were made by Him, and without Him was not anything made that was truly made.' We may take it that the *quod factum est* refers to what is truly made, and therefore what truly is. The difference, Scholastically speaking, lies in the presence or absence of form: it is form – a transcendent element! – that bestows being. Now, the bestowal of form constitutes an incurably vertical act of causation."

So I take it that 'vertical causation' is another way of expressing the 'eternal now' and in reference to the 'creation' it can be said that the world is created by the immanently transcendent divinity anew from moment to moment. So the passage could go also 'everything is created by Him and without Him nothing is made that is truly made. I think this conception of 'an eternal creation' should be emphasized and elaborated every time when one speaks for example with scientists about 'the creation of the world' and the world process: The Primary Act did not act in 'the big bang' and then evade itself in some transcendent dimension of Being like the Deists seem to think, but it acts in everything, especially and in potentia consciously through humans who have the possibilities to conceive it unlike animals and non-human Nature that follows its ways instinctually, and nothing could not exist without this immanent participation into the higher states of being either consciously or un-consciously. In the realm of art and human creativity it can be said that true art in some way or another reflects harmoniously the intellect of the Logos.

Ismo Meinander on 2011-04-09 at 05:40 said:

Correction: '... and nothing could not exist...' – 'nothing could exist'. My english is not perfect & I apologize some possible mistakes.

Cologero on 2011-04-09 at 19:13 said:

Thanks for pointing out that passage from Wolfgang Smith. It ties in, too, with Mouravieff's New Age, the era of the Artist ... as you and Prof Smith use the term. Artistic intuition needs to be expressed, and artistic expression is a continuing creative process, not a once and for all times event.

Cologero on 2011-04-09 at 19:32 said:

By attempting to recover the symbolic, Jordan is accidentally interesting but he ruins it with his literalness and fundamentalism. As an example, we can point to his misunderstanding of the cosmology of the four elements as a sort of proto-chemistry in the modern sense. Of course not, but as a qualitative understanding of the world, it is adequate and accurate. Could God have created a world without one of the four qualitative elements? Perhaps a world without the liquid state (water)? Inconceivable. Or without energy (fire)? Not at all. God is arbitrary for Jordan, not consubstantial with the Logos.

logres on 2011-04-10 at 00:49 said:

Yes, I hadn't thought deeply enough about the why of Jordan being wrong, but "accidentally interesting" probably aptly characterizes his work. I read a Catholic writer who thought that Duns Scotus' emphasis on God's will lead to problems in the West, but as I've come across traditionalist writers, I see that even this doesn't get deep enough. The examples are endless: Richard Weaver blaming William of Occam in *Ideas Have Consequences*, etc., etc. A lot of blaming in the West, not much substance, or rather, not enough to warrant a prophetic tone. Harold Weatherby has an interesting book called *"The Keen Delight"* on the effect of bad philosophy on poetry. He starts with Dante, goes through Hopkins, and ends with Eliot. Of course, his answer is more "scholasticism" of the Aquinas-type.

1.2 The Glory of God

The essential American soul is hard, stoic, isolate, and a killer. It has never yet melted.

DH LAWRENCE

If it is true that the “Great Divide⁸” was the Middle Ages, it might be worthwhile examining to what extent they remain with us, and how we might recover such. Ordinarily, it is claimed that Luther and Calvin and the Reformation ended the Middle Ages, and of course in a purely causal sense (itself limited to certain causes) this is certainly accurate. However, Luther and Calvin are inheritors of the Augustinian tradition, and much of what is praiseworthy in their *traditio* is essentially medieval⁹. Much could be further dug¹⁰ out of Reformation history that has gone neglected, yet there is a central strain of Augustinianism which Evola singled out for comment:

As for Christianity in its less popular forms, it presents an aspect of the tragic doctrine of salvation, which to some extent preserves an echo of the ancient truth: the idea—pushed to extremes by Luther and Calvin—that man on earth stands at the crossroads between Salvation and eternal damnation. This point of view, if lived intensely and coherently, could create the conditions for liberation at the moment of death or in post-mortem states.

The Hermetic Tradition, Note 2, page 96

It is not worth arguing that there isn’t a lot to object to in Christian theology proper, especially in its generalized concerns and contours, but even in the details. Yet the Augustinian tradition, with both its “great rewards and great dangers” (Khuenhelt-Ledhin), was a historical vehicle of impressing upon many men the necessity of pleasing God rather than

⁸<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2244>

⁹http://www.kinism.net/publications/tkr_summer_2010.pdf

¹⁰<http://anglicanrose.wordpress.com/>

men (the exoteric phrasing of its content). It gave a great cast of character to certain practitioners which went beyond the mere philosophical fatalism or negation of sensual pleasure which might be predicted by a superficial reading, and this was indeed a result that many lesser adherents naturally devolved. Certainly, Calvin's view (for example) might lead to a mechanical clockwork universe, in which every detail is "restlessly and ceaselessly ordered" by the direct hand of God, denying the possibility of actualization of being by the individual, and tending towards a complacent secularism. The anti-intellectual tendencies of Luther are well known.

However, these men were "medieval" in their grasp of life as a fairy tale that was dark in the middle, through which men must pass – hence the emphasis upon transcendence and perseverance, the "trials of faith".

Luther himself argued that man has to pass through *Anfechtung*, which was the crushing of the personality under the weight of sin. We can here posit that included in this "sin" was the "ego". William James investigates this lineage in his *Varieties of Religious Experience*, the tradition of being "twice-born" and the necessity of regenerating being.

Calvin's emphasis is different¹¹, but his proteges actually proclaimed that in "order to be saved, one has to be willing to be damned for God's glory". This paradox is also a crushing of the ego, and an attempt to impress man with the vertical energies which alone can deliver him from purely psychic or all too human phenomena.

Augustine, a mentor to both, situated the locus of this tradition in the "God-shaped hole" which exists in the inner heart, and argues that the purely natural heart "is restless until it rests in Thee". Although his *Confessions* helped inaugurate the Western odyssey, he remained thoroughly traditional in his attempt to preserve Plato's forms within the mind of God.

¹¹<http://paulhelmsdeep.blogspot.com/2009/07/augustine-and-calvin-on-knowledge-of.html>

As Evola's quote indicates, it was in the intensity of their final focus where the clue for real possibilities lay – by driving man outside of himself, and forcing the ego to “melt” in the presence of real transcendence (a transcendence guaranteed in the magisterial side of the Augustinian tradition, and linked with the “way of the heart” as a guide in the dark) the opening up of real religious vision could be made more fully present. Augustinianism in fact gave to the Protestant West whatever freedom from the ego it possessed, and a presence of the Super-Ego, which it could not derive from its geographic situation and cultural history.

It is here qualified that such would more or less create the possibilities for transformation or pre-transformation over time, including the “after-life”, rather than fully actualizing such in a truly self-conscious manner. We are not claiming that they represent a coherent perennial tradition – their coherence is derived from their intensity and whatever echoes they preserve, as well as whatever inspiration they manage to possess.

In this path is found the meaning of “original sin” in the Christian tradition – an assault upon the accidents and hopelessness of the perverted ego. It was certainly never meant to be applied to the real self, and indeed in moments of transport or inspiration, never was, but almost always only in the “proclamation of such” to the “masses”.

Even if it was muddled, traditionalists are in a position to recognize that men's experience of an event is one thing, their accurate interpretation and communicating of it something else. This allows them to begin to decode the record of spiritual experiences, even when it seems a wasteland. This is particularly important in Western studies and the reconstitution of our tradition.

Our verdict would be similar to that of Evola's on esoteric Catholicism – if the Anglo freethinker would return to magisterial Augustinianism, this would not be a regress, but a positive spiritual good. As disrupted as that tradition is on the surface, we have reason to believe that deeper patterns were at work. For instance, Luther drew on the *Theologica Ger-*

manica¹², which is attributed possibly to Eckhart and associated with the Teutonic knightly order.

Next to the Bible¹³ and St. Augustine, no book has ever come into my hands from which I have learned more of God and Christ, and man and all things that are.

The book advocates the union of the individual with God as an earthly goal. The Divine Drama, in which man is at the center stage, and must choose a path which either damns him to the pits, or leads him to better than Elysium, is given an existential urgency and self-evidential character, along with whatever of ancient doctrine the Western mind was capable of absorbing at that time.

If Gurdjieff's "way of the heart"¹⁴ characterizes the Christian path, how much more does it characterize the Augustinian tradition, which is essentially a theological poetry focused on the lone person, nevertheless sustained by God's sole Providence? It may be that in this existential sense, in the "echo" (as Evola has it) it might be possible for man to fulfill the Biblical mandate (itself a stronger echo) that each man would "feel after God, if happily they might find Him" (Aratus, quoted by Paul). The intense Biblicism and personal piety which characterized the initial Reformation was in this sense an attempt to "see through the glass darkly", and to reclaim the lost birthright. In divine sovereignty, all these men saw with Dante that here "Love and Fate are one". If they garbled the rapturous report, it is up to others to retune it.

Such investigations into Western history (heretofore interpreted largely by the detritus intelligentsia class, for whom the world before Voltaire was without grace or merit) will lead to surprising avenues of inquiry, in

¹²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Theologia_Germanica

¹³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bible>

¹⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fourth_Way

which it becomes clearer and clearer that the rivulet of traditional influence in the West had an odd habit¹⁵ of showing up, again and again, in strange guises.

The Augustinian tension between the soul that “believes in order to understand” and the God Who sovereignly calls such a soul to even desire it echoes the tension in traditional thought between the man who passes through the initiation of his own volition and in full passibility, in order to integrate himself with an order which is eternal and which knows nothing of such vulnerabilities to contingency.

From death, to life. This perennial wisdom may not have ever had a chance to become explicit in the West, but we find it even in our poets:

Take, he said, the belief in immortality, which, according to some men, is a matter of mild indifference. It is really a belief which affects our whole conception of the human race. Consider, he said, the carnage of war, with its pile of unnumbered corpses. It must make some matter to us whether, according to our serious belief, each man has died like a dog, and left nothing in the way of a personal existence behind him, or “whether out of every Christian-named portion of that ruinous heap there has gone forth into the air and the dead-fallen smoke of battle some astonished condition of soul unwillingly released.”

JOHN RUSKIN, quoted in W. H. Mallock’s *Memoirs of Life and Literature*¹⁶

Is this not precisely Evola’s teaching? Is it not time we reclaim all of our birthright?¹⁷

¹⁵<http://www.brusselsjournal.com/node/3732>

¹⁶<http://www.archive.org/details/memoirsoflifelit00mall>

¹⁷Please see *Greeks, Romans, Christians – Essays in Honor of Abraham Malherbe*, particularly the essay “The Aeropagus Speech: And Appeal to the Stoic Historian Posi-

Posted on 2011-04-23 by Logres

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-04-23 at 10:32 said:

Not to go off on a tangent, but I found the book, or at least the review of it, that you link to quite interesting, since it argues against the view, which I was taught quite explicitly in studying Plotinus, that Greek culture, or at least the works of P, A, and Pl, were preserved by the Arabs and the texts and translations made their way to Europe around the XIIth century.

On the other hand, doesn't the author and review, who start off by mocking the "Enlightenment" view of the "Dark Ages", lapse into exactly the same Modernist dogma, praising Athens and supposedly Jerusalem for 'freedom', 'democracy', 'curiosity' and all the other motifs Guenon would identify as the roots of the West's deviation? In Evola's terms, they seem to be taking the Church side of the "Roman Church" rather than the Roman, but then mis identifying it with the Classical world as such, and contrasting it to Islam. Since Evola preferred the Roman side, he would, and did, prefer Islam, precisely in the ways that the authors deride it!

If, as the authors say, Islam is evil for stoning the Woman Taken in Adultery, while Christ forgives her, is that not exactly what Evola would condemn: an unworldly 'spirituality' not fit for constructing a real society. Hence the need to take over the Roman machinery, transforming primitive Christianity into the Roman Church.

Or as Schuon said, Christianity is the "in a sense" illegitimate exotericizing of the esoteric core of Judaism, which imbalance Islam is "providentially" revealed to compensate and replace? Speaking of Schuon, the authors make much of Islam as "unable" to "assimilate" the Logos, which somehow prevents it from favoring democracy ! Now, Schuon established this parallel:

Gabriel – Word spermatic logos – Mary virgin – Christ

Gabriel – Word "Hear!" – Mohammed illiterate – Koran

I find this a lovely bit of structuralism, and I've often used it to illustrate what G. would call 'metaphysical insight', perceiving the hidden identity of the elements of disparate traditions, or what Spengler called 'physiognomic tact' and I resent the authors dirtying it up with their Islamophobia!

Logres on 2011-04-23 at 10:44 said:

Actually, I should have picked a better site to link to for the book, which was the main point of my link, and which I find fascinating. I would agree (and you are right to point out that more importantly, Schuon and others would agree) that Islam has an important traditionalist

donius against Later Stoics and the Epicureans", by David Balch. This volume contains excellent explorations of Pauline attitudes towards Stoicism.

role – that said, their current state of affairs is somewhat different than even a 100 years ago. Wasn't it Guillaume Faye (Archaeo-Futurism) who has argued that Europe's choice is between re-imposing real order on themselves, or having it done for them by Islam? So yes, that would be a Providential role. I am not familiar enough with Schuon's writings to comment, except to say that he has an enormous amount to teach.

Even “conservative” sites like Brussels Journal have imbibed the Enlightenment mindset (most conservatives simply are not). But it is definitely interesting that Western culture may have maintained far more integrity in various ways than we give it credit for. It's possible that the Celts had preserved some of the texts as well – have to look into Erigena.

1.3 Credo ut intelligam

Augustine inaugurated the path of confessionalism with his *Credo, ut intelligam*. All of the Axial Age Monotheistic religions developed a “heart path” which was mystical. This path was recognized by Gurdjieff as being one of the three paths to transcendence, along with the mind (yoga) and the body (fakir). Although an argument might be made that Eastern Orthodoxy¹⁸ kept the theory more pure and the practice more intense, the “way of the heart” in all three share many resemblances:

A.M.: When the spiritual heart has awakened, you feel a kind of burning, an influx of energy, a feeling of peace in your chest. When it only starts awakening, you feel pain in the chest. At first it's like heart pain, of-ten quite strong. Those who don't understand what's happening, think it's heart trouble. We've had cases in our commune when people felt acute pain at the time when their spiritual heart began to awaken. Doctors thought it was a heart attack, but cardiograms showed no heart disorders. Objective evidence spoke of good health. When the action of the spiritual heart expands, you may feel pain in your chest or even your

¹⁸<http://www.lprww.us/THE%20SPIRITUAL%20HEART,%20GOD%27S%20CHANNEL.htm>

shoulders. At first the area of action expands, but then it is localized and forms a kind of sphere in the middle of your chest. After a while the pain goes away and you feel the action only once in a while...

For Islam¹⁹,

... describes it as an organ in the breast of man which if it is well, the entire being is well; and if it is not, the entire being is not. By the Prophet's indication the *qalb* is not just a physical organ but something like an electromagnetic energy field with its center at the heart. It is a subtler force superimposed on what we call the physical heart. When the heart is turning to a site it will reflect that site. If your heart is connected with a situation, you are likely to reflect that situation. If it is set on something you are likely to attain it, given all the physical possibilities. Wherever your heart turns, it is towards a discernable thing. Its function however, its genetic code is to be ever-turning, never to be fixed upon anything. It is the scanner of objects which gives it the nature of reflectiveness. Its reality, though, is beyond that. The nature of radar and what makes it function is not what it reflects, it is not the image of the aircraft. Its operation is based on wavebands. What makes a heart a heart, a *qalb* a *qalb*, is an entity which is unique, which is ***Abad***, which is not related to anything that the *qalb* reflects and discerns. We can make a holograph of anything, but its origin is not the thing. A heart can reflect anything or any situation, any mental image or thought, but what gives it the power to have that nature of turning, non-attachment and freedom is none of these and it is over and above that, and there is nothing like it. In other words, what is trying to be expressed is that the master of the heart is Allah. The sufferer from the heart's reflection is you and I. And that suffering is part of our endowment. There is no way out of

¹⁹<http://www.nuradeen.com/archives/Nuradeen.htm>

it. It will reflect the good and the bad, the degrees of attachment and non-attachment. If we give it its due we will allow it to be a real *qalb* – it will turn at all times.

Even Evola's group dabbled in "heart-magic"²⁰.

Syncretism would be to indiscriminately blend these together, or to act as if they were all equal. Tradition (to the contrary) looks to what is Truth irregardless of any other consideration except for the wisdom of skillful means and necessary contingencies. Gurdjieff²¹ did something like this when he acknowledged the path of the heart as being one of the three primary ways to God, along with mind (yoga) and body (fakir).

In fact, the three stages of Orthodox²² spiritual progress are identical to Evola's:

1. Purification
2. Illumination
3. Theosis (becoming One with God)

Some traditions (such as the Catholic, and, like Gurdjieff) combined elements of all three major Axial hearth paths into one, with ritual for the body, contemplation for the mind, and prayer or discipline centered in the heart. Bonaventura's²³ *Itinerarium Mentis ad Deum* can be seen as such a permutation, for his times. With Bonaventura, the emphasis is on the mind but blended with a spirituality that is not bookish, but open for any who will make the attempt.

²⁰<http://cdacruz.wordpress.com/2009/10/08/opus-magicum-fire/>

²¹<http://www.kesdjan.com/exercises/intro.html>

²²http://www.pelagia.org/htm/b05.en.the_illness_and_cure_of_the_soul.00.htm

²³<http://www.franciscan-archive.org/bonaventura/opera/bon05295.html>

It is likely that Augustinianism, and probably that form as it expresses itself particularly and peculiarly strongly in Christianity, will remain a major attempt by humanity to attain true transcendence. Above and beyond that, it is a developed resource or *upaya* used by Heaven to orient man towards the Good. Although it often becomes little more than “Platonism for the masses” and tends to slide towards the Scylla & Charybdis of syncretism or fundamentalism, a little bit of familiarity with other heart-traditions, or with blended traditions, can begin to assist the mind and body in developing along with the heart, and also open possibilities for improvisation to attain the same end. *We can see that men’s experience of the transcendent is one thing, their interpretation often another.* Far from being an inevitable dead-end for fundamentalists or syncretists, the Heart-Path may offer opportunities for new growth and combinations which enhance old patterns enough to make them live again.

The dangers and ugliness potential in such an approach is obvious. The benefits are not quite so plain to see – yoga remains an attraction to many hip “seekers” in the West dissatisfied with spirituality. A heart-path inside a tradition gave some guarantee that seekers would not mistake the Non-being which was real and out of which they were called into existence for God Himself. It gathered energies and potentials for a future consummation.

Mircea Eliade makes the same point in *The Secret of Dr. Honigsberger*, when he has a character remark that asceticism (associated with the heart’s ability to reign in the body) is necessary before passing to the other side, not for its own sake, but because the individuality will be exposed without preparation to an entirely unfamiliar world in which it could be lost or destroyed. This was also the basis of much of the advice given in the *Philokalia* about ignoring visions and so forth.

Evola himself was well versed in Catholic dogma, and it seems to have given his mind a cast or mold which served him well both in subtlety, persistence, and also as a defense against the chaotic possibilities which

so many encounter as they awaken to the interior life. His awareness of this may well be the basis of his appreciation for what was good in Augustine and the tradition which he founded.

Posted on 2011-04-30 by Logres

* * *

Perennial on 2011-04-30 at 01:46 said:

I personally have my reservations about using St. Augustine a guide, however great a saint he was. St. Augustine had a certain dualistic attitude about the universe, which fits poorly with the holistic model of Tradition. I personally find St. Thomas more consistant and systemic, and therefore more reliable a traditional model, than St. Augustine.

Logres on 2011-04-30 at 22:11 said:

Am reliably told that George Heart's *Christianity: Dogmatic Faith & Gnostic Vivifying Knowledge* has a sympathetic take on Augustine & his relation to Clement. The only problem with Aquinas is that he seems to take a very abstract, ratiocinated approach to the knowledge of God (as opposed, to say, Bonaventura). A lot of people want to get back to Aquinas, yet somehow the whole thing never gets anywhere. Eager to learn more...

Perennial on 2011-05-01 at 03:06 said:

I believe it is probably more difficult to get back to St. Thomas, more so than St. Augustine, because few of us are taught to think on a level where Thomism would be comfortable discourse. In contrast, I think most people can understand St. Augustine and his pathos, and therefore it makes his way seem more palatable. In seeking a higher path, however, I think St. Thomas would be a better model.

Cologero on 2011-05-04 at 07:26 said:

Albert Gleizes makes the claim that Plotinus, Augustine, and Boethius are the intellectual founders of the Middle Ages, a thought which we cannot develop in a comment. (What dualistic attitude?) Yet it is clear that Aquinas is inconceivable without Augustine. Augustine's understanding of the Ideas as existing in the Divine mind and his insight that the Logos described by John is the Logos of the Greeks, recognized interiorly tie him to Tradition.

Augustine saves Aquinas from Aristotle's betrayal of Plato, as Aquinas – pace Aristotle, and following Augustine – holds to the ontological priority of ideas over things. Unfortunately, without that, Aquinas leads to nominalism, rationalism and the modern world.

Interestingly, the Thomist Maritain, *en passant*, lists Aristotle, Aquinas and Shankara as his model metaphysicians. However, no one since has been willing or able to integrate Shankara with Thomism. I can only hope that the man who will do that effectively has already been born.

1.4 Progenitors of Our Middle Earth

Since men become happy by acquiring happiness, and since happiness is divinity itself, it follows that men become happy by acquiring divinity. For as men become just by acquiring integrity, and wise by acquiring wisdom, so they must in a similar way become gods by acquiring divinity. Thus everyone who is happy is a god and, although it is true that God is one by nature, still there may be many gods by participation.

BOETHIUS

Plato, Proclus & Plotinus conceived and generated the idea of a society held together by the invisible beauty of a higher world, not dependent (strictly) upon the gods nor the accidents of Nature nor the will of man, but upon the rational soul which was immortal. This “soul” was actually equivalent to “spirit” because it was conceived not as a product of Mother Nature which was unfree by virtue of birth and controlled through the process of *mimesis*, but was rational in the sense that it could reach up and out to the Good. When the ancients said “immortal”, they predicated divinity.

An interesting fact is that, at the beginning of Christianity, the existence of these three entities in man – body, soul and Spirit – was upheld. Saint Paul, for example, accepted this, Saint Augustine as well. Later it was lost through the councils and decisions of the pope and the roman church. It remained as it is known to us now: body and soul. Now it would appear that the soul is the

only divine thing within man and that there is nothing else. What happened to the Spirit? It has disappeared. It is striking that it has happened this way.²⁴

This was the basis of Plato's war against "poetry" – it was a war against the process of naked mimesis²⁵.

Whatever the cause, man had been chained to his "matrix", and Plato's revolution was against this cycle. Plotinus and Proclus took up this theme, which had a culmination and reflection religiously in the *Therapeutae*²⁶ movement in Egypt, which gave the West monasticism, and also planted seeds of this thought in the very far West, appearing again in John Scotus Erigena²⁷.

Boethius picked up the Platonic theme and virtually transformed it. It was his version of it, in his "golden volume not unworthy of Tully or Plato", which was almost all that the Middle Ages would know of ancient philosophy and which they took as a new beginning, along with Augustine, who also transformed Platonism by situating the "Ideas" in the mind of God. This situating of the Ideas would also mutually transform "God" – God became more than Zeus, and even more than the Logos.

Victor Watts remarks in his introduction to *Consolation of Philosophy*:

Chapter 6 marks the end of Socratic dialogue and rhetorical embellishment, the end of Boethius' dependence on Plato and the advance to a higher plane of argument, viz. the exposition of the two aspects of history as Providence – the simple unchanging

²⁴<http://www.theforbiddenreligion.com/>

²⁵http://www.dandelion-books.com/support-files/rediscovering_plato_excerpt.pdf

²⁶<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Therapeutae>

²⁷<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/scottus-erigena/>

plan in the mind of God – and Fate – the ever changing distribution in and through time of all the events God has planned in His simplicity. Boethius appears to have combined two ideas; the idea of a mutable Fate governing and revolving all things, which he read of in the treatise *On Providence and Fate* by the 5th century Neoplatonist Proclus, and the idea, already touched on at the end of Book III chapter 12, of God as the “still turning point of the world”, and idea he found in the philosophy of Plotinus. The more the soul frees itself from corporeal things, and thus, according to both Proclus and Plotinus, from Fate, the closer it approaches the stability and simplicity of the place of rest in the centre, which according to Plotinus is God, the hinge of things, or Providence, the source of freedom and consolation for Boethius.

This is the thought, that here, Love & Fate are one, and neither is purely itself, since both are raised to a consummated height. We are close (here) to the idea of Dante that it is Love that moves the fateful stars. This “syncretism” or synthesizing represented the finest philosophical or exoteric exteriorization that was possible without loss, a transmutation of all that was noblest in the Dark Ages. It knows nothing of splits and dualities, but seeks the common essence, in order to be “carried away”. CS Lewis’ extended essay *The Discarded Image*, which deals with the medieval “worldview” devotes 15 pages to Boethius. “Until about 200 years ago, it would have been hard to find an educated man in Europe who did not love it,” he says. To become familiar with him, is to become “naturalized” to the Middle Ages. “In his account of creation, he is closer to *Timaeus* than the Scriptures”. Boethius has an intimacy of approach, a prayerful approach, which is missing in Plato (who needs a *tertium quid* perpetually), but the base ideas breath the same spirit, and are not frayed genetically, but enhanced.

JAK Thompson, professor emeritus of Classics at King’s College till 1959, remarks that it wasn’t so much Boethius creating the Middle

Ages, as Stoics and Neo-Platonism influencing the Middle Ages through him, and not in a mechanical, but a “very fine way”. Lewis thought that Boethius’ image of eternity through moving time was actually an eloquent, sophisticated improvement on the theory of Plato. In fact, Lewis went so far as to claim that Platonism had an “unfortunate” degree of influence on the medieval worldview, though he equivocates elsewhere in stating that there was a subtle slight disharmony between the apparently compatible positions.

Arguably, the Middle Ages had virtually nothing of Plato, yet seemed to have imbibed the “one thing necessary” from his breath. When Aristotle made his appearance, the debate over universals becomes possible, and we enter an “exteriorization” phase.

During the first part of the Middle Ages, Platonic and neo-Platonic influences dominated philosophical thinking. “Plato himself does not appear at all, but Platonism is everywhere,” as Gilson has said. (Gilson 1955, p. 144.²⁸) This situation prevailed until the recovery of Aristotle in the twelfth and thirteenth centuries. Hence, even though it is sometimes still done, it is quite wrong to think of medieval philosophy as mainly just a matter of warmed-over commentaries on Aristotle. For most of the Middle Ages by far, Aristotle was of decidedly secondary importance. This of course is not to deny that when Aristotle did come to dominate, he was *very* dominant indeed and his influence was immense.²⁹

I do not wish to disparage Aquinas, but it seems to me that there is something very “unmedieval” about most of his *Summa*, which does not rely on the immediate perception of God in the same way that (for

²⁸<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/medieval-philosophy/notes.html#11>

²⁹<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/medieval-philosophy/#AvailabilityOfGreekTexts>

example) Bonaventura does in *Itinerarium Mentis ad Deum*, but rather proceeds by way of a dialectic stripped of daemonic overtones, and hence, of the “inspiration” which had begun to guide Plato and Socrates. We begin (here) to be concerned about meta-linguistic rules and syllogisms. This may be more a matter of how he is read, but the tendency is there.

Certainly, it is easy to quarrel with Boethius’ presentation of logic, just as it is easy to quarrel with Plato’s presentation of Socrates. But the Middle Ages did not die because of Progress or Necessity or even scholastic nominalism. They did not die because the West lost its “soul” – Victorian English had an abundance of such. Westerners had lost their “spirit” which Augustine, Boethius, Paul, and Plato all breathed and shared. In fact, they had lost almost any spirit at all. It will be necessary, to change this, to breath that spirit again, which recognizes that “the longing is not less, and the Good is not gone”, that there is “a spirit in man which answers God”, which is not subsumed or obliterated in a sea of emotion religious or otherwise, but rather is manifested or revealed. This, of course is the medieval doctrine – “Grace does not eradicate, but perfects Nature”.

Posted on 2011-05-06 by Logres

1.5 Exit the Cave

Plato³⁰:

In the *Theaetetus*, Socrates asks: “How can you determine whether at this moment we are sleeping, and all our thoughts are a dream; or whether we are awake, and talking to one another in the waking state?”

Theaetetus: “Indeed, Socrates, I do not know how to prove the one any more than the other, for in both cases the facts precisely correspond; and there is no difficulty in supposing that

³⁰https://www.hermes-press.com/life_awakening.htm

during all this discussion we have been talking to one another in a dream; and when in a dream we seem to be narrating dreams, the resemblance of the two states is quite astonishing.”

Socrates: “You see, then, that a doubt about the reality of sense is easily raised, since there may even be a doubt whether we are awake or in a dream. And as our time is equally divided between sleeping and waking, in either sphere of existence the soul contends that the thoughts which are present to our minds at the time are true; and during one half of our lives we affirm the truth of the one, and, during the other half, of the other; and are equally confident of both.”

The Church:

For this reason it says, “Awake, sleeper, And arise from the dead,
And Christ will shine on you.”

EPHESIANS 5:14

Evola³¹:

The sacred and the divine are matters of faith. This is the truth which has been imposed on Europe of late. Our truth is otherwise: it is better to know that we don’t know rather than to believe. In the contemporary mentality, there is a central point at which the attitudes of materialistic science and religion meet: in an identical renunciation, in an identical pessimism, in an identical agnosticism about the spiritual, declared and methodical in one case, veiled in the other. The premise of materialistic science is basically that science—in the sense of real, positive and empirical knowledge—can only subsist in what is physical; and that in the non-physical there can be no science, so that the scientific

³¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/PaganImperialism/ThoseWhoKnow.htm>

method neglects it and abandons it, by lack of authority, to belief, to the dull and arbitrary abstractions of philosophy, or to the “exigencies” of sentiment and morality. In addition, religion, insofar as it is focused exclusively on faith and does not admit an esoteric initiatory teaching beyond the profane religion imposed on the masses, or a gnosis beyond pious superstition, ends up with the same renunciation. In fact, one believes only when one does not know and thinks one cannot know. Hence, there is again the same agnosticism of the “positivists” with respect to whatever is not material and gross reality.

The first step is a sort of “waking up” – Evola was writing after centuries of accretion and decay, in the dawn of the modern era, and he saw how faith (*pistis*) separated from knowledge (*gnosis*) would simply be another form of numbness or deadness to what is real.

Traditionalists of every stripe, as well as conservatives, wish to “stem the tide”, either politically or culturally or theologically. Evola draws attention to their errors in an essay³² on Junger’s work:

The merit of Jünger in that first phase of his thought is that he had recognized the fatal error of those who think that everything may be brought back to order, that this new menacing world, ever advancing, may be subdued or held on the basis of the vision of life of the values of the proceeding age, that is to say of bourgeois civilization. If a spiritual catastrophe is to be averted modern man must make himself capable of developing his own being in a higher dimension – and it is in this connexion that Jünger had announced the above-mentioned watchword of “heroic realism” and pointed out the ideal of the “absolute person,” capable of measuring himself with elementary forces, capable of seizing the highest meaning of existence in the most destructive experiences,

³²<http://www.new-antaios.net/2011/04/julius-evola-on-ernst-junge-r-east-and-west-%E2%80%93-the-gordian-knot/>

in those actions wherein the human individual no longer counts... Now it is important to point out that wherever forces belonging to the first of the three domains emerge and break forth, only the possibilities of the third domain can really face them. Any attempt to stem on the basis of forces and values of the intermediate zone can only be precarious, provisional and relative.

Evola's observations could be equally taken to apply in the cultural or religious sphere, as well as political, perhaps even more so. The "answer" to the "Decline of the West" can only come in the form of regeneration for the person or individual, outside of all structure if need be, church or state. In contrast to the seamless teaching of ancient wisdom (which continued in some consciousness down through our own day, as Evola attempted to enumerate), the modern solution is very much in the spirit of Kant, who "destroyed knowledge in order to make room for faith". Rather than oppose the *Zeitgeist*, it divinizes it.

One doesn't have to have the insight of B. Mouravieff to see that the *Zeitgeist* is in some sense "winning". As Rosenstock-Huessy notes, the modern world has melted everything but the atomistic individual and the Leviathan state. We cannot regenerate the Beast. At least, we do not start there. It is the individual who must "skillfully use" (and be "skillfully used"). The era of the individual is here:

Today we are living through the agonies of transition to the third epoch. We have yet to establish Man, the great singular of humanity, in one household, over the plurality of races, classes, and age groups. This will be the center of struggle in the future. They pose the questions the Third Millennium will have to answer... the State is on the defensive because it is inadequate for the needs of the coming age. The theme of future history will be not territorial nor political, but social...

Huessy's³³ sequence ran:

³³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Eugen_Rosenstock-Huessy

1. The Christianization of Europe/Romanization of the Church
2. The Papal Revolution 11th-13th century, where the Church destroys the yoke of State
3. Protestant Reformation
4. The Enlightenment

Huessy's flawed prophecy lacked any answer, but he saw what was upon us-

"Say neither it is blessed, nor it is cursed, but only 'it is here' ... "

What we see now is a desperate confusion, very far indeed from the harmony of true sight into Reality, which was creative, synthesizing, and eclectic, and managed to reconcile both Athens & Jerusalem.

As Gornahoor has noted, reinventing *ad hoc* answers or worldviews (in the modern jargon, "critical studies") is essentially more of the problem, not a solution. It is not "riding the tiger". It is watching the shadows of the puppets on the wall, and convincing others to do the same, while pretending that one is not in a cave, and that this is all that there is.

The "excluded middle" of partial ignorance does not exist in this atmosphere either. As conservative inability to mount opposition (either externally or internally) becomes more clear, there will become more people convinced that radical regeneration along ancient lines is the only possible exit from the Cave.

Posted on 2011-05-20 by Logres

1.6 Two Gnosticisms

Evola remarks in his essay on Steiner³⁴ that Theosophy is actually a counterfeit doctrine. That is, the validity is true insofar as it goes, but the practical effect is actually to blunt the true dogma which it vaguely apprehends.

³⁴<https://gornahoor.net/library/KarmaAndReincarnation.pdf>

Thus, modern “reincarnation” belief actually tends to inhibit the stark clarity which alone makes possible the choice between perdition and salvation, devolving (therefore) naturally to perdition. Here, as always, Evola speaks as a man who can discern without error the practical effects of abstraction. In another context, this might be known as a “spiritual gift”:

In fact, according to the Theosophical views, the “gods” and the adepts would be beings who had gone further ahead in “evolution”; the animals, “our younger brothers”, less “advanced”. But it will be a question of time: everyone will reach the door, those who are further ahead “sacrificing themselves” for the others; and the varieties of karma will have served only as instrument to “universal progress”. As is clear, all that can only be considered as a digressing and distorted addition of Theosophy to the authentic notion of karma. It should therefore not cause surprise if this notion often passes from the plane of a transcendental realism to a more or less Philistine moralism, becoming a type of sword of Damocles suspended over the head of whoever does not conform himself to the “laws of evolution” and to the related altruistic, humanistic, egalitarian, vegetarian, feminist, etc. corollaries professed by the movement. With that, even the practical value, the liberating potentiality of this teaching, which we already mentioned, must be lost completely.

This astounding claim hits very close to home for the “modern” person, whether New Age or Christian. Evola is essentially claiming that a counterfeit is actually worse than something (or anything) else, because an anti-Christ pretends or masquerades, blotting out and often discrediting the real article. Christ had a particular aversion to Pharisees, as to those who camp in front of the narrow door, with their backs to it, not intending to enter. The reason is simple — it blocks the door.

Something similar happens in most versions of Christian universalism and modern Gnosticism and even in Western political history, processes which (like DNA) fray as they replicate until the original point is lost, and all hope of gaining truth or transcendence from the teaching has been vampirized.

Any religion, myth, story, government, family, narrative or group can serve the function of passing on a shabby truth whose point is forgotten — this is no exclusive monopoly of the Catholic Church. It comes to pass that in the age of clay mixed with iron at the feet of King Nebuchadnezzar's statue, the atomistic individual is drawn face to face with inescapable questions about the true nature of the self, if he can see them. How can the Westerner see it?

To quote Rosenstock-Huessy³⁵ once more, we find him proclaiming the era of the individual:

Today we are living through the agonies of transition to the third epoch. We have yet to establish Man, the great singular of humanity, in one household, over the plurality of races, classes, and age groups. This will be the center of struggle in the future. They pose the questions the Third Millennium will have to answer... the State is on the defensive because it is inadequate for the needs of the coming age. The theme of future history will be not territorial nor political, but social.

Besides suggesting that we contract space and lengthen time (in opposition to the two modern tendencies to do the opposite), Huessy had few answers, only observations. Like most moderns, he had neglected Plato. Modernism is a "hell" of conflicting bodies.

Guenon and Evola and others have noted the "relativity" of the heavenly pattern as it relates to times and places, in which Heaven utilizes

³⁵http://www.argobooks.org/english/the_christian_future.html

upaya or skillful means to bring about the desired result to oppose chaos, lifting man out of his natural fate, even in the West³⁶:

But according to Anthony, only the rational man is in union with God (or *Nous* in Platonic or Aristotelian terms), *and reason is not at all common to all men*. Obviously, the modernist project of deriving human dignity from material and biological considerations has failed (it is unreasonable), with the resulting loss of cohesiveness in Western societies. So, if biologism cannot justify egalitarianism, then neither can Christianity, since full human dignity may only be virtual. Another way of putting it is to say that although in essence there may be a common divinity in men, it is not necessarily so in existence.

In a certain sense, materialism can be taken as a true condemnation of the futility of living purely empirically – man is, as the atheist argued, “a sack of protein and amino acid”. At its root, this is what Evola teaches – without self-realization, the purely sensual human animal is condemned to undergo the “hells”.

The teachings of Mouravieff are especially clear on this point, and his argument is that this was the original understanding of the Faith. As explained by George Heart (*Dogmatic Faith & Gnostic Vivifying Knowledge*):

The belief that salvation can only occur after death in a nebulous paradise of some sort, is according to us a mortal error. Salvation is to be realized after a long and unceasing strife against sin – properly understood – on Earth and inside our physical bodies... it is (elsewhere) vaguely insinuated that a pious life on earth will save man’s soul... (But) the mortal soul has to be integrated into the immortal soul – not directly to God – by means of a complex process of purification and sublimation. Salvation is the outcome of

³⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1224>

Man's unceasing, conscious and voluntary efforts... such is the meaning, necessity, and goal of the triple (tripartate) structure of man in Saint Paul. Let the dead (that is to say those in whom the mortal soul is still attached to the physical body) bury their dead.

You will also note here the agreement with Evola as to the possible danger of assimilating to something that is “less than” the true individual, which can occur in some varieties of mysticism. Mouraveiff further taught that reincarnation was “true” in the sense that man himself is an incomplete being – he comes into existence when pre-existent divine sparks are united with psychic bodies that assume physical forms. Thus, the real “man” is not re-incarnating, only the imperishable spirit, which will attempt (again) to attain salvation. Salvation as popularly understood in an exoteric sense therefore occurs when the body, soul, and spirit are united under the spirit, which is called “The Kingdom of God”. This complex process explains many of the vagaries, seeming contradictions, and deeper similarities among the great traditions.

In the Christian tradition the *pleroma* of Love is the falling away (maturing) of faith and hope as the fullness of Being is attained in this union inside of man, which puts man back as a judge over angels, and into the son-ship and daughter-hood of God. The uniqueness of Christ perfects paganism, but does not threaten it.

There is more than “rapport” here between Christianity in its purest form and traditionalism, there is almost total agreement. The modern Christian is generally “concerned” with the here & now, and separates this from the “afterlife” *in order to avoid this inconvenient duty of saving himself*. Here is Nicholas Gomez Davila³⁷ –

Concerning himself intensely with his neighbor's condition allows the Christian to dissimulate to himself his doubts about the

³⁷<http://don-colacho.blogspot.com/>

divinity of Christ and the existence of God. Charity can be the most subtle form of apostasy.

The Church should not be judged by its popular or populated forms, anymore than the New Age should be allowed to discredit Eastern tradition. The essential affinities between Evola's thought on salvation and reincarnation and Mouravieff's publication of what he argued was the esoteric "pearl" preserved within the Church, bear witness that Western tradition can be harmonized.

Posted on 2011-05-27 by Logres

1.7 NeoPlatonism & the Faith

Briefly put, the purpose of this whole work the Divine Comedy as well as its parts is to remove those living in this present state of life from misery and to lead them all the way to happiness. The kind of philosophy under which we proceed here both in whole and in part is the business of morals or ethics, since both the part and the whole are composed for practice rather than theory. But if in some place or passage things are lengthened out in the manner of theory, this is not for the purpose of theory, but of practice; for, as the Philosopher says in the second book of Metaphysics: "practical men theorize now and again."

DANTE

John Scotus Erigena was condemned posthumously by the Church, much like another John, John Philoponus. Both of these thinkers gravitated towards Greek philosophy, particularly Plato, though Philoponus

was more eclectic and Erigena more overtly Platonic. In the sixth century, Justinian appointed John Philoponus³⁸ to resolve the schisms in the Church. His work was shoved aside after it was completed:

I believe that Philoponus understood the infinity of the void as filled with a structure the extension of which was not the same as matter or energy in its particular place. It may be understood in theory as that dimension of the cosmos in which the universal and the singular are composed of one another without logical contradiction. It was in this sense a servant of the Lord God, the Creator of a world in which He was free to enter into as a man. Do not concepts like these help us to understand the dynamic definition he sought for when he wrote his argument for the divine and human person of Jesus Christ.

This exposition is similar to the defense of the distinction between *Meon* and *Pleroma* attempted by Gornahoor here³⁹

God uses the Void (possibility?) to rule what is actualized. It is important to understand the invisible structure of Reality, because many experimenters or unwitting visitants (everyone, after death) get lost because of lack of renunciation & knowledge. In Christ the Eternal Tao⁴⁰ Hieromonk Damascene notes that the existence of non-being (*Meon*) is real, and has been mistaken by many Western drug practitioners and others to be identical with God Himself, leading to unfortunate results. What seem to be trifles (such as the debate between universalism and nominalism via Occam) often are hinges upon which enormous cultural and metaphysical changes are leveraged. Philoponnus offered not only a truly “Greek” way of understanding the *homo ouisos* of the Creed so as

³⁸<http://www.quodlibet.net/articles/mckenna-arbiter.shtml>

³⁹<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-void-and-the-fullness-are-indissolubly-bound>

⁴⁰<http://www.amazon.com/Christ-Eternal-Tao-Hieromonk-Damascene/dp/0938635859>

to reconcile the Oriental Churches with the Orthodox, but also a metaphysic of reality which was in keeping with Plato.

The influence of Erigena was also enormous, even after the condemnations by the keepers of pristine rectitude – here is Nicholas of Cusa⁴¹:

I say “creates” inasmuch as this spirit makes the conceptual likenesses of things from no other thing—even as the Spirit which is God makes the quiddities of things not from another, but from itself, i.e., from Not-other. And so, just as the Divine Spirit is not other than any creatable thing, so neither is the mind other than anything understandable by it.

What is interesting about Erigena is that he (also) shares the conception of something beyond Nature out of which Nature “stands”, and from which Nature can be ruled. This is the basic super-naturalism which offers the possibility for metaphysics. The root of this transference between Plato and “the Christians” can be posited to lie in Pseudo-Dionysius⁴², arguably either the lone philosopher convert whom St. Paul made at Mars Hills in Athens, or a student of Origen’s at Alexandria.

As we often see in history, the origins of revelation often lie in the East, but their manifestation tends to appear in the West: “Westward the star of Empire makes its way”. Thus, Erigena’s philosophy represents an entirely faithful, yet more articulated and emphasized (and also simultaneously “pared down”) version of esotericism. Thus in the Periphyseon⁴³, Nature has four phases:

- i. That which creates and is not created (God’s essence)

⁴¹http://classics.dal.ca/Files/Eriugena_Philosophy_in_Heaven_ACA.pdf

⁴²<http://www.reversespins.com/dionysius.html>

⁴³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/De_divisione_naturae

2. *That which is created and creates (the world of Forms, or God's Ideas, as well as Spirit)*
3. *That which is created and does not create (physical reality)*
4. *That which neither is created nor creates (the Void?)*

It is easy to see how the Church was made uncomfortable by this, and easy to predict the response. Until Hegel⁴⁴ (who also veiled his esoteric side), Erigena's influence (as we have seen in Cusa, but in others like St. Victor), remains underground, and instead the Church gravitates towards Pseudo-Dionysius in the architectural movement of the Gothic, which arguably included elements of the Templic Order. In other words, the Church has been continuously challenged, repelled, and shaken by the mysticism which it has tried to "contain" within it, but which would have ceased to be real esotericism had it acquiesced in this containment entirely.

It might behoove theologians to return to Philoponus and the Alexandrians, before the split which rendered esotericism an entirely encrypted or underground "manifestation" which dared not be "originating" in an open manner, but which had to be either sublimated into something like the Grail Mythos or "ab-original" in a purely philosophical or hidden manner.

By terrible and beautiful contrast, Dante the poet could still embody both orthodoxy and esotericism in his greatest work, and this high burning unification was brought about partly due to his emphasis on *practice*. But then, Dante was a champion of the Guelph monarchy, a bearer of gold, a singer of Apollo, an angel in the sun. Erigena and Philoponus might have understood the multi-leveled and complex layers of reality which could invoke such powers, because their metaphysics complemented

⁴⁴<http://www.marxists.org/reference/subject/philosophy/works/en/magee.htm>

their religion. One might even say that Neo-Platonism is Providentially intended to internally perfect the metaphysic inherent in the Faith.

(Dr Curran quoted Dante's "Epistle to Cangrande della Scala")

Posted on 2011-06-04 by Logres

1.8 Gold, Jupiter, & Wine

Gornahoor quotes Evola here⁴⁵, regarding the possibility of theurgy and true astrology:

In his *The Hermetic Tradition*, Julius Evola suggests that what he did for alchemy, needs to be done also for astrology and theurgy. This post is a possible beginning for whoever would like to take on that task.

One possibility is the use of Marcilio Ficino's writings, including his invaluable letters. Ficino was an ordained Catholic priest, living in Florence during the times of Savaranola, before the Reformation. He could not possibly be expected to be plain & forthright in the same manner in which Evola could afford to be, or Steiner. As Gornahoor has emphasized, *practice* is paramount, and so most esoteric teachers (including St. Paul) have not bothered to be completely perspicacious; add Ficino's context, & many of his comments and thoughts become powerfully tendentious.

Ficino believed himself to be born under the sign of Saturn, yet what he meant by this (and he wrote against the literal astrologers) was not that he was doomed to one Fate or the other, but that Saturn would resist him should he attempt to live a complacent life, and would aid him should he choose to follow contemplation and scholarship.

Anyone who has listened to Gustav Holst's *The Planets* (particularly Jupiter)⁴⁶ should appreciate the Pythagorean connections Ficino makes

⁴⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2377>

⁴⁶<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nz0b4STz1lo>

between the seven important planets, the seven notes of the chromatic scale, and the seven colors of the rainbow. Ficino believed that Creation had implanted correspondences or seminal influences in the universe which were not only real, not only discernible, not only operative on a rational scale, but in final goal (and perhaps also the art of working) responded and resonated with the human spirit. Thus, there is a connection between the element gold, the planet Jupiter, and the liquid wine. In the animal kingdom, the lion would correspond, or manifest the same spiritual influence, which was revealing itself at various levels and in various kingdoms. Among trees, one could choose the oak. The proper arrangement of such could generate a resonance of the “cosmic Lyre”, of which man was the crux:

Now fiery things aid the attractive power, earthy things the retentive power, airy the digestive, and watery the expulsive... imitate so far as is possible the action of the heavens. But if you can pass through larger spaces in your motion, you will thereby imitate the heavens all the more, & will get into contact with more the strength of the celestials, which are diffused everywhere.

Ficino’s influence here was enormous, because flowing out from the Renaissance, the science of good magic (as opposed to profane, or black, magic) bloomed all over Europe, though separating itself from “divine matters”. With Ficino, it was all one stream of knowledge. Ficino distinguished within “idolatry” between false worship of (say) the literal sun, and the worship of the super-celestial Sun through the regard paid to the influence of the literal one. This distinction could be made because

The parts and members of this huge creature the World, I mean all the bodies that are in it, do in good neighborhood as it were, lend and borrow each others Nature; for by reason that they are linked in one common bond, therefore they have love in common; and by force of this common love, there is among them a common

attraction, or tilling of one of them to another. And this indeed is Magick⁴⁷.

This doctrine is the logical development of Neo-Platonism as read by Ficino; it is implied once Augustine places the Ideas in the mind of God.

Ficino invoked *Cosmos* in the old Orphic hymn:

O heavens, creator of all things, unconquerable part of the Cosmos, of ancient and venerable origin, beginning and end of all things. O Cosmos, father who illuminates the earth's sphere with its spherical movement, the home of the blessed, turning in a revolving motion. Cosmos, heavenly and earthly, guardian and custodian of all things, encircling the whole, holding in your breast the invincible necessity of Nature, red-eyed, untamed, many-formed, diversifying the universe, all-powerful father of Time, most excellent, blessed daemon. Cosmos, hear our prayers, and grant a quiet life to a pious youth.

This invocation at the noon hour, with the music of the lyre, was followed by the making of his fortune, as he received Medici's letter guaranteeing his pension. It enabled him to translate (among other things) Plotinus, Plato, and the *Corpus Hermeticum* (which was brought from Macedonia by an unknown monk to the court of the Medici).

By arranging certain things together, including music, work, & the elements, one could induce spiritual states which were favorable to Fortune's favorable winds. This was not "magic" as commonly understood, but rather, "understanding the times" in a very personal sense. Rather than abrogating free will in any way, it would indicate the manner in which possibilities might be encouraged to unfold.

Or again, as Dante had it, "here, Fate and Love are one" – the force that rules the Stars moves the heart.

⁴⁷<http://homepages.tscnet.com/omard1/jportat5.html>

“Far greater than the heavens is he who made you, Lorenzo, & you yourself will be greater than the heavens as soon as you resolve upon the task. For those celestial bodies are not to be sought by us outside in some other place; for the heavens in their entirety are within us, in whom the light of life and the origin of heaven dwell.”

Ficino believed that the work of Plotinus, Iamblichus, Plato, and others were given by God to help elucidate, secretly, the seeds of the Gospel mystery contained in Scripture. Because God had made the world one way, and not another, and because it had to be so by reason and His nature, man’s reason for existence was to re-unite Godhead and that over which dominion was given.

How did this transpire?

For the spirit is an intermediary between the gross body of the world and its soul. For whether the world’s body or mundane things have their being directly from the world’s soul (as Plotinus & Porphyry think) or whether the world’s body just like its soul has its being directly from God, as is the opinion of our theologians and perhaps Timaeus the Pythagorean, the world does wholly live and breathe, and we are permitted to absorb its spirit.

The gross is ruled by the subtle. Or, if you wish,

Plotinus & Avicenna then show that whatever terrestrial things come about on earth arise from the general concurrence of all the higher and lower causes at the same time.

Thus, true Science is possible, and idolatry is impossible, only when super-celestial things are primarily known.

Several Academy members, including Pico, died in suspicious circumstances during Ficino’s lifetime. Ficino walked a very tight rope, but

though others had denied the possibility of even symbolically understanding “the stars”, Ficino’s last work *The Book of the Sun* re-affirmed such. He was, in effect, another Plato without a suspicion towards art, and learned in Christian theology.

Celestial figures by their own motions dispose themselves for acting; for by their harmonious rays and motion penetrating everything, they daily influence our spirit secretly just as overpowering music does openly...

Nevertheless, the free will of man in the last instance presided over even these; small wonder, then, that it was no idolatry to “join” with them in the act of *adaequatio* or knowing, in which super-celestial good was perceived only through the literal figures, but without ignorant idolatry.

It is increased through the same power through which it was begun: it makes progress through the same power through which it was increased; and finally, it is perfected through the same power through which it made progress. hence our soul will sometime be able to become in a sense all things, and even to become God.

Posted on 2011-06-11 by Logres

1.9 Europe’s Spirit in the North

Gornahoor has deliberately underscored the “Russian connection”⁴⁸ for traditionalism in the previous century (and before). As if to emphasize such a connection explicitly “Romane”, the reception of Evola via Samizdat circles in the Soviet era demonstrates the resonance virtually all of his ideas⁴⁹ had with the ideas of those in Russia who were not linked with

⁴⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=334>

⁴⁹<http://www.amerika.org/tag/alexandre-douguine/>

the monarchy by tradition, but had “come into” it as part of the new Right.

This is all the more remarkable when one considers the circles that Evola kept. It also occurred in correlation with influence from Gurdjieff⁵⁰, because these certain individuals who basically lived in the Lenin Library were a “fourth way” group:

Stepanov, Golovin, Haydar Jamal, Yuri Mamleyev and Rovner were among those who for a few years “almost lived” in the Lenin Library, not only reading but also eating and—above all—talking there. They formed a small and very close Gurdjieff group—or, Rovner insists, a “company,” as its members were “too individualist” to form a group.

It was an offshoot of the Gurdjieff group which had assimilated Guenon’s corpus & eventually stumbled over Evola.

Of course, to the modern West, these persons are all lunatics⁵¹, and very prestigious individuals receive lots and lots of money to research them in order to expose their “rise to power”.

A debate between Aleksandr Dugin & a Brazilian interlocutor naturalized to the USA is quite revealing. In broken English⁵², Dugin attempts to convey his dismay and ultimate perspective on the liberal vs. conservative struggle for the soul of “America”:

It is obvious that modern Eastern societies have many negative aspects. But they are mostly the result of modernization,

⁵⁰<http://traditionalistblog.blogspot.com/2007/03/russian-traditionalism-started-with.html>

⁵¹http://ku-eichstaett.academia.edu/AndreasUmland/Papers/197791/Aleksandr_Dugins_Transformation_from_a_Lunatic_Fringe_Figure_into_a_Mainstream_Political_Publicist_19801998_A_Case_Study_in_the_Rise_of_Late_and_Post-Soviet_Russian_Fascism

⁵²<http://www.theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/275-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-iii.html>

westernization and the perversion of the ancient traditions. In my youth (early 80-s) I was anticommunist in the Guenonian/Evolian sense. But after having known modern Western Civilization and especially after the end of Communism *I have changed my mind* and revised this traditionalism discovering the other side of the socialist society, which is the parody on the true Tradition, but nevertheless is *much better than absolute absence* of the Tradition in Modern and Post-Modern Western world. So, I love the East in general and blame the West. The West now expands itself on the planet. So the globalization is Westernization and Americanization. Therefore, I invite all the rest to join the camp and fight Globalism, Modernity/Hypermodernity, Imperialism Yankee, liberalism, free market religion and unipolar world. These phenomena are the ultimate point of the Western path to the abyss, the final station of the evil and the almost transparent image of the antichrist/ad-dadjal/erev rav. So the West is the center of kali-yuga, its motor, its heart. *Mr. Carvalho blames the East and loves the West*. But here begins some asymmetry.

I love the East as a whole including its dark sides. The love is the strong, very strong feeling. You don't love only good and pure sides of the beloved one, you love him wholly. Only such love is real one. Mr. Carvalho loves the West but not all the West, only its part. The other part he rejects.

To explain his attitude in front of the East he makes appeal to the conspiracy theory. Scientifically it is inadmissible and discredits immediately Mr. Carvalho thesis but in this debate I don't think that scientific correctness is that does mean much. I don't try to please or convince somebody. I am interested only in the truth (*vincit omnia veritas*). If Mr. Carvalho prefers to make use of the conspiracy theory let him do it. The Western Christianity stressed the individual as the center of the religion and made the salvation the strictly individual affair.

The Protestantism led this tendency to the logical end.

Denying more and more the holistic ontology of the organic society the Western Christianity arrived with the Modernity to self-denial (deism, atheism, materialism, economism). French sociologist Luis Dumont in his excellent books *Essai sur l'Individualism* and *Homo Aequalis* shows that the methodological individualism is the result of the oblivion and direct purge by the Western scholastic of the early and original Greco-Roman theological tradition conserved intact in the Byzance and Eastern Church as whole... My opinion: American paleoconservatives, traditional American right are doomed. Their discourse is incoherent, weak and too idiosyncratic.

Dugin's politics may or may not be "proto-fascistic", & Carvalho may or may not have a good response, but Dugin certainly grasps the concept that love emanates from something other than a knee-jerk & shallow hatred of "the other" who disagrees over man's right to strip himself metaphysically.

The occurrence of so many threads in Russia is intriguing to those interested in "coincidences" and the course of Empires. If the star of the West has moved consistently Westward (and no less a secular scholar than Ortega y Gasset took such a theory seriously), it has crossed back into Asia from the Pacific (Gasset, by the way, thought that the disappearance of oak trees in Europe heralded something real and ominous). Russia may be the reconciliation point between the East & the West; Russia rather than China.

Homo Atlanticus, once more, is on the wane, even as he approaches his zenith. Holy Mother Russia unaccountably remains.

PA Sorokin, an emigre to America who founded Harvard's Sociology Department, used his cyclical view of history to locate the West:

Ideational truth is the truth revealed by the grace of God, though his mouthpieces (the prophets, mystics, and founders of religions),

disclosed in a supersensory way through mystic experience, direct revelation, divine intuition, and inspiration. Such a truth may be called the truth of faith. It is regarded as infallible, yielding adequate knowledge about the true-reality values. *Sensate truth* is the truth of the senses, obtained through our organs of sense perception.

He goes on to argue that *idealistic truth* is a synthesis of what is known by Faith & what is known by empirical experience. One could sharpen this insight⁵³ by pointing to the union of sense & faith in Evola's heightened metaphysical positivism, or magical realism. Such an *apotheosis* in the individual obviates the need to maintain the delicate balance between ideational truth and sensate experience; it (as it were) sets the individual outside of the cycles of time & space.

Russia, set as it is as a potential adjunct or anteroom of Europe, with access to all of her high culture, but straddling the waste places of Asia and the deserts of the East, above all living in the cold and the north, is admirably suited to become the arbiter of a Third Romanity. The continual wrestling match which this country has engaged Modernity & Enlightenment since inception augurs well for its future stars.

Mouravieff's explication of Peter the Great's providential role⁵⁴ in raising up Russia p.19 (as well as the importance of the Hellenic Orthodox world to universal history, along with speculations about China's future) are also important to keep in mind.

Posted on 2011-06-18 by Logres

* * *

Jason on 2011-06-30 at 20:12 said:

⁵³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1189>

⁵⁴http://www.bibliotecapleyades.net/archivos_pdf/mouravieff3.pdf

I'm surprised that no one on this site has yet mentioned Dmitri Merejkowski, his books are on the very same path that Gornahoor is treading. Basing himself on the *Stromata* of Clement, Merejkowski created a philosophical and aesthetic system that saw Paganism as Christianity before Christ and the pagan Gods as shadows of the coming Lord... ..

1.10 A Way Out, Further In

One of Evola's most prescient suggestions is that the modern aspirant towards transcendence should "ride the tiger" – the individual (or the person, but not the personality) should use the negative energies of the modern world to advance himself, until they are exhausted, for opposing them directly would invite destruction. There is an important qualification:

This restriction must be kept in mind. What I am about to say does *not* concern the ordinary man of our day. On the contrary, I have in mind the man who finds himself involved in today's world, even at its most problematic and paroxysmal points; yet he does not belong inwardly to such a world, nor will he give in to it. He feels himself, in essence, as belonging to a different race from that of the overwhelming majority of his contemporaries.

When one cannot find a way out, find one further in. At first glance, this is a seeming difficulty for the Christian, who is attuned to essentially reject the possibility of "utilizing" something lower to actualize something "higher". It smacks of Shelley-like Satanism. Gornahoor has addressed this more precisely here⁵⁵:

One can and one should, accept evil as the means of good; but one must never will it or do it, otherwise one would destroy with

⁵⁵<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/axioms-of-the-will-i>

one hand what one builds with the other. Good faith never justifies bad means; it corrects them when one undergoes them, and condemns them when one takes them. **COMMENTARY.** Evil increases the virtue of the wise but corrupts the weak.

One way to re-speak this (to the Christian) is that though ends don't justify means, yet means do not pardon ends either; so that what is called "moralizing" is often nothing but abdication of the entire moral sense of man at its root, whether it is "Christian" or not. Although might does not make right (since the gross is ruled by the subtle), neither does it follow that weakness makes right (Nietzsche's objection to the Faith, as expressed). "Force and justice rule the world; force, till right is ready" (M. Arnold, quoting Joubert). To think that weakness and victim-hood make right is to succumb to the lowest form of mental degradation possible (currently). Right makes right.

For all doing is shrouded in guilt, like the blaze of the flame in smoke.

Bhagavad-Gita (XVIII, 48b)

In this sense, all action in the world seems to fall afoul of evil's tincture. This is the reason for the ethical asceticism advocated by the *Bhagavad-Gita*: the true man (compelled to action) must do what is right, regardless of consequences⁵⁶, but not regardless of results.

Results are carefully calculated, but not for personal gain (or, one might add, even for personal "salvation"). It is here that Evola's remarks on Calvin⁵⁷ are relevant. Being willing to be damned for God's glory means being committed to ethical action in a total way that re-unites the

⁵⁶<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lq3zjTmVLbM>

⁵⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2194>

“afterlife” to this life. One begins to operate with reference to transcendence, of ways and means and also end. This was a way of exalting the moral sense in man without subjecting that sense to the ego. “Let God be true, though every man a liar”.

Or, “By patient continuance in well-doing, seeking for glory, honor, immortality...”

There is ultimately no conflict between the warrior & the saint. The cross, which is an inverted sword, once stood as the symbol of this.

One possible re-unifying thinker which could re-mediate between Christian ethics & perennial metaphysics is the Japanese Buddhist, Kukai⁵⁸. Kukai’s diagram for gnosis was

1. Freedom from bias
2. Insight into particulars
3. Improvisation towards enlightenment.

Like most perennialists, he placed the religious worldview below the metaphysical, but superior to the secular. Kukai’s work is a naturally magic bit of either one, & stands as an exemplar (for example, he argued that a “Triad” was at the root of reality, yet he maintains the hierarchy of metaphysic over “religion”).

Recently, venturing on such ground, the pope himself has directed Christian attention⁵⁹ towards P-Dionysius’ reworking of Proclus as a bridge towards Asia. There are some things to object to in the speech, but it is important because its aim is to conserve Proclus through Dionysius.

Apparently what Plato says and what great philosophy says about God is much more elevated, much more true; the Bible seems very “bárbara,” simple, precritical, we would say today. But

⁵⁸<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kukai/>

⁵⁹<http://www.zenit.org/article-22588?l=english>

he observes that precisely this is necessary so that we can thus understand that the most elevated concepts of God never reach his true greatness. They are always beneath him.

These images bring us to understand, in reality, that God is above every concept; in the simplicity of the images, we find more truth than in the great concepts. The face of God is our incapacity to truly express what he is. In this way he speaks — Pseudo-Dionysius himself says — of a “negative theology.” It is easier to say what God is not than to express what he really is. Only through these images can we grasp at his true face and, on the other hand, this face of God is very concrete: It is Jesus Christ. If Dionysius shows us, following Proclo, the harmony of the celestial choirs, in such a way that it seems that all of them depend on each other, it is true that our path toward God remains very far from him. Pseudo-Dionysius shows that in the end, the path to God is God himself, who makes himself close to us in Jesus Christ.

The pope’s essay touches upon the bitter wound or nub between the two – it is precisely this idea of reunion in God (or reabsorption into God) which is contested by traditionalism. I do not, however, see why perennialism could not accept the idea of exoteric, simple language as a manifestation of that which is beyond words.

It would certainly improve upon the Kantian idea that men are universally not merely equal, but *fungible*, which is to say, absolutely interchangeable. For the medieval imagination and the *prisca theologica*, as well as Evola, this is a grave and serious delusion, perhaps a prime one. The “Three Orders”⁶⁰ were once of those who fight, those who work, and those who pray. Evola speaks of “types” and Ortega y Gasset (a classic liberal) speaks of “qualitative man”. Many other cultured Europeans noted

⁶⁰http://www.wwnorton.com/college/english/nael/middleages/topic_1/aelfric.htm

the rise of “American man”⁶¹. As Gornahoor has argued⁶², the dividing line is the Middle Ages because after they were destroyed, the chain of being and the “orders” were obliterated.

Christianity’s temptation (and even tendency) is reduce everything to the lowest common denominator in the name of compassion. If we take a great yet flawed interpreter of Western history like Rosenstock-Huessy⁶³ in the modern era, we find him proclaiming the era of the individual:

Today we are living through the agonies of transition to the third epoch. We have yet to establish Man, the great singular of humanity, in one household, over the plurality of races, classes, and age groups. This will be the center of struggle in the future. They pose the questions the Third Millennium will have to answer... the State is on the defensive because it is inadequate for the needs of the coming age. The theme of future history will be not territorial nor political, but social...

Huessy’s sequence ran

1. The Christianization of Europe/Romanization of the Church
2. The Papal Revolution 11th-13th century, where the Church destroys the yoke of State
3. Protestant Reformation
4. The Enlightenment

⁶¹<http://www.scribd.com/doc/24545690/American-Civilisation-Julius-Evola>

⁶²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2244>

⁶³http://www.argobooks.org/english/the_christian_future.html

Huessy again profoundly incarnates the basic tension between perennialism & Christianity. To the perennialist, Christianity must always seem in danger of simply being turned inside out, & consequently, self-destroyed. Huessy fell into the trap of not perceiving that the “Zeitgeist” might not necessarily be the breath of the highest Being nor the pattern which was beyond Being. Another way of putting this is that being absorbed into the *Anima Mundi* **or even into what is perceived as “God”** may not be in accord with the true possibilities of the inner man.

Again, we are back to the argument over “absorption” into God. That, and that Perennialists are looking for something other than this “We” that is always thrown about in secular democracies.

Most important of all through this physical rebirth you are able to achieve the state of Vajradhara within one short lifetime in this degenerate age; otherwise it would take thee countless great aeons to achieve. Thus this rebirth is worth more than one thousand billion precious jewels.

PABONGKA RIMPOCHE

For the sake of this (the kingdom of God), Christians must therefore part ways with the likes of Augustine at times, though all manner of evil is said against us falsely for this (even by the Church):

Please notice carefully that in speaking of the good morals of some atheists, I have not attributed any real virtues to them. Their sobriety, their chastity, their probity, their contempt for riches, their zeal for the public good, their inclination to be helpful to their neighbor were not the effect of the love of God and tended neither to honor nor to glorify him. They themselves were the source and end of all this. Self-love was the basis, the boundaries, and the cause of it. These were all glittering sins, *splendida peccata*, as St. Augustine has said of all the fine actio of the pagans.

PIERRE BAYLE

And thus, we are back to the moralizing “we”. It would seem that the entire debate as it has ossified between Christianity & traditionalism could potentially be a “we”-argument dead end.

Given the historical examples of middle ground, and indeed either in the other’s camp, it should prove relatively easy to simply will the seemingly impossible reconciliation. If it is chosen to do so.

Continuing the argument at its highest levels and lowest roots (focusing specifically on the idea of “reabsorption”, with all the attendant assumptions about man’s ultimate fungibility or equation with all other men and indeed things) would seem to be an excellent place to begin.

The Christian should begin the exercise by meditating on what the possible meaning of this riddle is: Why does Christ never speak of Yahweh/Jehovah, but only of His “Father”?

And why did the “religion” of Christ not begin until after his triumph over death?

Finally, why does Christ come at the end of time, not “re-absorbed” into God, but giving all back, & riding a horse of war, with a sword coming out of his mouth?

The servants of the secret fire⁶⁴ should stand together.

Posted on 2011-06-24 by Logres

* * *

Perennial on 2011-06-25 at 01:38 said:

Please elaborate on “absorption” into God. By this you surely do not mean Theosis, which it would seem is a separate concept.

Ismo on 2011-06-25 at 11:45 said:

⁶⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Secret_Fire

There is a small error in the first link: it works only if one removes the _One can -part from it. If the text is open to correction it would be a good idea to remove the flawed part from the end of the link.

As it comes to 'Shelley-like Satanism', in some sense this could be true, if one identifies 'Ha-Satan' with manifestation itself, with the 'bright face' of Shekinah. But this sort of 'Satanism' would be very far from the usual popular hedonistic, self-centred and materialistic satanism or from the descending path of counter-tradition of the 'awliya-ash-Shaitân'; it would be instead very close to the traditional 'left hand path', exalted and elaborated by Evola also in some connections, and suitable only for 'regal souls', or virya and kaula, in eastern terms. There are a growing number of people in today's world who identify themselves as 'satanists' or as 'left-hand-paths', but shun away from both of the first-mentioned blind alleys. In this sense the term could and may refer to western form of the left hand path and maybe even one of the signs of east and west coming together. Of course it is understandable that there's a lot of confusion and lower possibilities that need to be cleared away before this sort of satanism can be seen 'in traditional terms'. Still, let us not forget that Saturn is the god of the Golden Age.

Good article, by the way!

logres on 2011-06-25 at 11:48 said:

Yes, as I see it, perhaps the biggest sticking point between Christianity and traditionalism is precisely whether or not theosis is absorption or reabsorption into God. If it is not, then much of the difficulty between the two goes away, on the pagan side. The difficulty is that these are experiential concepts – it's not possible for me to arbitrate them (as I've not experienced it). However, in a tradition where there is less of a conflict between the nation and the Church (eg., Russia) figures existed/may exist who can arbitrate and tell one whether compassion is compatible with supreme individuality and survival. My understanding of traditionalism is that they will avoid (at all costs) compromising on the issue of absorption into God and forfeiting the "being beyond being". Isn't this what caused the difficulty for Evola?

Logres on 2011-06-25 at 11:56 said:

Thank you, it's fixed. "Satanism" is a misleading term (from my perspective) for the left-hand path. The "royal path" or alchemy (?) is a much friendlier Western phrasing. I came across a term for Crowley recently, which was "vulnerable master" – that is, someone who had managed to integrate to higher reality by bypassing the heart chakra entirely (being almost entirely Service-to-Self, like Genghis Khan for instance). This term notes that he has something to say, but has also lost something in the process. To Christianity, in general, this is the danger of the "left-hand" approach, although such characters as Ehud in the Old Testament embody it.

Ismo on 2011-06-25 at 15:40 said:

Yes, 'Satanism' has a bad ring to it as a term, because of numerous mis-interpretations and confusions, but I'm convinced that it cannot be completely disregarded the more further we approach the end of the cycle and the beginning of the new one, that many of those who are able and will 'ride the tiger' will identify themselves as satanists. As in basic kabbalistic terms Satan (or Saturn, Aima) represents 'the left hand of God', in this way satanism is a very correct term for the left-hand-path. Destructive? Yes. Evil? Not necessarily, if one is able to traverse the tree without giving in to the lowest possibilities and *transform the destructive tendencies into something positive and constructive* = to ride the tiger.

There are also many different sides to this issue that I cannot go into in this short post, but by delving into the nature of Metatron's cube and into the cubic form of 'the new Jerusalem', and comparing these symbolic issues into the saying of Jesus to Peter (Petrus = stone) "Upon you I will build my church", many things about the last two thousand years and about the history of the Catholic Church ("The Synagogue of Satan", as some have said about it) start to open up.

Shortly, I see this issue about the coming age of Fire and our transitional times in the following way: Nietzsche got a hunch of it but failed to understand it; Crowley got a big glimpse of it but failed to formulate it without errors, intentionally or not; Lavey (or Levy) brought – typically for a judaic soul – out the lowest possibilities of it; Evola formulated it into a coherent form. The rest is yet to come.

Logres on 2011-06-25 at 19:46 said:

I certainly accept that that which is Good in the Kali Yuga era (in spite of the era) will look "bad" to virtually everyone. The confusion is still so great on the ground that it's difficult to say much more. But the line of formulation laid out there through to Evola I basically accept, except Crowley troubles me somewhat. I think it does have something to do with the bypassing the heart chakra, which Evola does not do, as is evident in his essay on Crowley (he accepts what is worthwhile, ignores the rest). Crowley was also a great showman, as well as (in my opinion) definitely a "lower" type of man, even in his exaltation beyond the ego. I don't think that the Kali Yuga necessarily entails the arrival or dominance of this "type", although it certainly may entail the necessary understanding & use of them. These are just sketchy opinions.

Ismo on 2011-06-26 at 06:54 said:

Logres, I completely agree with you on Crowley. In many ways he had great potential and great theoretical knowledge at his disposal, but his personal charlatanism was quite repulsive and his writings leave a lot of room for very negative impulses in regard of spiritual development and not mere psychism. In this sense he can perhaps be counted among 'the grey ones', and if the knowledge of his secret political actions are true it only strengthens this.

The reason I draw a line from Nietzsche to Evola and included Crowley (and even Lavey, sic!) is that all these gentlemen seem like precursors – and warningsigns! – of the coming age.

Evola also made his own mistakes (his injury in the third chakra is quite telling) and left some room for very negative impulses, although in every other sense he understood the most clearly and with Arya-like nobility the way of the differentiated man in the Kali Yuga. By taking what is worthwhile even from the most modern and anti-esoteric writers and thinkers, and dumping the rest, I see him as an archetypical LHP-practitioner.

Logres on 2011-06-26 at 10:36 said:

Ismo, I know nothing of Crowley's politics. And I agree about the warning – signs, that's a good way to put it. Trying to steer between residual sentimentalism & inversionism, here...

Ismo on 2011-06-29 at 15:42 said:

Basing my judgment about Crowley and Politics on this article, his views seem to be actually somewhat enlightened: <http://www.arcane-archive.org/religion/thelema/al-eister-crowley-on-politics-1.php>

... but as I understand and have read from his biography, he worked as some sort of a double-agent during the first or second world war. I cannot say this with an authority though, since I read it quite a while ago from a good friends book, and can't say if I remember absolutely correctly. Still, I think it is clear there was some shady businesses that he was into and politics was part of it.

Fighting with residual sentimentalism and inversionism... ? Join the Camp!

I.II Kind Hearts, & Norman Blood

Gewusst, Erkannt, Geahndet

SCHELLING

65

⁶⁵http://books.google.com/books?id=k-_r3feIiNoC&pg=PA101&lpg=PA101&dq=gewusst+erkannt+geahndet+schelling&source=bl&ots=YveYm9wWiV&sig=K5bIoWF-Hb4W9r14wYWhn4QcLI&hl=en&ei=SosLTpC2PIS-tgfn8CSAQ&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CBYQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=gewusst%20erkannt%20geahndet%20schelling&f=false

What is now called the Christian religion already existed among the ancients, and was not lacking at the very beginnings of the human race. When Christ appeared in the flesh, the true religion already in existence received the name of Christian.

AUGUSTINE OF HIPPO

So much comes back to the union of opposites, the basis of alchemy – the turning of lead into gold, the union of male & female, etc. One might suggest that the fourth chakra is the balancing chakra (the heart chakra⁶⁶) which unites heaven & earth. Perhaps one reason that Alistair Crowley is merely mined by Evola for insight, rather than endorsed as a master, is that Crowley essentially attains deification rather than divinization – that is, he bypasses the heart chakra totally (and all considerations of morality, even in the act of unconsidering it), dedicating one’s self to “service-to-self”. This is a difficult path; most humans have some feeling at least for their kith & kin, which (of course) is why Chesterton argued that the gods of Rome⁶⁷ were “human” in a way that the gods of Carthage were not

The Roman augurs and scribes who said in that hour that it brought forth unearthly prodigies, that a child was born with the head of an elephant or that stars fell down like hailstones, had a far more philosophical grasp of what had really happened than the modern historian who can see nothing in it but a success of strategy concluding a rivalry in commerce. Something far different was felt at the time and on the spot as it is always felt by those who experience a foreign atmosphere entering their own like a fog or a foul savor. It was no mere military defeat, it was certainly no

⁶⁶<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Anahata>

⁶⁷<http://www.worldinvisible.com/library/chesterton/everlasting/part1c8.htm>

mere mercantile rivalry, that filled the Roman imagination with such hideous omens of nature herself becoming unnatural. It was Moloch upon the mountain of the Latins, looking with his appalling face across the plain; it was Baal who trampled the vineyards with his feet of stone; it was the voice of Tanit the invisible, behind her trailing veils, whispering of the love that is more horrible than hate. The burning of the Italian cornfields, the ruin of the Italian vines were something more than actual; they were allegorical. They were the destruction of domestic and fruitful things, the withering of what was human before that inhumanity that is far beyond the human thing called cruelty. The household gods bowed low in darkness under their lowly roofs; and above them went the demons upon a wind from beyond all walls, blowing the trumpet of the Tramontane. The door of the Alps was broken down; and in no vulgar but a very solemn sense, it was Hell let loose. The war of the gods and demons seemed already to have ended; and the gods were dead. The eagles were lost, the legions were broken; and in Rome nothing remained but honor and the cold courage of despair.

I do not presume to judge the Crowleys of the world who invoke Koranzon⁶⁸; I am sure that God can do that all on His own.

However, it does seem to me that the Pagan/Christian split is rather out of date today; one can find plenty of neo-pagans & neo-Christians who agree that the world is essentially “secular”. Likewise, one can find plenty of pagans & Christians who actually desire to raise a standard against the modern world, although the means for doing so are disagreed over. Most Christians will view the attempt to forge a deeper unity as potential syncretism. A large-minded Christian friend of mine wrote that “I see certain challenges with the presentation of Christianity as an esoteric doctrine which is rooted in a kind of pan-religious, metaphysical

⁶⁸<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Choronzon>

syncretism". Certainly. If we explore the fear (which I share) of straying from the "Way" (for those who are rooted in Christianity as I am), I am lead to conclude that there is finally a kind of violence which is practiced on the self; Jesus gave this as "taking heaven by storm", or "violence carrying it away". One can either obviate the need to struggle by cutting out the heart chakra entirely and proceeding by way of bizarre practices which are not strictly speaking necessary for those who are not "seared" or "vulnerable masters", engage in fundamentalist fantasy, or integrate the Left & the Right hand paths at a much higher level than that given to us by the conditions we live in. In other words, "syncretism" is only a necessary problem at the exoteric level – it is a potential problem at the esoteric.

Now even Evola, in *Revolt of the Modern World*, speaks of the beginning usefulness of drugs to create an alternate sense of reality, but a fading of that need as progress is made. Here we have the "Christian" tendency from the other direction, just as there is a legitimate "pagan" tendency from "ours". *This places Evola squarely in the camp of those who wish to preserve the entirety of the human being.* This is close to what St. Paul must have meant when he said "all things are lawful, not all are profitable" – the keeping of Torah was a re-affirmation of a concrete and concretely discerned "path of heaven". It seems to me that such a deep drive to preserve the entirety of human aspiration and integral wholeness is ultimately what is meant by purity, or true religion. Thus, the division innate between exoteric meanings only carries us so far – a pagan who communes with Odin, yet who wishes to preserve the full meaning of "Englishness", is committed inescapably to certain Christian aspirations.

Defining what that looks like is difficult, even humanly impossible. If we abandon the "we" of exotericism, & focus upon the "I" of transformation, the difficulty of finding the "we" will become considerably less. This is the task facing the West – re-embrace metaphysics, or have the

metaphysics of the alien imposed upon us, as Guillaume Faye⁶⁹ has argued will occur in Europe⁷⁰.

Whereas Christianity and the Church and “paganism” may ultimately decide that some measure of separation is beneficial, it cannot be the case that a hard line divides those who practice esoteric paths. This is not “syncretism” – provided the sage⁷¹ does not trouble the faithful with their wisdom. This is simply the attaining of poetic opposites in a manner which dissolves the need to have a “war of ideas”. As John Ruskin points out, the “pathetic fallacy” in poetry is only a fallacy⁷² in the hands of an amateur. Likewise, here, the “reunion” of Christianity with the faithful pagans is attainable by the non-vulnerable master (one committed to totality in totality, with the whole of the balancing chakra). The common person can grasp this purely on the level of poetry, but in the supreme heights of God’s kingdom, in Valhalla, heaven and earth will kiss, righteousness and peace will make peace. This dream built the *imperium*⁷³ of Europe, from the times of Boethius through Zwingli’s insistence that Socrates would be found in heaven, all the way to the days of Kitchener’s storming of Khartoum and Lord Cromer’s administration of Egypt. This dream did not begin with the Catholic Church being “syncretic” or harboring esoteric doctrine (which it did). It did not die, in spite of such disasters as the crusade against the Cathars in Southern France. It began with the touching of Christ’s teaching with the Mediterranean world around Alexandria (at least in our memory). St. Peter and St. Mark transmitted the teaching of the perfection of the kingdom to Clement, who endeavored to “conceal” it openly in the *Stromata*. The fact that this secret teaching was both “secret” and “Judaic” or based on Torah is not a contradiction to

⁶⁹<http://guillaumefayearchive.wordpress.com/2010/07/09/190/>

⁷⁰<http://guillaumefayearchive.wordpress.com/2007/07/07/the-islamic-conquest-of-europe/>

⁷¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2314>

⁷²<http://www.ourcivilisation.com/smartboard/shop/ruskinj/>

⁷³<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mra08JZbSkg>

the true aspirant, should he choose it. The teaching⁷⁴ was concerning the architect of the Cosmos, and the path of those who desired to set themselves free from “demons”. This was because the “flesh” had to be superseded. Man’s destiny was to be more than human. “Greater than the angels”. This teaching is both “pagan” (in the sense that it accepts the reality of the supernatural), “Gnostic” (in the sense that this world is not made ultimately for bourgeoisie comfort⁷⁵), and “Christian” (in that it aims for the Father of Lights in Valhalla). It is inimitable. It is what it is. It is the Tradition. Here is a “Gnostic”, Alexander Dugin:

The mankind has always had two types of spirituality, two paths — “Right Hand Path” and “Left Hand Path”. The first one is characterized by the positive attitude to the surrounding world; the world is seen as harmony, equilibrium, good, peace. All the evil is viewed as a particular case, a deviation from the norm, something inessential, transient, without deep transcendental reasons. Right Hand Path is also called “The Way of Milk”. It doesn’t hurt a person, it preserves him from radical experience, withdraws from immersion into suffering, from the nightmare of life. This is a false path. It leads into a dream. The one going by it will reach nowhere...

In the apostle’s day, the way of milk was using demons for fortune-telling to make a buck or two.

Tennyson made the point that “kind hearts are more than coronets, and simple faith than Norman blood”; Heaven’s Truth, being additive, can simply add that the perfection is both the attainment of Norman blood, and the purity of simple faith with kind hearts, crowned with the corona. Likewise, esoterically, we seek to listen to those who can “discern

⁷⁴<http://jacksonsnnyder.com/arc/bible-news/apostolia/pdf/CLEMENT-Excerpt-Book-IV.pdf>

⁷⁵<http://www.arctogaia.com/public/eng/gnostic.htm>

the spirits” so that true North, all of it, comes into view, if happily we search for it, and find it. This is why Gornahoor attempts to harmonize Donoso Cortes with Julius Evola.

There is a great line in a very modern movie – *focus is somewhere in between rage & serenity*. In our decaying age, what is needed is focus, beginning in the Self. The one who truly wishes to find the Tao will listen to whomever speaks at hand with wisdom, judging in their heart, the heart. Here, in the kingdom of Heaven, “there is neither Jew nor Gentile”. That is the meaning of Saint Paul’s comments; since Grace perfects, and does not eradicate Nature, he is not teaching One-World Utopianism, in which a sexless, raceless, classeless drone inhabits the void created by technology on the earth. He is saying that Aratus and Socrates are in heaven, or could have been. It is finally only the struggle with the Self – not only “every sin” but “every weight” must be laid aside, for all things “are lawful, but not all are convenient”. *Upaya*, skillful means, or the balancing of the fourth chakra must occur, for in no other way can “Thy Kingdom Come”. There are plenty of “Christians” who have no idea what the *Basileia tou Theou*⁷⁶ means, or even that it exists. In our day, the brightest line is between those of bad will who are trapped by the self, and those of good will who have risen to the struggle. To tell the difference, begin to look deep inside.

Posted on 2011-07-01 by Logres

* * *

Kushiel on 2011-07-02 at 07:37 said:

For the deeper Christians who, against linear logic and cultural taboos, find high value in Guenonian Traditionalism and its modification by Evola, what can the “Left Hand Path” mean, as followers of Jesus Christ? How can the “Left Hand Path” be reconciled to Christ and consistent moral theology?

⁷⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kingdom_of_God

Kushiel on 2011-07-02 at 09:46 said:

Isn't the proper response of the pure sacred warrior to the "Left Hand Path, as seen, for example, in the dehumanizing "spermo-gnosis" and malefic activities of the O.T.O... PURE AN-NIHILATION? I feel like quoting the Korn here: "Slay the Pagans, wherever you find them"—isn't this the normal moral response of the outwardly violent but inwardly calm Ideal Traditional Warrior to immorality and decadence, no matter how dressed-up in pseudo-mysticism? Should we even attempt to reconcile what should not be reconciled? Is a Hegelian sublation possible where antipodes exist—God as LOGOS-AGAPE, transcendent, selfless Wisdom and Love vs. God as compassion-free CHAOS?

Logres on 2011-07-02 at 10:48 said:

Well, Dugin's definition seems pretty sound to me – the Left Hand path (for the Christian) would be the Dostoevsky path, or the path of violence against the self. This might look un-Christian to some; Evola himself advocates practices which would seem counter-intuitive (drug use, the right to suicide), but only under higher conditions. Alexander Dugin's definition captures some of that; and there are Biblical examples: literally, Ehud, and others in the "Hall of Faith" who (if you read their story) you would think were "pagans". Barak was a coward following a woman, Samson with his Philistine women, etc. Christ opened up a "broad" narrow path (a safe path) based on the balancing of the heart, but some people are so mangled they can't use that. There are some Left Hand paths that are not available to Christians, because they have already entered the Kingdom and begun the journey; to them, it is sin. To another, with no purpose, it may not be sin, but simply degeneration which may or may not issue in ultimate salvation of a kind.

Logres on 2011-07-02 at 12:51 said:

In a literal sense, yes, you are right. However, Christ's coming in Revelation is very similar to this – as are all the promises made to those who do not seek God. Yes, so in a sense you are absolutely right. The difference between Hegelian synthesis and poetic apprehension is that the poetry doesn't have to be literally crammed together (again, this is precisely what Crowley does in the Thelema, right? Good and evil are the same?). It's a synthesis that preserves particulars. In Christian dogmatic terms, this has to do with the difference between being part of Christ's head (or One) & being recapitulated as part of his body. This is the mystery referred to in Colossians – first, a Lordship of Christ, then the return to the Father. I don't think this mystery permits us to say that there is some kind of absolute Torah; the Torah becomes "relative" in order better to relate. Hence, there is a mystery of evil as well (Judas). All this does, for the Christian, is to preserve the possibility that other paths may have their own God-given destiny. It isn't a forced syncretism or even comprehension. At a deeper level, is there evil in the city, and the

Lord has not done it? I realize that most people will see this as a betrayal of Agape; I see it as a strengthening of it. Part of the human nature of Christ, which freely chose to serve under a yoke he by right could have transcended. Again, this is explicit in Scripture. So while I share the concern (if you are a Christian), and remain puzzled, I don't agree that we can always know with certainty what is taboo. Was the Iron Guard anti-Christian? Most would say so. I am not so sure.
http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iron_Guard

Will on 2011-07-03 at 09:30 said:

While Dugin's criticism is certainly applicable to modern 'spiritual' sensibilities, it is incorrect to say that this is the Right Hand Path. The difference between the Right and Left hand paths is not, as he asserts, between false and true, but rather between what Evola calls 'dry' and 'wet' paths, respectively. He regarded both as valid, for different types of people and different historical periods. His examples were early Buddhism and Indian Tantra.

The Right Hand Path is based, as Dugin notes, on withdrawal from the world. This is the principle behind monasticism, and if it is anti-traditional, then Christianity has a lot to answer for, since it has made use of monasticism perhaps more than any other tradition.

logres on 2011-07-06 at 12:08 said:

Dugin is taking poetic license – his point is more emotional than metaphysical (I think). Here is a good summary of how I feel about Crowley:

"The cosmic constellation of the human being, particularly in modern times, is extremely complex. On the one hand he remains within eternity, in the lap of the Divine Trinity, only unconscious. On the other hand, if he is to become conscious of his situation – which is the main task of the spiritual ontogenesis of man, if one may so express it (because we can develop ourselves only in the totality of body, soul and spirit) – he must for a period of time work upon himself within a further trinity: that of Christ, Lucifer and Ahriman. And if he errs (development always entails risks), he may quickly find himself within yet another trinity: that of Lucifer, Ahriman and Asura (a retarded spirit of personality, archai). He will then fall out of the evolution intended for him by the divine worlds, and take a different path of which the Gospel says that there reigns outer darkness; there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth (Matthew 22; 13). At some point this world too will be transformed into good, but today no-one can say whether the human being who takes this path will then still exist.

To the spoiled but also intimidated human being of today, it is highly uncomfortable to learn of truths like these. And yet he must either develop within himself the strength and the wish to face up to the truth, in order to recognize the true laws of development and work upon himself (then God Himself will be his helper), or sooner or later he will find himself on the path of 'continuous Fall'. In some black-magical occult circles this path is even considered the best, but such opinions belong to 'black' romanticism, which is a special kind of egoism."

This is Gemmy Bondarev: <http://www.altanthroinfo.9f.com/GoodEvil.htm>

Logres on 2011-07-09 at 01:07 said:

"The soul then perceives how Christ holds Ahriman back in the sphere of the mineral forces (the gesture of the right hand), and directs him to his realm of measure, number and weight. With the gesture of the left hand Christ keeps Lucifer back from the fall into darkness, and thereby opens up for him the possibility of salvation " – Bondarev

Mr Green on 2017-08-07 at 18:17 said:

Logres said:

"I don't agree that we can always know with certainty what is taboo. Was the Iron Guard anti-Christian? Most would say so. I am not so sure."

A shame that this statement went unchallenged. It is understandable that one is dazzled by an archetypal warrior personage such as Corneliu Codreanu, but a closer look at the history of the Iron Guard, especially after Codreanu's 'martyrdom' in 1939, should dispel every doubt that the 'Christianity' of this organisation was anything more than a merely nominal creed misused for nationalistic ideological purposes.

https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki/Legionnaires%27_rebellion_and_Bucharest_pogrom#

The legacy left behind by Codreanu's organisation of 'Christian' legionnaires is mainly an anti-semitism so blindly fanatical that it resulted in a mass orgy of such monstrous violence that it escapes comprehension how any human being, let alone a self-professed Christian, could be capable of such a depth of evil. It reveals that the organisation was massively under demonic influence. It was merely a parody of the Christian warrior principle: at times beautiful insofar as its image reflected an archetype, but ugly at heart.

Logres on 2017-08-08 at 22:11 said:

The pogrom occurred after the murder of Codreanu, and when Eliade had left for England. The most that you can claim is that the pogrom was the natural fruit of the Legion's work, and I think that would be difficult to establish, although I suppose it's possible (as my comment indicated so). I was speaking of Codreanu and his men, not the subsequent policies of the Iron Guard. What about the Legion of the Archangel Michael? And isn't it true that corruptio optima pessimi?

Mr Green on 2017-08-09 at 09:19 said:

I know that it occurred after the death of Codreanu. But how could possibly a truly spiritual order deviate so completely in such a short period of time after the death of its founding leader? Does not that tell us something about the general character of its membership body? How do

we know Codreanu himself wouldn't have participated in such excesses had he lived a little longer? Since I find much to admire in the man, I hope this wouldn't have been the case. But in any case, it is indisputable that Codreanu actively forged an intellectual anti-semitism so extreme that these cruel excesses committed so shortly after his death with the sanction of the order's elite cadres indeed, and unfortunately so, must be considered the fruit of his work. Ideas have consequences, and especially when fed to a paramilitary organisation prone to direct action. If the membership body at large had been genuinely permeated by the spirit of Christ from the beginning, as befits its official intention, these evils committed by that same body so soon after its beginning would not have been possible. If Codreanu had not approved of it (and this is an ambiguous matter), he must have utterly failed in the spiritual formation of this body, so that there was no one to succeed him, letting loose the lowest and most vulgar level of men. All these people considered themselves Orthodox Christian believers. It goes to show how irredeemably fallen people are when they are capable of justifying the most extreme evils as self-professed Christians. What do we need satanism for then?

Logres on 2017-08-25 at 23:43 said:

Well, apparently the entire world degenerated rather quickly after Creation, so I find it hard to believe that some kind of "Fall" (perhaps the acts referred to by yourself) did not intervene. How else do you reconcile the obvious nobility with the obvious crime? I'm not as familiar with Codreanu as I could be, So I'm not as eager to judge his entire heart; there was something noble there which went off the rails. If the head of a hierarchy is chopped off, I don't think you can automatically blame what follows on the leader. That would be like blaming the texture of Reconstruction on Abraham Lincoln without making a specific case..That's not the popular view of history, or of ideas, but Codreanu's "fruit" cannot be necessarily considered as the actions of certain elements in the Iron Guard following his violent murder.

Logres on 2017-08-25 at 23:54 said:

It's possible you're right: I am not as certain as you are. I don't think spiritual formation (as you say) is quite so straight forward: a man may do great things, and "lose his own soul".

Ilo Stabet on 2021-03-16 at 06:41 said:

I have tried finding the source of that St. Augustine but it's proving difficult. I find it reproduced a lot on the internet, but only a few mention its origin. The ones who do say it is from *Contra Faustus*, 33:6 – but I cannot find it there (nor within any of the other chapters). So it seems everyone that provides this source is also reproducing it from the one place and taking it at face value. Do you have any clues as to the real source?

Thank you.

Cologero on 2021-03-16 at 15:36 said:

It should not be difficult to find. It is in the Retractions, Chapter 12.

Ilo Stabet on 2021-03-16 at 16:09 said:

Thank you.

1.12 Yahweh's Template

For as lightning that comes from the east is visible even in the west, so will be the coming of the Son of Man.

In the madness of materialism the West delivers its great thinkers to the graveyard of thoughts, and tramples those in the dirt, who wish to abjure this madness with strong and holy words.

PRINCE V. F. ODOYEVSKY

A common understanding today is that Christianity is inherently Semitic, while the Gnostics attempted to embrace a deeper spirituality more in tune with the dramatic nature of man's fall. There is some truth to this, both emotionally & metaphysically; we have posted Dugin's essay⁷⁷ on Gnosticism, which should resonate with any denizen of the brave new world. Still, the Church (which is surrounded by a "halo of hatred", in Chesterton's words) is more complex than this over-simplification allows. The Gnostic-Christian debate has all the hallmarks of schizophrenia, a split in the mind of Mediterranean men, playing out in such sad tragedies as the Albigensian Crusades, in which Christendom made war upon her own bosom in an attempt to purge the self of an evil, perceived or not. We cannot de-Hellenize the Church or the Faith, yet the Faith sleeps uneasily with its Hellenistic past.

⁷⁷<http://www.arctogaia.com/public/eng/gnostic.htm>

History at this level presents a Gordian knot; the same levels of thinking which produced such an impasse, will not resolve the impasse. Hence, we turn to esoteric study.

Reputedly, the diaries of Clement⁷⁸ – or here⁷⁹ – have been translated out from their oblivion in the *Ante-Nicene Fathers*. In this work, there is an argument between Bar Cepha (Cephas, named Peter) and Shimon concerning the nature of the Creator. Shimon is a Gnostic who believes that he has a deeper truth than the Torah, coming from beyond time and space, tainted by the Architect.

During the debate (in which Cephas “the Rock” interestingly makes the point that reason & faith are necessary for firm he does not say true knowledge of God, rather than mere “belief” alone) Saint Peter admits that he *does* in fact know *where and whence* eternal spirits came, but that to discuss their origin would do Shimon no good, as Shimon has already begun with the false premise that Yahweh is ignorant of the true Father of Lights to whom the spirits belong. To believe that Yahweh ignorantly or in delusion created the fallen material bodies & physical world is to be so utterly wrong that it excludes one from the mysteries.

This is entirely consistent with the apostolic tradition. It is little known or appreciated how secretive the early church was⁸⁰:

By these, too, you will be able to silence those who oppose and gainsay the word of salvation. Only see that you do not give these things over to unbelieving and blasphemous tongues, for that is no common danger. But impart them to pious and faithful men,

⁷⁸<http://jacksonsnnyder.com/arc/bible-news/apostolia/pdf/ALL-CLEMENT-6x9-120707-embedded.pdf>

⁷⁹<http://www.scribd.com/doc/13561289/-The-Authentic-Peter-The-Preaching-of-Simeon-Kefa-from-the-Journal-of-T-Flavius-Clemens-Clement-The-Clementine-Recognitions-Recognitions-of-Cl>

⁸⁰<http://www.earlychristianwritings.com/text/hippolytus-christ.html>

who desire to live holily and righteously with fear. For it is not to no purpose that the blessed apostle exhorts Timothy, and says, “O Timothy, keep that which is committed to thy trust, avoiding profane and vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called; which some professing have erred concerning the faith.” And again, “Thou therefore, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus. And the things that thou hast heard of me in many exhortations, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.” If, then, the blessed (apostle) delivered these things with a pious caution, which could be easily known by all, as he perceived in the spirit that “all men have not faith,” how much greater will be our danger, if, rashly and without thought, we commit the revelations of God to profane and unworthy men?

So Cephas is following Christ’s method, which would be well known – teach in parables, do not explain to Pharisees.

Still it is unclear if Cephas’ objection is entirely merely that the wrong is done to “the Creator” – after all, as we will see, he is willing to wrangle a Pascalian wager. Perhaps, the more immediate problem is viewing *matter* as *inherently* evil. If one has to ascend, then it is more important to be right about *matter* than about God, since matter is what you are closest to. A matter which is purely evil would preclude (as we shall see) any higher knowledge as well. Hence, in esoteric studies, the need to begin with parables & with baby steps (as Christ does). To transcend, start to pay attention.

For metaphysically, Cephas’ more basic argument is that Gnosticism does not “resolve” anything about the problem of evil except by sleight of hand – if the True Father of Lights can aid us, he knows of us, and this means he knows of our plight. This would entail his foreknowledge of what Yahweh did, which entails the same dilemma which the Gnostics pose regarding Yahweh, & for which they indict him of being “lesser”. Cephas, in short, faced with the prospect of doubting all the known

senses, would rather leave the conundrum in Yahweh's court – the Father of Lights is more likely to have mercy (in case Yahweh is truly “lesser”). In other words, *we have here the basics of the argument of infinite regression combined with Pascal's wager* – Cephas is betting that the Torah does have a higher meaning, but that this meaning is not completely unconsonant with the literal, childlike meaning which is necessary to begin understanding the structure of the Cosmos. Most Christian orthodoxies unconsciously acknowledge, point to, and tend towards this truth at their subtle core; or more precisely, there is an element within them that does, at the least. Provided the Church does not fall into materialistic moralizing of the most grotesque sort, it should always have this drift. We know this debate as Law vs. Grace, but it takes many forms in Christianity, because Gnosticism was once part of her esoteric core, before it was ejected (perhaps self-ejected?).

As an example, this point is similar to the Pope's recent claim in his speech on Pseudo-Dionysius⁸¹ – there is a profound innate similarity between the language of the faithful (Calvin's method of discussing God) & the knowledge that goes beyond all words.

If we accept the Cephas-Mark-Clement connection in Alexandria, we can place esoteric Christianity in close proximity with almost all of the currents present in the Classical world (some claim that the Egyptian connection is a red herring, & the Eleusianian mysteries⁸² in fact are the real link⁸³).

Here is Cicero:

⁸¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2332>

⁸²<http://www.scribd.com/doc/28988441/Katabasis-The-Eleusinian-Mysteries-And-the-Early-Christian-Church>

⁸³http://books.google.com/books?id=zXPvqI9fz7QC&pg=PA124&lpg=PA124&dq=eleusinian+mysteries+christian+liturgy&source=bl&ots=MqdNdP8N35&sig=YlUhdPpZXm8GSTfze4mDBU3mnKE&hl=en&ei=Q2cSTTrroK-Tr0gH2ncm0Dg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CBcQ6AEwADgK#v=onepage&q=eleusinian%20mysteries%20christian%20liturgy&f=false

For among the many excellent and indeed divine institutions which your Athens has brought forth and contributed to human life, none, in my opinion, is better than those mysteries. For by their means we have been brought out of our barbarous and savage mode of life and educated and refined to a state of civilization; and as the rites are called “initiations,” so in very truth we have learned from them the beginnings of life, and have gained the power not only to live happily, but also to die with a better hope.

It is well known that the Roman nobility contributed many of their class to the ranks of bishops (eg, in Aquitania), and so we can concretely observe Christianity incorporate the civilizing mission of Rome.

To reiterate, Christianity is inseparable from -but unreconciled to - her Hellenic past. She cannot either totally forget, or completely remember.

In trying to reconstruct historical trajectories without “the mysteries”, we encounter great difficulty. The legend of Andrew going to Russia⁸⁴ (Cyril and Methodius are said to have found the Gospels already translated there) makes sense, & might put us closer to the point of reconstructing the seminal explosion of the Faith in the early centuries.

It would be easier if we had “the template”. Fortunately, the Scriptures themselves (as the quotations by Hippolytus demonstrate) are for more rewarding in this way than most suppose.

Jesus began with the Beatitudes (Matthew 5:3-12)

- the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven⁸⁵. (5:3⁸⁶)
- they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. (5:4⁸⁷)

⁸⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Saint_Andrew

⁸⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kingdom_of_God

⁸⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:3

⁸⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:4

- the meek: for they shall inherit the earth. (5:5⁸⁸)
- they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled. (5:6⁸⁹)
- the merciful⁹⁰: for they shall obtain mercy⁹¹. (5:7⁹²)
- the pure in heart: for they shall see God. (5:8⁹³)
- the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God. (5:9⁹⁴)
- they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. (5:10⁹⁵)

If one compares the Beatitude progression of poverty in spirit, merciful, etc. (8 steps) to passages in Scripture from 2 Peter (faith, self-control, knowledge, etc. leading to love in 8 steps), & match them against St. Paul's progression of faith, hope, then love (as outlined in Mouravieff's *Gnosis*), one gets a very close match.

For this very reason, make every effort to add to your faith goodness; and to goodness, knowledge;⁶ and to knowledge, self-control; and to self-control, perseverance; and to perseverance, godliness;⁷ and to godliness, mutual affection; and to mutual affection, love.⁸ For if you possess these qualities in increasing measure, they will keep you from being ineffective and unproductive in your knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.⁹ But whoever does not have them

⁸⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:5

⁸⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:6

⁹⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Works_of_Mercy

⁹¹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mercy>

⁹²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:7

⁹³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:8

⁹⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:9

⁹⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Matthew_5:10

is nearsighted and blind, forgetting that they have been cleansed from their past sins.

Also confirming this by the *Shepherd of Hermas* –

Hermas 22 1 When then I ceased asking her concerning all these things, desirous of beholding, I was greatly rejoiced that I should see it. 2 She looked upon me, and smiled, and she saith to me, Seest thou seven women round the tower? 3 I see them, lady, say I. 4 This tower is supported by them by commandment of the Lord. 5 Hear now their employments. 6 The first of them, the woman with the strong hands, is called Faith; 7 through her are saved the elect of God. 8 And the second, that is girded about and looketh like a man, is called continence; 9 she is the daughter of Faith. 10 Whosoever then shall follow her, becometh happy in his life, for he shall refrain from all evil deeds, believing that, if he refrain from every evil desire, he shall inherit eternal life. 11 And the others, lady, who be they? 12 They are daughters one of the other. 13 The name of the one is Simplicity, of the next, knowledge, of the next, Guilelessness, of the next, Reverence, of the next, Love. 14 When then thou shalt do all the works of their mother, thou canst live. 15 I would fain know, lady, I say, what power each of them possesseth. 16 Listen then, saith she, to the powers which they have. 17 Their powers are mastered each by the other, and they follow each other, in the order in which they were born. 18 From Faith is born Continence, from Continence Simplicity, from Simplicity Guilelessness, from Guilelessness Reverence, from Reverence knowledge, from knowledge Love. 19 Their works then are pure and reverent and divine. 20 Whosoever therefore shall serve these women, and shall have strength to master their works, shall have his dwelling in the tower with the saints of God.

– we can begin to discern a Christian “Tao” which was incorporating Greek mysteries and Roman rites in an effort to embody the “Kingdom of

God". It was this ideal, and not that of cheap grace or individual salvation, which fired the hearts & minds of Europeans during the Crusades and long after. It was this which went to the four corners – so if we are looking for this template, we may seek & find. The Faith is self-awareness & fullness of this embodied in a concrete civilization. The historical trajectories are suggestive clues, but we have to follow them, and expect to find them.

Again, the Faith represents in a way the balancing of the chakras of the universal Man, in the heart. The Faith (or can be) the apex of spiritual evolution for man. This places her at odds with those like Crowley who would seek to bypass the union of heaven and earth, or unbalance it. It is this struggle which defines the very headship of Christ; of His body and His many possessions we do not speak, but only of those called to be the lightning of God.

The power of the template to identify and predict the progress of the kingdom of God is astounding. This progression of knowledge applies at a civilizational level as well as a personal one. The two nation-civilizations most consciously working out the implications of revelation in the 1900s (for good or bad) were Germany & Russia. The last century centers (basically in a negative way) on the German-Russian axis. *The Crisis Of Civilization (Anthroposophie auf der Kreuzung der okkult-politischen Bewegungen der Gegenwart)* by the excommunicated Russian Anthroposophist Gennady Bondarev is worth examining, along with Bondarev's *Die Wartende Kultur*⁹⁶, Prokofieff's *Spiritual Origins of Eastern Europe*, & Irina Gordienko's *S.O. Prokofieff, Myth and Reality*. All of these works debate questions which Rudolf Steiner raised about dimensional human evolution, and where and how it would occur in relation to the world-cultures. The ideal German culture is supposed to come into expression via Idealism, Goetheanism, Anthroposophy, and Social Threefolding; the Slavic destiny (it is debated) instead amounts to

⁹⁶<http://www.amazon.de/Die-wartende-Kultur-Esoterische-russische-n/dp/3906712028>

bearing the Beast-State karma of world degeneration, thereby enabling other countries to hopefully gain ground⁹⁷. This is common ground in Steiner studies, apparently, and in related anthroposophy.⁹⁸

For better or worse, the Church sought a harmony between exoteric tradition and esoteric mystery. Our task as traditionalists ought to be to enable the Church to better fulfill that aspiration (by understanding the process as she should do), without worrying too much about whether she wishes to acquiesce in all particulars. Part of the terrible challenge devastating the Church today is her refusal to “scientifically” or factually embrace a concrete and concretely demonstrated practical metaphysic to explain her esoteric doctrine she has made exoteric (see George Heart’s⁹⁹ *Dogmatic Faith & Gnostic Vivifying Knowledge*). She has forgotten her own template, or dare not realize it. How could the Church not see that Hitler & Stalin’s advent presaged knowledge about the state of the Kingdom of God? Instead, she chose the “darkness” of refusing to see which Solzhenitsyn claimed had overtaken us at Nuremberg.

The last century was not the century without God – it was the century which realized the inversion of the divine template in history, and its increasing amnesic treatment in a Church pursuing social gospel & fundamentalism. Once the power of this template for identifying & regenerating Christianity is realized, it will be possible to begin to discuss in all humility the real challenges of the Church, including ancient divisions with present consequences.

Yahweh, for instance, may be a particular manifestation or theophany of God which is transcended (Jesus speaks of His “Father”) a particular version of this is precisely¹⁰⁰ the Eastern Orthodox dogma, in fact, where the transcendence is in a manner of speaking added to, or subsumed at

⁹⁷<http://www.altanthroinfo.9f.com/SpiritualEurope.htm>

⁹⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/New_Galilee_%28Sixth_EPOCH%29

⁹⁹<http://www.amazon.com/Christianity-Dogmatic-Gnostic-Vivifying-Knowledge/dp/1412062284>

¹⁰⁰http://www.romanity.org/htm/rom.18.en.augustine_unknowingly_rej

the Transfiguration. There are, of course, other possibilities, including the idea that Yahweh is an angelic ruler who is deluded, but that matter is not *inherently* evil, but is redeemed by its connection with spirit, however minute. However, this is not exclusive of the first possibility – God may be “drawing” for children here.

Formerly¹⁰¹ the Archangel Michael was the countenance of Jahve.
Now he is the countenance of God...

This is probably central to demoralizing or de-sentimentalizing the Church. In any case, the Gnostic emphasis was correct (flesh has to be transcended) while their understanding of Torah is wrong. In the Cephas debate, one senses that Cephas is dealing with someone who is getting steps out of order. If the Church had lost (or was unable to maintain or to teach) the proper steps as outlined in the Beatitude (combined with esoteric initiations), then the Gnostic misunderstanding and tragedy makes perfect sense. Further research into early Christianity & the Greek or Russian connections may reveal more interesting facts and interpenetrations than we have endeavored to touch on here for now.¹⁰²

Who is Yahweh? Jesus certainly never spoke of Him, except to say that “before Abraham was, I am”. Jesus taught of His Father; and yet he kept the rites of Yahweh in such a way as to transform them. The more he taught, the angrier the Law-protectors of Yahweh became. Yet Jesus affirms that “not one jot or tittle shall pass from the Law, till all is fulfilled”. There is certainly something odd about Jesus & Yahweh, as well as their relationship.

Russian theology can be viewed as a very complex & concrete struggle over precisely these issues – the Orthodox Church is both “more Jewish” and “more New Testament” than every other Church. One might go

ects_the_doctrine.01.htm

¹⁰¹<http://www.altanthroinfo.9f.com/SpiritualEurope.htm>

¹⁰²For more on Clement¹⁰³

so far as to claim that only in Russia has there been additional “life” in revelation (as a generalization) – the Catholic Church early on decided in favor of “dogma” and “reason” in peculiarly Western forms, which nevertheless had their “Russian moments” of inspiration and mysticism. Gornahoor has drawn attention to Russia repeatedly; it is not the only one¹⁰⁴ to remark so:

Ch. 13 The Russian Complex. How Mystery knowledge from Europe migrated into Russia in the 18th Century. The Trubetskoi family. The Russian mystical profile: Fedorov, Soloviev, Berdayev, and the Symbolist movement. Destruction of the mystical elements of Gnosis during the Revolution. The occult roots of the Russian Revolution. The survival of Sophianic teachings in the new atmospheric sciences with Merzekovsky, Vernadsky and others, leading to Gaia theory today.

Bondarev & Steiner¹⁰⁵ also argued that the Slavic and Teutonic worlds were the locus of human spiritual evolution, and therefore subjected to vicious reprisals from the opposing elements or “powers”. Gornahoor actually posits that de Maistre¹⁰⁶ represented a European connection with “secret doctrine” in Russia. All of the authors mentioned above (Fedorov, etc.) were the subjects of essays by Berdayev that are on the Web¹⁰⁷.

The Russian and Slavic feeling and consciousness with all its powers has to be awakened. We need a mobilisation of the national spirit. And recollection about the German self-consciousness of Marx is very useful in this regard. Against the German mindset of Marx concerning a world vocation of civilising by the German

¹⁰⁴<http://www.metahistory.org/GRAIL/AlternativeGrail.php>

¹⁰⁵<http://www.altanthroinfo.9f.com/GoodEvil.htm>

¹⁰⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joseph_de_Maistre

¹⁰⁷<http://www.berdayev.com/>

race in the East, we have to oppose our own Russian mindset concerning the mission of Slavism, which still has not had its own say in the world. We believe, that a strong Russia will provide a greater freedom to the world and to all the peoples of the world, than would a strong Germany, and that in the Slavic spirit there is greater an universality, than in the coercive German spirit. However great might be the significance of the Russian Revolution in Russian history, yet the world struggle of peoples is an event still greater in its significance, than is the Revolution. The Revolution has erupted because of the war, and it can be thought of only in connection with the war. The Germans have got their own idea in the worldwide struggle. Is there an idea with us? The Russians have shown such vulnerability, that they have fallen under the spell of a German idea. But our final word has still not been said.

Not all of the debate has occurred “outside” the communion – Bulgakov’s¹⁰⁸ theology of Sophia is interesting in this regard. Slavic civilization & religion has been willing to entertain energetic and dynamic views of both Yahweh & the archangel Michael.

The Gnostic debate over Yahweh’s real identity (ignorance or evil?) and equation with the Demiurge represented a dead end – it was the “dogmatizing” or externalizing (theologians would say “reifying”) of a false dilemma. Instead, Yahweh can be viewed as the Slavic nation(s) have chosen to do so – as an aspect of the Divine which is not conceived of legalistically or juridically as a kind of “final” name for God, but rather as a countenance given by God to man at a particular point of his development.

It is not enough for a Westerner to discuss “Law” vs. “Grace”; this guts the debate of metaphysics and Being and “reifies” in precisely the manner which lead to Gnostic misunderstandings and burst the early

¹⁰⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sergei_Bulgakov

Church into an esoteric core and exoteric skeleton, both of which were endangered without the other.

Steiner argues¹⁰⁹ that the Pharisees could not identify Christ by his face, because all of the apostles were transformed into his countenance during their preaching. This was why Judas had to betray with a kiss. Steiner also makes some observations which should interest anyone who has read Gurdjieff:

Moses worshiped a Moon God, Jahweh, and since the human astral body was perfected during the Old Moon stage of evolution, we might expect that Moses' God was one who was found in the astral body of feelings, emotions, and temptations. Moses presented his people with a decalogue of commandments designed to order their astral body of feelings, emotions, and temptations. Here's how you are to feel about your God and parents; here's the things you should avoid doing under states of intense emotion; here are the temptations you are to avoid. The "thou shalt not" clauses gave clear directions to the actions that the human astral body was to avoid to keep from offending their Moon God, God of the Astral Body.

One might suggest that the astral body (to which Gurdjieff gave such attention in efforts to "form" or crystallize it, to which event we attach the name "initiation") was the point of contact between the earthly Soul & the heavenly Spirit, whose focal point was the midpoint between the fair body of Earth and the angel standing in the middle of the Sun – Sin, Lune, the Moon. Thus, the "overcoming" of the Moon was synonymous with overcoming Sin. Yet the Moon was indispensable, because without the crystallization of the astral body in a "seed", no progress beyond the Moon could occur. For those without the Law, there was no Sin in the Law. For those without a conscience, there was nothing but the animal

¹⁰⁹<http://www.doyletics.com/arj/turningp.htm>

kingdom and the law of tooth and claw. Consciousness of sin (or formation of an astral body) was what enabled the “leaping over the moon” – breaking free – the marriage of the Soul and the Spirit. This, of course, is precisely what Mouravieff teaches in *Gnosis*, and which he claimed is a verbal tradition in Orthodoxy.

Romanity (as we refan its flames) could benefit from the secret fire passed on through Alexandria and kept safe in Russia.

Posted on 2011-07-09 by Logres

* * *

Theopathic on 2011-07-09 at 12:14 said:

Forgive me, this was a truly splendid and theo-philosophically interesting and instructive communication, but I am writing an essay about Evola and cannot find, for the life of me, the actual source-text for Evola's citation of the “Nitisara” (4.4) on the semi-deific nature of ideal rulers in “Revolt Against the Modern World.” Can any one help out here with this haphazard and inelegant question?

logres on 2011-07-09 at 13:17 said:

Granted, Faith = Poverty of Spirit, Goodness = Mourning, Knowledge = Meekness, Self-Control = Hungering/Thirsting for Righteousness is a kind of shift of tone, almost a progression within the progression, so that the first (Faith) is a product of the second (Poverty of Spirit). However, all the progressions move from Faith through Knowledge to Vision of God.

Heraklion on 2011-07-10 at 02:50 said:

Inspiring words, Logres. Achieving the task of non-linearly, non-syncretically combining the Truth of Torah and Christ with the remnants of so-called “pagans” whose hearts still have God's Law imprinted on them (see Paul, Romans, of course) is a mind-numbingly difficult task... Certain better-natured Masons and Rosicrucians attempted such-like things in the past, but failed... A brotherhood between Godly Pagans and Godly Christians as a counterrevolutionary militia opposing the Kali Yuga is seriously exciting to at least imagine...

logres on 2011-07-11 at 00:40 said:

As Cologero has pointed out, a huge danger is betrayal from inside – this is how occult power always work, and no doubt why such projects came to nothing in the past. Yet the biggest challenge (perhaps) is to manage to coordinate without achieving the very occult goal itself –

the attainment of a synthesis which combines the worst elements of both. Such might stand as a definition of “modern times”.

logres on 2011-07-11 at 00:45 said:

Theopathic,

It's in an easy on Junger, isn't it:

“In the Nitisara we are asked to explain how he who cannot dominate himself (his own manas) can dominate other men, and in the Arthaçâstra the exercise of royal functions is conceived as tapas, i.e. ascetism, ascetism of power. We might easily multiply references of this kind.”

If you are asking where Evola references it...

<http://euro-synergies.hautetfort.com/archive/2009/02/19/julius-evola-on-ernst-junger.html>

Count Cagliostro on 2011-07-11 at 02:54 said:

“To reiterate, Christianity is inseparable from -but unreconciled to – her Hellenic past. She cannot either totally forget, or completely remember”

Coming from Greece, I cannot but admire the wise choice of your words!

1.13 The Russian Turn

Alexander Dugin has pointed out¹¹⁰ that Russia has had no Enlightenment. In the context of this survival & ancient adversarial relationship towards the West, Nicholas Berdyaev¹¹¹ is worth quoting in full (he is analyzing the Westernizer Trubetskoi):

In this world there is no mystical translucency. But after his devastating of the mystical meaning of all the earthly embodiments, Trubetskoy ought to arrive at a certain difficulty. **Rendered difficult for him is the question about the Church. In the Church he believes in nothing, and besides the Church**

¹¹⁰<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=quxWhp5y23E>

¹¹¹http://www.berdyaev.com/berdiaev/berd_lib/1913_170.html

he acknowledges nothing. But the Church ought also to seem one of the “earthly utopias”, that this is the ultimate recourse of that utopianism, which seeks the heavenly within the earthly, the Divine within the human, the other-worldly in the this-sidely. Trubetskoy ultimately to acknowledge, that upon earth, within earthly human history, that the Church also is an impossibility and an utopia, that it can appear only at the end of the world, only in the other-sidely. And as regards the Church he ought to affirm his idealistic thesis, i.e. to acknowledge it as being non-substantial, and as a norm, an ideal. I reiterate, that the critique of theocracy by Trubetskoy is excellent. But upon the path on which he stands, the critique of theocracy mustneeds also be extended to the Church, as upon an earthly utopian embodiment of the heavenly. He reduces the Church to the sacraments. But the Church has always striven to be more than the sacraments, it traverses the sphere of the earthly embodiment of the heavenly. The Catholic Church conceives of itself as a theocracy, the Kingdom of God upon earth. But the Orthodox Church also is not free of theocratic pretensions to order the world as regards itself. The separation of the Church from the state, which Trubetskoy desires, is also a diminution within the Church of earthly embodiments of the heavenly, a diluted churchly utopianism. Must needs there not be upon this path a refusal of embodiment of the heavenly into the earthly, until the very end of the world? Trubetskoy subsequently defends the secularisation of the whole of life and all of culture, and this mustneeds be acknowledged as very powerful on his side. It is necessary to renounce the lie and the sham of a Christian state, a Christian science, a Christian culture, etc, etc. The process of secularisation has an inner significance. But the whole of life and culture ought anew to become religious. Trubetskoy does not uncover the path to this, he does not point out the means for the spiritualisation of life. The Church also is the path of the making Divine the world. But in the metaphysics

of Trubetskoy there is no place for the existence of the Church upon the earth. The Church as it were ought to remain in heaven.

He demolishes all the earthly utopias, but together with this he demolishes also the Church, as resulting from an utopia. Trubetskoy points out the whole difficulty of the existence of a Christian dominion. There is only one Christian dominion — this is the domain of the birds of the air and the lilies of the fields. Freedom from care is the Gospel testament. But upon earth it is impossible to be free from care, it is impossible to live, as do the lilies of the field and the birds of the air, upon the earth it is necessary to be prudent of domain. How to get out of this? It is indeed impossible to put off resolution of the contradictions of life until the end of the world. Do they not take too lightly the burden of the religious antinomy of life? It is necessary to accept life to the end, sacrificially and tragically. There is already therein no justification for the religiously neutral, for an external to God sociability and an external to God culture. Trubetskoy was more in the right than Bulgakov, when he rejects dominion from a Christian point of view and does not reckon it a task Divine. Bulgakov indeed has transferred over upon heaven his own economics, his own sweat. But the truth of Bulgakov is in this, that he sees the tormentiveness of the religious problem of economics and he does not reckon it possible to remain on the soil of religious neutrality. It must needs be recognised, that religiously there is nothing that is neutral, there is nothing that is outside religion.

What is interesting here is the critique of the Church – the Church becomes (if it accepts the separation of Church & State) nothing more than a very fancy and rarefied utopia. Since Nature is not Divine, nor is there such nonsense as a World-Soul, and since all else of interest occurs within the compartments of secular work (by definition, whatever is un-Church), then “the Church” is nothing but a holding action, a word we

place for something we do not have. Or, more pointedly, a Utopia. This (of course) is the default political position of conservatism today (something which Evola notes in the essay on Junger, *The Gordian Knot*¹¹²).

Now it is important to point out that wherever forces belonging to the first of the three domains emerge and break forth, only the possibilities of the third domain can really face them. Any attempt to stem on the basis of forces and values of the intermediate zone can only be precarious, provisional and relative.

As the “Church” of what “used to be”, conservatism merely attempts to slow or thwart the move toward the abyss. Men like Evola & Steiner attempted to erect programs which would remedy this fault, but nothing has (as of yet) materialized (the question has been raised at Gornahoor, of a lack of courage).

The systematizers failed, but so did the prophets and statesmen, like Russell Kirk. Western fighters in this intellectual strife may well look outside of the West to find the crack in the mirror.

If we go back to Berdyaev, he here puts his finger (with Russian characteristic flair) on the problem with the Enlightenment “mindset”. Seeing the contrast between secularism & theocracy, the Russian soul either prefers to risk theocracy (“Third Rome” and “Slavophilism”) or to endeavor a Third Testament (The Church of John). This is why Gornahoor has spoken of a revival or preservation of hermeticism & counter-revolution within Russia. Of course, many Russians attempted to secularize, but the attempt upon the soul (in general) failed.

A friend of mine (Tor, from Dunedain.net) writes

This is why we turn again to Holy Russia, because the madmen there have never stopped weeping and, if they have not picked up the sword, it is because their tear-rivers will serve

¹¹²<http://www.centrostudilaruna.it/the-gordian-knot.html>

to forge new ones. There is a death beyond dying that can be approached in the living that is beyond living and this mode, if abandoned in the new age, is approachable by all who have that little mite that can move mountains. Yes, it is faith that I speak of, and this mite is more powerful than all armies arrayed against it, all manner of worldly men that have some stock in old castles and feudal titles or yachts and mighty steel towers, and who scoff at the world and at man and perceive themselves to be gods. Yeah, verily, this is the spirit not of those who were simply crushed by the church for their herbal potions, but of the martyrs who willingly marched under a blood-red banner and gave their lives, all and total, for the new life that would be theirs whither and whether they fell.

It may be that within the belly of the beast (whether Soviet Russia or post-capitalist America) is found the strongest chance to preserve one's self & to (therefore) resist without resisting, that which seems irresistible.

In this struggle, every true Christian will have to be transmuted to a "hermetic", & every esotericist will have to strive to attain the martyr spirit. When the two have become one, the lightning shall come from the East to the West.

Posted on 2011-07-23 by Logres

1.14 Through the Illusion, into the Dream

Gornahoor has been emphasizing the ancient ideal of *polis*¹¹³ over against the modern cosmopolitanism and egalitarianism. One might note that *democracy* is a code word; it certainly doesn't stand for government of the people for the people – just ask the patriotic, conservative British Jew

¹¹³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2775#more-2775>

Glasman¹¹⁴ what happens when you stand with the peasant-commoners. Nor does *diversity* mean what it sounds – it in fact is code for larger ethnic voting blocks of pre-approved groups, which are strangely non-diverse. Is anyone worried that America doesn't have enough Icelanders residing on our soil? These magic words are filled with power, which aims for power, power of the basest sort. All modern political nostrums are lies; Orwellian language has triumphed. "Fascism" means "something bad" or "not-good", "tolerance" means something "not-bad".

Modern mindsets cannot think in any terms other than these binary ones, which usually short-circuit quickly when dealing with reality, which is dominated by the principles of co-inherence & transcendence (to name two notables). **Unfortunately, living on the cultural capital of past times in combination with technology has allowed the illusion of success to persist, resulting in what even their own propagandists term the "sorcerer-state"**¹¹⁵.

In ancient times, the problem of *the one-and-the-many*¹¹⁶ was a known mystery, about which preparation, study, and energy were spent in order to arrive at living Truth, which was then embodied in principles of order & *imperium* & *transcendence*. The unity of the medieval mind stemmed from these and other kinds of transcendence.

It is not chaos alone which has ruled since 1789, but lies and illusion, since there has to be a world order, or at least, an anti-order. In the absence of local rites and gods who are genuinely transcendent and lead to such (and here we think of the Orthodox Church's proper emphasis on local customs¹¹⁷ as salvific, potentially), the world is governed by occult powers

¹¹⁴<https://isteve.blogspot.com/2011/07/blue-labour-rapid-rise-and-faster-fall.html>

¹¹⁵<http://www.washingtonpost.com/wp-srv/style/longterm/books/reviews/erosmagicandthedeath.htm>

¹¹⁶<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/problem-of-many/>

¹¹⁷http://www.roadtoemmaus.net/back_issue_articles/RTE_15/Brittany_s_Celtic_Past.pdf

which are properly both Luciferic and Ahrimanic, attempting to draw the world and physical reality fully across Being into the illusion that material reality is all that is. It promises perfection and multiplicity, and will deliver the exact opposite. It, too, has a metaphysical goal, one which can be termed Anti-Christ.

The question is not whether this will end, of course it will. In wonderful words, a Greek citizen¹¹⁸ describes what is coming:

The common psychological traits of the corruption are what the ancients called alazoneia (brash presumption of knowledge by the ignorant) and anaishuntia (shamelessness)... One of the delusions is that there is a moral kernel in the country that we can turn to for consolation and renewal. There is no such thing. The corruption went too deep. The country is completely unprotected on the cultural and moral front. This too has not seeped in. And yet when people become desperate; when their world starts to crumble around them and all their delusions about themselves and their good life not only collapse, but do so without any legacy to fall back on and no dream to look forward to, then beware. We are in uncharted territory where Furies and Ate pilot the ship.

The last words of the Pythian oracle were said to be “Apollo will return a second time, this time, forever.” The question is when and how resistance will be offered, and in what state this “return” will find the world. In the West, there is still a wealth of potential forms which can be marshaled.

A chief goal of traditionalists, regardless of past failures and disappointments, could properly be to separate Christianity from those who would turn it into a vehicle of this degradation. “Decayed altars are inhabited by demons”, says Ernst Junger. Or, as Aristotle has it, “corruptio

¹¹⁸<http://www.firstthings.com/blogs/spengler/2010/02/12/greece-a-s-political-time-bomb/>

optima pessimi”. Christianity has tremendous pitfalls and problems, and for that very reason, is a prime battleground of opportunity.

It could be argued¹¹⁹ that the sacred text and tradition of Christianity is actually the very opposite of what it has been made to be, the partner of egalitarianism:

Recall, Andrewes’ argument begins with the existence of God—and communion with Him as the very substance of neighborly love. Egalitarianism tends to reverse this order making communion with God ancillary or a secondary to universal brotherhood. Not only this, but modernism also displaces the immediate and natural obligations of man for an abstracted “bodiless” mankind that has no necessary ties to either person, spouse, or family. Notice the degrees posited by Andrewes are in contradistinction to egalitarianism—i.e., 1) first, the dressing and feeding of our body, 2) then our spouse, 3) then providing for our children, 4) caring for extended family or ‘kindreds’, 5) friends and those we know, 6) compatriots, and, 7) finally, our church. Notice outward ethics, or the second tablet, really depend upon concentric relations and living these out. The reverse would otherwise make a man a louse, commanding him to love the extraordinary over the familiar. Also, we might suppose the church (#5) is further ordered between degrees of ecumenical, province, and parish since what wreck the greater church would be if all her individual local parts were in destitute?

Evil’s most effective means of stopping organic growth towards the Good is to counterfeit it, and to create confusion, such that genuine efforts are not recognized and come to nothing. This is occurring in our time and day with the Church. To continue to discredit the Church *per se* is to discredit Western civilization, and thus to plunge mankind further

¹¹⁹http://www.kinism.net/index.php/anglican/more/degrees_of_love/

and deeper into confusion, rendering the object of assault even weaker for the next attack.

Such a difficult position may seem unfair to those who “wake up”, but it is nonetheless real. This is why Gornahoor has repeatedly emphasized the need for personal struggle first, the *frein vital* or mastery of self-*manas*. Only such a one is equipped to enter the field of struggle without ultimate danger to the self or to others. It is in this struggle, and looked at in this manner, that the purest and most ultimate ground of commonality can be found with Christianity, which begins its Beatitudes with poverty of spirit, mourning, hungering & thirsting for righteousness, etc. Or, as Nicholas Gomez Davila¹²⁰ would say,

In the Christian obsessed with “social justice” it isn’t easy to discern whether charity is flourishing or faith is expiring.

All traditionalists and Christians should think about ways and means of personal transformation which can be (at least) potential ways and means of future union, the reconstruction of Esoteric Catholicism. As Seraphim of Sarov would say, the question is not one of *largeness of faith*, but of purity of faith, or *resolve*. Evola would call this *will*. They are very nearly the same thing. And for those who strive, they are one.

There is an older Christianity, not yet dead, which possesses this spirit, described by Sir Walter Scott in *Lay of the Last Minstrel*:

But earthly spirit could not tell
The heart of them that loved so well.
True love’s the gift which God has given
To man alone beneath the heaven.
It is not fantasy’s hot fire,
Whose wishes, soon as granted, fly;

¹²⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nicol%C3%A1s_G%C3%B3mez_D%C3%A1vila

It liveth not in fierce desire,
With dead desire it doth not die;
It is the secret sympathy,
The silver link, the silken tie,
Which heart to heart, and mind to mind,
In body and in soul can bind.

Can traditionalists not with this and with men of this heart find common cause?

Posted on 2011-07-29 by Logres

1.15 The Celestial & Super-Celestial

Exerpts from “Disputation Against the Judgement of the Astrologers”

Now because things always proceed in the same order, it is not by chance that there is some other determined cause outside matter and above the natural principle of agency, by whose intention individual things lead appropriately to the most perfect end. Unless one thing is so, the other cannot be.

Marsilio Ficino¹²¹ attacked the New Agers of his day; however, as we shall see, his aim was twofold – to establish Christianity against them, but to do so by incorporating truly Platonic insights which existed in potential already *in the very material which the astrologers were mutilating*. In other words, Ficino was adding to the tradition, rather than being a parasite (the condition that so many today embrace, whether “pro-tradition” or “anti-tradition”). There is no doubt this is a fine line, or as Christ would say, a “narrow gate”.

¹²¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Marsilio_Ficino

Now in the rational order of the heavens there is no tendency to defect, whereas under the heavens there exists in rational beings the tendency to defect of the will, but this does not derive from the rational part of their nature. In these beings the defect is brought back by God to the order of the good, that is, either into the order of justice through punishment or into the order of compassion through forgiveness.

In other words, there is such a thing as the Law of God, or *Lex Aeterna* (and indeed, always will be). Gurdjieff speaks of attaining an astral body which allows one to transcend or “jump over the moon”. Bondarev (via Steiner) speaks of Yahweh’s countenance being manifested under the lunar sign, that is, as a preparation to forming the astral body. The paideia¹²² of God has to occur prior as a formation or pre-evangelium; men have to have souls formed before their souls can be saved. Ficino’s hostility stems from his insight that contemporary astrologers were placing man “back under the stars and the moon”, in effect saying that the “external” world of illusion was pre-determinant and ultimate. This represented a regress, or retardive, influence on the Tradition. Mouraviff speaks of the internal “B-influences” which properly signaled the birth of the inner consciousness (complete only if one could then discern both A & C influence, and learn to use them consciously). The only way to graduate in this school or burden or task of God is to begin to transform the inner consciousness, both as regards itself, and as it regards the “outer” world. Hence the need for religion. On the contrary, both New Age & Progress-through-technology represent precisely that “externalization” which religions of older times engaged in during a process or cycle of decay; *man can only reach heaven by storm of the kingdom within*. Modernity hates religion so much because it sees in its caricature of such a direct competitor. This indicates occult influence. On the contrary, Ficino emphasizes a need for self-realization and transformation, rather than anything external.

¹²²<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Paideia>

But we answer that on the contrary, the dignity of the heavens is taken away if one tries to interpret the movements of the heavens and the force of the signs according to the nature of the lowly animals. Rather, one should say that the heavens give something to them rather than receive from them.

The stars help activate seeds of the Logos, and relate to physical forms by being exemplars and catalysts. Being born under Taurus does not make one hardworking, patient, servile – rather, as Ficino argues, it presents the soul born under such with certain possibilities, both good or bad. It is as the soul chooses in free will (a quality Ficino would agree *is only present by orientation to the Good*) that it actualizes aspects, dimensions, and perfections of these possibilities. The insights are only potentially there; most lack the metaphysics to activate them. This is why Gornahoor’s work is important.

And rightly, because the greater material part conforms to the greater material cause, so- this is most important – the formal part conforms to the formal causes, celestial and super-celestial.

Here we see Ficino acknowledging Being-Beyond-Being or the imperishable, which ultimately is potentially revealed in the rising spirit of the man who embraces personal alchemy. It is this man or woman who alone is “free”; to embrace planetary predestination (or inner liberation) without *soul-wisdom* of true free will is to fail to shape the potentials given to us “under the moon” & to become pejoratively pagan. Ficino is showing us what Christianity’s true aspiration should be – neither to abolish paganism, nor to relapse into it.

There are three kinds of foresight: firstly through divine infusion, secondly through natural instinct, thirdly through art. That which occurs through divine action includes divining through magical cult and the knowledge of daemons and spheres. That

which is natural is assisted by a certain melancholic temperament or tempered at the same time by a heavenly power, by which the mind easily gathers into itself and divines through its own divinity, or by the observation of heavenly patterns. Art has four kinds: the most common is medicine, the most uncommon astrology. Physiognomy is closer to medicine, divinization to astrology.

This is not child's play nor amateur stuff.

In all kinds of prediction judgement is very difficult: firstly because art is longer than a lifetime, but mainly because each art results, from the convergence of very many rules which are very different from each other, but each connected to the other. Secondly because the opportunities for judgement are limited, for neither is the mind always truthful nor do the things themselves exist in such a way that can be easily explained. Thirdly because experiential knowledge is faulty; since many factors can point to the same thing, it can scarcely be discerned by which one such or such an effect will proceed most powerful, and because experiments are not similar unless wholly similar in time and material. Fourthly because judgement itself is very difficult, not only for the same reasons, but also on account of the errors encroaching on the mind from the imagination and body. Here Isaiah says 'tell me the things to come and I will call you gods'... lastly, through whatever art future things are questioned, they are foretold more completely from a certain gift of the soul, than through judgement. Here those who are unlearned in the art often judge more truthfully than those who are learned.

I want to note that the last emphasis (the same emphasis we found in the Pope's recent pronouncement on Pseudo-Dionysius) is not an invitation to cheap grace or modern "Christendumb". It is an emphasis on the virtue of Faith, which is predicated on childlike (not childish) Sincerity

and Simplicity, just as the virtue of Hope is predicated on strength or fortitude, and the final virtue of Love is predicated on a successful passing of the “steps” or “tests” which are undergone in the formation of the second “astral” body. This is done under the union of the chakras through the heart, in subjection to the Lex Aeterna, which enables one to orient one’s self in contact with the new reality uncovered in the second birth. This is the basis of alchemical Christianity, which was incarnated in Christian Europe, and which depended for its strength upon just such an awareness of Truth, even in the beginning stages. For better or worse, Christianity represented a collective cultural effort to make esotericism “available” for the masses without sacrificing the ideals. This the meaning of the Icon.

Hopefully, the above excerpts can serve to indicate a common direction in which Christians & pagans alike can move which will be pleasing to the Creator, & can alone lead to liberation into the freedom that all rational beings yearn towards, incidentally providing deliverance from the Brave New World by making us “undigestible” (since the goal of occult influence is precisely an inversion of this by “processing” everyone into the lowest common denominator, which can only be decay & a shadow world of death). A good example of this for moderns might be Julian Lee¹²³, who endeavors to unite Eastern meditation, Christian devotion, and awareness of astrological patterns in his geographical astrological work. However, those who rightly fear delusion will be wise to “test all the spirits” and to seek the wisdom that comes from God, since these are times in which even the elect can scarcely stand.

Excerpts taken from Ficino¹²⁴, a book in the Esoteric series, edited by Angela Voss.

Posted on 2011-08-06 by Logres

¹²³<http://www.celibacy.info/>

¹²⁴<http://www.amazon.com/Marsilio-Ficino-Western-Esoteric-Masters/dp/1556435606>

1.16 The Seven Steps of Esoteric Christianity

What had so often occurred individually within the Mystery schools, far from external events, took place openly within Jesus Christ in outer world history.

RUDOLPH STEINER

Despite Evola's condemnation of Steiner as a "hopeless muddle", a closer look into Christianity can uncover patterns that might make us take Steiner more seriously. Steiner's seven steps of initiation closely correspond to passages from 2 Peter & The Beatitudes (mirrored in the *Shepherd of Hermas*) which represent a very ancient template for The Way (of Christ), a template also duplicated in shorter form in St. Paul's "Faith, Hope, (Knowledge) & Love" (in which "Hope" can be read to stand for the middle virtues of Goodness, Knowledge, Self-Control, Fortitude, Godliness, & Brotherly Affection listed in 2 Peter.

5 For this very reason, make every effort to add to your faith goodness; and to goodness, knowledge; 6 and to knowledge, self-control; and to self-control, perseverance; and to perseverance, godliness; 7 and to godliness, mutual affection; and to mutual affection, love.
8 For if you possess these qualities in increasing measure, they will keep you from being ineffective and unproductive in your knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.

As George Heart points out¹²⁵, this formula was supposed to be used by the Church to progress from naked Pistis & Dogma, through to actualized positive spiritual knowledge, and finally the Pleroma of Love, which is not merely a state of Being, but actually the highest state of Being.

¹²⁵<http://www.amazon.com/Christianity-Dogmatic-Gnostic-Vivifying-Knowledge/dp/1412062284>

The *Ekklesia* (for a number of reasons) has been unwilling & unable to perform this mission – to admit that the current Matrix would not exist without the Church would be the first step, but to strip down to truth is painful, although it would allow the Church to perceive that which could be done, which still inheres in the potentialities of our decline as “intimations of deprivation”.

Rudolf Steiner¹²⁶ lists the seven steps of initiation, which can be accomplished through meditation and the final step of a specific dream:

The neophyte who meditates on this theme for months and years has a vision of the Washing of the Feet in the astral world during sleep. Then he is ready to pass to the second stage of the Christian initiation.

The entire Schemata of Steiner follows (my suggestions in parentheses – Faith is assumed to begin the possibility of initiation):

1. The Washing of the Feet. (Goodness?)
2. The Scourging. (Knowledge?)
3. The Crowning with Thorns. (Self-Control?)
4. The Bearing of the Cross. (Perseverance?)
5. The Mystic Death. (Godliness?)
6. The Entombment. (Brotherly Affection?)
7. The Resurrection. (Love?)

¹²⁶<http://wn.rsarchive.org/Lectures/EsoCosmo/19060601p01.html>

As we are trying to see, these steps are roughly equivalent to the seven steps of growing Faith (*Pistis*), which must proceed towards *and even through* knowledge to stay alive. For example, Scourging can be viewed as a trial of *Knowledge*, since only those who truly understand & value rightly the external world (*Gott und die Welt*), holding it with a light hand, can accomplish this heavy task; let us look in more detail:

The Scourging, — At this stage man learns to resist the scourgings of life. Life brings sufferings of all kinds — physical, moral, intellectual, spiritual. Life is felt to be a dreadful and incessant torture. The disciple must endure it with perfect equanimity of soul and heroic courage. He must cease to know physical or moral fear. When he has become fearless, he sees, in dream, the scene of the Scourging. In another vision he sees himself in the Christ Who is scourged. Certain symptoms in physical life accompany this event. There is an intensification of the life of feeling, a wider sense of life and of love. We have an example of heightened sensibility transferred to the world of intelligence, in the life of Goethe.

In this “matching” of the virtues with Steiner’s steps, Faith is assumed & comes previously to the first initiation, and so Faith is but the beginning; initiations follow to allow the disciple to ascend the seven “following” heavens.

Interestingly enough, the “Scourging” was rumored to have occurred during the torture of Knights Templars during their suppression — the intense doubt & pain caused by the ordeal supposedly brought some of the knights to manifest Baphomet, who would have been one of the guardians of the lower regions of the soul, a double to the higher soul. It was taken as proof of guilt, although it may have simply represented the failure (under duress) of a Templar to pass a stage of growing initiations.

In the course of the stage in the Christian initiation known as the Crowning with Thorns, there arises the phenomenon known as

the Guardian of the Threshold — *the appearance of the lower double of man*. The spiritual being of man, composed of his impulses of will, his desires and his thoughts, appears to the Initiate in visible form. It is a form that is sometimes repugnant and terrible, for it is the offspring of his good and bad desires and of his karma — it is their personification in the astral world, the Evil Pilot of the Egyptian Book of the Dead. This form must be conquered by man before he can find the higher Self. The Guardian of the Threshold which has been a phenomenon of astral vision from times immemorial, is the origin of all the myths concerning the struggles of Heroes with monsters, of Perseus and Hercules with the Hydra, of St. George and Siegfried with the dragon.

The rest of the initiations can be matched up nicely¹²⁷ with the template of virtue begun in, and common to, the Beatitudes, 2 Peter, Paul's project of gnosis (which summarizes the middle virtues as "Hope" and makes explicit the command to begin in Faith), & the Shepherd of Hermas. Regardless of whether one accepts Steiner's account or links it with the early Christian community, this pattern which intertwines Exoteric expression (Faith is an exoteric "virtue") with esoteric "fullness" (Faith must be regarded as "passing away") is present in the foundational documents of the ancient Christian religion. It may be possible to also relate the "nine true parts of the fully human" to this template of virtues. Steiner also lectures on this mystery¹²⁸ (which by the way matches Mouravieff's division of the human person into three centers with three subdivisions).

1. Physical – Corporatio – Embodiment
2. Ether or life body – Nativitas – Birth

¹²⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2619>

¹²⁸<http://www.doyletics.com/arj/christia.htm>

3. Astral – Circumcisio – Circumcision
4. I — sentient soul – Apparitio – Appearance
5. I — intellectual soul – Passio – Suffering
6. I — consciousness soul- Mors – Death
7. Manas — spirit self – Resurrectio – Resurrection
8. Buddhi — life spirit – Gloria – Glory
9. Atman — spirit body – Regnum – Kingdom

Even if the pattern is contested, the idea of Faith the seed growing organically into a celestial body¹²⁹ of Love is virtually incontestible. The virtues are living & active (or should be) as their Lord the Spirit.

These patterns abound in Scripture, and elsewhere in the Christian Tradition. The last words of the Lord's Prayer are "thine is the kingdom, the power, & the glory forever". Here we see the repetition of 3's – the Kingdom is the Archetype (and also the return, the end of the mystery, when God is "all in all" according to Colossians), the Power is the Incarnation (Christ is not just "an" avatar, but the Lord of avatars), & the Glory is the Spirit (who is the more subtle and feminine element in the Godhead). Here again we find a ritualistic formula whose real meaning has been lost; there are others, such as the Spirit, the water, & the blood. Here we may hazard a guess that water is associated with soul-death, the moon, and Old Testament rites – hence, Yahweh, or the Archetype. The blood is flesh and man, so – the Incarnate Form of God. And so on. More research in esoteric sources (or helpful or knowledgeable readers) may be able to add to this.¹³⁰

Posted on 2011-08-12 by Logres

¹²⁹http://members.ozemail.com.au/~moorea/peter_keys_kingdom.html

¹³⁰A Catholic theologian who could serve as a bridge: <http://www.scribd.com/d>

1.17 Lesser & Greater Mysteries

Boris Mouravieff's Gnosis¹³¹ is a bridge between the Lesser Mysteries of orthodox Christianity and the Greater Mysteries promised in the Nordic tradition, as is clear from Mouravieff's passage concerning the existence of two types of humanity on earth:

In the first volume of 'Gnosis', we had already referred several times to this coexistence of two essentially different races: one of Men, and another of Anthropoids. We must emphasize the fact that from the esoteric point of view the latter term has no derogatory meaning. First constated very long ago, this fact, although it has been distorted because it is generally seen in a false light, was part of the national, social and judicial consciousness of many ancient and modern peoples. One finds its influence in the Indian idea of the Untouchable, the Greek Helot, the Jewish Goy, the medieval European white Bones and black Bones, the German Nazi Untermensch, etc. ... Incidentally, the legend of blue blood does not belong to the domain of pure fantasy. The error is not in the conception of blue blood as a 'psychosomatic' phenomenon, but in the naive medieval belief that this so-called aristocratic blood passes automatically from father to son. Readers of 'Gnosis' will easily understand the reasons why this attribute can belong only to twice born beings...

Here we see that "the sons of God" & "daughters of men" are a type — hence, male and female are not unalterable indicators of metaphysical status, nor is skin color; still, the physical type indicates or symbolizes a deeper truth, and is not without significance. More importantly, here we

oc/5994483/Jean-Borella-Gnosis-and-AntiChristian-Gnosis (like Steiner) between esotericists and the *Ekklesia* is Jean Borella: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Borella

¹³¹http://www.bibliotecapleyades.net/archivos_pdf/mouravieff3.pdf

see Mouravieff bringing sacred & secular tradition together — this is the spirit of the Traditionalist – to glean and to synthesize, without slavishly or formulistically following the an expected path (something Gurdjieff¹³² also emphasized).

Mouravieff makes this even more clear here:

Let us make an analogy: a navigator knows how to steer his ship toward any point on the seas or oceans without having been there before. To learn how to do this, he studied the science of navigation, which combines several subjects, such as nautical astronomy; in addition, he learned the use of certain instruments, such as the compass, the sextant, the chronometer, the log, the lead, etc., which enable him to find his position. What is more, he has marine charts at his disposal, and a whole library where he can find a detailed description of every corner of the seas, oceans, islands, of the coasts of continents, of the routes of access to all the gulfs, bays, roadsteads, pons, etc. All these elements form the method of approaching the solution to each problem he encounters in his work. Strong in his knowledge and savoir-faire, this navigator, when he receives his captain's order, can make his plans and steer his ship to its destination by the shortest way, although he has never been there before.

Here we see there are no guarantees, but a method is possible, where there is a will.

The current of 'B' influences from the Absolute II was received by Moses, who transmitted them to his people. It was this that made Israel different from the other nations, who lived immersed in 'A' influences under the religious domination of tribal gods. Having thus become the chosen people, depositories of the higher

¹³²<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2tRlNdK00HY&feature=related>

revelation, they received the Promise of the Advent of the Christ-Redeemer, of their own Redemption and that of the other nations through their ministry. Now the Jewish conception of Jehovah was originally the tribal god of Judah, but was later recognized by the other tribes, although with reservations. It was thus elevated to the rank of God of Israel, yet in the religious imagination of the Jews it was never raised above the attributes of the Absolute III, even when, much later, the monotheist conception of the one God came to light. This was a question of a relative monotheism, placing at the height of the celestial pyramid a sort of Demiurge, ('craftsman' in Greek), Jehovah, who was precisely established in the consciousness of the Jewish people as the God of Israel. This deviation is important. It even penetrated into Christianity. In the catechisms we find that Jehovah, (the God of Israel or the image of the Absolute III), is confused with God the Father, the Creator of the Universe.

This is Gornahoor's interest in parsing the Yahweh of the OT from God the Father, and even Jesus' Father, of the NT. One cannot disentangle the doctrines without separating the persons (at least in theory). This is not to commit to being a Marcionite; Bondarev argues that Yahweh is the face of God at a particular point in time, & that Michael is his face now.

Solomon's fall consolidated the traditional dualism that, until then, been intermittent, clearly giving it the meaning and form of an esoteric split. David's Christian tradition, neglected, deformed and largely forgotten by the ruling elite of the chosen people, who were preoccupied with political problems, was received and kept chiefly by the simple people — rarely by intellectuals — and continued to make its way silently through the centuries. After the split, the psychic and non-spiritual branch of the Tradition developed its own esotericism, second-class (if one may say so), since it

was limited within the boundaries of the Absolute Ill's authority. In its turn, this ritualistic esotericism gave birth to a whole science, equally traditional and hermetic, with Solomon as its head — Solomon, who is sometimes taken for God himself. Connected with the Temple, this Solomonist tradition of initiation was saved after the destruction of the temple by Titus in 70. This was the last calamity, and gave the signal for the dispersal of Israel. Having become occult, it continued to exist, carefully protected from local Christian persecutions, until the Arab conquest of Palestine gave it a refuge. The ruins of the Temple served as a rallying point and as a sacred symbol for its adepts. Thanks to the Crusades, contacts were established when European knights came to the Holy Land and settled there. The legend of the Knights Templar finding Solomon's treasure in the Temple ruins and making it an object of their special initiations, even though allowed by the Pope, surrounded the White-Coats with the mystical halo of a higher occult science as a complement to their Catholic confession, which remained effective. Parallel to this the Jews, dispersed all over the world, brought their mysticism, which was of Solomonist origin, into Western Europe, where it flourished in their ghettos during the Middle Ages.

Mouravieff here dismisses Masonism, & at the same time explains its association with the Jewish movement in the West, as well as secularization. The important point here is that we need to choose David (a prophet) over Solomon (an earthly king). David was *both*.

It is surprising to constate how easily Christian seekers, (or at any rate, those of Christian origin), brush aside the purely Christian Tradition of Moses-Elias-David which Jesus enriched with the New Testament, along with its projection into the future contained in the Gnosis revealed by our Lord after His Resurrection. Too often, seekers of perfectly good faith omit the Gospel and the Epistles, and delve into the Old Testament and the Solomonist

psychic tradition. Theoretically, this research is not harmful. *But if we take into account Jesus' principle by which the disciple cannot be greater than the master*, the work of these seekers cannot lead them any higher than a narrow psychic esotericism, limited to the domain of the Absolute III.

The important sentence is “a disciple is not greater than the master” – this is why it is critical to avoid problems in esoteric work which are easily avoided, such as choosing lesser masters, lesser mysteries, lesser paths, all of which really equal the lesser self. Disharmonic focus on pet issues or ideologies will obscure the real matter. Look at the Third Reich, if you doubt this. Choose wisely. Where the treasure is, there the heart is also.

Great Eternity therefore appears as the Great Cycle of Manifestation, encompassing the whole scale of subordinate Cycles and relative Eternities, as well as all Times, which are also relative. Thus it contains the Beginning — the first creative impulse that begins from the Absolute 0—and goes all the way to the End, that is, to the general and absolute Accomplishment. In this it passes down the whole length of the scale of the Macrocosmos, which contains all relative Accomplishments. The Love from the Absolute 0 fills all Manifestation to its uttermost limits, in all directions and all its specificities, under the aegis of the Absolute I and through the person of the Absolute II, after which, enriched by all the experience gained from one end of the scale to the other, including the kingdom of the Absolute III, it returns to its source in a primitive, unmanifest state at the heart of the Inexpressible. **Certain teachings consider this End of ends as a General Annihilation. This is an aberration caused by the psychological structure of our intellect, which is incapable of conceiving ideas outside time and space**, although, in scientific speculation and with the aid of mathematical ideas, we can reach a generally accepted conclusion of the relativity of both. It is a question of an abstraction which, pushed to the limit, is out of reach of the imagination

to which human beings can claim to have access solely by means of their Personality in its so-called ‘normal’ state, which is an underdeveloped condition.

This gives us an answer to worry over the question of “annihilating one’s self in God”, which had so troubled Evola. Mouravieff’s primary concern was to re-vivify the strain of David-Elijah-Jesus and make it public, thereby guaranteeing the safety of the “Great Work” of the second birth. This effort can be seen as a means of uniting the Greater & the Lesser Mysteries, as well as explaining where the Masonic initiations and Jewish influences were a sidetrack for the West.

In summary, Mouravieff’s work would appear to be an actual blueprint for reconstructing an esoteric tradition (in that he purports to pass down a valid and real Eastern Orthodox version), a tradition which would actually by a complete Cosmology capable of inter-relating both Romanity & the Nordic mythos.

Posted on 2011-08-26 by Logres

* * *

Cologero on 2011-08-29 at 00:26 said:

What did you mean by this statement: “male and female are not inalterable indicators of metaphysical status”?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-08-29 at 08:02 said:

Firstly, this paragraph rings very true thank you: The important sentence is “a disciple is not greater than the master” – this is why it is critical to avoid problems in esoteric work which are easily avoided, such as choosing lesser masters, lesser mysteries, lesser paths, all of which really equal the lesser self. Disharmonic focus on pet issues or ideologies will obscure the real matter. Look at the Third Reich, if you doubt this. Choose wisely. Where the treasure is, there the heart is also.

Secondly, where you talk about the worrying question of ‘annihilating one’s self in God’ (apparently this is inevitable at some stage or other), a little phrase springs to mind as the (re)solution: Solve et Coagula. So yes we will be annihilated, but there is also the possibility of reconstruction closer to the image of God. As it says in the Rubbaiyat:

Ah Love! could thou and I with Fate conspire
To grasp this sorry Scheme of Things entire,
Would we not shatter it to bits – and then
Re-mould it nearer to the Heart's Desire!

logres on 2011-08-29 at 08:38 said:

Poorly phrased – I was suggesting that biological sex is significant, but that it does not preclude (in the case of the woman) an experience of the mysteries.

1.18 The Church that was Left Behind

For many Christians, referring to a “secret Gospel” is either presumptuous, dangerous, or absurd — perhaps a bit of all three. And, indeed, such fears are usually the case with those who go in quest of Gnostic hierophanies¹³³ – just witness the popular mesmerization over the Da Vinci code novels and the “secret Gospels” (as if someone could read them & suddenly become enlightened with an alternative dogma-system). However, as Gornahoor has endeavored to demonstrate¹³⁴, there are important episodes of early Church history which intimate that much was lost (as perhaps, gained) during the *Ekklesia*’s struggle to accrete and purify the core dogmas. Clement’s *Stromata* represent such an effort:

Again he says that those who are “still blind and dumb, not having understanding, or the un-dazzled and keen vision of the contemplative soul . . . must stand outside of the divine choir. . . . Wherefore, in accordance with the method of concealment, the truly sacred Word, truly divine and most necessary for us, deposited in the shrine of truth, was by the Egyptians indicated by what were called among them adyta, and by the Hebrews by the

¹³³<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hierophany>

¹³⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2091#more-2091>

veil. Only the consecrated . . . were allowed access to them. For Plato also thought it not lawful for ‘the impure to touch the pure. Thence the prophecies and oracles are spoken in enigmas, and the Mysteries are not exhibited incontinently to all and sundry, but only after certain Page 69 purifications and previous instructions”. Ibid., bk.V, ch.iv. He then descants at great length on Symbols, expounding Pythagorean, Hebrew, Egyptian, Ibid, ch. v-viii and then remarks that the ignorant and unlearned man fails in understanding them. “But the Gnostic apprehends. Now then it is not wished that all things should be exposed indiscriminately to all and sundry, or the benefits of wisdom communicated to those who have not even in a dream been purified in soul (for it is not allowed to hand to every chance comer what has been procured with such laborious efforts); nor are the Mysteries of the Word to be expounded to the profane”. The Pythagoreans and Plato, Zeno, and Aristotle had exoteric and esoteric teachings. The philosophers established the Mysteries, for “was it not more beneficial for the holy and blessed contemplation of realities to be concealed?” Ibid., ch. ix. The Apostles also approved of “veiling the Mysteries of the Faith”, “for there is an instruction to the perfect”, alluded to in Colossians i, 9-11 and 25-27.

So that, on the one hand, then, there are the Mysteries which were hid till the time of the Apostles, and were delivered by them as they were received from the Lord, Page 70 and, concealed in the Old Testament, were manifested to the saints. And, on the other hand, there is ‘the riches of the glory of the mystery in the Gentiles,’ which is faith and hope in Christ; which in another place he has called the “foundation”. He quotes S. Paul to show that this “knowledge belongs not to all”, and says, referring to Heb. v. and vi., that “*there were certainly among the Hebrews, some things delivered unwritten*”; and then refers to S. Barnabas, who speaks of God, “who has put into our hearts wisdom and the understanding of His secrets”, and says that “it is but for few to

comprehend these things”, as showing a “trace of Gnostic tradition”. “Wherefore instruction, which reveals hidden things, is called illumination, as it is the teacher only who uncovers the lid of the ark”. Ibid., bk. V, ch. x Further referring to S. Paul, he comments on his remark to the Romans that he will “come in the fullness of the blessing of Christ, Loc. Cit, XX, 29.” a and says that he thus designates “the spiritual gift and the Gnostic interpretation, which being present he desires to impart to them present as ‘ the fullness of Christ, according to the revelation of the Mystery sealed in the ages of eternity, but now manifested by the prophetic Page 71 Scriptures’ Ibid., xvi;ten, 25-26; the version quoted differs in words, but not in meaning, from the English Authorised VersionBut only to a few of them is shown what those things are which are contained in the Mystery. Rightly, then, Plato, in the epistles, treating of God, says: ‘ *We must speak in enigmas; that should the tablet come by any mischance on its leaves either by sea or land, he who reads may remain ignorant*’.” Stromata, bk. V, ch. x After much examination of Greek writers, and an investigation into philosophy, S. Clement declares that the Gnosis “imparted and revealed by the Son of God, is wisdom. . . . And the Gnosis itself is that which has descended by transmission to a few, having been imparted unwritten by the Apostles”. Ibid., bk. VI, ch. vii A very long exposition of the life of the Gnostic, the Initiate, is given, and S. Clement concludes it by saying: “Let the specimen suffice to those who have ears. For it is not required to unfold the mystery, but only to indicate what is sufficient for those who are partakers in knowledge to bring it to mind”. Ibid., bk. VII, ch. xiv. Regarding Scripture as consisting of allegories and symbols, and as hiding the sense in order to Page 72 stimulate enquiry and to preserve the ignorant from danger. Ibid., bk. VI, ch. xv. S. Clement naturally confined the higher instruction to the learned. “Our Gnostic will be deeply learned”, Ibid., bk. VI, x he says. “Now the Gnostic must be erudite”. Ibid., bk. VI,

vii Those who had acquired readiness by previous training could master the deeper knowledge, for though “a man can be a believer without learning, so also we assert that it is impossible for a man without learning to comprehend the things which are declared in the faith”. Ibid., bk. I, ch. vi “Some who think themselves naturally gifted, do not wish to touch either philosophy or logic; nay more, they do not wish to learn natural science. They demand bare faith alone. . . So also I call him truly learned who brings everything to bear on the truth — so that, from geometry, and music, and grammar, and philosophy itself, culling what is useful, he guards the faith against assault. How necessary is it for him who desires to be partaker of the power of God, to treat of intellectual subjects by philosophising”. Ibid., ch. ix. ”The Gnostic avails himself of branches of learning as auxiliary Page 73 preparatory exercise.” Ibid., BK. VI, ch. x. So far was S. Clement from thinking that the teaching of Christianity should be measured by the ignorance of the unlearned. “He who is conversant with all kinds of wisdom will be pre-eminently a Gnostic”. Ibid., bk. I, ch. xiii. ” Thus while he welcomed the ignorant and the sinner, and found in the Gospel what was suited to their needs, he considered that only the learned and the pure were fit candidates for the Mysteries. “The Apostle, in contradistinction to Gnostic perfection, calls the common faith the foundation, and sometimes milk”, Vol.XII. Stromata, bk. V, ch. iv. but on that foundation the edifice of the Gnosis was to be raised, and the food of men was to succeed that of babes.

True Gnosticism was (in other words) an entrance to the “Greater Mysteries” which either could (or perhaps “had”) to begin in the “Lesser Mysteries”; it was to be accomplished by an elite of spirit & mind, and would involve the re-integration of all human learning into Hermetic (ie., underground) frameworks.

These are the commentaries of Annie Besant¹³⁵, a theosophical¹³⁶ writer from the last century. It is discouraging to see that such things have been brought to the attention of the educated Christian public long before, but apparently with only the result that confidence in the Faith has been undermined, without putting anything in its place (presumably this is why Evola disapproved of Steiner & Besant). Gornahoor has emphasized (with Evola) that it is “not a matter of showing the same misunderstanding towards Christianity as Christianity has often showed to everything else”. When A. Besant was struggling to keep her faith & requested more books to assist her, the leader¹³⁷ of the Catholic Anglican Revival told her “she had read too much already”.

Likewise, the same obtuseness is encountered from Eastern Orthodox Christians when Origen, Clement, or John Philoponus is brought up – of all the Big Three branches of the Faith, one would think the Orthodox would be sympathetic to those who are given “bad press”, even if by a Church Council. However, this is how it stands – the Church will not budge when one begins to read the Bible like the Bereans, and inquires as to the “mysteries” of the Faith – they are told that they are perfectly embodied (and imperfectly understood) in the completed Dogmas. Apparently, there are even accounts available which trace back to Peter’s¹³⁸ journeys (although they cannot possibly stem from Clement himself, who was born many years after). Given the resurfacing of the Nag Hammadi hoard (immediately after the apocalyptic World Wars), as well as existence of such monuments as the *Stromata*, the Church’s behavior is utterly inexplicable. To sum it up perfectly, the Church has declared *by fiat* that exoteric truth is the only kind of truth which exists.

¹³⁵http://www.theosophical.ca/books/EsotericChristianity_AnnieBesant.pdf

¹³⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Annie_Besant

¹³⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Edward_Bouverie_Pusey

¹³⁸<http://jacksonsnnyder.com/arc/bible-news/apostolia/pdf/ALL-CLEME-NT-6x9-120707-embedded.pdf>

It seems intent on preserving an orthodoxy which has been shown (to even the most casual eye) to have been largely a product of intense control, a control arguably necessary both then and even now, but which cannot possibly be exhaustive. The only possible route which could save the Ekklesia is to explore the very foundations of the Faith “once delivered to the saints” and see if (possibly) the “living ground and pillar of the Truth” could refer, not necessarily to those who write the official Church histories, but to those who have actually helped co-create or sub-create a Reality which is responsive to the truly transcendent and divine image in man, an image both solar and masculine reached for in the Book of Revelation¹³⁹, written by the apostle of the eagle¹⁴⁰ – John.

It is only in the light of such a Sun that the lesser lights and mysteries (such as the Moon) can have their own lumination. Does the *Ekklesia* wish to remain forever a vehicle at best of the lesser mysteries, or does it wish to take its rightful place as the inheritor of the secret fire¹⁴¹? If it does not, its own Scripture testifies against it, that it will be spit out as lukewarm, or even caught up in the heresy of the Anti-Christ¹⁴² (a fear which dominated the thoughts of the long-suffering Russian Church of the last century) –

For the mystery of iniquity doth already work: only he who now letteth will let, until he be taken out of the way.

Surely, if there was an earthly Jerusalem, and she is fallen, we have a greater – a heavenly Jerusalem, the true mother above. *The Protestant whim about the “invisible Church” may be more true than they imagine.* And if the chosen ones called Jews were cut off to graft in the Gentiles,

¹³⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k9IfHDi-2EA>

¹⁴⁰<https://www.amazon.com/Voice-Eagle-Heart-Celtic-Christianity/dp/0970109709>

¹⁴¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sacred_fire_of_Vesta

¹⁴²http://www.berdyaev.com/berdiaev/berd_lib/1913_170.html

how much more should the *Ekklesia* be jealous to guard the true sanctity of her mysteries, lest the Church itself be slain, since judgement begins with the house of God? Rather than attempting to define itself against a tradition which distanced itself from Divine Tradition as it unfolded (the Jews), the modern Church has pursued a philo-Semitic course; in another context (that of real Judaic tradition) this might be worthwhile, yet it places the *Ekklesia* in the position of sharing the same literal, awkward interpretation of the Scriptures which men like Origen¹⁴³ attributed to the Semitic spirit, and which the early Fathers ridiculed in Jew and pagan alike.

Posted on 2011-09-02 by Logres

1.19 True North

It goes without saying, that nobody initiates anybody else, if we understand by initiation the mystery of the Second Birth, the great sacrament, the initiation from above which is operative from above and has the value and duration of eternity. The Initiator is above...

VALENTIN TOMBERG¹⁴⁴

This truth is not a “Christian” truth per se, but a “great Truth” or mystery *inherent in the pagan sacraments themselves*. Had not Christianity elucidated them, doubtless some other higher vehicle or divine pattern

¹⁴³https://books.google.com/books?id=UC0eWGKHa9YC&pg=PA112&lpg=PA112&dq=CLEMENT+SECRET+GNOSIS&source=bl&ots=PKa9DTVJav&sig=0Dd0rSifdZ2VRT-MLg_LMI3BInA&hl=en&ei=i6HZTZb2C8nq0QG25Jz8Aw&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=3&ved=0CBwQ6AEwAjgK#v=onepage&q=origen&f=false

¹⁴⁴http://www.gornahoor.net/library/Meditations_versionTwo.pdf

would have impressed itself upon the heated wax of the human element which had emerged around the Mediterranean Basin in the years of Augustus, Pax Romana (for example, had Saint Paul not fulfilled his calling of being the thirteenth apostle untimely born to replace Judas). Hermeticism admits no division in the Infinite between sacred or secular (contra modern Christendom) and permits no dichotomy between natural and artificial (contra modern Paganism); rather, the Hermetic current (which is really the predestined energy of the divine) moves back and forth between earth and heaven, body and spirit, pagan and Christian, ascending the *Scala Naturae*¹⁴⁵ or Jacob's Ladder, sometimes rising on a quest, sometimes descending on a mission. As Tomberg meditates, the hermit is neither active nor contemplative (nor any other such dichotomy) – rather, he walks. He is a hermit-pilgrim.

Doubtless this is frustrating to some minds; it is, however, very illuminating to many spirits who cannot seem to find a “home” in the pre-arranged boxes of normal (or abnormal) life. Did Gornahoor convert me from my Christian blinkers I wore? Certainly – however, there is a sense in which it was meant to happen regardless, and when it did, it was (as Plato teaches) a re-discovery of what was already there.

Re-reading many of Gornahoor's old posts, I was struck by how many “answers” have been outlined here; how quickly I forget the painstaking groundwork of the founding father(s). Is there a lesson here, about being forgetful? Does self-complacency induce automatic amnesia? Yet here, if one wills to see and accept, is enough metaphysical form and experiential datum to begin the long yet blessed trip to the True North. Let us examine a small and seemingly superficial incident in the life of the Church and England, to poetically illustrate what True North can be. We begin by reminding ourselves of the teaching, through a prism:

To teach with kindly benevolence, not to lose one's temper and

¹⁴⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_chain_of_being

avenge the unreasonableness of others, that is the virile energy of the South that is followed by the well-bred man. To sleep on a heap of arms and untanned skins, to die unflinching and as if dying were not enough, that is the virile energy of the North that is followed by the brave man.

Evola is here quoting a Chinese sage¹⁴⁶, and it is worth noting that the superlative paragons of Southron and Northerner are both regarded under the rubric of excellence and true North; the Southerner could not be compassionate without the polar light. However, our genetics and earthly lives mean something.

We know that the geographical patterns of Earth mimic, mirror, and ultimately embody the imperishable realm of true spirit. Even someone as “Christian” as CS Lewis could grasp this concept all on his own – but then, even Christians aren’t like Lewis¹⁴⁷ any more.

The ontological blueprint, or map of meaning, which Lewis presents is both economical and easy on the eye. Each of the cardinal directions (North, South, etc.) has a significance that is simple but allows Lewis to adequately describe the philosophical atmosphere of earth—a realm where asceticism and hedonism clash, while the supernatural exerts a haunting magnetism on either side.

“This sweet Desire cuts across our ordinary distinctions between wanting and having. To have it is, by definition, a want: to want it, we find, is to have it.” Lewis presents a vision of the world that has the memorable lines of Narnia, in that it both embodies and transcends temporal reality. The terrain of *Pilgrim’s Regress*—frozen North, swampy South and inexplicable “Grand

¹⁴⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chung_Yung

¹⁴⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Pilgrim%27s_Regress

Canyon”— will be hard to forget. All the more so because I trace the same landscapes with my spirit.¹⁴⁸

There is also the strange coincidence¹⁴⁹ of Lewis’ conversion at or around the time of the Sudha’s death, and Lewis’ literary allusion to this fact in *That Hideous Strength*. Did Sudha Singh¹⁵⁰ represent a candle lit at the time of George MacDonald’s death, a candle then passed as a torch to Lewis? It is a strange thought.

It is a well-known, but poorly understood, fact of English literary and philosophical history that the group known as the Inklings (including their predecessors Chesterton and MacDonald) were engaged in a project of re-mythologizing that which had been de-mythologized, a project cut short by the War and the deaths of certain key members.

And if we believe that God is everywhere, why should we not think Him present even in the coincidences that sometimes seem so strange? For if He be in the things that coincide, He must be in the coincidence of those things.

Although Lewis’ love for things “northern” was certainly original enough with him, these things tend to have coincidences or connections with other events; Charles Williams’ (his colleague) might have termed them “co-inherences”. MacDonald was very interested in exploring the consciousness of man, as well as the possibility of a salvific role for imagination, which was magnetic towards true North¹⁵¹. Is it possible that

¹⁴⁸<https://bittersweetblue.blogspot.com/2006/07/pilgrims-regress-c-s-lewis.html>

¹⁴⁹http://www.george-macdonald.com/resources/sundar_singh.html

¹⁵⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sadhu_Sundar_Singh

¹⁵¹http://www.snc.edu/english/documents/North_Wind/By_genre_or_topic/Theology/Shadows_that_Fall=The_Immanence_of_Heaven_in_the_Fiction_of_C.S._Lewis_and_George_MacDonald_-_David_Manley.pdf

something cannot be imagined to begin with (I speak here of higher imagination, rather than the modern tendency towards sexual fantasy) unless *it already is*? Or does the imagination make it so, by being *the already is*, and the become? The Inklings were chasing the “holiness of the heart’s affections”; what they had dimly realized was that imagination represented a living Being and a creative power.

Certainly, their philosophical background enabled this. Lewis and the other Inklings (including Williams and Barfield) were basically Platonists; they had no use for a vision of reality which excluded the golden Chain of Being¹⁵², which used to be a uniquely Western formulation of a much older religion, and which formed the basis of well-bred men’s worldviews, since Boethius and Augustine, who located the Forms in the mind of God.

To believe in a hierarchical world that was orderly, invisible, higher, and transcendent was also to accept (by necessity) that this primordial Being was immanent, effective, real, and con-substantial with Nature – the more man came to understand this, the more he was able to embody these same ideals in a way that both diffused and intensified them. For a long, long time, the West moved in this orbit, and preserved the central truth while creating a strong civilization of altar and hearth, which persisted until the mid 19th century in dominating both the mind and the heart, at least in theory, often in practice.

It wasn’t a compassion-filled, Protestant revival which gave us the only culture-group modern American Christians can call their own, but rather a neo-Platonic, Oxford educated, contemplative or hermetic, literary group of semi-celibate men, whose very brief association gave rise to enormous influence. Later on, TS Eliot would attempt to speak of the objective correlative¹⁵³, and long before, Samuel Taylor Coleridge sus-

¹⁵²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_chain_of_being

¹⁵³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Objective_correlative

pected¹⁵⁴ many of these truths.

Lewis' *Discarded Image*, Williams' *The Descent of the Dove*, Tolkien's Northern myths, Barfield's *Poetic Diction* – these are emblems of the true North. If they accomplished so much with so little, what shall more focus and energy bring? Their influence grows daily, despite their death, not least where needed most – in the dessicated Christian Church. To Christians, I say this – if you ignore these prophets, why should God send you a greater? To pagans, I beg you to re-consider whether these men are united, by secret sympathies, with your own cause, to the glory of One at the top of the ladder?

Can we not re-unite them, though they are dead, in the memory of the heart? And were they not right to suspect that poetry, real poetry of the moral imagination, is not in conflict with true metaphysic, but with it does well consist?

Posted on 2011-10-29 by Logres

* * *

EXIT on 2011-10-29 at 13:23 said:

"It goes without saying, that nobody initiates anybody else"

Tomberg says this as if it is some obvious truth. On the contrary, people who believe that the divine is going to descend upon them often delude themselves into thinking that some low level magical experience constitutes enlightenment. Quotes like this only attract occultist kooks and counterfeits who profane the mysteries.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-29 at 13:50 said:

Wonderful quote from Meditations on the Tarot, I think it's entirely true and have never forgotten it – just one of the many profound truths contained therein. Love the image as well
Cx

¹⁵⁴https://books.google.com/books?id=qMqmiNbjuHEC&pg=PT493&lpg=PT493&dq=coleridge+analogy&source=bl&ots=HJ0AsPwViG&sig=90mcyP4rqq4yewHKpzg6hQi-G-M&hl=en&ei=HResTumoEYq6tgexzJTgDg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=3&ved=0CC8Q6AEwAg#v=onepage&q=coleridge%20analogy&f=false

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-29 at 13:55 said:

As for these, the – ‘many spirits who cannot seem to find a “home”’ – aren’t we taught that the Son of Man has nowhere to lay His head?

Not sure how you can say Christians aren’t like C S Lewis anymore – I think you’re behind with your reading, I’m certain I specifically mentioned the Inklings about a week ago. In fact I even ventured into the pub where they drink during my stint at the same university :-)

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-29 at 15:07 said:

By the way, speaking of ‘original Christians’, I’ve just learned that the sealed metal books discovered in Jordan earlier this year were verified as authentic by the Jordanian authorities over the summer:

<http://www.jordantimes.com/index.php?news=38498>

If you don’t already know of this breathtaking find you can read one of the news stories here:

<http://www.telegraph.co.uk/news/religion/8423689/Could-this-couples-Bible-codices-tell-the-true-story-of-Christ's-life.html>

and here

<http://www.dailymail.co.uk/news/article-1372741/Hidden-cave-First-portrait-Jesus-1-70-ancient-books.html>

This may be the earliest known image of Christ and these may truly BE the sealed books spoken of in Revelation, including the book that may only be opened by the Messiah.

They were found about 60 miles from Masada and about 100 from Qumran

Logres on 2011-10-29 at 15:58 said:

EXIT, you are right about that danger. But existence is inherently dangerous – you can’t avoid all danger, by installing infallible safeguards. That just makes the mystery a “secret” – instead, a real mystery is safe in plain sight.

Charlotte, once again, my choice of words is less than perfect; perhaps for “home” one could read “a familiar place”. Thanks for your thoughts.

Logres on 2011-10-29 at 16:00 said:

He doesn’t, in any case, mean that there aren’t people who provide initiations, just that they are not themselves the source of the Second Birth, just as he also means that the Second Birth can dispense with an initiator if “it” desires – that doesn’t mean that orders or preceptors aren’t desirable from a human point of view.

H00 on 2011-10-29 at 18:31 said:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QQqnc0P6qd8>

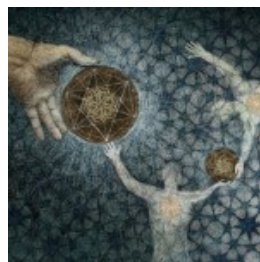
"Circa Survive – Strange Terrain"

<https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/en/c/cf/Blueskynoise.jpg>

1.20 The Nous

Basil the Great on the Nous¹⁵⁵.

Nevertheless, no one would allege the heaven to be invisible because of what is unknown; it would be said to be visible on account of our limited perception of it. It is just the same in the case of God. If the nous has been injured by devils it will be guilty of idolatry, or will be perverted to some other form of impiety. But if it has yielded to the aid of the Spirit, it will have understanding of the truth, and will know God. But it will know Him, as the Apostle says, in part; and in the life to come more perfectly. For "when that which is perfect is come, then that which is in part shall be done away." The judgment of the nous is, therefore, good and given us for a good end — the perception of God; but it operates only so far as it can.



The Orthodox did not invent¹⁵⁶ the Nous, they simply continued the thought and intellection and tradition upon the identical subject. Noetics is the science of not just "how we know what we know" (epistemology) but indeed "what does it mean to know, what are the modes

¹⁵⁵http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2011/11/st-basil-great-on-operations-of-nous.html?utm_source=feedburner&utm_medium=feed&utm_campaign=Feed%3A+Mystagogy+%28MYSTAGOGY%29

¹⁵⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nous>

of knowing, etc.”. To grasp the dimension of the *Nous* is to understand a great deal more about human beings than those in the grip of ideology are capable of; for instance, many “conservatives” are rabid about the “the Left”. But when you discuss the subject with them, you find that they define “the Left” as anything which is not “conservative” or “classically liberal”. And when you get them to flesh that out, it turns out that they actually *do* accept basic dogmas of the Left, such as the primacy and priority of individual, abstract Thought, or the absolute freedom of the will, the secular state, etc. A Noetic faculty would curtail such false starts by suggesting that each person or individual apprehends “facts”, not by dialectical and ideological ratiocination, but rather by the immediate intuition of the soul, which actually directs the direction that reason is allowed to investigate.

Another way to say it is that *Nous* “controls the terms of debate” not by anti-intellectualism, but by spiritual regulation, or hermetic respiration (see Tomberg). *Nous* is not irrational, but “beyond ratio”, if by reason we simply mean the defining of terms and the parsing of arguments. Reason works so well that a strong, true conclusion (as far as it goes) becomes mistaken (by the *Nous*) for the absolute truth, which “truth” the *Nous* then disguises from itself by appropriating for itself, forgetting (in that sense) that it simply used a tool well during an argument. Then again, it disguises it in the opposite direction by pretending that the “objectivity” and certainty of the argument springs entirely from the Ratio, when in truth, much of the religious meaning and portent derives from qualities inherent in the *Nous* itself, its hunger for Truth, etc. It is as if no other good arguments were or ever could be made in the world. In this way, the tangle of human convictions becomes instantiated as ideology, and clouds the mirror of the soul, which becomes progressively troubled by passion and despair, which alternate¹⁵⁷.

¹⁵⁷<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2010/10/paranoid-style-in-american-politics.html>

Lest you think this is merely an academic subject, here is one of the last of the old Europeans, Jacques Barzun¹⁵⁸, explaining the climate of North American thought in 1959:

“Never, in truth, has the educated population needed to be so often reassured about its distinguished fellow members’ (the intellectuals) being human – Did not a Harvard scholar of blameless life receive the discovery about Wordsworth’s illegitimate daughter with the words, It makes him seem like one of us? The world greets with approval any discovery of a shortcoming, applauds the confession of mistakes, and indemnifies the spectator for any fleeting sense he may have of diminution by someone else’s accomplishment. A truly modern dictionary would add an entry under ‘human’ – the opposite of admirable; and religious critics who repeat that a godless world falls into the worship of man should open their eyes to the demonstration of the contrary.”

Barzun also wrote a book entirely in praise of America, but at least he could clearly see the “state of the Union”. Gornahoor has often addressed this tendency of the modern mind to assume that an opinion is better than none, even if unformed. This overlooks the deformation of mind which occurs when one self-deceives one’s own self and pretends to knowledge that is neither true nor exact. Is it too much to suggest that the West’s abandonment of *the Nous* in favor of dialectic represents a peculiar and necessary step within a devolution of spiritual consciousness (and therefore, of Mind) itself? If Mind were not important, it could be detached from spirituality, and treated separately. It could be isolated, and contained. It could be dissected and degraded. And so it has. Our intellectual class (under assault from Art, Science, and Philanthropy in

¹⁵⁸https://books.google.com/books?id=DGF5C9GMFgC&pg=PA35&lpg=PA35&dq=barzun+temple+intellect&source=bl&ots=DUHPnuxQCS&sig=rNd6oFl05ceBt_TeoiCWEoprPs&hl=en&ei=vWL0Tq3pHuyGsALLwbn0Dg&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CB0Q6AEwAA#v=onepage&q&f=false

Barzun's thesis) will at last turn upon itself, when it is deprived of the magnificent edifice of the cathedral of the Spirit.

The abandonment of the *Nous* (along with the neopagan desire to purify the West of Christianity in its entirety) will at last result not in a de-sentimentalizing of thought, but an actual dessication along a different line. This is not primal purity, but Chaos. *The Nous* cannot be purified, except in the manner worked out in the Christian medieval tradition, indicated by paragons such as Saint Bonaventura in his *Itinerarium*¹⁵⁹. There is no cause for panic, simply a return to the source, a recollection of who we are called to be. This is the salvation of the West, which awaits each of us willing to come into the fullness of the apotheosis, destined for us as an act of free choice.

Posted on 2011-11-25 by Logres

1.21 New Birth, New Death

As the festival of the Gentile world nears, Christmas¹⁶⁰ will cast its inevitable charm over the hardest pagan heart, and it will beguile the most Christian heart (as it humanly should) into a forgetfulness of the metaphysical foundations of the Faith; we will forget our deep questions, and will instead celebrate like little children, only hoping to be more child-like than *childish*. Rather than Christmas being a diversion, a concession from God, or just sentimental nonsense, perhaps a meditation is possible on the relation of Birth, with Death. If Christ is born, will he not also, then, die? If such is His fate, how much more so ours? And can we do this in a way that is joyful? How about the transcendence of the Northern tradition, where does this fit into Christmas, or should it?

¹⁵⁹<http://www.franciscan-archive.org/bonaventura/opera/bon05295.html>

¹⁶⁰https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I8AU_aT2_G0

Even in Christmas, there is a bass undertone¹⁶¹. The weather reminds us of this, as do countless morality plays in literature, such as *The Phantom Carriage*¹⁶². Dicken's *Christmas Carol* is sentimental, but not sentimentalist – the Ghosts are not “tame” or “happy”, though they are joyful. The root of the season is in the hard earth, like iron, and the frozen water, as a stone. Nature lies dying, dead, sleeping. And we are part of this nature. Our bodies harden, dry up, and wither, as age progresses. The universe is “cold” to the natural and easy nature of man, as he is born. In order to “get inside”, to come into the cheer and the hearth, he must be “born again”. Having power over Nature will not save him, unless he is first able to extract himself from Nature, because otherwise, power over Nature is only power over himself as an object, or slave. Western man sought this short cut, & it has failed.

What is this New Birth? Is it (as the modern Church would have, offering us Santa cookies and cool-aid, instead of a Eucharist), a saccharine and emotional change in the psychological tone of the man? Is it (as the fundamentalists would argue) something as necessarily easy as saying a Jesus prayer, much like humming along with the Christmas elevator music we hear? The Church may be eternal, and it may be indefectible, but its modern state proves that it is not infallible. The New Birth is hardly known, and even more rarely understood. We will have to turn to Evola¹⁶³ and Steiner¹⁶⁴, two men “outside the pale”, to explicate it. Only then can sip our wassail without drinking damnation, or at least stupidity, unto our souls. Strange times, when the Church is still necessary, but no longer sufficient?

¹⁶¹<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2010/12/christmas-oratorio-intro-by-bishop.html>

¹⁶²<http://www.amazon.com/Phantom-Carriage-Criterion-Collection-Blu-ray/dp/B0056ANHSQ>

¹⁶³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

¹⁶⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2880>

Isn't this what Christmas means, anyway? Steiner¹⁶⁵ points out that all entities or even "things" (and certainly combinations of both such as Sacred writings) can induce a spiritual experience:

When a man does this day by day, then something shows itself in the soul which gives him new life, he is reborn, he is spiritually transformed. He sees around him a spiritual world of which he had previously no idea. Everyone who takes the first verses of the Saint John Gospel and lets them work upon him for the education and training of his soul, experiences the Saint John Gospel itself in mighty pictures.

These "soul pictures" were once known & studied in the Church; however, during this dark time, our Mother Church is barren and cold and dying, and there is no room in the inn for the weary traveler. Out of something dark, and into something small, the rebirth of the mystery occurs, a re-birth which will and must (in the end) redeem that which suffered and went astray to bring it to pass.

Evola speaks about learning to put up with suffering as if it were a case of bad weather (in Cologero's words) –

The Trial by Suffering is the acceptance of whatever appears to be. The individual's attitude towards suffering must be no different from his attitude toward a rainy day; it is something exterior and of no concern. Besides the writings of the saints and Stoics that Evola mentions, there is also Nietzsche's concept of *amor fati*...

This, too, is taught in Steiner, for without the lesser or even least part of Creation, and without the dark *chiascuro* of suffering or the chaos of the end times, that which is subtle, higher, and permanent could not come to pass. Evola gives the inward metaphysic of the dogma, Steiner

¹⁶⁵<http://wn.rsarchive.org/Lectures/19061127p01.html>

provides the poetic or symbolical meaning of the correspondent theology. Thus, Steiner inclines towards the exoteric, while Evola adumbrates the esoteric inwardness.

In order for the pupil to receive aright the influence of these words and find the 'word' which is proclaimed by the Saint John Gospel, the teacher spoke as follows: "Thou must fill thy soul for weeks at a time with this one feeling. Think of the plant. It is rooted in the dead stone. If it had consciousness, it would have to bow down to the dead stone and say to it: 'Without thee I could not live; out of thee I drew nourishment and strength: I owe to thee my being, I thank thee.' The animal would have to speak in similar words to the plant: 'Without thee I could not live, I incline myself towards thee in thankfulness, because out of thee I draw that which I require for my existence.' And it is the same with all the kingdom. Man, who has attained to a higher stage of evolution, must also bow down, as the plant to the stone, to those who work for him, and thank them." He who would become a Christian Initiate must develop this feeling during a period of many weeks — the feeling that he owes gratitude to him who stands beneath him. Then he experiences in the spirit the thirteenth chapter of the Saint John Gospel where this feeling is given sublime and eternal expression by Christ in the Washing of the Feet. Christ means to say: "Without you I could not be, I incline myself to you as the plant to the stone." As an outer symbol the Initiate experienced at this stage a feeling as if water were flowing around his feet. It continued for a long time. When he had gone through this, the Christian Mystic could experience the next stage of initiation. For this he must cultivate the power to endure all the storms and stresses of life. Then he experienced a second picture. He saw himself scourged, and could feel in his own body something like pain at certain points. This went on for many weeks. He experienced the scourging. Now he could rise to the third stage. The teacher said to him: "Thou must cultivate a feeling which can

endure that all thou holdest highest should be treated with scorn and derision.” The scorn and derision must be for him nothing, in comparison with his own inner strength and certainty.

Our stable, or inn, here below is dignified by the eventual destiny it will participate in. Evola speaks of *fire, suffering, & love* in three steps (which roughly correspond to *purification, illumination, & glorification* in the Christian tradition). Steiner complicates this somewhat with more “stations of the cross”; his final stages are cosmological in nature on the one hand, and on the other hand, seem to stretch out the three steps of Evola to end up in the same place (Resurrection or Instantiation).

Understanding the way-stations of Christ’s life (and/or accepting the destiny of our own), the “new birth” is a nothing hanging upon a nothing, a spark of life issuing from a heap of apparent death. In the personal life, this may be something quite small and seemingly innocuous (to our fallen nature) - Bonaventura wrote it, Ignatius of Loyola put it on his tombstone, and Holderlin put it at the beginning of *The Hyperion*:

Non coerceri maximo, contineri minimo, divinum est.

God chooses the weak things of the world to bring to nothing what is strong.

Why? Not because it is “strong” or because being weak is good, but because what is reckoned strong is unreal. On the contrary, the least part of God’s reality is more real than the greatest devising that Titanism can construct, because that which is prior, or inward, rules that which is outward, and that which is outward must flow from what gave it birth, and return to it, or fall into chaos.

This is the meaning of the Christmas story, not that a sentimental little ragamuffin in a barn is all that matters, but that he is the source of all that is. Nations are redeemed, miracles performed, cathedrals built, because of the child; Christianity did not beat swords into plough-shares,

but rather inverted it into a cross, which becomes a sword in a stone for the hour of need. Sentimentalistic Christianity wants to undo Creation (and therefore Redemption) by denying all glory in order to kill the glory of the world.

Glory is real. The glory of the world is unreal, before that which is before it. Because of the cradle, we know that the foundation of God's kingdom is forever assured. God himself built upon that which is unshakeable, which the enemy desired to see into, but could never anticipate. Evil, chaos, suffering, unreality – all these will continue to be foiled and defeated by the lonely, insignificant, and outcast. Even the glory of the world shall be saved.

This is the same tale, not told of an idiot, but whispered by the snow and the ice and the wind itself, which blows where it wills, and which contains the kiss which (passing strange) awakens the Sleeping Beauty of Spring. It is the tale of Robin Hood, the Hooded Man, & all of the troubadours who sang the Romance of the Rose, whose song gave birth to the chivalry that still lingers in the West at this late date. Death cannot conquer that which is deathless.

Tomberg thought that there were two paths available to those who wished to overcome the illusion, "Me, living – you, shadow". The first choice was that of India, which involved extending the illusion to the self. This is the path of indifference. The second choice involves extending love of the self to the "neighbor".

Perhaps Christianity has a permanent temptation, as the case of Steiner shows, towards an evolutionary worldview (which is unsound) and an affirmative path, an allurement towards matter. However, at Christmas, before the light dawns, the watching & the Lord are at one.

Posted on 2011-12-16 by Logres

1.22 Fears of What May Be, Erring Popes & Councils

Extra Ecclesiam non est salus: without (outside) the Church there is no salvation. This was the motto of the Christian Church during the Medieval Era, and (supposedly) that which is objectionable in the Church today – the neo-pagans argue that the Church assimilated and reduced what it could not destroy. *This argument is actually true, but not in the sense which the neo-pagans intend it to be.* The Church did indeed enter a phase of development which represented a diminution, but it was not because it had combated paganism, but because it had decayed the patrimony which those same pagans had entrusted to it.



Specifically, the Church rejected the tripartite definition of man which had been handed to it by those who converted into the Church because they saw something worthy of merit which completed their aspiration. The Fourth Council of 869 AD (note that Constantine had long ago “done his dastardly deed”) repudiated a sophisticated, metaphysical view of man’s nature in favor of something more exoteric and easy to understand.

Though the old and new Testament teach that a man or woman has one rational and intellectual soul, and all the fathers and doctors of the church, who are spokesmen of God, express the same opinion, some have descended to such a depth of irreligion, through paying attention to the speculations of evil people, that they shamelessly teach as a dogma *that a human being has two souls*, and keep trying to prove their heresy by irrational means using a wisdom

that has been made foolishness.

Therefore this holy and universal synod is hastening to uproot this wicked theory now growing like some loathsome form of weed. Carrying in its hand the winnowing fork of truth, with the intention of consigning all the chaff to inextinguishable fire, and making clean the threshing floor of Christ, in ringing tones it declares **anathema** the inventors and perpetrators of such impiety and all those holding similar views; it also declares and promulgates that nobody at all should hold or preserve in any way the written teaching of the authors of this impiety. If however anyone presumes to act in a way contrary to this holy and great synod, let him be **anathema** and an outcast from the faith and way of life of Christians.¹⁶⁶

The esotericism of the Church which had survived Justinian's codification was declared out of bounds. The time of this council was well after the "Roman" phase of the Church had ended, after the chaos of the Dark Age invasions by Lombards, Franks, etc. The Roman Catholic Church (RCC) was essentially struggling to maintain what it could, both of the Greek connections & the ancient Roman ones. John Romanides¹⁶⁷ has some helpful articles detailing the unintended consequences of Charlemagne's adoption of Rome. Although he is incorrect to exaggerate the damage done from a proto-Greek perspective, he is certainly right to perceive that the chaos of the Western invasions did immense damage to all Roman institutions. *Conditions in the West were so bad that Church fasts were lifted in order that populations might eat meat in order not to starve.* For the West, it was the Roman Church, or nothing – Chaos. It is unfair, then, to assume that perfect freedom of choice was exercised when the Church "misplaced" or misunderstood its patrimony. Esoteric meaning

¹⁶⁶Source: <http://www.piar.hu/councils/ecum08.htm>

¹⁶⁷http://www.romanity.org/htm/rom.03.en.franks_romans_feudalism_and_doctrine.01.htm

can be lost in the best of times (just look around you); how, then, can we assume a deliberate error? Instead, one ought to look for what is best.

The case of Iceland¹⁶⁸ proves the point; one man's respected voice won a reprieve for paganism there, but only a private toleration – this man was actually a pagan priest. Additionally, the main proselytizing was done on the basis of "trial by battle", a conflict in which (apparently) the archangel Michael came out over the berserkers, rune curses, and armies and storms of the pagan Gods. *And what was the price? Not to eat horsemeat, nor to expose the infants at birth to the elements!*

Note, also, that the conversion was done by royal decree & blessed by a heathen seer who had converted :

Shortly after Olaf Trygvason became King of Norway he decreed that the old faith should be discarded and replaced with Christianity. His decree extended also to the islands of Shetland, Orkney, and Faroe.

When news of Norway's conversion reached Iceland, it was received by many with great anger. "It is monstrous," they said, "to forsake our ancient beliefs."

But Njal, a respected leader known for his ability to foresee the future, replied, "I support the new faith. I believe that Christianity is a better religion than our old one. Those who accept it will be happy."

The rune magic which was supposedly lost was already very weak, just as Druidism had already been proscribed through battle and law by the Roman Empire. See, for instance, the account of the battle at the Isle of Anglesey¹⁶⁹. Christianity actually preserved many remnants of paganism and gave them (arguably) a new life. This is not to minimize the bigotry

¹⁶⁸<http://www.pitt.edu/~dash/njal100.html>

¹⁶⁹<http://www.philipcoppens.com/anglesey.html>

of (for instance) Norman priests in England after the Conquest, but is merely to recognize that the policy of the Church towards paganism is not a simple matter of clear-cut answers. Surely, if paganism had been potent at that point, St. Boniface and others would not have been able to hew down sacred groves for firewood? When King Edwin converted based on the famous sermon with its analogy of a sparrow flying through the hall, from one door to the other, the instance¹⁷⁰ proved that paganism had already lost the metaphysical knowledge of its own rituals.

Steiner¹⁷¹ and others offer a different account of what was occurring at the time, which has an attraction neo-paganism lacks – it is esoteric. It purports to be the revealing of the inner-ness; neo-paganism (on the other hand) seems to (often) an appeal to a neo-liberal conception of ultimate “freedom of religion”, rather than a cosmic account of history.

Perhaps the most brilliant and influential proponent of this Arabian culture were the Caliph Haroun al Rashid and his associates, in the Eighth Century AD. This culture was, as indicated above, brilliant in a way, but was also anti-evolutionary in that it failed to appreciate the Christ-Impulse and was infected with the Sorat/Ahriman influence from Jundi Sabur. Around this time the cosmic Intelligence began to “fall to earth”, out of the rule of Michael and in the “heads” of Men; the Pan-Intelligence becoming individualized, personal intelligence. This process was a preparation for what was to culminate after the dawn of the Consciousness Soul Epoch in the Fifteenth Century: that Men were to experience their thoughts as coming from out of themselves, as a personal intelligence in individual freedom. In 869 AD the fateful Eighth Ecumenical Council in Constantinople declared to be heretical the doctrine of “trichotomy”: that the Man is body, soul

¹⁷⁰<http://markmeynell.wordpress.com/2010/09/10/king-edwin-of-nor-thumberlands-conversion-and-the-sparrow-in-the-storm/>

¹⁷¹<http://www.bibliotecapleyades.net/biblianazar/ahriman04.htm>

and spirit — thus effectively “outlawing the spirit” in Western Christendom, and plunging West-European mankind ever more deeply into material experience. While this Council was happening on earth, in the soul/spirit world Haroun al Rashid and his associates, who had recently died, conferred with the individuality of Aristotle and associates: Alexander and the “Aristotelians”, together with the “Platonists” and the Knights of Arthur’s Round Table. In this meeting Aristotle and his associates resolved to bring to earth a renewed and Christianized wisdom suitable for the epoch of individualized intelligence of the Consciousness Soul, but al Rashid and his party remained opposed to this Christianization. Subsequently, on earth, the Arabian impulse was carried forward by philosophers such as Avicenna and Averroës, who upheld a decadent and retrogressive quasi-Aristotelianism, which denied human-spiritual individuality surviving death. And the Platonists descended to earthly incarnation, up through the Twelfth Century, as teachers of the Christianized Nature-wisdom of the School of Chartres. (This wisdom later inspired Bruno Latini, and consequently his pupil Dante.) In the Thirteenth Century the Aristotelians incarnated into the Dominican Order, wherein, with the help of the Platonists then in the spirit-world, they upheld the doctrine of human-individual intelligence and immortality, in the subtle conceptual thinking of the Scholastic “Realists”, as against the Arabian philosophers. The greatest of the Scholastics was Aristotle himself, incarnated as Thomas Aquinas, the proponent of the reality of Pan-Intelligence in the form of concepts — the “universals” — and of the reality of human-individual experience of intelligence. — After the end of Medieval culture and the beginning of the Consciousness Soul Epoch, al Rashid himself incarnated as none other than Francis Bacon, the fountainhead of modern, Ahrimanic scientism. (Paradoxically, Bacon was inspired by a high Initiate, who also inspired Shakespeare, Jacob Boehme, and Jacob Balde. [Karmic Relationships, Vol. II] Again: evolu-

tion is not a simple, two-sided conflict between “good” and “evil” — in a way, a nominalistic-empirical science “had to” enter cultural development.) Ahriman intends to make the now-earthly human intelligence entirely, overly individualized and personal, so that it degenerates into mere cleverness, driven by lower instincts and divorced from universal reality. But while Baconian science gained ground on earth, in the spirit/soul world the Platonists and Aristotelians convened in a “school” under the leadership of Michael.

No matter what one thinks of Steiner (and keep in mind Evola’s definition of re-incarnation), this account is at least a “mystery” account of the secret history of the world, rather than a Romanticization of an era which we are at least as completely detached from, collectively, as we are from the world of traditional Catholicism. **Certainly, the prohibition of the Holy Spirit at that council would explain the submersion of the esoteric stream in the West, so that it had to re-enter the Western world via Tomberg, Solovyov, and others much later on.**

Without the restoration of the tripartite doctrine, the verdictum of history on the Church will risk becoming that of John Keat’s¹⁷² on the clergy of his day:

Axioms in philosophy are not axioms until they are proved upon our pulses: we read fine things but never feel them to the full until we have gone the same steps as the author. The Consecration was – not amusing — there were numbers of carriages, and his house crammed with Clergy – they sanctified the Chapel — and it being a wet day consecrated the burial ground through the vestry window. I begin to hate Parsons — they did not make me love them that day – when I saw them in their proper colours — A Parson is a Lamb in a drawing room and a lion in a Vestry. The

¹⁷²<http://www.mrbauld.com/keatsva.html>

notions of Society will not permit a Parson to give way to his temper in any shape – so he festers in himself – his features get a peculiar diabolical self sufficient iron stupid expression. He is continually acting. His mind is against every Man and every Mans mind is against him. He is an Hippocrite to the Believer and a Coward to the unbeliever – He must be either a Knave or an Ideot. And there is no Man so much to be pitied as an ideot parson. The Soldier who is cheated into an esprit du corps – by a red coat, a Band and Colours for the purpose of nothing – is not half so pitiable as the Parson who is lead absurdities – a poor necessary subaltern of the Church –

This sad state of Churchism as opposed to Christendom will come to pass, not because neo-paganism was correct in assuming the Church to be an alien usurper upon the Northern heritage, but rather, precisely because the Church failed to preserve a heritage given it by those very pagans who converted, and failed to have it restored by those pagans who picked up their mantle and immediately denounced the world their ancestors created. This is because they are dubious metaphysicians, and incline rather to a “poetic” view of history; even the poets knew better than that:

This is the very thing in which consists poetry; and if so it is not so fine a thing as philosophy-For the same reason that an eagle is not so fine a thing as a truth-Give me this credit-Do you not think I strive-to know myself? Give me this credit-and you will not think that on my own account I repeat Milton’s lines~

“How charming is divine Philosophy

Not harsh and crabbed as dull fools suppose

But musical as is Apollo’s lute”

Keats saw the errors of the Church, but used poetry to intuit the ancient doctrines of “the vale of soul-making” & the “house of many mansions”

— it's a pity he couldn't have read Guenon on states of being. It would be easy to pillory the Church (and I agree with Keat's analysis of many parsons), but it is the harder (and more productive) to abandon invective, and to pursue the "great work" of following the Spirit.

Tomberg puts it this way:

Dear Unknown Friend, do not interpret what I am saying in the sense that I am opposed or even hostile to the above-mentioned societies, fraternities, and movements of a spiritual and initiatory nature, nor in the sense that I am accusing them of an anti-Christian attitude. Do not attribute me with a lack of respect for the mahatmas and gurus of India. It is a matter here only of the purely psychological tendency (that I have been able to observe something of everywhere) which prefers the ideal of the superman to the ideal of the Son of Man.

Tomberg goes on to add (this is the sixth chapter of *MotT*, the Charioteer) that the tendency is everywhere resisted in these organizations, that tendency to the three temptations of mania, inflation, and megalomania. But he insists that it is most effectively combated within the doctrine of the Church, which teaches that "the Lord" safeguards the sanity & humility of the initiate.

Isn't this what the West has always aspired to? The mutual recognition of truth under the umbrella of Truth? What is to prevent the practice of this, upon either side of the Roman wall?

Posted on 2011-12-24 by Logres

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-25 at 13:27 said:

A few thoughts sprang to mind when I read this. Firstly (in passing, really), I had never heard of this 'twin soul' heresy or that it was so controversial. I think I need more info about what is what – are literally two souls what is meant or is it a soul and spirit issue?

Secondly, I agree Steiner can shed light on very difficult parts of the path, although I do not necessarily share his express view of reincarnation. Reading this made me wonder whether viewing reincarnation as a form of channelling might help solve the problem (making it more a question of terms)?

I think the Chariot card may be number 7 but either way I was put in mind of the Phaedron Charioteer and the twin horses of the soul – maybe some are getting the soul confused with its horses? Just an idea, here's an extract by the way: <http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-phaedrus-charioteer>

I just found something from The Chariot card on my blog, the philosophy of a lunatic, which always amuses me:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/philosophy-of-a-lunatic>

I tarried not to tie my sandal shoe, but haste, post haste, through air my winged chariot flew (Aeschylus, Prometheus Bound)

logres on 2011-12-25 at 17:01 said:

Charlotte, I've had that thought, too – perhaps there is an element (the one atom that we never replace, according to Max Heindel) which is imperishable and the seat of immortality in the soul which corresponds to Evolan individuality, but (then) the “truth of reincarnation” would simply be the experience of having a supra-personal + sub-personal “flame” of being passed on which records an imprint of the seat of immortality (in worship of the previous bearer). “Channeling” could work that way. Incidentally, I need to ask you a question about waking up in dreams. I've had a lot of dreams where I am doing things with my hands, but can't remember to ask myself why.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-25 at 17:14 said:

well the way I see it we all have a spark of the divine with us, and the way of return is analogous to the Kabablistic process of 'raising the sparks', by which all souls/spirits return to the divine source. But I can see how the idea of it being a flame lends itself to the notion of passing on the torch. In the case of a great light like St Augustine, you might reasonably expect many torches of inspiration, wisdom, etc to be lit as a result of his endeavours, although you wouldn't necessarily say he's reincarnating over and again in students. It just suddenly struck me as I was reading that part of the post about Steiner that Thomas Aquinas might well have ended up 'channelling' Augustine if he studied his works in great depth and fully absorbed them into himself. What intrigues me more is how Steiner saw himself. Clearly Steiner was clairvoyant but clairvoyant vision is so rich in symbolism and has so many layers that perhaps it's all just a matter of interpretation. Certainly Steiner doesn't go out of his way to spoon feed or make things especially simple for his readers....often he's very challenging, I think he's the sort of

teacher that can be wrong so the student can reach a correct answer. Mystery teaching isn't 'easy' at the best of times, let alone from beyond the grave.

What do your hands look like, what kinds of things are they doing?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-25 at 17:17 said:

or maybe it was Aristotle, I can't remember, point still applies tho...didn't Aristotle use ellipses?!

logres on 2011-12-25 at 22:26 said:

Typing, right now! Ring on finger, left hand, wedding. I've tried to memorize the vein patterns, or note scars. Lately, have been trying to be "aware" of them at odd intervals in the day. Realized I usually look at object "in hand", not at them.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-26 at 09:38 said:

when I saw my hands in a dream I was taken aback by how they looked, it wasn't like looking at my physical body

logres on 2011-12-26 at 12:26 said:

I can't remember to look, in the dream.

Caleb Cooper on 2011-12-26 at 16:07 said:

You're lucky that you saw something so beautiful Charlotte. The night after you first mentioned the practice I decided to look at my hands while dreaming. They took on an unstable character, the fingers fusing together and separating, their size distorting around the edge of my awareness, in a reminder of the ugliness of my unintegrated soul.

It was a strange experience. Like my awareness was trying to catch and hold the hands in a stable form, but it was too slow, traveling through an unpleasant invisible molasses, and right when it might catch them it hit a thicker patch a few inches from the hands which it would slide off, the hands distorting with the slipped awareness.

Had a more pleasant experience looking at my hands in a dream tonight. I didn't see the luminous body or anything, but they appeared quite beautiful, probably because I was holding one of my soul fragments in my palms and healing it, so there would have been a very high stable frequency going through them at the time. But when I'm not elevated above my base state, yeah, pretty ugly. I should experiment with focusing the awareness on other parts of my body in the dreaming so I can see just how fucked up my soul is there as well:)

Boreas on 2011-12-26 at 16:36 said:

This conversation brought to my mind a music video that reminds me about dreaming, dreams and the astral world in general – and about hands. I don't if the symbology in the video is some kind of a "hint" to dream workers, but even if it's not, it's still quite fitting: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0rs_NRyNs4o

(You need to look it through to understand my point.)

Years ago, when I tried to awake in my dreams and did practices to accomplish this, one of the basic practices was to search for my hands in dreams and to memorize this while in awake in order it to become a habit while sleeping and seeing dreams. I never got any amazing results this way, but I think and have heard that many have.

Hands, like eyes, are the mirror of the soul and its constituting principles, and the alchemical planetary correspondences and the chakric correspondences can tell a lot about many things; I always get smaller or bigger cuts and wounds in my fingers or palms if there's something that I've done or said wrong – the size of the "reflection" (=wound) symbolising the level of the mistake, and the place of the wound the corresponding principle to look up to.

Boreas on 2011-12-26 at 17:19 said:

Charlotte said: "I think I need more info about what is what – are literally two souls what is meant or is it a soul and spirit issue?"

I don't have the exact information, but it might be a major mis-interpretation of the concepts of the animal soul and the rational soul, and the corresponding teachings in different traditions (kabbalah tree of life, germanic / nordic paganism etc.)

Logres said: "What is to prevent the practice of this, upon either side of the Roman wall?"

The same as always: human stupidity and selfishness combined with myopic worldly goals. But let's not lose our hopes that at least those "who are still gathered at the Vulture's peak" (or listening the ones who are gathered there!) understand and learn how to reconcile their own paths and personal truths in the light of the greater unity.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-26 at 17:29 said:

Caleb, they did not really look beautiful more strange – translucent and kind of grey, I was quite weirded out by it, as I was when I saw my astral self in a mirror once, that freaked me out a bit

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-26 at 17:31 said:

Boreas, the hands thing is the method taught my Don Juan to Carlos in the Carlos Castaneda novels – it is not so much the fact that one is looking at the hands that makes one conscious, but the fact one remembers to do something – looking at the feet would presumably be as efficacious, although there is something about hands as you point out....

Boreas on 2011-12-26 at 17:39 said:

From the link to the article 'Iceland Accepts Christianity' this caught my eye...

"In the meantime, the chieftains meeting at the Althing outlawed Hjalti Skeggjason for having blasphemed Freyja and Odin by calling them a bitch and a dog in his poem."

...and sent streams of joy through my soul, haha.

But seriously speaking, it also reminds one about the fact how easily the old truths are forgotten and denied in the frenzy of 'conversion' (apparent or real), for better or for worse (usually the first option), and how easily the baby is thrown away with the bath-water.

The Gods never left the old heathens, the heathens forgot and abandoned them to a great extent, and they also failed to renew their traditions in the way that they would have provided them the needed spiritual and cultural nourishment. Now the same fact applies greatly to both neo-pagans and to (neo-)christians, while at the same time on the outer world fundamentalism, atheism and nihilism abound. This is why a synthesis in the light of universal esoteric knowledge is so greatly needed in our time and in the following age.

Boreas on 2011-12-26 at 17:40 said:

Argh, a slip!

"usually the first option" -> usually the second option

Boreas on 2011-12-26 at 18:00 said:

OK. Based on this I take it could be an old shamanistic practice, since Castaneda fused (and confused) many teachings on his writings. I don't think it's the same – or a mere practical thing – if you look upon the hands or upon the feet. The right HAND path & left HAND path and so on...!

However, here's one animation link for the chakric correspondences:

http://www.iloveulove.com/images/ss_kundalini%20anim.gif

And a picture for the planetary correspondences:

http://ccrsdodona.org/images/1977_sag_palm1.gif

The color scales and the planetary symbols co-incide and relate to each other quite well, yet I'd say that the either the Sol symbol in the planets or the golden color upon the chakric finger correspondences are mis-placed.

"The science of hand-reading, strange as this may seem to those who have no notion of such things, is, in its Islamic form, directly related to the science of the divine names: the arrangement of the principal lines of the left hand trace out the number 81, and those of the right 18, giving a total of 99, which is the number of the names attributed to Allah (sifatiyyah). As for the name Allah itself, it is formed by the fingers in the following way: the little finger corresponds to the alif, the ring finger to the first lam, the middle and index fingers to the second

lam, which is double, and the thumb to the ha (as regularly drawn in its 'open' form): and here lies the principal reason for the widespread use of the hand as a symbol in all Islamic countries. From this we may understand the meaning of the verse in the book of Job: 'He seals up the hand of every man, that all men may know his work': and it may be added that this is not unrelated to the essential role of the hand in the rites of benediction and consecration..."

– René Guénon, *Insights into Islamic Esoterism and Taoism*'

logres on 2011-12-27 at 00:54 said:

Thinking about this today (I appreciate all the helpful comments, maybe this will help me) – the hands are the active part of the soul. When the mind is SURE and stable, you can concentrate on doing with the hands. Perhaps, in a dream, the hands can only become visible when the mind has reached a certain stability. Also, you may be reaching to DO something in a place that you are not yet ready to act – hence, the wavy hands. Heindel teaches that in past epochs, as the vehicle of the body was prepared, the spirits were attached, but not fully incarnated – they then experienced through the body, but not fully as we do. Something similar is going on with the hands in dreams. A fully awake person would have dream hands that were beautiful. Or at least not streaming off somewhere. They may be connected to another place, even inside the dream. That is backward, from the hands, down, rather than from the feet, up.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-27 at 08:08 said:

well the real and/or imaginary Don Juan was eminently practical, and when he revealed the purpose of the exercise to Carlos he said that it was the consistent effort involved with trying to see the hands (or whatever) that made the unconscious self absorb the practice so completely that at some stage one will inevitably see the hands. It's interesting what the Sufis/Guenon said about hands and one intuitively feels there's something significant about this part of the body having been chosen, but in the 'Don Juan school' they're not relevant in this way. His goal was simply to heighten perception. I've never heard of the hands streaming off or away before, or any other part of the body, that sounds like a dream to me. As far as I'm aware the astral self doesn't dissemble in this way and (in my experience) people generally appear as their most beautiful possible selves in that state, it can be quite interesting to see how the otherwise secret character and beauty of an individual manifests, especially with respect to the light in their eyes.

logres on 2011-12-27 at 13:48 said:

It was just a speculation – I've heard the hands look wispy or wavy, suggesting a movement to another plane. As I say, I've yet to accomplish it – my dreams for now are rather jumbled, although changing. Happy twelve days, to all!

Caleb Cooper on 2012-01-01 at 16:51 said:

On the original post, I think Rome's position is a little more nuanced, and if I understand correctly, compatible with Traditional teachings on the tripartite nature.

At my last RCIA class before Christmas break, there was a reading from St. Paul in which he used Spirit distinct from soul, giving me the opening to ask the Deacon what the Catholic distinction between them was. The Deacon's explanation was that God has breathed a Spirit into all men, and this Spirit is the Holy Spirit. I was quite pleased to hear this, as it seems essentially in agreement with Tradition, that the Spirit in man is a fragment of God, which also contains the entirety of God (like a hologram).

I'm not familiar enough with Church history to speak with authority, but what Constantinople IV may have been objecting to was the demoting of Spirit in man to the level of a soul, in which case they were actually defending the tripartite view of body/soul/spirit against body/lower soul/higher soul, which cuts man off from the higher spiritual vistas.

Logres on 2012-01-02 at 01:00 said:

Caleb, that's actually a very astute comment, & Cologero privately pointed out the same thing, so the Council's "error" may have been more one of context (ie., in the process, losing the instinctual point and definite dogma being incidentally touched upon by way of clarification) than of intent. A study on the dearth of tripartism in the Church might prove interesting and turn up more facts. This was meant to be introductory, & I obviously have a lot more to learn on the subject. However, the lack of clarification or context is troubling.

Logres on 2012-01-02 at 01:08 said:

Boreas, the blaspheming poet got what he deserved, so it's comforting that there is some justice in the world. You may be interested in <http://www.sacredscience.com/archive/GodwinArcheometer.htm>, although you sound like you've already been over this ground.

Dimitri on 2023-03-08 at 12:51 said:

Actually, I'd like to issue a correction to this article. I did some digging on the point of the Fourth Council of Constantinople (the Catholic one) because I found the language of Canon 11 suspicious, in that it didn't seem to be condemning a tripartite view of man; after all, why would it condemn the idea that man has "two souls" (which is not the tripartite view), rather than both a soul (anima) and a spirit (spiritus), if they have two separate words for both in Latin? As it turns out, it was doing no such thing:

"The eleventh canon anathematizes the doctrine that a human being has two souls. This refers to a doctrine promoted by Photius, that each man has two souls, one that is liable to error and another that is immune to error. Photius himself did not believe this doctrine, but gave arguments in its favor in order to prove that theologians could not afford to ignore philosophy. Many people took these arguments in earnest and believed the doctrine, requiring its repudiation

here." (Commentary on the Fourth Council of Constantinople, <https://www.arcaneknowledge.org/catholic/councils/comment08.htm>)

Upon digging into the matter further, I found corroboration for this when I looked into what Photios the Great was attempting to do by putting forth this teaching:

"In a feud with Patriarch Ignatios, Photios invented a fanciful theory that people have two souls, for the sole purpose of tricking Ignatios into embarrassing himself by being seen to take it seriously, whereupon Photios withdrew his proposal and admitted he had not been serious."

Historical context is important, folks!

1.23 The Guardian of the Threshold

One of the biggest problems with modern political entities is the question of cybernetics, or "the helmsmen": who watches the Watchers? Who guards the guardians? This problem is not very effectively answered today; if there was a famine in the year 1200, you knew¹⁷³ where the nobleman who was feasting on venison lived, what his name was, & whether or not he had contributed to the problem. Likewise, the king oversaw them in their turn, & perhaps an emperor looked over the king.

Modern man doesn't have an answer to "who the guardians" are, in either the terrestrial life, or the life-to-come. Only the "Free Market" regulates such matters.

Esotericism (however) has a very precise, and relatively homogeneous answer to this problem, which goes even beyond political solutions. The "Guardian of the Threshold"¹⁷⁴ is an entity personal to each human being, and consists of the sum total "bad" or negative acts of that being – this "doppelganger" constrains, judges, and (perhaps) terrifies that being, in this life & the next.

Tomasso Palamidessi articulated the strongest doctrines concerning this entity, but this idea is by no means peculiar to merely him. Papus

¹⁷³<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jacquerie>

¹⁷⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guardian_of_the_Threshold

mentions¹⁷⁵ the movement through the Zodiac houses which every being undertakes as part of its journey, and one of these entities or houses is “the guardian”. Likewise, Max Heindel speaks of the way the thought/mental, vital, and spiritual bodies interact in a way that is suggestive of the idea that we are surrounded by our own cosmic creations:

Repulsion is the centrifugal force and if that is aroused by the thought there will be a struggle between the spiritual force (the will of the man) within the thought-form, and the desire body. This is the battle between conscience and desire, the higher and the lower nature. The spiritual desire-stuff needed to manipulate the brain and muscles. The force of repulsion will endeavor to scatter the appropriated material and oust the thought. If the spiritual energy is strong it may force its way through to brain center and hold its clothing of desire-stuff while manipulating the vital force, thus compelling action, and will then leave upon the memory a vivid impression of the struggle and the victory. If the spiritual energy is exhausted before action has resulted, it will be overcome by the force of Repulsion, and will be stored in the memory, as are all other thought forms when they have expended their energy.

Rosicrucian Cosmo-Conception, p. 26

These facts or truths may be behind the old medieval belief that demons were attempting to pluck man off the ladder, or carry his soul to hell when he died. Heindel goes on¹⁷⁶ to speak of “ripe Fate” which not even the Lords of Destiny will enable man to “shirk”.

Franz Bardon also makes mention¹⁷⁷ in his magical system of mental “larva” which are generated by frustrated or misused desire.

¹⁷⁵<http://www.sacred-texts.com/tarot/tob/index.htm>

¹⁷⁶<http://www.rosicrucian.com/rcc/rcceng00.htm>

¹⁷⁷<http://www.abardoncompanion.com/IIH-Step1.html>

Valentine Tomberg speaks of the “Guardian” in some detail in Chapter XVIII of *Meditations on the Tarot*, particularly in relation to conscience.

The guardian of the threshold spoken of in the Hermetic tradition is the great judge, charged with preserving the equilibrium of that which is above and that which is below. The traditional iconography of the Church represents him with a sword and balance. The sword is his vivifying and healing action, giving courage and humility to the soul which hungers and thirsts for the depths, and the balance is his action of presenting the precise account of what must be paid in order to have the right to go further.

Thus, we see that behind the old medieval traditions of visions, temptations,¹⁷⁸ sin, the devil, etc. lurked a very prescient sense of the true reality of man’s situation, which is always perilous, always blessed. The modern world derides “shame cultures¹⁷⁹” as inherently backwards and perverse, yet it has nothing better to put in its place, nor has it managed to do away with “shame”, if for no other reason than that it can pass all the progressive legislation it wishes to, it cannot abolish the reality of the Guardian of the Threshold. This Guardian waits for every man, and for those who cannot don the armor of St. George whereby to triumph over the old serpent, a heavy price will be paid.

Such a spiritual truth is surely behind the old Scripture verse : “It is appointed unto man once to die, and after that, the judgement”. Even re-incarnation or the Lords of Destiny will not save a man from paying the full and terrible price for those deeds, for “re-birth” is not an erasure of karma, but rather a further ripening of it, a passing to an new & developmental state.

¹⁷⁸<http://classicalchristianity.com/2011/10/29/the-incredible-vision-of-st-drythelm/>

¹⁷⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shame_society

There is, in the Christian religion, one possible way out of karma¹⁸⁰, but it is not a release from its burden, but rather a servant-like assumption of it in a state of pleromic Love, the highest state of Being identical to the Lord Himself. This is known as “forgiveness” and “the new birth”, and rather than being a blank check for modern people to silence their inner “guardians” of conscience, it represents a higher path which allows a victory where perhaps none is possible. This can occur at the whim of the Lord, and therefore, is not ultimately subject to earthly protocol or guarantees, either in its favor (*extra ecclesiam non est salus*) or (as the case today is) against it as a presumption upon grace in the form of graceless and shameless culture.

Posted on 2011-12-30 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2011-12-30 at 22:45 said:

I should note that this “entity” is MORE than merely the lower doppelganger or judge – the descriptions given are from various angles, involving various aspects of something that actually exists in the depths and heights of a person’s being, vertically, up or down.

Attila on 2011-12-31 at 22:05 said:

All very interesting – but when push comes to shove – we all need a method of realizing our true nature within, through and in The Whole. One of the most beautiful ways is to be found in the Sufi tradition – as shown here:

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_SEs_CDciKk

logres on 2012-01-01 at 19:55 said:

Looks good, but I don’t speak Arabic. Can only intuit. The voice is hypnotic, however.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-02 at 05:58 said:

This is one of my favourite Arabic songs, and being devoted to a beloved I think we can give it some Sufi credentials :-)

¹⁸⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Body_of_resurrection

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YTZ01DNPqas&feature=related>

Caleb Cooper on 2012-01-03 at 02:45 said:

Brings back memories. When I started waking up I began perceiving demonic presences all over the place. I'm pretty sure now that at least most of them were lower aspects of my soul that I found repugnant and walled off. Fortunately I've learned to be a lot more gentle with them and myself.

At my first Shamanic training 8 months ago (foundation for shamanic studies) on my first journey, I was attacked by my totem at the time, a black panther. Which was very good, as we were no longer suited for each other; I survived my adolescence thanks to its strength, but it also represented the viciousness with which I defended my desire to be solitary.

What I needed though was to start opening up my heart horizontally, so I subdued the totem and released it. By the end of the workshop God provided me with a perfect primary totem for what I needed to learn, a quail (before you would fly, learn to walk grounded with more humility).

Recently, I had a pretty bad experience when I decided to try and pass the Trail of Fire. I was incorporating a Tibetan Technique of coming into resonance with a god and imprinting it upon the corresponding chakra (actually, the Tibetans _absorb_ the god into themselves, but I can only manage temporary merging, and that's on a _good_ day).

I didn't maintain the purity needed though and ended up somewhere bad, getting attacked by what a demonic aspect of Shiva might look like. It doesn't do any good "killing" something like that, because it just dissolves and covers you in it's crap, clogging your chakras for days. Maybe it was an aspect of myself, but it felt like an "other", not that I'm trusting that perception.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-03 at 07:14 said:

Caleb, I also underwent Shamanic training for many years, it was the first thing I really learned, which is appropriate as it is bound to come naturally to a human creature. Interestingly in the context of your own story, the occasion of my initiation into universal Christianity was the time I first came into direct contact/awareness with the animal totem, which in my case was a leopard. There is something highly symbolic about this animal, which I suppose you have already looked into. Almost immediately afterwards I found myself talking to and with birds, so again there is a parallel. In particular owls, wrens and eventually an Eagle, but this was more of a guide. Unlike you I did not link this training to any particular culture like Tibetan or Native American, although somebody I was involved with at that time was adept in the native American tradition. But I did not identify with anything in particular, like you I was very much 'myself'. Most initiated adepts, so far as I can tell, are drawn at some stage to Tibet and the misty hills of India. This does indeed seem to be a primary training ground, and it is easy to see why given the emphasis on self discipline, meditation techniques etc, it would be pretty hard to deny the

efficacy of method and also to deny that the Buddhist stream (along with the others) ran into the Christ stream at the turning point of history. You should be aware, though, that just as Kabbalah has its Qliploth, Sufism has its Islamic brotherhoods and Christianity has its inquisitors, Tibetan Buddhism has its demonology. When you start thinking in terms of minor gods rather than God you are open to trouble as you probably don't know what you are dealing with but are focusing instead on amassing power. Remember that during and prior to WWII it was to Tibet that the Nazis turned for the dark power that did so much to twist and subvert the magial aether, to pollute the magical streams. Remember as well that there are two eternities, one attained via dissolution and resolution in Christ, the other via crystalisation of an egoic diamond body. As an aside, I agree that so much of the 'demonic manifestation' associated with the lesser guardian is actually ego, outward expressions of our vices and weaknesses etc – but none the less terrifying for it. I had a 3.5 month trial with it at the end of last year and it all but did me in, I even asked for help, although the act of asking and gaining moral support – acknowledging the reality of the problem – was enough to help see it off. I was astrally attacked every single night, in the end I had no energy even to be afraid. The sign of the cross banished it.

Caleb Cooper on 2012-01-03 at 15:45 said:

Actually, the training I did was core-shamanism, which is not based in any particular tradition. It compares all shamanic traditions and extracts its principles from their common elements. I use different practices that I consider in harmony with Tradition, though the aegis I operate under in Hermetic Christianity, which I consider superior, or rather, Heaven was more fully fulfilled on earth than it ever has been in the person of Christ. Which is why I've started the process of entering into communion with Rome. When I went to my first mass I was surprised just how much power was present, even in its attenuated form. Very healing for my soul.

"When you start thinking in terms of minor gods rather than God you are open to trouble as you probably don't know what you are dealing with but are focusing instead on amassing power."

I generally agree here. When you come into resonance with the God behind the gods you don't typically have much need for the latter. When I seek a god, it's not rather than God, but as an aspect of God, like a facet of one jewel. Sometimes God is too big and blinding for a particular work, like trying to use a diamond sledgehammer when a jeweler's chisel would be more appropriate.

Specifically, for the work I was doing I needed an image at the same frequencies as the solar chakra. God contains all frequencies. You could extract the specific frequency from God, but at that point you have something that's less than God, so if it appears to you it will be as an aspect; the diamond of a regal lion if approached shamanically, perhaps as the Hindu god Rudra, or in my case when I went back and successfully completed the trial the Sun as symbol. So I guess this proves your point. If I'd stayed within the aegis of Hermetic astrology rather

than stumbling into the realm of gods the first time I probably wouldn't have ran into so much trouble:)

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-03 at 16:07 said:

funnily enough I had my 'first' communion yesterday, well second – I did try it earlier this year but found it genuinely appalling and very frightening as the church was wrong... this time I sought out an authentic Latin mass and it lasted 2 hours but I found very soothing, it was a relief not to have to do any 'work', but just let it all happen. I also felt it had a profound healing effect, although it's likely I'll always have an inclination to be independent in some way, my communions have always tended to in spirit or within the secret church and school.

I was actually converted to Christianity by a Benedictine 16 years ago but it's taken me this long to come around. I felt Catholic in terms of orientation and belief, but feared the communion due to issues with the Church organisation and hierarchy – fear of priests, basically.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-03 at 16:08 said:

PS for solar influences, why not Apollo? This also leads to profound insights about Orion and Artemis. Not to mention Dionysus etc... .

1.24 Harmonics

In order to win the daily battle¹⁸¹, we may resort to any number of tactics which can strengthen the "core" of man by magnetizing the higher centers of his personality, including plain music¹⁸². As several correspondents on this site have suggested, there may be a harmonic basis for this in Solfeggio notes¹⁸³. Counterpoint, basso profundo, & harmonics may provide us with a means of understanding the polyphony (and seeming polytheism) of Life. Music teaches us to eschew the demon of dialectics, as well as helping to cure the demon of the noonday sun¹⁸⁴. We can use it to see

¹⁸¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3005>

¹⁸²<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IoSuyUFiEYo>

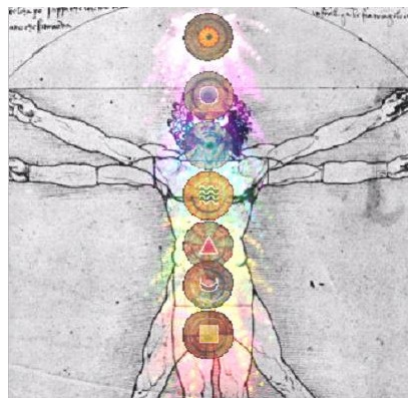
¹⁸³<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9su80VjewS0&feature=related>

¹⁸⁴<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2012/01/their-noonday-demons-and-ours.html>

harmony, rather than conflict, or conflict-in-harmony.

The “diamond self” (it is averred) is the opposite path from the dissolution of the self and resolution of the new Self in Christ; even Tomberg emphasizes this in his *Meditations*, that the path of the East is to withdraw into the self, and it is valid, but not highest. After all, there are many stars in the night sky, all of them real, no doubt many glorious, but there is but one North Star which we may steer by in our humanity. And this, in fact, is true. The Medieval Era, whatever else it is, is the paramount Age of Man, Man as Man. Just as ancient times were the times of the gods, and modern times are the times of the robot and the beast, the Middle Ages were the time of Man. Likewise, Christianity is (or should be) the religion best calculated to preserve that which makes us human, as a trophy and shield to bear into heaven.

However, what if ultimately (in the post-mortem states) these two paths, the path of the Diamond, and the path of the Hermit, are not (in fact, finally) separated? We already intuit this to be so, since Christianity claims that Christ’s final act will be the conquest of Death and Hell, the Recapitulation of all things within the Logos, where, at the end of Time, he will surrender his *imperium* back to the Father (see Colossians). Will the Logos, through whom all things were created, lose something given to His care? Thus, the survival of one avatar of Man upon the path of the Hermit means that those of the Diamond Self, the wandering stars, will be at the end of time, gathered back into the fold. It is possible to be a Super-Man, your own Christ, because of the final Christ, found not during your stay in the vale-of-soul-making¹⁸⁵,



¹⁸⁵<http://academic.brooklyn.cuny.edu/english/melani/cs6/keatsltr.html>

but later, in the houses-of-many-mansions, at the end of time.

We see this to be so from the breath. Man breathes in, then exhales. With close attention, one can tell that it is the “breathing out” (or surrender) which collapses the chest and pulls the life down into the spiritual heart, whereas the breathing in raises the spirit in exaltation. But then again, in effect, the breathing in is also (in its way) a prayer to above, although it is more aggressive in taking. Likewise, one can see that breathing out might be taken as a rejection of God, or a letting go of even Him. The breath, although in two paths, is finally One. There is one breather, one breath.

The path of the diamond self is simply the continuation of existence (or a certain form of it) in the post-mortem state, indefinitely, which will trace its own way back to God. The path of hermit is actually swifter, though it seems to tarry in the fields and byways and inns of the ring of the world. One “makes haste, slowly”.

Which is better? Which is more noble? Since they are finally the same, the choice is left up to us: “Whatever you bind on earth, will be bound in heaven; whatever you loose on earth, loosed in heaven...be careful how you judge – which ever way a man judges, in that way shall he also be judged...” Does the Super-man wish to be without the Self of higher Selves? How can he be God, if there is no God? What else does it mean, to say, the Lord has given him a name above every names, highly exalted? There are many little Christs; if there were not, how could we picture the Exalted One?

The chakras correspond to the sacred Solfeggio notes (the glands of the endocrine system are externalizations of the inner pathways, coagulations of serpentine energy which imitates the sacred network), and this forms the Kundalini energy trail. Here is Evola:

Lightning moves downwards, which Evola explains it is a sort of “command of those who have reached this supreme plane is like a thunderbolt that travels along the entire hierarchy, starting

from the top until it reaches the vibrations at the very bottom, which shape matter. This is the so-called *vajra-vak*, the diamond-thunderbolt of the living word." (TYoP, page 13) The cyclical nature then allows the initiate to 'shape matter'. Then he begins again at the bottom, as Evola describes the process of upward moving chakras: "Through the earth chakra one acquires an extraordinary material strength. Through the water chakra one may acquire youthful energies, thus neutralizing the processes of aging and of organic decay ("The Water of Life"). Through the fire chakra one acquires the power of transforming and of dissolving the elements (this corresponds to the Hermetic saying *solve et coagula*)." (TyoP, page 184)

Source: [http:](http://www.joanlansberry.com/wr-hekau/serp2of2.pdf)

[//www.joanlansberry.com/wr-hekau/serp2of2.pdf](http://www.joanlansberry.com/wr-hekau/serp2of2.pdf)

Those who wish to return from the pharaoh's tomb bearing a forked stick with a brazier of fire on their head will have to "wake up", which is to initiate their chakras. But how? Do we do this alone, or with others? With the Other? As a diamond-thunderbolt who utters the *vajra-vak*, or as someone supplicating "the Lord"?

Here is Tomberg's description¹⁸⁶ of what happens in the Christian path, which many regard as "Semitic":

The power which makes man into an upright, vertically oriented being entered into men following the Fall. In essence it was what today we usually call "pride". The Bible shows the nature of this power by the words of the Tempter: "Ye shall be as Gods." When pride entered into human nature through the Luciferic impulse, a vertical scream, from below upwards, came into being in the human organization. The physically perceptible expression

¹⁸⁶http://www.eleggua.com/Objects/Tomberg-Spiritual_Basis.html

of this scream is the backbone. What has formed itself physically into backbone consists astrally of *pretensions of pride*. These pretensions have themselves as object : they feed on themselves. So arises the upward streaming swirling movement of the passion of pride. The form of the vertebral column is its physical expression.

Now the basic pre-condition for the Manas revelation is that a stream must come into being which goes in the opposite direction : from above downward. Regarded *spiritually*, it is the stream of revelation ; as soul-phenomenon, however, it is borne on the stream of *humility*. But opposing it is the pride which lives in all human nature since the Fall.

Therefore, in order to make it possible, a purification of human nature must precede the Manas revelation. This purification consists in the dying out of pride in that part of the astral body required for cognition. Man has to submit to a process of *humiliation* which brings the Manas organization to maturity. This humbling is accomplished as follows : The man who out of the forces of his consciousness soul has chosen the spirit will be, as it were, ‘incarcerated’. On the one hand, a protective wall will be erected around him against evil influences ; on the other hand, a dome arches over his head consisting of the *silence of the spiritual world*. Thus arises an *empty* space where the man is quite alone. This space is so empty that even evil cannot enter there. The man has an opportunity fully to experience his powerlessness and poverty. He also grows fully conscious of the nature of his personal feeling of pride in all its vanity, and the powerlessness of his pretensions. In this emptiness of soul and silence of the spirit, his pride gradually dies away — until one day the decisive hour arrives in which the man feels himself to be a broken hollow reed and finds no more strength in himself to stand upright in the world. For what has held him upright since time immemorial, the power of his pride, is now broken ; the core of life for his personality is wiped out. Then man experiences himself as *so*

empty that there remains only one thing to do : to give the last breath of his life of soul to love. When he does this, the walls of his prison vanish and heaven opens above him ; the Manas organization has matured. The "vertebral column", which through the death of pride had become a hollow reed, is filled *from above* with the love-revelation of the spiritual world. So he becomes again an upright being — but in quite another sense than before. He now stands upright because he knows himself to be a connecting link standing between heaven and earth. For the *new* wisdom of world evolution is not heaven's wisdom alone, neither is it earthly wisdom alone ; it is their harmony sounded on the strings of the human being who is stretched between heaven and earth.

A similar "imprisonment" of the human soul also takes place after death. *Kamaloka* is not a world, but a *condition of the* human soul. It is a condition in which the soul is closed off from all that happens in the world. There it goes through the purification brought on by its state of being alone. "Imprisonment" takes place not only on the path of cognition and after death, but sometimes in the course of destiny of human individuals on earth. So one will never understand the deeper destiny-tasks of such individualities in the history of mankind as, for instance, Mary Stuart or the Man in the Iron Mask, if one regards their fate merely as "punishment" for the past and not also as "preparation" for the future. The "political" reason for imprisonment may have been the rivalry between Mary Stuart and Elizabeth, it may have lain in the birth rights of the one known as the Man in the Iron Mask who was kept in prison for over forty years — but those are not spiritual reasons. The spiritual reason these personalities had to experience and suffer the fate of undeserved prison loneliness is the preparation of a Manas organization.

Now, denatured from the Semitic sense of Sin, we are still describing here a "sin" which exists as the "vertical scream" upward of serpentine power attempting to seize what it has not earned. It is worth nothing that

this criticism can be made from “Aryan” principles – honor to whom honor, etc., rather than “sin”. Is not God, if a person, due certain honor? Was this not the basis for the medieval conversion of the tribal kings to the Lord of Glory? Although Jesus spoke of taking heaven by storm & violence, what is done here is (according to Tomberg) actually against the organization of the spinal column itself. The spine is not “an eternal circle”, but rather a rising spiral – that is, the serpent’s power of cunning has been broken into by vertical energy. Thus, the spinal column makes an eternal circle going up & down, a Jacob’s ladder. Additionally, due to the vertical “raising” of this column to the solar power of the Sun (and here is the Hyperborean religion), continual influx of vertical power can reach the spinal column and enter into the human being. In this manner, the serpent is hoisted aloft upon the brassy pole, and sacrificed for the sake of those who live “under the Sun”, that we might become eternal stars of righteousness, though some differ in glory, as one star the other. Man walks – that is, he is man, suspended (as on the Tarot card) or hung between heaven and earth, upside down. The Middle Ages were the supreme time period for the recognition of all that it meant to be man.

This is why Jesus proclaimed his “yoke to be easy, his burden light”. Not because it was, but because it offered a means of saving the poor sheep of personality (the human element) which other paths of breaking out of the eternal circle did not, at least until the final in-gathering. Additionally, it was the fountain, capstone, polar star of all the methods, in that (once the post mortem states are reckoned at the end of time), “He will be all in all”. The scattered, diamond-thunderbolt wandering stars of others who have gone their own way will return, or be gathered in.

Tomberg has much more to say about the solarization of the intellect, the selenization of the will, and lunarization of the imagination, as well as the chakras, which sheds light on the Hyperborean relationship to Christianity.

Posted on 2012-01-07 by Logres

* * *

thelight on 2012-01-07 at 12:42 said:

"The Middle Ages were the supreme time period for the recognition of all that it meant to be man."

Can't agree with this statement (since it ignores lost knowledge) but it is valid to the point that we can only work with what has been handed down to us, if we take what remains of our derelict organized faith (Catholicism). The middle ages only held partial revelation.

Do you actually believe that there is a continuum of consciousness in the "post-mortem states" (i.e, an after-life in the genuine sense of the term) or is this more poetic-metaphor cad?

Logres on 2012-01-07 at 18:49 said:

Tomberg thinks that there is a purgatory, either of the serpent, or of a progress to God, the Church teaches it, and the ancients believed it, so that's good enough for me. Additionally, I have had a supernatural experience which confirmed a post-mortem state, or at least a preternatural one, for some entity, an experience not sought for by myself, so yes, we don't "die" except insofar as our physical body is concerned. What happens to those who don't go to God is the subject of several chapters in Tomberg's book – re-incarnation (Gurdjieff's teachings) are based on the electricity of the irritation between Yes/No in man. Poetry can be a swamp, but it can also be disciplined into "seeing".

Matt on 2012-01-08 at 04:15 said:

Logres,

Would you agree that the initiated continue their existence after the dissolution of the physical body, but the uninitiated cease to exist, or maybe more accurately exist at a mere unconscious/larval level, when their physical bodies die?

And another good entry.

thelight on 2012-01-08 at 08:50 said:

Does Cologero stand by the belief in a "post-mortem state" of consciousness? I'm unsure if Evola stood by that claim, rather it was seeing things in a metaphorical sense, but since actions done while alive has cause and effect, they are "immortal". Also understood is the idea of "flame to flame" and your presence living on in others etc (not to leave out the phenomena of psychic residues and larval states such as "ghosts"). All of these happenings are materialistic views and do not suggest a conscious being continuing life after death of the body.

Visit here for an opinion piece on Tombergs' Meditations on the Tarot : <http://billcorrk.wordpress.com/2007/03/29/tombergs-heretical-nonsense/>.

Logres, it's also hard to say for certain if OBE's are not projected imagery of the psyche. We would all love to believe there was a conscious survival after death of the body even through an initiatic operative method but what have we got to believe or prove this other than Faith?

Boreas on 2012-01-08 at 09:30 said:

"We would all love to believe there was a conscious survival after death of the body even through an initiatic operative method but what have we got to believe or prove this other than Faith?"

In theoretical level, esoteric knowledge of the elements – both great and small, material and psychic, microcosmic and macrocosmic – based upon the universal law of correspondences.

Earth (body) dissolves to Water

Water (emotions) evaporates to Fire

Fire (intentions) disappears into the Air

Air (reason) transforms into Aether

Aether (intellect) flies into the Void

The support of consciousness in this dissolving process naturally depends upon the level of spiritual progress – or of the level of "Manas organisation", as it is called by logres in this article. I think it can be said with somewhat certainty that some small part of consciousness goes through the transmigration process through all these phases even in the case of non-initiates, though the "trauma of death" can blurry even this, not to mention other distracting and obscuring factors.

Boreas on 2012-01-08 at 09:36 said:

"Everyone is proud of something. We are proud of God!"

– An esoteric Sufi proverb

thelight on 2012-01-08 at 10:04 said:

"The support of consciousness in this dissolving process naturally depends upon the level of spiritual progress – or of the level of "Manas organisation", as it is called by logres in this article. I think it can be said with somewhat certainty that some small part of consciousness goes through the transmigration process through all these phases even in the case of non-initiates, though the "trauma of death" can blurry even this, not to mention other distracting and obscuring factors."

I won't hold my breath.

logres on 2012-01-08 at 10:10 said:

In a certain sense, I suppose it's true that no one knows what happens after death, because we aren't there yet. While I think Tomberg would agree with what you wrote, Matt, he would

caution that this belief does not become the Gurdjieff quest for creating the four subtle bodies, crystallizing essences out of each body and building them into a tower of Babel. He believes it is possible, but thinks that this is what the serpent promised Adam & Eve (he did not lie, but offered a horizontal magic whereby mages could create a ghost body, then a body of a ghost body with intellect, then one with will and soul, etc.). They could then re-incarnate. Much of what is called "initiation" is (in fact) this kind of lower magic, which reaches an impasse due to its specialization. This is why Scripture calls them wandering stars, and there is no hope for them until the end of time. Or, rather, they are their own hope. This is how he argues.

With regard to post-mortem states, the soul is created by God as his "image", which is NOT defaced. The likeness is defaced, not the image. Therefore, though hell can scorch it, it cannot be destroyed. Nothing can destroy it. Scripture talks about the "works" of man being burned up, nevertheless, the man himself shall be saved. This is what is being spoken of.

If you don't like the Bible, consider natural Reason. Is it reasonable to believe that immortality is merely a metaphor? That all intuitions, premonitions, whispers, etc. which take place in the magical current of the world are simply so much sound & fury? Too much emphasis is being placed on the difference of the afterlife from now; this is only partially true. There is a change in the mode of existence.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-08 at 10:41 said:

fascinating post Logres and a lot that could be commented on! Fiery spear springs to mind....Cx

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-08 at 10:51 said:

@thelight I think it's reasonable to say that certain types of spiritual experience are wholly or in part to do with the psyche, but OBEs aren't like that – you can easily verify they are 'real' by checking in on facts, time/space are traversed differently but this world is as it is – in theory you could go visit someone, watch TV with them then tell them in person the next day what happened. i've not done this kind of thing before and I think a lot of people abuse their astral gifts by spying on others in the lower astral, but I know it is possible. A really good book to read on this subject is George Ritchie, *Return from Tomorrow*. It is a heartwarming, wonderful story whatever your views on this subject – <http://www.near-death.com/ritchie.html>. As a war veteran and psychologist he also has a lot of credibility

Boreas on 2012-01-08 at 15:18 said:

"I won't hold my breath."

That's good. You really should let it go when the time comes.

Matt on 2012-01-08 at 15:32 said:

Lorges,

Thanks for replying. I don't really have any disagreements with what you have written in your reply (I think we're on the same ground here). I'm also not implying that immortality is just a metaphor (though you might have been addressing TheLight there). Just contemplating out loud so-to-speak about the idea of there being a difference between the paths of the initiate (and probably not in the sense you wrote of today's typical initiate) and the common individual. Similar to what Mourieff wrote in his book, or what Raphael Johnson has written (and spoke of in his podcast on Augustine).

I'm sure this comes across as mere rambling on my part. Apologies.

Logres on 2012-01-08 at 19:11 said:

Matt, I was responding to TheLight there, not you, I understood your meaning. Just wanted to be clear because I was confused on the point until I read MotT; there IS a clear distinction between "initiate" or not, most certainly. However, the Church's teaching (which I accept) is that everyone has a spark of divinity which even their freedom is not allowed to efface. Presumably, this hologram (or whatever you wish to call it) allows God the power to ultimately redeem them (if and how and when He chooses). I wasn't aware F. Johnson discussed this. Can you link?

RE: Charlotte's point – the reason God withholds superpowers until a certain level of sanctity is reached (excepting the case of the super-men who use the serpentine energy to ape miracles or in some cases, specialize at the cost of soul and surpass them) is because the same power that can heal can presumably wound or kill. God therefore waits until a certain disposition of the will is "fixed" in virtue – then He confers abilities commensurate with virtue. This is how the angelic hierarchy functions as well.

Matt on 2012-01-08 at 20:00 said:

Here's the link Logres,

<http://reasonradionetwork.com/20110721/the-orthodox-nationalist-saint-augustine-of-hippo>

Maybe its F. Johnson putting his own interpretation into things, but according to him, Augustine, like a number of the church fathers, makes a difference between what the baptized and the unbaptized can expect for their future when the physical body dissolves (I guess on here we can substitute baptized and unbaptized for initiated and uninitiated). The baptized will be given immortality (whether they will experience eternity in hell or heaven is up to each individual) whereas the unbaptized will essentially return to the earth (hence not achieve immortality). I just think its interesting how it connects back to here with Gornahoor on Evola, as he makes this point too about immortality being conditional, and a mere larval survival after the death of the body isn't the same thing. This has all constantly been on my mind lately, so I just wanted to see how you've come to understand all this.

Logres on 2012-01-08 at 22:59 said:

You will be helped (as I was/am) by reading Tomberg – he deals as subtly and religiously with this as anyone I am aware of. There is no doubt baptism incurs a karmic debt (if the person ignores it). Keep meditating on it. If Augustine really thought that, it proves he viewed baptism as “magic”, divine, but magic. I am not sure what to think about reincarnation, “larva”, etc. Am inclined to think people lose pieces of their soul which are restored to them when someone else “breathes them in” (this is a method of dispelling ghosts and incurring the gratitude of the spirit of the ghost, btw). This someone else then can keep and share (return) at the same time, thus becoming a karmic “servant” who is “exalted”. Jesus (then) would have done this on a grand scale. But how small can one make a soul before it disappears?

Cologero on 2012-01-08 at 23:27 said:

No, Mr. Light, we do not stand by any belief but rather stand on gnosis. If you prefer authorities rather than your own self-awareness, you can read our posts on the Ancient City and the veneration of ancestors. In the Bhagavad Gita, we read:

When adharmā (impiety, unrighteousness) overwhelms the family, O Krishna, the women of the family become corrupt; and when, O Krishna, the women are corrupt, there arises a mixing of castes. This mixture leads into hell the family itself as well as those who destroy it; for their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice-balls and water.

Ch 1:41-42

Swami Nikhilananda offers this interpretation:

The reference is to the Hindu religious rites for the dead, known as the *śrāddha* ceremony, in which rice-balls and water are offered by the eldest son for the satisfaction of the soul of the deceased. This ceremony cannot be performed by children born of irregular marriages ... Deprived of the rice-balls and water, the soul of the deceased, according to Hindu tradition, goes to hell. The offerings of rice-balls and water is a symbol of loving and reverent thoughts for the dead, which help to foster a feeling of close relationship between the living and their forebears.

This is the Tradition of the Indo-European peoples, although nowadays we offer flowers in the West. Note how this teaching differs from many self-defined pseudo-Traditionalists, who either refuse to beget sons, or maintain irreverent and hateful thoughts about their ancestors of the past 1500 years, or, worse, deny their continued existence and influence.

For Guenon's explication, please refer to *Man and his Becoming* according to the Vedanta. Evola writes of two paths:

This type corresponds spiritually to the "forefather's path"—*pitr-yana*—which the Indian traditions speak about, also called the earth path or mother's path, according to which the individuals are dissolved entirely after death into the original stocks, in the forces of the race and forefather's blood, with which true existence alone rests. But, opposed to this path, there is the solar path or path of the gods—*deva-yana*—also called the Nordic path (while the first path, the path of the totem, is called the path of the South); a path which we can also call Olympic, travelled by those who make themselves immortal, who become gods, who "go out in order not to return".

As for the fellow perturbed by Tomberg, it demonstrates why such teachings were always passed on in secret. In our disordered age, some concessions need to be made. Of course, salvation is possible without any Hermetic teachings. But some men seek after liberation, so they have a different need.

Matt on 2012-01-08 at 23:58 said:

Logres,

Yeah, I started reading Tomberg at the end of 2010. I haven't yet finished his work due to being busy with school, family, my other readings etc. But I am making it my goal to finish reading it.

logres on 2012-01-09 at 08:55 said:

Matt, I'm slowly working my way through, also. Am not trying to be mystical, or put off your question, which is a good one. Cologero's answer above contains the germ of an answer to that question (baptism being birth or ancestry from above) or you can approach it theologically. One has to keep in mind that a "personal" answer may be valid gnostically, but not valid publicly, which is where I am at – in terms of personal experience and knowledge towards me, baptism is a rite which confers a divine blessing or birth, depending on the giver and the recipient. What I would say publicly is that it establishes some kind of a link to the destiny of the Church. I wish

I could go further at this point, but cannot. It is a very pressing question, which you are right to ask.

Thanks for the vinegar sponge so far, but still I thirst. When one thinks of it, the state of post-mortem is of utmost importance. Of course it best to "know rather than to believe", but as often our musings, idleness and forum chit-chat are distractions to doing the actual work that will save us (so to speak) from a rebirth to a samsaric repetition or dissolution into Hades. Perhaps it is necessary that one's being should be centered to death at all moments, and indeed how one approaches death is central to all religions and spiritualities.

Cologero wrote : "This is the Tradition of the Indo-European peoples, although nowadays we offer flowers in the West. Note how this teaching differs from many self-defined pseudo-Traditionalists, who either refuse to beget sons, or maintain irreverent and hateful thoughts about their ancestors of the past 1500 years, or, worse, deny their continued existence and influence."

Two things I must take issue with here. While it is loyal and honorable to revere ones ancestors, few can trace their ancestry back beyond a thousand years, let alone 30,000 yrs since the dawn of Europe (never-mind if they worshiped under a "Semitic" god or not and if the I.E. invasions only occurred 3,000-4,000 yrs ago). Are flowers still enough food for the remembrance rites?

On the other hand, what of celibate priests and other holy men who do not beget sons? Are these too, "hateful pseudo-Traditionalists"? What do you make of Evolas situation then whom saw the family (biblical "family values") as a giving in as opposed to the comradeship of a holy männerbund? There is also the Hermetic question of "the mysterious race of perfect men, unknown to previous generations." The Royal Art of the "Sons of Hermes"?

Cologero: "a path which we can also call Olympic, travelled by those who make themselves immortal, who become gods, who "go out in order not to return".

Bravo. Now this quote on the Nordic path is perhaps the most significant statement made thus far but how is this literally achieved if I must ask a direct and predictable question?

logres on 2012-01-09 at 23:19 said:

Well, you can always start with the hundred or so articles Cologero has put up on the site (along with others, in the past). I'd recommend the essays on the Three Trials. <http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

There are plenty of others, meant to direct one's inquiry, rather than to give a pat answer. I don't know your background, so you may already know this – part of the efficacy of Hermetic work consists in the student's own desire and thirst. So it depends what you are asking – if Evola is the angle you are interested in, I am sure someone on this site can help to pinpoint some texts that will assist you.

logres on 2012-01-09 at 23:20 said:

Charlotte, as always, you leave me curious – what is a flaming spear?

Boreas on 2012-01-10 at 05:07 said:

TheLight said: "Now this quote on the Nordic path is perhaps the most significant statement made thus far but how is this literally achieved if I must ask a direct and predictable question?"

A good article on the subject by Guénon can be found from here:

http://www.lodgeroomus.net/downloadcenter/uploads/The_solstitial_doors1.pdf

Initiation and Spiritual Realization certainly has some worthy texts also about the subject of ascending and descending realizations and corresponding goals etc. If it's Evola you are interested, then I'd suggest starting with 'The Doctrine of Awakening' about the subject of liberation from the cosmos.

You are certainly right that one minute of practice (meditation etc.) is worth ten hours of theory, but if the theoretical background is missing or unclear, then practice is also easily mis-directed.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-12 at 13:30 said:

Boreas I can't say all of what was in my head at that moment, but I can confirm that it relates to the spear used to pierce the side of Christ on the Cross. Funnily enough yesterday while I was thinking of what to say about this I randomly opened the first book in my library that came to hand and it turned out to be a passage about precisely this object. As such I found it worth detailing on my blog:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/mystery-of-the-spear>

The mystery of the spear wound points us towards spiritualisation of the physical body. The special, pure elixir that flows from the side of the Lord is certainly an esoteric reference to an esoteric process of development that occurred – for the first time, yet symptomatically for all human beings – here on earth within the space of a few hours.

(We need to counter the idea that spiritual processes and the higher developments they bring about unfold exclusively beyond the threshold, and never impinge on the sensory world. It is an erroneous gnostic mode of thought that regards the Christ sacrifice, His transformation and resurrection, as a process solely of spirit and soul. This would be a denial of Paul's teaching.

What use is spiritual development if it has no reforming effect on the lower bodies? And these lower bodies – particularly the lowest, the physical body – belong to the earthly world and can only be worked upon during incarnation. All development in the spirit aims to enliven the mortal human being.

All higher spiritual development at the same time works and impinges on matter. Serious spiritual work always leads to deed and action in the physical world. The appearance of a divine being in the material world embodied this to the very highest degree).

The spear-wound mystery is one of transformation, of etherisation; and it takes place before the eyes of those present at the time. One of these witnesses became a source of truth for us, leaving his testimony in the form of the Gospel of St John.

If this Gospel by the disciple whom the Lord loved is read in the right way it reveals to us deep truths about the Mystery of Golgotha.

Judith von Halle, *Secrets of the Stations of the Cross and the Grail Blood*

Boreas on 2012-01-12 at 18:20 said:

Charlotte, you are absolutely correct that all real spiritual experiences are truly Earth-shattering (!); especially if there is still something rigid in our being, the effect of the spirit shatters it like focused Solar Rays crack and melt the ice. The gift of Tears!

After all, a truly Human soul is a fully lighted house with five windows of blood and living water, shining with blazing letters of light in the dark cave of the personality.

"A man of wisdom sees the world through his own windows." – Lao-tzu

Can't help linking this: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RDS2PWRuB7M>

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-12 at 18:38 said:

Yes I often think about the gift of tears, it's one (of many) things from MoTT that was really impressed upon me ...so much to say!

1.25 Sun, Moon, & Stars

I want to remark on something in Tomberg's *Meditations*, in comparison between Chapter 18 (The Moon) & Chapter 19 (The Sun). Besides many other side meditations of delight (including a short, extremely well put defense of medieval scholasticism, which he says was a marriage of wisdom and intelligence to produce intuition), Tomberg gives us two symbols in each chapter. They are both based on the hexagram. Readers who frequent Gornahoor may recall that Mouravieff mentions the hexagram in connection with spiritual initiation, in his marvelous *Gnosis*. The hexagram (according to Tomberg) can be arranged either with two

squatty triangles at the top and a rectangle in the middle (in which case it symbolizes antinomies and opposing lines which “eclipse” the Divine Intelligence in man and drive him back into the stagnant water which the crawfish or lobster is dwelling in on the card, The Moon), or it can form an interpenetrating two triangles, like the star of David, which is the Divine Trinity coming down, and the Earthly Trinity (of Mother Sophia, Daughter, & World-Soul) rising up. This last is the next card, The Sun.

This is a fabulous symbol which shows that the same facts, arranged in different configurations, produce entirely different results : it is simply a question of force-lines and spiritual energy, which makes the difference and either bars man’s path (The Guardian of the Threshold) or opens the gates of initiation. It is also worth noting that Evola speaks of something similar in his work on magic, related to ascending the different “steps”, each of which are guardians. Is there a particular “step” into the spiritual world which involves a hexagram and an all-seeing eye, which is either malevolent/protective or benevolent/benedictory?

If we accept the revelatory power of Tomberg’s symbolism, there is more food for thought here, beyond even private initiation or struggle. The Western path is asserted by Tomberg to be superior even to Eastern methods, not because they are superior when compared each to each on a level, but because the Western method was slightly more complete. Tomberg associates this with the woman in Revelations¹⁸⁷, whose footstool was the moon, clothes were the sun, and was crowned with stars.

Here, again, the moon & sun are juxtaposed, but the stars are additive. What are they? Tomberg claims that they are the Western edifice which goes beyond the Eastern transcendental Self¹⁸⁸ which knows itself as God. Tomberg believes that (immortal and immutable, eternal and transcendent as it is) the Self actually can go “beyond” even itself, and meet other “Gods” – other selves which are the world of the hierarchies,

¹⁸⁷<http://bible.cc/revelation/12-1.htm>

¹⁸⁸<http://www.worldwisdom.com/uploads/pdfs/27.pdf>

angels, and other “just men made perfect”. These are “the stars”.

Immediately, we are transported to Dante’s emergence out of Purgatory:

To get back up to the shining world from there
My guide and I went into that hidden tunnel,
And Following its path, we took no care
To rest, but climbed: he first, then I-so far,
through a round aperture I saw appear
Some of the beautiful things that Heaven bears,
Where we came forth, and once more saw the stars.

Canto XXXIV

The medieval world was not oblivious to “Eastern doctrine”, but approached it from the Sankya-side¹⁸⁹, in refusing to ultimately identify the Self as the final pinnacle. Rather, the “Self” could begin a new ascent, and rather than find itself “frozen” or “alone”, looked up to see the other stars. The individual “purusha” or “monad” was affirmed, but a universal Purusha was not denied. As Tomberg remarks (and as a medieval man would readily agree) “for the devil, also, is transcendental and immortal”. V. Tomberg points to Jung as a thinker in the West who narrowly missed the Eastern way, and left a door for identifying a bigger horizon beyond even the archetypal Self. The spiritual moon is the Sun which shines at midnight, which (of course) in a manner of speaking is “just like the stars”, or points to the stars, which are smaller suns, shining at midnight.

It is this world which Tomberg writes to defend, as his *Meditations* defend the reality of the Tarot deck as a hermetic vehicle from the Middle Ages, meant to communicate what certain men of the West had learned concerning “the secret things of God”.

¹⁸⁹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Samkhya>

Posted on 2012-01-14 by Logres

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-15 at 13:50 said:

Squaring the circle!

Yes, a very important symbol, I actually used this at the start of my epic poem, *The Myth*:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/hidden-stargates>

ates

and described it at the end of the introduction here:

There in orbit turn the star-lings,
Planets binding, suns inclining,
In such ways that whole dimensions
Fold inside the vaults of Heaven.
Angels watch the hidden stargates –
One from North, a second South-side –
East and West. The seal is six-faced.
Secret form – a cube, shaped inside.

logres on 2012-01-15 at 22:34 said:

That is (if I take your meaning) almost precisely what Tomberg was getting at, phrased symbolically and cosmologically? A stargate as a “guardian”? Beautiful poetry, regardless...

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-16 at 11:14 said:

Thank you Logres for the kind words. I was not consciously hearkening to MoTT when writing this, but spent about 5 years around this time intensively studying the book so it's not surprising if there's some resonance!

1.26 Deep Materiality

Tomberg remarks in his *Meditations* that Christianity places the locus of sin, not in the body or material existence (such as he thinks is implied to a degree by Eastern metaphysic), but in the soul. The body, then, as such, becomes rather a focus of redemption and revelation, rather than

something which needs to be shed (along with the sense of “self”), in order to attain Enlightenment. Tomberg even refers to the personality as the “lost sheep” or lonely and vulnerable flock which the Lord came intending to seek and to save. These views can be linked with his comments on hermeticism differing even from “saintliness”, in which he insists that the hermetic is like Jacob wrestling with the angel, in that it refuses to sacrifice or suborn its intellect. Instead, it wishes the intellect to be “re-made” but kept, in the image of holiness. This defines Tomberg’s path over and against those of magical bent (such as Franz Bardon¹⁹⁰) who might seem to believe that no essential connection exists between purification/illumination/theosis and the awakening of the vital bodies, and those who utterly reject Tomberg’s aspiration to pursue something which is essentially different than the saintly path of (say) someone like Saint Cuthbert, who waded into icy sea water¹⁹¹ and sang psalms all night long to develop their will. Tomberg (I think) would say that the saints truncated a part of their personality, and that the magicians sacrificed a piece of their soul.

Rather than looking at this as a Hegelian synthesis, perhaps we should see Tomberg as essentially re-uniting something which was once indivisible, on a higher plane. I will call this the path of the “hermit”, using Tomberg’s own image. This (I would argue) should be seen as the path of the Middle Ages, which abrogated the reign of the saints (from St. Martin all the way to St. Guthlac) in seeking a more “human” path, somewhere in between “beast” and “god”. For instance, Saint Martin might have helped save the Empire by engaging in martial leadership, but chose instead to pursue the “saintly path” of abnegation. Anyone who has read Evola would have to feel a twinge of regret when reading the life of the

¹⁹⁰http://www.asiya.org/athenaeum/Bardon_Magical_Evocation.pdf

¹⁹¹<http://www.mainlesson.com/display.php?author=macgregor&book=christopher&story=cuthbert>

this saint¹⁹².

How is this path to be sought? I will not necessarily argue that it has to take place within the “Church” (the body of Christ) – for a number of reasons, this is impracticable. Tomberg gives us another clue in *Meditations* – those who are “humble” have certainly been in the presence of God. But what, he asks, if they have not consciously known this? What then? Is the intuition invalid? No, they have experienced it somewhere else, either in a dream, or somewhere even more dreamlike.

And this leads us back to “deep materiality”. In the “Secret Life of Doctor Honigberger”, Eliade¹⁹³ suggests that the Divine Absolute keeps most of us from developing our spiritual powers in order to both protect us, and prepare us, for that world. A certain detachment, and asceticism is necessary, because to suddenly enter it would be a sensory overload which would lead to destruction at worst, confusion and loss at best. The Middle Ages embodied the most “natural” and “sane” path because it balanced an awareness of this life as an “antechamber”, while giving full play to the grace inherent in the innocent body. It was the soul which needed (above all) purification, not the body, or the spirit. This was the secret genius and angel which united Europe and created Christendom. As the picture reminds us, the blessed Theotokos actually nursed the man-God, who did not scorn to become a child. Let us, then, not scorn the “days of small things” when we are as children, and are not as we shall become. Not yet.

Posted on 2012-01-21 by Logres

* * *

Boreas on 2012-01-21 at 12:13 said:

¹⁹²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Martin_of_Tours

¹⁹³http://www.plural-magazine.com/article_the-secret-of-dr-honigberger.html

"For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places." – Eph. 6:12

I'd add that we wrestle them in ourselves, in our personality, and when we have won ourselves and our own petty desires, the "principalities and powers", "the archons of this world" and "the prince of this world" reveal themselves as pure divine powers, beyond good and evil. Before this they manifest as tempters, accusers and opponents, who test the purity of our motives and intentions, our following of the divine will – just like Satan did to Job (and later on to Christ).

Logres on 2012-01-21 at 17:03 said:

That would be consistent with pursuing a "middle path" between abjuration pure and simple (the saints) & premature exploration (most currents of Magick). This seems to sum up Tomberg's "project" in his Meditations on the Tarot. Thank you for the comment. In the end, we would look back & see that the dark powers existed primarily because of the turning away from God to begin with ("all them that hate me, love death"). It is also consistent with the vision of Recapitulation, in which the last enemy that is conquered is Death (and its attendants).

Logres on 2012-01-21 at 17:08 said:

The only warning I would add to Boreas' statement is that (historically) we have often seen how seemingly pursuing a synthetic project ends up destroying both thesis and antithesis. For example, to the uninitiate, Hegel combines classical philosophy with Christian revelation in such a way as to annihilate both (the "Left", Marxism). Of course, to the initiate, Hegel can be revealed to be engaged in hunting much bigger game, and in not doing what his "defenders" claim at all. Simone Weil also cautioned against this kind of eclecticism. It is something to consider for any "man of the West" in his interests which lie "outside of" Western tradition. There are spiritual energies at work here, and we see where most multicultural or New Age thought ends up. Hence, Gornahoor's emphasis on pursuing a "valid" spiritual tradition of one's very own, knowing it very well, being grounded in it. If Plato's "Ideas" only exist as spiritual vortex and energies generated by higher Beings, then "playing" with Ideas might involve great danger. This must have been the basis of picking a guide, or teacher, and of adhering to what had been "revealed" already: after all, why should the Absolute and the Infinite give us better guides when we won't listen to the ones we've already been given? And wasn't this the basis of medieval "tradition"? Dante?

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 09:53 said:

I've decided most of the answers are in Lord of the Rings :-)) (having just watched the entire set of DVDs again!). Can't beat the book tho, shame the font is so small... ..

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 09:58 said:

Also, more on topic, recently I read something by Judith von Halle about the spear wound, I think I shared this – touches on purification/reforming of hte bodies.

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/mystery-of-the-spear>

Logres on 2012-01-22 at 16:29 said:

Charlotte, thanks for linking that... I was wondering what you meant by that comment.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 17:10 said:

oh let me see, well in my mind we are working on the formation of sustainable resurrection bodies and I felt this was relevant – so while the saint goes the way of purification through self denial, the hermeticist wrestles with the angel. But both have the Resurrection body as an end goal, or part of it at least, do you not think that is so? I am thinking perhaps of the aspect of practice that leads to results tangible on all planes, the manifestation you spoke of recently.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 17:12 said:

which is also what brought me onto Lazarus, as for a while I felt it was important to think of this mystery, though I would not necessarily have been able to say why – more it was because of the direction that we seemed to be going in with the stream of posts and comments, of consciousness

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 17:16 said:

also there was an internal prompt to read this book of VT's, which like Christ and Sophia addresses and helps to shed light on some of the very dense and complex situations and challenges raised by MoTT

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 17:26 said:

the being 'remade' corresponds to an extract here:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/lazurus-come-forth>

The resurrection within Christianity of the Hindu and Buddhist spiritual life, to which the church owes the arising of the whole monastic movement and the founding of religious orders in late antiquity, as not the last event of its kind in church history.

Others followed according to the law that all truth and love of the past that have timeless values are called back out of the realms of forgetting, sleep and death into the daylight of Christian spiritual life through the call that from age to age reminds, rouses and awakens.

Through this call sounding forth from Him who is the Resurrection and the Life, saying 'Lazarus, come forth!' – the most noble and valuable aspects of pagan antiquity were also

resurrected.

The Platonic and Aristotelian treasury of thought arose radiant in transfigured form and inspired great spirits of the church to take up the *philosophia perennis*, in which lay the task of lifting up the chalice of pure human thinking and sacrificial offering to divine revelation.

For this was the essential aim of the scholastics: the raising up of the chalice of crystal clear human thinking upon the altar of Godhead – the Godhead manifesting in divine revelation... ..

... ..for the history of Christianity is not that of adjusting to world progress – it is the story of the return of the Prodigal Son, ie, humanity, to the Father's House. its path is not so much a forming of the future as a resurrection of the past – not indeed the mere return of the past, but the reawakening of its eternal core of truth in all its greatness and nobility.

As the fall of the human being into sin was a descent from the heights of consciousness of the everlasting Presence of God, so does the way of reascent lead through the same stages by which the descent was made – that is, through the stages of resurrection of the past.

And the future of the world, its end, the Last Day, is not the final triumph of the progress of natural evolution, but the state of the resurrection of the whole of the past. The Last Day is no specific 'day' of the last year of the world, but is the ever present process of resurrection that culminates in the resurrection of the eternal 'first day of creation'.

It is the primal creative Word: 'Let there be light!' that forms the essence of the Last Judgement. yes, the world passes away – and simultaneously it is resurrected. The eternal creative Word: 'Let there be light', is the Alpha and Omega, the first and the last, and the eternally present (Revelation xxi, 6).

Logres on 2012-01-22 at 20:42 said:
ntique and "difficult" transformations.

1.27 Remarks on Tomberg

Those who are interested in reading *Meditations* ought to peruse this index to his book here¹⁹⁴. Consulting the index under "personal magic", one is referred to pages 478-480 (among others):

¹⁹⁴<http://www.beautytruegood.co.uk/tarotdex.htm#G>



Therefore, it follows from the preceding that magical formulae are not invented – just as true poetry is not invented – but that they are born from blood and light. This is why one uses in sacred magic, as a rule, traditional formulae – and this not because they are ancient, but rather because they took birth in the above indicated manner and they have proved themselves as such. This was well known to Martines de Pasqually, for example. The rituals of his magical invocations consist only of traditional formulae, drawn above all from the Psalms – not because he was a practicing Catholic but solely in view of their magical effectiveness (in the magic that he taught and practiced). Sacred magic differs from personal or arbitrary magic – beyond the differences which we have stated in the third Letter – also in that it “makes use” of the agent of growth, whilst arbitrary magic works above all with the magical agent of electricity... neither science nor personal magic can perform miracles... on the other hand, every human word can become magical if it is sincere to the point of engaging the blood, and if at the same point it is filled by faith to the point of setting the luminous waters of hope from above in motion.

Tomberg is not rejecting paganism or magic per se (such as that outlined by the UR Group in their essays with Evola on magic, or by Franz Bardon in his work); he is endeavoring to place it within the Empire of Heaven. Just as traditionalism finds its fulfillment in the notion of an Imperium or sacral Emperorship which guarantees the “shields of the earth” (kingdoms) by stepping even higher, so does Tomberg push Eastern mysticism into the “Selves beyond the Selves” & the “Magic from on high” which supersedes without annihilating all lesser shadows and analogies.

Tomberg quotes Christ in the Beatitudes, who says:

Matthew 5:33 Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of old time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself NKJV: swear falsely , but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths: 34 But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne: 35 Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King. 36 Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black. 37 But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.

Rather than being a prohibition of any oaths, or magic, Tomberg interprets this as being a temporary injunction which is absolute until the proper “centers” (inner/outer) are restored. It is a question of our lack of knowledge – the only kind of personal magic that un-illuminated man can “reach” is serpentine and purely horizontal – thus, it represents only a deepening of his plight. However, once the relationship with the “waters above the earth” is restored, it is a different question. God prohibits because we are not ready.

There is a significant link here with the following idea from Hebrews 6:

For when God made the promise to Abraham, since He could swear by no one greater, He swore by Himself, saying, “I WILL SURELY BLESS YOU AND I WILL SURELY MULTIPLY YOU. And so, having patiently waited, he obtained the promise. For men swear by one greater than themselves, and with them an oath given as confirmation is an end of every dispute. In the same way God, desiring even more to show to the heirs of the promise the unchangeableness of His purpose, interposed with an oath, so that by two unchangeable things in which it is impossible for God to lie, we who have taken refuge would have strong encouragement to take hold of the hope set before us. This hope we have

as an anchor of the soul, a hope both sure and steadfast and one which enters within the veil, where Jesus has entered as a forerunner for us, having become a high priest forever according to the order of Melchizedek.

The double oath is found on the tablet of Enoch, who walked with God-

As above, so below.

Man's destiny is to have what he wants, but in God's way, and God's time. This is the mystery of the "Self beyond the Self", which only the "Self" can find.

Posted on 2012-01-28 by Logres

1.28 Recapitulation

Saint Paul teaches in the epistle to the Colossians that all things will be summed up in Christ, who will then deliver the kingdom up to the Father, as He had it from Him from the beginning. Then, will come and be the "end". This teaching, along with verses such as "heaven and earth will pass away, but the word of the Lord (My Word) shall endure forever" give glimpses of another doctrine hiding behind the "perspicacious" meaning of *sola Scriptura*. If "heaven and earth" will pass away, then there is an element of nihilism to Scripture, compatible with the ontological assertions of certain other ancient scriptures. Yet, the passing of heaven and earth is not "the last word" – we can connect this with Tomberg's doctrine of the "Self (God) beyond the ultimate Selves". Not only can men like Enoch escape the horizontal circle of the serpent, so can *buddhas* from the East, and yet their escape remains an inexplicable fact. Avatars are introduced to communicate in the opposite direction, but this, too, is a mystery. Men, said Paul on Mars Hill¹⁹⁵, quoting Aratus and other Greek

¹⁹⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Areopagus>

poets, seek for God, if “happily they might find him”. The possibility is real, and not limited to the Hebraic tradition. However, the esoteric Christian tradition is not so much that others (such as the Greek) are “incomplete”, but that it is capable of being added to. *These are not quite the same things, to be incomplete and to be capable of addition.*

But this is not all. From another Pauline epistle comes this¹⁹⁶: “man’s works shall be burned up in fire, but he shall be saved”.

The *Apokastasis*¹⁹⁷ used to be the doctrine of the early church, until the needs of holding together an Empire and a marching order of transcendent temple-worship lead to Justinian’s measures¹⁹⁸. The West was in such dire shape following the barbarian tribal invasions and the imperial collapse that Church fasting requirements were relaxed so that the sick and the poor could eat enough meat to survive – this was common in the West, at least. This was the kind of context into which Christianity stepped to carry the banner of transcendence and order. The original vision of a recapitulation (or re-breathing of God’s breath) gave place to more concrete, useful, and also (in their own way) more accurate reflections of what man needed to know during those dire times. What good was a doctrine of universal salvation if it would be simply used to justify laxity and apathy?

Scripture teaches that Christ loved his sheep (His “body”) as a bridegroom loves his bride-to-be. If Christ intended to not enter heaven without cleansing his bride (and even “harrowing hell”¹⁹⁹), this leads us to believe that the “path” which he opened as an avatar was intended to embrace the entirety of the human race (including other avatars with a human face), because “if I shall be lifted up, I shall draw all men to me”.

The foregoing overview should make clear the complexity and dif-

¹⁹⁶http://biblebrowser.com/1_corinthians/3-12.htm

¹⁹⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Apocatastasis>

¹⁹⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Justinian_I

¹⁹⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harrowing_of_Hell

ficulty of the Christian tradition. It is not so simple as to say that the Church did merely or only this, or that, or that Christ taught only this, or just that. There were multiple facets or aspects of the primordial Tradition being preserved, but being preserved while undergoing a metamorphosis. If we object that much was lost, indeed this is true, yet how can it be “lost” if we know it was? Esoteric traditions, such as the Fedeli Amore²⁰⁰, have persisted within Christendom throughout history, down to this day, and one can trace its influence (as above) in the writings of Saint Paul, who had “many things hard to understand” and many other things he “wished to say to you”, but “you were not able”.

Thus, the nihilism of the “heaven and earth being rolled up as a scroll” is consistent with an esoteric doctrine of Christ as final avatar, not to abolish other avatars, but to entirely make sense of them and complete them by adding the cornerstone, which is as great a “mystery beyond the mystery” as esoteric doctrine is a “mystery” to something purely external.

In fact, the doctrine of Recapitulation can be deduced from that of karma and sexual union. If man and woman “become one flesh” (as Saint Paul warns those thinking of undertaking temple prostitution), then the subtle and vital bodies (as well as the physical) are united. Christianity, in fact, does not deny the ancient yoga techniques of retention of semen (the physical body), holding of the breath (the subtle body), and the stopping of thought (the vital body). In fact, it incorporated it into its priesthood. But it argued that there was “another way”. This is true Christian form. As long as the reason is understood all is well. And here it is. If a man loves his woman as Christ loved the Church (with the result that the “one flesh” is totally sanctified, a double burden, or perhaps a double help, in the end), then the karmic chain of carnal relations to the woman will not hold the male out of paradise. Just as Christ “weds” to the Church, so can Christians make of monogamy a chivalric chastity and “second

²⁰⁰<http://web.eecs.utk.edu/~mclennan/Classes/US310/Dante-Fedeli-d-Amore.html>

coming of Love”, which can inspire something akin to that which fired the “Dark Ages” of Dante.

So which path is easier? Total abstinence, or devotion to “the one woman” above all else? Either way, it is time for Christians to repent.

Posted on 2012-03-03 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2012-03-04 at 00:49 said:

Much more really needs to be said and meditated upon, and this is (in a sense) woefully incomplete. For one thing, Mouravieff has interesting passages in Gnosis on the fact that “a man is not without the woman, nor the woman without the man, in the Lord”. HOO might add something here about Percival, perhaps. Von Hildebrand (a convert from Protestantism to Catholicism) has interesting meditations on the man-woman dyad, and Steiner himself remarked that the male spiritual body was feminine, while the woman's was male. What needs more meditation is the fact that Christ did not come as other avatars did, withdrawing into himself upon a mountaintop or waging war with magic upon the kingdoms of the world (although he implicitly endorses such, in its place), but as an avatar of avatar who incorporated a multitude of previous faces/masks and made a particular Tao to unify what had before been at an impasse. In particular, the bride-bridegroom motif (which is visible in historical form in the history of Anglicanism in Britain, most embodied, perhaps in the writings of Jane Austen) seems to be a singularity which ought only to be attempted by God.

1.29 Middle Earth Once More

By way of such aspects, we see—it is clear—in the Middle Ages an awakening of the true forces already acting in Nordic-Aryan Romanity, of its true solarly, propitiated from such a resurgence or rebirth from a new contribution of Aryan blood...

Gornahoor translating Evola²⁰¹, on Cesaro

²⁰¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3861>

Indeed, a *tremendously sophisticated* defense of the very opposite view (which Evola here castigates) can be found by a modern feminist²⁰², which draws on both Neumann and J. Bachofen in truly classical fashion, in order to defend the earth-cults and the “rise of the feminine”. Yet it should be obvious by now to all those with perception that the “rise of feminism” entails the non-existence (in experience) of the solar origins, whereas the opposite is not true. Solarity can comprehend and order what is below it, but what is below it cannot comprehend and order solarity – this is the meaning (of course also) of the Biblical myth and mandate for the man to be the spiritual “head” of the woman, although it is typically taken very literally. Thus, “what comes after” is not a novelty or evolution, but rather a devolution. This is exactly the opposite of that which is generally “held” in the academic and spiritual worlds of today, where progressives try to convince others that they have “something better to offer” in tune with the *Zeitgeist* than those horrible old days of long ago when “we” (who is this “We”, here?) didn’t know any better. This is the world of the Iron Polygon²⁰³ and the “Cathedral”²⁰⁴, where everyone has a “right” to “rights”, which usually means squabbling over personally disgusting political material. Some might argue for the “Matrix” as a better word here, and I am sure the terminology and word play will continue to be plied, in order to come to a more perfect understanding of how the Modern World is evolving.

But “devolution” is a tremendous theme that recurs over and over again with Evola. An acquaintance put it this way:

²⁰²<http://www.bu.edu/arion/files/2010/03/Paglia-Great-Mother1.pdf>

²⁰³<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2007/05/iron-polygon-power-in-united-states.html>

²⁰⁴<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2009/01/gentle-introduction-to-unqualified.html>

- (1) Evola dealt with both the seen and the unseen, the commonly recognized and perceivable, and the obscure.
- (2) Evola dealt with the controversial — the things which salaried men dependent upon their peers' approval refuse to speak on.
- (3) Evola represents a regal framework which recognizes the proper stance of a solider, the transcendental outlook. This is also imperial insofar as the imperium stretches beyond any exception that a man or people might make for itself.
- (4) Evola, even if his wartime endeavors may have been misguided, was always forward looking. His thought is relevant to the present day.
- (5) Because of the above, Evola thought, in uncommon fashion, whereas most others simply regurgitate the opinions of their peers.
- (6) Evola was one of a few universal minds, both pan-European and looking seriously at the cultures of the East, of the type that are no longer found today among a worldwide culture which no longer takes the traditional arts seriously and tears down those who do.
- (7) Evola plotted a path for individuals to overcome, to transcend their individual limitations, without dependence on dogma.
- (8) Evola did not mince words, neither adding fluff in order to sell himself to the masses nor adding mean witticisms for the sake of producing petty laughter.
- (9) Evola was not motivated by fear, positing or selling post-mortem metaphysical realms for those whose hearts are too faint to face the present one. He could not and did not divorce the political and metaphysical — the danger of all priests who implicitly attempt to play at politics.
- (10) Evola was rooted and established in the transcendental, the spiritual man spoken of and lauded by the ancients, the sage who is known to those who know they do not understand.

(Credit to Joel Dietz, of The Conservatory, Dunedain.net)

Steiner's idea of "Evolution" can (ultimately) be said to de-rail his entire system, no matter what his other virtues and how much other truth he contains, or personally embodied. This could account for the death of his movement after his passing, for there was no doubt that Steiner knew a great deal of mysterious and occult things. Evola, situated as he was, was in a better place to understand how little compromise was possible with the new conditions; he knew that the Revolution intended to dethrone the true Self in the name of the sensate individuality. Steiner, on this point, illustrates how devastating even a minor flaw in Reason can be, a point Alain Benoist is also illustrating before our eyes in his current career (as Gornahoor has also highlighted).

Like the Roman Catholic Church showed man, a great deal of experiential freedom can be tolerated, but not certain fundamental theoretical errors which go deep enough, leading (in the end and if pursued vigorously) to the "triumph of man's reason"²⁰⁵.

There is a "Christian" reason for this very fact, as well, which is illustrated over and over again, countless times, in the annals of man (Evola learned quite well from his Catholic teachers). Errors do not immediately manifest their fruits (which is why they are "fruits"), at least not to those of us in between heaven and earth. The only thing that can help here is to be "wise as serpents", or, (as Jesus illustrated) to use one's divinely inspired and lead Reason to steer through the narrow gate, for Reason (the Noetic faculty) is the only portion of man²⁰⁶ which a "beginner" can use with impunity from his dark side.

The good thing is that there are "fruits" which can be held up to be judged. Were the Middle Ages really that bad²⁰⁷? As credit substitutes

²⁰⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Revolt_in_the_Vend%C3%A9e

²⁰⁶<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvfbocYAs7w>

²⁰⁷<http://listverse.com/2009/01/07/top-10-myths-about-the-middle-ages/>

for open slavery in late stage capitalism, can one continue to maintain that everything ancient regime is distasteful and misguided? It is inconceivable to the modern mindset that anything important has been lost, since it is governed by instrumental “reason”, functionalism, and a pragmatism which is ideologically charged to rationalize whatever it cannot account for strictly speaking, on even its own terms. It is also precommitted to what Tomberg would call the purely “horizontal”, or “circle of the serpent”: we do not need God (or the higher Self) because we now have “Infinity” (or perhaps, “Singularity”). Pages of narrative are necessary to qualify how this “gutting” of transcendence can preserve any meaning at all.

The Middle Ages (if one will actually open the annals²⁰⁸ and writings of history, or even go to a cathedral to study them²⁰⁹) are a permanent refutation of the idea and ideal of Progress. How can “Progress” mean anything when confronted with the undeniable fact that the Middle Ages, *even on their own progressive theories*, bridge the Ancient collapse and the Modern Day? What will they refute a Gothic rose window with? They were the time of the “truly human”, living in a precarious but cheerful balance (even Nietzsche saw their cheerfulness tinged as late a century as the 17th), between the age of the gods and the age of the animals. They were perfectly willing²¹⁰ to utilize technology, when a cultural space could be found for such, but were unwilling to commit themselves wholesale to a view of man as a “plug-in” to his own devisings.

As the Modern World deepens its devolution, the Middle Ages will continue to grow lighter and brighter. It will become more crystal clear that there is only way out – not a path “deeper into Chaos” but a path

²⁰⁸<http://www.flw.ugent.be/btng-rbhc/pdf/BTNG-RBHC,%2034,%202004,%204,%20pp%20567-579.pdf>

²⁰⁹<http://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/24428>

²¹⁰<http://listverse.com/2007/09/22/top-10-inventions-of-the-middle-ages/>

back to where we have been told “There Be Dragons”.

The world already awaits us.

Posted on 2012-03-16 by Logres

1.30 Making the Modern Mind

Sometimes it helps to meditate on what is good by looking at the opposite, at least for those of us who only have “intimations of deprivation²¹¹” and have not yet found our true center. This kind of “cautionary tale” meditation or meditating “by negative example” is very easy in Western societies at present. One need only take the nearest objects at hand in the mental furniture and stare at them awhile. You just need to know how to reverse the negative plate photographically in your own soul-mirror, which can be challenging. Still, if one knows roughly what the room should look like²¹² by appealing to authority, then perhaps there is value in it.

What, one may ask, is “self-evident” about all men being created equal? That they are equally unique? Or equal in outcome? Equal in ability? It is not self-evident at all, on the contrary. The only thing truly self-evident is that men are singular, unique, personal²¹³, even when they are deprived of Being and live at the level of the animal. But this is a far cry from what Jefferson meant.

Locke (along with Ockham & Bacon) is also regarded²¹⁴ as self-evident, for it was the British Enlightenment along with “classical liberalism” which undermined the Anglo-world, rather than just the French Revolution.

²¹¹<http://www.dunedain.net/discussion/viewtopic.php?f=3&t=1070>

²¹²<http://www.righthandpath.org/the-church-and-the-common-mind/>

²¹³http://www.amazon.com/MODERN-AND-AMERICAN-DIGNITY-Contemporary/dp/1935191896/ref=pd_sim_b_1

²¹⁴<http://www.nytimes.com/books/first/p/porter-modern.html>

Yet what is self-evident about “property rights”? If one takes it mystically as a “given”, certainly, but that is not the position of the modern mind, which is the only possible position to effect a stand. Rather than respect the ancient homestead, modern states generally bulldoze them²¹⁵. Property is not the “family farm” but “my stuff”. The invisible hand of the market supposedly irons out any disparities or lack of balance, and Nature’s bountiful table has room for all? But Locke wrote when the New World’s resources were being discovered and settled, just as Rousseau wrote from the vineyards and shade trees of France. Property rights today no longer have the “home as castle” basis they once did. A friend of mine recently argued that we just have to take the mystery of property as a “given”; this same friend rejects monarchy, whose basis was precisely this “given” and mystical “thingness” of the King owning his property, the kingdom.

Another friend thinks “infinity” is self-evident²¹⁶, a given, that the horizontal and evolutionary world of the serpent will last, and last forever. This (however) is precisely what one could fear – that the illusion of being God-less can perpetuate itself indefinitely in the long, slow decline²¹⁷. Others place their faith in “singularity²¹⁸” that Science will soon give us. If a new planet, replete with earth-like resources, were to wander into our solar system, these same people would still deny the Destinies and Fates and the God who had brought it. It would be an excuse to continue on the present course.

All of these modern nostrums can be traced to handfuls of thinkers, which have been individually and collectively refuted, over and over again, to very little avail. Karl Marx, Max Weber, John Locke, etc. *Yet the Mod-*

²¹⁵http://www.landrights.org/ocs/SocioCultural/BufaloRiverInholdrs_2.htm

²¹⁶<http://www.amazon.com/Beginning-Infinity-Explanations-Transfo-rm-World/dp/0670022756/>

²¹⁷<http://thearchdruidreport.blogspot.com/>

²¹⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Technological_singularity

ern Mind remains because it is a mindset and a compulsion, a generator of self-sustaining eggregorae, the spider of the fable told by Swift²¹⁹, rather than the bee.

If Chaos and Law are co-equal, this means that Chaos is pre-eminent. But the other point of view, prevails, for now. We are not arguing against an argument, but an “anti-argument” which refuses both reason and revelation. It can’t even discover the riches of its own pagan heritage, because it’s willing to borrow the worst elements of exoteric Christianity in order to destroy any supernaturalism which might unsettle its pathological existence. And over and over, in the face of the most terrible catastrophes, like General Haig ordering another push over the fields of Flanders, it proclaims it has made “progress” when all it has done is to waste even more time and resources achieving pitifully small objectives. This is the meaning of Progress, the anti-Middle Ages, the negative photograph of what should be made to exist.

Posted on 2012-03-24 by Logres

* * *

Caleb Cooper on 2012-03-24 at 13:35 said:

As regards the horizontal world of the serpent (huge thanks to Gornahoor and especially Cologero for making me aware of Tomberg, studying the eighth arcanum right now) lasting forever:

It’s my understanding that while universes die, the physical cosmos is an increasing infinity forever, but in a beautiful way to the glory of God.

Imagine an individual universe as a vertical cone, infinitely wide at the top where it’s time begins, and narrowing as time passes until it converges on a singularity at its end time. The singularity is God, manifesting His full glory _within_ the physical universe. “And I beheld his face from whom the heaven and earths fled...”

One of the most arresting images from Revelation is God’s full glory manifesting, which is so intense that it dissolves the universe. From the perspective of physics this is correct. Observation causes the wavestate to collapse. And within the wavestate, time does not exist,

²¹⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Battle_of_the_Books

that is, a wavestate contains all it's past (and future, which is irrelevant in this case of the end time). So what would be the consequence of of God turning His gaze fully a universe?

Total wavestate collapse, which would cause all moments of time to simultaneously exist. And on the physical plane, all those instances would have mass, multiplying the mass of the universe by the number of plank units it existed for. There are about 1.85×10 to the 43rd power plank units in a second, so the number is ridiculous. More than enough mass to instantly destroy a universe in the final epikrosis, every unit of space potentially collapsing into a black hole large enough to form a universal seed, turning inside out and exploding in a big bang in a new dimensionally separate universe on the black holes other side.

(I suspect this may finally be the mercy that allows some of the 'wandering stars' to die and return to the wheel that turns toward the true God. This is just speculation, but I suspect some of those immortal diamond body's are still anchored in the mid-world; being able to travel to the Celestial realms is not necessarily the same as fully transferring the seat of your consciousness there).

The upshot is that for every second the universe exists, 1,855,094,832,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000 universes will be born. The suffering of the cosmos is ever increasing, the glory of God is every increasing, unto eternal infinity.

As it was in the beginning

Is now and ever shall be

World without end.

Amen. Amen.

Logres on 2012-03-24 at 16:02 said:

Thanks for the well thought comment, which is very beautiful, also. There is (of course) truth to "infinity" (and Tomberg insists on this) but it is only possible to appreciate and fully benefit from it within a vertical perspective (which you just gave). Most of those I know who make these kinds of arguments are making them precisely so they won't have to address God, the Self, the soul, the cosmos, etc. They are rejecting cosmology by hiding within infinity's sands.

Andrew on 2012-03-25 at 00:49 said:

@ Caleb Cooper

A good image of Samsara, and while it may be the case, verily not something to celebrate from my own Buddhist perspective.

1.31 Reversing the Modern Spell

Cologero writes:

There is nothing here to oppose effective rites and rituals, or even the acts of a traditional science. After all, the physical world itself is a symbol, a reflection, of the metaphysical. But that is a topic in itself.

From the writings of the UR Group:

Yet it would be useless to seek a parallel between the organs and functions of the physical body on the one hand and the inner essence of man on the other hand, since the former are determined by conditions proper to the animal life and by their relationship with the external world. Thus, they represent a deviation, albeit one necessary to certain purposes of existence. Therefore, we cannot directly conclude from the function of an organ, as known to ordinary consciousness, its value as a symbol and expression of the Inner Man.

LEO, *First Steps Toward the Experience of the Subtle Body*

Much could be commented here, in regards to both of these glosses. We will content ourselves with noting that there is a certain implicit theory of *Auctoritas* inherent in both of these views, which are the same truth expressed from two different facets of that truth. But since most people are “stuck” in ordinary consciousness as an existential fact, they would see them as contradictory, and therefore in order to transcend or overcome this, they would have to rely on someone else to point their way towards the truly real. They would have to “believe” and then do more than just believe, that both of these statements were true, not because Truth is contradictory, but because they are both obviously woven from the same thread.

Thus, the necessity of Dante, and other “interpreters” who can “read the runes”. Much of what the modern world enacts politically or otherwise is an effective reversal of the proper order of Space and Time²²⁰. Man was built to re-unify Time, and to divide Space, thus granting himself immortality under God, with “many mansions” to inhabit. Modern man concentrates on inverting this pattern – chopping Time up into meaningless segments of factoids, and throwing everything into a muligan stew to simmer until the entire planet boils over. In fact, modern man thinks there is no pattern there at all²²¹ – the illusion is reality. Thus, he can do as he pleases, or so imagines.

What we can say about Symbol and Materiality is this – the link between the two, like the silver cord or golden thread which links the various bodies which are possible of realization in man, is where one can find the “answers”. It is the place where heaven and earth “kiss” (as symbolized in Dante) that holds the interest of one who yearns to follow Romanity, Tradition, & Reality.

If finding that link is difficult and confusing, this is all the more reason for Gornahoor to emphasize the practical, experiential, existential necessity to do so, provided one builds with sound *theoria*, rather than experimenting in the modern *ad hoc* fashion, aiming at nothing more than “something new”.

While it is certainly true that it is difficult to pinpoint true North (witness the many criticisms of Gornahoor made from various angles), this does not mean that it is impossible. After all, God has sent many prophets, messengers, angels, witnesses (among whom was Dante), all of whom will answer a specific yearning of the true needle of the heart, as it homes Northward. With God, and with the heart made in His image, nothing is impossible.

Posted on 2012-03-31 by Logres

²²⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3166>

²²¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Orders_of_creation

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-01 at 13:18 said:

Where exactly do you see “many criticisms of Gornahoor made from various angles”, at least of any merit? Rather, there is near total silence, and not the Silence that de Giorgio refers to.

Why is true North so hard to find? Hasn’t the compass been invented yet, or do you prefer not to use it? The alternative is to engage in perpetual war with neither end nor resolution, like the Highlanders. We know the prize, but who has the courage to claim it?

Logres on 2012-04-01 at 20:48 said:

It’s difficult for some, apparently, particularly when it comes to letting go of the material and seeing what is behind it; the only merit I claim is that I recognize this, and repent – I think again. Something being difficult of application doesn’t make it unattainable, if the person struggling with it is able to reorient themselves. Or does it?

Logres on 2012-04-01 at 21:04 said:

I’ve not read any of any merit, as of yet.

Yakubu Abdul-Aziz on 2012-04-23 at 11:27 said:

I have the magical spell book by Anna Riva, i dont understand most of the things in it but i want to use it.

logres on 2012-04-23 at 23:03 said:

If you are “magically” inclined, you should consider Evola’s work on the subject: <http://www.amazon.com/Introduction-Magic-Rituals-Practical-Techniques/dp/0892816244>

Theologically, Palamidessi & Evola are safe guides to such territory. I have no idea what Anna Riva’s ideas or praxis would look like. Does it attempt to transcend the spirit world, or merely to dominate it?

1.32 When the King Enjoys His Own Again

When Cromwell presided over the Puritanification (and therefore, the ultimate modernization) of England, the common people were not nec-

essarily fooled²²² as to what the end result would be. For them, it was mainly about the lack of charity and feasting, yet the beginning of the song makes clear that they understood something of what was at stake:

Why should we from good Laws be bound?

The meaning here, is, Why should we be proscribed from being under good Rule?

This is a good question to ask, & to meditate upon. Why, indeed, should (in either the inner or outer worlds) men be separated from good governance? Just as one may perceive that the overthrow of monarchies across the West did not result in the promised reign of sweetness & light, so can anyone who wishes perceive that man is “fallen” and that this lack of assimilation to God does not produce freedom or liberty, but rather, disorder and misery. Why should I not be resurrected and regain control of my own body? Is this not a disorder? It is indeed. The King should be restored, and the royal path leads to the throne.

The Regal Path was the subject of correspondence²²³ between Julius Evola and Tommaso Palamidessi (who has been cited²²⁴ here before). To read one of Palamidessi’s pamphlets (published²²⁵ by the Archaeosophical Society) is to be drawn into a current which unites esoteric Christianity, yoga, occult lore, & ancient pagan mysteries. Just as he eschews a fundamentalistic Christianity (which stops at “belief”, a “belief” in *Sola Scriptura*, the formal exoteric Church alone, personal conscience or conviction, etc.), so does he eschew “mere Paganism”, which amounts to saying “who needs God to have God?”.

Christian esotericism is in its essence, the bringing to light of the

²²²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_World_Turned_Upside_Down

²²³http://www.fondazionejuliusevola.it/Documenti/Evola_Palamidessi.pdf

²²⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3115>

²²⁵<http://www.lulu.com/shop/tommaso-palamidessi/the-occult-constitution-of-the-man-and-the-woman/paperback/product-18794493.html>

Archaic tradition, and has always existed since Christ to today, even though the Church of Rome and the Protestants have never consented to its recognition.

Palamidessi believes that the distinguishing feature of a Christian archeosophy is the “gradual” initiation. The spiritual imprint of “masters” is used to a minimal extent (as a midwife), and (rather) the effort of the disciple is what becomes prominent. He mentions that both baptism and confirmation are rituals in which the “subtle body” (still impressionable) is imprinted with the power of the initiator. However,

in the present condition of the official religions, also those endowed with Sacraments, they are incapable of guaranteeing (but maybe not of effecting?) the salvation of souls and their spiritual happiness; nor can anything concrete or decisive be achieved by the various societies of esoteric culture...

Instead, what is needed is the experiential knowledge of the Divine, gained through discrete, concrete practices which are well-tested and known, and also through the initiation from above which can operate at the behest of angelic forces and ultimately God, but which can be assisted horizontally by a legitimate and charismated “master”. Tomberg addresses these possibilities (along with rituals, examples, historical cases, etc.) at length in his *Meditations*. Gornahoor has made it very explicit here²²⁶.

Archaeosophy was his effort to (to some extent, perhaps as much as is possible or has been done) codify a vast realm of occult practice & lore under the cross of Christ – hence the Lotus-Cross Order. He saw himself as (essentially) doing what the Church could (and should) do.

Palamidessi makes clear that the ancient Church knew of such in the following remarks on Clement, Origen, and others (familiar territory for Gornahoor readers, but worth noting again):

²²⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4005#more-4005>

... in the beginning (of Christianity, he means) Jesus Christ had given his disciples the keys of the archaic tradition, that is of Archaeosophia, and therefore of the truly total Ascesis that is the Ascesis biophysical, mystical in the superior sense, and initiatic... and what else could have been meant by men like Saint Basil, Father of the Greek Church, who lived in close contact with the initiated monks of the Orient, in the year 374 AD in Caesarea of Cappadocia, today Kaisarije in Anatolia, by saying: “we receive the dogmas that have been transmitted to us by right and those that have come to us from the Apostles under the veil and under the mystery of an oral tradition. How could be diffused publicly that which non-initiates are forbidden to contemplate? ... that is exactly why many things were transmitted in an unwritten form...” (*Treatise on the Holy Spirit*, XVIII). And Clement in *Stromata* I, chapter XII, specifies: “Since the holy tradition could not be something common and public, at least if one realizes the greatness of its teachings, it is necessary to hide ‘this wisdom expressed in mystery’, that the Son of God has taught us.” After having recalled that among the Jews there existed oral teachings, after having reviewed Greek philosophy: “Gnosis is a deposit which has been transmitted and has arrived to very few people: it is the ‘Wisdom’ and was communicated orally to some Apostles who had received it from the mouth itself of the Son of God” (*Stromata* VI, 7). In the year 203 AD, Clement was succeeded by his disciple Origen to continue the work of the master. In his polemical work *Contra Celsum*, Origen confirms the existence of a secret doctrine within the Christian Church, divided into an exoteric or external section, and an esoteric or internal section. “It is necessary to conceal the royal secret...” (V, 19).

Excerpt from *Pamphlet #1, The Archaic Tradition and Foundations of Archaeosophical Initiation*

The bishops and monks of the early Church were intimately familiar

with the possibility and reality of what Palamidessi claims to teach, & he goes as far as to note that the modern Church has largely lost the knowledge of her own teachings (which places us firmly in the Kali Yuga, just as Christianity emerged at the end of a miniature Kali Yuga within a smaller epicycle, around 30AD). Daniel's dream of the statue had come true.

Since Tradition *is what persists*, the fact that the Church is either unaware, or else ignorant, does not obliterate the Pattern from Above – Tradition will persist, and God needs neither a Church nor a “people” if they think they can forget Him, because “out of these rocks He can raise up children of Abraham”. The “Spirit blows where it lists”. Modern Christianity cannot avoid this collision with its own Scriptures, in the “unmarked verses” of its own Bible.

“He who comes to God²²⁷ must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him”. Contained in this verse is a prescription (or at least a permission) for esoteric practice, for it demands a knowledge of personal Divinity, a metaphysic of Being (what “is”), and a theory of praxis involving devotion (*bhakti-yoga*). Saint Paul himself refers to this when he tells his little Church that he yearned for them until “Christ is formed in you²²⁸”. There is also baptism for the dead²²⁹.

The formation of the Christ-body in the personality of the individual wishing to be “saved” involves the tripartite nature of man, the chakras (including the heart-chakra, where the Christian initiation is situated), & the various “bodies” attached to one another in their “fallen” and un-assimilated configuration. Mouravieff discusses all of this, using diagrams and a science of numbers, in *Gnosis*, as well.

It would be interesting to study further the correspondence of Evola with Palamidessi, but after going over several of his pamphlets in detail,

²²⁷<http://bible.cc/hebrews/11-6.htm>

²²⁸<http://bible.cc/galatians/4-19.htm>

²²⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Baptism_for_the_dead

it is clear that what this “other Italian” teaches is uniquely “Christian” in a way that Franz Bardon’s system of magic (for example) is not quite; it is more “fully” Christian in a way that Steiner’s evolutionary theories lack the metaphysical heft for; and it is more “truly” Christian than the doctrines of Max Heindel, who was connected with Steiner, and whose work had more to do with “revelations” than with initiations. Palamidessi also emphasized the harmony of magic, theurgy, and meditation, as well as the place of art and breathing exercises, in a very simplified (and possibly, safer) form.

All of these things lead me to conclude that he is a good place to begin esoteric practice with, especially for someone who is a Christian.

Tomasso lists many kinds of Ascesis. There are:

1. Physiological and Psychosomatic Ascesis (see Eliade’s book²³⁰)
2. Social Ascesis (see the Right Hand Path²³¹)
3. Mystical Ascesis (Alchemy and the Saints)
4. Theurgical Ascesis (Magic²³² – eg., Peladan, Eliphas Levi)
5. Magical Ascesis (here, we may place the pagan magicians)
6. Cosmic Ascesis (true astrology)
7. Sapiential and Initiatic Ascesis (the Royal Path)

²³⁰<http://www.amazon.com/Yoga-Immortality-Freedom-Bollingen-Series/dp/0691017646>

²³¹<http://www.righthandpath.org/>

²³²<http://www.scribd.com/doc/24362696/How-to-Attract-your-Desires-Eliphas-Levi-1854>

Palamidessi also delves into “the three powers of the heart²³³”, how each of the three centers of man can be saved, particularly the last and most dangerous one, the eros-dynamic soul, which contains the “gravity” in fallen man that will drag him away from God.

Posted on 2012-04-14 by Logres

I.33 The Wisdom of God

Our interpreter, T. Palamidessi²³⁴ echoes George Heart’s interpretation²³⁵ of Mouravieff:

The times require the cooperation of all, and we offer a way which is safe, swift, direct, towards the overcoming of one’s own moral, psychic, spiritual and biological states... Certainly the Catholic Church if it wanted to, without contradicting itself, could in modern times begin the second part of the mission, that of presenting the other face of Christianity, its esotericism, or, if you want, “Christicism according to an archeosophical vision”. If once the great Clement of Alexandria stated “I keep certain things under silence, by a willful choice, for fear of writing things which I have even avoided saying... I would not give a sword to a child... (*Stromata I, 1,14,3*), well, today the Church could break, albeit cautiously, this useless and harmful silence... today it seems that the moment has come for us to



²³³<http://argivephoenix.blogspot.com/2011/05/three-powers-of-heart.html>

²³⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tommaso_Palamidessi

²³⁵<http://www.amazon.com/Christianity-Dogmatic-Gnostic-Vivifying-Knowledge/dp/1412062284>

speak, at least to a certain extent... *Man on an earthly level has a thirst for truth, knowledge, freedom, total love and the spirit of self-preservation.* The same human being when he has the proof of his own survival, with all the implied consequences, then he will want to defend at all costs this survival in the best possible conditions, not as a wandering and confused spirit, now in a fleshly body in this world and now in the immense cosmic ocean of the Hereafter, but as a personal, deified I, which at the end of its days can depart safe and tranquil, not as an astronaut, but as a Theonaut, to land in the kingdom of Heaven where God has been waiting for Him always...

He cites Ecclesiastes 12:6 as proof that man has a “subtle body” (also cited by George Heart):

Remember Him before the silver cord is broken and the golden bowl is crushed, the pitcher by the well is shattered and the wheel at the cistern is crushed...

Hell is a real possibility for most humans.

He who dies impure and not used to the scenery of the states after death, enters a world where he will be forced to experience the fears, the sufferings and the desolation of limbo, of purgatory and of hell. In this new world and in its state of consciousness, even though the permanence is not eternal but transitory it is still full of risks, of dismay, and may give the impression of eternity. The risks consist of bewilderment, anguish, confusion and the inability to find the way leading to the Light of God. And then he will flee towards a new reincarnation as a way of escape, after a crisis between the states of sleep, dream, the frightening and accusing visions. Nor is there hope of being saved by the absolution and sacramental assistance of a priest, for those who have recourse to him, driven by fear of a divine punishment. Even though this

help is a form of Initiation at the point of death, the dying person must have a preliminary religious preparation, both ordinary and extraordinary, exoteric and esoteric, and the education for the trials of the hereafter, already here in this life, while in full consciousness and vigor. The Redemption of Christ exists, but on condition to die Initiates.

The intelligence, writes Evagrius²³⁶, lives in the heart, the thought in the brain.

Sin, also, is real, and not merely the construct of our mind. It has a metaphysical root.

In conclusion, the forbidden fruit was not a sexual sin but an apostasy of Adam from God and the progressive yielding to the action of Karma, set into operation by him, which led him to walk and take the descending spiral of involution, then of evolution in the materialization.

Some struggle against this – heroes, martyrs, mystics, saints and paramystics (adepts). Here is how “monks” do it:

The athletes of asceticism and of exertion openly and directly measure their strength against devils, wiping them out so as to direct themselves toward the Adamitical homeland, Paradise.

All of this lies hidden, not merely in Christian tradition, but the Scripture itself.

To who wins will be given to eat of the tree of life... who wins will not be harmed by the second death... to who wins will be given the manna... to who wins will be given the power over the

²³⁶<http://www.britannica.com/EBchecked/topic/236341/Gnostic-Centuries>

nations... who wins will be dressed in white robes... who wins will be made a pillar... to who wins will be give to sit on my throne... who wins will inherit these things...

Apocalypse of John

It is important to note that Palamidessi distances himself from magic in a way that Franz Bardon does not, explicitly.

We have nothing to do with magic as commonly understood, which has already been damned by God, the Church, & the honest... but always remember, the magician compared to God is humility incarnate, absolute trust, unquenchable Love, is a penitent Magdalene who washes the feet of the saviour, is Parsifal, in ecstasy, before the holy cup of the Graal.

In this, he follows Tomberg. However, this does not mean that the Christian mage or adept or paramystic has no “means” to work with, or is restricted to merely mental prayer:

The icon can be considered a castle of meditation, a magic circle, a powerful means on which to fix the physical eyes and the eyes of the mind to isolate oneself from the profane world and enter into the sacred world. The images become supports for meditation. The holy image, whose use will be explained practically, fixed upon during meditation exercises, directs the will for the salvation of the devoted, and provokes a metaphysical experience. Iconognosis is a starting point for concentration, meditation and ecstasy. The image is dynamized, is animated, is filled with fluid like a pentacle, and performs deep, healthy transformations on the conscience. Archeosophical iconognosis is the most advanced form of ascesis through symbols. The icon concentrates, protects against distractions and temptations, and homologates the consciousness and the biological energies of the body to an archetypal icon formed by the Initiate and registered in the akashic plane.

Palamidessi argues that Christianity is intertwined with a “more perfect Initiation”, one which is in essence the same as the pagan mysteries, but made more perfect (a principle enshrined in the New Testament, which perfects the Old). It is three-fold (to all three centers of man, properly identified even Scripture as Mind, Heart, Soul & Strength, and is made easier by exoteric preparation through Christianity. It is “undeniable that this initiation is typical of the Christians,” who participate in a “charismatic economy (administration of the gifts of grace) of the present, which throws open the doors to the Kingdom.”

Another source to confirm the claims of Palamidessi in regards to Christianity, both positively & negatively, is Jean Borella²³⁷. His diagram here can be compared to Soloviev’s Law of Development²³⁸. Borella discusses how Gnostic became a dirty word within the Christian community, but how it properly belongs nowhere else.²³⁹

To be continued...

Posted on 2012-04-20 by Logres

²³⁷http://books.google.com/books?id=fBLjJ_DWgFQC&pg=PA68&lpg=PA68&dq=borella+diagram&source=bl&ots=ZGH73h-0Jx&sig=9uEolJjQqe5tyF384QuP0paAV3E&hl=en&sa=X&ei=KyqST5HZD0P02wXn47XpBA&ved=0CCsQ6AEwAQ#v=onepage&q&f=false

²³⁸<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3571>

²³⁹Palamidessi proposed Out-of-body experiences, clairsentience/clairaudience, and the remembrance of past lives as spiritual experiments which could demonstrate with certainty that there was something beyond the material world. He dedicated his pamphlets that these quotes were taken from to “Alexander, faithful defender & friend of Origen, in memory of his martyrdom at Caesarea in Palestine, when in 250AD the anti-Christian persecution of Diocletian broke out. Rome, Sept. 29, 1968.

1.34 Palamidessi reads Evola

There is an Italian commentary on, and reprinted text of, a letter from Evola to Tomasso Palamidessi here²⁴⁰. Although this is not a translation, this is a rough survey of the contents of the letter, with a transliteration attempted at certain points, to convey or emphasize the meaning.

The commentator notes that the interactions between various schools, personalities in Italian esotericism was *non sempre pacifici* (not always peaceful). Although Palamidessi's career has not been as well studied as Evola's, for obvious metaphysical reasons of "heft", this letter sheds a great deal of light. Palamidessi was born in Pisa in 1915, and moved to Turin at the age of 18, in 1933, having already demonstrated an interest in botany, astronomy, astrology, and medicine. After getting to Turin, he dedicated himself *ad formazione occultista integrale* (to the formation of an integrated occultism). One of his teachers was the director of Museo Egizio, Ernest Scamuzzi. Around 1940, he had contact with Alfred Witte²⁴¹'s Amburgo, as well as with Alexandre Volguine²⁴² (French astrologer), and some other personages connected with Masonry or Martinism – Umberto Gorel Porciatti and Gino Witnesses. With the exception notably of astrology, all of his interests coincide with those of Evola's, and in fact, Palamidessi specifically replies to Evola's *Man as Power* (1926) & *Hermetic Tradition* (1931)²⁴³ in pamphlets like *The Erotic Power of Kundalini-Yoga* (1949). Palamidessi's pamphlets, unlike Evola's metaphysically hefty tomes, have a technical, practical "cut". His debt to Evola is quite clear, when focusing on the content, and in some cases, Evola noticed a very real plagiarism. Palamidessi's doctrine follows closely three cardinal points of Evola:

²⁴⁰http://www.fondazionejuliusevola.it/Documenti/Evola_Palamidessi.pdf

²⁴¹http://astrologer.ru/Witte/biography_eng.html

²⁴²<http://www.solsticepoint.com/astrologersmemorial/volguine.html>

²⁴³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Hermetic_Tradition

1. Hermetism & Alchemy are interpreted in light of tantric yoga
2. There is a hidden initiation thereby available to those who are “not profane”
3. Tantric yoga is this path

Palamidessi eschews a merely Theosophical orientation towards the “subtle bodies” (the lunar path). *Questa, quindi, la linea di pensiero comune* (This, therefore or thus far, is the line of common thought. The analyst points out that Evola and Palamidessi engaged in ripostes over time, and that Evola’s final veredictum was formulated later:

La donna assoluta non solo non possiede quell’Io, ma non saprebbe nemmeno che farsene, essa non sa nemmeno concepirlo e la sua presenza agirebbe in modo estremamente disturbatore presso a ogni genuina estrinsecazione della di lei più profonda natura.

J. EVOLA, *Metafisica del sesso*, Roma: Mediterranee 1958 , 1996, p.
179

The absolute woman not only does not possess the “I”, but she wouldn’t even know what to make of it, she does not know how to conceive it, and its presence would act in an extremely disruptive manner in every genuine objectification of her deepest nature.

Palamidessi seems to have oscillated back and forth between “explicit admiration” for the author of such works he had borrowed heavily from, & ardent criticism on this one point. Here is the untranslated Italian:

Siamo decisamente contro a tutti quei filosofi ed occultisti tanto ideologicamente nemici della donna da relegarla per molti secoli nel numero delle cose e degli esseri inferiori, laddove invece avrebbe potuto essere esaltata quale vivente espressione dell’Eterno femminile.

Mi stupisce come un grande scrittore di esoterismo orientale della statura di Julius Evola ... abbia commesso il grave errore di negare alla donna il privilegio dell'immortalità e di quel principio che fa dell'uomo un essere superiore e imperituro. C'è proprio da chiedersi con quale criterio l'Evola abbia definito in un suo articolo sulla rivista Ignis (gen.-feb. 1925, n° 1-2) ... "la donna come cosa" L'uomo e la donna, di qualsiasi sviluppo morale e mentale essi siano, non sono cose, ma individui, il cui livello evolutivo è tale da manifestare, o no, quel principio che fa dell'individuo un Dio. Ad ogni modo, questa mia constatazione ... non infirma affatto la mia simpatia di studioso nei confronti del dr. Evola che, se ha commesso degli errori di valutazione psicologica nei confronti della donna, ha pure dimostrato una profondità di vedute e di pensiero in altri settori della scienza occulta.

We decisively oppose all those philosophers and occultists who are ideologically enemies of woman and relegate her for many centuries to be among things and inferior beings, when instead, she should be exalted as the living expression of the Eternal Feminine. It amazes me how a great writer of Eastern metaphysics of the stature of Julius Evola had created the serious error of denying to woman the privilege of immortality and of that quality that makes of man a higher and eternal being. It is proper to ask ourselves by what criteria does Evola define woman as a thing.

Man and woman, of whatever moral and intellectual development, are not things, but individuals, whose evolutionary level is such to manifest, or not, that principle that makes man a god. In every way, my thinking does not invalidate at all my scholarly sympathy toward Dr. Evola who, if he committed some errors of the psychological evaluation toward women, has only demonstrated a depth of insight and thought in other areas of occult science.

It is only fair to note that Palamidessi had engaged in an extensive reading of Evola for years, up to and including virtual "plagiarism", as Evola himself at one point noticed (Guenon would later on comment,

on the basis of reading excerpts that he was a “charlatan”, although Evola seems to have wound up on equitable terms with Tomasso, both of whom died about the same time). Evola granted women the *corpi sottili* (subtle body) but not the transcendental I, a position with roots in Weininger.

Here I can’t help wondering if there was simply a blundering error on one or both of Evola or Palamidessi’s part, over the wisdom application of a principle. The fact that great import or danger falls or turns on such a juncture should not amaze us. Here is an apocryphal²⁴⁴ Luther quote

If I profess, with the loudest voice and the clearest exposition, every portion of the truth of God except precisely that little point which the world and the devil are at that moment attacking, I am not confessing Christ, however boldly I may be professing Christianity. Where the battle rages the loyalty of the soldier is proved; and to be steady on all the battle-field besides is mere flight and disgrace to him if he flinches at that one point.

And here we can intuit that although there is incredible danger of the “Eternal Feminine²⁴⁵” being used in the Dark Age of the Kali Yuga to exalt chaos(as the virtuoso Paglia flirts with doing here) , that perhaps at the higher levels of debate, a very tragic misunderstanding can occur between those of deep insight. This may or may not be the case with Palamidessi.

In fact, it is an old Northern custom²⁴⁶ that a woman can act in the place of a fallen or absent male champion. Tolkien knew²⁴⁷ about this, and it puts one in mind of Deborah the judge, Esther the queen, and Judith the champion²⁴⁸. The female is all the more potent for being forced

²⁴⁴<http://creation.com/battle-quote-not-luther>

²⁴⁵<http://www.bu.edu/arion/files/2010/03/Paglia-Great-Mother1.pdf>

²⁴⁶<http://www.mun.ca/mst/heroicage/issues/9/forum2.html>

²⁴⁷<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MSNPeJAgBzo>

²⁴⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Book_of_Judith

to do violence to her sex and transcend it (in this case, taking the male place).

One is also tempted to wonder – if Satan counterfeits “traditional” metaphysics by causing the resurgence of suppressed elements during the Kali Yuga, to the point of them achieving political power, wouldn’t that mean he is counterfeiting something real, even in the feminine element?

It may be that Palamidessi, and Evola, as appeared to occur late in real life, can be reconciled.

More to come next week, with more transliteration from the letter, and with deference & thanks to Cologero for suggestions.

Posted on 2012-04-28 by Logres

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-30 at 23:31 said:

What can you conclude from the notion that a “woman can act in the place of a fallen or absent male champion.” The simply reinforces her secondary nature, doesn’t it? How would we react to a man acting the the place of a fallen female? Wouldn’t we consider that a lessening of his powers rather than an increase?

Why is the “male gaze” worthy of capital punishment? Is it simply because Thryth objects to it as a woman, or because she objects to it as queen?

You could have chosen a real example, rather than literary creations, e.g., St Joan of Arc.

I don’t understand this: “if Satan counterfeits “traditional” metaphysics by causing the resurgence of suppressed elements during the Kali Yuga, to the point of them achieving political power, wouldn’t that mean he is counterfeiting something real, even in the feminine element?”

What elements are suppressed in the Kali Yuga? Doesn’t a counterfeit always counterfeit something real? No one creates a knock off of a fake Rolex.

Cologero on 2012-04-30 at 23:43 said:

Readers interested in the question about the “I” should read Chapter VIII in Weininger’s *Sex and Character*.

As for the link to the postmodern journal on Northern customs: there is no disagreement about a continuum of male and female characteristics. However, the point they miss, is that to define the continuum requires two significant pieces of knowledge. To ignore these, is tantamount to expecting a colour-blind man to define the visible light spectrum.

1. One must know what are the male and female characteristics.
2. One must know the two poles of the spectrum: absolute man and absolute woman.

To try to define these empirically is to beg the question. The only solution is *a priori*.

Aeneas on 2012-05-01 at 23:41 said:

If Evola exaggerates the differences between man and women, it seems that Palamidessi wants to obliterate every distinction. What, then, is the male equivalent of the Divine Feminine, if not the Holy Spirit? Or put another way, the male is Purusha and the female Prakriti. But Purusha is Atman (the "I"), so where does that leave Prakriti? Has Evola betrayed oriental metaphysics, or is he drawing a logical conclusion?

Charlotte on 2012-05-02 at 06:57 said:

Holy Soul, the Shekinah, Bride of Christ

logres on 2012-05-04 at 06:32 said:

Agreed concerning Joan of Arc. Journal chosen due to Tolkien's scene with the woman – rather than being "feminist" or anti-tradition, it is a reaffirmation of male characteristics. What greater insult than to be beaten by, not the king, but his little daughter? However, there is something "more" in Christianity than Evola gives in relation to sex; Evola never discusses to what extent the upsurge of chaos & the female are actually in contingency with the divine plan; our alternatives are not Evolutionary view vs. Evola. I realize most people here know that, so it was a cheap point. I should concentrate on discerning more along the lines of Charlotte's comment, which was where I am headed. To that end,

<http://www.kober.com/marriage.php>

Bo-Yin-Ra

Also, Mouravieff's comments about the knight and his true lady who advance step by step up the stairs of the divine Solfeggio notes in Gnosis obviously is speaking of ascetic practices within and outside marriage designed to realize the Eternal Union of the separated poles. I'll try to excerpt this more directly very soon.

logres on 2012-05-04 at 06:34 said:

Palamidessi has a pamphlet directly concerning occult characteristics of the male & female, so I won't comment anymore on him till after I have obtained & read.

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 20:13 said:

essay here you may or may not find interesting, talking about Guenon's astrology, end of Kali Yuga, shift from polar to solar etc

<http://www.alignment2012.com/polar-to-solar.html>
Cx

1.35 The Nachterschein of Classic Liberalism

Having come across a remark in AKC²⁴⁹'s letters that the really cultured and spiritual European does not have a peer in their Eastern counterparts, I returned to a volume of Wilhelm Humboldt²⁵⁰'s collected letters and essays, excerpted by subject. Although one can tell that the writing was not in English (the German lumbers through the translations, probably because English doesn't have words for some of these ideas), and although he was not per se a traditionalist or even a religious man, it contains a testimony to the power of spiritual perception that was once much more common in Europe – that of the civilized Christian, in this case, looking at the unfolding modern Age. In this excerpt, he mentions the *Bhagavad-Gita*, which (incidentally) he was much interested in. In this selection, he defends the idea that poetry and philosophy jointly can express (at their highest) the same truths that religion has been accustomed to deal with (Matthew Arnold thought the same thing & incidentally, John Ruskin thought that the “pathetic fallacy” was only a fallacy in the hands of lesser masters²⁵¹). My question would be, isn't religion just exactly that, what they describe? Why re-invent what is already there? Isn't religion the relationship of Life between Poetry, myth, and philosophy? What is astonishing in reading his letters is how close he comes to the truth by his own native powers of cultured perception, & yet how far he is from the kind of mental clarity that AKC embodied, or that Traditional

²⁴⁹<http://akc.satishankar.com/2012/09/selected-letters-of-ak-coo-maraswamy.html>

²⁵⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wilhelm_von_Humboldt

²⁵¹<http://www.ourcivilisation.com/smartboard/shop/ruskinj/>

studies aims at. My conclusion is that he was indeed a cultured, *but not a spiritual*, European, & that this flaw has largely to do with the decline of Christianity within its traditional pale²⁵². One cannot help but think that the greatness of these “classical liberals” springs from their *Nachterschein* of Christianity, which still retained enough magic to cast a spell over the Iron Age which they were unwittingly hatching.

Poetry and philosophy grow out of the same soil; they come from the highest and deepest levels of mankind, and the difference between a genuine philosophical poem and one which does not deserve the name lies in the question whether the two sources are represented as truly joint or whether they have been mechanically superimposed upon one another.

It is a prerogative of poetry to claim man’s total undivided nature and to lead him to the point where his finite nature loses itself in intuitions of infinity. Poetry deserves its name only when it achieves this. Therefore nothing is excluded from its proper field – no object, no genre, not the plainest elegaic, not the most lightheartedly joyous nor the more irrepressibly or capriciously comic verse. For feeling itself, partly in its own movements, but especially when it is purified by the aesthetic sense whose activity is always stimulated in man at the first musical note, carries a relationship to infinity. An artform knows no barriers except those placed by its own definition. But the true secret lies in the creative imagination within which all art operates and which it controls. By its magic power in a mode very much like that described in the *Bhagavad-Gita* it so destroys finite nature in its substance and so preserves it in its forms that, living in the midst of sense involvements, it dissolves all sentient emotion into pure, ideal-oriented perception, just as the dogma of renunciation and immersion dissolves the liveliest action into non-action. What

²⁵²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Pale

Krishna says of creatures, namely that they meet by remain unknown to each other, like sudden apparitions (II, 29) is also and characteristically true of any genuine poem. It stands before us, and not footprints tell us whence it came. It requires certification from elsewhere, therefore, and the invocation to a higher power is a need felt as natural by every poet, insofar as he is not – as is the author here under consideration — imbued with the feeling that he is carrying such certification from on high within himself.

If poetry, then, is to combine with philosophic ideas in a worthy manner, the latter must be of the sort that they too could not have come about without an invisible capacity for inner inspiration. The fire and loftiness of poetry must look necessary for calling forth truth from the depths of the spirit; philosophic dogma must not seek a poetic garment like a borrowed ornament but must pour itself out in voluntary, free rhythms, moved by an inner urge; it must move within poetry as though in a natural, indigenous form. But this can only be the case if the philosophic ideas go back to the point where the rationalizing intellect has to give up its effort to develop effects from causes; the point where truth flames forth by the mere purification and orientation of spirit, by the removal of all dialectic semblances, from an intensification of pure self-awareness. In this realm, where the poet feels strong enough to maintain the nature of truth even in the midst of ardent poetic imagination — imbued with the feeling that he is carrying such certification from on high here alone is found the true philosophical poem.

Posted on 2012-10-12 by Logres

* * *

Cassiodorus on 2012-10-13 at 12:04 said:

The nature of the relationship between Christianity and classical liberalism is a subject that has taxed me ever since I had my first mature thoughts. It would seem that from the perspective

of Tradition, the metaphysical order of Christendom and “Enlightenment” rationalism are utterly incompatible- Pope St Pius X referring to modernity as a “many headed hydra”, the heresy of heresies. On the other hand, many proponents of “conservatism” today seem to argue that classical liberalism represents the flowering of Christian principles, being natural partners in which liberty *depends* on the Creator and a transcendent moral order.

The Traditionalist, Titus Burckhardt, commented in his paper “What is Conservatism”, that conservatism was born the moment that Tradition came to an end in the West.

Logres on 2012-10-13 at 22:12 said:

That’s actually a very helpful observation – thank you Cassiodorus. I think the sin of the classical liberals was to fail to see the source and origin of their celebrated liberty – it “looked” to them like this was possible for all people, everywhere, rather than being a happy flourishing for certain climes and seasons. As an ideology, it is antithetical to Tradition – and it pains me to come to that conclusion, because I was bred on such things.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 01:01 said:

“Isn’t religion the relationship of Life between Poetry, myth, and philosophy?”

And this relationship is manifested in prayer. Take the litany of the blessed virgin, for example, or the canticle of creatures. These prayers flow from contemplation, and back towards it.

Logres on 2012-10-14 at 21:03 said:

I suppose so. I recently read advice on prayer to focus on the chest, rather than the heart, and let the heart be attracted to the warmth of the prayer. High liturgical poetry has always drawn me, even when outside its circle. Repetition is now acquiring a peculiar, rare beauty for me.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 21:33 said:

“Why re-invent what is already there?”

I took a poetry class once, there was a poet who came to speak, he said “poetry is the closest thing to prayer.” I thought, well, why not just pray ?

He then recited a poem about getting drunk and losing control of his bowels.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 21:40 said:

Repetition: yes, litanies are beautiful. Time stops during a good litany.

Logres on 2012-10-16 at 06:19 said:

Interesting. Considering the poetry of the Scriptures is first rate in the Wisdom books, I have a hard time understanding this also – or pick some Latin hymns. On a deeper level, poetry and prayer are probably the same thing, with sacred poetry being actual prayer. I'm not sure anyone has really done this well in the West, although I haven't read John of the Cross' poetry...yet.

Cologero on 2012-10-18 at 08:17 said:

Jesus & his Apostles & Disciples were all Artists
A Poet a Painter a Musician an Architect : the Man
Or Woman who is not one of these is not a Christian
William Blake

Logres on 2012-10-19 at 23:10 said:

Humboldt, I think, was arguing this in his excerpt I just put up – I am thinking that he embodies the old ideal of cultured man quite well, with the exception that he had no external help from Traditional doctrine – but he yearns for it. Unfortunately, brilliant though he was, he didn't write great poetry. But he tried it anyway...

1.36 The Path of Blue Flowers

Cologero has drawn attention to the *Path of Flowers* as the way of the ancestors; during my time at the “Spengler Forum”, D. Goldman remarked that Novalis had something of an obsession with the Blue Flower.²⁵³

I came back to this remark after hearing Gornahoor's explication of the Path of Flowers (here is a Yoruba²⁵⁴ inspired effort): might not Novalis have instinctively reached for the Blue Flower to indicate to himself the path he was choosing? He was certainly of a mystical turn. What about doing something more practical, for those who are asking?

For those more interested in concrete ways to do such things (and there have been complaints in the past for “action”), one might for in-

²⁵³<https://en.wikiquote.org/wiki/Novalis>

²⁵⁴<http://www.neworleansvoodoocrossroads.com/ritualtoancestors.htm>

stance try treating human spiritual imbalance with Bach Flower Remedies²⁵⁵. This may be “New Age” territory, but it doesn’t belong to the New Age crowd, anymore than Jesus hanging on the cross belongs primarily to Jesus Freaks or Zionist evangelicals. On a personal note, I can tell you (having made my own) that pine oil and daisy essence both affected my spirituality in a positive manner; go experiment. Strangely enough, I read Cologero’s post on the flower path about the same time I had started noticing & thinking about those crosses on the highway ditches – marking the graves of victims of the automobile²⁵⁶ (this essay is worth reading for those unconvinced that we aren’t fetishistic about our technology). Coincidence? Only if you believe in it.

I would like to connect this with the medieval world through Bede’s story²⁵⁷ of Saint Dryghthelm²⁵⁸, who used to bathe in ice water to bring to mind the memory of his “nightmare”, in which he foresaw spiritual states to come. There is no shame for someone who finds that he or she is called (for now) to follow the ancestral path rather than the path of the gods. If this is suitable for their soul, the rest (including graduation in the gymnasium of the Universe to higher grades) will follow. Origen and Clement of Alexandria taught that the world was a vale of soul-making (as did John Keats), in which the soul was exercised for virtue as in a gymnasium. This exercise was preparation for “higher grades”. Since I can’t personally say I have graduated, I can only follow the teachings of those who are farther along, and who decree that the Law bids us follow the path set before us *now*²⁵⁹. This is the justification for larger-scale religion, if it is done properly and with a God-fearing spirit. Those who carry their rebellion against God over into other traditions by leaving

²⁵⁵http://www.bachflower.com/38_Essences.htm#WildRose

²⁵⁶<https://docs.google.com/document/edit?id=1NqfNKS2t9MiZ3unc70qVaN1wpm5y-GbxV5fTR37mfo4>

²⁵⁷<http://escholarship.org/uc/item/8pz3g97j#page-6>

²⁵⁸<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dryghthelm>

²⁵⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5037>

Christianity in a huff will find what they seek – the Anti-Christ. For those who “branch out” or deepen their own tradition, and strive to relentlessly self-examine themselves first of all, these other traditions will only add to what they already possess.

Seek & you will find. This is the message of esoteric Christianity, coupled with an insistence that the seeker predispose themselves through metaphysical Love, as Tomberg advises in *Meditations*. Julian Lee²⁶⁰ has remarks²⁶¹ along these lines: *if your heart is pure, the world becomes peopled with saints and heroes and old magic become new again*. Fasting, prayer, meditation... not very popular these days. But simple and easy to practice, producing rapid results if done in the proper frame of spiritual mindfulness. It doesn't take much to get “God” to notice. And what one learns “there” one carries back into the world when the fast is over. I don't fast for long periods, but even short ones are helpful. One day, maybe I'll accomplish a very long fast; like most Westerners who inhabit our spiritual desert, I'll probably have to “work up to it”²⁶².

We close with another excerpt from von Humboldt:

You ask me what I mean by ideas when I say that they are the only permanent thing in man and that they alone deserve one's lifetime attention. The question is not easily answered, but I shall try to make myself plain. Ideas are first of all opposed to ephemeral external things and to the sensations, desires, and passions directly referring to them. Everything which aims at selfish intent and momentary pleasure fights ideas by its very nature and can never be transformed into them. But many higher and nobler things as well, such as doing good, providing for one's family, all sorts of other actions, deserving thought they be, are not to be counted as ideas.

²⁶⁰<http://myrealizations.com/>

²⁶¹<http://www.celibacy.info/>

²⁶²<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2012/10/russias-orthodox-church-teaching.html>

They many occupy a person whose life rests on ideas, but only insofar as they are something he does; other than this they do not concern him. They could of course themselves be founded on an idea, and in an idea-oriented and organized person they always are. This idea would be the one of universal good will, accompanied by a feeling that the lack of good will is a disharmony or an obstacle which makes it impossible to join the order of higher, more perfect spirits, the benevolent sense which infuses all nature. Such actions may also spring from a feeling of duty; and duty, if it originates in a pure feeling of “ought” without the least consideration for preference of divine reward, is one of the loftiest of ideas. One must also separate from ideas what is mere knowledge of the intellect and of the memory. This may lead to ideas but does not itself deserve the name. You can begin to see now that “idea” aims at something infinite, at an ultimate relatedness, at something which would still enrich the soul if it were free of all earthbound connections.

All great and essential truths are ideas in this sense. But there are very many things which cannot wholly be grasped or measured by thoughts and which nonetheless are true. This is where the artist’s creative imagination enters the picture. For this faculty has the gift of representing the sensuous and the finite — physical beauty for example, even aside from beauty of countenance and its soulful expression — in such a way that it seems to pertain to the infinite. Art, including poetry, is therefore a means of transforming much into ideas that originally and in itself could not be placed there. Even truth, though it lies primarily in the realm of thought, needs such an addition in order to reach its consummation.

Thus far we have looked at ideas from the point of view of their objective content; we may also describe them in accordance with the psychological mood they call for. Just as, measured by their objective content, they are an ultimate relatedness, so they

demand, in order to be grasped, a wholeness of psychological attunement, i.e., a united effectiveness on the part of all psychic capacities. Thought and feeling must unite intimately and since feeling, even if its object is the soul itself, always carries something of materiality, it is only the artist's creative imagination which is capable of effecting feeling's union with thought as without this intervention, thought objects to the admixture of materiality.

Whoever has no sense for art, or no genuine feeling for music or poetry, will find it very difficult to grasp an idea and feel its intrinsic substance. Such a difference between people is founded in their original psychic constitutions. Education avails nothing here. It may add something, but it cannot create what isn't there, and there are hundreds of artistically and technically knowing and trained people who plainly demonstrate with every word they say that their natural receptivity towards ideas doesn't exist — which is to say, they lack everything that is needed. The great value of ideas is primarily recognized in this way: man leaves behind him everything when he departs this earth, everything, that is, which does not belong wholly, exclusively, and independently to his soul disconnected from all earthly relationships. But that is just what his ideas are, nothing else besides his ideas, and that is their genuine mark.

Whatever doesn't have the right to occupy the soul during those moments when it of necessity renounces all earthly things, cannot be counted as ideas, either. But to reach that moment, enriched by purified ideas, is a beautiful aim and end, worthy of our hearts and souls. In this connection, and for this reason, I called ideas the only permanent things because nothing else can grow when earth itself vanishes... of friendship, this should be quite clear... what I call love is something totally different (from friendship). It appears in life but once; it does not delude, and it is never deluded. It rests totally and utterly upon ideas.

Posted on 2012-10-19 by Logres

* * *

Alexander on 2017-04-30 at 08:42 said:

Interesting about the Novalis' Pitriyana path, or the Path of Flowers. It never came to my mind before, but it all makes sense – his fascination with sickness, death, night and feminine. Deep intuition too. Even his young fiancée (named Sophie, I thought that's also interesting) died too early. My own introduction to the Magical Idealism was at the very young age from reading a short generic entry on Novalis in the old encyclopedia. Short and generic but it sparked a life long fascination. And later along my path I kept encountering Novalis in places I would never expect. Lama Anagarika Govinda quotes Novalis in "Foundations of Tibetan Mysticism" (book I still find worthy). Same book introduced me to Guenon and later through him, Evola, who again also quoted Novalis in "The Metaphysics of Sex." I always wondered just how much influence Novalis had on Evola, although now I can see why would Evola, who follows the Devayana path, "renounce" Novalis later on.

"There is no shame for someone who finds that he or she is called (for now) to follow the ancestral path rather than the path of the gods. If this is suitable for their soul, the rest (including graduation in the gymnasium of the Universe to higher grades) will follow."

I'm not sure if I understand this correctly. Is Pitriyana then not a second, permanent death of individuality?

1.37 The Soul of Jupiter

Phillip Sherrad²⁶³ was apparently critical²⁶⁴ of Guenon, at points. Tomberg emphasizes that there is a "Self Beyond the Self", which Christians call God, as well. However I am not so certain, speaking even as a Christian, that these types of debates are more a matter of method & emphasis, rather than absolute substance. Guenon (it is true) speaks much of Principles rather than Persons, but surely he is meaning something very similar? Why would Christians quibble over a word? Is it because they can

²⁶³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philip_Sherrard

²⁶⁴<https://thechristianmysteries.blogspot.com/2011/04/late-philip-sherrard-and-member-of.html>

see only Either/Or, and if they do not *disputato*, then they perceive they will be forced into a multi-lateral world of comparative religion?

During the reviews and summaries of Clement's Journal²⁶⁵, I tried to show how Saint Peter comes across within the text – he is perfectly willing to debate anyone in good faith he judges to be an honest inquirer, & he even tours the marbles of Phidias²⁶⁶ in Asia Minor with Clement and others, to see what he can learn from Greek art. All of his religious opinions are the result of a process of careful philosophical reasoning which, if they are somewhat Hebraic, are at least Greek in rule and form. Furthermore, odd Christian practices are found to have a factual and spiritual basis in esoteric postulates and experience. The Jewish element provides the abstract postulates and the initial atmosphere of spirituality, yet the new religion is oriented towards Truth in whatever garb, because it is subordinated to the childlike personality of the bishop.

As Cologero is fond of saying, only those who have experienced these things (especially those who have had both) are fit to sit in judgement on these things.

The Early Church certainly was eager to embrace Greek learning. Lactantius²⁶⁷, Clement, Origen, Justin the Martyr, and many others like Chalcidius went so far as to claim Socrates as one of the Church's own, because he loved the truth. "The words are no obstacle," says Lactantius, "because the sentiments agree with the Truth." The old icon painters sometimes placed, in the narthex of their churches, the wise Greeks, because they were a sort of "ante-chamber" to the great mysteries of the Truth (see Bachovo²⁶⁸ Monastery). Their argument was merely that the Greeks (and others) did not know "the whole Logos", and sometimes turned back from a full apprehension of the Truth, because they were

²⁶⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4533>

²⁶⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phidias>

²⁶⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lactantius>

²⁶⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bachkovo_Monastery

not completely free of the infatuations of their own culture – merely consider (for instance) the Greek fad of *demokratia*²⁶⁹, and one can see how this might have objectively been the case.

In Lao Tzu's *Te Ching*²⁷⁰, there is an elaborate argument for the principle of Unity, the Dyad, & the resultant Triad, an argument that finds an echo in the work of Kukai²⁷¹: whether one calls the ultimate subtleties of Spirit which are irreversible and irrepeatable (and as Tomberg argues, therefore, outside the scope or judgement of Science, which confines itself to the realm of *fungible Space* and the division & re-combining of solids), the "Principle" or the "Person" is both lawful and according to nature (like a principle) & also contains what is human (although it is super-human).

This reminds me of an amusing story about Thomas Merton's work with Buddhist monks to establish "common ground" – at one point in the meeting, it was discovered that what the Buddhists called contemplation, the Christians translated as meditation, and vice versa. Both sides were "at odds" from the very start, because they were already talking past each other. Might not a good deal of the confusion between traditionalists of various stripes be of this variety?

Dmitri Orlov in his latest post²⁷² demonstrates how even political discourse (and presumably higher forms like religion or even culture itself) can become a means of obfuscation and misunderstanding. In fact, since things are known by virtue of the one doing the knowing²⁷³, we should expect many misunderstandings in our stunted environment.

This is a longish, roundabout way of arguing that the science of Traditionalism (and God forbid it become a science like the others, but rather a

²⁶⁹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Demokratia>

²⁷⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tao_Te_Ching

²⁷¹<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kukai/>

²⁷²<https://cluborlov.blogspot.com/2012/10/the-limits-of-language.html>

²⁷³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5098>

real *knowing*) is likely just beginning a long re-ascent to implementation.

Just as Pico de Mirandola²⁷⁴ did a great service in dividing Magick into Theurgy and Goetia, thus opening the path for Bruno & others to re-ignite alchemy or for Druidry to revive (without the demonic elements against which Christianity had fought so fervently), scholars and students and practitioners today have a great opportunity to “divide anew”, not in a way that “murders to dissect”, but with the sword of the Spirit that leads to life, reuniting what belongs together.

Posted on 2012-10-26 by Logres

1.38 General Law

After finishing *Gnosis 1,2,3*, the concept of **General Law** stands out as very nearly the most important paradox in the book we can grasp, if we want to grasp daily practical implications. This concept has political implications, as well as personal: No one escapes General Law – it is impossible. In the words of Phillip Dick in the novel V.A.L.I.S.²⁷⁵, “those who fight the Empire, become the Empire (the Black Prison)”. Or if you prefer Saint Paul, “we struggle not against flesh and blood... bodily exercise profiteth little... we are in the world, but not of it...”. General Law is the daemonic/angelic/demonic hierarchy which determines natural history and cosmology, as well as the fate of the person who is “under the Law”. Now, for Saint Paul, the law is “holy and good”, yet it is “*given* for the lawbreaker”. One might say, it is a *given*. But Mouravieff does more, and attempts to explain the inner workings of this law. For instance, how can it be both good & evil? What does Saint Paul intend to teach, here? We are knee-deep in the mysteries of the epistles with this teaching. One principle is worth mentioning as an aside: The General Law allows you

²⁷⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Giovanni_Pico_della_Mirandola

²⁷⁵<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VALIS>

to escape it *only if you train (or create/provide for) your replacement*. All sorts of applications could be made here, for instance, with the duty to raise children, or a master teaching a pupil.

This Law is iron – the more one attempts to confront it with human means in space and time, the more powerful the Law becomes. It grows through defiance. This is the existential defeat and despair of fallen man, and it is, coincidentally, *precisely what the illusory dream of Revolution is truly all about*. Man will confront the cosmic tyrant and break his chains. Man will stand against the gods, on behalf of all of our sorrow, rage, fear, suffering, and hunger. Many would portray Christ as the new champion of this. And man will thereby strengthen Satan.

But what did King David²⁷⁶ see of this?

Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing?

² The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the Lord, and against his anointed, saying,

³ Let us break their bands asunder, and cast away their cords from us.

⁴ He that sitteth in the heavens shall laugh: the Lord shall have them in derision.

⁵ Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath, and vex them in his sore displeasure.

⁶ Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion.

⁷ I will declare the decree: the Lord hath said unto me, Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee.

⁸ Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance, and the uttermost parts of the earth for thy possession.

⁹ Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel.

²⁷⁶<http://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Psalm+2&version=KJV>

¹⁰ Be wise now therefore, O ye kings: be instructed, ye judges of the earth.

¹¹ Serve the Lord with fear, and rejoice with trembling.

¹² Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and ye perish from the way, when his wrath is kindled but a little. Blessed are all they that put their trust in him.

The General Law *is the missing link* between the testaments of Law & Grace. Jesus, also is, because he satisfied that General Law, and thereby provided an opening. But the Law is not dead, but is active and alive still, unless one is under the aegis of some symbol. It is also a warning to Modern Times: the power of the angels will only bind our chains tighter if we presume to liberate man in any other way than the one way given, the narrow way. This way is to transcend the human condition, through vertical energies, & to enter the Kingdom of Heaven. There is no other way which the Guardians of the Threshold²⁷⁷ will permit, personally or collectively. As seductive as the idea of building everyone a duplex with running water and free phone lines is, it is actually a grave sin against every human being & one's own soul to directly confront the Guardians of the General Law with human desire and physical means, *promoting the Revolution on earth*. Revolution will only build more Revolution, because it will only build the Black Prison higher and stronger. I will repeat this – to directly confront the hierarchies in a human and physical (read “political”) manner is to spit in Christ's face (who Himself refused this temptation, though he might have done it for his own sake). Ultimately, all Revolutionists are building their own Hell, and it will be all the more secure for that, since they built it, who imagine that anything in this life on its own level can “save” man, political or otherwise.

In fact, as Luther apocalyptically²⁷⁸ said, it is the gravest sin in the

²⁷⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guardian_of_the_Threshold

²⁷⁸<http://creation.com/battle-quote-not-luther>

world today, because this is the occult point of attack:

If I profess, with the loudest voice and the clearest exposition, every portion of the truth of God except precisely that little point which the world and the devil are at that moment attacking, I am not confessing Christ, however boldly I may be professing Christianity. Where the battle rages the loyalty of the soldier is proved; and to be steady on all the battle-field besides is mere flight and disgrace to him if he flinches at that one point.

The Moderns are traitors even to their founding saint, as the above amply illustrates; sadly for them, Luther may be saved anyway, but they will not, because God will laugh them to scorn and mock them, and Christ Himself will break them in pieces. Christ permits the General Law, because He himself satisfied it, and has directed in what manner it may be overcome. It is *hubris*²⁷⁹ to imagine another way.

There is a warning for traditionalists also – the Gods of these times permit the modern excess in an open manner, and thus to directly confront this in an overly physical manner is to become guilty of the same modern *hubris* the Moderns practice (think the Confederate States of America, here). Rather, warn those who need warning, & save yourselves, first, and allow Revelation and history to unfold until “it is time”. Do not confront Satan directly (for even the archangel Michael did not²⁸⁰), for the power of evil has not yet been exalted. This is the Kali Yuga. This is why the founders of Gornahoor have spent so much time on “theory” and personal practice, rather than “direct action”, although one can certainly prepare the groundwork and framework against the chaos that is sure to inevitably transpire.

²⁷⁹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hubris>

²⁸⁰[http://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Jude+1%3A9&version=](http://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Jude+1%3A9&version=KJV)

Instead, we should spend our excess power and time in seeking to legitimately (read, traditionally) escape General Law in the approved manner, through the narrow gate. The jealous and all powerful (within their spheres) hierarchies seem to give man much “leeway” but it is actually a total illusion, designed to keep him in chains to further the Common Good and destiny of the species, rather than liberate his soul prematurely. Man is so fragmented and insane, spiritually, that God permits him to be ruled with illusion and lies in order that this generation will perish in “feeding the moon” (see Gurdjieff’s teachings), but that the Divine Plan will go on. Man will think himself free under the Revolution – the Revolution is a deepening of the Lie to its most powerful point to counterbalance the excess of disintegrative energies that is loose in our time.

And he will die and perish, and his states and societies will perish with him, because Man is more important than he dreams, or than even the Revolution promises. Man will endure anyway.

Even the Demons delight in the Great Game, but they secretly yearn for heroes who are equal to tilt the course against them, teaches Mouravieff. Is this what you, too, desire? Then bow down in the temple of Rimmon, & repent of speaking ill of high authority, with all of its attendant woes and evils, and seek the narrow gate. Reject Revolution, embrace Authority; submit, and bow down in the temple of Rimmon²⁸¹ if you have to, but pray without ceasing to the Illuminator of the Heart, that you might defeat the adversary, and be set free eternally. This is the meaning of the saying, *if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed*.

But for those who resist, the Absolute III and the energies of the occult servants of the Holy Spirit will devour them.

This, and much more, is taught in Mouravieff’s *Gnosis*.

Posted on 2012-07-13 by Logres

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²⁸¹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Naaman>

apeiron on 2012-07-14 at 17:20 said:

Nice, but that link you provided to Luther's famous battle quote argues against the legitimacy of it. The quote was attributed to him in a fictional 19th Century novel by Elizabeth Rundle Charles however poetic it may sound. Luther would have done well to follow his own advice had he not come so late to the Jewish question, but by then the Revolutionary Reformation had blown full swing and Europe was dangerously partitioned with disastrous future consequences to follow.

Particularities aside, and to simply take what the essence of the message you are trying to convey on an objective level this is what we conclude: Don't fight the Satanic forces of the Kali-Yuga head on, (as to do so would bring the wrath of the Zeitgeist/Universal/General Law which at this point in time favors the Adversary) but instead form an elite of the few who remain awake in the night to save your own asses from the last judgement and to hell with the rest of the goyim. I'm still trying to figure where the heroic part comes in. Did Christ not incur this wrath under crucifixion(perhaps as initiation)? Did not the Iron Guard and so on?

The old' days still had men worthy of a higher caliber to oppose it, because despite all, the essence of that opposition carried a spiritual significant meaning that rings true to us.

logres on 2012-07-14 at 22:17 said:

For the sake of clarity, your construal is not what I intend to mean. Saving yourself has nothing to do with it. Since I've just lost two lengthier replies, I'll content myself with noting that Mouravieff's concept of Authority in consonant with Tradition, & that the issue here is: What are you capable of forcing the General Law to concede? I am not discouraging anyone who is capable from acting; what I wish to avoid is encouraging those who think that there is no warning here for us, as well as the Revolution.

logres on 2012-07-14 at 22:22 said:

You fight spiritually just as you would physically – using an Art of War, rather than acting without a precise knowledge of times and seasons, inner or outer. I am not trying to discourage that, but rather note that there is a warning here to us all. It was a point I did not want to make, but thought that knowledge and logic from the doctrine of General Law required be made. That's certainly not the last word on the subject, and would require another essay.

1.39 Liturgy and the Logos

A popular refrain I hear from fellow Protestants is that “meaningless rituals”, gestures, “smells and bells”, or vain repetitions (a Scriptural phrase) won’t help find favor with God. While I am certain that ritual can (and does) degenerate into “those of darkness” who are fascinated with the dead (Rene Guenon) and their debased conclaves or practices, the pre-existent Logos of the universe that created the world through its pattern entails that relationships between and among “things” exist, even at the lowest level. Anyway, if vain repetitions include all things which repeat themselves, then why do we always prefer beautiful pictures or soothing colors for certain environments, as opposed to the opposite? As Millinerd²⁸² pointed out, what happens when you “lose the Faith” in a church that used to be a drive-through? Will you be reminded by the stained glass on the wall? The spires? The ringing old church bell? Or the grease stains under the carpet? “Cultural Christianity” is the nave or ante-chamber of the Church – the paintings on the walls of these early Churches were the Greek Philosophers like Heraclitus. It is Justin the Martyr, not Hippolytus, who should guide our thinking here.



The absolute consensus among anyone interested in Tradition is that some patterns are more significant (or more elevated) than others. Some Ideas are more fruitful than others. Some people are better than others, at least in the sense (and no one can disagree with this) that they are truer to their real Self. But what happens when you forget there is a higher Self that is more real? You turn to Revolution. And you hate your patrimony. The worldview of those who reject liturgy *per se* actually leads to real “vain repetitions”: One damn thing after the other.

²⁸²<http://www.millinerd.com/2006/07/cultural-christianity.html>

The Logos²⁸³ exists, both “in here” and “out there”. It was pursued in olden days all over the face of the earth. Here is Strabo²⁸⁴ (St. Clement mentions the Hyloboi also):

As for the Garmanes, he Megasthenes, *Indica* fragment 41 Schwanbeck says that the most honourable of them are named Hylobii and that they live in forests, subsisting on leaves and wild fruits, clothed with the bark of trees, and abstaining from wine and the delights of love; and that they communicate with the kings, who through messengers inquire about the causes of things and through the Hylobii worship and supplicate the Divinity.

Here is an example of how various rites and rituals from *within* a single Tradition coalesce. If one takes the Four Corners of the Earth from the Taoist exercises²⁸⁵ (Dragon for the east, Tiger for the south, Eagle for the West, and Bear for the North), and matches them to the eight directional exercises, we see that the archery exercise matches the Bear’s stolid pose, the light-scanning exercise goes with the eastern Dragon, the waist spin goes with the southern Tiger, and the adoring wave goes towards the western Eagle.

We can cross-match this against Druidry²⁸⁶, and assign the place of yellow or light with the East and the dragon, the place of fire-orange-pink-gold with the Spirit in the south, the place of the limpid and pure water elements that are blue in the West, and the green quarter with the North, from which came life out of the ice.

Further matching this with the Christian tradition, we associate the East with the Father or primal Ur-Spring/archetype, the South with the

²⁸³<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Logos>

²⁸⁴https://laudatortemporisacti.blogspot.com/2012_11_01_archive.html

²⁸⁵<http://www.thegreattao.com/html/taoofrevitalization.html>

²⁸⁶http://aoda.org/Articles/The_Sphere_of_Protection.html

descending fire of the Holy Spirit's charisma, the West with water and the elements used in service of the Son/Logos, and the North with the symbol of the green Earth, or the "Amen", the union of the three higher elements. Is this purely arbitrary? We think not. Even if it was thrown in dispute, it would only be to find a more faithful representation, much as one artist is "greater" than another.

The watches of the day, as well as the organs of the body, could also be related within this scheme. Indeed, when people reject "old Custom", do they even know anything about what is being thrown out? Who knows, in the Christian West, or even better practices, the Emberdays²⁸⁷? While better arrangements than this one occurring to me certainly should exist (I hope someone out there has studied this far more deeply), this configuration suggested itself naturally to my mind *while I practiced the exercises, without any mental work*. In other words, they arrange themselves this way – symbols teach us themselves, while we do the "work", because they exist already, independently, and at a higher plain. This pre-existence implies that liturgy, far from being vain repetition, made up or arbitrary, is *either given for use, existent as help, or revealed*²⁸⁸, with even a little attention or effort. I agree with Cologero that "mulligan stew" has no charm, so this exercise is not intended to convince everyone (as Simone Weil rightly warned against) that all religions/Traditions are just various and equal routes to the same path. We already can see vividly where that Idea leads. It is as fruitless as the idea that anyone outside your constellation of thoughts²⁸⁹ is doomed to Hell inevitably. A Tradition is not arbitrary when you are "called" to it; hence, Christianity has some impact on virtually everyone in the modern West, even if they prefer this not to be the case.

The purer and nobler the supplicant, the better the liturgy. This is

²⁸⁷<http://www.fisheaters.com/emberdays.html>

²⁸⁸<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-cosmic-hierarchy>

²⁸⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2377>

what gave the Church its liturgy for thousands of years, and is not “pagan” – it is there, because the Logos is there. The strategy of the Catholic Church (and also the Orthodox, to some degree) was to baptize the natural cultures and human climates they came across, purify it, exalt it, and let Nature be subsumed (and preserved) within Super-Nature. They did not posit an endlessly devouring circle of hermeneutic suspicion, where “Idolatry” became the greatest sin. Actually, *the greatest sin is to worship nothing at all*, because that would imply that one’s natural state was the highest possible sphere of actualized Existence, and this would imply that the fallen self (or at least the non-perfected self) was the goal of all Creation. Isn’t this exactly what “salvation by faith” among the modern Protestants has come to mean?

I have sketched a very simple symbolic pattern which demonstrates that Taoism, Druidry, and Christianity have a deep resonance at the level of abstract symbolic in the physical world and its connection to the Logos or Pattern. Christianity itself cannot really extricate itself from its decline without re-emphasizing the teachings surrounding the Logos – only this will give a legitimate “common basis” for discussion, practice, and commonality, while also rightly showing Christians how to transcend even that in the fullness of the teachings of the Logos mystery (the preparations, Incarnation, and Second Coming, then Recapitulation).

Vain repetitions? Nothing is more vain than individuals who expect to ignore the Logos, over and over again, and still find cheap grace with a God that they imagine in a vacuum. When the Logos repeats a pattern, it is not vain – nor is it vain when man can see this pattern, and align himself with it, including in the arena of gesture and invocation. All depends upon the discernment of the Spirits.

What the Christian Church needs is not just Reformation and Revival, but Renaissance as well, patterned only upon the Logos, and not upon Luther, Charles Finney, or even Leonardo, who are by definition incomplete at best.

Whatever one can say about the Middle Ages (which we may be living in fairly soon as a purgatory for our arrogance), it was certainly more cheerful even in its high dudgeons, to illustrate which, we close with a story²⁹⁰:

The emperor knowing that the bishop, being occupied in a great variety of secular business, was now and then guilty of a barbarism, both in speaking and in reading Latin, with the help of his chaplain effaced the syllable *fa* from the words *famulis* and *famulabus*, which form part of a collect in the service for the defunct, in the missal; and then called on the bishop to say a mass for the souls of his father and mother. Meinwerk, therefore, being unexpectedly called on to perform the service, and hastening to do it, read on as he found written, *mulis* and *mulabus*, but, perceiving the mistake, he repeated the words correctly. After mass, the emperor said, in a sarcastic manner, to the bishop, 'I asked you to say mass for my father and mother, not for my male and female mules.' But he replied, 'By the mother of our Lord, you have been at your old tricks, and have made a fool of me again; and now, in no common way, but in the service of our God. This he who is my Judge has declared that he will avenge; for that which is done to him he will not pass by unpunished.' Thereupon, he immediately convened the canons in the chapter-house of the cathedral, ordered the emperor's chaplain, who had been a party to the trick, to be most severely flogged; and then, having dressed him in new clothes, sent him back to the emperor to tell him what had happened.

Posted on 2012-11-09 by Logres

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²⁹⁰<https://laudatortemporisacti.blogspot.com/2012/10/henry-ii-and-bishop-meinwerk-of.html>

Logres on 2012-11-11 at 06:25 said:

John Romanides has done some work on re-invigorating the teaching of Logos:

"This is written because Fr. John Romanides, relying on patristic texts and the hymnography of the Church, argued that the revelations of God in the Old Testament were revelations of the fleshless Logos, the Angel of Great Counsel, the Wisdom of God..."

He is needlessly anti-Western at times, but points out that Augustine's views on theophany left out the traditional teaching.

Cologero on 2012-11-11 at 10:32 said:

Anti-Western? Romanides claimed that the barbarian Franks (meaning all Germanic tribes) hijacked the Orthodox church in the Western half of the Empire in order to use it as a tool for control and domination. Curiously, neo-pagans have a similar view when, according to this view, it was actually their fellow Germanics who imposed Christianity upon them in order to secure the Western Empire.

It will be interesting to keep this in mind during the discussions of the Three Orders. The bishops in question were descendants of the Frankish Emperor Charlemagne. Here are two choices to keep in mind: (1) Were they trying to bring the Logos into awareness, i.e., so society would be a "theophany" of that Logos? (2) Were they cynically using these teachings as a means of political control?

Curiously, and I think humorously, Romanides complains that the word "frank" has come to mean open and honest while "byzantine" means just the opposite.

Logres on 2012-11-12 at 22:06 said:

That's a wonderful point, considering that John Rao presumes this entire question settled in favor of the RCC when he goes after the modern West:

²⁹¹

Obviously, Maurras' comment shows he stands in favor of this as spiritual fact, as well. I think the Orthodox have a strong argument which should be given some weight, but it's an argument much more applicable to (for instance) the Norman Conquest and the links of the Normans to the papacy (at least in the case of England – I think there was a Norman abbot who actually wrote a long denunciation of the whole affair). The chaos in the early West was very severe – people had to resort to eating meat during Fast periods because of famine, and the incursions were endless.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-12 at 22:22 said:

²⁹¹<https://www.amazon.com/Liberty-God-That-Failed-Constructing/dp/1621380068>

I believe it is a vital question to be settled on which side of the East-West schism is correct according to the Tradition.

On the one hand, Aleksandr Dugin alleges in *METAPHYSICS OF THE GOSPEL* that the Orthodox conception of the Trinity is in accordance with Hindu perceptions whereas the Catholic dogma of filioque contradicts it.

On the other hand, Joseph de Maistre mentioned that the Catholic view is the same as Plato's where One generates Two and together the Two generate Three.

At stake in this question is whether or not the West of the years say 1060-1300 AD was a Traditional society, whether or not the Holy Empire, the Crusades etc etc were legitimate. If Catholicism is correct then the mediaeval west was Traditional. If Orthodoxy is correct however that means the root of modernity is to be found in the very beginnings of western society.

I believe it is because of Dugin's adoption of the Orthodox critique of the west, as expressed by Romanides, that he regards the entirety of the west as being equal to the modern world and thus the enemy.

Cologero on 2012-11-12 at 23:02 said:

Jason-Adam: there is Rome, the second Rome (Constantinople) and the third Rome (Moscow). Because the Spirit is one, and the Saints are inspired by the Spirit, the faith is One, that is, it can only unify, not divide, once it is understood. As we have written many times, the Hermetic secret to conversation is depth. Words cannot fully express the ineffable so care and a good will are necessary. What exactly does the "filioque" mean? How was it expressed in the past? What specifically is the objection? And so on.

As we have shown, and will show more fully, the West from 1060 to 1300 was Traditional in its social order, in its metaphysical understanding, in its understanding of the Intellect, and so on. None of major writers on Tradition has denied this. If you have evidence to the contrary, it would be interesting to discuss, especially if you can relate it specifically to the effects of the "filioque".

The world process is dominated by two forces: Love and Strife. One leads to order, the other to chaos. Be careful which one you choose.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-12 at 23:14 said:

The Roman Catholics say the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son (filioque in Latin) whereas the Orthodox say He proceeds from the Father alone.

The "new Right" (Dugin) argues that by alleging a double source for the Spirit allows for a double or even multiple procession, thus the spirit can be possessed by multiple individuals at the same time; whereas with a single procession only one individual (the monarch) can be filled with the spirit. Dugin claims the filioque is the root of democratic thinking.

Cologero on 2012-11-13 at 07:40 said:

I'm afraid, Jason-Adam, the Mr. Dugin is quite mistaken. Which particular monarch are you referring to, since by that standard, there can only be one? Need I remind you that the spirit blows where He wills, not necessarily where Mr. Dugin's theology expects.

I asked you to do a few things, all of which you ignored. The first was to explain that if Tradition is one, how can there be a conflict? There are those who prefer to drive a wedge to widen differences horizontally, making them unbridgeable; our method is to go deeper vertically to find the common understanding. I suggest as a start, you bone up on what the filioque really means. This is a *good resource*.²⁹²

Another thing I asked you was to show precisely where the Medieval west was not traditional. Once again, you neglected to do that. "Democratic thinking" arises from the degeneration of castes; *alterations in dogma follow degeneration*, not the other way around. This is not the place to show how Protestantism overthrew, not just the established spiritual authority, but the very notion of a spiritual authority as a separate caste. Further democratic degeneration was possible only by the rejection, or forgetting, of the spirit in itself. This has already been dealt with, and we will do so again.

Is he really tying his whole argument on the filioque? Is that proving to be a burning issue in New Right circles?

Logres on 2012-11-13 at 08:35 said:

I'm not surprised that Dugin has heard of Romanides – Romanides was operating in a desperate situation of defending the Orthodox against its own bishops who were cooperating with the liberal WCC (World Council of Churches) – so it's important to remember the Spirit of the Times he is struggling against, and make allowances – you have to remember (at root however) that JR agrees with Karl Barth that "religion is a neuroses" that needs a cure – in this sense, he's no different than Freud.

Cologero on 2012-11-13 at 08:36 said:

I think I need to state this a different way, since I was assuming it was perfectly clear to everyone.

- A religious dogma is the exoteric expression of an esoteric truth.
- A Tradition is infallible and cannot promulgate a false dogma.
- Hence, a false dogma is NOT the cause of a deviation, but rather its result.
- Therefore, any deviations in the West need to be explained a different way.

²⁹²<http://www.catholic.com/tracts/filioque>

- As for the famous “filioque”, what it really means is “through the Son”, a notion that no Orthodox should be denying.
- Esoterically, roughly speaking, we can say that the Spirit proceeds from the principle of Being through the Logos.
- To deny that implies that the action of the Spirit in the world process is independent of the Logos, or cosmic order.
- To accept that leads to the conclusion that Chaos may be the result of the Spirit.
- This probably explains Mr. Dugin’s rather strange ideas about chaos.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-13 at 16:29 said:

I was not expressing my opinions here but merely trying to express Dugin’s. If I have done so poorly I deeply apologise for my lack of clarity and knowledge.

A problem I am finding is that a lot of Dugin’s key writings on Christianity & Tradition remain untranslated from the Russian. In the Russian writings Dugin adopts a very hardline “rigorist” Orthodox anti-Catholic approach that he does not use when he is writing in English or French.

I am pleased to see Cologero’s comments above because I believe he has resolved the riddle of how Dugin has come to his theory of chaos – it is indeed rooted in his understanding of the filioque issue.

To answer for Dugin the questions above :

1. He would say that while the Tradition is one, cultures are many and they can not be merged. You are familiar with this notion, it is the same as De Benoist’s misunderstanding of the Ancient City.

2. He claims the mediaeval west was not traditional because the Holy Empire founded by Charlemagne was based on usurping power from the Emperor of Constantinople. Dugin also states that Traditional cultures do not war with one another hence the crusades by their nature prove that the west was not traditional. Again you have dealt with this belief of the “new right” previously.

As for the notion of the monarch, Dugin believes though he tries to heavily disguise it, but he reveals it every now and then, that the world can indeed have only one monarch who transcends the bounds of differing cultures and he believes that monarch is the Russian Tsar – the heir of Caesar, the Sultan and Genghis Khan. His vision of the future world empire of Eurasia is a multiconfessional state like the Ottoman Empire or the Mongol khanate where a single ruler is simultaneously the head of all the religions under him. Each religious group would be entirely self-contained however and have no dealings with others except through the monarch.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-13 at 16:55 said:

I forgot to mention as well that Dugin sees the creation of the filioque as the result of a degeneration of caste – the revolt of the priestly caste (the Pope) against the royal power (the Emperor of Constantinople). The mediaeval west was thus not traditional because it did not have a ruler who possessed spiritual and temporal power, in the west the power was divided between the pope and the german emperor. Dugin sees Frederick II's ideal as a failed attempt to reassert the royal power against the papacy and restore tradition.

Dominion on 2012-11-13 at 20:34 said:

This is to me a clear indication of Dugin's Evolian influences in his views on the sacred King. Regarding the model of the Sacred King bringing forth his legitimacy to the priesthood and the warrior castes, this does seem to reflect in some ways the Orthodox model of the Father bringing forth the Son and Holy Spirit. An interesting argument I have heard from Orthodox sources is that the filioque introduced a hierarchy into the Godhead (Father, Son then Holy Spirit) rather than the Father as source and Son and Holy Spirit as his word (Logos) and hand acting in the world was what created the strict hierarchy which centralized the Catholic Church and led to its Latinization and the loss of many traditions, such as the Church that existed in Anglo-Saxon England, and the Celtic church.

Taking Cologero's view that the filioque describes "through the Son" would probably be a good way to create dialogue between the Eastern and Western Churches, but I must say that I have not heard this view from most Catholic apologists.

Logres on 2012-11-14 at 11:44 said:

Your post on Feudalism is a wonderful place to start, as Romanides accuses the Franks of inventing the feudal order. So, when Duby investigates these two bishops:

"Gerard of Cambrai and Adalbero of Laon are the two bishops that Duby focuses on, in the period of about the year 1000 to 1200"

in this time period, it is precisely the years that Romanides claims the Franks consolidated their "grip on power". I've been reading Ruskin's Bible of Amiens, and so far, although he acknowledges that Clovis (for instance) became more himself through Christianity (for good and bad), he wants to maintain that the spirituality which sprang up in feudalism was a precious imitation of true archetypes. I don't see how Romanides can justify the Donation of Constantine as a necessary Roman forgery to protect the West Roman papacy, and acknowledge that even some Franks took their side, as well as argue that Roman military interventions in cahoots with the Islam conquerors in Spain was a necessary alliance, & then accuse the Franks of being perfidious. Constantinople would have been better off (it seems to me) if they had focused on shoring up their own territory, and cooperating with the Germans and Franks against Islam. The

fact that the Franks were theologically unsophisticated doesn't cinch his case – what was Caesar doing west of the Rubicon, if not making “Romans” out of the barbarian tribes?

Logres on 2012-11-14 at 11:47 said:

“This probably explains Mr. Dugin's rather strange ideas about chaos.”

Romanides even justifies the French Revolution as a restoration of “Roman liberty” to the Gallo-Roman populations, in the wake of Frank excesses (which were really a betrayal of their own ideals, rather than an inversion of them).

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-14 at 16:57 said:

I agree exactly with you, Logres. Sadly however most of the European, Frankish-descended peoples of the “new right” continue with their “Enlightenment” derived hatreds of their own ancestors and Traditions.

1.40 The Bible of Amiens

Romanides argues that the Franks decimated Roman urbanization & established feudalism in an effort to maintain a precarious grip on overextended power from their home bases:

In the time of Pippin of Herestel (697-715) and Charles Martel (715-741), many of the Franks who replaced Roman bishops were military leaders who, according to Saint Boniface, “shed the blood of Christians like that of the pagans.” In order to defend itself against foreign interference and protect itself from the fate of conquered Romans elsewhere, the papacy promulgated electoral laws in 769, according to which candidates for the papal dignity had to be cardinal deacons or presbyters of the city of Rome, and Romans by birth. Only Roman nationals were allowed to participate in the elections. Thirteen Frankish bishops were in attendance when these decisions were made.²⁹³

²⁹³http://www.romanity.org/htm/rom.03.en.franks_romans_feudalism_and_doctrine.01.htm#5

Meanwhile, Roman revolutionary activity in Gaul had not yet been fully suppressed. Pippin III had died the year before and Charlemagne and his brother Carloman had taken over the rule of Austrasia and Neustria. Within the surprisingly short period of only twenty-two years, from 732 to 754, the Franks had defeated the Roman-Arab alliance, swamped all the provinces of Gaul, and had swept into Northern Italy. This was made possible by the new feudal order which was first established in Austrasia and Neustria. The Roman administrative units of the *civitates* were abolished and replaced by the military *comitates*. The former free Romans were transferred *en masse* from the cities and were established on the slave labor camps called *villae* and *mansi*, alongside the serfs. They were called villeins (*villains*), a term which, for understandable reasons, came to mean enemies of law and order.

The Visigoths in Spain were overthrown by the Romans, who opened their city gates to the Berbers and Arabs. The Franks reacted with determination to avoid the occurrence of the same in Francia (Land of the Franks) by abolishing Roman urban society.

By the middle of the eighth century, the Frankish armies of occupation were overextended far beyond Austrasia and Neustria, where the main body of their nation was established. They could not yet afford to take over the church administration of Papal Romania as they had done elsewhere. It was expedient to play the part of liberators for the time being. Therefore, they appointed the Roman pope as a vassal of Francia. The measure of freedom left to the Romans in Papal Romania depended on their right to have their own Roman pope, bishops, and clergy. To lose this right would have been tantamount to the same loss of freedom suffered by their compatriots in Northern Italy and Francia. Therefore, they had to be very careful not to incite the Franks.

The Romans had made alliances with the Arabs (and Jews) and suc-

ceeded in overthrowing Visigothic Spain. Romanides is clear²⁹⁴ what his argument is:

The church in Francia remained in the grip of a tyrannical Teutonic minority.

Strangely enough, Romanides admits that the Donation of Constantine was a deliberate forgery by the West Romans (done in Francia) which was a cloak-and-dagger effort to convince the Franks that there was imperial and religious sanction to Rome's complete independence (from Charlemagne's meddlings). This forgery (in Romanides' work) is really not condemned, but rather exonerated. There is no doubt that Romanides is right that there was a struggle for power between the remnants of Romanity and the "free Franks", or that the medieval Church was founded upon the French feudal structure which eventually triumphed in the Lombard struggle over the papacy. He even goes so far as to credit the French Revolution with restoring the balance against the invading, subjugating Franks, who had believed that God had given them the *imperium* by divine right of trial in battle (and here, Dugin's emphasis on Chaos as salvific finds a benefactor and friend in Romanides).

There is no mention of Frankish loyalty to Rome during the invasion of the Huns under Attila²⁹⁵. It is hard to see how Romanides can credibly call a province like Gaul legitimately "Roman", given that Caesar had conquered the tribes there, & yet when similar *foederati* tribes had remained loyal to the Romans during the ensuing incursions, but had predominantly paid the price in blood and treasure by defeating Rome's enemies on the battlefield, Romanides regards them as aliens. The fact that the Frankish tribes from the Harz regions²⁹⁶ finally made a political

²⁹⁴http://www.romanity.org/htm/rom.03.en.franks_romans_feudalism_and_doctrine.01.htm

²⁹⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Battle_of_Ch%C3%A2lons

²⁹⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harz>

reality out of what had become a social reality (the death of Roman political structure in the West) seems more or less appropriate. Romanides here sees primarily an ethnic struggle, where it would (even in his own account) seem to have been one more of *faction* – Rome certainly wanted to remain within the sphere of Byzantium, bad enough to lie about it; but it also tried to reclaim its frontiers.

John Ruskin's account of these doings seems far more sane and noble. Although admitting that the French people of 1789 were such that "no people had ever been so loyal in vain", he nonetheless wrote a paean to the Frankish people and their Christianity in *What Our Fathers Told Us: Bible of Amiens*²⁹⁷.

I return gladly to the dawn of chivalry, when, every hour and year, men were becoming more gentle and more wise; while, even through their worst cruelty and error (eg., the incident of the Vase of Soissons²⁹⁸ & Clovis), native qualities of noblest cast may be seen asserting themselves for primal motive, and submitting themselves for future training. Constantine's victory only gave form and dying color to the falling walls of Rome, but the Frank and Gothic races, thus conquering and thus ruled, founded the arts and established the laws which gave to all Europe her virtue joy and virtue. And it is lovely to see how, even thus early, the Feudal chivalry depended for its life on the nobility of its women. There was no vision seen, or alledged, at Tolbiac. The King prayed simply to the God of Clothilde.

Ruskin has some other interesting passages on the college of Augurs begun by Numa, and the vestal virgins, and the supreme pontiff (who makes sacrificial offerings on behalf of the whole human race). Ruskin sees through the "stench of the barbarian tribes" into the soul of what

²⁹⁷<http://www.gutenberg.org/files/24428/24428-h/24428-h.htm>

²⁹⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vase_of_Soissons

gave the Gothic birth, as distinct either from Classical youth or Arabic cradle.

We are not to see in Frankish monarchies a dull literalism – surprisingly, the Franks did not always adhere to strict “monarchical” lines of succession. Adalberon (the same archbishop who exonerated Adalbero of Laon from charges of adultery with Emma of Italy, brought by fellow nobility), was a chancellor who decisively acted against the ruling dynasty in favor of Hugh Capet²⁹⁹.

Crown the Duke. He is most illustrious by his exploits, his nobility, his forces. The throne is not acquired by hereditary right; no one should be raised to it unless distinguished not only for nobility of birth, but for the goodness of his soul.

Adalberon would later plot against Capet. Even the sins of medieval times tended to exonerate and recognize God. And here, I will end with the best defense possible against the modern accusation of “using God’s name” to do “Satan’s work” (leaving aside the rhetorical ellisions and fallacies which render this idea feasible to our minds); Edmund Burke:

The age of chivalry is gone. — That of sophisters, economists, and calculators, has succeeded; and the glory of Europe is extinguished forever. Never, never more, shall we behold a generous loyalty to rank and sex, that proud submission, that dignified obedience, that subordination of the heart, which kept alive, even in servitude itself, the spirit of an exalted freedom. The unbought grace of life, achieved defensive nations, the nurse of the manly sentiment and heroic enterprise is gone! It is gone, that sensibility of principle, that chastity of honor, which felt a stain like a wound, which inspired courage while it mitigated ferocity, which ennobled whatever it touched, and **under which vice itself lost half its evil, by losing all its grossness. . . .**

²⁹⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hugh_Capet

This is what occurred under Charlemagne, and more, if we can accept Ruskin's account, which is by no means unsympathetic to ancient Rome. Why did Byzantium pursue a policy of attempting to subordinate the Western half of the *imperium*, when it was clear that the quarrel would end badly?

Posted on 2012-11-16 by Logres

* * *

jason-Adam on 2012-11-16 at 23:41 said:

This is a brilliant piece, Logres, and I must commend your erudition and precise exposition of the facts involved.

To resolve the quandary of the Frank-Byzantine dispute, I can only cite the work of Spengler who saw the Western-Frankish-Roman culture that arose from the barbarians and blossomed under Charlemagne as a new culture with a distinct perception of God that was peculiar to itself – while the Franks and Byzantines both prayed to Christ, Christ meant a different substance to each. Ultimately the Byzantine soul was much closer to the Islamic and so for them the constant alliance with Islam against the west was not a betrayal.

I don't see Spengler as being contradictory to Guenon, if one does as Ptolemy did and posit smaller epicycles of cultures within the universal cycle.

An interesting subject for further investigation is how in our day the partisans of the Eastern Church – such as Dugin – have allied with the Western neopagans – de Benoist – against the tradition of the Old West of Charlemagne and l'ancien regime.

Logres on 2012-11-17 at 11:32 said:

Thank you very much, but this is really only a historical sketching to help flesh out Cologero's thesis, and therefore, subject to comment & change. I do think Ruskin's work is helpful, however, as he pursues "synthesis through depth" – that is, he helps us see through the barbaric nature of the times, into what was happening in their souls, which is the only kind of history worth telling. You are quite right about Spengler – he is a philosopher who discerns the Forms, handicapped by a lack of Tradition, who nevertheless does surprisingly well. Incidentally, Ruskin has some great quotes on Protestantism, which I think I'll try to transcribe.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-17 at 16:05 said:

I am an admirer of Ruskin's, so I look forward to the quotes.

Perhaps you or Cologero could help answer me this question... ..by profession, I am an art historian, now as part of my studies I know all about the Pre-Raphaelite movement (for which Ruskin was the guide and champion of) and other streams of Romanticism that were very much into mediaevalism and trying to revive its' spirit whereas the Neoclassical movements of the same time period were into glorifying democracy and liberalism (think of Jacques Louis David or Eugene Delacroix) – so why is that writers of Tradition prefer Classicism to Romanticism ? I understood the points Charles Maurras made in one his early essays but the way I see it it can be just easily argued from the reverse that Neoclassicism is of the revolution and Romanticism is of the reaction. Spengler I believe had that notion.

Logres on 2012-11-19 at 11:47 said:

My impression (my training is in literature) is that Romanticism to some extent embodied the Gothic impulse over against Classicism, which to some extent embodied Apollonian impulse (to put it in Spenglerian terms). So to this extent, Classicism is “multicultural”, whereas the Romantics are counter-enlightenment. Keats, therefore, makes attempts at philosophy (“house of many mansions”, “vale of soul-making”) and says “the eagle of truth is greater than the lyre of Apollo” – whereas Pope says “the proper study of mankind is man – presume not God to scan!”. So the process of degeneration (as Cologero has shown and argued) is articulated by the dark powers through a species of playing off one against the other : by turns, each side is made wear the white hat, or the black hat, depending. This is why the Hermetic counter-method is “unity in depth”. Both sides were involved in degeneration: what the Pre-Raphaelites did better than either was to use visual art (and here I am speculating and out of depth) to blend the best of both into something uniquely spiritual and also (arguably) English. Hence, their perennial and growing interest, even to people of Orthodox spirituality. This is also a quality found in some of the Victorians, like Dickens or Carlyle. I hope this stimulates your thought – your question did mine... maybe Cologero or others could say more?

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-19 at 18:59 said:

I have nothing more to add to your succinct and brilliant analysis, Logres.

Personally, I do find that Gornahoor has an “objective” (used in the sense of commitment to Tradition without personal biases) viewpoint sadly lacking in most so called Traditional websites. I think perhaps it's because

As I grow older in age and wisdom I start to feel that I must limit my interactions with the modern world to harden myself and gain more spiritual insight... an hour spent on the web is much better spent praying the Rosary... ..

David on 2012-11-19 at 21:29 said:

@ Logres This may be out of context a bit, but as of the last comments both on this text

and on others, you have mentioned «colgero's thesis». Apart from this site (which I must say is brilliant, thank you), is there a book or something with a more structured approach ? Having not joined the site when it started, I must re-read all the older post from the 71 pages up to now, and as interesting as it can be, it doesn't have the structure of a book per say. Thank you.

Logres on 2012-11-20 at 10:24 said:

Jason Adam, I am glad you found the piece valuable, it is encouraging.

David: There are certain posts of more help than others, which I would read, & then go from there...

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4798>

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3545>

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4870>

are good places to start. But Cologero would say (& I would second) that the best thing to do is to actually open a "medieval" book & read it alongside. Either Dante, or even Ruskin's Bible of Amiens, because Ruskin is sympatico. The "thesis" is simply that the springtime of the West is sufficiently traditional as to invite exploration fruitful for today (contrary to moderns, whether pagan or secular, and contrary the Eastern Orthodox). Carlyle's work on the French Revolution (for that matter) is not medieval, but it is prophetic. Boethius is a huge cornerstone of the Middle Ages – Cassiodorus, Isidore of Seville, & others can be read with profit.

Ananda Coomaraswamy's letters (for that matter) are valuable for a Westerner, as they point him where to look:

http://ignca.nic.in/ks_01.htm

Here is Guenon on St. Bernard:

http://www.worldwisdom.com/public/viewpdf/default.aspx?article-title=Saint_Bernard_by_Rene_Guenon.pdf

The Middle Ages have been torn to shreds by modern scholars, so I am not sure a single work out there exists, which would argue comprehensively for this from a traditional point of view.

Can someone else think of one?

1.41 Gothic Christianity

John Ruskin, (pp. 189-191), Bible of Amiens³⁰⁰:

³⁰⁰<http://www.gutenberg.org/files/24428/24428-h/24428-h.htm>

Quite the most beautiful sign of the power of true Christian-Catholic faith is this continual acknowledgement by it of the brotherhood – nay, more, the fatherhood, of the elder nations who had not seen Christ; but had been filled with the Spirit of God; and obeyed, according to their knowledge, His unwritten law. The pure charity and humility of this temper are seen in all Christian art, according to its strength and purity of race; but best, to the full, seen and interpreted by the three great Christian-Heathen poets, Dante, Douglas of Dunkeld, and George Chapman. The prayer with which the last ends his life's work is, so far as I know, the perfectest and deepest expression of Natural Religion given us in literature; and if you can, pray it here – standing on the spot where the builder once wrote the history of the Parthenon of Christianity:

I Pray thee, Lord, the Father, and the Guide of our reason, that we may remember the nobleness with which Thou has adorned us; and that Thou wouldst be always on our right hand and on our left, in the motion of our own Wills: that so we may be purged from the contagion of the Body and the Affections of the Brute, and overcome them and rule; and use, as it becomes men to use them, for instruments. And then, that Thou would'st be in Fellowship with us for the careful correction of our reason, and for its conjunction by the light of truth with the things that truly are. And in the third place, I pray to Thee the Saviour, that thou would'st utterly cleanse away the closing gloom from the eyes of our souls, that we may know well who is to be held for God, and who for Mortal. Amen.

John Ruskin wasn't much on Protestantism, although one senses that he could have acknowledged the innately Gothic, conservative nature that plays through Northern European spirituality:

First, that throughout the Sermon on this Amiens Mount, Christ

never appears, or is for a moment thought of, as the Crucified, nor as the Dead: but as the Incarnate Word—as the present Friend—as the Prince of Peace on Earth, and as the Everlasting King in Heaven. What His life *is*, what His commands *are*, and what His judgment *will be*, are the things here taught: not what He once did, nor what He once suffered, but what He is now doing—and what He requires us to do. That is the pure, joyful, beautiful lesson of Christianity; and the fall from that faith, and all the corruptions of its abortive practice, may be summed briefly as the habitual contemplation of Christ's death instead of His Life, and the substitution of His past suffering for our present duty. Then, secondly, though Christ bears not *His* cross, the mourning prophets,—the persecuted apostles—and the martyred disciples *do* bear theirs. For just as it is well for you to remember what your undying Creator is *doing* for you—it is well for you to remember what your dying fellow-creatures *have done*: the Creator you may at your pleasure deny or defy—the Martyr you can only forget; deny, you cannot. Every stone of this building is cemented with his blood, and there is no furrow of its pillars that was not ploughed by his pain. Keeping, then, these things in your heart, look back now to the central statue of Christ, and hear His message with understanding. He holds the Book of the Eternal Law in His left hand; with His right He blesses,—but blesses on condition. “This do, and thou shalt live”; nay, in stricter and more piercing sense, This *be* and thou shalt live: to show Mercy is nothing—thy soul must be full of mercy; to be pure in act is nothing—thou shalt be pure in heart also. And with this further word of the unabolished law—”This if thou do *not*, this if thou art not, thou shalt die.” Die (whatever Death means)—totally and irrevocably. There is no word in thirteenth-century Theology of the pardon (in our modern sense) of sins; and there is none of the Purgatory of them. Above that image of Christ with us, our Friend, is set the image of Christ over us, our Judge. For this present life—here

is His helpful Presence. After this life—there is His coming to take account of our deeds, and of our desires in them; and the parting asunder of the Obedient from the Disobedient, of the Loving from the Unkind, with no hope given to the last of recall or reconciliation. I do not know what commenting or softening doctrines were written in frightened minuscule by the Fathers, or hinted in hesitating whispers by the prelates of the early Church. But I know that the language of every graven stone and every glowing window,—of things daily seen and universally understood by the people, was absolutely and alone, this teaching of Moses from Sinai in the beginning, and of St. John from Patmos in the end, of the Revelation of God to Israel. This it was, simply—sternly—and continually, for the great three hundred years of Christianity in her strength (eleventh, twelfth, and thirteenth centuries), and over the whole breadth and depth of her dominion, from Iona to Cyrene,—and from Calpe to Jerusalem. At what time the doctrine of Purgatory was openly accepted by Catholic Doctors, I neither know nor care to know. It was first formalized by Dante, but never accepted for an instant by the sacred artist teachers of his time—or by those of any great school or time whatsoever. Neither do I know nor care to know—at what time the notion of Justification by Faith, in the modern sense, first got itself distinctively fixed in the minds of the heretical sects and schools of the North. Practically its strength was founded by its first authors on an asceticism which differed from monastic rule in being only able to destroy, never to build; and in endeavouring to force what severity it thought proper for itself on everybody else also; and so striving to make one artless, letterless, and merciless monastery of all the world. Its virulent effort broke down amidst furies of reactionary dissoluteness and disbelief, and remains now the basest of popular solders and plasters for every condition of broken law and bruised conscience which interest can provoke, or hypocrisy disguise. With the subsequent quar-

rels between the two great sects of the corrupted church, about prayers for the Dead, Indulgences to the Living, Papal supremacies, or Popular liberties, no man, woman, or child need trouble themselves in studying the history of Christianity: they are nothing but the squabbles of men, and laughter of fiends among its ruins. The Life, and Gospel, and Power of it, are all written in the mighty works of its true believers: in Normandy and Sicily, on river islets of France and in the river glens of England, on the rocks of Orvieto, and by the sands of Arno. But of all, the simplest, completest, and most authoritative in its lessons to the active mind of North Europe, is this on the foundation stones of Amiens. Believe it or not, reader, as you will: understand only how thoroughly it *was* once believed; and that all beautiful things were made, and all brave deeds done in the strength of it—until what we may call ‘this present time,’ in which it is gravely asked whether Religion has any effect on morals, **by persons who have essentially no idea whatever of the meaning of either Religion or Morality.** All human creatures, in all ages and places of the world, who have had warm affections, common sense, and self-command, have been, and are, Naturally Moral. Human nature in its fulness is necessarily Moral,—without Love, it is inhuman, without sense, inhuman,—without discipline, inhuman. In the exact proportion in which men are bred capable of these things, and are educated to love, to think, and to endure, they become noble,—live happily—die calmly: are remembered with perpetual honour by their race, and for the perpetual good of it. All wise men know and have known these things, since the form of man was separated from the dust. The knowledge and enforcement of them have nothing to do with religion: a good and wise man differs from a bad and idiotic one, simply as a good dog from a cur, and as any manner of dog from a wolf or a weasel. And if you are to believe in, or preach without half believing in, a spiritual world or law—only in the hope that whatever you do, or anybody

else does, that is foolish or beastly, may be in them and by them mended and patched and pardoned and worked up again as good as new—the less you believe in—and most solemnly, the less you talk about—a spiritual world, the better. But if, loving well the creatures that are like yourself, you feel that you would love still more dearly, creatures better than yourself—were they revealed to you;—if striving with all your might to mend what is evil, near you and around, you would fain look for a day when some Judge of all the Earth shall wholly do right, and the little hills rejoice on every side; if, parting with the companions that have given you all the best joy you had on Earth, you desire ever to meet their eyes again and clasp their hands,—where eyes shall no more be dim, nor hands fail;—if, preparing yourselves to lie down beneath the grass in silence and loneliness, seeing no more beauty, and feeling no more gladness—you would care for the promise to you of a time when you should see God’s light again, and know the things you have longed to know, and walk in the peace of everlasting Love—*then*, the Hope of these things to you is religion, the Substance of them in your life is Faith. And in the power of them, it is promised us, that the kingdoms of this world shall yet become the kingdoms of our Lord and of His Christ.

John Ruskin here does much to delineate the spirit which Duby investigated³⁰¹ in the early cathedral-building, the spirit which (if one accepts the claim being made here) represented the summit of Christianity, right after the dawn age of the Frankish imperium.

I am unaware of any rivals to this claim that are traditional in their orientation, excepting the Orthodox perspective which we dealt with last week. The modern critique of “the Dark Ages” hangs entirely on whether or not one accepts the modern technique of infinite manipulation (including of “man’s nature”, which is not supposed to exist, but yet

³⁰¹https://www.amazon.com/Age-Cathedrals-Art-Society-980-1420/dp/0226167704/ref=la_B001HD1HRE_1_6?ie=UTF8&qid=1353721991&sr=1-6

is subject to intense discussion and engineering anyway). The Victorian era itself did not pretend to rival this period, but rather saw itself in its shadow, or else rejected it entirely. The Reformation period either borrowed heavily from it and lived in its clothes, or else attempted to purify it (or obliterate it). When we arrive at the last century, it was supposed to have disappeared forever, and the American era helped to deliberately deepen this delusion.

But no one, even the detractors, really believes that any following Western period can compete with it in terms of youth and springtime power, for it is my distinct impression that not even the Renaissance conceived of itself entirely as a new beginning (as the Dark Age was) but rather as a “re-birth” of a life that was already in existence.

What do the readers think?

Posted on 2012-11-23 by Logres

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-25 at 00:05 said:

Ruskin's description of the unconscious collective mind of the Moyen Age is a perfect representation of the springtime of the West in the Spenglerian sense.

Two facts are made apparent : Frankish Christianity, not anything else, is the basis of Western, Franco-Germano-Roman culture, the culture of the restored Roman Empire that emerged from the ruins of the Vth and VIth centuries, and all further Western cultural life has been either an intellectualisation of or else a denial of this inner soul of the Christian West. The “American” period we know live in can be shown to be in fact a non-Western occupation of Western souls and minds... I am confident in the future of the West because history shows all cultures have a Second Religiousness phase, where the springtime beliefs reemerge and overcome materialism and rationalism. Who knows, perhaps Gornahoor is a beginning to this end ? Judging by comparisons to other cultures, the formation of the Western empire and second religiousness is not yet to come until sometime around 2080-2200 AD... .

One error Guenon and Evola might made about the West I think is to judge it as a culture in formation against those who were fully fulfilled... looking into the future, if the West can overcome Americanism at some point the future seems brighter for Tradition... .

Logres on 2012-11-27 at 13:26 said:

Jason-Adam, the letters of AKC that have been linked to on this site might be as helpful to you as they were to me (although I've not finished them). Is anyone else interested in reviving the Forum?

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-27 at 22:59 said:

Please show me the link to the letters as regretfully I have not seen them before... ..sadly I have not studied AKC as much as I should have, something I will rectify soon.

The Forum seems a bad idea for me, as I do not desire to debate but only to ask questions and learn. Having been a member formerly of several metaphysical Internet discussion groups, the arguing I encountered there made me want to stay quiet.

Logres on 2012-11-28 at 06:21 said:

There may be a better link, but here is the one I was using:

<http://www.scribd.com/doc/106308792/Selected-Letters-of-A-K-C-oomaraswamy-PART-1>

Cologero first put this up. You may be right about the Forum, although ours seemed to operate differently.

Graham on 2012-11-28 at 17:04 said:

There was debate, but no bickering. I agree that we should make an effort to revive it. The intention was always to conduct the more involved discussions there.

Logres on 2012-11-29 at 06:25 said:

Perhaps we should agree on either a subject or topic to discuss?

1.42 Sola Scriptura in the Middle Ages

The doctrine of Sola Scriptura was once understood in a total sense: that is, as a call to assimilate one's self to the Logos of God through meditation (often on the Psalms), & to preach this Gospel to every aspect of Life. The faith was not a matter of private devotion, merely. Ruskin's comments are well worth reading – he is speaking of Art and of Jerome's method of

interpretation. We note that the Protestant theory finds little approval in his pages:

Much more, must the scholar, who would comprehend in any degree approaching to completeness, the influence of the Bible on mankind, be able to read the interpretations of it which rose into the great arts of Europe at their culmination. In every province of Christendom, according to the degree of art-power it possessed, a series of illustrations of the Bible were produced as time went on; beginning with vignetted illustrations of manuscript, advancing into life-size sculpture, and concluding in perfect power of realistic painting. These teachings and preachings of the Church, by means of art, are not only a most important part of the general Apostolic Acts of Christianity; but their study is a necessary part of Biblical scholarship, so that no man can in any large sense understand the Bible itself until he has learned also to read these national commentaries upon it, and been made aware of their collective weight. The Protestant reader, who most imagines himself independent in his thought, and private in his study, of Scripture, is nevertheless usually at the mercy of the nearest preacher who has a pleasant voice and ingenious fancy; receiving from him thankfully, and often reverently, whatever interpretation of texts the agreeable voice or ready wit may recommend: while, in the meantime, he remains entirely ignorant of, and if left to his own will, invariably destroys as injurious, the deeply meditated interpretations of Scripture which, in their matter, have been sanctioned by the consent of all the Christian Church for a thousand years; and in their treatment, have been exalted by the trained skill and inspired imagination of the noblest souls ever enclosed in mortal clay. 46. There are few of the fathers of the Christian Church whose commentaries on the Bible, or personal theories of its gospel, have not been, to the constant exultation of the enemies of the Church, fretted and disgraced by angers of controversy, or weakened and distracted by irreconcilable heresy. On the

contrary, the scriptural teaching, through their art, of such men as Orcagna, Giotto, Angelico, Luca della Robbia, and Luini, is, literally, free from all earthly taint of momentary passion; its patience, meekness, and quietness are incapable of error through either fear or anger; they are able, without offence, to say all that they wish; they are bound by tradition into a brotherhood which represents unperverted doctrines by unchanging scenes; and they are compelled by the nature of their work to a deliberation and order of method which result in the purest state and frankest use of all intellectual power. 47. I may at once, and without need of returning to this question, illustrate the difference in dignity and safety between the mental actions of literature and art, by referring to a passage, otherwise beautifully illustrative of St. Jerome's sweetness and simplicity of character, though quoted, in the place where we find it, with no such favouring intention,—namely, in the pretty letter of Queen Sophie Charlotte, (father's mother of Frederick the Great,) to the Jesuit Vota, given in part by Carlyle in his first volume, ch. iv.

“ ‘How can St. Jerome, for example, be a key to Scripture?’ she insinuates; citing from Jerome this remarkable avowal of his method of composing books;—especially of his method in that book, *Commentary on the Galatians*, where he accuses both Peter and Paul of simulation, and even of hypocrisy. The great St. Augustine has been charging him with this sad fact, (says her Majesty, who gives chapter and verse,) and Jerome answers, ‘I followed the commentaries of Origen, of five or six different persons, who turned out mostly to be heretics before Jerome had quite done with them, in coming years, ‘And to confess the honest truth to you,’ continues Jerome, ‘I read all that, and after having crammed my head with a great many things, I sent for my amanuensis, and dictated to him, now my own thoughts, now those of others, without much recollecting the order, nor sometimes the words, nor

even the sense!’ In another place, (in the book itself further on³⁰²) he says, ‘I do not myself write; I have an amanuensis, and I dictate to him what comes into my mouth. If I wish to reflect a little, or to say the thing better, or a better thing, he knits his brows, and the whole look of him tells me sufficiently that he cannot endure to wait.’ Here is a sacred old gentleman whom it is not safe to depend upon for interpreting the Scriptures,—thinks her Majesty, but does not say so,—leaving Father Vota to his reflections.” Alas, no, Queen Sophie, neither old St. Jerome’s, nor any other human lips nor mind, may be depended upon in that function; but only the Eternal Sophia, the Power of God and the Wisdom of God: yet this you may see of your old interpreter, that he is wholly open, innocent, and true, and that, through such a person, whether forgetful of his author, or hurried by his scribe, it is more than probable you may hear what Heaven knows to be best for you; and extremely improbable you should take the least harm,—**while by a careful and cunning master in the literary art, reticent of his doubts, and dexterous in his sayings, any number of prejudices or errors might be proposed to you acceptably, or even fastened in you fatally, though all the while you were not the least required to confide in his inspiration.** 48. For indeed, the only confidence, and the only safety which in such matters we can either hold or hope, are in our own desire to be rightly guided, and willingness to follow in simplicity the guidance granted. But all our conceptions and reasonings on the subject of inspiration have been disordered by our habit, first of distinguishing falsely—or at least needlessly—between inspiration of words and of acts; and secondly by our attribution of inspired strength or wisdom to some persons or some writers only, instead of to the whole body of believers, in so far as they are partakers of the Grace of Christ, the Love of God,

³⁰²http://www.gutenberg.org/files/24428/24428-h/24428-h.htm#Footnote_3-15_38

and the Fellowship of the Holy Ghost. In the degree in which every Christian receives, or refuses, the several gifts expressed by that general benediction, he enters or is cast out from the inheritance of the saints,—in the exact degree in which he denies the Christ, angers the Father, and grieves the Holy Spirit, he becomes uninspired or unholy,—and in the measure in which he trusts Christ, obeys the Father, and consents with the Spirit, he becomes inspired in feeling, act, word, and reception of word, according to the capacities of his nature. He is not gifted with higher ability, nor called into new offices, but enabled to use his granted natural powers, in their appointed place, to the best purpose. A child is inspired as a child, and a maiden as a maiden; the weak, even in their weakness, and the wise, only in their hour. That is the simply determinable *theory* of the inspiration of all true members of the Church; its truth can only be known by proving it in trial: but I believe there is no record of any man's having tried and declared it vain.³⁰³

Beyond this theory of general inspiration, there is that of special call and command, with actual dictation of the deeds to be done or words to be said. I will enter at present into no examination of the evidences of such separating influence; it is not claimed by the Fathers of the Church, either for themselves, or even for the entire body of the Sacred writers, but only ascribed to certain passages dictated at certain times for special needs: and there is no possibility of attaching the idea of infallible truth to any form of human language in which even these exceptional passages have been delivered to us. But this is demonstrably true of the entire volume of them as we have it, and read,—each of us as it may be rendered in his native tongue; that, however mingled with mystery which we are not required to unravel, or difficulties which we should be insolent in desiring to solve, it contains plain

³⁰³http://www.gutenberg.org/files/24428/24428-h/24428-h.htm#Footnote_3-16_39

teaching for men of every rank of soul and state of life, which so far as they honestly and implicitly obey, they will be happy and innocent to the utmost powers of their nature, and capable of victory over all adversities, whether of temptation or pain. Indeed, the Psalter alone, which practically was the service book of the Church for many ages, contains merely in the first half of it the sum of personal and social wisdom. The 1st, 8th, 12th, 14th, 15th, 19th, 23rd, and 24th psalms, well learned and believed, are enough for all personal guidance; the 48th, 72nd, and 75th, have in them the law and the prophecy of all righteous government; and every real triumph of natural science is anticipated in the 104th.

Ruskin lived when it was still possible to walk down and view a truly Catholic society in something other than monuments.

Posted on 2012-11-30 by Logres

* * *

George on 2013-02-02 at 09:38 said:

“... and in the measure in which he trusts Christ, obeys the Father, and consents with the Spirit, he becomes inspired in feeling, act, word, and reception of word, according to the capacities of his nature.”

This would be unacceptable today, as it immediately undermines belief in equality and what would follow is Democracy – why should all have equal vote when all have different abilities to discern “according to the capacities of his nature”?

1.43 The Word Remains Within

American Christians generally use “logos” (if they use it) in the sense that Aristotle wants to use it:

For Aristotle, *logos* is something more refined than the capacity to make private feelings public: it enables the human being to perform as no other animal can; it makes it possible for him to perceive and make clear to others through reasoned discourse the difference between what is advantageous and what is harmful, between what is just and what is unjust, and between what is good and what is evil. (PA Rahe)

That is, when modern Christians use the word Logos, they predominantly conceive of “that which makes for argument, or logic”. This definition is by and large the regnant one, even among the classical Christian movement. Practically speaking, the Logos is thought of in terms of that which “makes sense” out of our logic, and connects us, through dialectic, to the mind of God.

Although I would not want to argue that this is not a dimension of Logos, I do say that it is an impoverished one. Philo, for instance, terms it the *logos endiathetos* (*the word remaining within*), while the Stoics (who influenced not to much St. John as Justin the Martyr) believed that the Logos was the generative principle of the universe. Philo, also, assigned to the Logos a kind of demi-urgic status. Surely St. Paul must have had something like this in mind when he described Christ as being the vessel and sum of the worlds, which He would recapitulate and return to the Father at the end of time.

The point here is that Logos is not merely an Aristotelian or Enlightenment concept of active, dialectical Reason, a spark of divinity that ensures our divine image and reflects some logical function of Christ’s ontological status. This would be to mechanize the Logos, or at least, trend in this direction. It would be to make the Logos merely a pattern filtered through right Reason (which, of course, it partly is).

Justin Martyr wrote the following:

I shall give you another testimony, my friends, from the Scriptures, that God begot before all creatures a Beginning, who was a

certain rational power proceeding from Himself, who is called by the Holy Spirit, now the Glory of the Lord, now the Son, again Wisdom, again an Angel, then God, and then Lord and Logos.

The Orthodox want to argue that this “angel of the Lord” is actually the divine energies which one experiences in illumination (after purification). It is not a created being or merely external theophany (as Augustine is alleged to have thought) which is brought into and out of existence in order to create a saga of revelation, but rather, participation in the divine energies (the divine essence being reserved for God, forever, alone). “Being in the Spirit” allows one to experience this divine energy.

If we take our hint from the Orthodox, we might try thinking of the Logos as *all higher states of being* whatsoever (the lower ones being created by natural deprivation or distortion of the collateral states associated with Logos). The Logos is “Light” or “Life” – the “Kingdom of God”. Understood this way, Jesus was Himself the embodiment in full of the reign of God: He did not exhaust, but rather, fully expressed, the Logos.

The Logos is therefore a spiritual state of Being, a higher kingdom of existence, a noetic faculty of soul, the seeds of Creation, the divine image within, Right Reason, the Nous itself and all higher worlds (excluding God’s essence), the Logos Spermatikos and First Born before all Worlds, the Alpha and Omega and the end of time, and the way, truth, and life, which is the light of men.

It is clear that the emphasis in the West has been, for centuries now, upon the dialectical apparatus of the logical mind, and while divine certainty has been ascribed strongly to this (how else could David Hume die in such peace of mind?), it has tended to both arrogate and impoverish the depths and even the width of the human spirit and soul. Christianity itself has been implicitly guilty in this, because Western Christianity tends to think of God, when it does so at all, as a logically accessible entity that operates according to the strictures of common, rational thought; in practice, it is often reducible to the “structures” of thought.

With this is mind, next week we will begin our trip through Iamblichus' arithmetic theology, showing how a "mysticism" of the numbers is possible that is revelatory of fundamental patterns in both lower and higher reality.

Posted on 2012-12-20 by Logres

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Dominion on 2012-12-25 at 03:43 said:

If the Logos is all higher states of being, one must consider what is to be made of the other two Divine persons of the Trinity. Might we think of the Holy Spirit as the Wisdom that the initiate seeks? The Holy Spirit is called "the Helper"; Beatrice helps Dante in his journey, and the perennial Sophia who is the true love of the initiate is essential for leading him to God, who reveals himself slowly. Thus we have the Logos (the states of Being) on the one hand, and the Holy Spirit (helper and guide) on the other. In the Christian Tradition, both stem from the Father, the person of the Trinity who "generates" (but does not create) the other two. It may be possible to consider the Father the face of the supreme Reality, the fundamental essence of which the states of Being and the Divine Wisdom are reflections, extensions and manifestations.

In this line of thought, the reconciliation of Christ's statement that "none can come to the Father but through me" and the transcendent unity of religions taught by the perennial Tradition logically follow.

Logres on 2012-12-25 at 11:14 said:

Good thoughts, Dominion. I've heard the Son and Spirit called "the two hands of the Father", but (of course) this slides towards seeing them as One Person. Nevertheless, perhaps the unity of God needs more emphasis in our day of fragmentation and needless accretion of knee-jerk thought patterns within Christianity. If Christianity, instead of being seen as a competing religion to supersede all others, was actually a purifier and exalter and perfecter of what was good in those religions, this would be the counterpart of emphasizing God's unity. The Church was often more anti-pagan than pro-Christ, and we're still paying for it. Have you seen Bulgakov's work on Sophia? http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sergei_Bulgakov

It sounds as if you had... .

Dominion on 2012-12-25 at 13:31 said:

I have not, but thank you for the link. Your comment on the Church's anti-Heathen vs pro-Christ attitude is apt. Unfortunately, the same attitude has been taken between Christians

themselves (the miaphysite question between Eastern and Oriental Orthodox and the Papal issue and filioque between East and West come to mind). Personal ego and prestige have often outdone impersonal and rational dialogue and common cause in the search of truth, right down to when St. Nicholas punched out Arius at Nicaea. If Christians cannot interact with each other, then dialogue on Tawhid and the one-ness of the Divine reality may be far off yet.

Graham on 2012-12-27 at 09:07 said:

Gentlemen, on the need for pro-Christ 'positive formulations' and 'dialogue' ... did the last five decades never happen?

"Where there is no hatred of heresy, there is no holiness."

Dialogue is 'vewwy nice,' but has to be sharply qualified in terms of its final cause. On the exoteric level, it must aim at conversion; on the esoteric, spiritual depth; on all levels, at the correction of error. When the final cause is ignored, dialogue and positive formulations become in effect ends in themselves, and thereby tools of the Demon sowing confusion.

Dominion on 2012-12-27 at 13:30 said:

That's more or less my point. Much of the dialogue that has taken place has been in order to render reconciliation on the exoteric plane at the expense of Truth. This is especially true with the Catholic Church. That said, esoteric dialogue has also occurred and indeed been fruitful. The Traditionalist writers are fine examples of that.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:35 said:

The problem I have with hesychasm is that it is Orthodox and Orthodox practices can not be adopted by Catholics without sacrificing Catholicity – despite what one wants to think, there are huge differences between the Western and Eastern Churches that ultimately come down to culture. When all is said and done I think Orthodox Christianity is as foreign to the West as Islam or Hinduism is despite the same Triune Deity we worship. Remember the Tradition is one but the forms are many.

I used to be very interested in Western Rite Orthodoxy, until I found that becoming Orthodox basically involves adopting an anti-Western line of thought.

Sadly however I have not as yet found a Western, fully Roman Catholic, path to theosis... ..and I appreciate anyone who can point me in the proper direction.

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 21:26 said:

I believe, Jason-Adam, you are erecting artificial barriers. We pointed out that Scupoli's "Spiritual Combat" was adapted by the Orthodox with minor changes; we mentioned that for a reason. Furthermore, perhaps even others will gain from working through the exercises in that book, even if they need to make certain concessions in the language.

As for a Western path to theosis, there is plenty to choose from, but I'll list the Divine Comedy, the works of John of the Cross, "The Three Ages of the Spiritual Life" by Garrigou-Lagrange, and "Mystical Evolution" by Fr. Arinterro.

catharsis : theoria : theosis = purgation : illumination : unification

As for hesychasm, I don't believe it is something anyone should be trying on his own.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 22:25 said:

I spoke too broadly and I ask for forgiveness for my error : Spiritual Combat/Unseen Warfare is indeed a classic of both Western and Eastern spirituality... ... What I was trying to say is that the theology of Gregory Palamas, which is the basis of Orthodox mysticism, is based on dividing the essence and energy of God, something the Church of Rome denies, thus despite whatever has been said in recent times one can not uphold Palamas and be Catholic in good faith. I am not denying the validity of Palamas for the Orthodox church, but I don't know if he can be accepted by Westerners as a guide.

Logres on 2012-12-27 at 22:45 said:

Energy vs. Essence : I know it is a loaded discussion, but it does seem to preserve the idea of God's unmanifested Divinity, which (as I understand it so far) is central to Traditional thought in general.

Graham on 2012-12-28 at 14:35 said:

"I believe, Jason-Adam, you are erecting artificial barriers."

On this note, Jason-Adam, one might benefit from reading Marco Pallis' essay 'The Catholic Church in Crisis'. I am certain it would help you orient yourself, and may indicate to you some areas in which the West could learn from the East.

"As for hesychasm, I don't believe it is something anyone should be trying on his own."

Certain remarks of Guenon's on Yoga apply, especially since what has been published on hesychasm is, like Yoga, largely a popularization, as I indicated in an earlier comment:

"Nevertheless it must be added that these same 'practices' can also have repercussions in the subtle modalities of the individual unsuspected by the ignorant person who undertakes them ... " (Reign of Quantity, Confusion of the Psychic and the Spiritual)

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-30 at 18:44 said:

I read Pallis' article but am not sure how far it can be accepted – one of the errors condemned by B Pius IX was that of saying the Papacy was at fault in its dealing with the Eastern church... ..

Logres on 2012-12-30 at 23:19 said:

Graham, this is utterly right, I was thinking more of the lack of appreciation in the Church for the pagan foundations that go into Christianity, and which are an essential element of it, at least if it is to survive. The dialogues of later years have been aimed more at modernizing, and not even at neo-paganizing, certainly not at making explicit the sacerdotal and cultural foundations of the Faith. How to reconcile Boniface with St. Patrick, is more of what I was wondering?

1.44 The Road to the true West

We will return to the Number 8 & Iamblichus, very soon.

The Inklings are well-known to Christians, and greatly lauded; unfortunately, very few are interested in the more profound portions of any of their work.

Gornahoor has already pointed out³⁰⁴ that CS Lewis ultimately held a reductive view of the myths which he so delighted in; however, *it may have been somewhat different for Tolkien*. They had made a pact together: Lewis was to write a novel about space-travel (in which he suggested that the celestial elementals could be real – did he mean this?), and Tolkien would write a story about time-travel. Tolkien became sidetracked with Lord of the Rings, but “The Lost Road” was a story which he tried to weave into the Mythos of LOTR.

It begins with a father and son, both Englishmen; the son is hearing voices through the natural elements, or in dreams, which spell out the syllables of what he thinks is a language. Alboin is the son’s given Christian name. Alboin is dark-complected, and going off to the university – his mother is dead, and he is an only child. He is staying with his ailing father just prior to going off to school, and is introspecting:

“Dark Alboin. I wonder if there is any Latin in me. Not much, I think. I love the western shores, and the real sea – it is quite different from the Mediterranean, even in stories. I wish there was no

³⁰⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3545>

other side to it. There are darkhaired people who are not Latins. Are the Portugese Latins? What is Latin? I wonder what kind of people lived in Portugal and Spain and Ireland and Britain in the old days, very old days, before the Romans and the Carthaginians. Before anybody else. I wonder what the man thought who was the first to see the western sea.”

His father argues the next day:

“Of course, I am not a philologist, but I could never see that there was much evidence in favour of ascribing language-changes to a substratum. Though I suppose underlying ingredients do have an influence, though it is not easy to define, on the final mixture in the case of peoples taken as a whole, different national talents and temperaments, and that sort of thing. But races, and cultures, are different from languages.”

Alboin argues with his father about prehistory – where his father thinks that pre-culture and pre-history would be beastly and animal-like, Alboin is inclined rather to think that something better and greater inhabited the time of the past along the coasts of Cornwall. They end up discussing the “secret language” that Alboin is deciphering from intuitions: *lomelinde*, for example, he is pretty sure means nightingale.

One of the Eressean Elf-latin phrases he had translated was this:

Westra lage wegas rehtas, nu isti sa wraithas.

“A straight road lay westward, now it is bent”.

Alboin’s father dies over the course of early term, and Alboin is saddened because they had not been as close immediately prior to his death as they had when he was younger, and had just started the translations. This turns out to be reflective of a father-son relationship that was occurring in the hyper-reality of the world which Alboin is dreaming about.

Thus said Aelfwine³⁰⁵ the far-traveled – “There is many a thing in the West regions unknown to men, marvels and strange beings, a land fair and lovely, the home land of the Elves, and the bliss of the Gods. Little doth any man know what longing is his whom old age cutteth off from return.”

Before his father dies, he tells him – you can’t go back.

Alboin however, realizes that his inner being is differently constituted:

“He felt he could say that his most permanent mood, though often overlaid or suppressed, had been since childhood, the desire to go back. To walk in Time, perhaps, as men walk on long roads; or to survey it, as men may see the world from a mountain, or the earth as a living map beneath an airship.”

Eventually, he deciphers a long passage:

And Sauron came to Numenor, fell under Shadow, war-made on powers – sea fell into the Chasm and Numenor down-fell. The road straight went west-ward, all roads were now bent, and the death-shadow is heavy (to us).

As the story unfolds in the hyper-reality, it becomes clearer that at one point, a straight road into the West passed gradually upwards into the lower heavens through the lower waters, and that men once walked this road to the abode of the gods; after the coming of Sauron, and the Fall, when Atlantis was overthrown, the world became round, and the road into the West was bent, so that only after death could men walk it. This is part of the story of Numenor, which occurs before the Lord of the Rings tale. Numenor and Atlantis are linked.

³⁰⁵<http://www.elvish.org/gwaith/aelfwine.htm>

Alboin has had a son, named Audoin, who is also hearing visions and dreaming dreams. He is too young to know that in the past, a figure had appeared in a dream to Alboin, calling himself Elendil, the elf-friend, who offers him his desire : to go back.

“That cannot be, it is against the law.”

“It is against the rule – laws are commands upon the will and are binding. Rules are conditions; they may have exceptions. They may be strict, yet they are the means, not the ends, of government. There are exceptions, for there is that which governs, and is beyond the rules. Behold, it is by the chinks in the wall that the light comes through, whereby men become aware of the light and therein perceive the wall and how it stands. The world is not a machine that makes other machines, after the fashion of Sauron. To each under the rule, some unique fate is given, and he is excepted from that which is a rule to others.”

Alboin answers, then, that yes, he will have his desire. However, his very young son, Audoin, is drawn into the plot.³⁰⁶

Then Alboin seemed to fall into a dark and a silence, deep and absolute. It was as if he had left the world completely, where all silence is on the edge of sounds, and filled with echoes, and where all rest is but repose upon some greater motion. He had left the world and gone out. He was silent and at rest: a point.

There is a father-son pair in Numenor, long ago, who are experiencing a similar struggle together – the father is trying to get the son to disavow allegiance to Sauron, who is now effectively controlling their king. The paternal bond prevails, the son, against his will, disavows Sauron. This parallels Audoin being dragged into Alboin’s choice in spite of his free will, due to the bargain and the blood relationship.

³⁰⁶<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Audoin>

“There is storm over Numenor.”

The fragments are not all linked by Tolkien, so this is not a “Story” per se. However, he had interesting thoughts and designs for this one.

“The Father made the world for elves and mortals, and he giveth it into the hands of the Lords, who are in the West. There is Iluvatar, the One, and then there are the Powers, of whom the eldest in the thought of Iluvatar was Alkar the Radiant; and there are the firstborn of Earth, the Eldar, who perish not while the world lasts. And then there are also the afterborn, mortal men, who are the children of Iluvatar, and yet under the rule of the Lords. Iluvatar designed the world, and revealed this design to the Powers; and of these, some of these he set to be Valar, Lords of the World, and governors of the things that are therewith. But Alkar, who had journeyed alone in the Void before the World, seeking to be free, desired the World to be a kingdom unto himself. Therefore, he descended into it like falling Fire; and he made war upon the Lords, his brethren. But they established their mansions in the West, in Valinor, and they shut him out, and they gave battle to him in the North, and they bound him, and the World had peace, and became exceeding fair... all things have an end in this world, for the world itself is bounded, that it may not be void. But death is not decreed by the Lords: it is the gift of the One, and a gift which in the wearing of Time even the Lords of the West shall envy.”

Elendil teaches his son that though wisdom is lost in Numenor with Sauron, we can have the wisdom to know there is no escape, except to a worse fate: “the old songs are altered or forgotten; twisted into other meanings”. Sauron offers Empire, Machines, and Conquest to the West, but Elendil persuades Herendil to join him in disobedience to Sauron (and in obedience to the King, although his mind is twisted): “Even to dispraise Sauron is held to be rebellious.”

Does this not describe our own era?

Sauron cannot build ships that sail the road upward into the West, although the Numenoreans tried to build airships previous to this, which never reached the mansions of Valinor. All the Empire can do is to build engines of war and conquest that are limited to the horizontal level.

The world, which was once a straight road up into the heavens, a vertical ascent on a level incline, has become bounded: a fallen orb in which the vertical is chained to the horizontal, and the true road West is closed. Nevertheless, this is not Fate or a Law, but a Rule, which has exceptions. Certain exceptional men, such as Aelfwine or Albain, can have experiences of Eressea and the Western Isles, but this is the exception now, not the rule. Some can escape, because, as Tolkien intimates, the true road to the West is now hidden in the post-mortem states, and is therefore still existent, even in the “round world” of waking men.

Tolkien goes on to link his stories of the West to the voyages of St. Brenden³⁰⁷.

I hope one can get a small taste of how a master storyteller, faithful Catholic, and man of letters was able to go further than someone like Lewis in intuiting how the old myths did not breathe lies through silver³⁰⁸, but actually were “true myths”; wherever Tolkien is, I am certain Valinor and Middle Earth exist, even if he has passed beyond them. And if they exist in the heavens, then there is also a road into the true West, however little traveled, that is accessible still. Tolkien’s myths hold great potential teaching power, when harmonized and explained within the Tradition.

Posted on 2013-03-15 by Logres

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³⁰⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brendan#The_Voyage_of_Saint_Brendan

³⁰⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mythopoeia_%28poem%29

Scardanelli on 2013-03-16 at 10:01 said:

Great job... this was quite refreshing and inspirational. im glad you linked to the Mythopoeia poem. I only discovered a few days ago and it was somewhat of a revelation reading it. Coincidentally, I've just begun reading B.M.'s Gnosis series and was reading some of your previous posts on it. I've only just begun the first book, but it seems like there are some similarities here between the concept of surpassing the "general law" and Tolkien's concept of rules as opposed to laws. Anyway, thanks for this!

Thorsten on 2013-03-16 at 15:27 said:

I need to go reread Tolkien's works (especially such lesser-known ones as *The Book of Lost Tales* with which the story at hand is evidently connected) having since learned about the metaphysical significance underlying his mythology. As a philologist myself I can't help but point out that the "Elf Latin" quotation,

"Westra lage wegas rehtas, nu isti sa wraithas."

is what appears to be Tolkien's rendering of Proto-Old English or some stage intermediate between Proto-Germanic and Old English. Given that Tolkien's use of language both historical and constructed (or in this case reconstructed) often has multiple layers of symbolism (E.g. Rohirric language and culture drawing so heavily from that of the Anglo-Saxons) and often alludes to historical or mythical motifs (E.G. Eärendil – ?arendel 'luminous wanderer' of Germanic Myth:<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Earendel>) I would be interested in knowing more about the context of this quotation, because the use of this phase of the English language not used elsewhere by Tolkien to my knowledge.

All the best.

Logres on 2013-03-16 at 21:23 said:

At the moment, I've misplaced my only copy, so I'll try to post the context of the quote, Thorsten, later, but it shows up in several places in the opening of *The Lost Road*.

Scardanelli, very insightful: yes, I put that quote in because it is a beautiful exposition both of the unique destinies of the individual, and also because it draws a very subtle and necessary distinction between Rule and Law. General Law attempts to keep "everyone in their place" : the true individual will "escape" General Law by proper and lawful efforts (to which Mouravieff gives directions) which place them on the path of destiny, which is the exception to the rule because it fits the emerging hero. A moment of reflection will show that this happens all the time on the non-supernatural level anyway, and is designed to lead us to this great realization.

Logres on 2013-03-16 at 21:38 said:

Alboin translates that passage along with the Aelfwine quotation for his father, just before the old man goes into his final decline. So it is a last scene of the "good old days" (discussing

philosophy, etc.) between father and son. And thank you for the links, sir.

Thorsten on 2013-03-17 at 10:13 said:

Thank you for the further info, Logres. I'm always happy to provide input regarding things of this sort. OE and Germanic philology is one of my areas of focus on account of ancestry and appreciation of the insight it provides into older Indo-European spirituality, especially regarding the role of the warrior, something Tolkien understood so thoroughly.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-17 at 14:05 said:

That was excellent!

Tolkien really had a great intuition and imagination. The vision I got just from the small anecdotes, incredible!

The synthetic, technological empire by which Sauron imposes his rule (as you stated is the state of the world in our time). In contrast to the organic, initiatory, and pure existence the men of the west exist in is superb. The visions of Alboin (whose name seems to be reference to Albion), which arise from his inner souls memories (intuition), and his struggle to understand them in reference to the prevailing thinking (his Father) about myth and legend, within the standard contemporary religious, and secular views. As opposed to what he intuitively knows to be the case.

Tolkien's presenting of myths and legends of the ancient past through a devoted Catholic worldview as not being mere folk tales and, or pagan devilry, that should be either enjoyed as fiction- or completely disregarded as the latter. But as living within the spiritual memory of us in the now, and being purified by the blood of Christ point to a higher path, and truth that has been lost to most, but can be recalled by those who have the intuition, and understanding to do so. Both of which are gifts of the Holy Spirit, but thankfully can be strengthened by contemplation, and Sacramental life.

I thank you for this!

Logres on 2013-03-17 at 22:07 said:

I was shocked, also, when I read the Lost Road. Pleasantly so.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 12:24 said:

Indeed!

Logres on 2013-03-18 at 13:04 said:

I would like to see a traditional artist of letters take the idea of The Lost Road, and integrate it into the Tradition as purest art. It would be like reforging an ancient sword.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 13:29 said:

Hmmm... Well then, I may have to make an attempt. This would be a most excellent task, I do write a bit of poetry, mostly prose.

Creating a vision of the Great struggle between cthonic techo/ materialistic forces and the Solar organic initiatory forces, played out somehow in the inner, and exterior world of a character existing in the contemporary world. Who must overcome himself, and the society at large, with some sort of external aid that exists in the greater present, which is now, and simultaneously all times. And it could incorporate the ideas of great Traditionalist thinkers, and ancient Spiritual wisdom. The trick is to take the concept without being a complete mimicry.

Scardanelli on 2013-03-18 at 13:42 said:

I haven't had much time to explore this concept, but lately I've thought that it would be interesting to use traditional forms of verse but in a modern context... For instance epic poetry written in an old English alliterative verse form but dealing with the true heroic in the modern world. It could serve as a type of bridge...

scardanelli on 2013-03-18 at 13:54 said:

If enough people involved themselves in this effort, an entire descriptive language could be developed that would help us identify the truth of what the modern world really is, somewhat along the lines of Old English kennings used in reference to themes of Old English /Norse poetry. Tolkien's use of the "Iron Crown" in Mythopoeia is a great example.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 13:56 said:

Yes. The heroic in action in this darkest of times. For now the hero must stand against the entire current of wrong thinking so indulged in, and enforced. The counter- initiatory motion of "progress" and the adharmic thought called "liberation" in its various forms. The monsters he would be up against are feminism, homosexual "rights", etc. And these could be personified with great villainous beasts that maintain their existence by the psychic vampirism of their hosts, that being the special interest group that it feeds upon, and these are all merely pawns used by the ultimate dark lord whose goal is global empire, and his magick is "sin"-ema, and television, etc.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 13:57 said:

A collaborative effort would be good.

scardanelli on 2013-03-18 at 14:58 said:

I think that it would be useful to remember Tolkien's distaste for allegory here. His writings are true creation, or subcreation in his words, and do not necessarily symbolize or personify

anything. His main concern was to create a truly moving work of art. To me, it seems somewhat akin to Tomberg's description of sacred magic... to create something and project it into the world and which consists of a unity between one's will and the divine will.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 15:07 said:

Yes. However these anti- traditional movements are beasts that exist on the energy of the people involved in them, and are ultimately tied to the agenda of mono-cultural globalism, which are run by black magicians, who use spells through the media. The media is black magick, that conforms most people to the agenda that it promotes. And it would be a useful way to show the inherent lower nature of these ideas that are promoted by these agents, and activists.

Thorsten on 2013-03-18 at 17:13 said:

True enough. Tolkien did profess distaste for allegory on more than one occasion, particularly when some suggested outright, and simple-minded equivalences with historical or contemporary developments (e.g. between Saruman and Hitler, or the orcs and German troops). It goes without saying that Tolkien was operating on an much more profound level than something so cheap and superficial as that. However the point I make is that Tolkien did (as can easily be verified with many many examples) use real world languages, proper names from real world history, etc as stand ins for the "actual" languages, proper names etc. of Middle Earth. This was done because he reckoned it would carry greater evocative power for his readers than would the use of the constructed ones. Tolkien said plainly that the use of Old English for the language of the Rohirrim was a surrogate for the real language of Rohirric. Old English and Old English names were felt to carry much of the same character, and to express the spirit or inner nature of the Rohirrim. Analogous equivalences abound, such as the use of Hobbit for khu-dukan etc.

So the use of Proto-Germanic in that phrase has some significance. It may be a subtle one, perhaps even relatively insignificant in the grand scheme of the narrative, but nonetheless no accident.

I didn't mean to dwell on this aspect more than is called for (for now anyway) but being a lover of language myself my mind immediately homes in on these things and am aware of how important languages were to Tolkien for their ability to suggest the world-view of a particular "race" and the like.

Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-18 at 18:22 said:

oops. I thought you were replying to me. Sometimes its hard to tell exactly what's going on with the phone view.

Logres on 2013-03-24 at 06:31 said:

I meant to link to this wonderful post:

<http://failedhermit.blogspot.com/2012/12/catholic-poem-in-time-of-war.html>

1.45 Putting a Rose Back on the Cross

Cologero has been very generous in allowing many of us to write on Gornahoor.

For that reason, I've sometimes repaid him by not posting anything, when I was sure I had nothing important or clear to say.

I am ending the series on Iamblichus; the reader will have to write his own recapitulation, or Decad. I am not certain where I will go from here, but have purposed not to write "for the sake of writing".

There are a couple of thoughts, I think, worth re-visiting, concerning Christian esotericism.

1. Many of the texts seem to focus on obtaining the virtues. Is this because Christianity is lost in the "lesser mysteries" of obtaining back primordial man? I am inclined not to think so. Whereas much neo-pagan initiation seems to center around an "experience" or a realization, Christian practice (or those influenced by it) invariably focus on acquiring concrete moral virtues. These concrete moral virtues are meant to lead to higher angelic states, symbolized in the theological virtues.

2. This contrast is even seen with one of the grandest Stoics, Epictetus.³⁰⁹ There is nothing but good to say of this man, but when all is said and done, he is not the same figure as the Apostle Paul: he does not present us with the theological virtues. This is not his fault, nor even a fault. It is simply an observation.

3. In the Romance of the Rose³¹⁰, we are presented with a garden

³⁰⁹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Epictetus>

³¹⁰http://www.legends-and-myths.com/40_2.cfm?i=1001-legends-myths-initiation-romance-rose

whose wall is guarded by several figures representing Envy, Sorrow, Poverty, etc., which the inquirer must “pass” or eschew in order to enter into the garden. Or do these disfigurements (in another sense) actually function as guardians? In any case, it is hard to miss the parallel with the Seven Deadly Sins. Again, Christianity is definitely aimed at conquering manifested sins in a manifested way; it is a religion of Incarnation.

4. While it thus (granted) appeals to those at the lowest level intellectually, it maintains higher links capable of being articulated within the most subtle and refined cosmologies or metaphysics. I have already in the past endeavored to link Steiner’s work on the Seven Steps of Christianity³¹¹ with a passage from Saint Peter, and indirectly, the Sermon on the Mount. Granted (again), this is cosmology or hermeticism, which as Guenon points out, is not a complete metaphysic, and we follow Guenon on that point. Part of the reason Christianity is hard to define is that it can fit various metaphysics.

5. Where does this leave the esoteric Christian, or the Christian who wants to be faithful to his tradition (and thereby, to God), but go beyond the low and easily distorted spirituality which passes for currency in today’s world of cheap grace? Guenon even argues that the Rosicrucian tradition (a hermetic one, and so incomplete, devoted to the lesser mysteries) has passed into desuetude. Charles Upton makes the same claim regarding the neopagan mystery school of Iamblichus. A great deal has been “lost”. But is it really lost? Is it really embedded in Time in such a fashion that it is incapable of rekindling embers and starting a new fire? We think not.

6. This leaves the task of our day; as Cologero put it, we should not sit around waiting for George to do it. On the contrary, we are not wine-snobs and connoisseurs waiting to be fed – our job is to begin to prepare the meal, if we want to eat.

7. We can always start with attention to our thought and our moti-

³¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2880>

vations and thereby, to the deepest wellsprings of our actions, whether spiritual or physical. A resurgent body of Christian esotericism no longer has to contend with infra-Church bodies of Inquisitors, political machinations of suspicious kings, or a host of other difficulties encountered during the Middle Ages (which, all in all, were a better time). We also have more information and resources, of a kind, at our disposal. In this area, at least, much will be required of us. Then, perhaps as Cologero has said, if we prepare these lesser things, and do our homework, the greater mystery of what spark will rekindle the flames will be revealed. In any case, it is undoubtedly still alive – what would the “Wise Men” of today do to experience the birth of the Christ-child, but look to the sign of the Eagle and the Cross? Then, perhaps, we will regain the Rose.

8. As a personal postscript, I do think Charles Williams must have had some knowledge, however fragmentary, of what we seek here — his writings center around too many hermetic themes. Even his interest in Dante is remarkable. Coupled with his early (relatively) death, he is a “person of interest” to me.

Posted on 2013-04-19 by Logres

* * *

George on 2013-04-19 at 22:43 said:

Thank you Logres. I find your posts very interesting and helpful.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-04-20 at 05:28 said:

I too really enjoyed your writings, and hope to see your writings again soon.

God bless.

David on 2013-04-20 at 09:23 said:

Very interesting. As you say, we must be ever vigilant and responsible, just as the parables of Mt 25. This particular sentence was very inspiring : «Again, Christianity is definitely aimed at conquering manifested sins in a manifested way; it is a religion of Incarnation». Thank you for your writings.

George on 2013-04-20 at 16:47 said:

Would it be possible to create a "lesson plan" for studying Christian esoterism, with levels of reading from beginning through advanced? I think this could help some uneducated folks (like myself).

George on 2013-04-20 at 19:46 said:

Would any recommend "Guenonian Esoterism And Christian Mystery"?

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-04-20 at 19:54 said:

George, I would highly recommend "Meditations on the Tarot: A Journey Into Christian Hermeticism" a most excellent book for beginner and master alike. Also study Arthuriana deeply. In a way at this time the Christian Hermetic mystic has to forge a path, luckily I have experience in the Golden Dawn and OTO. They helped greatly in my quest however I would tell the neophyte to avoid those now and focus on Christian mysteries.

Look into Angelology, and just do internet searches for Christian Hermetica, etc. But really "Meditations" is an excellent start.

Logres on 2013-04-20 at 22:04 said:

I can't comment on the book, but Jean Borella seems fairly sound (I have only read one of his works). He is of interest, if for no other reason, because he is a theologian in the Church who seems to have taken Guenon very seriously. Others, like F. Seraphim Rose, freely admit their debt, but "moved on" afterwards. Any Christian who wants to grow in their faith, and is interested in traditional teaching should probably read this or books like them. George Heart's work on Gnosis is very good – Cologero recommended that one.

<http://www.amazon.com/Christianity-Dogmatic-Gnostic-Vivifying-Knowledge/dp/1412062284>

Robin Amis has done some work on Christian esotericism.

<http://praxisresearch.net/>

He even has a website. I tried to put together such a primer, but I don't trust my judgement enough yet. There has been a lot of criticism (see the Forum) directed at people like James Cutsinger and others who (at first glance) seem to be paralleling "the Faith" with some kind of overarching Tradition with a capital T. Since I believe in a God simultaneously man and yet God, three and yet One, it doesn't bother me to think that there is salvation outside of "the Faith": the Faith remains the Faith.

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/James_Cutsinger

All Tradition is under attack today – that's why they call it the Kali Yuga. We see how "traditional" Islam is now having suicide bombers carry out their attacks on civilians. So everything

that can be subverted, will be. What might be helpful is to aid one another in studying various branches of Tradition that individuals can “see” where to fit within the Faith, without dilution or compromise. This is a difficult task; but what else does “every thought captive to Christ” entail? Mihai is working on this, by the way. Father Thaddeus’ little book on Thoughts, or “Unseen Warfare” by Scupoli are good places to start. I think we will have to go back to spiritual fundamentals, in order to get anywhere recovering (for example) the Rosicrucian initiation (which supposedly derived from Apostle Mark’s conversion of some Egyptian theurgists). If the research is done with enough right reason and honesty, and spiritual fundamentals like humility and vigilance are practiced, a primer could be done. Perhaps that should be attempted.

Logres on 2013-04-20 at 22:08 said:

Agree wholeheartedly with the advice given by J Maximillian. I almost went down a dangerous path, had Cologero not recommended Meditations. Definitely read this, and see Cologero’s website for excerpts. The beauty of Christianity is that rapid progress can be made through humility and charity: it’s important to remember that our interest in Tradition be incidental, and entirely subordinate to God. Otherwise, we risk falling into “magic”, the opposite of Tassawuf (as the Sufis would say – credit to Charles Upton on these observations). At least for the Christian, who is without excuse in these matters.

And thanks to everyone for commenting.

Cassiodorus on 2013-04-21 at 22:57 said:

Yes. But, I must say that it was slow going for me to absorb.

I would also recommend Wolfgang Smith’s “Christian Gnosis” who offers some interesting views on the relationship of Trinitarian theology and Perennialist metaphysics.

A much easier introductory work that I thought was quite good would be Richard Smoley’s “Inner Christianity: A Guide to the Esoteric Tradition”.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-22 at 12:04 said:

What is your opinion on Arthur Edward Waite ?

Borella is one of the best. Tomberg is great as well. Also I can recommend Eliphas Levi, a real Catholic Cabalist.

Three Ages of the Interior Life by Father Gerrigou-Lagrange is a good primer on mystical theology.

Try to read up on antique and mediaeval philosophy first though – Plato, Aristotle, Plotinius, St Dionysius, St Augustine, St Boethius, St Thomas Aquinas, St Bonaventura, Meister Eckhart, St John of the Cross etc etc etc

1.46 Finishing What the Inklings Started

Given the level of interest in Christian circles in the Inklings, as well as the responsive reading of articles on Tolkien or Lewis at this site, it might be helpful to pinpoint what the perennial appeal of the Inklings is, wherein the power lies, and how one might recover and extend it.

Lewis makes no bones about his debt to George MacDonald: “I fancy there is not a single work in which I did not quote from him”. Lewis claimed that the reading of *Phantastes*³¹² and *Lilith*³¹³ “baptized” his imagination, which lay dormant until his reasoning faculty “caught up” to the baptism many years later, and he found out that MacDonald had been telling him the same thing the whole time.

Through MacDonald, Madeline L’Engle and Dorothy Sayers³¹⁴ (who promoted the revival of Trivium from the Middle Ages) also came under the influence of the spirit which animated the Inklings. Mihai has addressed how the imagination can lead one astray³¹⁵ in the religion life; it can also be put into the service of the Truth, much as Scholasticism (which Tomberg praises on this score) put Reason in the service of the faith, until William of Ockham and Jean Buridan³¹⁶ and Duns Scotus and others abandoned their sources and created nominalism³¹⁷.

This was the unique project of the Inklings; Cologero has remarked how poetry, myth, and legend is the main popular manner of transmitting Tradition exoterically to the masses (and here, we may note Matthew Arnold’s insistence that religion and poetry are more akin than one might suspect). So we may see the Inklings as attempting to extend Christian mytho-poesis to the masses through something akin to religion, but dif-

³¹²<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phantastes>

³¹³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lilith_%28novel%29

³¹⁴<http://www.patheos.com/blogs/scriptorium/2011/10/7482/>

³¹⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6278>

³¹⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Buridan

³¹⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3468>

ferent, both in focus (the Imagination) and vehicle (mythopoetic truth). This is the basis of their perennial appeal and power.

It should be unnecessary to remark that Tolkien falls from a different spiritual heredity, through the Catholic Church, but that he was linked to the other Inklings by a kindred and worshipful fascination with things “Northern”. Charles Williams, of course, came to the Inklings via the Masonic and Rosicrucian orders; however, he too knew George MacDonald’s work³¹⁸. It is fair also to say that all of them, more or less, were drawn towards Dante, and this is not accidental.

Both Dante and MacDonald would have rejected modern “Science’s” claim to arbitrate truths of Reason, let alone Spirit:

“Scientists/witches like Watho attempt to know nature, but are in error: “human science is but the backward undoing of the tapestry-web of God’s science” (2, 236). MacDonald does not contradict science, nor does he press a theistic interpretation onto his readers. In fact, allegorising too would come close to an “undoing the tapestry” which would be quite alien to MacDonald. Rather he replaces anthropocentric science with an ecological perspective in which nature and its “sympathetic forms” come first, whether religious/fantastic or scientific/rational.” This is John Pridmore³¹⁹ commenting on MacDonald’s fairy tales. The discourse which thus speaks of nature has its own authenticity and autonomy—The theistic and non-theistic accounts of nature are neither incompatible nor is the one to be reduced to the other.” This is not synthesis or dichotomy. “Instead MacDonald’s art is to present nature in a natural form, that is, in the form of the fairy tale. The cut-up, labelled, specimen means nothing; the flower is everything: “To know a primrose is a higher thing than to know all the botany of it”.

³¹⁸<http://georgemacdonald.info/williams.html>

³¹⁹http://www.snc.edu/english/documents/North_Wind/By_genre_or_topic/Nature_and_Ecology/Nature_and_Fantasy_-_John_Pridmore.pdf

Unspoken Sermons

Why compare George MacDonald and Dante? Besides the fact that MacDonald lived a hard life and resembled a Russian *staretz*, and leaving out the fact that MacDonald was not an initiate, nor did he possess a great style (as Dante did), MacDonald was known to have read Church patristics, from which he derived a great deal of his imaginative and intellectual freedom from the rough-hewn Scottish Calvinism around him. His writings, moreover, are told primarily to embody moral truths: that is, he aims to make the Good appear more Beautiful. I have pointed out elsewhere a rather strange link in time and space³²⁰ with an Indian Sikh and preacher, which is of interest in terms of “passing the flame”.

George MacDonald was the seminal influence (spiritually) upon most of the Inklings (although it could be said that Tolkien added something different and also better to this union). The Inklings in large part existed because of the life of denial and enchantment with “baptizing the imagination” which he initiated, without the advantages of secret doctrine or formal initiation, and really only a few old books of theology and the example of his living father to point him in the right direction. However, like Dante, he endeavored to educate the reader towards that which was Holy, to make the Good attractive, new, strange, and overpowering. He was a spiritual teacher first, a man of letters accidentally.

Lewis formally (and unfortunately) rejected Tradition (as Gornahoor has established³²¹). Nevertheless, this was not as true for either Tolkien or Williams, which accounts for Lewis’ strange affinities for both, which pulled him in different directions (due to Williams’ unorthodox spiritual ancestry). Williams’ early death and the war, as well as Lewis’ marriage, and various other events, broke up the Inklings fellowship.

³²⁰http://www.george-macdonald.com/resources/sundar_singh.html

³²¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=the-discarded-image>

In Lewis' later work, *Till We Have Faces*³²², there is a marked return to mythology and deeper spiritual import. I have not read *Leaf by Niggle*³²³, but this later work of Tolkien is also more explicitly personal and also more explicitly mythopoeic, in the sense that it virtually claims that the Imagination, if saved, can be shown to have a place in the economy of heaven that is intimately linked to the true heart's desire.

Why have modern day Christians confined themselves to a kind of fundamentalistic admiration for the "fantasy" element within the Inklings work, almost completely ignoring the actual sources and spiritual import of the Inklings at their most complex? This is despite the fact that, in the Inklings, they do not have to contend with esoteric doctrine, except a kind of careful employment of it in some of William's work.

This kind of avoidance indicates an almost pathological ignorance of spiritual depth. The reality is that the mission and purpose of the Inklings went far beyond what was actually manifested, and indeed, could be revived. Let us hope that men of Tradition, and Christians if possible, undertake this work, because the implications of their most mature thinking and art carry them far beyond even the fantastic shores they undoubtedly discovered.

Honoring our ancestors would undoubtedly include faithfully differing from them in light of Tradition (MacDonald was practically cut off from it, and yet managed to discover enough to ignite the only revival of Christian letters England has known), and yet laying claim and extending whatever is consistent with Tradition in them.

This time around, those doing this would be armed with real Tradition. And what might Imagination in the service of Tradition look like?

Future posts will aim to demonstrate the truth of these claims concretely, and offer suggestions for carrying on the work of the Inklings.

Posted on 2013-04-26 by Logres

³²²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Till_We_Have_Faces

³²³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Leaf_by_Niggle

* * *

David on 2013-04-27 at 20:40 said:

This is very interesting, thank you. When you look into the works of such as Dumézil or Lévi-Strauss on mythology, you indeed find out that the structure (and purpose?) of poetry is that of symbolism and religion. For the ancients, everything was interconnected; just as playing was a mode of learning both concrete and moral truth; just as war was an exterior and interior fighting, etc. Poetry was on par with traditional passing of truths. Because in the end, it's about Truth, and that Truth doesn't have to be bound to ONE book; there is always retelling and reinterpretation.

1.47 Poets of the Reunion

Here is Chesterton³²⁴:

The originality of George MacDonald has also a historical significance, which perhaps can best be estimated by comparing him with his great countryman Carlyle. It is a measure of the very real power and even popularity of Puritanism in Scotland that Carlyle never lost the Puritan mood even when he lost the whole of the Puritan theology. If an escape from the bias of environment be the test of originality, Carlyle never completely escaped, and George MacDonald did. He evolved out of his own mystical meditations a complete alternative theology leading to a completely contrary mood. And in those mystical meditations he learned secrets far beyond the mere extension of Puritan indignation to ethics and politics. For in the real genius of Carlyle there was a touch of the bully, and wherever there is an element of bullying there is an element of platitude, of reiteration and repeated orders. Carlyle could never have said anything so subtle and simple as MacDonald's saying that God is easy to please and hard to satisfy. Carlyle was too obviously occupied with insisting that God

³²⁴<http://www.chesterton.org/discover-chesterton/selected-works/the-critic/george-macdonald/>

was hard to satisfy; just as some optimists are doubtless too much occupied with insisting that He is easy to please. In other words, MacDonald had made for himself a sort of spiritual environment, a space and transparency of mystical light, which was quite exceptional in his national and denominational environment. He said things that were like the Cavalier mystics, like the Catholic saints, sometimes perhaps like the Platonists or the Swedenborgians, but not in the least like the Calvinists, even as Calvinism remained in a man like Carlyle. And when he comes to be more carefully studied as a mystic, as I think he will be when people discover the possibility of collecting jewels scattered in a rather irregular setting, it will be found, I fancy, that he stands for a rather important turning-point in the history of Christendom, as representing the particular Christian nation of the Scots. As Protestants speak of the morning stars of the Reformation, we may be allowed to note such names here and there as morning stars of the Reunion.

Now what interests us here is not the “alternative” dimensions of MacDonald’s theology which in any case were “alternative” relative to Calvinism, but rather the extent to which he rediscovered the Tradition on his own. Take his *Phantastes*, for instance, the volume which yelled at Lewis in the bookstall, until he purchased it and had his imagination baptized.

Phantastes has a decidedly “romantic” theme, in that a man is baptized Anodos by a bequest from his dead father and his fey grandmother, and sent into Faerie Land in quest of “he knows not what”. This takes a turn toward the “eternal feminine”, as various female figures either protect or assault him in his progress on the way, in which he meets a knight with rust-colored armor, who warns him against the a particular lady. Indeed, MacDonald seems to have entirely spiritualized the erotic in this fantasy; we would not follow the modern turn in seeing this as merely an underhanded sublimation, but would rather point towards (say) Mouravieff’s doctrine of “polar beings”.

Among other remarks, MacDonald has his character wonder aloud if “all men have souls”. At one point in the story, Anodos goes to the “Church of Darkness” where the ogress is reading the Scripture, explaining how darkness is not merely coeval, but dominant, over Light. It is there that he finds his shadow, which attaches itself to him, and renders him incapable of rightly discerning Faerie Land.

So, then, as darkness had no beginning, neither will it ever have an end. So, then, it is eternal. The negation of aught else, is its affirmation. Where the light cannot come, there abideth darkness. The light doth but hollow a mine out of the infinite extension of darkness. And ever upon the steps of light treadeth the darkness; yea, springeth in fountains and wells amidst it, from the secret channels of its mighty sea. Truly, man is but a passing flame, moving unquietly amid the surrounding rest of night; without which he yet could not be, and whereof he is in part compounded.

Here is one critic who attempts³²⁵ to point out in what way *Phantastes* falls short (not merely artistically but poetically) of Dante’s masterpiece. Of this “falling short” there is of course no question.

Again, what interests us is how MacDonald was able to work out some of these moral or spiritual truths about the Self on his own. We know that he read Novalis, for instance, and some of the Church Fathers, such as Saint Gregory of Nyssa. In *Phantastes*, he mentions Cornelius Agrippa and Albertus Magnus in a short story within the story about magic, in which (interestingly enough) he suggests that Love is always more powerful than magic, and that all magic of the operative sort meant by the word nowadays implies a sort of danger or risk to the practitioner.

What does he propose for us? MacDonald attempted to make the Good both real and beautiful, which is to say, alluring. However, rather

³²⁵http://www.snc.edu/northwind/documents/By_work/Phantastes/A_Note_on_the_Structure_and_Conclusion_of_Phantastes_-_John_Docherty.pdf

than paint in the lurid colors of esoteric magic, he spoke in the fairy tale. It is in the medium of poetry and fable and “mythopoeia” that such deep truths can be safely and innocently communicated, particularly to modern man, who is “lost” to direct routes back to God. And this is what makes the Inkling project memorable: that MacDonald began the effort to rebaptize one faculty of man (Imagination) in an attempt to hallow what has so often been a source of evil and seduction, and thereby cause man to “forget his forgetting” and to remember the primordial Beauty from which he sprung.

More excerpts from MacDonald’s work, and a closer investigation into the mechanics of his project, as well as closer correlation with Tradition, are to follow, but we may take the following as the germ of his philosophy:

All that man sees has to do with man. Worlds cannot be without an intermundane relationship. The community of the centre of all creation suggests an interradiating connection and dependence of the parts.

Posted on 2013-05-03 by Logres

1.48 A Higher Imagination

Typically, as Mihai has pointed out, the imagination functions to degrade man. It offers him pornography, violence, and all other species of lust: a 24/7 cinema strip of running images. If it’s not doing this, it’s running narcissistic movie clips of nonstop happy endings for the engrossed slave, who lives in the Matrix and desires to conform to his own ignorance and those around him.

Every so often, writers come along who seem to break free from this, and challenge our perceptions. This can occur in either direction. Obviously, Lucifer “imagined” a world in which God was irrelevant and

distant, a “sub-creation” that was independent of God’s kingdom. The Left has made great use of such imaginary images and art, which it terms “higher” in relation to the ordinary mechanical cinema that runs in men’s head: artists like Bunuel³²⁶ have attacked the Church with brilliant subtlety and abandon. This is “higher”, but only in relation to the degradation previously induced by Leftist “ideals”. So it is a carrot-and-stick ploy: man is driven by lusts, and lead on by illusions.

Sometimes (however) the writers challenging our perceptions happen to be operating from a magnetized or sanctified area of their own personality. It is the Inklings who were the true “rebels” towards the System, not the Surrealists or Existentialists or Dadaists, given that the “System” is not even what it is portrayed to be. They proposed that a portion of man’s personality could be elevated in such a way that it would “drag” other portions of that personality behind it.

Is this an “un-traditional” Idea? We do not think so: Mouravieff in Gnosis suggests that any portion of man can be magnetized and provide a “core” which then magnetizes the rest of his personality. Furthermore, various physical and national races have various “make-ups” – the Anglo-Saxon, one, for instance is relatively balanced and placid, whereas the Slavic personality is not. This probably explains the Anglo-Saxon capability for “watering down” his religion to the lowest common denominator, a fact that made him uniquely suited to further the Kali Yuga through Anglo Empire. The German and the Slav would have made a harder choice.

There is a specific example of the doctrine of polar beings which occurs in *Phantastes*, which we will excerpt partially and summarize, along with other passages, next week. How did MacDonald know to have Sir Anodos learn love by being willing to lay down his desire for the white lady because “she belongs to another, better man”? By pure intuition?

³²⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Luis_Bu%C3%Bluel

Posted on 2013-05-18 by Logres

* * *

Scardanelli on 2013-05-18 at 11:16 said:

Thank you for these posts Logres, they're always insightful and I appreciate them. I'll have to read up on MacDonald in anticipation of your

William Zeitler on 2013-05-18 at 12:25 said:

There's nothing like actually reading the man. Phantastes and quite a number of his other books are free for Kindle. I got the complete works for \$2.99. Been working through them waiting for the subway, etc. He definitely has an elevating effect I have not experienced with other authors (even C.S.Lewis).

Lemonheadz on 2013-05-18 at 13:05 said:

"Is this an "un-traditional" Idea? We do not think so: Mouravieff in Gnosis suggests that any portion of man can be magnetized and provide a "core" which then magnetizes the rest of his personality."

What exactly is "traditional" about Mouravieff?

Logres on 2013-05-18 at 21:47 said:

1. Doctrine of Unity
 2. Praxis of Awakening
 3. Subtlety of analysis
 4. Comprehensive theory explanatory of more spiritual "facts"
 5. Doctrine of angelic/demonic hierarchies
 6. Esoteric Christian core
 7. Breathing exercises/yogic techniques/exercises of prayer
 8. Mathematical expression
- There is more.

Logres on 2013-05-18 at 21:49 said:

Mouravieff expressly states he writes for the modern man – that is, he writes to reach him where he is capable of being reached; this perhaps gives a certain flavor which is unpalatable to those used to reading ancient texts (which Mouravieff includes), Guenon & company, and other sources. He writes expressly to convince in a practical way, modern man (that is, it is not merely rhetorical).

Logres on 2013-05-18 at 21:50 said:

Thank you both (Scardanelli): I hope to be very precise and also original in going through portions of MacDonald and even Lewis (on the Anti-Christ).

1.49 Phantastes

It must be said (for subscribers to the *Sintesi*) that the Inkling project manifests a decidedly “Dionysian” accent: that is, it is the spiritual striving of those who do not possess the Truth innately, but are able to aspire, yearn, and perhaps awaken to that Truth through art and particularly the vegetative mystery rites which survive in the Dionysian mysteries.

The other characteristic of solarly is that of a light that arises and fades, that it has death and resurrection and a new death and a new dawn and, in other words, a law of becoming and self-transformation. This is Dionysian solarly as opposed to the Apollonian principle. It is a virility that aspires to the light through a passion that cannot free itself from the sensual and telluric element and even from the ecstatic-orgiastic element typical of the lowest forms of the Demeterian cycle. The association, in myth and symbol, of feminine and lunar figures to Dionysius is, in this regard, rather significant. Dionysius does not accomplish the transition, the change of nature. It is a still earth-bound virility in spite of its luminous and ecstatic nature. The fact that the Dionysian and bacchanal mysteries were associated with the demeterean mystery, instead of with the purely Apollonian mystery, clearly indicates to us the final point of the Dionysian experience: it is a “dying and becoming” in the sign not of the infinite which is above form and the finite, but of that infinite that is fulfilled and delights of itself in the destruction of form and the finite, harking back therefore to the forms of telluric-demeterean promiscuity...

JI Packer, a Protestant theologian, remarks somewhere that the Celt manifests a deeper apprehension of spiritual realities than their Anglo-Saxon counterparts, which is borne out in the history of Puritan theology (think John Owens). Indeed, Evola cites the Celt as specifically prone to the matriarchal side of spirituality, and therefore, the Dionysian path may represent the closest collective approach such a spirituality can make to Tradition. So, when we praise the Inklings, please keep in mind that their approach is in some ways indirect – Williams, Barfield, Lewis, and MacDonald were all to some degree Celts. Everyone but Tolkien, who of course had a Catholic or more Roman approach to spiritual matters.

Mouraviëff comments on racial differences in *Gnosis*: the Russian (for instance) often has two magnetic poles in his personality, which stymie each other. Since Dionysian striving represents a common situation for the aspiring–noble, modern man of the 19th and 20th century, Mouraviëff attempts to explain Tradition as if speaking to Dionysius; that is, he tries to strengthen the longing, and to properly diagnose the poles within the seeker, so as to enable magnetization.

This is precisely what the Inklings, and more specifically MacDonald, are doing in their fiction.

Here is MacDonald on self-knowledge, or introspection:

Afterwards I learned, that the best way to manage some kinds of painful thoughts, is to dare them to do their worst; to let them lie and gnaw at your heart till they are tired, and you find you still have a residue of life they cannot kill.

Renunciation:

Joy cannot unfold the deepest truth, although deepest truth must be deepest joy. I wished to be... no longer a man beside myself.

Evil:

... I was almost glad that I had sinned...

Death:

“The hot fever of life had gone by, and I breathed the clear mountain-air of the land of Death. I had never dreamed of such blessedness. ... I lay thus for a time, and lived as it were an unradiating existence; my soul a motionless lake, that received all things and gave nothing back; satisfied in still contemplation, and spiritual consciousness.

Phantastes, 314

Thus I, who set out to find my Ideal, came back rejoicing that I had lost my Shadow. If my passions were dead, the souls of the passions, those essential mysteries of the spirit which had embodied themselves in the passions, and had given to them all their glory and wonderment, yet lived, yet glowed, with a pure undying fire. They rose above their vanishing earthly garments, and disclosed themselves angels of light. But oh, how beautiful beyond the old form!

Phantastes, 314-15

Sin:

Alas, how easily things go wrong! A sigh too much, or a kiss too long, And there follows a mist and a weeping rain. And life is never the same again. (235)³²⁷

Owen Barfield points out that MacDonald is allusive, **but not elusive – he puts his finger on the truth and does not merely have an “inkling” but speaks whereof he knows:**

³²⁷http://www.snc.edu/northwind/documents/By_work/Phantastes/The_Sources_of_Phantastes_-_John_Docherty.pdf

Is there not in this poem a certainty, a grounded knowledge? It is not content to stop in imagination and hint and suggestion. One feels that its meaning, its openly expressed meaning, reaches right down into the solid earth and right up into the empyrean. It is the resurrection of the body—in terms of the body.

Just because MacDonald focuses upon the *Phantastes* or feelings does not entail a neglect of will and thought:

Anodos is oblivious of any evil menacing *his* House of Alma, the “fairy palace.” However, this palace contains twelve halls of dancers/statues representing shades of feeling. (These twelve satellite halls reappear as the mood chambers of the wise woman in *The Lost Princess*.) Presumably it is because MacDonald is describing only the areas of life which are the concern of *Phantastes* that his fairy palace is solely a palace of the feelings. Anodos, however, does experience “wilful” aspects of feeling when he pursues the marble lady out of the palace, and “intellectual” aspects of feeling in the library of the palace.

In one of MacDonald’s letters to his wife, the melding of Christianity with vegetative rites becomes somewhat plainer, breaking out into the clear daylight of his prose:

Some of the dark closes & entries look most infernal, and in the dim light you could see something swarming, children or grown people perhaps, almost falling away from the outlined definiteness of the human, . . . Dearest, you must come here with me, you would be so interested. It is like no other place . . . You know Edinburgh is built very much up and down hill; and so in some places narrow closes, some so narrow that your little arms could touch both sides, run from top to bottom of the hill through these great, tall houses. Glancing down one of these I was arrested. It was Very narrow and went down, as if to Erebus, and suggested bad and

dangerous places, down into the unseen and unknown depths. But across the upper part was barred the liquid hues of the sunset, against which stood the far off hill with some church, tower or something of the sort in relief against the infinite clearness. . . . Dearest, I hope you will not be frightened tonight. God, the Sky God—the Green Earth God be with you, our own God, as David says.

Letter from MacDonald to his wife, 1855, in Sadler 87-88

MacDonald seems to be wrestling with reconciling the mystery religions with Christianity (female with male).³²⁸

Indeed, Anodos himself confesses this to be his own project during his sojourn through Faerie Land:

Perhaps, like a geologist, I was about to turn up to the light some of the buried strata of the human world, with its fossil remains charred by passion and petrified by tears...

I won't unveil every detail of the plot and structure of *Phantastes*, although in brief it is the story of a man's quest for the "White Lady" & his renunciation of her in favor of a "better man", partly due to the fact that the protagonist continually tries to "touch" or "hold" her prematurely, thus destroying the magic that is re-creating them both. Sir Anodos, in this story, is unable to distinguish between legitimate and auspicious impulses which lead to salvation, and those which lead to damnation (eg., the summoning of his shadow in the chapel of darkness with the ogress). It is a fugue or dream state: Sir Anodos acts on blind impulses, which are automatic – some are good, others are bad, although, the ending reveals

³²⁸http://www.snc.edu/northwind/documents/By_work/Phantastes/Chthonic_Aspects_of_Phantastes=From_the_Rising_of_the_Goddess_to_the_Anodos_of_Anodos_-_Fernando_Soto.pdf

that even the bad is the “shape which the Good was forced to assume” at that time and place to bring greatest help.

MacDonald’s world corresponds to a post-mortem state – the main character has “died” and is journeying through the intermediate worlds, looking for his polar being, and for heaven.

I do not think that the Inklings’ work is for every reader; some will be put off by the “childlike” qualities of Narnia, Middle Earth, or Faerie Land. However, I am maintaining (for all that) that what we have here is not ordinary children’s fantasy, but complex and spiritually subtle allegories which are meant to “land upon the precise and needed point” in order to generate spiritual change. That this change would occur in the Dionysian individual is another, less obvious point, which would explain why their work was largely rejected as the century wore on. Men increasingly dominated the landscape with a sub-Dionysian spiritual state.

What the Inklings are really doing is charting a course through “Fairie Land” (either in this life, or the next) which is valid for a certain kind of spirituality. As such, those individuals can and should read them to great advantage.

Posted on 2013-05-24 by Logres

* * *

Jacob on 2013-05-25 at 13:29 said:

Hi, I really enjoy reading your articles.

As I began reading *Phantastes*, I thought it at least in some ways reminiscent of Dante. Mainly because of the plot of chasing a hard to obtain lady through fantastical settings. Do you believe some of the difference between the inklings and say a writer with a better understanding of tradition like Dante could have to do with the influence of Steiner?

Also, where did your first quote come from?

Jason-Adam on 2013-05-25 at 15:29 said:

Crowley could also be perceived as a Dionysian ?

Logres on 2013-05-25 at 22:43 said:

Jason-Adam: qualified Yes; from what I know of Crowley, & without sitting in judgement on his soul (which the Church prays for), Crowley seems to present the challenge of someone who didn't want to save his soul, just his spirit. But I am not qualified to speak of Crowley, since I've only hearsay, plus the one essay on him by Evola here at Gornahoor's library. Still, there is a difference between someone who remembers the Sun during the night, and someone who attempts to make themselves burn as a Sun to the night itself.

Jacob: the first quote is from the Society of Independent's translation of Evola's *Sintesi*, done by Cologero. And, yes, Dante's grasp of Tradition/Truth seems stronger, and there is no doubt that Steiner is problematic in ways that Dante is not, although MacDonald came slightly before Steiner's career, in any case.

1.50 The Philokalia's Martial Character

What struck me on the beach—and it struck me indeed, so that I staggered as at a blow—was that if the Eternal Principle had rested in that curved thorn I had carried about my neck across so many leagues, and if it now rested in the new thorn (perhaps the same thorn) I had only now put there, then it might rest in everything, in every thorn in every bush, in every drop of water in the sea. The thorn was a sacred Claw because all thorns were sacred Claws; the sand in my boots was sacred sand because it came from a beach of sacred sand. The cenobites treasured up the relics of the sannyasins because the sannyasins had approached the Pancreator. But everything had approached and even touched the Pancreator, because everything had dropped from his hand. Everything was a relic. All the world was a relic. I drew off my boots, that had traveled with me so far, and threw them into the waves that I might not walk shod on holy ground.

GENE WOLF³²⁹, *Citadel of the Autarch*³³⁰

³²⁹http://www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/23069.Gene_Wolfe

³³⁰<http://www.depauw.edu/sfs/interviews/wolfe46interview.htm>

We've been given, as Christians, and have accepted, as fools, a very impoverished reading of Scripture, one in which Jesus emerges as someone so milquetoast³³¹ that He wouldn't dare overturn the money-changing temples and bureaucratic stalls of Liberalism or secular Democracy, could He by fickle mishap, arrive today. In a perverted sense, this is entirely true, for even this "phase" (degenerative as it may be), must exist entirely and utterly (though not *self-consciously*) of His will, alone. As Cologero points out, this period of chaos must have Laws which govern it as well, just ones we're not as used to noticing. Yet, when the man comes around³³², the rules will get a lot less murky, quickly. There's a huge difference between God in heaven giving man time, and God descending to sort it out.



As for these difficult-to-discern-patterns of the Kali Yuga, could it be that part of the reason the Bourgeois Period is still alive and kicking is that ignorant men, latently of the brahminic or warrior caste, deliberately and desperately support it, seeing quite clearly the huge gap between the Third Estate epoch & the epoch of the Shudra and the Outcast? After all, the merchant class is still "objective", at least; the Shudra is neither objective, nor free. Not seeing the huge gap between the Third Estate and that of their own (since it is unrealized), they volunteer to wage the struggle to stave off the tidal wave. This seems to be Mencius Moldbug's conclusion in this piece of punditry³³³, for instance:

Moreover, the fascist militarists who actually do this job are some

³³¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Caspar_Milquetoast

³³²<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k9IfHDI-2EA>

³³³<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2013/06/civil-liberties-and-single-reactionary.html>

of the best men in America. **American communism, for obvious reasons, loves to send America's best men to Afghanistan to get their private parts Osterized by fertilizer bombs.** This is American war since 1945: State solving the problem of how it can get DoD to stick its d— in a blender. Solving it rather well, I'd say. Many of America's best men are in the Pentagon, and good men know how to obey, and into the blender goes that d—. Still, much testicle remains.

How long will the warrior caste (even more so those imitating it, either out of malice or virtue) be content with propping up a “country” designed to make life easy for the worst specimens of humanity? Now extending its obligation³³⁴ (and therefore, its power) to the entire planet? We shall see – there are a lot of soldiers returning from the Middle East.

Also, it seems clear to me that the Spirit behind modern culture, for obvious reasons, wants to convince those who are formally, latently, or partially (if not truly) Good that Good and Evil are illusions, and that in the name of some catch-phrases like Equality & Tolerance, Life ought to be made easier for everyone, even those who really aren't aware of anything above them, even their conscience. Isn't this what Evil would say to Good? That in reality, the distance between us is an Illusion? Something Jesus said comes to mind:

And the lord commended the unjust steward, because he had done wisely: for the children of this world are in their generation wiser than the children of light.

LUKE 16:8

Could it be that the Revolutionaries have long known (better than most) that seeing into the Nature of man is pre-requisite to changing

³³⁴http://www.huffingtonpost.com/2013/06/28/obama-africa-hunger_n_3515684.html

things? Granted, they can only imagine that Good exists because of sluggish inertia, that it couldn't last, except as an inherited accretion and knee-jerk reflex (which of course, sees things backwards, given that most people engage in Evil for precisely this reason). But they have been adept³³⁵ at manipulating the remnants of the castes to achieve their end. Have you taken a literary criticism class, lately? All you read is literature of perversion and revolt. Take Sarah Kane³³⁶, for instance. Every effort is being made to extend the suffering of our "elites" through the "middle" and to unite that suffering with the lower castes. I saw a sign on a church recently which, against all odds, was actually apropos: "While we play Church, God's creation becomes more corrupt." The Bible Belt itself is not as well off³³⁷ as it appears.

What would a Frankish noble have done if confronted with the modern world? Undoubtedly, after a tour through both prison and mental health facilities, he would have emerged much wiser and more cautious of General Law³³⁸. He would (in fact) lay plans with a prudence and cunning that would complement his innate qualities, and guarantee a larger success in the long run. On the other hand, the qualities he has innately, I lack. What can I learn from him, and where can I learn it? *As noted above, there is the possibility of learning from our enemies, in that we see by negative example, how they employ means to ends and discern what is best for their kind.*

But there is much more for those who wish to transcend the purely Mephistophelean character of the clever Revolutionary, the spirit who negates³³⁹, the composting bacteria which works among those whose souls die before they ever learned they had them:

³³⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Frantz_Fanon

³³⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sarah_Kane

³³⁷<https://www.prbuzz.com/non-profit/70427-depression-and-pornography.html>

³³⁸<http://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=general-law>

³³⁹<http://www.pointandcircumference.com/macropoetics/Dante.htm>

With Faust, the Romantic rebellion breaks out in full force. At the outset, the poem promises to take the reader “from Heaven through the world to Hell.” Note the inverse direction. And still less than *Paradise Lost* does Faust portray a coherent universe. A scene in a student hangout, a seduction drama, the spectacles of the first and second Walpurgisnacht, Faust’s adventures as general, artist and civil-engineer-cum-dictator – all this does not add up to a comprehensive portrayal of human life. The flames of Hell, briefly glimpsed, are taken about as seriously as in a comic strip; while Heaven (complete with a “old guy” Deity at whom the urbane and sophisticated devil thumbs his nose) is but the self-serving reflection of a middle world where the amoral have their way. **Unlike Dante’s journey, Faust’s is the opposite of instructive.** At the end the hero has destroyed the world and learned nothing, the angels confuse his ruthlessness with aspiration; and the author himself seems to have *unlearned* whatever awareness of right and wrong he may have had at the outset. The final scene of Faust appears meant to contradict the scene at the summit of Purgatory where Beatrice insists on confronting Dante with his peccadilloes: “A high law of G-d would be broken if Lethe were passed and such food tasted without some toll of remorse that sheds tears.” Faust does not have to say he is sorry; enters heaven in the company of *unborn children*, consciousness and conscience are effaced. The Israeli scholar Rivkah Schechter is, I believe, right in seeing Faust as the prelude to Auschwitz.

Hence, we turn to very particular texts, spiritual and literary and political, to nourish the awareness which we lack, which we horn-swoggled ourselves out of by accepting the Devil’s food when we should have been vigilant.

Law: mechanism which should be used in whatever way will generate the preferred result. Old fashioned law did too much to protect individuals from the social will. the mediocratic model avoids

bourgeois notions such as principles or liberties. If the community believes someone should be punished, the legal system should not put obstacles in the way. The idea of providing protection for defendants from the state is no longer required, as modern state agents can be presumed to act on behalf of society rather than on behalf of an elite. **Mediocracy believes in having as many laws as possible, but enforcing them selectively. This provides maximum flexibility, since harassment can be targeted at appropriate individuals.**

FABIAN TASSANO, *Mediocracy*

Christ the King told Satan to “get thee behind me” during the Temptation, which was the rough equivalent of a medieval king saying “away with you, you varlet!”. Then, and only then, did angels minister to him. One of the traditional Christian’s first tasks will be to learn not to accept a part in the inverted medieval passion play of the Spirit of the Age, but rather to wrestle with the powers and principalities (within himself, foremost) and force them to play the role in his own mystery play. For those “waking up”, seemingly innocuous things take on spiritual significance. They “manifest”. Do we wish to become cardboard characters, doomed to fire, in his play, or force him to step into our own?

Isn’t this the root of the “difficulty with Christianity”? Is it what it appears to be? It may look milquetoast, but this is an illusion. The regal-warrior spirit is carefully hidden in plain sight. Christ becomes a King by rejecting the world, the flesh, and the devil, by repulsing Satan’s attempt to get him to play a part in a play in which his lines were penned by Satan. Isn’t this what the Revolutionary narrative is all about? We may not know all, or even much, but we know *enough*. Enough to begin to resist the temptation.

Spirituality such as found in the *Philokalia* nourished the spiritual life of the Eastern Empire, & from them, flowed westward, even if in-

directly³⁴⁰. The Franks gladly submitted to the High King of Heaven: Chlodovechus exclaimed “Oh, if I had been there with my Franks!”³⁴¹. It’s possible to view this as an aberration and twisting of Aryan spirituality. But then, what do you do with such organizations as this³⁴²? What about the Templars? Together, the Western tribes and the religion of Christianity created a fuller manifestation of Tradition (and corresponding higher aberrations, at times, when corrupt) than possible otherwise. *Corruptio optima pessimi*.

Here is practical advice from the *Philokalia* – it has the smell of authenticity, as it isn’t something one would “make up” on the spur of the moment. If one isn’t a Brahmin, then simply gain the appropriate insight and apply it to your own circumstances. For instance, knowing that some thoughts have a demonic origin is highly useful, no matter what caste you belong to. I think you will see that this corpus of spiritual teaching is anything but “sentimental” and “Semitic”. It is, in fact, triumphant and almost Promethean.

Similarly, anger, whether reasonable or unreasonable, obstructs our spiritual vision. Our incensive power can be used in a way that is according to nature only when turned against our own impassioned or self-indulgent thoughts. We must not therefore expend all our effort in bodily fasting; we must also give attention to our thoughts and to spiritual meditation, since otherwise we will not be able to advance to the heights of true purity and chastity.

If a man, still enmeshed in sin and anger, dares shamelessly to reach out for knowledge of divine things, or even to embark upon

³⁴⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Cloud_of_Unknowing

³⁴¹http://books.google.com/books?id=maMXAAAYAAJ&pg=PA11&lpg=PA11&dq=had+I+been+there+with+my+franks&source=bl&ots=s2TTKEM_i4&sig=2KwFfrp1sd3jJH0NKYTErse9aK4&hl=en&sa=X&ei=JFzMUfPuHcS1ygHmvIDABQ&ved=0CEUQ6AEwBA#v=onepage&q=had%20I%20been%20there%20with%20my%20franks&f=false

³⁴²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iron_Guard

immaterial prayer, he deserves the rebuke given by the Apostle; for it is dangerous for him to pray with head bare and uncovered. Such a soul, he says, ought to 'have a veil on her head because of the angels' (cf I Cor. 11:5-7), and to be clothed in due reverence and humility.

Blessed is the monk who regards every man as God after God.

There are times when the demons suggest thoughts to you and then urge you to rebut them with prayer; whereupon they withdraw of their own accord, so as to deceive you into imagining that you have begun to overcome such thoughts and to rout the demons.

You should be aware of this trick: at times the demons split into two groups; and when you call for help against one group, the other will come in the guise of angels and drive away the first, so that you are deceived into believing that they are truly angels.

When the intellect attains prayer that is pure and free from passion, the demons attack no longer with sinister thoughts but with thoughts of what is good. For they suggest to it an illusion of God's glory in a form pleasing to the senses, so as to make it think that it has realized the final aim of prayer. A man who possesses spiritual knowledge has said that this illusion results from the passion of self-esteem and from the demon's touch upon a certain area of the brain.

Know that the holy angels encourage us to pray and stand beside us, rejoicing and praying for us (cf Tobit 12:12). Therefore, if we are negligent and admit thoughts from the enemy, we greatly provoke the angels. For while they struggle hard on our behalf we do not even take the trouble to pray to God for ourselves, but we despise their services to us, and, abandoning their Lord and God, we consort with unclean demons.

One who has attained dispassion has not necessarily achieved pure prayer. For he may still be occupied with thoughts which, though dispassionate, distract him and keep him far from God.

Undistracted prayer is the highest intellection of the intellect.

The warfare between us and the demons is waged solely on account of spiritual prayer; for prayer is extremely hateful and offensive to them, whereas it leads us to salvation and peace.

When the intellect has been perfected, it unites wholly with God and is illumined by divine light, and the most hidden mysteries are revealed to it. Then it truly learns where wisdom and power lie... While it is still fighting against the passions it cannot as yet enjoy these things... But once the battle is over and it is found worthy of spiritual gifts, then it becomes wholly luminous, powerfully energized by grace and rooted in the contemplation of spiritual realities. A person in whom this happens is not attached to the things of this world but has passed from death to life.

Ironically, there is a “martial” quality about the *Philokalia*, which is consonant with the “marching character” of Christianity, itself a religion (in many ways) that was military. The Church, after all, was “militant”. If it was³⁴³ (perhaps dubitably) a religion of the lower castes, nevertheless, it should be remembered that it was through the Roman army & Constantine, ultimately, that the religion won its victory over those, like Julian the Apostate, who wished to endorse Iamblichus and the NeoPlatonists rather than a religion. Christianity “chose sides” because it has a martial quality. I think this is the way to “resolve” the debate with neo-pagans: the Vedantic wing of Christianity wasn’t strong enough to preclude an all-out war against all “paganism”, so perhaps this should be rectified.

Yet Christ is a King, not merely a high priest. And the King is not mocked; He is no sentimentalist, but like a detached general, he awaits the inevitable outcome of His warfare. The King is Dead. Long live the King. The King is Coming. Life itself, the King.

³⁴³<http://riversfromeden.wordpress.com/2012/04/20/christians-in-the-roman-army-countering-the-pacifist-narrative/>

We believe that we invent symbols. The truth is that they invent us; we are their creatures, shaped by their hard, defining edges. When soldiers take their oath they are given a coin, an asimi stamped with the profile of the Autarch. Their acceptance of that coin is their acceptance of the special duties and burdens of military life—they are soldiers from that moment, though they may know nothing of the management of arms. I did not know that then, but it is a profound mistake to believe that we must know of such things to be influenced by them, and in fact to believe so is to believe in the most debased and superstitious kind of magic. The would-be sorcerer alone has faith in the efficacy of pure knowledge; rational people know that things act of themselves or not at all.

GENE WOLFE³⁴⁴, *Shadow and Claw*³⁴⁵

The “Third Wave” of Christianity will come when Christians themselves reclaim their monarchic legacy, hidden in Scripture, of Christ as the prophet, priest, and king (warrior). If we apply the insights of the *Philokalia* quoted above, we would conclude that the history of the West has been a very careful, selective seducement of a predominantly warrior-religion, designed to “set it up” for a final illusion. That is, the glories of the Renaissance and the wonders of Science and the blessed peace of secular humanism are analogous to demonically-induced spiritual states designed to convince the one who undergoes them that they are “favored” and have reached “deliverance”. However, there is still a chance that the victory of Logos in the West can be redeemed. That is, instead of the Divine withdrawing back into the Divine, the human can be drawn up into God (the aim of Christian warfare, which approaches the passions with warfare in an attempt to “possess” them for God). This can only

³⁴⁴http://www.goodreads.com/author/show/23069.Gene_Wolfe

³⁴⁵<http://www.goodreads.com/work/quotes/40575>

happen if the West uses discernment to see that the Logos presented to it, of which it is most acutely aware, is to be sanctified to God & taken up.

Thus, Western Christians have to see, at one and the same time, both the limitations of its Tradition (a warrior-religion) and the timelessness of it (a true reflection of something Transcendent, which was worth defending, albeit with more wisdom). This will involve restoring the “Vedantic wing” of the Faith, which will include esoteric studies. All resurgencies, ill-fated or blessed, of Christianity have begun with the return to “Christ the King”.

Posted on 2013-07-05 by Logres

* * *

michel on 2013-07-06 at 10:39 said:

Yes! If only more elites were like you Logres, then the restoration greatly longed for might stand a chance. I pray that the vigor of your writing is reflected in your actions.

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-06 at 12:26 said:

This is amazing. I am inwardly in a similar state of being as Logres; independently I had come to the same conclusion myself that true, mediaeval Christianity was and is a militant, intolerant, warrior religion that gives to the man who follows it a high will to power and dominance, the ability to control his emotions, and a sense of community that gives the fight of our life meaning and purpose that transcends not only ourselves but all time and space... ..

Logres on 2013-07-06 at 22:14 said:

Thank you both for reading, although I am not one of the current elites (for which I begin to be more thankful, the more I learn). I wrote this partly because several readers last year had asked “what to do?”, wondering if Christianity had anything to offer. I think, after reading in the *Philokalia*, that it does, & have been pointed back to the theme of invisible warfare. Who would this NOT help? I am also glad that others perceive this too – which makes neo-pagan denial of Medieval tradition all the more... well, odd. Thank you for your prayers, Michael.

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-08 at 12:56 said:

Dear Logres,

may I ask do you have a personal regimen of spiritual practice ? I apologise if this sounds rude but as I see that we are similar minds though you seem to be of a higher level of development, I ask because I'd like to learn from you.

Also, have you read this book before ? It's Orthodox and ant-Catholic so I have some issues with it but all in all it makes a good defence of monarchy and the mediaeval Christian Tradition.

<http://www.romanitas.ru/eng/THE%20MYSTERY%20OF%20CHRISTIAN%20POWER.htm>

Lastly, in the past you've discussed Franz Bardon, would you recommend his books and exercises for someone looking for a transcendent experience ?

Logres on 2013-07-10 at 11:38 said:

Jason, I think "intolerant" here is certainly in the sense of the modern word. That is, Christianity has no room for any competing -isms, heresies, etc., and maintains a traditional character, period. It is not interested in accomodating anything at the cost of its principles, although it may stoop in charity, infinitely. And it would certainly resist (if it were strong) incursions from foreign bodies who were designing to feed off its corpse (eg., modern Islam, the full blown Reformation political movement, etc.).

1.51 Never the Twain Shall Meet

I chose to write on *The Dark Cloud of Unknowing* to illustrate something that is true that has been discussed here (that East & West are not divergent in Tradition). The author was an anonymous Englishman during the 14th century; ergo, a quintessential "Western" mystic on an isolated island in the West. It is unknown who he was, but it is thought he was in the East Midlands (based on his language). He came after Richard Rolle, and before Walter Hinton, and is roughly contingent with Julian of Norwich. On the Continent, during this time of the Hundred Years War & plague, the great German mystics also appeared. Europe was stirring with heresy, and the Reformation was not far off.

Romanides and Athanasios Bailey (whose Orla.Pubs is off the web now) maintain that the West lost the concept of "energetic" salvation;

that is, the West favored a juridical model in which God “reckoned” righteousness or (prior to the Reformation) “declared” or “atoned” man into righteousness. This is the “ransom” theory that developed from Anselm³⁴⁶. While we agree that certainly the deviations of Truth in the West have taken the form described by Romanides, we do not concur that the essence of Western Tradition is accurately described: the trend, perhaps, but not the essence or remnant (and there is always a remnant, Romanides should know this).

Specifically, the Frankish and Norman conquests of the West (followed by wars of conquest aimed at the Eastern Empire) are supposed to have caused the entire and widespread loss of genuine Christian understanding (and, given Eastern theology’s emphasis on right wisdom of God and categories of thought, any resultant vital Christianity). However, as we shall see, Western communions made use of negative theology, and were aware of the same dogmas which governed Eastern apophaticism, however much it may be granted that it received less emphasis the farther West one went. As one author points out, the more *cataphatic*³⁴⁷ Western theology has (as a safeguard against God-in-man’s-image) the idea that the Logos is the archetype of man’s Image. As an aside, I will note that the Eastern Church considers the 12th or 13th centuries an era in which sensual pleasure and softness enter the Western spirituality; the reply to this would be to note that while this is true, undoubtedly, it also came as part of the Troubadour movement, and could be viewed more positively (as Cologero has suggested) as a particular emphasis on Logos, peculiar to the West.

Additionally, John Scotus Erigena³⁴⁸ had translated Dionysius from Greek into Latin much, much earlier in the Isles, so the English had access to negative theology, which influenced the author of the *Dark Cloud*, and

³⁴⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Anselm_of_Canterbury

³⁴⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cataphatic_theology

³⁴⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johannes_Scotus_Eriugena

bore fruit in his treatise. It should be unnecessary to point out that the age of Cathedral building was founded on Dionysian theology, and had already taken shape³⁴⁹.

No one can think of God. Therefore it is my wish to leave everything that I can think of and choose for my love the thing that I cannot think. For while God may be loved but not thought. God can be taken and held by love but not by thought. Therefore though it is good at times to think of the kindness and worthiness of God in particular, and though this is a light and a part of contemplation, nevertheless, in this exercise, it must be cast down and covered over with a cloud of forgetting. You are to step above it stalwartly but lovingly, with a devout, pleasing, stirring of love and desire to pierce that darkness above you. You are to smite upon the thick cloud of unknowing with a sharp dart of longing love and do not cease no matter what happens. 6:130-131.

This, "For the love of Jesus is very well said." For in the love of Jesus there is your help. Love is so powerful that it makes everything one (common). Therefore love Jesus and everything that he has is yours. By his godhead he is the maker and giver of time. By his humanity he is the very keeper of time. And by his Godhead and humanity together he is the truest guide of the choice and use of time. Knit yourself then to him by love and by faith. And by virtue of that knot you shall be a familiar partner with him and with all who are so knitted to him by love... 4:366-373. The example of all this is shown in the life of Christ. PC23:24.170 Mary models the way of contemplative prayer. So she hung her love and her longing desire in this cloud of unknowing, and learned to love what she could not see clearly in this life by the light of understanding in her reason, nor truly feel in the sweetness of love in her affection; so much so that she paid little attention to whether she had been a sinner or not. Yes! And so often I think that she

³⁴⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abbot_Suger

was so deeply affected in the love of the Godhead that she scarcely noticed the beauty of his precious and blessed body as he sat so handsomely speaking and teaching before her. It seems from the gospel that she was oblivious to anything else either bodily or spiritual. XVI: 834-842

The author makes the same energy/essence distinction that the Eastern Church makes: we never become God by nature, but only by grace. Rather than “the Jesus prayer”, we instead have this:

Schort preier peersith heven.

(This, by the way, would even find an echo in the Puritan theology of “Heaven Taken by Storm”). The use of one syllable words like “God” or “Love” are recommended for unceasing prayer, which builds on confession and regular meditation on revealed mysteries.

It is preferable to meditate on God’s goodness, rather than one’s own sin (contra-Calvinism), since whatever one thinks about “sits between” God & the self, although he does not deny that exoteric or ordinary religious meditation lays a foundation from which to build true contemplation, by God’s grace, later on, which is given regardless of merit or dis-merit, but according to desire.

Thinking may not goodly be getyn withoutyn reding or heryng
comyng before... Ne preier may not goodly be getyn in bigynners
and profifers withoutyn thinkyng comyng bifore.

How will they believe, if they have not heard? He suggests that many are against contemplation, and have a false humility (thinking that their piety is perfected as high as may go in exoteric meditation) *because they are simply unaware of any higher path (they have not heard, and are deceived in imagination)*. So this is a defense of the esoteric or contemplative way, but he preserves their unity by arguing that the higher active path

& the lower contemplative path are actually the same path. Additionally, he links these three paths with the “beginner”, “proficient”, & “perfect” which we see used by Garrigou-Lagrange³⁵⁰ in his small work on Christian conversions.

I will also note some affinity in this work with later Western development in Pierre-Caussade’s *Sacrament of the Present Moment*³⁵¹. I believe that one could take Western manuals such as these (while recognizing legitimate shortcomings and criticism) and build an impressive library of religious contemplation that would bear and stand comparison with modern day Eastern modes or models.

The point is not to say “nu-uh, we have it too” but rather encourage Western readers to look deeper into their own tradition – not without reason is it said (not to our honor) that prophets are not without honor, except in their own country. But why go so far East? Surely there are far spiritual and physical countries at hand, who have more elective affinities with our background, that remain, yet, Christian?

The author of *The Cloud* advocates two interesting strategies for overcoming mental “thoughts” and entering into love. Firstly, one can “look over the shoulders” of the daily thoughts which crowd you, focusing on something beyond them, while not obliterating them directly. Secondly, one can “cower down to them and surrender to them”. This last strategy is particularly recommended by him as a means of annihilating the enemies, for God will swiftly come to the rescue of His children who lie helpless before a wild boar. Additionally, this keeps the Ego from getting involved in combat, which only “messes things up” (according to this mystical author).

He is not advocating Quietism³⁵² (since one continues outward reli-

³⁵⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Reginald_Garrigou-Lagrange

³⁵¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Pierre_de_Caussade

³⁵²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quietism_%28Christian_philosophy

gious observance) but, rather, the attention to thoughts: observing their arrival with discretion and judgement, a practice that is fundamental, say the Fathers of the *Philokalia*. One surrenders to the interior work of God, while exercising patience and obedience outwardly. Again, we see that Christianity is in this sense, martial, since the soldier maintains discipline in a fight which is not necessarily (even by esoteric standards) appearing to go well. Hope is instead placed in the action of Grace, rather than merely the enhancement of Nature. This is the Christian legacy, both inwardly and outwardly.

The author also translated *Dionysius' Divinitie Hid*, & wrote several other treatises, which quote Augustine, Aquinas, Aristotle, and Richard St. Victor (placing him within the European stream). Those who will pursue God through “un-thinking” Love will end up grasping many intellectual mysteries along the way, and the Love we have is passive only towards God: it actively overcomes discursive thought (placing all creatures whatsoever in a “cloud” of forgetting) and is naked only towards God, being active in the sense that it moves instinctively back to the source of all Being, God who exists by Nature in the state we must attain through Grace alone.

The same attention to thoughts that is recommended in other Traditions is found here, embedded within the Christian tradition.

... If a man happened to be your deadly enemy and you heard him cry out with such terror, in the fulness of his spirit, this little word “fire!” or this word “out!” you would have no thought for his enmity, but out of the heartfelt compassion, stirred up and excited by the pain expressed in that cry, you would get out of bed even on a night in mid-winter, to help him put out the fire, or to bring him comfort in his distress. O Lord, if a man can be moved by grace to such mercy and compassion for his enemy, his enmity notwithstanding, what compassion and what mercy will God have for the spiritual cry of the soul welling up and issuing

forth from the height and the depth, the length and the breadth
of his spirit, which contains by nature all that a man has by grace,
and much more!

Posted on 2013-07-12 by Logres

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-13 at 12:04 said:
Your posts are always full of meat, Logres. I commend you.

Jacob on 2013-07-13 at 23:55 said:
Great post as always.

I find it interesting that you would mention a text written by a Jesuit. The Jesuits sometimes use language that at least to me seems similar to some non-dualist authors. Guenon mentioned once in one of his books (can't recall which) that the spiritual exercises were similar to techniques used by esotericist, but lead to completely different results. Is that something inherent in the spiritual exercises, or is Ignatian spirituality a great way in the Western tradition to reach our goal? It certainly has a somewhat martial nature.

From what I understand at from reading Internet articles, the jesuits are somewhat over-run with Fruedian psycho-babble and other non-traditional ideas, but people like Hans ur Von Ballthasar was a big supporter of Tomberg's Meditations (or at least wrote a foreword to it). What do you think?

Sorry if this question has come up before or if I have misunderstood something.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 10:06 said:

Jason, thanks for the feedback: it's good to know my intention to give a lot of material in the essays comes through without cluttering it up.

Jacob: I am not qualified to answer this, as the text mentioned is the only portion of Ignatian spirituality I have read; Cologero is likely to know more, although I will attempt to do some research (perhaps the next article?). I do not see, however, how any objection could be raised to Caussade's work, judging its spirit, unless it were a very subtle one I am missing.

Jacob on 2013-07-14 at 13:43 said:

Ok, thanks Logres. I'm sure Cologero will stop by to elaborate, and thanks again for another post.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 22:00 said:

I hope Cologero comments (or someone else who is better read than I) on Jacob's excellent question. I've read part of Loyola's Life, and it seems to be that of someone who experienced the divine in an ascetic way, so I am anxious to find out more of what Guenon's judgement was on the subject. All of my posts are aimed at framing Christian theology in a broader context which parallels traditional metaphysics, although obviously as a Christian (albeit someone who came from a Reformed background) I believe that Christ as a "true myth" and the "avatar of avatars".

Cologero on 2013-07-15 at 00:20 said:

Jacob, that book you referred to is *Perspectives on Initiation*, in which he claims that the spiritual exercises were partially inspired by initiatic methods of Islamic origin, but for a different end. They follow the Western path of purgation, illumination, and union. I don't know if or where Guenon describes the Islamic techniques and what their goals are, presumably "deliverance" which must be beyond union. On the plus side, at least from Guenon's point of view, Ignatius was not a "mystic" (in Guenon's use of the word) since his exercises are active, not passive.

The Jesuits have certainly deteriorated since their founding; the question is how did their strict formation, spiritual exercises, and dedication to learning not protect them. I think anyone wanting to start on order on that model, and it is a good one, needs to look into that.

Balthasar left the Jesuit order long before his introduction to MoTT.

Jacob on 2013-07-15 at 01:27 said:

Ok thanks Cologero.

That is a very good question on their degeneration. I'll certainly think on it. But do all traditions not naturally degenerate because the quality of the person does the further we sink into the KY? Or is it more willfully on our part than that?

Of course the current pope is a Jesuit, but I personally am not sure what to think of him as a person. He has spoken out against capitalism a lot which I hope he does, because he sees the worthlessness of materialism like Evola; and not because he is a pandering to leftist.

Logres on 2013-07-15 at 12:09 said:

I need to look into Guenon's definition of mysticism, but the author of this treatise insists that the "passiveness" we have before God is active in a sense: a body has legs and can walk, although it cannot see, it can feel and walk. This is the analogy he uses, but does insist on a prior foundation of confession, rites and rituals, and also contemplation. This would safeguard (certainly in a better era) the Intellect.

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-15 at 21:29 said:

All things decay and die, only God is immune from this, so don't blame Jesuit spirituality for the failure of the order in our times.

Cologero, who would you say is a mystic in the Guenonian definition ?

V.O. on 2013-07-17 at 05:55 said:

"the author of this treatise insists that the "passiveness" we have before God is active in a sense"

The claimed passivism of the mystical often informs Evola's critique of Christianity, but this is incoherent from an Orthodox perspective.

Losski writes:

"The doctrine of the energies, ineffably distinct from the essence, is the dogmatic basis of the real character of all mystical experience."

The energies of God are equivalent to the revelation of God to the world; as conditioned by the energies, mystical experience is thus the contemplation of this revelation.

What could be more "active" than the dedication to the revelation that shatters the pretense of the entire world?

Cologero on 2013-07-24 at 05:57 said:

J-A, probably Therese de Lisieux is a popular example of a mystic in the Guenonian sense.

1.52 The Trivium & Mystery

Cologero's translations³⁵³ have provided this gem, from de Giorgio:

We could also call it "intuition" although no psychological quality is given to this term: the psyche in fact is below the spirit, the intellect, the heart—these three terms denoting, under three aspects, the same type of integrative activity of the divine. The spirit expresses the direct integration whose absolute type is the divine breath, the intellect expresses the cognitive permeation, the heart expresses radiant receptivity: by means of the first, one is elevated, with the second, absorbed, in the third, one is welcomed and realizes himself. Representing here a vertical axis, the spirit is the peak,

³⁵³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6649>

the intellect the base, the heart the center that gathers the two extreme points and extends them, prolonging them horizontally, hence the Cross as radiant symbol of universality and unifying centrality.

The intellect, the heart, and the spirit are One. I would like to relate this to the Trivium³⁵⁴, in the Christian Western Tradition. The Trivium consists of grammar (which is emphasized first), then logic (which crops up second, as the pupil reaches puberty, which is age-appropriate), and finally, rhetoric, where the student begins to be the master of his knowledge, rather than being eternally dominated by Facts in a kind of Gradgrindism³⁵⁵. Now, none of these occur without the other – even young children learn a form of rhetoric, in the form of songs and poetry and stories. It is merely that the emphasis of the logical progression occurs in an age more suited for it, while the other two categories receive only their due. If we were relating this to a knowledge of castes and Order (including internal order) we would say that the Spirit correlates to Fact, the Heart to Logic, and the Intellect to Rhetoric (for true self-consciousness is consciousness of the Master inside, allowing domination of both Self and Destiny). The Spirit initiates, or factualizes the supernatural; the Heart has its inner logic that we must learn to listen to; the Intellect realizes and epitomizes the power of the Invisible made Visible, the fruit of what has gone before.

This explains, by the way, the strange association of heart & head, the primacy of God's calling, and the divinization of man within Supernature, becoming God's equal by Grace.

I did not read this schema – it was obvious to me, latently so, when I read the passage above from de Giorgio. On the contrary, one might choose to say, at times, that the Spirit leads by an inner logic, the Heart

³⁵⁴<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Trivium>

³⁵⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gradgrind>

creates a vision or rhetoric of the goal, and the Intellect deals with the “facts” the matter. I would reply – the student/pilgrim will at various stages emphasize different portions of their Trivium, and so a change of emphasis or the seeming appearance of a “shuffle” of responsibility in certain circumstances, does not destroy the analogy. The exception, in other words, should strengthen the rule: the analogy fits.

The Trivium was made explicit during the Carolingian period³⁵⁶ of Western civilization, and is surely cognate in some inner way to the doctrine of Trinity; if nothing else, reflection such as Augustine’s on the tripartite nature of the soul and its relation to the tripartite functions of the persons of God encouraged a numerical attention to Three. Adding this to the Quadrivium produces a perfect number, Seven³⁵⁷. There were, of course, ancient Pythagorean doctrines (derived from Egypt) which taught ruler-ship by the Hebdomads or Sevens. It should be unnecessary to point out that the medievals would have seen significance in Four Gospels, Three Persons of the Trinity, Two Natures in One Christ, and the Divine Unity.

Are the “Three” related to³⁵⁸ the Spirit, the Water, and the Blood of Saint John?

And there are three that bear witness in earth, the spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one.

One of the discouraging things I see in Christianity is an inability or unwillingness to reconsider previous meditations in light of new ones. Are the liberals the only ones who are allowed to be daringly adventurous, since the Fathers who wrote the *Philokalia* have not their like today?

For instance, we might ask ourselves, as Christians, more than just where the revelations to Adam or Enoch went. We could even ask more

³⁵⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Carolingian_era

³⁵⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5879>

³⁵⁸http://biblehub.com/1_john/5-8.htm

than whether Guenon was right to argue that Christianity was just one vehicle or aspect of the Tradition, or whether men like Jean Borella³⁵⁹ are right to criticize Guenon as a “Judaizer” of sorts (the answer to this is mostly irrelevant to the spiritual level that most Christians, or most people, for that matter, would find themselves at in this life). My belief is that, in looking for correspondences in other religions (if done in obedience to the Spirit), Christians will be strengthened and surprised in ways that intensify the experience of their own Tradition, if it is kept rich enough. Who, for instance, is the Sophia³⁶⁰ in Proverbs? We have an advantage in our Era, in that, certain questions having been tentatively elucidated and put forward, the modern situation is such that no conclusively binding regulation on conscience has been reached by the Faith. Perhaps we are missing great opportunities here?

I will suggest something else for those who are interested in esoteric Christianity. During Pentecost, each person heard the sermon of Peter *in their own tongue*. Since Pentecost only recapitulates what had already happened I would like to posit, as a means of reconciling the findings of Nag Hammadi with Orthodoxy, that Jesus’ inner circle of *discipulos* each heard the Christ speaking in the language of their soul certain secret sayings known only to them. Whether this occurred at once, or whether it was done mystically, or one at a time, we take it at face value what the Gospels and other texts confess: that these are the sayings of Jesus *given to this or that one* of the disciples³⁶¹. In other words, each was given the “One” in a form that they could understand and pass on. The Synoptics look very much the same, book to book, but try reading Mark and then skipping to John.

This presents no problem for Christian theology, in that there may

³⁵⁹<http://www.religioperennis.org/documents/Editorial/Issue5/editorialIII1.pdf>

³⁶⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sergei_Bulgakov

³⁶¹http://gnosis.org/naghamm/nhl_thomas.htm

still be preserved four exoteric Gospels, perhaps (also) for that reason kept more accurately and therefore more reliably. This presents no problem for esotericism within Christianity, as it is not dependent on the Letter or written record in any case. But it does reconcile what we know about history and archaeology, in broad enough terms, to declare a peace with Tradition.

If Christians were more attentive to our own Trivium, we would have no need of Traditionalists to teach it to us, today. Or Gnostics, for that matter, real or imagined.

Posted on 2013-07-19 by Logres

1.53 Esoteric Christianity & the Anti-Christ

Part of the problem with standing in the Western ruins involves clearing away the fog of spiritual war, which is deliberate and has the effect of turning the conflict into a free-for-all, in which chaos and confusion deepen demoralization. Rudolf Steiner's work is important in any history of esoterism, however, his reliance on evolutionary terminology and concepts, and the deterioration of Theosophy/Anthroposophy following the acceptance by those movements of modernist or New Age categories of thought, make this a perilous project. Nevertheless, Steiner potentially gives Western minds the ability to cognitively "discern the spirits" and rightly "divide Thoughts". Specifically, the work of Gemmdy Bondarev is helpful in accomplishing this.

Bondarev's magnificent chapter³⁶² on the *Mystery of Good and Evil* offers a platform from which we can see what is happening upon the world stage, in a manner compatible to Christianized minds, *given that the Anglo-Saxon & the Romanity blocks of mankind were given the task of developing man's consciousness in a certain direction*, thus giving them the

³⁶²<http://www.altanthroinfo.9f.com/GoodEvil.htm>

Imperium but also exposing them to unique dangers. *Corruptio optima pessimi*, so they say.

In a nutshell, the teaching is this:

In this era, for which the Christ was necessary to guide and develop man's increasing Luciferic impulses in the imagination and the growing Ahrimanic dominance of Number/Measure, the specific danger is that a New Trinity will be formed, not from Christ upholding Lucifer with his left hand (from falling into fantasy) and suppressing Ahriman with his right (from reducing everything to King Whirl and the God Number), but from the Asuric powers which will harmonize Lucifer and Ahriman in their own Anti-Christ, to replace Christ. The issue is as much about Higher vs. Lower, as it is, "Good" versus "Evil".

The Asuras are demons (*archai*) of the lowest order of angels, spirits of sub-personal impulse, which will attempt at this moment in history the subversion of the Luciferic gift of the ability to choose between Good & Evil, and will use Ahriman to initiate or incarnate a one-world order or earthly paradise, in which man is made comfortable and easy in all of his animal impulses; *thus the spiritual degradation will occur unnoticed, apace*

To those steeped in Tradition, this sounds not only plausible, but familiar.

Christ knew the danger of this moment, and His descent into hell was designed to redeem the possibilities of Lucifer and Ahriman (higher angelic powers) in order to maintain a balance, only accomplished under the higher "I". *The Asuras, by contrast, need man's spiritual energies to be directed to lower, or sub-personal ends, in which man will become an animal, and eventually, lower than an animal.* They are incapable at this time of being redeemed (they are Legion, and Christ sends them into the pigs), and will collapse during Cosmic Ascension into the "eighth sphere", or the outer darkness, where there will be Aeons of gnashing of teeth

and weeping, as no one knows (at this time) how they will be redeemed, or if anything of humanity they have carved out for themselves will survive this outer darkness to be Recapitulated when the Eighth Sphere is regained.

This is “feeding the Moon” on a vast scale, or something even worse. The Fathers dealt with these creatures in the deserts of the Thebaid, because these misguided angels need man’s energies either to survive at all or simply out of envy (no one really knows for sure – their intentions are not “enlightened”, even to the extent that Lucifer’s were). This lower order of fallen angels is purely demonic and sub-lunary. That is, they cannot expect to be mastered by man (as other fallen daemons may be capable of), but actually have to be “killed” or left behind. They are not nature spirits, angelic archons, or even “daemons”, but sub-personal demons who are seriously retarded, and have “evolved” by degeneration. **It is their power that is evident and prime during the Kali Yuga.**

The prelude to Anti-Christ is the milieu of a coming earthly utopia in which life is made easy for Shudras and Out-Castes. These peoples identify with the Asuras. They reflect cosmology, by being parasitic, and needing the higher elements to be made lower, so that Life is made easy for them. However, unlike Lucifer or other fallen angels, who were the “gods” of the old myths, they are not “higher” than man in any sense, and it is doubtful whether they can be “taken with us”, so to speak, even on our terms. The Christian Tradition’s solution was to excise them totally, to separate from them. Modern esotericism entertains more hope. This is an interesting question: *all agree that they are sub-personal*. They may specifically be sub-personal, in particular, to the Western project of generating a sanctified Ego under the direction of Logos, an Ego capable of being “raised up”. This was the basis of the Super-Ego which dominated Western high culture until recently.

Evil acts when Good is exalted (although it appears the other

way around to us in the Kali Yuga). Thus, the danger of man as he attempts to redeem his consciousness and integrate his lower and higher I (Alchemy) is that he is exposed to the action of the Asuric forces, in a false Trinity: *this is the Reign of Quantity, or the Age of the Anti-Christ, or "Modern Times"*. It is a necessary step with laws of its own, one of them being that Man has to be capable of discerning cognitively what is happening in order to clearly resist.

Here is Bondarev on discerning the times, & it would apply interiorly, as well:

The earthly human 'I' arises through the combining of these ingredients: thinking, feeling and willing. They all owe their genesis to the earthly existence of man: the higher nerve activity, the sensations and perceptions and a certain unconscious, instinctive force – the will. All three ingredients have a positive and a negative pole: affirmation is opposed by negation, a positive feeling by a negative one, constructive will is opposed by destructive will or absence of will. All this has long been known to the traditional sciences. Spiritual science completes the picture by adding the knowledge of the **personified** nature of all psychic and spiritual manifestations of man — his qualities. When physiology speaks of the decay of nerve substance during the thought process, Anthroposophy provides in addition the teaching of ahrimanic beings, of their goals and world-mission. When psychoanalysis describes the 'sludge' in the soul and the various confusions arising in the human 'libido', Anthroposophy places over against this the teachings of the 'Doppelgänger'—being dwelling in the sub-nature of man, and of reincarnation and karma. The conditions prevailing in the cosmos require of man that he should attain knowledge of the world-battle waged by the Gods against the luciferic and ahrimanic hordes. In this battle the highest God, who passed through death on earth and pointed the way to the final overcoming of the

world-dualism of spirit and matter, is on the side of man. But man can follow Christ only in the 'I', for He is the God of the human 'I'. **This means that, in his 'I', which he lives out in the combined faculties thinking, feeling and willing, the human being should strive for the ideal of the higher life, which brings not impoverishment and loss but enhancement of self-consciousness and the wealth of individual being.**

The spiritual elite will have to sharply "discern spirits" in order to brighten the Light sufficiently to discern the second coming of Christ, both to battle Anti-Christ, but also to accept and know Christ – too many Christians will think that the Anti-Christ is Christ himself, or be demoralized. Likewise, many of the esoteric high initiates in the West are like the misguided spirits, and cannot discern the possibility that they have not "arrived". They are living in a "false heaven", and are vulnerable to subversion. In fact, in the West, they have succumbed *en masse*.

This plays out in history, following the triumph of Christianity, as a second temptation:

The new epoch brings yet another problem. If we disregard mass culture, which is already in a terminal state of decline, and we turn to those who, in the face of all hindrances, have found through their connection with esoteric Christianity the strength and ability to balance the working of Lucifer and Ahriman through the impulse of the Christ – the God of the human 'I' who reveals Himself through the Holy Spirit when the human being overcomes everything that is national, tribal, racial – we find these people confronted now by the retarded spirits of time, the Asuras. **They lie in wait for those who are striving towards the consciousness-soul and cause them to lower this into the sphere of the instincts. For this reason the Anglo-Saxon and German-speaking peoples, whose task it is to bring to birth the 'I' in the threefold soul, and who therefore have**

to master the consciousness-soul, and also those who turn to Anthroposophy, incur the greatest risk in the new epoch. Dangers have always lurked on the path of development, and this will always be the case. But if we expose ourselves to dangers, we should do so with understanding. It is a purely Asuric idea to want to build an earthly paradise where man is not exposed to any risks. **The majority of people will be led in the new epoch to a certain degree of individualization. Intellectualism will increasingly become a possession of the broader masses, but for the sole purpose of harnessing these masses completely to mechanized culture, to the extent that the human being will be incorporated as an element into the various mechanical-cybernetic systems of the future, and also, in part, of the present. The 'Highest' to which man can look up will be, instead of the Spirit Self, ahrimanic immortality, while the most varied cybernetic-parapsychological refinements will spread over the earth, which not only prolong human life, but also rob souls of the possibility of passing through a spiritual evolution after death.** In the last resort it will be possible to convey a not inconsiderable portion of humanity into the sphere of the electro-magnetic energies, the fallen ethers, in order on this foundation to build up an anti-world, an anti-cosmos, which will be placed over against the divine world creation. **The initiates of the Latin and the Anglo-Saxon race know of this and look upon such a perspective of development as being quite acceptable.** But it is not given to them to understand and become conscious of the fact that there is no place in it for the human soul and spirit, as they are subject to the influence of ritual (ceremonial) magic. Already these people are the virtual rulers of the world. Must we keep silent about all this, and wait patiently for the events to unfold? – May every thinking person answer this question for himself. We owe a certain forbearance to the person who simply does not want to believe all

this, who thinks that the world is moved by the chance fortuity of events and the play of arbitrary choice or of the noble intentions of human beings standing in isolation to one another. But it is quite different for those who have grown out of the swaddling bands of their social, political and occult infancy. They should on no account underestimate the significance of present events. Rather, they are such that their significance cannot be estimated highly enough. We are the witnesses and participants in a cosmic mystery drama, the course of which has an immediate bearing on our own destiny.

So we are in the middle of a morality/mystery play. Hence the popularity of such works as *Harry Potter*. Voldemort is coming back³⁶³.

1. The goal of those who wish to stand should be to master themselves first of all. Guenon, the Church Fathers, traditional Eastern wisdom, and the insights of Western “mystics” all agree on this fundamental point of discerning the origin and arising of spiritual impulses. In the West, the emphasis on Logos was designed to structure and rule the mass of the inner world, providing a way of discrimination. No Western project will be able to do away with Dogma and Logos, both because of prior shaping and because of the unique Western task of integrating the lower I with the higher I, which implies not a retreat from matter, *but its spiritualization*. I don’t intend to debate or discuss whether the difference with the East is fundamental or a matter of perspective, as others are more qualified. **For the beginning Westerner, it hardly matters**, except to point out that Christianity is likely a more suitable vehicle for their climbing of the Ladder than anything else. Part of learning to stand is mastering the fear and fog of our currently engineered situation: God’s winds are still blowing; friends and

³⁶³<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PRh0uz23SX0>

enemies are not easily discerned, but they can be discerned. Use the Logos to help decide.

2. Secondly, the structuring of society in a Traditional order will have to occur, *but it will have to be done voluntarily and in full spiritual freedom and insight*. Establishing an outright spiritual tyranny, however desirable from the point of view of the alternative, will not work. However, this doesn't mean that the accusations will not be made, even if Western man "returns". As Westerners return to the Eternal Fountain, they will have every name in the Book hurled at them: Fascism, Totalitarianism, Elitism, etc. A patient ability to refute and answer and hold fast (*Apologia*) will be in order. We will be in the same position of the early Christians, who had to be ready at all times to give a gracious and seasoned answer for the hope within us.
3. Thirdly, one can see that the old religions are not irrelevant, *since generic "initiation" doesn't necessarily solve the problem on a grand scale, but rather opens one to the possibilities of subversion on the astral plane*. The post-mortem state is still relevant, and indeed, may be a safer mode of spiritual transit (if Reason is allowed to guide the soul) than outright spiritual baptism during the Kali Yuga. In fact, one might even argue that Christianity is the religion par excellence of the Kali Yuga, in that it does not require elite knowledge, but only that a connection to such be vital (through apostolic succession, angelic influence, and/or esoteric Christianity). It may actually be a "shell" to protect a vulnerable and newly born "ego" for the post-mortem transit. Isn't this precisely Evola's point in regard to Roman Catholic theology?
4. Regarding Steiner, if Steiner's "evolution" is seen as prior in Time,

but not in logical priority (as Cologero has written³⁶⁴ is possible), or in terms of Inner Form, then his views of ascension are not necessarily New Age, but rather can describe the trajectory of man's development during the dark Age of the Kali Yuga. It is unimportant that he has become a "movement" subject to degeneration: the Roman Church endorsed Vatican II, but this doesn't mean that the war is over, or that all is lost.

The Chaos of the Asuras³⁶⁵ is allowed because it will deepen the strength and insight of the newly born Western Ego under Logos, to not only freely choose God, but to even pierce to the possibility of discerning Christ and Anti-Christ, which is a different task than discerning Good and Evil. The old liberal mindset sees only cardboard Good and cartoon Evil. In the coming storm, man will definitively be lead to choose between Higher and Lower, and maybe even Good and Best. Man will acquire Sophia, the gift of judging angels, and discerning/commanding demons.

In the Christian Tradition, we would say, God doesn't want angels, but "sons". Perhaps the innocent child, the Ego that looks up to the Heavenly Father, the "sheep of the personality" (Tomberg) is the only inner warrior capable of beginning combat in perfect humility against the infernal forces of the Kali Yuga.

Posted on 2013-07-26 by Logres

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John Chrsitopher Sunol on 2013-07-27 at 02:53 said:
this is eastern traditions

³⁶⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6305>

³⁶⁵<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Asura>

Logres on 2013-07-27 at 06:15 said:

If so, so much the better.

Jacob on 2013-07-27 at 10:23 said:

I really enjoyed this one, Logres. From everything I've read discernment is very important on the spiritual path. Which is likely why working along with someone more developed on the path is stressed among other reasons of course.

I read some Steiner right before finding Guenon. After reading Guenon, I decided Steiner was at least of lesser importance and abandoned reading him. Of course, he's an interesting figure much like a Swedenborg, I'm not sure exactly what to think about him. Tomberg must have thought there is some value in his work though.

JA on 2013-07-27 at 11:31 said:

Your posts Logres each week fill my mind with material to be digested slowly and carefully...

... ..

Are you still following the western Orthodox path ?

This website may or may not be helpful

<http://sophiafoundation.org/>

JA on 2013-07-27 at 12:03 said:

Bondarev is really interesting, I'm noticing a lot of correspondences with Mouravieff. Plus he is more conservative and closer to Tradition than most Anthroposophists.

Logres on 2013-07-28 at 06:32 said:

JA, thanks for the link. Right now, I would say so: I have some kind of call to either Catholicism or Orthodoxy, & am trying hard to interpret that. Reading *Apologia Pro Vita Sua* at the moment. It's easy to want things to be work out faster than they are. I think you right about Bondarev: Steiner as read through his eyes seems more lucid & less potentially confusing: glad you share that perception.

JA on 2013-07-29 at 10:48 said:

In fairness though it must be pointed out Bondarev was expelled from the Anthroposophical Society, so his views are not the "official" views of anthroposophy.

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 13:49 said:

Jason-Adam, I suppose I've concluded that in our time, the unique conditions mean that movements QUICKLY become corrupted, if not being corrupt to begin with. I need to research Bondarev's credentials more, but his words have the stamp of detached Truth:

"Anglo-Saxon political occultism builds on the many thousand years' tradition of the cultural movement from East to West. Its leading occultists (where and in what form does not concern us here) say: 'We are the only rightful heirs to the Greco-Latin culture. The Gods themselves, and the stars, look favourably upon us in our striving to rule the world. The time of the Latin race is over, and it must disappear. Central Europe stagnates and keeps us waiting. Admittedly it brings something to culture, but has to be held in a firm grip, its conservatism must be destroyed, it must be economically weakened and politically lamed so that it cannot prevent America from realizing the world rule to which it is destined. As to Eastern Europe, its importance is, in the end, limited to the reserve of genetic forces, which are considerably weakened in the rest of the world.'

The Nordic ideology arose in the wake of the cultural impulse in its movement from the South of Europe to the North. It is to an unimaginable degree reactionary, because it appeals for the restoration of the ancient Hyperborean, if not even the Polarian root-race. Only to Lucifer can the deeper meaning, the content, of an ideology of this kind be known. But its human bearers are only dreaming, they are possessed by it because not a single conscious mind among them is capable of establishing any reasonable relation to that in the highest sense spiritual planetary being of humanity as a unity devoid of all individual characteristics. Nordic ideology also has an ahrimanic component – it is Louhi, the Queen of the North (Kalevala)."

From reading more of his *Crisis of Civilization*, he makes the claim that the national souls each have a contribution to make, with particular souls taking the lead or Imperium in a given cycle. Thus, the American Empire was built to stop or frustrate the legitimate movement of the Slavic soul to attain purity, which should have given Russia the lead in developing affairs. This explains the concentration of destruction that was aimed at Germany (which currently held the high ground) and Russia (which was destined to be handed the torch).

His views on souls and races seem right as they argue that FOR THE TIME BEING ONLY certain tasks were legitimately falling into the hands of the Folk-Souls. It was imperative, therefore, to substitute an Anti-Christ, which would counterfeit this movement. And so we arrive at today, and the "ideal" of confusion and race-mixing. Satan gets the first move in the chess game, or it looks that way to us. Actually, we've just not been paying attention, and God was at work to begin with.

Bondarev even claims that Rome is involved in some of the turmoil, which may be true, and something to keep in mind when considering the Orthodox-Rome debates.

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 13:52 said:

Jacob – Bondarev has some interesting comments on Boehme (which might apply to Swedenborg as well, although he says that the far North folk-souls have been granted a kind of reprieve for the time being). Detachment, as you say, is very important in seeing things more clearly, it's the *sine qua non*.

John Chrsitopher Sunol on 2013-08-04 at 08:00 said:

I do not see real Christianity secret, that is freemasonry which is witchcraft not Christ like

Logres on 2013-08-04 at 21:53 said:

How about Asperger's? Good point!

JC Sunol: You are right, of course, at least in one sense – the Truth has nothing to hide. However, there are different connotations to “secret”; as Cologero and others point out, Truth can hide in plain sight, when men are blind. Of course, there is also the sense of a secret hidden for a purpose, so that men are trained in the finding of it. Also, some things are just unknown, or beyond experience. Christianity presents secrets or mysteries, however, it doesn't “give a sword to a child”. If you read Bondarev, he makes the claim that Jesuitism and in particular the post Inquisition Church makes “an assault on heaven”, while Freemasonry (also originally uncorrupt) “plays around with hell”. Tomberg makes the astounding claim that Lucifer was redeemed on the cross, in his exposition on Pentecost (and Golgotha). Ahriman, Bondarev teaches, is the particular exoteric form of the Kali Yuga; the perversion of Luciferic power would presumably be in the corruption of Freemasonry, the exaltation of Ahriman (in the West) through the mechanicalness that entered Rome after the suppression of the Templars. But the driving force behind both become the Asuric or lower elements, which utilize the other two. Even this is probably a phrasing in “terms understandable” for our time, and has to be measured against Tradition as a whole.

kid on 2013-08-04 at 23:22 said:

aspergers would be along the same lines, yes. ive worked a lot with autistic children and the way they lack abstract thought and how their interests revolve around how something creates a particular sensory response in them as opposed to “what it means” or something, sounds like ahriman coming to life. this is all speaking generally of course. but it is a very strange disorder. and sometimes i wonder about the luciferian type of thinking that schizophrenics seem to exhibit. which was perhaps more pervasive in times past?? not sure what to make of it all exactly just gets me thinking..

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-17 at 11:54 said:

I came upon an interesting piece of information, suggesting that Christ was a last manifestation of Aryan Saoshyant who shows up every 3000 years – Saviour from a book of Avesta, making Christianity a branch of Iranian (Aryan) religion. This is why Iranian magi visited Christ.

Olavsson on 2015-12-23 at 11:53 said:

There are some very important points in this article on the occult war and the ability to principally discern between different trends and identify their underlying, hidden forces.

I know that the author did not intend to discuss this, but perhaps someone else will, for I am genuinely interested in understanding it and cannot resist raising the question. How can this “unique western task” mentioned by the author, in terms of spiritual realization and initiatic ascent, be explained from an ‘objective’ point of view of pure metaphysics? It seems arbitrary to me, but this may very well be because of my own lack of insight in this regard. In order to reach any mutual understanding here, we must resort to clear metaphysical principles. The alchemical process described in the article would seem to constitute simply an extension of the human state, to use an expression of Guénon, which is a possibility of many other traditions beside our own, and not the highest possibility.

Merry Christmas to everyone!

shaun on 2016-04-23 at 13:42 said:

The prelude to Anti-Christ is the milieu of a coming earthly utopia in which life is made easy for Shudras and Out-Castes’ who exactly are the shudras and outcastes and do you believe they should be killed off?.

Matt on 2016-04-25 at 00:10 said:

Is any of Bondarev’s work available online? It seems a bit hard to find.

Halvor (Raknes) (@HalvorHalvor) on 2016-05-29 at 16:58 said:

I’m not up to speed on most of the modern day references in this article, but I have an impetus to share some thoughts on some of the thought forms I perceive here.

My perspective comes from having worked with Reichian Applied Sex Economy for over a decade, beginning at about the same time that I dedicated my life to God.

Basically, my issue is with all who employ their thinking faculties principally in order to come to grips with what’s going on and to find their own paths. Which means basically EVERYBODY.

As long as people abstain from initiating the cybernetic (self-guided) process of moving into their physical bodies, as opposed to simply using them as temporary hangouts. Some thought processes cannot begin except through a combined mind-body interaction, and this is something the individual needs to learn for himself – and as part of his social surroundings – and not something that can be attained through the continued intervention of another person (therapist). The latter may be employed to initiate internal process work, but cannot be part of the continued body habilitation process.

When such full-body energetic processes commence, the individual will find themselves not only thinking laterally but, essentially, also engaging power configurations, secularly, spiritually

as well as those powered and enforced by society values.

Neglecting to enter into said body habilitation process leaves the human being in either the Luciferian grips, unable to ground intellectual processes in one's everyday life, or the Satanic/Ahrimanic grips where techniques and numbing desensitization provides the capacity for dealing with matter quantitatively but at the same time deprives the human being of any contact with ethics.

The Asuras are clearly part of the that lower spiritual realm which New Agers yearn to "ascend" away from, yet, our task at hand at this juncture is to engage and integrate EVERYTHING. And this can only be achieved through an integral full-body-mind approach.

We are going to subjugate Lucifer and Satan/Ahriman by animating Sorat, and we must do it from the position of being Crucified, i.e. having internalized the noumenal life of Christ. The we WILL find our vocation in constituting the Kingdom of God on Earth.

The Asuras and the Archons will dissipate as we progressively take possession of our bodies on all levels from the most coarse to the most rarefied in a consolidated and sustained process. This of course includes taking full control of our sexuality, learning to employ it as the advanced social tool it is meant to be when procreation is deprecated and obsoleted,

And to Olavsson's question wanting to know why leadership in these undertakings must be a "unique western task" the answer is simple: Western intellectual and spiritual traditions, especially as they have also made essential contact with other traditions (Eastern, primitive) constitute the vanguard of humanity in that they have broken new ground that the others have not yet learned to be in. All that the others possess, equally essential in its own right, can be integrated by those inhabiting the vanguard.

Logres on 2016-05-31 at 08:53 said:

@Matt: <http://initiativeforanthroposophy.org/the-events-in-ukraine-and-possible-future-scenarios-essay-2-earthly-and-celestial-russia-part-1/>

Also, Google, Beyond Good and Evil, Bondarev, and that will give you a link.

1.54 Endgame

When one begins to experience the full effect of the "Times" we live in, it becomes obvious that there are a multitude of factors at work. Cologero has pointed out the increasing complexity and speed of events in the Kali Yuga. Although at first and superficial glance this would strike one

as *entirely* negative (as the rate of “Change” at first is so excited as the preclude the inhibitions of right reason and the evidence of unintended and logical consequences) it is also apparent that a particularly high rate of change begins to have the opposite effect – people quickly, within their lifetimes, see the necessary outcome of events which they misjudged in their youth. The brain no longer has to anticipate the event – events come full circle within years or decades. This is increasingly the case in our own times – a good many converts to Tradition come out of the fog of chaos.

It is by no means certain, however, that the full cycle is possible for many. Some simply die along the way, either physically or morally or spiritually. What is contingently different is that in one physical lifetime, many have the opportunity to learn the ins and outs of Chaos simply by “living” and surviving long enough to be bludgeoned into Tradition by Reality itself.

The first step in Anti-Tradition was to cast aspersion and doubt upon first principles so that one said with Pilate “What is Truth?”. In the West, this was both the cynicism of the Renaissance and then the open infidelity of the Enlightenment. Then came the open confusion of Good with Evil, so that each could be transposed: “Woe unto those who call good evil, and evil, good,” said Isaiah. In our case, Romanticism signaled the initial onslaught, which culminated in moral relativism in our own day. So what comes after this? Naturally, the third and final stage (which is analogous to Divinization in the Christian tradition, after Purification and Enlightenment) is the utter inability to tell up from down entirely, so that Reality itself is confused with Delusion and Insanity. Because Time has sped up, the moral relativism of the 1900-1960s is quickly passing into the delusional insanity of the post-Clinton years, in which the Psyche becomes impotent to discern what is mere wish-fulfillment and what is actually real. See this blog (for instance³⁶⁶) for an in-depth analysis of

³⁶⁶<http://onecosmos.blogspot.com/>

this mindset, which came to full bloom in the 1990s. There is a fourth stage after the third, for the simple reason that after the third, when all reserves have been used up in subsidizing the degeneracy of the avant-garde elements, complete and total collapse is the inevitable outcome of these multiple co-morbidities. This is what is spoken of as Chaos.

For an analysis of this process on the purely physical plane, see the Archdruid Report³⁶⁷. But it operates on all planes.

How long this Dark Age (which will be a true Dark Age that makes a mockery out of the propaganda which portrayed the Middle Ages as “dark”) lasts is up to, quite simply speaking, a spiritual elite.

It is obvious from the increasingly compressed time periods of each stage that we will quickly and shortly (within our lifetimes) enter the final phase. Thus, it is not a mere theoretical imperative to begin to work on the Self, and to plant the seeds of the Future, but a necessity of the highest moral and spiritual order.

Where will we find this order? Will we find it by cobbling together scraps of Nietzsche with a new populism? Here is what the Russian Church³⁶⁸ says: we should not succumb to “a fruitless populist radicalism”, in order to fight the rising threats of immigration and multiculturalism. Multiculturalism itself exists globally outside the ivory towers of Western decay only as local cultures flattened by globalism. The bitter experience of One World united by post-Christian capitalism is the fuel which stokes the rationalizations of those who theorize it. So that the enemy is actually the post-Christian economic order, an order emanating from New York, London, and Berlin. Steve Sailer calls this the “invade the world-invite the world³⁶⁹” strategy. The true and ancient enemy is not

³⁶⁷<http://thearchdruidreport.blogspot.com/>

³⁶⁸http://english.pravda.ru/news/russia/29-10-2013/126027-russian_orthodox_church-0/

³⁶⁹<http://isteve.blogspot.com/2005/02/invade-world-invite-world-personified.html>

the alien among us, but rather the mind behind the mask which connives and schemes and manipulates that presence, which wishes bad fortune to come upon the lower cast. As Mencius Moldbug³⁷⁰ puts it, the State Department has an interest in keeping the American military busy extending its boundaries over seas, rather than tending to home affairs.

But who to blame? Should one assign responsibility, if it cannot be found? Should one, in fact, infer it?

I do not believe that this is a noble course of action for the truly resolute, for those who follow the path of Hercules. Does Hercules concern himself over-much with Eurystheus and his plots? Does he rage against Hera of the jealous eyes? Does he mutter indignities against the powers-that-be?

He pursues the mark relentlessly, yet almost casually. He has made the burden light. This making the burden light is what those who prophecy gloom miss. They do not feel equal to the challenge. I feel obligated to point out that the Dark Age ethos which is so often feted by the New Right was in fact likely lead by a transmigratory elite of nobility, as the intrigues by Celtic chieftains against Julius Caesar often made clear. It is far from clear to me that what was happening wasn't actually a family affair, in the sense that various initiates, chiefs, warriors and their on-hangers engaged in the leadership of the various bands or tribes of men living in the North of Europe. The genetic and clannish unity was an accidental by-product of a culture focused on high Northerness. Indeed, this appears to have been the normative pattern throughout Europe until our own day³⁷¹, & the pursuit of such actually gave an accidental advantage to those of "Northerness", en masse. The subtle ruled, and benefited, the dense. Without that subtlety, it is just more "fruitless populism", I fear.

All the same, it is good (as Jeeves says) to "know what tune the devil is

³⁷⁰<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2013/06/civil-liberties-and-single-reactionary.html>

³⁷¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abram_Gannibal

playing". It is certainly wise and prudent to assess and measure and identify one's spiritual adversaries, to maintain a sort of casual and detached regard of their latest fads and pursuits, and to know their names. Has anyone forgotten how Italy provoked³⁷² France's star player into throwing away the World Cup? It's useful to know weak points in the make up of the adversary.

So far, as yet, the Right remains on the defensive, primarily because it is simply impossible to combat point-by-point every single inanity and injustice which is forwarded from the Left. As the crisis deepens, and as up and down become more indistinguishable to all but a few, more opportunity will arise for those with proper preparation to begin taking active roles in providing the umbrella of order in a world raining brimstone.

Hercules is unmoved, both by the presence of his own Moriarty (replete with numerous henchmen), and by the presence of even preternatural intervention and conspiracy. In fact, he stands their worst blows, and turns the injustice upon its head. It is not personal, for him, but rather, an occasion for spoiling the Egyptians. Is he not the son of Zeus? What is coming, however, from his triumph, will lead to the complete vindication of every possible injustice, and upon every scale and in every aspect, which was thrown against him.

The path of heaven contains the plan for such a perfect vindication for those who are worthy of it. Since our enemy will have nothing but a fight, then victory will accidentally be part of this. It is said, in fencing, that one should look, not at the sword, but at the eyes, of the opponent. So I have heard it said...

Posted on 2013-11-02 by Logres

* * *

³⁷²<http://www.worldcupblog.org/world-football/world-cup-moments-zinedine-zidane-headbutts-marco-materazzi.html>

jc00001 on 2013-11-03 at 21:21 said:

Brilliant post, answers many questions about the condition of the world today from a Traditionalist perspective.

1.55 Restoration, Revival, Renaissance

The order of these nouns is deliberate. Secular humanists desire to have the last without either of the first two, particularly and most insistently, the first. Christians are generally unconcerned or even aware of the first, & if it is brought to their attention, they become truculent. The third also escapes the notice of many of them, who have been relegated to the merchant or warrior castes, or who have been converted while being laborers or even *shudras*. In fact, one of the primary dogmas of this era is the idea (variously expressed) that “you can’t go back”, that “(all) change is good”, & that “new is always better”, and almost no one dissents from it. (Wendell Berry hilariously points out³⁷³ that if using a computer is a new idea, then not using one is an even “more novel” one.)



That is why it is important to pursue one’s vocation and caste, as well as practice the “lesser mysteries”, rather than spend too much time worrying if one has attained supreme Enlightenment. Because in the New Age worldview, to not have reached the summit of Mount Parnassus is to not have done anything. This reminds one of A. Jarry’s evil motto – “Until we’ve destroyed everything, we haven’t done anything”. This bastard-like, ungrateful, and rebellious attitude has transferred itself out of the failed 60’s movements, & into the “mainstream”. Nowadays, if someone

³⁷³<http://www.jesusradicals.com/wp-content/uploads/computer.pdf>

doesn't have visions of the angels, adopt children from foreign countries, and float through life in a haze of super-tolerance and up-to-date information, then why possibly bother? Beware of thinking like those who are masterless and rebellious.

Tracy Lee Simmons points out in *Climbing Mount Parnassus*³⁷⁴ that

The foundations of the modern world are viewed more competently from this (the "classics": study of Greek/Roman civilization) height. Poetry, drama, democracy, idealism, scientific curiosity, and so much else furnishing our minds are better grasped, and better judged. We drift without classics, floating on our own derailed, exiguous islands. And we become fodder for demagogues. We need not a revolution, but a restoration.

I will give you an example. Alcibiades, in Thucydides' *History*, defines democracy as the concern simply that the good of all be given due consideration, rather than merely the good of a few (the non-slaves). Now Alcibiades was bargaining for his life with the Spartans, to whom he had fled in exile, so perhaps he was being disingenuous. Nevertheless, even the villains and knaves of ancient history have an unpolished grace that should make us blush. Jose Maria Gironella in *The Cypresses Believe in God*, has Ignatio say that he defines socialism as the belief that the "rich shouldn't have everything, and the poor nothing". Rather than hate democracy uncategorically, perhaps it would be better to examine it & to see where it legitimately applies (eg., local self-governance) & where it becomes an ersatz religion, a demon, and a false God.

In the context of real Restoration, of that which is always True & is always so & abides forever, a great many false dichotomies and catch phrases dissolve into clarity. GK Chesterton, for instance, attempts in his Agrarian and Distributionist thought (which he bases on Hillaire Belloc

³⁷⁴<http://www.amazon.com/Climbing-Parnassus-Apologia-Greek-Latin/dp/1933859504>

and other Catholic thinkers), to demonstrate what “Christian democracy” actually meant, rather than what it came to mean detached from God, the soil, and all wisdom.

Therefore, the first thing or first question is “what constitutes Restoration”? As Jacques Barzun notes of education, it is dangerous to look too closely at the object (like staring at the sun, or trying to see the Pleiades head on), because the growth of “education” (or Restoration) is a slow, intangible, and subtle process which is difficult to assess. It might be better, argues Barzun, to stick to teaching Latin, Greek, chemistry, and the rest of the traditional subjects well (just a few of them), and let “education” occur like the growth of a tree. So, work at the destined work of your vocation; practice what lesser mysteries Providence brings to your attention; & assiduously and patiently cultivate your spiritual garden. You are climbing Mount Parnassus³⁷⁵.

If one is drinking from the fountain of Tradition (which can be increasingly recognized the more and deeper draughts one imbibes), then you need not fear to lose the way. Alain de Lille (doctor universalis, d. 1203) wrote of the “intelligible sphere whose center is everywhere, and whose circumference is nowhere” because he had drunk from it. And where did he find such wisdom? Of course, first of all, he had read or been told of such a hermetic tradition. Yet also, it is said that he was preparing a lecture on the attributes of God, and had gone down to the Seine River bank to walk. He met a young child, who had dug a hole in the sand. The teacher told the boy he was lecturing on God tomorrow, and asked what he was doing. The child said, “I am putting the river inside of this hole”. The doctor laughed heartily, and said there was no possibility of that, that his purpose would fail. The boy looked at him, and said that it would be equally impossible to speak of God the next morning. Alanus³⁷⁶

³⁷⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mount_Parnassus

³⁷⁶http://www.princeton.edu/~achaney/tmve/wiki100k/docs/Alain_de_Lille.html

was shattered, and although he showed up the next morning, he tore his robe off, & without another word, strode out of the university to join a monastery and find the answer to the riddle. God will speak to you in homely terms, in the lesser mysteries, in exoteric religion or philosophy, as surely as in the greatest terms, & the Christians assert that this is due to the Incarnation.

Incidentally, for Christian readers, I will recommend Coleston Brown's *Magical Christianity*³⁷⁷ (the source of the Alanus de Lille story) as a sourcebook for uncovering the Tradition hidden within their own religion. It matches well with Iamblichus' progression of the first ten numbers, and we shall see if it has any correspondence with the zodiac of Hercule's labors, as well.

Posted on 2013-11-23 by Logres

1.56 The Christian Social Order & Pythagoras

Christopher Ferrara gives a very basic, but nonetheless interesting tour of Western civilization here³⁷⁸. I hadn't heard of Werner Jaeger³⁷⁹, but I've ordered his three volume set. One sentence really springs to mind: "*The State was the atmosphere within which the soul breathed*".

This was the common link or identical conception that joined Hellenism with Christian Europe. What it seems to be saying is that the State and the soul *are equally spiritual, that they in fact co-arise*, and that you cannot oppose them against one another. Both have a transcendent origin and divine destiny. However, experience shows us that they do (in

³⁷⁷<http://www.amazon.com/Magical-Christianity-Symbols-Spiritual-Meditations/dp/0835608557>

³⁷⁸<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3P9nFumxKp8>

³⁷⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Werner_Jaeger

fact) conflict. Witness the great Greek tragedy of Antigone³⁸⁰, in which the Greek mind pitched this tension to a great height. So intellectually, they have to be co-equals or resolved in a higher One-in-Many, but experientially they run into conflicts, as Athens discovered during the brutal struggle with Sparta, when she “destroyed the village in order to save it”³⁸¹.

Ferrara argues that the role or place of the Church of St. Peter (we would say the external, exoteric Church) was actually to arbitrate this tension, to decide in questions of natural or moral law when they come into conflict, by using the supernatural mind of Christ. Regardless of what you think this caused in history, this is a brilliant and sound way of explaining the evolution of the Hellenic and Celtic world (which shared these tensions) into medieval and traditional Europe. The Church provides the balance, and mediates between “Antigone” and the divine state. What this proves is that the Soul and the State are relatively divine: that is Spirit exists (as well as celestial powers) that transcend either. However, when the Soul (or the State as a “soul” in the divine body of the King³⁸²) is raised by grace to a high pitch of holiness, you can see exoteric conflict at the terrestrial level of common law or State rule, or perhaps between two noble souls. So the conflict is both necessary and superficial (if both sides are guided by the celestials, angels and God), & it can be resolved by God, provided both parties adhere to the Spirit.

There is no question that this process broke down in Europe, and we began to see irresolvable conflicts between holy souls, with Christian Germany drawing the sword³⁸³ against Christian France, both sides singing Christmas hymns in the trenches. The secular narrative states that this only proves that we had reached a dead end, and that in fact the entire nar-

³⁸⁰<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Antigone>

³⁸¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Melian_dialogue

³⁸²<http://www.libraryofsocialscience.com/ideologies/docs/the-kings-two-bodies/index.html>

³⁸³http://wwi.lib.byu.edu/index.php/Wilhelm_II%27s_War_Speeches

rative even back to Socrates or ancient Israel was in fact a gigantic fraud, and that there is no such thing as positive revealed religion, transcendent souls, or a Church (although various parties within modern Western civilization keep various elements of these – the classical liberals keep the transcendent soul, the evangelicals still believe in a Church, etc.). But the full synthesis was shattered, beginning (officially) with John Locke and our own Founding Fathers, who accepted the shattering of the synthesis begun by Luther and others within even the Church (read Luther on the scholastics).

So we have a second tension that develops : what happens when the Church is no longer able to arbitrate between Antigone and the folk-State or the semi-divine *polis*? Again, the modern answer is philosophical despair, and the flight into comfort, democracy, and a positive law that depends only upon the decree of Hobbes' Leviathan, or a Machiavellian prince. In other words, we have Chaos, as the older elements never completely retreat, but actually help prop up the mass of confusion and allow it to continue. The whole rickety affair, like the Old One Hoss Shay³⁸⁴, holds together against all odds until it just doesn't any more.

The esotericist may well be able to provide some help here, as the Church of John has come into more light thanks to the plight of the external Church of Peter. The alchemist or the esotericist may help to heal the conflicts between various elements within the West, but it is important to note that healing will (by Logos) have to occur along the lines of the existing synthesis, shattered as it was and is. Thus there is an implicit endorsement of General Law by Mouravieff, Pythagoras, and other perennial thinkers (as we have noted on this blog). That is, the esotericist attitude is always that it is best for the perverse man to die, as there is no help for such a one in this plane of existence (sayings of Pythagoras). Thus, Romans 13 and the "sword" of the State, along with the Ten Commandments, the Tao, and the necessity of folk and moral

³⁸⁴<http://www.legallanguage.com/resources/poems/onehossshay/>

traditions still stands. To give an example, after the Pythagoreans were assassinated in a Greek city-state (only 2 escaping the burning house) they withdrew from politics and left the wicked to themselves. This is a sound attitude, and it is also a sound attitude for Mouravieff to point out that Chaos can sometimes reach a point in which it is preferable for the good man to favor Law over this Chaos, a principle also taught by Pythagoras: “strengthen those of the Law, do not help those who are against it”. This is the fundamental anti-Revolutionary attitude of even the Church of John. “Let the dead bury the dead”. *Christ did not come in order to give revolutionaries a chance to create utopia on earth by agitating for liberty from the Logos*. See Groen van Prinsterer³⁸⁵’s work, for even a Reformed rejection of Revolution. Or, as James puts it, Love the Brotherhood, Fear God, Honor the King. There is Order in three sentences.

Thus, we see that classical liberalism may be the highest secular personal ethos to ever reflect Divine Truth, but it is (correspondingly) *the absolutely most insidious form of substitute or ersatz for either civic religion or political General Law*. Now why would someone say this? **This is because it makes a Law out of that precisely which is supposed to transcend Law, to exist outside of the Law, and to fulfill or supersede the Law**. Isn’t this sounding almost Phariseeical? This supercession is in reality and truth, not in political or material matters, because the two must always be separate (Christ and Mammon).

Now from the Left, this is precisely what one should not do; instead one must mingle Mammon and Christ, because one really doesn’t believe in either, but rather in the sorcerer-state illusion that is created by the co-mingling. Here is Culianu defending precisely³⁸⁶ this Leftist posi-

³⁸⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guillaume_Groen_van_Prinsterer

³⁸⁶http://books.google.com/books?id=DDVkJ97dMoC&pg=PA105&lpg=PA105&dq=sorcerer+state&source=bl&ots=RUI02pcH_q&sig=EQZguDlKDvyVy68VR E a8SLUY6Hg&hl=en&sa=X&ei=zxzxUr_pMaTKsQTqoYF4&ved=0CEUQ6AEwAw#v=onepage&q=sorcerer%20state&f=false

tion. Since an irresolvable hypocrisy is present and presents itself in the Leftist mind, it leads to a pre-emptive charge of hypocrisy against truly traditional orders, which invariably present (to the modern mind) the spectacle of “good men” winking at “evil” by endorsing such things as slavery, genocide, repression, prejudice, etc. Of course, these are loaded terms, since from a higher point of view, the Right is not endorsing them at all, they are destroying them by ignoring them, which is the only way to do away with them (contra the Utopians). Thus, *render unto Caesar, what is Caesar’s*, etc. And, one may add, let Caesar render unto God what is God’s. This looks like hypocrisy to the fundamentalistic mind of the modern secular classical liberal, because they have made a “Law” out of “Grace”. Like the Pharisees, they are angry that Christ comes eating and drinking, endorsing Caesar, and mingling with sinners (in today’s narrative, those who are not “*politically correct*”). To them, it sure looks like Christ should have put the Romans in their place; they are often fond of comparing conservatives to the hypocrite Pharisees, but these days, classical liberalism looks more like the civic religion of choice for America, replete with its own sacraments, high priest, martyrs, and accoutrements that justify a religious lineage. The greatest political or moral sins of our day are (in this order) bigotry, intolerance, and prejudice, all of which are viewed as fundamentally hypocritical.

The *verdictum* of Tradition lies against this conclusion. Pythagoras had no problem endorsing law-giving tyrants, nor did Plato, Mouravieff, and apparently Christ himself, who came to bring a sword to the earth and to make the Ten Commandments more rigorous. None of these endorsed tyrants were Leftists, but were emphatically prototypes of “the Right” (at least from a Leftist perspective). They were corrupt men, but men of Order, especially by comparison with today. If I were to look hard enough, I’ll bet I could find some reference in Tomberg to such matters, as well. Someone told me that there can’t be too much a separation between politics and spirituality, or else “it doesn’t make

much sense anymore". Well, men of Tradition can always simply withdraw from politics (like Ernst Junger or Pythagoras) and turn a blind eye to the inevitable backlash against Revolution. This (of course) will also be branded as hypocrisy.

Actually, there should be a huge chasm between politics and spirituality, because "most men" shouldn't dabble in politics, and they should follow a religion, rather than worry about being "spiritual". So perhaps neither should exist: the biggest gap possible! The State and the individual, however, will continue to share a transcendent purpose that neither can deny to the other, as long as higher religious vehicles and esoteric practice fecundate society and ritual with what TS Eliot calls the necessity³⁸⁷ of a "Christian culture". The problem isn't disjunction between religion and state, it's that the Left only sees a particular kind of conjunction which they object to. Their own version (a soft tyranny formed by democratic and corporate control of thought³⁸⁸) seems not merely benign but positively self-evident. Whatever Order manifests itself as predominant, it will have the same enemies that Christianity has today – or, at least, they will be saying the same things.

It's important, in the moral confusion and intellectual Chaos, to remember what men of Tradition (including the very classical liberals who progenitated our latter day mutation) said concerning the nature of the State, the nature of the soul, the nature of God. To do so is the only kind of revolutionary act that has any truth in it at all.

I think there is more to say on the subject, and much farther to see, by those with clearer eyes and hearts and heads than my own. Whatever they find, I will wager that there is a kind of frightening confusion of all categories that occurs within the Leftist dialectic, and allows it to project

³⁸⁷<http://www.theimaginativeconservative.org/2012/06/t-s-eliot-s-christianity-and-culture.html>

³⁸⁸<http://www.amazon.com/Democracy-Incorporated-Managed-Inverted-Totalitarianism/dp/069114589X>

its own hypocrisy as a form of shadow upon those who see that some evils in the world are not capable of eradication, least of all by overthrowing what little Order man is capable of half way keeping up.

Posted on 2014-02-04 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2014-02-04 at 22:55 said:

Should have included: "Liberalism. . . tends to release energy rather than accumulate it, to relax, rather than to fortify. It is a movement not so much defined by its end, as by its starting point; away from, rather than towards, something definite. Our point of departure is more real to us than our destination; and the destination is likely to present a very different picture when arrived at, from the vaguer image formed in imagination. By destroying traditional social habits of the people, by dissolving their natural collective consciousness into individual constituents, by licensing the opinions of the most foolish, by substituting instruction for education, by encouraging cleverness rather than wisdom, the upstart rather than the qualified, by fostering a notion of getting on to which the alternative is a hopeless apathy, Liberalism can prepare the way for that which is its own negative: the artificial, mechanized or brutalised control which is a desperate remedy for its chaos. (CC, 12)" TS Eliot

Caleb Cooper on 2014-02-06 at 14:41 said:

Tomberg on Revolution: "... it is not the difference in dogma nor that of cult or ritual which is the cause of Cain's crime , but uniquely the *pretension to equality* italics in original or, if one prefers, the *negation of hierarchy*. Here also is the world's first revolution – the archetype of all revolutions... For the cause of all wars and revolutions – in a word, of all violence – is always the same: the negation of hierarchy.

On authority, law, and their dependence on the office of Emperor: "This is why the first idea that the Emperor Card naturally evokes is that of the *authority* underlying *law*. The thesis which proceeds from the meditation on the three preceding Arcana is that all authority has its source in the ineffable divine name of YHWH and that all law derives from this.

This is why authors of the Middle Ages could not imagine Christianity without an Emperor, just as they could not imagine the Universal Church without a pope. Because if the world is governed hierarchically, Christianity or the *Sanctum Imperium* cannot be otherwise. Hierarchy is a pyramid which exists only when it is complete. And it is the Emperor who is at its summit. Then comes the kings, dukes, noblemen, citizens and peasants. But it is the crown of the Emperor

which confers royalty to the royal crowns from which the ducal crowns and all the other crowns in turn derive their authority.

Europe is haunted by the shadow of the Emperor... because the emptiness of the wound *speaks...*"

Logres on 2014-02-08 at 00:41 said:

Found in Tomberg: "The crime of all revolutionaries is emotional impatience"...

1.57 Western Social Order

Part I Cologero points out that quibbling over minor points of philosophy & actualizing states of being are not equivalent for the noble character. That is, philosophical debate is not for the gentleman, beyond a certain point. Surely the West (as such) was built upon such a fundamental impulse, as the aristocracy of the Franks and Germans were a rough and ready group of fighters, with little taste for Byzantine theology. John Romanides³⁸⁹ has criticized this substantially, but does not address in any way the fact that the West managed to not merely retain much more than a shadow of Byzantine mysticism, but actually to incorporate and seemingly "add" elements of Tradition with which the East was less familiar. Cologero has discussed this under the title of The Three Orders³⁹⁰. Byzantium retained the purity of dogma from Constantine's day, but the social order was collapsing. They were apparently unable to escape the curse of political factions: in other words, they lacked unity³⁹¹. Procopius³⁹² even relates a story about Justinian the emperor which is intriguing;

³⁸⁹http://www.romanity.org/htm/rom.03.en.franks_romans_feudalism_and_doctrine.01.htm

³⁹⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5198>

³⁹¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Byzantine_Greeks

³⁹²<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Procopius>

And some of those who have been with Justinian at the palace late at night, men who were pure of spirit, have thought they saw a strange demoniac form taking his place. One man said that the Emperor suddenly rose from his throne and walked about, and indeed he was never wont to remain sitting for long, and immediately Justinian's head vanished, while the rest of his body seemed to ebb and flow; whereat the beholder stood aghast and fearful, wondering if his eyes were deceiving him. But presently he perceived the vanished head filling out and joining the body again as strangely as it had left it

... perhaps some of the “pure in spirit” who could perceive his disappearing head were Pythagoreans. In any case, political factions dismembered Byzantium long before the Seljuk Turks and the Crusaders delivered the finishing blows. Although I don't agree with the pejorative, the adjective “Byzantium” today still describes a certain kind of stifling, convoluted atmosphere that is almost impossible to fathom. In fact, Cologero has also pointed out that the East/West schism was primarily exoteric, & should not (in fact) be recognized as decisive or definitive by those who have eyes to see. Just as the Inquisition's attack on esoteric bodies within the Church should be “ignored”, in the sense of recognizing it as a natural kind of failing in these situations, while retaining both facets for future use, the West vs. East problem is also illusory, if one is trying to deduce eternal principles out of historical dialectic. Instead, move from Unity towards the One, rather than reasoning from the many back to Unity.

The Revolution is derived from such dialectic; although Romanides is not a revolutionary, his theology has made it in some senses more difficult to rapproche with West, in that there is nothing constructive or creative about it, and one has to “supply” what is missing. Indeed, had it not been for Gornahoor, I myself would have found his logic convincing, and would no doubt by now be reading Alexander Dugin and plotting

to immigrate to Russia, or at least pining for it. A Revolutionary reasons thusly:

1. The Church has done bad things, or been implicated in the doing of said bad things.
2. Therefore, we are better off today with the Church in chains, culturally, if not annihilated forever.

Therefore, the upshot today is that, “as for my people, women are their oppressors, and children rule over them”. Isaiah 3:12.

As Robert Nisbet has pointed out in *Twilight of Authority*³⁹³, the modern liberal state that has resulted from the above reasoning (which is shared by some of the brightest and best young people I have met or been acquainted with) drifts toward either chaos or a monolith that reduces individuals to atoms, with no power or defense against the centralized state, which has been optimized (ostensibly) for the good of all, and particularly the new “individual” neo-bourgeois³⁹⁴. Phillip Rieff is a Jew³⁹⁵ that every man of Tradition ought to read: his book on *Teaching & The Second Death* closed off, forever for me, the idea that the new “individual” had anything to add – his diagnosis of the spiritual sickness that grips us is profound. It is no use arguing, you have to treat the condition as an illness; in this Romanides and Tomberg are in essential agreement, as are all the Traditional thinkers.

Unfortunately, a lot of the young are ineluctably drawn to the syllogism above, and those of old age, who are hopelessly lazy and self-corrupt, encourage them. What the enthymeme³⁹⁶ above leaves out is significant. What, for example, happens to other Ideals besides the Church that become tarnished? Are they to be discarded as well? And what happens

³⁹³<http://www.amazon.com/Twilight-Authority-Robert-Nisbet/dp/0865972125>

³⁹⁴<http://www.firstthings.com/web-exclusives/2012/08/the-neo-bourgeois-project>

³⁹⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philip_Rieff

³⁹⁶<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Enthymeme>

when Man has tarnished his last Ideal? Should Ideals themselves be given up? What would that look like? Can Ideals be rehabilitated? Why should the abuse of an Ideal disavow the goodness or reality of that Ideal? Are Ideals inevitable, even when denied? Why did the Ideals fail to begin with? Are they inherently evil, inviting abuse? Why should this be? Can Ideals be critiqued by anything else other than Ideals? Were the Ideals ever properly instituted in the first place? Why or why not? What would a false Ideal look like, and how would we recognize it?

Cologero rightly points out that Socratic dialogue can end in *aporia*. But what if the Socratic dialogue was done, as he suggests, within a framework of actualization, as acts achieving states of being? That is the project of Gornahoor, or at least, the part I am most familiar with and best understand. It may be preaching to the choir, but it's certainly better than what you'll get at the average Sunday School, and you'll know something more than a four-part Gospel harmony, although such things have value.

As an aside of interest, an author that links to the site frequently, Brett Stevens, has written a popular piece³⁹⁷ which summarizes in popular form some of the cogent criticisms of political European nationalism that Cologero has made in much more in depth and subtle terms. Some of the readers may find the piece useful and convincing, as I did. It points us in the direction of achieving what our director and founder a scale of spiritual order, rather than appealing to the baser parts of human nature, our own and others.

The West, historically, has excelled at achieving difficult balances with periods of crisis, from its inception, which involved multitudes of groups and periods of disorder. It can be hoped that it will do so again.

Part II A recent comment by John of Salisbury made me think:

³⁹⁷<http://www.amerika.org/politics/destroy-white-nationalism/>

Not only were these scholars unable to drive out the bad scholars,
but in combating insanity, they temporarily became insane...

I thought about this question in relation to other questions or comments relating to the “inner struggle” of the man of Tradition in today’s very untraditional world. I had a good acquaintance on the Internet give up study in that area because he needed something more cheerful. If you will notice, Cologero does not restrict his reading to Guenon and Evola, but also studies a wider range of writers on a diverse array of subjects. It is probably true that a steady diet of Evola and Guenon has the potential to unsettle one. Caleb is planning to put up a post that addresses part of this, in that Tomberg’s *Meditations* are designed to lay a firm foundation, without which (if you neglect the first card of the Tarot), the rest becomes unstable. Cologero has done a fine job of supplementing Evola and Guenon (whom he terms the “Master of Tradition”), with the meditations on the *Meditation*. The Tarot discussion list (and Caleb’s article) is designed to assist in this process. In trying to imitate our betters, we often overstep or over-estimate our own capabilities, sometimes not deliberately, as we try to “come up to speed”. Incidentally, much of Phillip Rieff’s thought in *Culture and Its Second Death* explores the danger of being initiated into our elder’s/better’s debates too swiftly, including the fundamentally erotic desire to criticize those to whom we owe everything. Rosenstock-Huessy called this “Teaching too Early, Learning to Late”, in which the danger is that we learn just enough to be dangerous, to ourselves and others.

A little knowledge is a dangerous thing – drink deep, or taste not
the Pierian spring!

I can certainly relate to this, having passed in and through and back into such phases, over the course of my short 40 years. In the case of Gornahoor, the best possible foundation has been laid down, but it has

been made freely and openly available (with no secrets) laying out the Arcanum that must be mastered before entrance into the Mysteries. But the danger is still there, just a necessary one: in our chaotic age, one has to invite everyone, since those who should be ready are not. Jesus gave this in parable form in the tale of the Wedding Feast invitations.

John of Salisbury cites a medieval authority who claimed that there are three types of souls: those who fly, those who crawl, those who walk. Those who fly learn much, and swiftly, but soon forget. They make poor students (I think this is my soul's danger, for instance). Poetry may be a help to such students. Those who crawl are dull of soul – in Pythagorean circles, they would not be allowed to be initiated, for instance, during the old days. Those who walk, steadily and constantly, those who are pilgrims, make the best students, fit to climb Parnassus and drink from its springs.

There was another recent article on Gornahoor that explained some of this quite well – different types or souls have to be handled³⁹⁸ differently. Michel's comment on this post³⁹⁹ by Cologero gets to an esoteric root that lies behind a lot of misunderstandings that occur during these confusing times. Different types or *differing potentials* require completely different spiritual trajectories: in Mouravieff's words, if the center is God, and we all find ourselves scattered at various circumferences, the trajectory back of necessity takes a variety of angles and forms. And some people don't necessarily manage to make a straight line, either!

All of this is to say that the "care of souls" remains paramount: even if one is caring for one's own soul, in which case, even more "care" is required, not less.

In some denominations of Christianity⁴⁰⁰, the cure of souls (Latin⁴⁰¹:

³⁹⁸<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6980>

³⁹⁹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7093>

⁴⁰⁰<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Christianity>

⁴⁰¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Latin_language

cura animarum), an archaic translation which is better rendered today as “care of souls” is the exercise by priests⁴⁰² of their office. This typically embraces instruction, by sermons⁴⁰³, admonitions and administration of sacraments⁴⁰⁴, to the congregation⁴⁰⁵ over which they have authority from the church⁴⁰⁶. In countries where the Roman Catholic Church⁴⁰⁷ acted as the national church, the “cure” was not only over a congregation or congregations, but over a district. The assignment of a priest to a district subdividing a diocese was a process begun in the 4th century AD. The term *parish*⁴⁰⁸ as applied to this district comes from the Greek word for district. Those who earned their living on a position without cure of souls were known to have a sinecure⁴⁰⁹ (hence the expression).

Even when one is taking the “dry path”, and investigating the layers of one’s own soul in an esoteric manner, there is a care or “art” involved, & note merely a science (this may be where the balance between East and West is reached, as the East approaches spiritual things almost mechanistically).

This pervasive feeling of hopelessness, of fighting against fearful odds, of being doomed, can be viewed and attacked from several angles. Since I’ve been asked several questions lately that pertain to it, I assume it’s relevant, and am relating it back to the conquest or reconquest of Western Social Order. It may relate to the “noonday demon” that attacked the desert monks, a lassitude and despair that could only be overcome with

⁴⁰²<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Priest>

⁴⁰³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sermon>

⁴⁰⁴<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sacrament>

⁴⁰⁵<http://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/congregation>

⁴⁰⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Christian_Church

⁴⁰⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Roman_Catholic_Church

⁴⁰⁸<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Parish>

⁴⁰⁹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sinecure>

productive work: this is why Cologero has emphasized that practicing one's caste and craft is as important as becoming "enlightened". This is in the spirit of the Patristic fathers, who had monks weave baskets, plant gardens, build buildings, etc., because (as the *Philokalia* teaches) Satan can only attack along one front when we are working, rather than all fronts simultaneously.

First, as noted above, it is paramount to appreciate that simultaneously, Guenon is both the measuring rod (for several reasons, not least of which is that our teacher, Cologero, regards him as such) & also that which is to be transcended. That is, the goal is to not make Guenon's mistakes. For a Westerner, then, we recognize that Guenon advocates a path away from exoteric form, in favor of an East that (in his day) was less tainted, and a source of hope. Of course, today, we see that the East has imitated the West, and that Coca-Cola and blue jeans have flattened the globe. Cologero has done a huge service in upholding Guenon's standards, but eschewing some of his conclusions.

Secondly, we avoid the pit of getting caught up in erotic disputations over nothings. We've seen a lot of posters come and go – many wanted to dispute with Cologero over various bagatelles or supposed critical mistakes. The Hermetic method (favored by Western thought that is faithful to Plato, Bonaventura, etc.) eschews such disputes, as does St. Paul. Avoid fruitless disputation... .

Thirdly, for the above reasons, we should probably avoid a pure diet of Guenon and Evola and traditional thinkers, if for no other reason (this is an additional one) than that those who battle vampires and monsters develop a kind of hardness about them that can be monstrous. It is not natural (and they would have recognized this) to have to spend your whole life in combating insanity, from dusk till dawn. Rejoice over their gift to us, but don't forget to plant a fig tree. Our times are conditioned by different possibilities; many battles are lost, others are looming, and some new possibilities have deepened or awakened. As our master

Goethe says, *a man who is not of his own times, can be a man of no other time*. Read a mystery novel, watch a movie. Even the medieval thinkers (such as the author of *Philobiblikon*) says that it is possible to appreciate modern thinkers and writers, along with the ancient ones. Evola and Guenon have modern dimensions to their thinking. ***The entire Quantity/Quality distinction can become (at times) almost a quantitative category which taints our perception of Quality.*** The medievals emphasized the value of Estimation, in which the beginner practiced his craft of working by esteeming that which had objective, natural moral value, in their own day. Even in our day, there are people which have dignity, things or activities which have value, etc.

So temper it. If it gets you down so much you can't function at all, and quenches the inner fire, even down to the last spark, find something more cheerful for awhile. But realize it isn't Guenon or Evola's fault – its a privation within ourselves. Luckily, within the Christian esoteric and exoteric tradition, we are allowed holy-days and feast days, in which we can re-create ourselves in the wonder of Creation, which abides, even in our horribly dark days. As our teacher Wordsworth says, *one impulse from a vernal wood, can teach you more of man, of moral evil and of good, than all the sages can*. Presumably, Wordsworth didn't even have access to the sages which we do, so temper this with grateful knowledge, and spend some time learning the constellations, or admiring the wonder of a storm. In the *Romance of the Rose*, an initiatic text, the writer asks rhetorically, what can be done with someone who doesn't appreciate the approach of Spring and the gods of Love!

Fourthly, there are other thinkers out there, perhaps secular ones, who can be as circumstantially valuable to us as Evola and Guenon, under certain conditions. I would class Phillip Rieff in this category, at least for those like myself. He gives a feeling of “utter hopelessness”, but this is meant to be curative, in the spirit of Kafka⁴¹⁰. And it is aimed at the *hubris*

⁴¹⁰<http://books.google.com/books?id=45d6JsdVFaiC&pg=PA50&lpg=PA50&>

and ignorance of our modern self. Some self-hatred and the cutting off of limbs or eyes is appropriate (symbolically speaking) as most moderns are in a rather unique bind, being cut off from their own soul, which is *naturaliter anima Christiana* (Tertullian). So a little Theodore

Dalrymple, Richard Weaver, Phillip Rieff, Christopher Lasch, or other such notable secular saints is of great value to many – if nothing else, it’s a safer way to process (like the liver) the toxins of our intellectual age, which are in the air we breathe. Just realize that (being creatures) we have to balance our diet intellectually (until we are enlightened, when all things become pure). *If you read Rieff, you’ll realize you should probably be listening to Haydn’s classical music (or some other classical composers!).* However, the trip is worth it. Rieff shows us (in *Culture, Its Second Death*) that all of our spiritual states (even the Sartrean hell, which lurks for us today) are manifestations of our soul’s possibilities along the Vertical. There is no escape (or no false escape) from the vertical – we have to face up to the real problems and questions, first. As Solomon says, the house of mourning is more fruitful than the house of laughter, if it is a mourning of repentance. If (however) one is past this, then one is past it.

Christians are “ahead of the times”: we are not immersed in them. So just because this is the Kali Yuga, it (everything) still matters very much. One of my teachers, a Lithuanian who taught literature, once berated me for reading Christianity into Shalamov’s⁴¹¹ work: the whole point of his story was how small acts had meaning in and of themselves, regardless of a Christian interpretation or outcome! The character (interned in a camp) had found a can of condensed milk. For a short time, this can was God’s grace, without being officially God’s grace! Such is the mighty, eternal, and infinite mercy of God, which mercy endures forever, His

dq=kafka+withered+hand&source=bl&ots=y0FVlpXRL0&sig=VxXgUnJ-qHSfTDsw6og2NQcl8w8&hl=en&sa=X&ei=PL0LU-bSK8XJsQT5vIG4BQ&ved=0CGkQ6AEwCQ#v=onepage&q=kafka%20withered%20hand&f=false

⁴¹¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Varlam_Shalamov

chief attribute. This is the lesson Tomberg teaches also – not control, but mercy and Love, which is the Queen of Magic.

This is our burden, this is our time. It is hard, and we have to help each other. We have to show mercy, while remembering Truth. I hope this is encouraging, & look forward to being taught and helped by others on this path.

Part III In the *Philobiblon*⁴¹², Richard de Bury (Bishop of Durham) justifies his love of books in a Christian framework by pointing out that Plato is said to have paid 10000 dinars for a rare scroll of Philolaus. Philolaus⁴¹³ work was most likely a transmission of the teachings of Pythagoras, who had gone to Tyre and to Egypt in order to learn from the masters there. Plato used this work to compose the *Timaeus*, one of the more “mystical” of his treatises. If you are wondering where the Eastern Church got its teaching on the total dissimilarity between the essence of God (unknowable) and His energies (especially those manifested in Creation), this is where it comes from: it was part of the Tradition embodied in Hellenic wisdom, culled from Egypt:

This is the state of affairs about nature and harmony. The essence of things is eternal; it is a unique and divine nature, the knowledge of which does not belong to man. Still it would not be possible that any of the things that are, and are known by us, should arrive to our knowledge, if this essence was not the internal foundation of the principles of which the world was founded, that is, of the limiting and unlimited elements. Now since these principles are not mutually similar, neither of similar nature, it would be impossible that the order of the world should have been formed by them, **unless the harmony intervened . . .**

⁴¹²<http://www.philobiblon.com/philobiblon.shtml>

⁴¹³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philolaus>

PHILOLAUS, *Fragment DK 44B 6a*.

Out of Egypt, said the Patristic Fathers, *have I called my Son*. Here was an example of the higher, “secret” meaning of Scripture, which they discerned in the literal text, and defended in their apologetics. The **Logos** (of course) is the intervening harmony which causes the co-inherence⁴¹⁴ of the invisible higher world (which is Divine, and completely dissimilar) and the mortal, material world (which nevertheless is made “in the Image”). Through the Logos, argued Saint Paul, the worlds were brought into Being, and they will be recapitulated or “summed up in Him” again at the end of Time (Colossians). The Christian ought to be “ahead of the Times”, because the Logos has in these latter days revealed Himself as co-substantial with the Father, our older brother, a person Who stooped to conquer Death.

The modern pagan rejection of Christianity puts the West in an interesting position. It is a sort of Mexican stand off. On the one hand, the pagans of the classical world actually were incorporated into the Medieval Tradition (arguably with historic difficulties or distortions), and converted to the Church in droves, with notable exceptions. So the stream of spirit moved into Christian civilization, presenting two problems: 1) Some pagan thought was lost or misunderstood, but to the extent it was not, it now presents as “Christian” (eg., the doctrine of Purgatory). 2) Tradition now possesses a distinctly Christian cast in the West. It is for these reasons (among others) that Gornahoor has encouraged a revival of Tradition that is a return to the Medieval outlook, both because a rejection of the Logos understood as Christ would be to repeat on a grand scale the historic distortions which did occur when Christianity assimilated Greece & Rome, and because to an enormous and little understood degree, Christianity was actually meant to be the perfecting and crown of those very pagan mysteries. There are other cogent reasons, more prac-

⁴¹⁴<http://web.sbu.edu/friedsam/inklings/coinheritance.htm>

tical than that, as well. Cologero's quote from Tomberg⁴¹⁵ about "salvation" is relevant here:

Salvation is the helping hand offered to idealistically minded human beings who, though no longer identifying themselves with natural evolution, still lack sufficient strength of themselves to alter its course.

It is perilous, possibly foolhardy, to reject a prophet, vehicle, or messenger, because why would God send another one? Or, put even more precisely (since God's mercy is infinite), why would we recognize the Divine the second time, if we rejected it the first time around?

These, however, are merely practical considerations of various orders, which can always be contested empirically or historically in the form of interminable debate. What is more importantly at stake is the very concept of Logos itself, both metaphysically and practically. Every Tradition had a Tao or Logos which represented the work of the best minds and spirits in apprehending what the Spirit was trying to teach men over vast bodies of space and Time, and the infinite abyss of the Fall (even worse). A rejection of Logos might well be accompanied by a turning inward, like the crawfish in Tomberg's Tarot card, which represents the darkening of the Nous in self-imposed, invincible ignorance.

Since obeying the Logos, then enlightening the Nous (Law and then Grace) represent only initial steps, the first stages of divinization, what is being lost is the very possibility of even preparing for Enlightenment, and even more opportunities wasted in what is a long, long journey. **This, in very fact, is exactly what political, social, and spiritual Revolution represent.** Every traditional writer popular with even the New Age crowd (Mouravieff, Tomberg, and Heindel) mention in passing besides the obvious fact that Revolution represents emotional immaturity and

⁴¹⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7147>

darkened Reason, and is an insufferable barrier to progress in the esoteric art. The idea is not that the esoteric man will be “free” in the sense that he will never darken a Church door again in his life, but rather that the more “free” one becomes, the more one serves and is able to properly fulfill even exoteric duties. *Mouravieff, I believe, mentions that one must train one’s replacement, before the Universe will allow one to “escape” one’s current status quo.* Predictably, this was faithfully reflected in Cologero’s meditations, and that portion of Gornahoor’s program was just as predictably disliked by certain quarters.

Tomberg lays particularly heavy emphasis both on Love as being *more* perfect than the Eastern ideal of returning to the purely embryonic primordial state (he does not however, deny their validity), and the practice of mercy and service as being integrally bound up with the “gift of tears” given to the West. He teaches that the lost sheep of the “personality” was destined for salvation, and pleads with the Lord of mercy to forgive him for retaining the use of the human reason and its chakra in his *Meditations: the French Hermetic Christian tradition of Magic was uniquely both human and Christian in this way.* Like Abraham pleading with God for the life of the city, Tomberg suspected that this was God’s divine intention all along, and that earlier Traditions were only “imperfect” in that they were capable of being preserved, refined, and transformed in a non-Revolutionary way into something even more themselves. That was why he dared to wrestle with the angels. In chapter 2, he even asserts that Love is prior to Being.

And in fact this was how the Christian claim should have been made, and occasionally, was made in the proper manner by very august characters and intellects. There was actually a small revival of it at Cambridge⁴¹⁶ in old England, but these are far from the best expositors. A better example of it would be Bonaventura, or John Scotus Erigena. Yet the “baptism” of what was true, beautiful, and good was certainly how the medieval

⁴¹⁶<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/cambridge-platonists/>

instinct understood itself to be working, although obviously it was imperfect as it played out in time and space.

Or is it? Unused to seeing Tradition embodied at all, & undiscerning (in general) of possibilities and limits, the modern world wears its spectacles from a supposed Olympian vantage point in order to condemn the old orders. A Time & Space in particular (400-1500) isn't a rarefied time and space, but falls in between 700BC-399AD & 1501-2014 AD. Which means that criticism aimed at this period would reflect upon the periods immediately proceeding and following; to truly judge the period, one would have to resort to Transcendence, and this judgement is much more favorable.

Therefore, Cologero has asserted the distinction between Revolution and "the opposite of Revolution", or between Becoming and an Order based on Love's generation of Being. So that we ought to take a different and more charitable view⁴¹⁷ of the Middle Ages:

Paradox... is not dialectical. Paradox is the simultaneous assertion (not the reconciliation) of opposites. Because of the paradox not just of Christ's incarnation (God in the human) but also of divine creation (God's presence in all that is infinitely distant from him), **matter was that which both threatened and offered salvation**. It threatened salvation because it was that which changed. But it was also the place of salvation, and it manifested this exactly through the capacity for change implanted in it. When wood or wafer bled, matter showed itself as transcending, exactly by expressing, its own materiality. It manifested enduring life (continuity, existence) in death (discontinuity, rupture, change). Miraculous matter was simultaneously – hence paradoxically – the changeable stuff of not-God and the locus of a God revealed (34-35) In this sense, medieval history can never be

⁴¹⁷<http://www.millinerd.com/2013/11/modernity-middle-ages.html>

properly “understood” as much as experienced⁴¹⁸.

Bynum continues:

Paradox is by definition impossible to explain in discursive language. One cannot simultaneously assert contraries. Rude, other-denying facts such as identity and annihilation, or the haunting presence and yet utter beyondness of ultimate meaning, cannot be spoken together. Yet together they must be lived. Their simultaneity cannot be stated; it can only be evoked – and even this only inadequately.

It can easily be seen that a man of Tradition would have an easier time soaking in thought that is affinitive to him by taking the same non-Revolutionary approach common to the classical & medieval worlds. The Church gets blamed for burning books of pagan knowledge, but it needs to be remembered that a great deal of ancient learning was in fact saved by the Semitic “axial religions”, baptized by the saints (St. Patrick permitted “finger magic” based on the oghams), & passed down in the common culture of a thoroughly medieval and Christian people. And this does not even begin to address the esoteric or scholarly side of it, which was much more aggressive and open to inheriting the pagan tradition, including embodying it in the Eucharist⁴¹⁹.

We distinguish, therefore, between the occasional or even sustained rhetoric of the Christian authors (including that arch-pagan and super-Christian, Tertullian) and the actual action of the Spirit, reflected in their thought, which actions blows where it wills & ignites high intellects, pure characters, & rare hearts in a variety of Traditions. What is the purpose of

⁴¹⁸<http://ayjay.tumblr.com/post/67747782276/if-the-reader-will-suspend-his-disbelief-and>

⁴¹⁹http://deepblue.lib.umich.edu/bitstream/handle/2027.42/64788/jasonbp_1.pdf

this variety except to reach those *within* a specific variety, & to convince those who are rising above it with the use of it, with even greater proofs, that their path is blessed? For since our access is not direct, we approach this through a desire of imitating that initial inspiration, but the fact of inheriting very specific traditions from those above us in the Great Chain of Being. And since it stands to strong Reason that if one is “risen” above one’s Western tradition, it would seem to serve but little to the purpose to immerse one’s self again in the elementary and rudimentary elements, we conclude that the medieval heritage remains of great, even inestimable, value, most particularly for those who desire to rise above it.

Or, as Saint Paul put it,

2 But is under **tutors** and **governors** until the time appointed of the father. 3 Even so we, when we were children, were in bondage under the elements of the world: 4 But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son, made of a woman, made under the law, 5 To redeem them that were under the law, that we might receive the adoption of sons. 6 And because ye are sons, God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, Abba, Father. 7 Wherefore thou art no more a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ. 8 Howbeit then, when ye knew not God, ye did service unto them which by nature are no gods. 9 But now, after that ye have known God, or rather are known of God, how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements, whereunto ye desire again to be in bondage? 10 Ye observe days, and months, and times, and years. 11 I am afraid of you, lest I have bestowed upon you labour in vain.

If Christianity, too, has a tutelary function in the exoteric realm, it still makes seemingly little sense to surpass one tutor, and to graduate to another. After a while, might one not wonder if the problem was in the pupil, rather than the tutor? Be sure that one is truly seeking the Father,

rather than merely desiring to escape the General Law of the Tutor, & this requires great, even supernatural honesty with the Self.

The emphasis on decency and good order, even in spiritual matters, is characteristic of the medieval outlook. We could do well to profit from it. It accords greatly with being men who are affiliated with that which is the “opposite of a Revolution”: men of Logos, men of the West.

Posted on 2014-02-14 by Logres

* * *

Ash on 2014-02-14 at 19:18 said:

I am currently reading William Thomas Walsh’s work in the Inquisition of Europe. He argues that the dominant heresies of the time stemmed from the Manichees, among others, and represented political as well as spiritual threats to the Christian order, stoked on by conversos and those more loyal to Kings than Pope. The lesson is, there are few who truly view their actions as being “bad”, neither inquisitors nor heretics nor schismatics. So extending a true higher unity to the social plane is the most arduous of tasks, even in Christendom. Perhaps the answer to the mindset you described is the Christian virtue of charity, even in the harshest of settings like that of a corrupt, failing, or fanatic church.

The reading circle I am currently part of has in its numbers Ismaelis, Westerners outside any Churches like myself, and some Christians. It works when a small number respects that higher unity. We might move from the unity to the One someday. The elite from different faiths may be able to have that unity as well. It will be a miracle indeed if we see it extended to whatever new order arises.

Logres on 2014-02-14 at 23:46 said:

Charity would be a much better watchword than tolerance, that is certain. Some good thoughts there, yes it is arduous; is it any wonder there were problems? So many people think the answer is to just give up on the Ideals; I can’t see this, as it is a logical and metaphysical impossibility anyway. If our social order reflects our personal orders, then we truly are faced with a big task. Not impossible, however. Not impossible.

Logres on 2014-02-24 at 22:34 said:

I was thinking about Phillip Rieff’s vertical/horizontal distinction. It occurred to me that the Christian cross has a raised horizontal bar, to remind us that the vertical lifts up the horizontal,

but that the vertical bar is longest, so that it retains its pre-eminence, even as it serves the material plane. So the Christian cross is modified from the ancient one in a subtle way. Rieff argues that the safest course of life is to live in movement more or less horizontal, but reminds us that this is “that which ought not to be done, but is permitted”: this may have an analogy with exoteric religion, which has certain things permitted, but not encouraged. Rieff also insists that there is a difference between transgressive (Revolutionary) order or disorder, and a permissive order (which openly specializes in the horizontal), and a further distinction still between older orders, which merely permitted without dignifying the permission. So his sociology may have some relevance to students of traditional order, like the Middle Ages...

Max on 2014-02-25 at 15:08 said:

The sun sets in the west and while dark continues its transition to north before being born again. Transformation takes place in the dark says Guenon, the highest is reflected in the lowest. How can one navigate the dark landscape without having knowledge of good and evil, what is up or down. We recognize the struggle in ourselves. To flee to some supposed safe haven is no answer, it means death. We accept the challenge to walk through hell. There is no escape anymore. Western man is not one to turn away. The warrior stares the danger straight in its eye and demands; give me all you got! I am still here. I am not afraid.

JA on 2014-02-26 at 08:28 said:

I think that the problem with reading solely Guenon and Evola is that they define what is wrong more than propose what should be... ..

argusandphoenix on 2014-03-17 at 23:43 said:

Rieff made the distinction, I was inferring from that insight. A revolutionary order is one that transgresses by denying that there is such a thing as Transgression, but then schizophrenically enforces this through making it a transgression to punish transgressions. Hence, the hatred for the natural moral aristocrat, or otherwise. A permissive order specializes in evading vertical claims by maneuvering with infinite cunning back and forth along the horizontal incline. It negotiates with what is eternal. This is the “natural state” of most men. Older orders (and here I might disagree, but think perhaps I am just not understanding) are normative in that they do not attempt to abolish General Law, but rather, sublimate it. They would make room for permission (eg., the brothel and red light district by the railroad tracks) but would officially condemn it. Their attitude towards the transgressors was more intolerant, and can only be understood fully in light of later events (the Red Terror, and such) which came out of the triumph of the inverted order. They insisted on accepting the transgressors if and only if some use or place could be found from them in the existing order (eg., the impressing of criminals into the army, etc.). Otherwise, they left them alone with periodic repressions. I agree that feudalism can't return, per se, but am

not sure we don't have it already. What else but a serf is a Walmart employee? Rieff thought the beginning of wisdom was in "Thou Shalt Not" and the fear of the Lord. This is the triumph of the vertical that simply can't be surpassed (as I see it, although it can be embodied to some extent, perhaps to a great extent) in the evolution of Time and Space in a literal fashion. Your vision is keen indeed, but few attain the dispassionate effort to see it. What it will look like, from the outside, is rather a slowly ascending spiral, with many more Dark and Golden Ages to come, and more versions of feudalism, revolution, restoration, order. From the inside is a different matter. But history is usually written from the outside. – Logres

Pickman on 2014-04-04 at 18:22 said:

The Imperium is already here, Tradition as it is the cosmos and universal will of the logos is always upon us and acting even on modernity. Far future or past, it's with us now, in the present we simply lack the multidimensional vibrational consciousness to witness it. What is time? What is space? What is materiality – all illusion.

The spirit is what we have witnessed manifested throughout the ages, but any age or historical record mean nothing because it is not in the present. Thus true presence is the unwavering spirit throughout the flow of the universe.

The Imperium is now, because it is the highest expression of the universal will for even when millions of decades pass our order will re-manifest into it's proper and divine peace will be known once more.

Logres on 2014-03-02 at 00:32 said:

<http://www.millinerd.com/2011/01/horton-on-election-modern-purgatory.html>

"Not surprisingly, Hart sees the poverty of this perspective as a direct result of the loss of that old millinerd hobbyhorse, the *analogia entis* (the "covenant of light"), which again, is shorthand for patristic/medieval metaphysical consensus, that transcendence – the only Christian kind – which transcends classical notions of transcendence. Christian "being" is almost always caricatured before it is deconstructed. But Xavier Zubiri explains the actual Christian view: "Being is operation. And the more perfect something is, the deeper and more fertile is its operative activity. Being, said Dionysios, is ecstatic." But back to Hart:

What is absent from the Calvinist/Bañezian picture of divine causality is that ancient metaphysical vision that Przywara chose to call the '*analogia entis*'. In this "analogical ontology", the infinite dependency of created being upon divine being is understood strictly in terms of the ever-greater difference between them; and, under the rule of this ontology, it is possible to affirm the real participation of the creature's freedom in God's free creative act without asserting any ontic continuity of kind between created and divine acts. When, however, the rule of analogy declines – as it did at the threshold of modernity – then invariably the words we attempt

to apply both to creatures and to God (goodness, justice, mercy, love, freedom) dissolve into equivocity, and theology can recover its coherence only by choosing a single 'attribute' to treat as univocal, in order that God and world might be united again. In the early modern period, the attribute most generally preferred was 'power' or 'sovereignty' – or, more abstractly, 'cause.'

Calvin's theological errors, therefore, were the result of an atmospheric poverty. We trust the medievals not because they are old, but because of the air they breathed; and whether people realize it or not, people like C.S. Lewis because, as a medievalist, he breathed it too... "

Notice that "the Covenant of Light" is the exact exoteric counterpart to the project of the Meditations, in Tomberg, and that the Great Chain of Being expresses this as a metaphysical Philosophy, the Queen of Sciences.

Michel on 2014-03-02 at 12:40 said:

Lovely article Mr. Logres. I have some questions though, is the modern pagan thought and influence widespread? Also (regardless of whether or not it is widespread), does it really pose what may be called a threat? Perhaps being a recluse I am unaware of certain things. Finally, at a certain point, doesn't the line between "esoteric" and "exoteric" become non-existent? Isn't it just One Savior? One Faith? One Spirit? One Love? (I know enough at least to sometimes still feel the effects of the misuse of those words.)

From the Infinite Archetypes, everything has been fashioned, God in His Wisdom has determined their measurements viz, limiting them and manifesting/creating them according to their own Archetypal Nature, their initial states as Limited Realities "occurring" as Being; the thing that is the sufficient reason for this creation being Beauty or Beatitude, the result of which is Love. There must be Beauty for there to be Love. But there must be Light for something akin to perception of Beauty to occur. "The Light" as a Reality can be seen on the one hand as God, or on the other hand as the "intermediary" necessary for Creation itself to occur. This is an "intermediary" without conjunction or mixture. It is simply an intermediary (and the first point of view, i.e. viewing it as nothing other than God, for His presence is never bereft of Radiance, finds its validation in this, no conjunction, no mixture, just Light). Of course this intermediary has been revealed to us as many names in the form of avatars and prophets, but it has been chiefly revealed as Jesus Christ. Moving on, the Presence of Christ enabled the Archetypes to see the Beauty of God. Seeing this Beauty, they fell in Love with Him and wanted this Love to continue forever. How could this be done?

Digressing, when we see something we deem beautiful, we fall in love with it (for instance, a man is almost immediately attracted to a beautiful woman and can love her without even knowing her name), and seek to unite ourselves with it. But upon uniting ourselves with it, being one with it, there is nothing left to deem beautiful, to "desire", to Love. The replacement of this void, is the "desire" for the perpetuation of the experience we had when we first united ourselves to it. The form of Love has changed therefore, from loving the thing, to loving the

perpetuation of the experience of the thing. Thus we “desire” this and it can reach a point where the strength of this Love is so strong that we forget all else and are immersed in the experience; for instance, during the sexual experience at the epitome of the orgasm.

The perpetuation of this state of Love, could only be if God recreated the Universe with each instant/moment. So that, when the Universe, or rather, when we are recreated (by virtue of “the intermediary of The Light”) with each instant/moment this recreation conforming to our Archetypal Natures, which is why it is called manifestation or unveiling- “unveiling of our Archetypal Natures via limitation into Being” we see the Beauty of God and fall in Love with Him all over again, and hence we are “Being”. All the activities of all creatures are nothing other than, to a lesser or greater degree, a modulation of this Activity. The creatures reflect this Love, this “thing” that has caused them to “BE” in a haphazard way; they think they love this or that, but in truth, it is only God that they seek, it is only He that they Love. The process that brought them here must be “overturned” for them to realize this, they must see the essence of the traces; it is in this physical world that they are fully “expressed” as a Possibility, the salt has “encapsulated the beings” so that this “fixity” mimics their Immutable Archetypal Nature in its Changelessness, its “Infinite Fixity”. Just as they were unveiled by Light to be manifested, so they must be unveiled by Light to see who they really Love, or they must be veiled by darkness just as God covers Himself in “thick dark clouds”. What is called the “exoteric” is just a veiling of this Love; but Christ has torn the veil separating us from it, we can once more, from our “fixed state as salt” which mimics what we are as Immutable Archetypes via His “intermediary” as “The Light” see the Beauty of God and fall in Love Him not in the haphazard way characterized by the life we knew before, so that by virtue of this Love we are “Being” and as such, we can experience this Love, manifested as the creation of US as the Universe with each moment; in short, so that by this Grace, we can be saved. This is the Grace that overturns the cosmogonic process by repeating it in an upside down manner (by ascension as compared to descent or “falling”).

So with that (please forgive me for my long comments) I fail to see the exoteric or esoteric, only the One Love of God and different “measures” of perceiving it; this Love has never changed and it “endures forever”.

scardanelli on 2014-03-02 at 13:34 said:

Thank you for the link to the CS Lewis quote, Logres... is was a warm refreshing breeze for the soul. Another man enamored of all things medieval, Kenelm Henry Digby has a fascinating little book called *Maxims of Christian Chivalry*- a collection from his larger work *the Broad Stone of Honor*. I've come back to it off and on when in need of inspiration. From the foreword: “Nay! Nay! Chivalry is not dead, even in our day of sordid thought and selfish aim. It only slumbers. It will awaken, careless of all gain, defiant of all danger, devoted, impetuous, enthusiastic as ever crusader, when a man recognizes his vocation to personal honour...”

Logres on 2014-03-03 at 02:39 said:

Thanks, Scardanelli, for the reference.

Michel, I agree, but notwithstanding Borella and others' insistence that the essence of Christianity is "the esoteric made exoteric", the religion is based around paradoxes to begin with, so that esoteric and exoteric (being terms we use to denote spiritual experience) remain with their meaning, despite the eventual vision in which they merge in the Light. Just as there are a lot (or at least a few notable) pagans who have "Christian bones", but remain formally pagan, there are accurate spiritual contours denoted by the use of the terms you mentioned (exoteric, esoteric). Specifically, it's the manner in which "God", the "Light", or "Love" is experienced – is it primarily through rituals or dogmas or practices, or does it flow through images that surface in the soul? There may be quite a few pagans farther along in Christian esoteric practice than many nominal Christians will ever hope to be. It's a strange, paradoxical, and uncomfortable fact (along with many others), but it seems to match with Divine and human truth. I don't understand why this is, but it is a mystery, and in order to comprehend it, one has to enter into the Arcanum. Since those who do this tend to be of higher spiritual quality than the rest of us, we call them "saints" or "prophets" or some other term, and speak of them having an esoteric truth that others lack, or that others can only formulate through art, poetry, or ritual, and experience in fleeting fashion, but hopefully more fully after death. That's the only way of harmonizing seemingly conflicting truths, in the paradox. Or, even better, through meditation on the paradox. Ideally, however, you are correct, & perhaps we can say that the perfect man is the one for whom the esoteric and exoteric aspects are seamless realities, either entered at will, and accurately correlated to each other.

Logres on 2014-03-03 at 16:48 said:

Michel, better answer here:

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7152>

"Exoteric philosophy comprised ancient Greek philosophy. Esoteric philosophy is identical with the Christian religion"

Notice that in this syllogism, exoteric is identified with the esoteric Logos or inner Fire of the universe (of the Stoics), and that esoteric is identified with outward ritual. So this is a chiasm, in which earth echoes heaven, and heaven echoes earth. But yet (and this is the part where I may be differentiating a little from you) both remain more fully themselves, a paradox.

Michel on 2014-03-04 at 14:54 said:

Thanks for the answer: "the essence of Christianity is the esoteric made exoteric".

"So this is a chiasm, in which earth echoes heaven, and heaven echoes earth. But yet (and this is the part where I may be differentiating a little from you) both remain more fully themselves, a paradox."

I hope I didn't convey the notion that as modes of being, there is no distinction between heaven and earth and the subtle world too. I meant that after accomplishing the Hero's Journey, the World in its entirety is seen in a completely new way by the being that would have accomplished it. As modes of being, they each have their own conditions, but the Hero has gone beyond these conditions, the Hero has realized that within himself which acted as the sufficient reason for the prevailing of these conditions, and has conquered them.

"There may be quite a few pagans farther along in Christian esoteric practice than many nominal Christians will ever hope to be. It's a strange, paradoxical, and uncomfortable fact (along with many others), but it seems to match with Divine and human truth."

I don't know if Freemasonry can still be considered as something akin to a Christian Path, but even in the preliminary stages for example, when one is locked with a skull and bones in a dark part of the lodge, preceding one's initiation, one meditates deeply on the futility of his prior perceptions of life (the room's setting acting as a support for the initial destruction of his false and profane self), and is ready, for the death that is to befall him, to re-begin a re-orientation of this perception of life, having being reduced to his *materia prima* following the utterance of the *fiat lux*; as he begins the initiatic voyage, his perceptions of the world merge from within, realizing and actualizing according to his aptitudes, the possibilities within himself, learning to live again building Solomon's Temple; but you say this yourself, the paradox is resolved the deeper one sinks into the Arcanum. The stumbling block for most is the persistence of some of these perceptions even after they have, to a lesser or greater extent, began the path; they never truly mastered silence/death and hence began the path with their own pre-conceived notions, albeit subtle and "crafty" (in their solemnity and apparent reality), as the goal, thus they may end up worse than they were before, having gone deeper into a certain perception that they should have earlier destroyed e.g. a notion of what "heaven is", a bias either for or against something, a "belief" etc.

In fact, in the beginning, there should be no attempt at all to try and fit into something or to escape anything, first, it should be an acceptance of what one is, whatever that may be, followed by a seamless cathartic collapse or a sudden realization of the futility of what people call "me"; something akin to a gestalt. One advantage of being under someone's tutelage, is that they can help with this deconstructive process; to use an Islamic concept to better explain it; there are certain Sheikhs or Muqadims (someone who is like a stand-in for a Sheikh) who exert something called the *Himma*. This is akin to the *fiat lux*, in that it is a "reproduction" of the Divine Command that created Order out of Chaos; the Tutor has the ability to directly assert his 'will' towards the disciple so that the disciple is freed from certain difficulty. This can help the disciple in the beginning to completely destroy himself (his profane self) and achieve silence/initiatic death as well as later on, when the disciple is under a heavy burden, or is stuck at a certain point in the initiatic voyage. That means that by his *Himma* or you can say "will-power" (not forceful, just harmonious and in tandem with nature), a Tutor can help a disciple experience higher states

of consciousness, literally- show him the essence of things even without much effort from the disciple. So the point is that perhaps the lingering of certain pre-conceived perceptions is what makes some Christians not able to make as much progress as pagans. (I hope by pagans you don't mean "new-age", I take it you mean philosophers like Plotinus and Aristotle).

1.58 The Metalogikon

The Medieval period represents, for Western man, a kind of germinal gestation of the Spirit in the form of an *actualized* Christian civilization, one which was fully in accord with Tradition, as far as it was able to go. We know this because, for the neo-pagans, it is too "Christian" & for the neo-Christians, it is too "pagan". Something with this many enemies has to have more going for it than meets the eye, & when one begins to dig in its archives, or leave through its holy books, or experience its ghosts in an old castle, you get a cold breath of fresh air that refreshes the heart.

I wrote in an earlier post:

Cologero's translations⁴²⁰ have provided this gem, from de Giorgio:

"We could also call it "intuition" although no psychological quality is given to this term: the psyche in fact is below the spirit, the intellect, the heart—these three terms denoting, under three aspects, the same type of integrative activity of the divine. The spirit expresses the direct integration whose absolute type is the divine breath, the intellect expresses the cognitive permeation, the heart expresses radiant receptivity: by means of the first, one is elevated, with the second, absorbed, in the third, one is welcomed and realizes himself. Representing here a vertical axis, the spirit is the peak, the intellect the base, the heart the center that gathers the two extreme points and extends them, prolonging them hor-

⁴²⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6649>

izontally, hence the Cross as radiant symbol of universality and unifying centrality.”

The intellect, the heart, and the spirit are One..⁴²¹.

John of Salisbury was a minor church official in England, & yet he ably defended the classical ideal (expressed in Seneca and Cicero) of the philosopher: the lover of wisdom has to live as if these things (the Tao) were actually true, subordinating earthly desires and concerns to a higher goal. To this end, one studied grammar as the foundation, proceeded to logic-dialectic to pursue the ends of what was begun, and summarized this rhetorically in the “living flame” of a common chase after the Logos. Errors in grammar (mixing categories of speech) are analogous to conflating Spirit & matter, or of admixing them (eg., “race” = the spirit). Errors in logic are analogous to perverse twisting of the Logos inside one’s self (eg., it’s some one else’s fault). Errors in rhetoric are analogous to not being able to judge the spirits, following will’o’the’wisps (eg., Equality as God). Therefore, the educated man pursues a formal calling (for which he is more harshly held to account) in learning to tell what is true from what is false, & what is good from what is better or Best. The uneducated man has to look to his betters for guidance (as indeed does the educated man, as sainthood or herodism actualizes liberal studies in real freedom).

Where is anyone of John’s stature⁴²² today? If he exists, he is certainly not holding an official post: that is the difference between then & now.

Because of the chiasm formed by earth and heaven, in which the material world becomes the divine drama or staging ground for salvation, and in which *whatever you bind will be bound, whatever loosed, loosed*, the Hermetic method is to continue the medieval project of christening earth and humanizing heaven: that is, earth must be baptized, & heaven taken by storm. Rather than effacing human nature, personality, and the

⁴²¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6658>

⁴²²<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/john-salisbury/>

Logos as it sustains the “shields of the earth”, it overcomes General Law by drawing the entire human person up into the Divine order, simultaneously actualizing and drawing down the celestial powers, as was the original intent of God.

One only has to compare Eastern Orthodox icons to the Book of Kells to appreciate the difference in Western spirituality, which very early on committed itself to a playful acknowledgement and sublimation of the natural order. It was no accident that Pelagius hailed from Ireland, or that the Irish monks “saved Western classical civilization”. Whereas the East has been more heavily influenced by the idea of breaking out of the charmed, magic circle of the Fall, the West has been more willing to run the risk of damnation by insisting on a full recognition of the Logos in the material Creation. This does not mean that Eastern Orthodoxy is opposed to the Western Church, far from it. It is simply to point out that they are, in the end, returning to the same place, from a different point, like radii back to the center of the circle. The French hermetic tradition which inspired Tomberg openly admits and acknowledges the importance of co-inherence⁴²³ of the two worlds, which are One. Charles Williams (who drew attention to the term) was influenced by some of the same circles as Tomberg was.

So it is not merely a matter of all Westerners re-converting to the Eastern Church (although perhaps this is how God shall choose to re-unify?), but rather of rediscovering that one’s lines have “fallen in pleasant places & that I have a goodly heritage” (Psalms). In re-reading works such as John Cardinal Newman’s *The Idea of the University*, or John of Salisbury’s *Metalogicon*, or perhaps Boethius’ *Consolations*, we can see the Western, classical yearning for the order of the City, for Tradition, for the true & original religion, which pre-existed the Christ, but was re-energized by the appearance of its crown prince.

I have pointed out that Grammar corresponds to Spirit, Logic to Lo-

⁴²³<http://pweb.jps.net/~sangreal/cw.htm>

gos, and rhetoric to the archetype or Father. This is how liberal learning can again be brought into a right relationship not merely with right Reason, but with the embodied and personal Good, which is a super-Person:

If we were relating this to a knowledge of castes and Order (including internal order) we would say that the Spirit correlates to Fact, the Heart to Logic, and the Intellect to Rhetoric (for true self-consciousness is consciousness of the Master inside, allowing domination of both Self and Destiny). The Spirit initiates, or factualizes the supernatural; the Heart has its inner logic that we must learn to listen to; the Intellect realizes and epitomizes the power of the Invisible made Visible, the fruit of what has gone before.

In this way (surprisingly) the Spirit “chiasms” (or inverts by crossing a boundary in a creative way, the opposite of revolution, which is not fecundate) with “Fact” (which we tend to identify somewhat strangely with pure matter), the Son who is “matter incarnate” is seen as the heart of the worlds with a logic that transcends analytical power alone, and the Father is not the brutal demi-God who oppresses, but rather the Archetype or “Ground”, the “infinite possibility” Himself, out of which all proceeds.

Tomberg has pointed out that pantheism, emanationism, demi-urgism, and creation ex nihilo all correspond to various aspects or levels of Being, all true, which can be properly coordinated in the One.

This is why the medievals did not mind reading the *Timaeus*, which frankly teaches that there is a demi-Urge, or perusing the Stoics (whose spirituality they did not share as much in common with as the theurgic tradition of Plotinus), which emphasizes the unity of the Logos in the natural world (pantheism), or in picking up Iamblichus or Plotinus (whose systems of theurgy were incorporated into the Roman mass). They held all this together with the Grammar of Dogma, which demanded that the mystery of the Spirit as it actualizes in matter is the foundation point for

slowly climbing Parnassus and reaching the heights which in earlier ages may have been scaled more swiftly or dramatically by avatars and heroes who shared a small portion of the charisma of Christ.

Now that Christ has come, the real work begins! Rather than rely on being born as a “son of God” dedicate to Apollo (like Pythagoras), or being conceived by the interaction between Olympian celestials and mortals (like Hercules), we have been fully restored. But being fully restored, the work has only just begun, as it is now our calling in this darkest and brightest of all Ages to achieve on the inside, project on the outside, and re-echo the divine nuptials that have been consummated between Heaven and Earth. This is the chivalric destiny the Middle Ages glimpsed and began to achieve, & this is what each must set themselves again to do.

To that end, it is encouraging that, even in John of Salisbury’s “bright age of Faith”, he complains that false philosophers and fake Christians abounded, that learning was already turning dim, that madness was loose upon the earth in the form of institutional folly, and that corruption too often triumphed over virtue (he and Thomas Beckett were allies). Maybe the Age we live in, as Cologero has said, has its own unique advantages, and that much can be done in candlelight, away from the hustle and bustle of a world that (even at its best) was ambiguous about accepting the Lordship of the King.

Posted on 2014-03-07 by Logres

1.59 La Revolution Devore Ses Enfants

During the years leading up to 1789, Paris had increasingly become the exclusive city in France, a city-among-cities, with no peer. One of the dynamics behind the destruction of the ancien regime was Paris’ desire to subordinate the legitimate and ancient diversity of the *pays* (regions) of

old France. Paris would become the truly capital city, rather than the body of the king, since in the medieval world, the city or seat of sovereignty, was in the actual person of the king, wherever he happened to be touring. With the Enlightenment justifying its bourgeois aspirations, and Art turning to the bizarre and degenerate, the entire city descended from famine into chaos.

We can see an analogous process at work today. America has decided to be the “Paris” of a global order which encompasses nothing less than the world plantation. All of the world’s goods flow into American territory, just as French produce and goods flowed into the environs of the burgeoning Parisian enclaves. With a philosophy behind it to justify its aspirations (multiculturalism, tribalism, and the continuance of Revolution), the “new American” seems poised to plunge his country into the same chaos that engulfed France in 1789. This is because, as we all know, the Revolution must play on.

With notable differences (Paris had a lot more potential to control the local French countryside than America has to control all of the world, and Paris was more homogeneous than America is today), it is true to say that America and its satellites and imitators comprise a global arrangement increasingly aspiring to universal “values”, which is to say, global sway. This is what the neo-liberal consensus comes to mean. When they say “human rights”, what they mean is the “customary rights of those over whom we hold sway, our serfs”. There are no visible aristocrats, just beautiful people making large incomes living in good style, in cosmopolitan centers of “Westernness” all over the world. Oswald Spengler points out how the⁴²⁴ *megalopoloi* come to dominate the countryside in late phases of civilization, reaching their tentacles into the land to suck wealth out of it and legitimize itself by aggrandizement *vis a vis* the provinces. In the final analysis of this cycle, it is the ostentatious display of arbitrary power

⁴²⁴<https://journals.lib.byu.edu/spc/index.php/CCR/article/viewFile/12966/12830>

and wealth, at the expense of everything else, which marks the final phase. The outer shell of civilization, precisely as it grasps power, wastes away.

In something reminiscent of pyramid schemes and cultic orders, with perhaps a bit of sheer bee-like and herd-like behaviour thrown in, everyone's greatest concern is to escape the smaller town and go "where something is happening", which is to say, money, power, and other attractions.

This phase is operates to help America become a "world city". More and more people are invited; more and more countries are invaded⁴²⁵. The entire country, from the Everglades to Gnome, Alaska, becomes a truly diverse *cosmopolis*. This befits America's status as "most advanced region" of the planet, future home of the "world-city" that turns all other places into backwaters, from which to draw more staying power and ferment. True, others imitate us (Europe, most of all), yet half-heartedly. Some regions even attempt to un-imitate us: witness Putin's intransigence over the Ukraine. **And wouldn't the invasion of the Ukraine make Russia more diverse?**

What happens when 1789 comes round again, & the countryside (this time) is prepared to resist, not just in the Vendee⁴²⁶, but all across the planet, when China and Brazil and Portugal all say "no" to the unbridled spread of the end of history? Or will they? Will America be forced to fulminate more Revolution at home, in order both to project enough power, and to maintain enough solidarity to convince the other regions to cooperate? What happens when the Revolution begins to devour its own children⁴²⁷? My guess is that the stakes have risen, since America is becoming divided, and losing its power to project grandiosity and force. So there is a lot on the table, to lose, at this point, for the Revolution,

⁴²⁵<http://isteve.blogspot.com/2012/09/invoke-world-invite-world-gag-american.html>

⁴²⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/War_in_the_Vend%C3%A9e

⁴²⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jacques_Mallet_du_Pan

with Russia thinking about dusting off the crown of Christ and China waffling over whether liberal democracy is really a valid replacement for a civilization that lasted over 4000 years⁴²⁸.

What ought to be done to prepare, in an outward sense?

Plinio Correa de Oliveira⁴²⁹ makes some tantalizing remarks about the Revolution and Counter-Revolution which should help the contemporary “American”.

1. Those who are “of the Reaction” are, by their very nature, exposed to ridicule and a feeling of helplessness, sometimes even in their own eyes, as their ignorance contributes to a lack of realization of who they are: in this sense, the “wholeness” they partially lack is mimicked by competing systems of thought which may confuse their soul, providing a sense that although they can never fit, yet what they cannot fit into possesses some of the qualities they intuitively seek, such as legitimacy (in this case, illusory). It forces them to view themselves in a tragic light. This, of course, is all the better for “the Revolution”, as it consigns their worst enemies to the outer darkness, partially self-imposed. We get to pay the upkeep on our own soul-prison.

2. Many are latent Reactionaries: that is, their upper levels of soul are dominated by the current thought paradigms, but deeper down, they are instinctively “men of the Right”. These people simply need firm guidance, and to be shown strong moral character, coupled with principled action and depth of soul. They will be drawn, just as instinctively, to those of the first category who have stabilized themselves and emerged with the Hyperborean spirit. This second category could be termed “Demetrian⁴³⁰”, instinctively drawn to those who can incarnate the power that they seek and lack. This would be a warrior class, maybe even a priest class, and in converting these classes, the natural capos or leaders would achieve

⁴²⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joseph_Needham

⁴²⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6893>

⁴³⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7233>

a preponderance of force that would allow for an overthrow of the Revolution, and a change in the balance of power. The Revolution succeeds by hiding its aims; the Counter Revolution can only succeed *by revealing its aims to this class*, but the manifestation has to be multi-dimensional, profound, and utterly authentic. Nothing less would convince the sturdy, hapless enforcers of Revolution who unwittingly serve the very forces they hate at a deeper level.

3. He compares the Revolution to the vine in the Amazon rain forests called the strangler fig⁴³¹. I have often made the mistake of thinking (and so have others, I suppose) that “this couldn’t last”. But in a startling metaphor from the *Liber Naturae*⁴³², (Buch der Natur⁴³³), our author shows us that the goal of the strangler fig is to kill the host *and establish itself as a free standing tree*. Of course, the original tree will not be allowed to live after it has served its purpose: this is why the Revolution hid and covered its aims. It wanted “this and that”, or “old and new”, together: tolerance for the lower castes, that’s all. But the true aim is the annihilation of the original tree, which suggests that envy and hatred are, in reality, the real motivating causes of the Revolution after all, rather than compassion. The two organisms are incompatible, and only one has the essence of Life. This dissembling is a weak point in the Left, as they are now the “authentic and legitimate order”, and our author says that firm and unwavering contradiction in a manly spirit, even against overwhelming social disapproval, is the only way of unmasking the lie – as Veuillot⁴³⁴ says, *the emptiness flees contradiction*. Any real resistance will be met by deceived men of the number two category, and their involvement in persecution will only serve to enlighten them as to the

⁴³¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ficus_aurea

⁴³²<http://blog.adw.org/2010/11/the-word-of-god-is-more-than-a-boo-k-a-reflection-from-the-post-synodal-exhortation-verbum-domini/>

⁴³³https://de.wikipedia.org/wiki/Buch_der_Natur

⁴³⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Louis_Veuillot

real aims of the Revolution and the real worth of the “rebel” (who is the opposite of one). The Left has been winning without even trying for so long, that a real dose of suffering of any kind, at whatever level (including the wallet) would quickly make it clear that only the men of the Right have the freedom to overcome circumstances. This is quite clear right now in the crisis over Crimea: Russians are willing to sacrifice to restore the Third Rome, however imperfectly, and Americans are too lazy to even understand the issues involved, let alone drip any blood. Russia wins. America has been purging herself of the men who are of the mettle to make American force stick overseas; it remains to be seen whether she can perfectly finish the Revolution at home, as more and more of the aims come out of the closet in order to ascend the decayed altars like demons haunting the throne.

4. It is imperative to promote the association of men who are truly of the Right. Cologero has gone to great lengths to do just that, & it will be up to us to continue this push. By providing a “home” and the camaraderie that all men need, noble or not, but which we alone tend to lack, given the circumstances, an important element of morale is introduced, as well as the opportunity to learn from one another, and no longer feel “alone”. Many here have voiced how lonely it is out there, and this is true. But the hearth fire burns, despite the cold winter night. There are various ways of seeking this kind of fellowship, but it is fundamental to mental sanity during the apex of Revolution, the height of its power, just before it begins to turn upon itself. We are going to need all of our wits and resources in the years ahead, as Chaos is standing at offstage right, and the raving lunatics of the Left are congregating at stage left. After all, when Satan is on the throne, what can he really say about Revolution?

That’s probably insulting to Satan. What we’ve got on our throne is a collective demon or elemental force, generated by centuries of passions and muddled thought. Satan is a man of Law, and wouldn’t dream of having dinner with revolutionaries. He’d rather joust with a man of the

Right.

Posted on 2014-04-04 by Logres

* * *

Roman Bernard on 2014-04-06 at 04:45 said:

Typo: La Révolution dévore ses enfants
(with an “e”)

JA on 2014-04-06 at 13:53 said:

One thing I must keep pointing out is Guenon's writing in “The Reign of Quantity and the Signs of the Times” that the present atheist-materialist epoch – based on the absence of God – will be replaced with a counterfeit spiritual society – based on a false God – which accords perfectly with the Apocalypse of St John explaining how the Antichrist will be worshiped as God... ..which is why I believe that the American consumerist global society will fall to a Russian-Eurasianist faux “traditional” world order that will be the reign of Antichrist... ..until the Grand Monarch arises from France to restore true Catholicity... ..

Pickman on 2014-04-06 at 14:37 said:

True JA. Also consider that the angle of critique coming against the scientific-mechanistic milieu is from the new-age spiritualist clique.

Tradition must assert itself.

Logres on 2014-04-06 at 18:47 said:

Why would the true monarch come from France?

JA on 2014-04-06 at 19:47 said:

Logres, dear brother – Catholic prophecy predicts the coming of a French grand monarch to save Europe and Christendom from evil, if you would like I can post some links to various writings from the saints mentioning this.

Also, using Evola – things come full circle, the revolution began in France, it will end in France... ..

Timotheus Lutz on 2014-04-06 at 20:27 said:

‘Also, using Evola – things come full circle, the revolution began in France, it will end in France...’

That seems rather short-sighted. The subversive explosion of 1789 was the result of trends that had for very long been present all over Europe.

Michael on 2014-04-06 at 22:27 said:

JA, If you don't mind, please post a good source for the prophecies concerning the grand monarch. I'd like to learn more. I wonder why it would be the king of France and not the emperor.

Logres on 2014-04-07 at 00:34 said:

It would be fitting for the French to atone for 1789. King Arthur, not to mention (as noted) the Emperor under the Mountain, make for fine candidates as well. Prophecy is not to be despised.

JA on 2014-04-07 at 08:35 said:

<http://www.todayscatholicworld.com/great-catholic-monarch.htm>

1.60 Tomberg's Labor

Valentin Tomberg (as any reader of this blog by now knows) plays a not insignificant role in linking Christianity with esotericism, even paganism (of the older kind). It would be easy to just go through and cherry pick random quotes from Tomberg: this would actually turn out much better than one might imagine, since Tomberg manages to stuff every sentence with profound meaning and an inner direction which helps even isolated sentences maintain their context.

There is a particular section of text which helps to elucidate his purpose more sharply and pointedly than is his wont, as Tomberg usually manages to hide in plain sight. On my first reading of the text, I apparently gleaned much less than I missed, and am ashamed to say that this only jumped out on a second reading.

The macrocosmic sphere of paradise (St Paul's third heaven) and the microcosmic layer of Eden are the *initia* (beginning) to which one is initiated in the macrocosmic initiation as well as in the microcosmic initiation. Ecstasy to the heights beyond one's self

and entasy into the depths within one's self lead to knowledge of the same fundamental truth. Christian esotericism unites these two methods of initiation.

There is his entire program in a nutshell (incidentally we see that the Christian method is more about the union of the *modes*, rather than emphasis on the division between the two *techniques*). He is writing a secular "John" for a modern age. This is very like Goethe re-casting Job in *Faust*, except thankfully Tomberg actually claims to know what he is doing, and seems to back this up. In other words, Valentin Tomberg is actually claiming that a Christian can mingle the exoteric and esoteric modes of knowing in their own person, without (and this is the important point) compromising or losing either one individually.

If this claim reminds you of the claims regarding Christ and the *homo ouison* with or without iotas (made by successive councils⁴³⁵) it should, for that is actually his aim. The Christian is a "little Christ", and Tomberg wishes to perfect Nature (exoteric religion) with Super-Nature (esoteric meaning), without however losing either the Self or the "Self beyond the Selves". Jesus is the man-God, and Christians are also called to be fully God and truly man. He is not splitting hairs, he is describing or coming to terms with, something *he had already fully experienced*.

The figure of the Emperor is the "truest man" (King David), and the hermit (prophet) is the most like God (fully God), remarks Tomberg in his chapter on the Pope. The pope (or priest) actually balances earth with heaven. So an invisible principle of union is here shown to be concretely uniting two seeming opposites. Here we have Soloviev's "Ideas", with the veil lift by for a moment, Tomberg explaining the Arcanum that shows even the invisible worlds correspond to Law rather than Chaos. For here it is not a matter of seeing contrasts, and is never a matter of contrasts.

⁴³⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/First_Council_of_Nicaea

John Michael Greer brilliantly points out⁴³⁶ that focusing on differences actually obscures them (this is because, as Iamblichus teaches, you have to start with One, not Two). If you focus on similarities, the differences are seen truly and starkly for what they are.

Any present or future set of events, however unique it may be in terms of the fine details, has points of similarity with events in the past, and those points of similarity allow the past events to be taken as a guide to the present and future. This works best if you've got a series of past events, as different from each other as any one of them is from the present or future situation you're trying to predict; if you can find common patterns in the whole range of past parallels, it's usually a safe bet that the same pattern will recur again. Any time you approach a present or future event, then, you have two choices: you can look for the features that event has in common with other events, despite the differences of detail, or you can focus on the differences and ignore the common features. The first of those choices, it's worth noting, allows you to consider both the similarities and the differences. Once you've got the common pattern, it then becomes possible to modify it as needed to take into account the special characteristics of the situation you're trying to understand or predict: to notice, for example, that the dark age that will follow our civilization will have to contend with nuclear and chemical pollution on top of the more ordinary consequences of decline and fall. If you start from the assumption that the event you're trying to predict is unlike anything that's ever happened before, though, you've thrown out your chance of perceiving the common pattern. What happens instead, with monotonous regularity, is that pop-culture narratives such as the sudden overnight collapse beloved of Hollywood screenplay writers smuggle themselves into the picture, and ce-

⁴³⁶<http://thearchdruidreport.blogspot.com/2014/03/american-delusionism-or-why-history.html>

ment themselves in place with the help of confirmation bias. The result is the endless recycling of repeatedly failed predictions that plays so central a role in the collective imagination of our time, and has helped so many people blind themselves to the unwelcome future closing in on us.

So the “hermetic” method is actually just *sanity*, applied in depth and height, of the common-sense-rule of having a unity-principle and not forcing apples to be seen as oranges. If one sees sleep follow work, then awakening follow sleep in Nature, one can assume (by analogy) that Death follows Life, and then Life supersedes Death. This is the affirmation of the Great Chain of Being⁴³⁷, the “Book of Nature”, the Analogia Entis.

So (too) we can say that it is the inner “priest” in man which reconciles the manly-earthly King with the God-mad prophet, in the dark of night, before the black turns to red, white, then gold at the dawning of the Sun. There is always a balance, and always a “higher level”. This is because God is always God: “higher up, and further in”. As Tomberg says, choose spiritual death, and choose hell: choose Life, and you have chosen God. It’s so simple, children can do it, and so complex, that even seraphim yearn to be able to see clearly.

This occurs within Christian esotericism, and within the Christian esotericist, who privileges neither the *badge* of Christianity nor the *heritage* or *technique* of ancient practices *which are given new life through baptism*. Does anyone really suppose that it would be “spiritually exciting” to live under the rule of the tutelary stars in the same sense that the heathen did? So that an ill omen meant almost certain death? The heathen are a picture of our natural man, sunk in darkness. Paradoxically, it is the man who learns that he is under the rule of stars who then begins to escape that rule of the stars, and the wise man becometh free. This is why

⁴³⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_chain_of_being

astrology is as much an art as a science, and why the Middle Ages baptized it, but *did not use it to replace* the mass and the organized Christian religion. In any event, men like Pythagoras were not subject to the stars in the same sense that the local god-fearing goat-herders were. He learned to judge the angels, & it was this that made him free. So the “Christian” sees that while there is “progress” (and man learns to be “free” of powers), yet these things were altogether written for our sakes⁴³⁸, because we have the same process to over go in miniature. So, in a sense we are more free, in a sense we are less: welcome to the Kali Yuga. The point is to find God.

In the same manner, it is the true “Christian” who both grasps intuitively the power of the antique Tradition, & yet sees it living through its transformations in Christianity and onto into and despite the Kali Yuga; he or she it is who can keep the contradictions together because he approaches from a standpoint of *faith*, rather than doubt, and thus *doesn’t sink into experience* through the moving, opening, readying of wavering doubt (like Eve before the apple). This is the man who can keep *entasy* (unpeeling one’s soul layers) and *ecstasy* (voyaging into God) from dissolving together into the slime of muddle and confusion that tends to stamp those trying to be “spiritual” in the Dark Ages, using the one to heighten and enhance the other. The same wind wrecks one vessel, and lifts another one over the waves. The same wind drives down some birds, and causes the hawk to soar. Jesus the God-man is the true *in hoc signo vinces*⁴³⁹ for the esotericist or exotericist, since both are valid, and both “mean” the same thing. This is one of the meanings of the hypostatic union: that there is fully each, without loss of either.

Faith precedes experience because sense experience alone takes too long, and tends to lose one in a “dark wood”. Additionally, “faith” is actually a divine principle which begins to work before it is either deserved or understood. It thus appears “blind” to the blind, and “powerless” to the

⁴³⁸http://biblehub.com/1_corinthians/9-10.htm

⁴³⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/In_hoc_signo_vinces

powerless. It is actually the power and potency of God, Who is willing to act *long before man is worthy of it*. Thus, it is power, because man (at that juncture) has no power. In this way, man is invited to cooperate with God, and that is the price of ascent and the meaning of the night time, which sees great growth. *But this merely accords with the Nature principle of paganism*: a seed has to first fall into the ground and die, before it can have the life of the tree. Likewise, God's power is so great, it first has to die, because it has to "make a little space" for man by withdrawing, or else man could not be. God is so powerful, He can afford to suffer in silence. God alone can afford it. Here is the meaning both of *kenosis*⁴⁴⁰ and of grace.

We will be looking at Tomberg's journey, through the eyes of the *Meditations* (and using some of the notes sent out on the mailing list, not to mention Cologero's observations and thoughts), however, it will primarily be an attempt to unfold or unpack some of his meaning, so that it stands out more clearly, so that others can "meditate" (which was his whole purpose anyway).

Posted on 2014-04-11 by Logres

1.61 The Syllables of the Gods

I want to call attention to an aspect of Tomberg's work that is perhaps unnoticed. He writes so straightforwardly, so poetically, so lucidly, that one can obtain an illusion (particularly if you are only reading with your discursive intellect) that you are understanding him without, in fact, catching on. I know because I did this.

And then I have cited a verse from the Song of the Soul of St John of the Cross, because it has the virtue of awakening the deeper layers of the soul...

⁴⁴⁰<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kenosis>

There it is, at the beginning of the Magician, a few sentences into his work. He means this quite literally. He who wishes to awaken deeper layers of his soul can memorize, meditate upon, and at times recite this verse. In modern parlance, this poetry is a *spell*. This is not to be taken in a mechanical way, as if one could (in the sleep state) merely mouth these words and expect great things to occur in one's interior life. However, it is quite literally true nonetheless. I suppose there are other verses of poetry which could do the same thing, such as Novalis' *Hymns to the Night*, or passages from Wordsworth, which taught and inspired a large portion of the generation of Victorians, people whose souls were arguably a lot thicker and deeper than ours tend to be today.

By the very act and virtue (read this word as immanent/inherent potency or power, not merely sentimental moral quality) of having a sacred Latin language in which the Scriptures could be memorized during the Middle Ages, our spiritual ancestors imparted a species of magical and incantatory power to their thoughts, words, and meditations on the Divine. He who committed all of the Psalms to memory (as those who began their course of monastic study at Cassiodorus' school had to do, a precedent which held for successor schools) had training as a doctor, an exorcist, a priest, a sage, and perhaps even a magician.

This doesn't mean that we have to advocate a revival of Latin. Think of reading antique poetry or Scripture as an exercise in active-passive receptivity, as does the high priestess, who covers the intermediate realms with a veil, who is seated, who is reading a book, and who wears the tiara with three levels. She is not "busy" inventing narratives, exploring fantasies, or hammering out rationalizations/self-justifications. In other words, she is distinctly un-modern (in the shallow sense). We are perfectly cognizant of Goethe's famous dictum that a man who is not of his own times, cannot be a man of any, but what we are insisting on is a genuine multiculturalism, rather than one in name only. Is it not right to place ourselves in the shoes of our ancestors? To see the world from their eyes?

CS Lewis got this far, but we go further⁴⁴¹: we claim that in this act of transcending our own times, of traveling into the medieval and Renaissance world which gave birth to the French hermetic tradition, we will encounter the timelessness which is always *there*.

Here is another verse of poetry that contains a magical motive power:

A painter of the Umbrian school
 designed upon a gesso ground
 the nimbus of the baptized God:
 the wilderness is cracked and brown.
 But through the water pale and thin
 still shine the unoffending feet
 and there above the Painter set
 the Father and the Paraclete.

What does poetry set us down in the middle of? What is it that does not change, which is beyond even the syllables of the Gods⁴⁴²? Even if we say that Change is eternal and supreme, then this is what does not change. As Calasso writes, *men always tell themselves, do as the gods do*. The Christian tradition regards that which is deathless, which changes not, as God. There are other names for it, including the Tao. *That which suffers hell, and abides, is deathless. That which aspires to God, and is not shaken, is deathless* (my paraphrasing of Ur von Balthasar in *Theo-Logic*). In poetry, we enter a word of multiplicity and duality, but without a loss of the living Logos, since within the syllables remains a path which draws us toward a remembered unity. Poetry (therefore) has been considered an antidote for the flux or dialectic of Reality that spirals downward: poetry attempts to reverse this flow and raise the reader or poet upward. Philosophy and religion (exotericism) make what is implicit in poetry

⁴⁴¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3545>

⁴⁴²<http://www.amazon.com/Literature-Gods-Roberto-Calasso/dp/0375725431>

more explicit, at the cost (sometimes) of vividness or innate vitality, but with a gain in discipline or form. The Autonomous Duality is challenged head-on.

Bonaventura says *non coerci maximo continer tamen a minimo divinum est* (that which is not compelled by the most powerful, but which nevertheless can contain even the smallest thing, that is divine). Wagner has Hans Sachs⁴⁴³ sing,

I feel it and can not understand it,
can keep it not, but not forgotten:
and I grasp it all, but I can measure it not!
But how should I take also
what seemed to me immeasurable?
No rule would fit there,
and yet no error did it contain.
It sounded so old – and yet was so new
A birdsong as sweet as May!

The fact that we “discover” so many things today is actually a sign of our stupidity. We have a long Fall to recover from. The fact that we have more knowledge of ancient times than our Medieval Age ancestors did doesn’t help us appreciate or understand it any better. Actually, to endure a “Dark Age” and to follow the burning in one’s heart (which is exactly the inner meaning of the Gothic spirituality that flowered in union with the “new religion”) is a sign not of weakness, but of strength. If Time is flowing backwards from the Cross, then the Middle Ages were the restoration of Rome which had fallen in judgement for the sins it committed and the excesses it suffered: the Holy Roman Empire. What came before Rome? The Golden-Silvern-Brazen ages of Empire, and indeed one sees the restoration of these periods in the rise of Euro-Atlantis

⁴⁴³<http://classicalmusic.about.com/od/classicalmusictips/qt/Was-Duftet-Doch-Der-Flieder-Lyrics-And-Text-Translation.htm>

& the rebirth of Russia, the persistence of China. And what was before that? More cataclysms, and even greater civilizations, including Solomon, Egypt, and Atlantis. The world is inundated with the Great Flood, under the sign of the Fish. Those who breath underwater will survive. God is re-creating the world.

Why is this? Is this not the triumph of the “last man”, the craveling, and the weakling? We assert that water is the element of Life. This is why Lao-Tzu compares the Tao with water, because it goes to the lowest spot and generates life from below. It does not contend, and therefore, it wins the victory. The element of water is not mixed (as is earth), it is not perishable with what it consumes (as is fire), it is not evanescent (like the air). It is therefore, the first sign of life, of baptism, and of the upward spiral which (when it reflects what is above faithfully) partakes of the upward movement. Vicktor Shauburger⁴⁴⁴ has some interesting insights on water, how it generates power/life from inside of the spiral.

The High Priestess reminds us that our “feminine” side is not female, but rather active-passive, generating through creative imagination the needed ascent as it reflects in a virginal pool what comes from above. The Dyad⁴⁴⁵ can be identified with the Wisdom (Sophia) of God. Together with the Monad, the Dyad is the parent of all which comes after.

Since all of us recapitulate the Macro-Cosm, it is necessary to find the virginal pool within ourselves. This is an act, as Plato taught, of remembering. I find what is already there, what is changeless, relative to the flow of thoughts, feelings, sensations which are multiple and are not “I”, but rather than which the I perceives.

It is important not to mistake the congerie of little “i”s or a particular configuration of these “i”s (which are legion) for the real I. As Tomberg puts it, there are illusions “above” just as there are illusions “below”. The more deeply and truly one strips away these mechanical programs (which

⁴⁴⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3SNnHyaLwi8>

⁴⁴⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5557>

operate automatically and easily and comfortably, not to mention deceptively), the firmer ground one is able to stand and then sit upon.

In the movement away from the “I” to the narrative of the “we”, of liberation and of activism, to the time-bound provinciality of the modern “hermetic” who is sealed within a plastic and airtight capsule of great artifice, I see a parody of the Divine process which was intended to reawaken the soul. In this substitution is not Life, but death, because it contradicts the very highest spiritual laws of liberty, which is that one must first dare to the Unity, then listen to it properly.

Tomberg has already outlined the katalogical movement of the soul as it mimics the Tao of God, and catches fire with Truth. It is aspiration/mysticism, gnosis, magic, revelation. These are the syllables of the God, Yod-He-Vau-He.

Even dialectic itself has its place, but not as a substitute God or a false self.

Posted on 2014-05-17 by Logres

1.62 Nature’s Lessons on Interior Friction

Cologero has beautifully highlighted the central paradox⁴⁴⁶ of “he who wishes to rise” or “the aspirant”:

It is clear in fact that if persuasion sharpens itself to a pure, unrelated sufficiency—i.e., to a statey—rather than to sufficiency as denial of an insufficiency—i.e. to an *act*, to a *relationy*—the antithesis certainly has a value and is

explained: in a first moment, the I *must* posit privation, a non-value, even if under the condition that it is posited solely because it must be denied, since this act of negation, and this alone, makes the value of persuasion come to light.

⁴⁴⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7360>

It should be unnecessary to point out that the analogue in the Christian religion is the mystery of both the Incarnation and the Resurrection: Why would the imperishable, how would it, take on flesh and the carnation of the body?

This is the narrow eye for the rational Western intellect, honed to a fine point: How in the world can one deny the world in order to affirm it? But if it is not a question of denial purely, but a countervailing power, then the denial is an illusion, a trick of the darkened Nous.

In fact, there is only one solution to the “dilemma” of the “waking mind”: only that which transcends it can legitimately call upon it to give over its discursive logic (or, more accurately, suspend it), in order to calm the being and become aware of both deeper and higher levels (which in the storm of our ordinary life, are often transposed and confused).

I would like to point out a natural analogue, which perhaps those of a Druidic bent may appreciate. It is in fact the case that when one deals with energy generation in Nature, it is the downward spiral in both water and air (the waterfall and the tornado) which creates a sufficient counterpoise and balance that inverts the energy and gives rise to enough power to actually over come physical laws, or at least their resting state. It is in this manner⁴⁴⁷ that the fish often traverse up a creek or stream, and it is in the moment of the touchdown of the air funnel that maximum power is created, both to destroy and also (in some instances), to carry things up into the funnel and deposit them safely elsewhere. Fire of course must have similar processes, and lightning in fact demonstrates a similar process: enough friction is built up between opposing points that an energy transfer occurs, and the water and the black give place to fire and light. Vicktor Schauburger⁴⁴⁸ spent years in the forests of Germany drawing lessons from nature, lessons which could have benefited from

⁴⁴⁷<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3SNnHyaLwi8>

⁴⁴⁸http://www.amazon.com/gp/product/1858600480/ref=ox_sc_act_title_1?ie=UTF8&psc=1&smid=A256Y65LR9QM8G

the interpretation and essay on Nature that appeared in Evola's work on magic.

In the Orthodox tradition, it is taught that if the *Nous* concentrates upon itself, it is inexorably drawn, powerlessly (from a material point of view) towards the Divine, the Eye of the Eye.

For the aspirant, it should get easier to see the symbols around one and to not merely read them in an intellectual sense, but to draw spiritual sustenance and power from them. This is a process which ideally terminates in interior friction, as Boris Mouraviëff teaches in *Gnosis*. What we perceive as an inconvenience, an irritation, even misery and suffering, is actually an opportunity, our only opportunity, to create a central paradox sufficiently powerful enough to regenerate the interior (and exterior, eventually...) being.

This is not mystification (as exoteric Christians in my own circles regard it) or a retreat into "the God within"⁴⁴⁹ (as this website tends to see things), but rather a wise use of the only resource available to us in our fallen condition. This inner friction, then, is our salvation, and it can be sharpened to the point of persuasion, or conversion, rather than dissipated in a lot of bluster and squabbling with ourselves over innumerable inner contradictions between the various "I"s.

It is because these various "I"s are unaware of each other that we drift from configuration to configuration, and only dimly and fitfully remember, at rare moments, that this is not what life is about.

Lying to one's self about this quenches the Spirit and dissipates the inner friction to the point that we reach an equilibrium between opposing forces, a point at which the net sum is Zero. Instead, the goal is to create the Primal One, and overcome moral bankruptcy and death. From this, flows Deathlessness.

"Narrow is the way, straight is the gate, and few there are that find it".

⁴⁴⁹<http://civilizingthebeast.blogspot.com/>

Anyone interested in tracing this autobiographically in the life of a Western saint can find this mapped out in Augustine's *Confessions*, brilliantly arranged in Jean Luc Marion's seminal work on the subject⁴⁵⁰.

Augustine anticipated even the decay of postmodernity, and goes beyond it by seeing that the Self has an excess over and beyond itself, an excess that in the Tradition is called "the Self Beyond the Self", or God.

It is this that made our fathers men, and some of them, more than that.

Posted on 2014-08-02 by Logres

* * *

Paulo on 2014-08-05 at 16:57 said:

Who can have the strenght today to make this friction? Finding a hard woman and going after hear with all the difficulties in the way,when there is a lot of easy woman all around?

Fallen Adam on 2019-05-12 at 16:07 said:

"For the aspirant, it should get easier to see the symbols around one and to not merely read them in an intellectual sense, but to draw spiritual sustenance and power from them. This is a process which ideally terminates in interior friction, as Boris Mouravieff teaches in Gnosis. What we perceive as an inconvenience, an irritation, even misery and suffering, is actually an opportunity, our only opportunity, to create a central paradox sufficiently powerful enough to regenerate the interior (and exterior, eventually...) being."

I understand that we need to have a more contemplative relation to nature and our inner life, in that we try to get a perception of their deeper meanings and analogical relations. What is the connection of this, to moments of suffering and hardship however? Is it that we need to look at our exterior problems and negative parts of the inner life, according to their place in the whole meaning of our life and creation in general.

Logres on 2019-05-15 at 23:27 said:

⁴⁵⁰http://www.amazon.com/Selfs-Place-Approach-Augustine-Cultural/dp/0804762910/ref=sr_1_1?s=books&ie=UTF8&qid=1406959858&sr=1-1&keywords=jean+luc+marion+augustine

Mouravieff teaches that conscience (consciously awakened) is the only instrument powerful enough to fuse the disparate and conflicted elements of being. That is why lying to yourself (with the twin sins of pride and complacency) is the cardinal sin that holds us back, because we cannot even hear our conscience, let alone act upon it in anything but a desultory manner. Which is too slow for a mortal life span. Have you read the first volume of Gnosis? Would you consider participating in the Gnosis group, to further your own understanding? Group work is a really helpful means of speeding up the process of learning to suffer consciously in a way that sows the seeds for something else to grow, such as a worldview that more accurately reflects objective reality and begins to grasp it in a living way. But you have to experience the difference, and then learn to experience it consciously. So, yes, we have to start experiencing our suffering consciously, in terms of the whole, which means addressing inner lies and contradictions. Seeing those consciously changes the dynamic and creates possibilities. We have to see “thou art the man” (prophet Nathan to King David). It would be justifiably depressing if one’s fallen personal everyday state was “the measure of all being”. But that’s what we tell ourselves, left to ourselves.

<https://www.gornahoor.net/Library/mouravieff1.pdf>

The link, if you don’t have it, to the first volume

1.63 **Ecce Ancilla Domini**

All magic is the putting into practice of the maxim: the subtle rules the dense, writes Tomberg. He quotes the words of Mary to the angel Gabriel at the head of the chapter. The empress symbolizes the super-consciousness ruling the consciousness (which rules force, which rules matter). The crown on the head of the empress represents the super-consciousness ruling consciousness. Papus defines magic as “the application of the strengthened human will to accelerate the evolution of the living forces of Nature”, while Peladan defines magic as “the art of the sublimation of man”. Magic is also “the science of Love”. The attentive reader should think of Dante, because the stars are moved by Love, and the stars rule us, to begin with, as intermediaries. The aim is accelerated evolution, the means are Love, symbolized by the Eagle and the sceptre.

Valerie Flint has done good research⁴⁵¹ on Christianity's unique relation to magic during the Middle Ages: Christianity baptized and used a great portion of it, for several reasons, in a traditional manner. She argues that Christianity succeeded in large measure because her priests were more effective at dealing with curses, disease, and moral darkness than were the pagan peers, and also because they learned what was best from old Europe. I encourage people to consider if this may need to become so once again.

Redemption, he goes on to say, requires the synergy of two wills: the divine and the human. Therefore, when Peter heals a man (Acts 9:32-34), the involvement of Peter is not a superfluity or accident. The healing required Peter; nevertheless, it is true that it came completely from God as well. Tomberg refers this mystery to the Incarnation, and it requires deep meditation. Sacred magic renders service, not merely to what is above, but to that which is below. Thus, it is not merely the vulgar connotation of "magic" that is of interest, but thaumaturgy. It is first necessary to contact the Divine (mysticism), then it is necessary to decode this in the understanding (gnosis), prior to the putting into action of that which is "given". The magus becomes a link between that which is higher, and aims to heal, and that which is lower, and requires assistance. The mage is crucified, but the magus is not a martyr: rather, he is a thaumaturgist⁴⁵². The aim of magic is "liberated action". Tomberg notes that had he not visited the Chapel of the Holy Blood at Bruges⁴⁵³, he could not have written this chapter.

What does this mean? Cologero has written over and over that books do not a conversion make, let alone an internet career. Religion itself,

⁴⁵¹http://www.amazon.com/Rise-Magic-Early-Medieval-Europe/dp/0691001103/ref=sr_1_1?ie=UTF8&qid=1410577722&sr=8-1&keywords=valerie+flint+magic

⁴⁵²<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iamblichus>

⁴⁵³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Basilica_of_the_Holy_Blood

to be vivified and vivifying, has to be founded in mysticism (faith), illumined by gnosis (hope) and actuated by sacred magic (love). It grows cold without faith, clouds without gnosis, and is impotent without magic.

And yet, the books are somehow necessary⁴⁵⁴. Who among us can say that, without books, we would pursue divine study with more acumen? We receive this learning, however, at second and third hand, all the same, and all the more. This is one of the meanings of Tradition. A man speaks, a disciple writes, a reader learns, a teacher passes on, a learner assimilates, a wise man remembers, and the flame passes down. It is a fact that super-consciousness guides the story of the Cosmos, and that in the Ashkaric records (which Tomberg takes to exist as a matter of fact), there is a living proof that even the Eternal itself keeps records, records events, remembers the passing human simulation, a simulation with a divine end and point.

There is a tendency in humanity not to take itself seriously enough, or to take itself seriously in a flat and horizontal way (and this split is a typical tendency towards dichotomy and flattened, binary thought). The “cure” for this proceeds along the lines of divine magic. Just as humans have a variety of means and methods for getting over physical illness, so do humans find a variety of means for getting over moral illness. This “divine attractor” (which can, quite frankly, be judged by its fruits) draws a great many parallel lines through a great many planes and worlds. These are curative: that is to say, they are (in Mouravieff’s terms) “B” influences. It is up to the synergy of the human will with the divine to both discern and cooperate with them. *That is all that we can do*. Initially, without Him, we can do nothing. It is only farther down the road that there ceases to be a division between the divine and human will in terms of friction and resistance.

If you reach for something, and fail, and yet that something stays beside you and gives itself to you, you have experienced the divine magic, because the point was to see that you could not possess it, it had to be

⁴⁵⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Philobiblon

given to you. And who else gives it to you but the Friend above”. In the Psalms, it teaches expressly that “he gives gifts to those who are below” (in Hades). How much more to those who pursue the disciplines of “accelerated evolution”? This is a rigorously mathematical certainty, from the lesser to the greater. Glory to God for His long suffering (an ancient invocation for healing in any situation), the argument from the greater to the lesser is also valid! If He loves the righteous, will He not also seek out the last sheep? Who can possibly understand this? Why should God be operative in both directions, from below towards the “above”, and from above towards the “below”?

This is because God is Love: He is the energy that moves the universe, the stars, which moves us. But of course, we are meant to move the stars. The one way to do this, is to achieve the energy of being in the state of Love, mistress and empress of magic.

Posted on 2014-09-13 by Logres

1.64 The Lutheran Reformation

It’s October, and I am thinking, inexorably, of the Protestant Reformation, where my spiritual roots lie. In order to do those roots justice (it does no good to saw them in two), I have to understand the contention made against the Church of the West, the Latin Roman Catholic Church. Now there are two types of attacks usually made on the Church: one of these points to specific abuses (in the modern day, these have to do with altar boys, but I qualified this ever since I found out⁴⁵⁵ that most of the perpetrators were priests the Church let in under pressure from Vatican II reforms and the Cultural Wars, after the 60s, in the decade 1970-1980), and the other has to do with the doctrine of Sola Fide. So that it is important to remember that the RCC was liberalizing when it got burned:

⁴⁵⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_Jay_Report

that is, it let in a lot of alternative candidates who would not ordinarily have been anything but rejects, following the pressure of the spirit of the Times, and predictably, got what it deserved. But this is not really an argument against the RCC per se, so much as it is a cautionary morality tale: better to have stood against the world and gone under, than to have compromised and then tried to hide the sorry result. I assume that indulgence sales must have operated along the same lines: lots of pressure from secular rulers to loosen up those tight demands, and make things more accessible to the money changers and to Mammon.

It is easily seen that *Sola Fide* was an attempt to cut open the circle of God's decrees at one proper, precise point, the point where the energies of God touched the response of man. The circle of God's decrees met at this one point, in the response of faith. This was done so that man could take a minimum of credit (belief, or trust, is a very responsive, passive, spiritual reaction to the action God had already objectively accomplished in the finished work of the cross), and so that God could get a maximum of glory (the faith response only proved that the Spirit had regenerated a man. From above, God reaches down in election, but the regeneration operates from below: both are accomplished through that eternal love that operates from the foundations of the world. Thus, even in salvation, man is caught in the pressure of God's Providence acting from above, and God's decretal purposes entering from below (AA Hodge said that regeneration occurs in the subconscious). The design of this was to preserve second order acts (Free Will and the apparent synergism of having to "come to Christ" in an act of Faith), without sacrificing (or at least sacrificing a minimum of) God's sovereignty. Of course, inevitably there were theologians and sectarian leaders who wondered, out loud and in print, that if there was no mystery in the Eucharist, why should there be any mystery in the *Ordo Salutis* either? So their conclusion was that no Law at all was required: if you were saved, you were saved, and if not, you weren't. This only pushed the mystery back to why there was such

a “salvation” or Supernature at all, treating the Incarnation and all its effects like a cancer that needed shrinking. As we shall see, Revolution does precisely this: it is, at root, a vast oversimplification (which explains the apparent emphasis on sophistication in “matters indifferent”, ie., technology). Luther himself was no Revolutionary, and didn’t anticipate fully where his ideas lead, although he saw enough⁴⁵⁶ to smell trouble. Likewise, Calvinism itself is a kind of “shorthand”, which is true as far as it goes. Here is what Evola said of it:

As for Christianity in its less popular forms, it presents an aspect of the tragic doctrine of salvation, which to some extent preserves an echo of the ancient truth: the idea—pushed to extremes by Luther and Calvin—that man on earth stands at the crossroads between Salvation and eternal damnation. This point of view, if lived intensely and coherently, could create the conditions for liberation at the moment of death or in postmortem states.

Note 2, page 96, *The Hermetic Tradition*

Note that Evola (unlike Luther or especially Calvin) is not committed to the idea that this “shorthand” represents a comprehensive treatment of spiritual matters. In all of this, the intent was flawlessly impeccable. The Reformation presented itself as a restoration of the full orbbed, original Gospel, over against the new Phariseism of works religion that had forgotten what the point was. Indeed, Luther’s *Anfechtung*⁴⁵⁷ was actually an experience of moral collapse in the face of the demands of the Gospel, a collapse so total that only self-despair could provide the impetus to embrace Christ in an act of flying to the Cross. Luther was, for instance, interested in the *Theologica Germanica*⁴⁵⁸, which spoke of such spiritual states.

⁴⁵⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/German_Peasants%27_War

⁴⁵⁷<http://www.orlutheran.com/html/anfecht.html>

⁴⁵⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Theologica_Germanica

What could be wrong with this? Well, in a sense, nothing. In fact, it is true that Calvinism and Lutheranism potentially were Restorations of the Gospel. That is exactly what Europe needed: not a Renaissance, but a Restoration. Instead, it got a Revolution. If Lutheranism and Calvinism had preached the comfortable truth that God calls a man as he is, and declares him righteous by imputation to begin the process of salvation, the Church might have been Reformed. Instead, it wasn't Reformed at all, and when the Reformers split off from the Church, by definition, they were admitting that the goal was no longer Reformation. Instead, in places like England, a minority of nobles decided to use it as a pretext to rob the Church and strip the altars⁴⁵⁹. In the Netherlands⁴⁶⁰, mobs of idiot villagers lead by hedge priests smashed works of art that they couldn't even comprehend, let alone create. And in Germany, all hell broke loose.

What could have been an opportunity for the Gothic, North-West European culture to assume its rightful and perhaps even dominant place within Christendom over against an overly Baroque, ossified and undoubtedly corrupt leadership emanating from Rome, instead became a long Deformation and Degeneration of the Church, which has ended in our day by the secular hyper-Calvinization of the religion of Progress. This was, to be clear, the fault of all parties in Europe, on either side.

In addition, the study of the *Ordo Salutis*⁴⁶¹ and the doctrines of Grace (TULIP⁴⁶²) lead to a conviction on the Protestant side that if you didn't speak the precise language of the debate, and agree with the way of framing the question in a specific and penultimate way, you were a heretic

⁴⁵⁹http://www.amazon.com/Stripping-Altars-Traditional-Religion-1400-1580/dp/0300108281/ref=sr_1_1?s=books&ie=UTF8&qid=1414554060&sr=1-1&keywords=eamon+duffy+stripping+altars

⁴⁶⁰<http://www.amazon.com/Calvinist-Preaching-Iconoclasm-Netherlands-1544-1569/dp/0521088836>

⁴⁶¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ordo_salutis

⁴⁶²<http://www.theopedia.com/TULIP>

and anti-Christ. This was partly understandable, given the Catholic intransigence and stubborn insistence that “surely we have to contribute something to our salvation!”, which amounted to agreeing with the way the Protestants framed the debate. In fact, both sides framed the debate in essentially legalistic terms (right down to words like imputation and justification), and conducted it like a court room trial. This was merely a continuation of the Western fascination with innovative abstract categories (you thought the Greeks were bad?) that had lead to the East-West split to begin with. The fall of Rome was so damaging in the West that they had literally lost on a large scale (not totally) the doctrines of illumination and glorification for instance. It was so bad that, for awhile, Irish Christians were in closer communion with the spirit of Egypt than most of the West. Whole provinces (eg., Spain) remained Arian for extended periods of time.

So this was partly a hangover from the time of the Invasions, when God was pictured as the just judge⁴⁶³ coming to town for the hanging assizes, because this was the day-to-day experience to begin with, the raw theological data of human experience. Meanwhile, the Eastern Church acquired a Byzantine varnish that further confused the newly civilized barbarians. The West never really gotten over the fall of Rome, and Luther came along to finish the job. This was a lost opportunity, historically speaking.

So where does this leave me, contemplating the Reformation? I think that the theology of the Cross (as opposed to a theology of Glory) paid some dividends, that the particular way of cutting open the circle of God’s mysterious decrees that the Reformers preferred yielded priceless insights, and that the Northern European Gothic spirit⁴⁶⁴ was probably going to erupt at some point, unfortunately choosing the spiritual arm of

⁴⁶³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dies_Irae

⁴⁶⁴<http://anglicanrose.wordpress.com/2012/07/23/northernness-responder/#more-2822>

Society as its main target (later, would come the turn of the kings). John Ruskin discusses some of this in his *Bible of Amiens*, which I have posted on, and readers can refer to Cologero's posts on the Three Orders⁴⁶⁵ as a start. John Romanides' work is invaluable for illuminating the debate between East and West but reaches very unhelpful conclusions: what the West was, it was, and it might have been much more. Unfortunately, rather than attain spiritual pre-eminence, the Northwest of Europe chose the path of Empire, which (of course) was no longer Holy, but based on mercantile and raiding trader powers, the hated "Anglo-Atlanticism" which Alexander Dugin wishes to bring low. The Reformation set the stage for this by shattering spiritual unity, and further muddying the waters in its outcomes. There is still much to be gained and seen by what it did, both positively and negatively (as we do not wish to imitate the party spirit).

However helpful Reformation theology is (and most people don't know nearly enough about it), it is not helpful to have a naive belief that a particular facet of the Truth contains the sum of all Truth. However true this might be, were men angels, and could they see with angelic sight, mortals (even with the perspicacious Word of God to guide them) have to consider ALL facets of God's truth. Luther wanted to throw out the book of James, for instance, an "epistle of straw". And he seemed to have no knowledge of the ancient, ancient doctrine (both classical and Catholic) that the "Word of God" was much, much more than merely the enscriptured text of the Bible, or even the act of Incarnation: it was everything in between as well, because the worlds were created through a Living *Logos Tòmeus* (this is in your Bible). Additionally, the doctrine of Recapitulation raised the question of the archetype of the Father in relation to the summing up Word or Logos, which means that at the end, it is not the Word that is Supreme because the Word will return everything to the Father. Luther hated philosophy, so he couldn't be bothered with such

⁴⁶⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=the-three-orders>

trifles.

What he did know and realize, was that something had gone very, very wrong in the West. On this account, he was most certainly even more right than he understood. Luther was living in an era in which the Church had already distanced itself off from the German mystic tradition in the North (Tauler, Boehme, Eckhart) and almost cut itself off from its own tradition in Italy (Italy was prepping for Machiavelli and the Renaissance). So his legitimate spiritual experience found no outlet, and he had to formulate the dogmas of the Reformation almost single-handedly, forging them in the fires of his conscience. This would have been a difficult task for a man much better prepared than Luther, and with more help. Like Lenin after Marx, Calvin came after Luther and ossified the Reformation, guaranteeing that the mystery of the Incarnation in its full aspect would be viewed through a very narrow lens, however accurate for purposes of establishing Christian security and comfort, a lens which would be used to focus the fires that would engulf Europe in Revolution.

And this is the tragedy: God had intended a Reformation. However, He has also revealed that He intends to show every work for what it ultimately is. *In this case, Reformation laid the ground work for Revolution. We have to Reform the Reformation.*

To my understanding and knowledge, there is only one Protestant thinker who has ever made or attempted a conclusive study of this process of Reformation, which he failed to see was inherent in some of its doctrines and emphases: Groen van Prinsterer⁴⁶⁶. This is because in most cases, Reformation was accomplished through Revolutionary tactics, and its bad form to bite the hand that feeds you. Van Prinsterer is an anomaly, although Alexander Vinet is an interesting thinker.

It is, for instance, a Revolutionary tactic to throw out babies with bathwater. A legitimate grievance is advanced, and then it is used to jus-

⁴⁶⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guillaume_Groen_van_Prinsterer

tify a comprehensive programme of rebellion. This is precisely the pattern that we see in the Reformation. It started with legitimate insights into truth which badly needed to be shared and spread, and righteous objections to horrific abuses, which badly needed to be stopped, and ended up by tearing apart the body of Christ, killing a quarter or third of Germany and other parts of Europe in the process. The office of pope was tarnished forever, the safety of tradition was undermined, hierarchy was threatened in any form, and most of all, Protestantism lost all contact with mystical and ancient traditions, which resulted in the fomenting of a potent brew of materialism (the Dutch Empires gave rise to other Empires), secularism (particularly in England, where sects had their heyday), and revolution in France along with scepticism and ultimately atheism in Germany (who gave us higher criticism).

How can we honor Luther during Reformation October? We can embrace the truths he so tenaciously clung to, but we won't really embrace the spirit of Luther until we learn to see farther than he did, and to rectify the errors he inevitably set loose. We have to Reform the Reformation. Luther would surely be the first to proclaim that God must have other Reformations in mind, that he was not Christ, that if popes and councils can err, so can Reformers, and that surely his discovery and recovery of Truth (if real) must of necessity lead to even more Truth?

We have slept in Zion. The secularists have claimed Luther as their own. The revolutionaries are faithful to his spirit. The atheists praise him for making every man his own priest. The schismatics and lunatics thank God for Luther's Bible, which enables any idiocy to take the stand along with the most venerable and sacred mysteries in God's Creation. But we, the possessors of his lineage, do nothing but repeat verbatim what he said. Luther once said, *The Letter Kills*. Let us recover and discover Luther again, and let us find what he was looking for: absolute certainty in the almighty grace of God to pardon unspeakable sinners, but let us understand that the mysteries are not thereby done away with, but rather grown

exceedingly great. Let us recover a Theology of both Glory and the Cross, and eschew the revolutionary tactic of pitting one thing against the other in the body of the living Christ, the Man-God, the eternal Word, whose Kingdom shall have no End, and who is coming again like lightning from East to the West.

What we need is a Protesting Catholic Western Church; what we are getting in America, instead, is a late Catholic form of degenerate Protestantism. Is it too late to Reform the Reformation? Our spiritual giants and ancestors showed us how to make a beginning. With their example, we can perhaps avoid the ending.

Posted on 2014-10-31 by Logres

* * *

X on 2014-11-01 at 00:55 said:

Each time I read what you write, Mr. Logres, it feels like eating a rubber.

X on 2014-11-01 at 07:20 said:

No, sorry, after I have eaten it I discovered that it is actually meat which looks like rubber.

Joseph O'Sullivan on 2014-11-01 at 07:53 said:

An excellent and thought-provoking piece. Many thanks!

andros on 2014-11-01 at 08:22 said:

Yes, thank you for the tasty fare, seasoned well with nourishing links – I look forward to finding the Duffy tome in particular. One link perplexed me though: re. 'most of the perpetrators were priests the Church let in under pressure from Vatican II reforms' links to the John Jay Report. The wiki link states 'Almost 70% of the abusive priests were ordained before 1970, after attending pre-Vatican II seminaries or seminaries that had had little time to adapt to the reforms of Vatican II'. Can you resolve the contradiction please?

William on 2014-11-01 at 09:18 said:

Might you suggest a link (a Gornahoor page or something else) on "Theology of Glory"?
Thanx!

IA on 2014-11-01 at 10:15 said:

Very thought-provoking article. I was raised as a protestant too but certainly not progressive. I remain unconvinced that protestantism begat liberalism. Today we see status-marking Eloi egging on race and sex identity group human rights hucksters. Self-deification is also popular it seems.

These people to my eye seem more like descendents of millenarianism, associated with Irenaeus who's writings concerning millenarianism came into opposition to church doctrine established by Origen and Augustine (Norman Cohn, *The Pursuit of the Millennium*, Oxford University Press 1970). Church doctrine began to emphasize individual (and not collective) spiritual progress continuing into the next world, as opposed to this one. Admittedly, modernists do not maintain the original nationalist or racially collectivist mindset of imminent salvation. They hold to a kind of class and quasi racial solidarity though. They are the good whites opposed to the haters and bigots.

logres on 2014-11-01 at 11:46 said:

Andros, thanks for clarifying my poorly stated point. I had read the report quite some time ago: the best way to make the argument is to note the elective affinity, or the correlation, rather than stating it the way I did. The "crop" coming up after the 1960s should have been treated differently, as they represented a different wave of souls, with affinities to the times they lived in. As with all such movements, their formative years were in a period of decay immediately preceding the change. The same thing happened with Barzun and the old professors at Columbia, at the university: They should have stood up to their prodigy. Instead, under pressure to treat them "as we were treated" or out of blindness to what had happened, or laziness, or what have you, they caved, and ushered in the revolutionaries. Even though the new era is always born under the aegis of the old, it is still true to say that the new rulers, in spirit, are always people seeking to create conditions favorable to their new inner state. So there is a correspondence between the result and the previous state.

IA, good point: studying the millenial cults would yield a lot of insight into Church history. However, the evidence for connecting Revolution and Reformation is not merely philosophical (or Catholic), but historical. Cromwell combined millenialism and Reformation. The American Revolution was a Scottish Presbyterian affair (at least the British thought so), and the French Revolution had a connection to Huegonot movement. You see atheist ex-Catholics, but most of your modernist critical theorists, philosophers, "community organizers", etc. tend to come from a liberal Protestant background. At least, that's my impression. But I'm not interested in tarring Protestantism, rather in protesting against its flaws.

andros on 2014-11-01 at 18:21 said:

Logres, thanks for the clarification. However, the linkage between sexual abuse within the church(es), Vatican II and/or the new 'crop' is still a weak argument, tending to scapegoat a particular section and exculpating the church itself.

The sexual abuse of the vulnerable by those in authority is a heinous crime. The crime is exacerbated when the abusers are sheltered by an institution which demands of its adherents a moral standard which it signally fails to uphold itself. Therefore the primary failure is of the institution as it is, not any one part (as 'fall guy'), and has to do with the nature of power, self service and moral turpitude.

So let us start the true reformation by recognising the cause of our own failures, and most especially within those institutions where such failures are magnified.

Defend Christianity by all means, but let not the behemoth of churchianity lurk in silence to feed off the unwary.

IA on 2014-11-01 at 19:27 said:

One thought about protestants: they were all northerners. Maybe the easygoing mediterranean culture couldn't fertilize the ice people in their own lands. If nature is equal to nurture that might explain it.

Logres on 2014-11-01 at 21:46 said:

Andros, granted. I am not making an argument that the Church is not heinously culpable. What I am saying is that they are, but wound up in that position for a very specific, formal reason: namely, they caved in to "the Times". This was reflected in "conservatism-for-conservatism's sake" (Churchianity), which then provided a gateway or opening of weakness for compromise with the arrival of the barbarians within the gates. Abdication, scandal, and endless compromise has followed. My point in mentioning the report was to draw attention to the fact that the very thing most secularists beat the Catholic Church with (the Satanic abuse of children), has a connection with a formal act which they applaud out of ignorance (being "up to date"). This shows the incoherency and chaos of using Revolutionary categories to do theology, social criticism, or organic gardening. I am not defending the RCC on the matter of what happened or how it is handled. It's the biggest reason I am not a Catholic. But we should indict or diagnose the root problem, along with the symptom. Historically, celibacy has not created this problem in the Church. That was my point, and I didn't make it clearly. The power, self-service, and moral turpitude you mention are valid points, and I suppose you could see Vatican II and the scandals as both on the level of symptoms, with a deeper root cause. However, some symptoms can cause other symptoms, and themselves be exacerbating causes, so I think it deserves exploration.

IA, the Northern peoples deserved to have their cultural heritage baptized and assume its proper place within Christendom. Eamon Duffy's book looks interesting: his thesis is that in England, the peasantry and poor folk clung resolutely to their Catholic heritage, which was all

they had, having had the Celtic tradition suppressed by the synod of Whitby. A minority of nobility and the rising classes were set against this. This explains the survival and staying power of the Anglican Church, which was the compromise eventually reached. But that won't last forever either, given Revolutionary social conditions. The purpose of this blog as I understand it is to begin to do consciously what has been done (lately) unconsciously, and to uncover and begin to use the actual living roots of Tradition where they still survive, and to begin to grow from them.

Logres on 2014-11-01 at 21:51 said:

No Church can survive without the heart, which is the Church of John, the esoteric lifeblood of even the body of Christ. But esotericists should have an interest in what happens to the formal body of Christ, where unity is still preferable to division. You can see that unity, although not formal, when you look at Scupoli's book on Spiritual warfare and compare it to the *Philokalia*, the traditions of the Irish Church, and even some of the writing of the Puritans.

1.65 The Emperor's Post

Iamblichus, Hercules, the *Meditations of the Tarot*, and Mouravieff's system of numbers can be correlated, with study and practice. I am stopping (for now) at Number Four, the Emperor, and drawing more closely several threads together to illustrate how this is so.

Kukai⁴⁶⁷ I have mentioned before as a co-inhabitor of tradition.

In the section 3.12 on developments of the state of mind, we find this interesting passage:

1st to 3rd states: Pre-Buddhist stages: worldly "vehicles" of *samsaric* entrapment:

1st state: "The mind of the goat foolishly transmigrating in the six destinies (or realms)" (*ishô teiyô-shin*): The state of desire driven by animal instincts without moral restraint; the stage to which belong common people, hell-beings, hungry-ghosts, beasts, *asuras* ("titans"), and various deities or celestial beings trapped in their *samsaric* destinies.

⁴⁶⁷<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kukai/>

2nd state: “The mind of the child tempered but ignorantly obsessed with moral precepts” (*gudô jisai-shin*): The state of ethical actions and virtue that promote social order but without any “religious” goal; the stage to which belong Confucianism and the Buddhist precepts (*ritsu*) for the laity.

3rd state: “The mind of the child composed and fearing nothing” (*yodô mui-shin*): The state of deity worship and extrinsic magico-religious practice for the sake of overcoming anxiety with the thought of attaining supernatural powers or immortality, or reaching an eternal and blissful heaven; the stage to which belong Taoism and various forms of Hinduism or Brahmanism.

4th to 10th states: Buddhist stages (the fourth to ninth being exoteric Buddhism and the tenth being esoteric Buddhism):

4th to 5th states: Hinâyâna stages: “vehicles” of those who aspire towards self-enlightenment without caring for the enlightenment of others.

4th state: “The mind of one affirming only the elements and negating the self” (*yuiun muga-shin*): The state of the *śrāvaka* who analyzes phenomena into the psycho-physical “aggregates” (*skandhas*) and/or the elements (*dharmas*), to thus negate any belief in a permanent ego (*atman*); the stage to which belong the teachings of the historical Buddha and his direct disciples and of the *Abhidharma* scholastics. While the substantiality of reality is thus deconstructed into its elemental *dharmas*, the *dharmas* themselves however become fetters, thus taking from three lives to sixty aeons to achieve liberation.

5th state: “The mind freed from karmic seeds” (*batsu gôinju-shin*): The self-other duality and recognizing the interdependency between self-enlightenment and other-enlightenment and between wisdom and compassion.

The reader of Mouravieff's *Gnosis* will no doubt recognize that Man 1, Man 2, and Man 3 (of which man #3, the man of rationalized intellect

is dominant in our era), are excluded from enlightenment, just as the esoteric Orthodox tradition teaches through Mouravieff's work. That is, the man of movement, the man of heart, and the man of mind are all subject to samsaric entrapment, by virtue of the very virtue which characterizes them, the organizing of their being around a privileged center. It is Man # 4, the man who has begun to balance his centers through the difficult process of self-knowledge (which is painful as well as arduous), who can be said to begin to "inherit the kingdom of God" (the *basilieia* of God⁴⁶⁸).

In a healthy civilization, the men of intellect would have supervised the building of the edifice of the *Ekklesia*, the *Oikumene*, or the Third Kingdom. This edifice would have centered around the natural revelation of a worldly order, a worldly order ultimately ruled through the self-sacrifice of the Emperor (who, significantly, is the Fourth Card of the Tarot, thus superseding or sitting in guidance over the first three, in relation to manifesting the King of the World). In this way, authority is allowed to "come out into the open"⁴⁶⁹, and to play its proper role in saving cosmic energy by "conserving" energy, thus freeing up an excess for potential use for divine purposes that go beyond maintaining the order of things. This is the mystery behind Romans 13 and other verses, in which the apostles admonished Christians "to love the brotherhood, fear God, and honor the King", and to pray for those in authority, who bear not the sword in vain, that they may live quiet and peaceable lives of godliness.

In the Fourth Labor of Hercules⁴⁷⁰, the hero inherited the power of the man-beast Chiron, who is unable to bear immortality due to the dreadful wound he received from Hercules. It is important to note Tomberg's

⁴⁶⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kingdom_of_God_%28Christianity%29

⁴⁶⁹<https://bonald.wordpress.com/2015/01/07/not-ready-for-monarchy/>

⁴⁷⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6806>

astonishing claim that the Emperor is the most “human of men”, and that this entitles him to assume the post of guardian of the shields of the earth. King David is the paragon of this fact – herder, warrior, champion, outlaw, king, sinner, priest, and initiate: his life was a full one, and his heart for his son Absalom made him a man “after God’s own heart”, being the paternal instinct writ so large that it conquered even the hatred of his own seed. Indeed, we find in history that men like King Alfred, King Arthur, and all the other paragons of chivalry were “men in full” : not the one first to boast, or the flashiest, or the loudest, but the one last to abandon the cause of earth. It is this love of simplicity which gives the emperor his wounds and makes him the “best of men”, worthy to create an age in which deeds even greater than his can be done. The card of the Emperor teaches the divine conservation of what it is to be human — or, phrased exoterically, “whatsoever a man sows, that shall he reap” & “I have reserved 7000 who have not bowed the knee to Baal”. Thus, Man not only endures, he *prevails*.

In all of these studies, a kind of “evolutionary test” (Mouravieff’s terminology) is being meted out : the rule is, use what you have for the best, or forfeit those talents to someone else, for man is neither beast nor machine. If ancient Greece’s common cultural task was to delineate Man from wine and centaurs and the wild boar, then our time’s task is to insist that Man is separate from the machine.

To continue with Mouravieff, Man #2 is easily lead astray by ideals, choosing ones which are either flawed, or suit his predilections and accidental being. Man #1 is swiftly lead astray in a dark wood, wandering, of sensual attractions. Man #3, when corrupted, spearheads the ideological annihilation of natural and traditional order. When not corrupted, the order that they organize intellectually and spiritually provide the possibility for all three orders to co-exist peacefully and creatively and to lasting profit. But in actual practice, Man#4 represents any of the other three basic types which have begun to awake, and thus it is also true that a second

Triad is generated to begin organizing in all serious earnest in a way that defeats the natural tendency of entropy. Thus, Guenon emphasizes, in his discussion on Time and the Circle in Chapter 23 of the *Great Triad*⁴⁷¹, the role of the Cross, or the four quarters of the world. These quarterings are made manifest in the four wounds of the emperor, who may be a man of action, a man of heart, or a man of mind, provided he has followed the divine in achieving, through Love, a participation in each. The Three Orders then, fully function and are protected, under this Lord.

Distinctively, he achieves this in full immersion in secular affairs, as the “most human of men”, and is thus not the greatest of Men #4, but the one among them who is the most human, and therefore most fit to rule. He is a man with the “gift of tears”, for instance, and one finds (correspondingly) a higher development of the idea of chivalry in the West than the East (although it is not absent, identity with distinctive difference).

If the Emperor sits on the Imperial Throne, there can be many Kings made straight, who are not fully at the level of Man #4, but whose type resonate strongly enough for the energy of the Emperor to magnetize towards this eventual goal, or at least constrain within an outer semblance of that path.

It is hard to predict how this web works, because we often stand outside, but in practice, any Man #4 who stays true enough will cause repercussive changes beneath him that tend to drag more of prime materia and Creation towards the source of his Love, whereas those beneath him will tend to deteriorate without his immediate secular influence and power, even if occulted.

Whereas the tendency of the Emperor is to accrue forfeited spiritual power, rather than rely upon external influences. This does not preclude the possibility of a corruption and fall, only to say the impulse is now on

⁴⁷¹https://www.gornahoor.net/library/Rene_Guenon_The_Great_Triad.pdf

the side of Heaven, with the passage to Man #4. It is a mistake to think that “divine right of Kings” taught the infallibility of annointed rulers, and use this as a straw man.

The ravaging Erymanthian Boar (“the wild hog in the woods⁴⁷²” in the old folk tune passed down from the times of medieval England) is the ravage of Time, the entropy of Creation which is set loose from divine balance. It is in this way that the pope claimed that “a wild boar is loose in the vineyard of God” when it became evident that Luther was a man of character who was no paper tiger. It is significant that it was the princes of Germany and the king of England whose betrayal and subversion lead to a complete rupture between the Protestant and Catholic worlds.

Mouravieff explains that some of this came to pass because the character of the people is an element that has to be constantly adjusted to in government : whoever has aspirations to progress along the path laid out by the Emperor will have to manage the first Triad of forces, and become used to discerning the neutralizing force which mediates between active/passive. If this is done under the will of God, such an ability will tend to draw that person into the character of real *Auctoritas*, in whatever circle they inhabit, big or small.

I will note, for now, the correspondence of the “oscillations” and the juggling motif of the first Tarot card with the center of movement, and the correspondence of the second⁴⁷³ and third⁴⁷⁴ cards with the emotional and intellectual center, respectively. Much more can and should be said about these correspondences: for one thing, it is the achievement of an intellectual connection and balance which allows the conception of the God-man, who is (of course) the new King of Kings and Lord of Lords, and who opposes the purely (in relation to himself) material world of

⁴⁷²https://www.gornahoor.net/library/Rene_Guenon_The_Great_Triad.pdf

⁴⁷³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7287>

⁴⁷⁴<http://www.fourhares.com/pdfs/mott/Letter-3.pdf>

the Prince of this World.

But the emperor, he is at a post, in balance: a certain level of civilization, real civilization and not the fake stuff masquerading in rhetoric, has been achieved. The shields of the earth can be marshaled and drawn to their rightful destinies. He is not the most sensual, the most emotional, or the most intelligent man, but the most *human*, and therefore in a more complete sense, remembers what it means to enjoy the material world, yearn for the heart of all meaning, or see into the pattern of the Logos. In a world that hates the cosmic Law, men find it easy to forget the totality of Man – that is, until the emperor enters from stage right, when time stops again.

Posted on 2015-01-24 by Logres

1.66 The Metaphysical Principles of the Infinitesimal Calculus

As someone who awoke rather late to the importance of mathematics (whose general use for the esoteric student is not only helpful, but even necessary), I decided to read my first full Rene Guenon treatise⁴⁷⁵.

The fundamental distinction which he makes is between the Indefinite and the Infinite. Since Wilhelm Gottfried Leibniz⁴⁷⁶ was the progenitor of the modern calculus, and since the term “numerable infinity” (or rather the concept) originated with him, Guenon takes aim primarily at Leibniz’s explanations and way of thinking. Guenon’s contention is that all of the criticism (and the subsequent development of the field of calculus) could have been adequately dealt with, had the proper distinction been made between what is Indefinite, and what is truly Infinite.

⁴⁷⁵<https://arcaneknowledgeofthedeep.files.wordpress.com/2014/02/guenonmetaphysicalprinciplesinfinitesimalcalculus.pdf>

⁴⁷⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gottfried_Wilhelm_Leibniz

Guenon insisted that there was only one Infinite, and it was not divisible or numerable. It follows from this that any Number is necessarily non-Infinite, since whatever is one thing rather than another (as all Number implies about itself) is by definition non-Infinite. It is therefore, numerable or quantifiable, and therefore Indefinite, rather than Infinite.

Leibniz had a confused notion of esoteric studies (Rosicrucian) and tried to modify his terms to suit the understanding of those he was speaking to, but Guenon contended that he did this rather poorly, as he failed to make the distinction fundamental to any science, and so opened the path for the modern tendency to do away with the one Infinite in favor of quantifiable infinities or multiple infinities on the secular or profane plane of being.

One can see this confusion in the subject of Fractals, which are somehow implied to be infinite (given that they can always be expanded to see “more” articulation, which repeats itself “endlessly”). This endlessness is not infinite, for it belongs to the plane of the finite, and represents an ability of the human mind to divide the finite indefinitely, rather than truly opening up some kind of substitute infinite perspective that can displace the one Infinite (which is impossible).

Guenon deals with the subject in some technical depth, which ought to interest those inclined towards mathematics by nature and training, and is a master (even in translation) of maintaining proper distinctions and speaking accurately: as they once said of Dr Greg Bahnsen⁴⁷⁷, *rem acu tetigisti* (*you touched the thing with a needle*).

Leibniz wrestled with the implications of what he himself was trying to say, but ultimately was lead astray in his thinking by his own terminology. The concept of “limit” is actually (according to Guenon) analogous to the transition from one plane (the physical) to that of another (the metaphysical), and represents a “transposition” from a limited state of

⁴⁷⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Greg_Bahnsen

being to that of an infinite one. I believe there are some posts at Gornahoor on that topic, under Michaelstadter. Nevertheless, the notion of “limit” when used mathematically is not properly infinite, but connotes the event horizon of what is indefinite, and teaches by analogy what is proper to the metaphysical sphere only.

Number can increase indefinitely, and in fact (as Archimedes showed long ago⁴⁷⁸) can be calculated up to a point at which the human mind can no longer comprehend what it is calculating. That is, it can go on indefinitely, until the human mind is “mazed” and dissolves. But since it is in fact a Number that is being reckoned, it is not, and never can be, Infinite.

On a related note, I picked up Phillip Pullman’s *The Golden Compass*, the first book in *His Dark Materials*, which is a quote from John Milton (who was “of the devil’s party without knowing it”, according to Blake).

Into this wild Abyss
The womb of Nature, and perhaps her grave
Of neither sea, nor shore, nor air, nor fire,
But all these in their pregnant causes mixed
Confusedly, and which thus must ever fight,
Unless the Almighty Maker them ordain
His dark materials to create more worlds,
Into this wild Abyss the wary Fiend
Stood on the brink of Hell and looked a while,
Pondering his voyage; for no narrow frith
He had to cross.

Pullman hated CS Lewis, and wrote his “atheist fantasy” to displace the Narnian worldview. He is in the interesting intellectual position of refuting himself, since once one has experienced the “true God” as a “Demi-urge”, one can thereafter never really be certain that 1. You aren’t experiencing an “alternate”, deeper illusion of the Demi-Urge (his “Loving

⁴⁷⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Sand_Reckoner

Side”) or 2. that there isn’t another truer God behind the Light of Lights, which would then turn into a second, higher Demi-Urge. Or, as Tomberg writes, “there are illusions above, as there are illusions below”.

Pullman is a perfect example of what happens when one sets out to defend a true, but false idea (in this case, self-contradictory) with psychologically plausible fantasy. It is, in fact, true that many people worship a “false God” as the true Creator, but this fact is recognized in all Traditional science and in all sacred Scriptures. As good as the novel is (it is very taut and well written, with interesting ideas to play with), it turns out that (additionally) that if Pullman’s ideology triumphs in Reality, one will not be able to salvage enough Romance and aura of danger to set further fantasy novels, since the entire ambience of his novel revolves around an alternate reality “High Church England”, replete with dreamy spires and dread castles, which don’t exist anymore once the “new man” has created the brave new world of the Revolution. As always, the first circles of Hell are the most romantic and exciting. After that, it becomes a bit too predictable. Readers of Pullman’s novels who wish to “deconstruct” him will have to imagine, first, The Cathedral⁴⁷⁹ *a la moderne*. Which requires more intellectual or spiritual horsepower than (say) smashing the Middle Ages, since a nose on one’s face is harder to see. .

There are, however, indefinite, or countless fantasies, which Revolution can dream up, and only one way to be Right. It takes a genius like Guenon to see, diagnose, and dissect this error as it manifested in the secular science of modern mathematics.

Posted on 2015-05-09 by Logres

⁴⁷⁹<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.co.uk/2009/01/gentle-introduction-to-unqualified.html>

1.67 Order & Right versus The Cathedral

It's interesting that the title of Evola's work⁴⁸⁰ is almost a prescriptive piece of advice, or a command -"Revolt!", & that he advocates here a proper understanding of what a revolt would look like if it were legitimate: this is how a *kshatriya* would act to maintain purity as he overthrew what was false. Yet there are several stringent preconditions. First, any half measures are rejected: one cannot revolt using revolutionary principles of any kind, which are doomed. Thus, the "conservative" option is stillborn and simply not an option – one cannot build on that which is already sliding into the abyss. Secondly, the revolt is first of all as witness – that is, one is impassive and immovable, standing still as all else goes over the cliff.

Thirdly, any revolt would have to include self-knowledge, as acting outside one's natural caste would be bound to cause inevitable complications which would compromise the outcome – a peasant trying to lead kings would not come to any good end. This explains much of the Church's problem in resisting modernism : even spiritual brahmins are not authorized to assume the emperor's post. Since the West is engaged in a kind of global revolutionary enterprise, we are looking for the emperor's post, rather than a king who can re-establish centrality under an already recognized holy empire. It also explains the nature of anti-American sentiment that is brewing abroad – even other decaying civilizations sense that resistance to the global trends somehow involve answering and ending American pre-eminence, rather than merely establishing some kind of vacuum.

What Moldbug has called The Cathedral⁴⁸¹ can rightly be viewed as a

⁴⁸⁰http://www.jrbooksonline.com/pdf_books/revolt.pdf

⁴⁸¹<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2009/01/gentle-introduction-to-unqualified.html>

Demetrian impulse⁴⁸²; the liberal order in fact represents precisely what one could term a gynocratic drive towards the Nanny Church-State.

The Cathedral, with its informal union of church and state, is positioned perfectly. It has all the advantages of being a formal arm of government, and none of the disadvantages. Because it formulates public policy, it is best considered our ultimate governing organ, but it certainly bears no responsibility for the success or failure of said policy. Moreover, it gets to program the little worm that is inserted in everyone's head, beginning at the age of five and going all the way through grad school.

Instead of regal legitimacy, the moral-sentimental impulses of a substitute order (bereft of real authority) lead by degenerate brahmins and warriors (mlecchas) will impose an alternate scheme which does not correspond to Cosmic Law.

The choice by Moldbug of the term "Cathedral" to describe this entity is particularly felicitous: about the time of the rise of the Romanesque/Gothic, according to Evola, the Papacy was in the process of humiliating the Empire in the investiture controversy – Gregory made Henry IV stand in the snow at Canossa⁴⁸³. Henry, true to the Evolian formula & claim, had made his case in no uncertain terms: His letter ends, "Henry, ***king not through usurpation but through the holy ordination of God***, to Hildebrand, at present not pope but false monk... I, Henry, king by the grace of God, with all of my Bishops, say to you, come down, come down, and be damned throughout the ages." In other words, contrary to the Cathedral, either of the Middle Ages, or of the Puritan era, or of our own era of secular hyper-Calvinism, the ordination of the holy Emperor flows, truly, from God directly, with neither people nor pope intervening. Evola speaks of the warrior-priest almost as if it was a fourth caste. It was to this

⁴⁸²<https://gornahoor.wordpress.com/2015/06/07/the-demetrian-race/>

⁴⁸³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Investiture_Con controversy

order or class that the Templars belonged, who tellingly owed allegiance, not to the Ekklesia but to a Temple.

The cooperation of the American Church in endorsing and legitimizing the split between secular/sacred has been crucial, as American Christianity is not merely predominantly exoteric, but also (now) maternal and this-worldly: all transcendent proclivities have been curtailed, castrated, or exorcised. Thus, what really matters today for most churchgoers is excising the very elements which remain and remind them of what has been abandoned or lost. The alternative to revolution (transcendent hierarchy) has been rendered literally inconceivable. As Phillip Rieff⁴⁸⁴ would put it, any truly therapeutic reaction would be rendered still-born by instant attention and dissection by the existing organs of The Cathedral, including the media, the churches, and the government agencies. In privileging the “spiritual” over the profane, the original intention of transcendence has been lost, & what has followed has been either the marginalizing of the Church in the face of secular Revolution, or, the trivializing of the secular and the spiritual in a false dichotomy that emasculates the transcendence of either. Moldbug⁴⁸⁵ makes clear how the political process functions under the secular-spiritual Cathedral:

Without separation of church and state, it is easy be for a democracy to indulge itself in arbitrarily irresponsible misgovernment, simply by telling its bishops to inform their congregations that black is white and white is black. Thus misdirected, they are easily persuaded to support counterproductive policies which they wrongly consider productive. Union of church and state can foster stable iatrogenic misgovernment as follows. First, the church fosters and maintains a popular misconception that the problem

⁴⁸⁴<http://www.amazon.com/Fellow-Teachers-Philip-Rieff/dp/0571106781>

⁴⁸⁵http://www.slate.com/articles/technology/bitwise/2015/06/curtis_yarvin_booted_from_strange_loop_it_s_a_big_big_problem.2.html

exists, and the solution solves it. Secondly, the state responds by extruding an arm, agency, or other pseudopod in order to apply the solution. Agency and church are thus cooperating in the creation of unproductive or counterproductive jobs, as “doctors.” (my note: this is Phillip Rieff’s “Therapeutic Culture”) Presumably they can find a way to split the take. The root problem with a state church in a democratic state is that, to believe in democracy, one must believe that the levers of power terminate with the voters. But if your democracy has an effective state church, the actual levers of power pass through the voters, and go back to the church. The church teaches the voters what to think; the voters tell the politicians what to do. Naturally, it is easy for the politicians to short-circuit this process and just listen to the bishops. Thus the government has a closed power loop. With the church at its apex, of course.

Those of this Church who come to their senses (in some respect) have a difficult time getting their footing under them. For example, Oriana⁴⁸⁶ Fallaci, in her confrontation⁴⁸⁷ with radical Islam, appealed, not to the traditional order of the West, but to the liberated serfs:

Well, in my view America frees the plebes. Everyone is a plebe there. White, black, yellow, brown, purple, stupid, intelligent, poor, rich. Actually the rich are the most plebeian of all. Most of the time they’re such boors! Crude, ill-mannered. You can tell immediately that they’ve never read *Galateo*, that they’ve never had anything to do with refinement and good taste and sophistication. In spite of the money they waste on clothes, for example, they’re so inelegant as to make the Queen of England look chic by comparison. But they are freed, by God. And in this world there is nothing stronger or more powerful than freed plebes. You will

⁴⁸⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Oriana_Fallaci

⁴⁸⁷<http://www.freerepublic.com/focus/news/669794/posts>

always get your skull cracked when you go up against the Freed Plebe. And they all got their skulls cracked by America: English, Germans, Mexicans, Russians, Nazis, Fascists, Communists. Even the Vietnamese got theirs cracked in the end, when they had to come to terms after their victory so that now when a former president of the United States goes there to visit they're in seventh heaven. "Bienvenu, Monsieur le President, bienvenu!" The problem is that the Vietnamese don't pray to Allah. It's going to be much harder to deal with the sons of Allah. Much longer and much harder. Unless the rest of the Western world stops peeing its pants. And starts reasoning a little and gives them a hand.

And it is disconcerting, and confusing at first, to see that "what is left" in the West seems to have attached itself to the symbols and ideals of the American Revolution, with all of its concomitant ideology. This is what the Kali Yuga looks like, & it is why Evola is so prescient and precise in dealing with the possibilities offered to us in this time.

Ms. Fallaci alludes to something here important to Evola's case:

The Italians have become such little lords. They vacation in Seychelles, come to New York to buy sheets at Bloomingdale's. **They're ashamed to be laborers and farmers, and won't be associated with the proletariat.** But those of whom I speak (immigrants/Muslims), what kind of laborers are they? What work do they do? In what way do they satisfy the demand for manual labor that the Italian ex-proletariat no longer supplies?

She had courage, culture, and breeding, but these qualities are not enough to do more than to notice the external processes of decay and to fight rear-guard, temporizing actions. At least she was paying attention. In the global West, technology and wealth has caused the abandonment of the castes, with the result that hordes of immigrants are required as virtual slave laborers. *Additionally, liberals like the engendered chaos.*

Moldbug offers further confirmation that Liberalism thrives and wins because of the *libido dominandi*⁴⁸⁸ which Dante also argued was filling up Hell:

One of the key reasons that intellectuals are fascinated by disorder, in my opinion, is the fact that disorder is an extreme case of complexity. And as you make the structure of authority in an organization more complex, more informal, or both – as you fragment it, eliminating hierarchical execution structures under which one individual decides and is responsible for the result, and replacing them with highly fragmented, highly consensual, and highly process-oriented structures in which ten, twenty or a hundred people can truthfully claim to have contributed to the outcome, you increase the amount of power, status, patronage, and employment produced. Of course, you also make the organization less efficient and effective, and you make working in it a lot less fun for everyone – you have gone from startup to Dilbert. This is Brezhnevian sclerosis, the fatal disease of organizations in a highly regulated environment. All work is guided by some systematic process, in which each rule was contributed by someone whose importance was a function of how many rules he added. In the future, we will all work for the government. Individually, this is the last thing your average intellectual wants to do, but it is the direction in which his collective acts are pushing us. In short: intellectuals cluster to the left, generally adopting as a social norm the principle of *pas d'ennemis à gauche, pas d'amis à droite*, because like everyone else they are drawn to power. The left is chaos and anarchy, and the more anarchy you have, the more power there is to go around. The more orderly a system is, the fewer people get to issue orders. The same asymmetry is why corporations and the military, whose system of hierarchical executive authority is

⁴⁸⁸<http://www.amazon.com/Libido-Dominandi-Liberation-Political-Control/dp/1587314657>

inherently orderly, cluster to the right.

In other words, it is nothing other than a desire to usurp the higher spiritual castes that produces *the strangely synchronized & seemingly invincible movement of Leftism*. The same desire on the economic level has created the political vacuum being filled by immigration. In all cases, **it is the abandonment of individual *ius* and collective *fides* (Evola) which opens the door of chaos**. No one knows who the Emperor is, or (worse) would recognize him if he were to appear. The Cathedral denies that there is such a thing: the only Emperor (for them) is the hyper-individual, whose creation is ongoing and perversely polymorphous (Herbert Marcuse). It is doubtful if The Cathedral will be able to totally control the forces which they are playing around with. In fact, they are comfortable with using the chaos against their enemies, deploying it, so to speak, tactically.

It is highly interesting that in fact we are witnessing the investiture folly worked out all over again, yet with even more dire consequences. For another good historical analysis of this trend (but one with ideological problems) one should consult Rosenstock-Huessy's *Out of Revolution*, which connects the dots between the various revolutions. We are now in an accelerated phase of this process, & understanding the "cloak of maliciousness" which Liberalism covers its bare parts with will allow discernment of the ways Res Publica is becoming Res Pubica, and what seems likely to happen next. Moldbug's analysis concretely demonstrates how a false elite can benefit from "power-sharing" and revolution at the expense of the common good, & at the same time get long term results they say they eschew. But it is Evola who touches the point with a needle. The good news is, as twilight sets in, that many who are latently able have not yet begun to fight, & that there is a deeper law at work, capable of being discerned and connected with at the metaphysical level.

Posted on 2015-07-18 by Logres

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Mark Citadel on 2015-07-23 at 14:07 said:

“Evola speaks of the warrior-priest almost as if it was a fourth caste. It was to this order or class that the Templars belonged, who tellingly owed allegiance, not to the Ekklesia but to a Temple.”

The Templars are very interesting. I have spoken in private communiques with Orthodox Christians in Russia and Belarus about the need for an organization that can operate outside the purview of the official church and powers that be, almost like a mimic of what Hezbollah did in Lebanon, but in the Orthodox world. This would of course be an entirely anti-Liberal venture and a preparatory force for the chaotic ‘twilight’ we are entering into.

I really liked this essay. I am admittedly no scholar when it comes to Moldbug, but you compliment his work nicely here.

Logres on 2015-08-02 at 09:12 said:

Moldbug is purely a comedic ironist, with little pretensions to anything beyond analyzing or “auditing” the USG (United States government). However, he does a good job of clinically taking apart the Cathedral & exposing the pretensions of the man behind the curtain. I do think he is right about how power-sharing is driving the evolution of hyper-democracy and Revolution, and haven’t seen anyone else pull apart the mechanics at that level. Of course, this is seen as “good” or even ultimate good, which is why it is invisible. I’m reading James Fitzjames Stephens’ critique of JS Mill’s *On Liberty*, & he is saying a very similar thing about the secular government’s potential to become effectively a Church; additionally, it clarifies that Mill lies at the root of a great deal of the modern Cathedral’s religion. Mill was a powerful writer, and a poor thinker – the distinction between “other regarding acts” and “self regarding acts” is like (as Stephens says) asking which acts of ours take place in space, and which in time: it’s artificial, designed to produce a rhetorical conclusion. Stephens clarifies the more traditional consensus that held in the British Empire, in which certain forms of coercion were legitimate, and were connected to moral and philosophical principles.

2.1 Le Bateleur, or Thus Endeth the Lesson

I will assume, for this, a basic familiarity with the text, as well as perhaps some of the items and discussions on the mailing list. Rather, we will look at several prisms or aphorisms or anecdotes from this chapter, to help elucidate in precise detail what quarry Tomberg is hunting.

First of all, like his master, Tomberg affirms that the “most dangerous spiritual malady” is “self-complacency”. This is a huge claim, and we will see later how it is justified in detail. Tomberg was well aware of the dangers of megalomania and insanity, & apparently thought worse of this first sin (question: can we rank the seven deadly sins?). Elsewhere, in a similar spirit, he remarks that **“vice is oppressive or disgusting and virtue is boring” : it is *concentration* that matters.** By this he certainly does not reject the “moral tradition of the virtues”, but rather is commenting on the legalism or moralism that is always too busy relating moral principles in concrete hierarchies of rules to be bothered with attaining *the whole purpose* of the Law. He (also) elsewhere relates that the

Law appears to us as (Phillip Rieff would say) an interdict¹, & that this fact is important (has an esoteric meaning) because what it means is that God is not an *egregore*, or reflection of the human mind that responds to corruption and sin. God is Who He is, & that is Good News. The Law is Good News. So much for Luther. So the first virtue is “poverty of spirit” (the Beatitudes) and alack of self-complacency. Angels can fly because they take themselves lightly. Other sins (like hypocrisy or pride) are lesser: of course all sins have an element of the first Arcana of Sin, so this is not a justification of sinning, that grace may abound.

2. He mentions the perpetual service of *Sacre Couer de Montmartre*² as a picture of the inner reality of a lack of self-complacency, which is the one thing needful. This silence, by an ancient law, engenders the influx of holy forces. As all numbers are multiples of One, so all spiritual Arcana flow from poverty of spirit. “You will receive power from on High”: “in Paris one works, one amuses one’s self, one sleeps, one dies”... all the while, the center of the city holds in the form of a sacrament in silence. This is an important metaphor, given how much time Tomberg spent in France. Evidently, he viewed the Church there as essentially creating the jovial atmosphere of Paris.

3. The world is not a mosaic. Diversity can only bring us together once a real, true, beautiful, & good Unity has previously unified Man. If the world is not One, it is not knowable. So there is a place for beginning with Dogma or exoteric practice, where a framework is established in anticipation of the scaffolding being pulled down one day when the living temple is completed. There is no room here for starting (as Revolutionaries and binary thinkers do) with the Dyad as the Monad. First things first.

4. He draws an enormous amount of attention in the first chapter to the Emerald Tablet. This tablet teaches us that the phenomenal world

¹<http://www.upenn.edu/gazette/0507/arts03.html>

²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sacr%C3%A9-C%C5%93ur,_Paris

is not nothing, because it is moved (like sand) in the wind: nevertheless, it must be affirmed that the Wind is not like the patterns in the sand in a literal way. Wind and sand are not equivalent. Tomberg will affirm in this and future chapters that the uniqueness of Christianity lay in its desire and power and calling to sublimate both inner and outer way (Sand and Wind) into one picture in which nothing was lost of either the one or the other. The old Greek question of the One-and-The-Many³ was resolved in perichoresis, Trinity, & Incarnation. “*As philosophers, Christians, and scientists*, we embrace the Emerald Tablet”. The line of succession is Enoch/Hermes Trismegistus, Orpheus, Pythagoras, Philolaus (Divi Platonis nostri praeceptor), Plato, the NeoPythagoreans (Apollonius), the NeoPlatonists (Plotinus), continued down (for example) through Ficino (since Ficino is the one citing the line of succession).

5. The method of analogy is the only means of apprehending or beginning to apprehend Truth as the intuition develops; although it is quite possible to err with this method, it nevertheless is the door to truth: “it is qualified to lead to the discovery of essential Truths”. We reason that the Sun sets with glorious colors (it bleeds), Night falls, but we wait for the Dayspring, which must return, pace Hume. Even Science heightens probability in order to sharpen analogies to yield the most to intuitions (the Double Helix code, for instance), notes J. Maynard Keynes. Tomberg is making a vast and overarching case here. Nature teaches us that the acorn does not “resemble” the tree (to the naked eye), unless one is paying attention, that is, intuiting the process as it unfolds in play. All tree like things have seeds, and all seed like things contain trees.

6. He affirms the basic table of correspondences which obtain and hold between metals and planets, common to all ancient and traditional Cultures, with minor variants and errors, but notes that the correspondences with the Tarot are far from agreed upon. Tomberg is no idiot: he

³http://www.philosophy.ox.ac.uk/__data/assets/pdf_file/0005/5855/What_is_POU.pdf

is clearing the ground of objections by showing he has taken them into consideration. This is the act of a scholar and a man of good breeding. It is also a clue to his purpose: he will provide the Tarot with the symbols and arcana which it lacks via the stars, due to confusion.

7. He connects this intuition towards play with classical European ideas as well, such as Schiller's *Speiltrieb* (the urge to play) and Jung's "individuation" (synthesis of the conscious and unconscious elements in the personality), *in which the perfect vision of the beautiful Good transforms duty into a delight*. Nonetheless, there is Play and there is play. Be careful when you play, otherwise, you will become a charlatan. Alas, says Tomberg, too many are both charlatan and genius, so let Le Batteleur be a perpetual Guardian of the Threshold to always return to! He quotes an anonymous author:

To perceive and to know, to try and to be able to, are all different things. There are mirages above, as there are mirages below; you only know that which is verified by the agreement of all forms of experience in its totality – experience of the sense, moral experience, psychic experience, the collective experience of other seekers for the truth, and finally the experience of those whose knowing merits the title of wisdom and whose striving has been crowned by the title of saint. Academia and the Church stipulate methodical and moral conditions for one who desires to progress. Carry them out strictly, before and after each flight into the region beyond the domain of work and effort. If you do this, you will be a sage and a mage. If you do not do this – you will only be a charlatan.

The Arcanum of Geniality of Intelligence, analogous but not identical to the play of a little child, is the First and Final Good, the Monad and the One, identical to the Archetypal (space) and Mythical (time) of the Godhead, which is the arena in which souls are exercised in a vast gym-

nasium designed to produce “greater than angels”. That is our begging beginning, and our triumphant End-ividuation.

Posted on 2014-04-25 by Logres

2.2 The High Priestess

When God manifested in the created plane, the Two inescapably arose. First of all, as secondary to God, and secondly as articulations within itself, to create the pyramid and hierarchy of all Being. There is nothing wrong with Two: as Cologero notes, the animus within the woman is necessary for her healthy development. The Two is very good in itself, but not by itself. This is noted earlier on as *it is not good for man to be alone*. This would also apply to the feminine part within man’s own interior.

Watch a political debate, read a cutting edge expose of the Gospels, pick up a history book, or (worse) sample a modern textbook. For that matter, pick an acquaintance’s brain. What you will inevitably almost always discover is someone for whom the Two is not merely a good, but is actually God, subsisting alone. Not only have they made a false god out of what is created, but (for them) the One and indeed any other competing Twos simply don’t exist. Thus, those who think the Catholic Church was part of a vast cosmic conspiracy involving the Demi-Urge suppressing channellers from the stars simply never get around to asking themselves the simple question, If God is a fake God (**Yahweh is the Demi-urge**) then how do I know the One True Light God is not just in on the fix? What if the deception *is even more elaborate* than I first believed? No for them what is an important psychological insight gets distorted into a cosmology, an ideology, and at last, a madness. They cannot square the circle. This phenomena is common today.

Psychologically and humanly speaking, people like modern liberals, civil rights activists, free thinkers and others may certainly possess a mod-

icum of truth. Yet, what lie does not contain modicums of truth? It is not hard to be partly right. But this is not what is claimed: it is claimed that this is the truth, the whole truth, nothing but the truth, and (most importantly) the only truth which could possibly matter. And it must be taken *as presented*, which is to say, in isolation from the One. It is, at root, a narrative created by the demonic power of the egocentric mind, which attempts to enslave others to its dominating will. This is the opposite of the what the Priestess was created to be: instead of the *alma mater*, we have the devouring wrath of the psychotic Lilith, who hates Eve, and attempts to destroy Adam (this is how salvation comes from the woman, for Eve will oppose Lilith).

We see at work here the very power of distortion and twisting which they claim to see in the One. To quote Phillip Dick, **“Those who fight the Empire, become the Empire”**. Or to quote Jesus, “resist not evil, but overcome evil with Good”. Anyone who uses the Ring of Sauron against Sauron is doomed to either become like him, or to be turned into a slave. God Himself does not overcome evil with evil, but rather overturns Hell from the inside out. Good triumphs because it remains unchanged when Evil touches it, and is capable of changing Evil into its opposite. Evil cannot make this claim, and therefore, has no true power. Evil can only uncover what is already Evil, and test what is Good.

This is not to say one cannot be a warrior and a man of the One. There are beautiful stories about how to reconcile the two, & many men have done it extremely well, so well they merit great titles and honors, and perhaps even more than man can say. Giorgio⁴ has pointed out that the warrior (however) is female in relation to the brahmin or priest. That is, the warrior has to overcome the flesh to arrive at the one, he has to fight himself. He has to struggle against the tendency to carve out a separate kingdom away from the Law of the One. This is the first temptation faced by man, to divide himself into Two and to make a kingdom of his

⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6036>

own, separate from the aboriginality of the Self Beyond the Selves.

How can this be? How can the virile, manly warrior be female? When the universe is taken hierarchically, we can say that that which is above something is male in relation to it, and that which is below something is female in relation to it. Things below revolve around, cling to, and require for their health and sanity the relation to that which stems from above. When something is detached, it careens off into the outer darkness,⁵ and although it may retain its own hierarchy for a time, there is a process of decay that sets in immediately. The horizontal cannot sustain itself by itself. It requires a link to the vertical. Thus, everything is male/female, and yet we can properly speak of certain things as “male” or “female” in configuration to each other.

Neither is privileged. Without the female, the male does not make itself known. If there is a privilege, it consists of duties. To quote the Baron, **loving, proud obedience and humble command** are the duties of respective stations. Since all of Being involves climbing the ladder or the Tree, there is no Black Iron Prison⁶ of compartments or boxes, but rather a kind of dance. If you are living in a Black Iron Prison, it is because your soul (to that extent) is tainted and evil, and God manifests to you as the oppressor. The eye, being not single, cannot see the Light. The psychological insight (however) of this state is correct: you are seeing that the God you made in your own image is actually a Demi-Urge. Angels appear as demons, men of good breeding and sound sense are tyrants, Western civilization is the greatest evil on earth, etc. The only way out is “deeper in”, that is to say, to pull the beam out of your own Eye.

The lesson of the second Card is that **Two cannot exist alone**. Which (put this way) is irrefutable. QED. Or, put another way, **Two can only exist together as One**.

Tomberg gives an example of what happens when the Two wants to

⁵<https://biblehub.com/jude/1-13.htm>

⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VALIS>

be alone:

Passing on to mysticism which has not given birth to gnosis, magic and Hermetic philosophy – such a mysticism must, sooner or later, necessarily degenerate into ‘spiritual enjoyment’ or ‘intoxication’. The mystic who wants only the experience of mystical states without understanding them, without drawing practical conclusions from them for life, and without wanting to be useful to others, who forgets everyone and everything in order to enjoy the mystical experience, can only be compared to a spiritual drunkard.

He mentions that those who develop the spiritual sense develop a “touch” which allows him to apply and understand what he has experienced. This is analogous to the virginal pool, which more deeply reflects (until it engenders or creates) what is shining on it from above : the Sun gives birth over the void, or the waters. One begins to examine the thoughts that enters one’s mind, to make them pass “tests” (smell, touch, hearing) before true gnosis (or sight) is finally engendered, much as a baby learns to see in three dimensions and to arrange shapes in proper contours to the forms emanating them. This is the meaning of “become as little children”, who are female/passive at first as regards that which is already fully grown and solar.

The Gnostic challenge to the Church is an opportunity to recover what was Once: an exoteric Church which is sustained by a Life, to reunify the split between Gnosis and Faith that spiraled out of control in the early development of the West. Neither the New Age or Gnostics on the one hand, nor the purely exoteric believer on the other can long subsist in division. Such a division engenders monsters, more confusion, and less and less life. We can apply this pattern to the post-colonial schools of thought in literature, to the revolutionary and reactionary schools of thoughts in politics, and to the endless culture debates in sociology and geopolitics.

“On the part of the human being it is the act of daring to aspire to the supreme Reality, and this act is real and effective only when the soul is serene and the body completely relaxed – without smoke and crackling fire.”

We remember the One, because gnosis and magic and alchemy “do not dazzle God.” In the eyes of God, their practitioners are “dear sheep to him: in his consideration of them he desires that they shall never go astray and that they shall have life increasingly and unceasingly”.

The yoke is easy, the burden is light. There are more dangers ahead, but to learn the lesson of the One is to pass into abundant Life.

Posted on 2014-05-10 by Logres

2.3 Unweaving the Web of God

From Chapter 3, *The Empress*, Meditations on the Tarot.

But it so happens that in human consciousness one separates the inseparable – in forgetting the unity. One takes a branch of the tree and cultivates it as if exists without the trunk. The branch can have a long life, but it degenerates. It is thus that in forgetting gnosis and mysticism, magic has been taken separately which, being a branch separated from its trunk, ceased to be sacred magic and became arbitrary or personal magic. This latter mechanized to a certain degree and became what one understands as ceremonial magic which flourished from the time of the Renaissance until the seventeenth century. It was par excellence the magic of the humanists, ie., it was no longer divine magic, but human magic. It no longer served God, but man. Its ideal became the power of man over visible and invisible Nature. Later invisible Nature was also forgotten. Visible Nature was concentrated upon alone, with the aim of subjugating it to the human will. It is in this way

that technological and industrial science originated. It is the continuation of the ceremonial magic of the humanists, stripped of its occult element, just as the former is a continuation of sacred magic, but deprived of its gnostic and magical element.

More might be said here – for example, the degeneration of the current cycle or branch of mankind in comparison to the past, the decay of religious and cultural forms in recent memory (eg., Protestantism, etc.), as well as noting the imagery of a branch broken from the tree of life. Man believes he can pluck the fruit, and retain it. This is the inner meaning of decline. What would the true man oppose to this? He then quotes Papus (also citing Eliphas Levi):

Ceremonial magic is an operation by which man seeks, through the play of natural forces, to compel the invisible powers of diverse orders to act according to what he requires of them. To this end he seizes them, he surprises them, as it were, in projecting, through the effect of correspondences which suppose the unity of Creation, forces of which he himself is not master, but to which he can open extraordinary outlets... ceremonial magic is of an order absolutely identical to our industrial science. Our power is almost nothing alongside that of steam, electricity, and of dynamite; but in opposing them by appropriate combinations to natural forces as powerful as themselves, we concentrate them, we accumulate them, we compel them to transport or to smash weights which would annihilate us.

Traite elementaire de science occulte, Paris, 1888, pp 425-426.

This is why salvation will not automatically spring from the research of the nuclear physicists in Bern (or anywhere else), despite our fond dreams and hopes, and despite the value of science. The above observation is virtually identical to something which lay at the heart of the work of George MacDonald, the genial spirit behind the Inklings.

Scientists/witches like Watho attempt to know nature, but are in error: “human science is but the backward undoing of the tapestry-web of God’s science” (2, 236). MacDonald does not contradict science, nor does he press a theistic interpretation onto his readers. In fact, allegorising too would come close to an “undoing the tapestry” which would be quite alien to MacDonald. Rather he replaces anthropocentric science with an ecological perspective in which nature and its “sympathetic forms” come first, whether religious/fantastic or scientific/rational.” This is John Pridmore⁷ commenting on MacDonald’s fairy tales. The discourse which thus speaks of nature has its own authenticity and autonomy—The theistic and non-theistic accounts of nature are neither incompatible nor is the one to be reduced to the other.” This is not synthesis or dichotomy.

Instead MacDonald’s art is to present nature in a natural form, that is, in the form of the fairy tale. The cut-up, labelled, specimen means nothing; the flower is everything: “To know a primrose is a higher thing than to know all the botany of it” (*Unspoken Sermons*)

Tomberg makes an identical point in this chapter concerning the various “truths” of pantheism, gnosticism, theism, and occultism, as well as offering a “re-weaving” of them to save their magic. Man resists these intellectual and spiritual difficulties, because it deprives him of his illusion of power. So what is the answer?

Imagine, dear Unknown Friend, efforts and discoveries in the opposite direction, in the direction of construction or life. Imagine, not an explosion, but rather the blossoming out of a constructive “atomic bomb”. It is not too difficult to imagine, because each little acorn is such a “constructive bomb” and the oak is only the

⁷http://www.snc.edu/english/documents/North_Wind/By_genre_or_topic/Nature_and_Ecology/Nature_and_Fantasy_-_John_Pridmore.pdf

visible results of the slow explosion... Imagine it, and you will have the idea of the great work, or the Tree of Life.

Isn't it easier to comprehend the vertical play of invisible forces behind our workaday world, asks Tomberg, than to explain the mystery of how "fully explained" living cells stay alive and multiply? These meditations, like those of the Inklings, ultimately spring from the power of the moral imagination to re-integrate those decayed and splintered faculties of man which have occurred as a result of his "triumph" over himself and over Nature. This illusory triumph does have a "truth", but it only possesses it as a shadow or "intimation" of what could have been, and can still be.

Much of the magic today will consist in a re-weaving of what was undone.

Between a prayer⁸, a chant⁹, and a war-song¹⁰, wherein lies the difference in our war against "that which all too easily is"?

Posted on 2011-11-19 by Logres

2.4 Inner Meaning of Augustinianism

Before we proceed along the Arcana of the *Meditations*¹¹, it might be helpful to point out a link between "gnosis" and the "arcana". In the very first chapter of his *Meditations* Tomberg highlights the truth that arcana represent "enzymes" or "ferment" which make the soul fruitful by awakening *the deeper, ever deeper layers*, and which lead to a spiritual "event", which is then termed the "Mystery". Human secrets are merely

⁸<http://www.sv-luka.org/praylake/index.htm>

⁹http://wiki.answers.com/Q/English_lyrics_to_Preliator_by_Globus

¹⁰<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3pTUvB9uExI>

¹¹http://www.gornahoor.net/library/Meditations_versionTwo.pdf

parts of those two processes which are (for good or bad reasons) deliberately concealed, so just as arcana is higher than secret (being the “life” of the “secret”) so are mysteries greater than arcana. If you are following the Gnosis seminar or read carefully, you can compare the “ferment” of the enzymes with the “friction” which Mouravieff cites as producing “heat and light” which can unify (and fructify) the soul.

They are speaking about the same thing, but from slightly different perspectives. If God is the circle whose center is everywhere, and circumference is nowhere (and this was the Medieval tradition in accord with Tradition), and if each of us “fell” in a different way and direction, then we all work our way back to God from a different point and in a different direction. Likewise, in esoteric studies, slightly different starting points and perspectives produce a seeming difference, which is on closer inspection the same thing in a different garb or mood or tone: initiates recognize each other, because they have all returned (are returning) to the center.

Mouravieff teaches that each of us starts as a conglomerate of “little i s”, an abyss or void, analogous to the waters in Genesis. The real self has withdrawn to create a void, and then must re-emerge to re-create the chaos and triumph over the chaos. It is in this way that matter is drawn up into Spirit. These “little i s” reflect the random A influences which operate to keep them under General Law (Accident). One personality wants one thing, another personality wants another, and each one takes turn pushing the human entity in opposing directions, according to the randomness that operates within this magic circle (as it were), where the different directions cancel one another out. *This explains why things are “real” but not real at the same time*: each influence is powerful in its immediacy and its proper vicinity, but loses power as it pushes the Ego out of the vector of its power, which is inversely proportional to the distance. The Ego then comes under another vector, pushing in (likely) an opposing direction. Most men spend their lives bouncing around like a pinball, and at the end of their lives, *the meaning of that existence sums*

to an integral that approaches a Zero. Tomberg addresses this by pointing out that the unforgivable sin (or at least the most serious) is spiritual self-complacency: most men simply accept this situation as normal. We live in a civilization where this is largely accepted as the best, maybe the only, way of conducting one's life.

It is unfashionable (for instance) to observe Lent, to read antique European writers meditatively, to honor your father and mother, to remain monogamous and faithful to your wedding vows, etc. These practices were marks of an earlier situation in which men had agreed that the randomness of Life would be subjected to a higher Law that would begin to transform the otherwise iron-clad law of general Accident. Today, the absurdity of Life is the subject of cutting-edge drama which either justifies it, celebrates it, or wallows in it: Western man no longer believes in a method of transcending this human condition. They simply can't be bothered.

Just as MouraviEFF teaches the idea that "one should get comfortable with being uncomfortable" (credit to a participant in the seminar) in order to sustain the necessary and painful efforts to begin to change this situation, Tomberg teaches that the magician must turn "work into play": this is the first condition, the primal Arcana, the *unum necessarium*. Ousepensky remarks that we find motives all the time to overcome inertia for worldly affairs, and so that it is of course possible (even more possible) to find motives to sustain such an effort. In older civilizations, it was the desire not to be damned, or the aspiration to achieve a "high culture", or certain interests that centered around clues discerned in mundane life that hinted at something "more" (this would be an example of discerning B influences correctly, the influences from Higher Mind that are cast into the void of A influences, and which all flow in the same direction).

And why not? Where is it written in the conscience that man should pursue complacency?

I am reading two books on Saint Augustine, one by F Seraphim

Rose¹², and the other by Jean Luc-Marion¹³. Since Augustine is such a seminal watershed for both the classical and the medieval world (and therefore, the Western world), his *Confessions* are an important measuring stick. Like Jean Calvin in *The Institutes*, he teaches that to know yourself and to know God are in the end, sharing the same goal; unlike Calvin, he understands that they come at last to the same thing. The Self and the Self-beyond-the-Self always exist together. It might be useful to remember that the definition of a “person¹⁴” (an individuum, not a personality) is that they have transcended themselves and recognize other Self(s). This occurs firstly by recognizing the fragmented nature of the personality and the latent existence of a higher Self, which is then a necessary goal to achieve.

Recognizing the metaphysical basis of other selves and accommodating the appearances is arguably a Western distinctive uniqueness, and it comes at a price, which is why constant contact with the Tradition has to be maintained, and explains why simply replacing the West with the East is not advisable, since the East has its own unique emphasis, also in perfect ultimate harmony with Tradition. It is nonsensical to mistake a unique emphasis and artful native form with the essence of Tradition, just as it is also nonsensical to suppose that that essence can be reached in a vacuum without developing a suitable “vehicle” within a given cultural Form: neither triumphalism or syncretism is sophisticated enough to do justice to the situation. Deeper Western thinkers used to do more justice to spiritual complexity.

¹²https://www.amazon.com/Blessed-Augustine-Orthodox-Church-Theological/dp/0938635123/ref=sr_1_1?ie=UTF8&qid=1409057181&sr=8-1&keywords=seraphim+rose+augustine

¹³https://www.amazon.com/Selfs-Place-Approach-Augustine-Cultural/dp/0804762910/ref=sr_1_1?ie=UTF8&qid=1409057110&sr=8-1&keywords=jean+luc+marion+augustine

¹⁴<http://orthosphere.org/2014/08/03/book-review-persons-the-difference-between-someone-and-something/>

Similar to Mouravieff's teaching that "shocks" or "falls" can actually prompt self-reflection and self-remembering, Saint Augustine states that whether he was virtuous or lost in vice, his life redounded to the praise and glory of the Lord, because the Lord's name was great, and greatly to be praised. He had discovered that his "great question" (who am I? a mystery to myself...) ended in the great mystery (a God without end): the two become One.

So the basis of the *Confessions* is the dual awareness that the "I" is an illusion, and that the ultimate resolution of this paradox would end in gnosis of the one true God. The Eastern Orthodox criticize (and to some extent rightly so) Augustine's conception of grace and his relation of it to free will, but that is not really the spiritual point of the *Confessions*, something which Jean Luc-Marion's work makes perfectly clear: Augustine was teaching that the fragmented, fallen self finds its true self in the truest Self, "that our hearts are restless till they rest in Thee". So the inner meaning of Augustinianism is precisely in accord with what Tomberg & Mouravieff state.

Posted on 2014-08-30 by Logres

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<https://matthewnanderson.wordpress.com/2016/03/06/ego-defense-mechanisms/>

2.5 The Emperor

The ones who truly love their traditions don't take them too seriously. They march to get their heads shot off with a joke on their lips. And the reason is that they know they're going to die for something intangible, something sprung from their fancy, half humor, half humbug. Or perhaps it's a little more subtle. Perhaps

hidden away in their fancy is that pride of the blueblood, who refuses to look foolish by fighting for an idea, and so he cloaks it with bugle calls that tug at the heart, with empty mottoes and useless gold trim, and allows himself the supreme delight of giving his life for an utter masquerade. That's something the Left has never understood, and that's why its contempt is so heavy with hate. When it spits on the flag, or tries to piss out the eternal flame, when it hoots at the old farts loping by in their berets, or yells "Women's Lib!" outside the church, at an old-fashioned wedding (to cite just some basic examples), it does so in such a grim, serious manner — like such "pompous assholes," as the Left would put it, if only it could judge. The true Right is never so grim. That's why the Left hates its guts, the way a hangman must hate the victim who laughs and jokes on his way to the gallows. The Left is a conflagration. It devours and consumes in deadly dull earnest. (Even its revels, appearances notwithstanding, are as grisly an affair as one of those puppet parades out of Peking or Nuremberg.) The Right is different. It's a flickering flame, a will-o'-the-wisp in the petrified forest, flitting through the darkness...

JEAN RASPAIL, *The Camp of the Saints*¹⁵

The Number of the Emperor is Four; this is the sign of Earth's four elements, and also the procession of the movement of Being out of the perfect triangle-circle of One-Two-Three, into the world of material creation, the union of spirit and matter. The Emperor has authority because he has achieved existence, he knows something, & he is capable of acting (1-2-3): he can therefore assume the post of emperor because he is "earth of earth", "the most human of humans", King David – a shepherd, a hero, a champion, a warrior, an outlaw, a king, a sinner, a saint. He is the

¹⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Raspail (1925–) a French author, and explorer.

manifestation of the Divine in the form of he who bears the sceptre, and is (therefore) the wielder of the sword not in vain.

The rise of the emperor to the post appointed for him by God occurs in the topsy-turvy world: for this reason, the emperor is “out on the green grass”, under the skies. His authority originated in the fact that the power of his being is such that he can hold court in the wilderness, and indeed (most likely) this may be where he plants the seeds that lead to his rule. As Rosenstock-Huessy argues in *Out of Revolution*, real political authority is worth nothing unless it is so powerful that it first begins “under the stars” or the clear blue skies. We reject the “whiff of Hegelianism” that wafts from Huessy’s¹⁶ work; however, he is correct to say that political authority changes with the revolution of the stars, and that even the secular revolutions (which aped legitimate procession of government) adhere to this change that which falls from the skies first (particularly when government is corrupt and asleep at the wheel). *Auctoritas* comes from the one who is self-restrained and crucified: that is, the emperor does not need the outer symbols to rule – they come to him like gravity draws smaller objects: he is comfortable at first, not with worldly power, but with naked Being. Like the sage on the mountaintop, the emperor sits by the river banks, or in the woody dells, or out in a cow pasture. He dwells outside the “city”, when the city is falling apart and degenerate. He is at home within his own skin, and is free from worldly influences¹⁷ which dominate the “kingdom of this world”. He is King Alfred living in the swamps, awaiting his chance to reconquer England from the Vikings.

This is the opposite of the career politician, the demagogue, or the opportunist. His power comes from power over self, not over other people. He holds sway over others, and carries or embodies real authority over them, and as a result, he exercises legitimate power. Tomberg makes the strong case that compulsion is superfluous for those with real author-

¹⁶<http://plato.stanford.edu/entries/rosenstock-huessy/>

¹⁷<http://unurthed.com/2009/10/21/mouravieffs-correction/>

ity: “where there is authority, there is present the breath of sacred magic filled by the rays of light of gnosis emanated from the profound fire of mysticism, there compulsion is superfluous”. Viewed this way, Leftism or revolutionary thought is basically like a mental disease, which is healed by true action on the body politic through the esoteric organs. This is consistent with the doctrine of the Gnostic Church as the “heart” of the organized Petrine and Pauline Churches.

“The Emperor has renounced movement by means of his legs (they are crossed) and action by means of his arms (one hitches the belt, the other holds the sceptre).” The “instinctive and impulsive” nature of the Emperor is restrained, by self-restraint acting under Divine influence. It is this, and this alone, which allows him to hold the post of guardian of the office of Empire. When King Alfred made peace with the Danes, but had Guthrum baptized, he secured the Anglo-Saxon kingdom of England and the Danelaw as a united realm, bringing peace to the land. He could have hid vengeance in his heart, but instead, he converted his enemy, quite literally, to a friend. It is this type of action which the Holy Roman Emperor aimed at, being king of kings and lord of lords, the means by which the petty rivalries of monarchs (which would later destroy Europe in repeated conflagrations) were brought to heel before the sacred body of the King¹⁸. Tomberg remarks that the Middle Ages contain a wealth of political theory (which is unique, even from classical Greece and Rome) on the post of the Emperor: under this list, we include Dante (who sided with the White Guelphs¹⁹ in the Ghibelline controversy) and John of Paris²⁰.

“The emperor has renounced personal opinion to receive revelation of Truth, personal action in order to become a vehicle of sacred magic,

¹⁸<http://www.amazon.com/The-Kings-Bodies-Ernst-Kantorowicz/product-reviews/0691017042>

¹⁹<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UcGDRYQd-uQ&feature=related>

²⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_of_Paris

the way of personal development in order to be guided by the Master of the Way, and his own personal mission in order to be charged with a mission from above.” This makes him the “source of Law and Order”.

I think I have quoted Bonaventura before²¹: That which is not confined by the Great, but is contained by even the smallest, it is that which is Divine. God (the Self beyond Self) becomes King in respect of those who freely worship Him, and He is crucified in relation to those who choose to fight or struggle with that freedom against the Font of Freedom. In both cases, a withdrawal is accomplished in order to establish a realm of freedom. Hitler and Napoleon, both, attempted to occupy the post of the shadow of the Emperor, but they took up the sword to do it. That is, they placed their trust in worldly machinations: power and the grapeshot or Panzers that were seen to produce such.

There is an Emperor of Europe, of Christendom. The post is occupied. It in our day is occult, in shadow, but God does not allow a vacuum in Nature: the man who has a vacuum of Ego and Pride will be courted by the Spirit for the post of Emperor, and there is undoubtedly an occulted Emperor today, in 2014. The complete synthesis of mysticism-gnosis-magic which is effected in the Emperor is also, Tomberg states, the definition of *initiation*, where eternity and the present moment meet together.

Mysticism becomes true without falsehood (Gnosis), and most certain (magic), and then absolutely certain in the light of pure thought as both subjective and objective experience (Hermetic philosophy): the Emperor is the hermetic synthesis of the emanations of God’s light upon the world, though he may be unappreciated, unknown, hidden, or occulted.

“Presumption? It would be a monstrous presumption if it were a matter of human invention instead of revelation from above.”

“Ask” (mysticism or touch), “seek” (gnosis or hearing), “knock” (magic

²¹<http://noxrpm.com/post/2609941502/non-coerceri-maximo-continue-minimo-divinum>

or sight/vision) – Luke 11:9. These become *comprehension*. This is *initiation*. The goal of initiation is *depth*, or “niveau”. For the post of emperor, the aim is the realization of patriarchy, the “father-man”, the most human of all men, the heir of David. It is the four wounds spoken of which mark the Emperor, and provide him with the concrete experience to fulfill his destiny, to be anonymous, or (rather) synonymous with the post of Emperor itself: hence it is said, King Arthur only sleeps, as does the “King under the Mountain” (the Holy Roman Emperor). If the king sleeps, he shall return.

Indeed he is already here.

This bears reflection upon in the present day, for those who want to rebuild the monarchies. It was the Empire which gave birth to kings, the Holy Empire, and not the kings who built up the Empire. Rather than seeking to restore a particular pedigree or bloodline, thus exposing these men and the movement to an undoubted reaction which will be most violent, more thought should be put into finding the occulted Emperor, and also, collating and honing the methods and practices which will produce divine candidates of this quality. There is a lot of synthesis to be done in esoteric studies, and it can only be done rightly by those who have experienced it. The Emperor will require men of depth around him to respond to his authority, & also to embody emperorship in their little field of influence. Has anyone given thought to joining the Gnosis seminar? Mouravieff gives a practical method for recovering the initiation of Christendom.

One ought to try to recognize Emperor within one’s self, by seeking that which is truly Just. As Cologero has outlined, justice is the synthesis of moderation (the man of the senses), courage (the man of the emotions) and wisdom (the man of the intellect). You can see the same symbolism of numeric progression: what does Courage have to do with Gnosis? This is surprising, as one would expect Intellect to correlate with Gnosis, and Courage with Magic. When such a deliberate contradiction to our

“everyday” wisdom or literalness is generated, there is an opportunity to look more deeply. The man of Gnosis needs courage as the primary virtue because it goes so strongly against the “naive realism” which dominates worldly thinking. The man of Magic requires intellect, because he has already mastered courage (or courage has mastered him) and he requires mastery of the science and art, since Magic is potentially quite dangerous. Fast (senses), Watch (master passions), and Pray (effect the use of Magic under the name of God alone).

Posted on 2014-12-26 by Logres

* * *

Olavsson on 2014-12-27 at 14:28 said:

Most beautifully written and absolutely on target. The coming of the True Emperor is certain, and the realization of that truth is enough to keep the fire burning no matter how long we have to wait. Always remain loyal to the end.

TeenyTinyTarot on 2014-12-28 at 18:18 said:

What I assert is this,—that a man ought to be in serious earnest about serious things, and not about trifles; and that the object really worthy of all serious and blessed effort is God, while man is contrived, as we said above, to be a plaything of God, and the best part of him is really just that; and thus I say that every man and woman ought to pass through life in accordance with this character, playing at the noblest of pastimes, being otherwise minded than they now are.

Plato, *Laws*, 803c.²²

kenthmaker on 2014-12-29 at 10:35 said:

This is a beautiful post and a fecund inspiration for a new year. Thank you.

²²Just read another translation of this as quoted by Peter Kingsley in *Ancient Philosophy, Mystery, and Magic*, page 170.

Logres on 2014-12-29 at 13:21 said:

Thank you for reading. That is a good quote, TTT: as “Samwise” on the old Spengler Forum at Asia Times Online used to argue, religion is or ought to be a “task” – that is, God, immortality, and the soul have to be “achieved” by somebody. So we can assign ourselves the yoke of virtue, if we are listening to the highest parts of our soul. This was the entire yearning of the old classical tradition.

Space Lizard on 2014-12-29 at 15:49 said:

From the ashes a fire shall be woken,
A light from the shadows shall spring;
Renewed shall be blade that was broken,
The crownless again shall be king.

Logres on 2014-12-31 at 22:33 said:

But the Consul's brow was sad,
And the Consul's speech was low, 210
And darkly looked he at the wall,
And darkly at the foe;
“Their van will be upon us
Before the bridge goes down;
And if they once may win the bridge, 215
What hope to save the town?”
Then out spake brave Horatius,
The Captain of the gate:
“To every man upon this earth
Death cometh soon or late. 220
And how can man die better
Than facing fearful odds
For the ashes of his fathers
And the temples of his gods,
“And for the tender mother 225
Who dandled him to rest,
And for the wife who nurses
His baby at her breast,
And for the holy maidens
Who feed the eternal flame,— 230
To save them from false Sextus
That wrought the deed of shame?

Aquila on 2015-01-15 at 12:30 said:

According to my information, Dante sided with the Ghibellines. Now, what is White Guelphs? Never heard about that.

John Fitzgerald on 2021-02-07 at 15:12 said:

I have been aware of the existence of this site for a number years, but for some reason it's passed me by until this very weekend. It's been the long-overdue eruption of Dante into my life (my fault for the delay, not his) that has brought me here.

I have only just read this powerful reflection – or evocation, rather – of the Emperor this evening. Yet this piece I wrote for the Albion Awakening blog in May 2017 seems uncannily similar, certainly with regards to the Emperor appearing (or reappearing) on the periphery as opposed to the centre.

<http://albionawakening.blogspot.com/2017/05/the-return-of-constantine.html>

I had read and absorbed Tomberg though, and continue to do so, as it's a life-time's endeavour, of course. So maybe that accounts for the similarities.

Thank you and God bless,

John Fitzgerald

Cymru / Manchester

2.6 The Superstition of Reason

To paraphrase a Scottish poet, perhaps no other word, other than those of *Liberty* or *Christ*, have been subject to as much abuse as the word “*Reason*“. These days the word *Reason* has been defined to objectively exclude the very possibility of higher Intelligence, or higher Logos. At best, dialectical Reason (of the kind that American liberals imagined Socrates to be engaged in, illustrated by the career of Scott Buchanan²³) is al-



²³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Scott_Buchanan

lowed to achieve the suspension of *Aporia*. John Rawls²⁴ embodied or re-embodied a lot of the vigor left in classical modern liberalism by restating Hobbes and Locke's contractual theory in a way that Buchanan might have found congenial, given as he was to attempts to re-invigorate the social "federalism" of the early American republic. This is the area which the great critic Richard Weaver termed "the excluded middle", and he argued that much of liberalism "dances about in it". At the other end is the view that "reason is what the mind uses, and the mind is what the brain does": this view is increasingly popular in a "rational" era. The term "reason" in either case (though far more malignantly in the latter) substitutes in such a way as to obliterate (like a lunar eclipse) the obviously solar presence of higher Reason. On the contrary, anyone who experiences an illumination (greater or lesser) finds that the experience is finding one's self, and simultaneously experiences finding something that is already thought (utterly rational) and yet utterly free (alive and imparting life and therefore freedom). So the sum of the experience is supra-rational. This would not seem to be such a controversial point, as it is well within the intellectual capacity of a hard-working twelve year old, but in the modern West, it appears to be so. It also happens to be the united and universal testimony of the best human beings of all higher cultures, and even of many of those which are not "higher", which explains why the burned out dregs of liberalism often turn to the lowest common denominator they can find among the outskirts of Tradition, in the form of the New Age or noble savagery.

In the tale of *Vikrama and Vitala*²⁵, the king captures a vampire at the behest of a treasonous tantric sorcerer, who intends to use both of them to overthrow legitimate authority. The tale is instructive, as it points out that illegitimacy lurks not in the most obvious evil, but rather in the moralistic facade of the cunning and clever, who see an opportu-

²⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_Rawls

²⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Baital_Pachisi

nity for advancement at the expense of those who do not “know”. The king is saved by listening to the captive vampire, who reveals the plan of the sorcerer and suggests a manner to overcome him. In this fable, it is seen how superstitious “Reason” has actually become, because it denies both the authority of the Emperor and attempts to master the black arts in Saruman-like fashion in order to augment personal power. Is it not superstitious to deny the fullness of God’s Creation, and to make taboo and totem out of whatever is accidentally congenial to one’s bent? The natural authority of the secular ruler and realm of the supernatural are both to be subjugated to the desires of the sorcerer-state, a theory of politics which one actually finds expounded in the works of Culianu²⁶. We can see how “Reason” in the modern world, both as the prostitute and the ostensible mistress of Science and Justice, is similar to the thaumaturgic tantric-sorcerer of the Legend.

As great a poet, humanist, and thinker as Voltaire was seduced by the charms of secular thaumaturgy. It is a well known fact that the sublimated erotic rivalries of great thinkers and rulers who are legitimate often become mimicked in miniscule through their disciples, who are unable to appreciate the full scope of their work, but certainly key in on the tensions of their desires within the rivalries. Phillip Rieff drew attention to this in his work on *Second Death*²⁷. Thus, *Voltaire’s Bastards*²⁸ come to dominate the mental landscape of the West. Poor Voltaire wrote entertaining fiction like *Candide*, but never really (and self-confessed this) came to resolve the problem of Evil, and had to be content with living like a parasite off the ruins of an Age he helped to destroy. Don’t end up

²⁶<http://thearchdruidreport.blogspot.com/2011/10/plutos-republic.html>

²⁷<http://www.amazon.com/Fellow-Teachers-Culture-Second-Death/dp/0226716449>

²⁸http://www.amazon.com/Voltaires-Bastards-Dictatorship-Reason-West/dp/1476718962/ref=sr_1_1?s=books&ie=UTF8&qid=1423888644&sr=1-1&keywords=voltaires+bastards

like him.

The only way out this impasse is not to partake of the fighting in the rubble and ruin of the Western mental landscape, which is at this point dominated by the bastards of Reason in various titanic forms: there are the scientific crowds who can't accept something unless it can be explained in its most reductive terms, there are the masses of political factions who believe that the one burning question right now is to catalyze some form of resistance to the spread of whatever alien idea they define themselves in opposition to, there are the groups of people who endeavor to "dance about in the excluded middle" and prop things up by appealing to something along the lines of *Religion Within the Limits of Reason Alone*²⁹, etc., etc.

No wonder Gornahoor lays so much emphasis on avoiding dialectical quarrels with those who don't share aims and principles, getting things right at the foundation, and putting practice into theory (and vice versa) from the beginning, so that one is most assuredly not at the behest or beholding of a salary, an occupation, or a career of some sorts. These webs of A influences (legitimate in their own way, but self-canceling in the sense that they operate mechanically through humans under their sway) will eventually reduce what they master to rubble, much like the current landscape seems to be vividly illustrating.

Those who want to find something that Russell Kirk called *The Permanent Things* would do well to model their lives more on the life of a king Vikrama, who was brave enough to face vampires, and wise enough to listen to what he learned and avoid the trap that had been set for him. A young man could do much worse than aspire to the heroic and respect the supernatural – or, as Jesus put it, to be wise as a serpent, but innocent as a dove. The alternatives seem to be being part of the Sheeple, or aspiring to rule over them as a sorcerer.

²⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_Toland

Posted on 2015-02-13 by Logres

2.7 The Seven Sacred Liberal Arts

It is no coincidence that the Sacred Liberal Arts are Seven in number: this is the number of the mysteries, the steps towards union with God³⁰, and the rays of Creation, as well as the visible planets, the notes in the musical scale, and the steps or levels of the Kabbalah. There are also seven deadly sins. We can collate some of them, as follows:

Table 2.1: Correspondences between seven qualities

Liberal Art	Augustine's Ray³¹	Mystery	2 Peter³²	Beati- tudes
Grammar	Animation	Freedom and Action	Washing of Feet	Faith-Virtue
Logic	Sentience	Unity and Philanthropy	Scourging	Virtue-Knowledge
Rhetoric	Rationality	Comprehension and Philosophy	Crown of Thorns	Knowledge-Self Control
Arithmetic	Virtue	Harmony	Bearing the Cross	Self-Control-Steadfastness

Continues in next page

³⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=10801>

Liberal Art	Augustine's Ray Stage		Mystery	2 Peter Beati- tudes
Geometry	Ataraxia	Truth and Scientist	Mystic Death	Steadfastness- Godliness
Music	Intuition	Goodness and Religion	Entombment	Godliness- Brotherly Affection
Cosmology	Union with God	Beauty and Art	Resurrection	Brotherly Affection- Love

The liberal arts presuppose high intelligence, as the personal consciousness of the practitioner has to have already gotten as far as to see that there is no conflict, in the end, between Faith and Reason: since intellectus is destined for reunion with God just as surely as is purest faith. The union is effected in the consciousness of the just, or those made just. Those addicted to disputations or dilettantism will find the way of participation barred by the nature of the realities handled by the art. For those willing to re-engage them, the position and order of the seven liberal arts is teaching something about what its spiritual purpose is: it does this by the *analogia entis*³³, the law of correspondence, and the doctrine of signatures. The above table is a start.

For example, Mouravieff's Man # 3 is a man of rhetoric (ideas); he engages the world intellectually, even when acting emotionally or instinctively, he uses the intellectual sectors with emotional or instinctual coloring heavily. Such a man would need to beware traps of rhetoric, and also study to engage more deeply in the truest and best use of creative rhetoric.

³³<http://www.millinerd.com/2006/12/whos-afraid-of-analogia-entis.html>

Rationality, self-control, and the “crown of thorns” (the crucifixion of the intellect) would be things most necessary for this initiate to attend to in his self examination and training. He would attend to them knowing that they were his greatest strength, and also his greatest weakness, whereas weakness in the other disciplines would manifest completely differently: they would either be far more obvious, or far less – A man #3 would either be grossly deficient in the emotional arena, or (perhaps), far less tainted in that area (than in the intellect), and more artlessly or naturally pure, simply because it was not the seat of his ego, and precisely because it had been less “developed”. Indeed, even in the exoteric literature, we find references to wisdom like this, as for example John Cardinal Newman recommending the benefits of liberal education³⁴ for distracting the mind from idleness or temptation to fear, which is the besetting structural sin of a Man #3.

Therefore although Geometry seems like a strange subject to study to develop one’s spirituality, this is the ineluctable conclusion one is led to when delving into the interiority of man. For example, Thomas Hobbes came to Geometry³⁵ rather late in life, and it shows in his thought, as illustrated in this amusing story:

He was 40 years old before he looked on geometry; which happened accidentally. Being in a gentleman’s library, Euclid’s Elements lay open, and “twas the 47 El. libri I” Pythagoras’ Theorem . He read the proposition . “By God”, sayd he, “this is impossible:” So he reads the demonstration of it, which referred him back to such a proposition; which proposition he read. That referred him back to another, which he also read. Et sic deinceps, that at last he was demonstratively convinced of that trueth. This made him in love with geometry.

³⁴<http://www.newmanreader.org/works/idea/index.html>

³⁵<https://www.uh.edu/engines/epi2372.htm>

Quoted in O L DICK, *Brief Lives* (Oxford 1960); A quotation about Thomas Hobbes by John Aubrey (1626-1697)

Another observation that shows the non-arbitrary nature of the patterns in the Logos: the feet are the lowest part of the body, but also closely connected to spiritual development. Incidentally, this is the basis of “foot-washing” and also why people’s feet get cold first when they are dying. There is also the old Bible verse: “How beautiful upon the mountains are the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace; that bringeth good tidings of good, that publisheth salvation; that saith unto Zion, Thy God reigneth”. (Isaiah 52:7) Mouravieff cites in *Gnosis* the practice developed by a group associated with Karel Weinfurter, in *Man’s Highest Development*³⁶, which details spiritual exercises designed to center development on the feet. The Middle Pillar Exercise³⁷ in Rosicrucian magic is a kind of “grounding”, as well. Both exercises are a kind of magical “Grammar” (and Arithmetic). They are initiatory. And so can all the sacred liberal arts.

An entire program of spiritual and emotional and intellectual development is laid out in the Trivium and the Quadrivium, leading (finally) to union with God as its ultimate end. We can see that this seventh branch of the table is the highest plane of existence. The matching tables could make this very practical and specific. This seven fold pattern should be tried in a spirit of expectant humility: the numbers are not arbitrary.. He who maintains this out of sheer ignorance has not graduated the very first stage of instinctual life: the protozoa are more intelligent, in that they do better arithmetic with their instincts, and better grammar with their participation in Logos. The ignorant sceptic sorely needs the sacred liberal arts.

³⁶<https://archive.org/details/manshighestpurpo032199mbp/page/n10>

³⁷https://www.golden-dawn.com/eu/UserFiles/en/file/pdf/Middle_Pillar.pdf

Recognizing the inner meaning of the liberal arts frees it from endless debates around the exact and minute particulars of the “Canon”: it is less important what is precisely “in” (or “out”) of the Canon, than in whether or not whatever is being studied shares a certain inner pattern and spirit. For example, *Faust* is a Western classic. However, there are other obviously acceptable substitutes³⁸: someone can get an education from very few books, if they are “right” for their inner development. The development of depth in the pupil means a student of the *Bhagavad Gita* and a disciple of the Gospel of John could hold a conversation and understand one another, because they share a deeper inner language. Canon details, provided they follow a pattern laid down by the Logos, are authentic and true. Esoteric recovery of the Liberal Arts will re-vitalize them, and save us from snobbery or dilettantism, or irrelevance.

Some will admit that the numerical pattern is interesting, but will find the details too speculative and abstruse. They are not cynical so much as possessing an over-developed worldliness. But their skepticism is even more difficult to address. Still, we can try to see if we can aid them, tossing a bone³⁹:

SIMON: I – do you have any idea how seven became a lucky number?

Prof. DEVLIN: I have no idea, whatsoever, except that, you know, if we forget lucky numbers, there is a mathematical notion called a happy number. To get a happy number, you look at the number and you start squaring the digits and adding the answers. If you keep on doing that, eventually either you’ll end up with the number one or you will end up getting a sequence of numbers that cycles. It begins 4, 16, 37. Seven is the smallest number that gives you one.

³⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Tragedy_of_Man

³⁹<https://www.npr.org/templates/story/story.php?storyId=11803762>

As you see, this is exactly the kind of stuff we find in Iamblichus' *The Theology of Arithmetic*⁴⁰, which is dismissed today as risible. After leafing through the chapter on the Hebdomad (Aquinas commented on Boethius' commentary⁴¹ on the Hebdomad), I did a little research, to see if I could find out what Iamblichus meant by calling 7 a virginal number. As it turns out, it is similar to seven being a "happy" number:

Evidence A⁴² (this source is derisive, but gives a valuable tid-bit)

Other numbers arise naturally, but seven is "left out": 1-3 are generated by the point, the line, and the plane, and 4 is generated by the solid. 3 & 4 then generate 5 in the Pythagorean triangle as hypotenuse, and 6 as the area, 8 is the first cube number, and 9 the first square. But Seven is nowhere to be found "in mathematical nature", except by intention.

Evidence B⁴³

Agrippa states it is the only number that both 1) when multiplied by another number, produces none of the numbers in the decad (unlike 5, as in $5 \times 2 = 10$), and 2) is not the product of another

⁴⁰https://archive.org/stream/iamblichus-theologyarithmetric/iamblichus-theologyarithmetric_djvu.txt

⁴¹<https://www.amazon.com/Exposition-Hebdomads-Boethius-Aquinas-Translation/dp/0813209951>

⁴²https://books.google.com/books?id=udptayxY2E8C&pg=PA27&lpg=PA27&dq=hebdomad+athena+virgin+iamblichus&source=bl&ots=2mH2dyjQgG&sig=ACfU3U1fwbHMQmhzoZ67D8M2Hfwa4CJ_qw&hl=en&sa=X&ved=2ahUKEwjQjZ60q-HhAhUNVa0KHTmLBI0Q6AEwC3oECACQAQ#v=onepage&q=hebdomad%20athena%20virgin%20iamblichus&f=false

⁴³<https://books.google.com/books?id=ifrHAAAAQBAJ&pg=PA161&lpg=PA161&dq=virgin+seven+iamblichus&source=bl&ots=kef3A0I8kF&sig=ACfU3U2Q5NAMGciQ-tERPOxLYWPxU5vmRA&hl=en&sa=X&ved=2ahUKEwisq7e3ruHhAhUJvKwKHe0TAjuQ6AEwAh0ECAkQAQ#v=onepage&q=virgin%20seven%20iamblichus&f=false%20target=>

multiplication of another number (only $1 \times 7 = 7$). So it has “no father or mother”.

Mathematics hasn’t been affected by “Modernity”. At least not in the qualities of the elemental numbers. The conclusion has to be that Seven is a repetition of One: It is Unity, Recreated and Manifested in fullness or perfection. Consult Genesis 1. Even the French Revolution had to go back to the days of the week.

Yet what other meaning could the numbers possess, if not to direct our attention to a particular spot, for deepening wisdom? For those lacking the arithmetical instincts of the amoeba or average honeybee because they deprive themselves, consider the alternative, which is that learning has no pattern, and no symbolism, but is purely utilitarian or even existential. Under this view, there is nothing requiring a leading out “from”, and nowhere to quest “towards”. Such positions all too obviously lead to nihilism, because if you destroy the symbolism of numbers, you are left with Zero. Others will find it somewhat fanciful, perhaps – But why 7 and not 12? Or 21? What is the meaning of Life? You may as well answer 42⁴⁴! or else take Iamblichus seriously.

So certainly, each number “means something”; they are something: thus, there are other numbers and patterns and meaning “after” 7, just as there are meanings for before 7. Since the intersection between Macrocosm (Triad) and Microcosm (Universe of “4”) is 7, this has radical implications for education and spiritual development: our forefathers knew this in some way, whether instinctively, by experience, esoterically, or otherwise. Twelve (of course) results from the multiplication of 3 and 4, and is therefore just as significant as 7. And if we know how months differ from days, we have a clue to answer how. Perhaps the liturgical year could be brought into relation with the Liberal Arts? There are other things to

⁴⁴<https://www.independent.co.uk/life-style/history/42-the-answer-to-life-the-universe-and-everything-2205734.html>

say about the Numbers of course, all of them, and someone else could say more of 7. So the pattern can be enriched and expanded.

If God created the world by wounding himself and withdrawing to make the Void, then our imperfection is a task for both Him and our selves to overcome and finish the Creation, for God is at rest (He is perfect). He rests, having become man and overcome death, so that we might become God. God is, therefore, “at work” through us in our imperfection. He is perfect, and yet (on the human plane of activity), imperfect, since the revealing of the sons of God is not yet here:

Praeterea, ostensum est supra quod essentia Dei est ipsum esse. Sed ipsum esse videtur esse imperfectissimum, cum sit communissimum, et recipiens omnium additiones. Ergo Deus est imperfectus. Objection 3: Further, as shown above (Question⁴⁵ 3, Article 4), God’s essence is existence. But existence seems most imperfect, since it is most universal and receptive of all modification. Therefore God is imperfect.

Aquinas goes on to deny that God is imperfect (he answers this objection), yet there is an inner meaning to the old verse: And He said to me, “My grace is sufficient for you, for My strength is made perfect in weakness (I Cor 12:8-10). What is this making perfect, if not God taking on imperfection, to suffer with those humble or pure enough to be of His mind, in order to further creative spiritual evolution?

Thus, the liberal arts are the strength of God for our weakness of mind, yet they are simultaneously nothing compared to the strength of God that they lead towards. For once completed, they are fulfilled: “He who finds truth, beauty, and goodness, finds more” (Dr. Michael Baumann). This is why Aquinas on his deathbed said⁴⁶:

⁴⁵<https://dhspriority.org/thomas/summa/FP/FP004.html>

⁴⁶<http://scriptoriumdaily.com/thomas-aquinas-big-pile-of-straw/>

I adjure you by the living almighty God, and by the faith you have in our order, and by charity that you strictly promise me you will never reveal in my lifetime what I tell you. Everything that I have written seems like straw to me compared to those things that I have seen and have been revealed to me.

Part of our task requires us to avail ourselves of a rational and sound mind, and to think God's thoughts after Him. In order to transcend humanity, we have to develop our humanity up to its natural limit: the common saying in parlance is, Put Wings to your Prayers. Trust in God, tie up your camel.

Sharpening the mind in, through, and on the sacred liberal arts, allows the fastest progress in developing the intellect up to its natural limit.

Hopefully, more work will be done in recovering the basis of the Seven Sacred Arts. The orders of angels comes to mind, as does Bonaventura's Journey of the Mind into God⁴⁷: for example, if you add philosophy and theology to the seven liberal arts, you have 9, which is the order of the angels. A young scholar aspiring to be a sage could do worse than undertake the revitalization of the Sacred Seven Liberal Arts. Interest in it is already increasing, as evinced by this recent article⁴⁸. The table provided at the start, along with the esoteric background, may be of very practical use. Our forefathers, even a hundred years ago, had not entirely forgotten that the edifice of civilization is built, not on Mammon, but on something much deeper. They even carved it into stone⁴⁹, so we could not forget.

Hopefully, we have scratched the surface enough in the above to

⁴⁷<http://www.ntslibrary.com/PDF%20Books/Bonaventure%20Journey%20of%20the%20Mind%20Into%20God.pdf>

⁴⁸http://www.tomworrel.com/uploads/3/4/7/9/34794642/ahiman_worrel_article_page_7-37.pdf

⁴⁹<http://www.studiesincomparativereligion.com/uploads/ArticlePDFs/403.pdf>

demonstrate that there is a deep organic inner Logic behind the tradition and lay out of the Seven Sacred Liberal Arts, enough to get you interested, and started. It's just a beginning.

Posted on 2019-05-05 by Logres

* * *

Zach on 2019-05-09 at 21:15 said:

Thanks. This came on a significant day for me.

Although I am well past being a "young scholar." The Hobbes anecdote is hopeful.

Logres on 2019-05-12 at 00:20 said:

I like the quote that Cologero put up recently, that the young learn from us what we've learned by heart (I can't remember the name of the Frenchman quoted). Falling in love with it, or all over again, helps us learn it by heart. Maybe you can help pass it on. Thanks for reading.

Clement's Initiation

3.1 Titus Flavius Clemens and the Golden Chain

What evidence could we adduce for the claim that Clement of Alexandria possessed secret wisdom?

First of all, we could establish his difference from (say) Tertullian or even Jerome (who had the dream about getting rid of his pagan library):

... by philosophy I mean not the Stoic, nor the Platonic, nor the Epicurean, nor that of Aristotle; but whatever any of these sects had said that was fit and just, that taught righteousness with a divine and religious knowledge, this I call eclectic philosophy.

For Clement, Christianity was true, not because it overthrew paganism, but because it completed it. Furthermore, truth was truth, not “Christian” truth. Yet he goes somewhat further, differing from (say) Augustine, who first believed in order to understand, writing instead that

As many men drawing down the ship, cannot be called many causes, but one cause consisting of many; — for each individual

by himself is not the cause of the ship being drawn, but along with the rest; — so also philosophy, being the search for truth, contributes to the comprehension of truth; **not as being the cause of comprehension, but a cause along with other things, and co-operator; perhaps also a joint cause.** ... But the Hellenic truth is distinct from that held by us (although it has got the same name), both in respect of extent of knowledge, certainly of demonstration, divine power, and the like. For we are taught of God, being instructed in the truly “sacred letters” by the Son of God. **Whence those, to whom we refer, influence souls not in the way we do, but by different teaching.** And if, for the sake of those who are fond of fault-finding, we must draw a distinction, by saying that philosophy is a concurrent and co-operating cause of true apprehension, being the search for truth, then we shall avow it to be a preparatory training for the enlightened man (*to gnostikon*); not assigning as the cause that which is but the joint-cause; nor as the upholding cause, what is merely co-operative; *nor giving to philosophy the place of a sine qua non.* Since almost all of us, without training in arts and sciences, and the Hellenic philosophy, and some even without learning at all, through the influence of a philosophy divine and barbarous, and by power, have through faith received the word concerning God, **trained by self-operating wisdom.** But that which acts in conjunction with something else, being of itself incapable of operating by itself, we describe as co-operating and concausing, and say that it becomes a cause only in virtue of its being a joint-cause, and receives the name of cause only in respect of its concurring with something else, but that it cannot by itself produce the right effect.

The reserve about “sine qua non” is perhaps worth further debate. However, one understands, in order to believe. Yet one might go (in fact) further than this and construe that for Clement, Christianity could only remain true to the extent that it was also willing to be completed in its

turn, or re-completed. That is, what took absolute precedence over exoteric doctrine would have been the divine Logos which from the beginning undertook the creation of the world as a school for the souls of men, a school which was living and active, creative and artful, not capable of being uttered in fullness in a creed. This plan would have been understood as articulated (and articulate) through initiation into what was pellucid, beautiful, and virtuous, the vestibules of the holy. "He who finds them, finds more." The mastery of such would have been gnosis, the goal of pistis (only in this sense inseparable, but absolutely separate otherwise, since Clement would never have separated pistis completely from gnosis, but defended the "higher knowledge"):

It is then, as appears, the greatest of all lessons to know one's self. For if one know himself, he will know God; and knowing God, he will be made like God... But that man with whom the Word dwells does not alter himself, does not get himself up: he has the form which is of the Word; he is made like to God... and that man becomes God, since God so wills. Heraclitus, then, rightly said, "Men are gods, and gods are men." (ANF 2.271).

The Instructor, 3.1

On this wise it is possible for the true Gnostic already to have become God. "I said, Ye are gods, and sons of the highest." (ANF 2.437).

Strom., 4.23

By thus receiving the Lord's power, the soul studies to be God; ... To the likeness of God, then, he that is introduced into adoption and the friendship of God, to the just inheritance of the lords and gods is brought; if he be perfected, according to the Gospel, as the Lord himself taught. (ANF 2.506)

Strom., 6.14

... they are called by the appellation of gods, being destined to sit on thrones with the other gods that have been first put in their places by the Saviour. (ANF 2.539).

Strom., 7.10

What, then, shall we say of the true Gnostic himself? "Know ye not", says the apostle, "that ye are the temple of God?" The true Gnostic is consequently divine, and already holy, God-bearing and God-borne. (ANF 2.547).

Strom., 7.13

But he who has returned from this deception, on hearing the Scriptures, and turned his life to the truth, is, as it were, from being a man made a god. (ANF 2.551)

Strom., 7.16

Yet there is even more than demonstrating the fitness of Clement's teaching as a vessel for esotericism. Although the Mar Saba letter of Clement mentioning the "secret Gospel of Mark" is debated among scholars, we should not be entirely convinced by scholars who argue¹ that Clement's lack of further quotation implies disapproval.

Clement himself held a position that truth was incommunicable at high levels, except by initiation, or proper coding. This is consistent with his Pythagoreanism².

This is drawn out at length by S. Muller³:

¹<http://ixoyc.net/data/Fathers/622.pdf>

²<http://www.bu.edu/wcp/Papers/Anci/AnciAfon.htm>

³http://stephanhuller.blogspot.com/2011/01/how-to-read-and-understand-clement-of_23.html

As we noted in our last post Clement used the conflict with regards to Paul accepting circumcision in Acts and the Epistle to the Galatians to illustrate ‘a hidden harmony’ which is necessary for ‘right conduct’ and ‘right belief.’ Now Clement has moved beyond this and opened the door to things written in two different forms in two different ‘forms’ of the gospel. What Jesus spoke in a low voice (whispered) are the parables which appear in the revealed gospels of Christianity which circulate generally. These parables represent a ‘lower’ or subordinate form of the mystic wisdom ultimately revealed by Jesus and preserved in some other gospel form. Yet the harmony between these two gospel forms is indeed what Clement understands as the ‘ecclesiastic canon’ – a Pythagorean term which clearly represents again the preserving of an original tune in a ‘lower key’ (perhaps distinguished from the tonic by a “*diatessaron*”).

When we go back to Clement’s original discussion it is important to see the underlying Pythagorean coloring to his use of the term *kanona*. For we read again: “He spake all things in parables, and without a parable spake He nothing unto them;” and if “all things were made by Him, and without Him was not anything made that was made,” consequently also prophecy and the law were by Him, and were spoken by Him in parables. “But all things are right,” says the Scripture, “before those who understand,” that is, those who receive and observe, according to the exposition of the Scriptures explained by Him according to the ecclesiastic canon; and the ecclesiastical rule is the concord and harmony of the law and the prophets in the covenant delivered at the coming of the Lord.

Thus in no uncertain terms then, Clement understands the term ‘canon’ in a Pythagorean sense. In this particular case Clement uses Jesus’s condemnation of the Pharisees who ‘lie’ about the truth of the Law and the prophets and its prediction of a messiah like Christ as an example of unworthy behavior in the tempo-

rary Alexandrian community. Whoever Clement is attacking (the Carpocratians? the Marcionites? both?) have divorced the secret gospel from its original 'harmony' with the public gospels so as to ruin the true ecclesiastic 'canon' understood in the Pythagorean sense.

Salvatore Lilla⁴ is agreed to have done good work on Clement explicitly in relation to the Gnostics, which dimension of Clement had been previously ignored (perhaps because there are so many others?).

The body of Clement's work is saturated (also) with Jewish' mythology.

It is unnecessary to rehearse his spiritual lineage through Papias to the apostles, or to trace his influence in later Church mystical theology, but Dionysius was an indirect pupil, and Dionysius' writings are arguably "unorthodox" enough to accommodate a possible Hermetic root source. The notion of the deep "I" emanating and proceeding and then returning⁶ to God are of particular import. His Stoical influences are so far beyond doubt as to be unremarkable.

We can conclude that Clement's "canon" included all things because "all things were from God". Thus, paganism cannot evaporate or be subordinated:

In fact, nevertheless the thief possesses really, what he has possessed himself of dishonestly, whether it be gold, or silver, or speech, or dogma. The ideas, then, which they have stolen, and which are partially true, they know by conjecture and necessary logical deduction: on becoming disciples, therefore, they will know them with intelligent apprehension.

⁴<http://journals.cambridge.org/action/displayAbstract;jsessionid=C80CC407F4BFC4A35AD9963BC675DA26.tomcat1?fromPage=online&aid=2407972>

⁵<http://www.bgbucur.com/PDFuri/ClementHierarchy.pdf>

⁶<http://www.reversespins.com/dionysius.html>

Here, Clement virtually argues that Christian Gnosis in fact re-illuminates that which it has already illuminated indirectly, through union with its derivatives. This return and reconciliation (similar to the doctrine of recapitulation given in Colossians) of paganism and Christianity should make clear that it was possible to achieve a balance between the two which allowed “each to be for the other, but differently”.

Clement himself admitted that there was a “secret Gospel”, but claimed that it was not what the Gnostics pretended it to be. Might it have looked more like Mouravieff’s⁷ work?

Even his pupil Origen’s echo is true to this presupposition & Clement’s teaching:

Jesus conversed with His disciples in private, and especially in their sacred retreats, concerning the Gospel of God; but the words which He uttered have not been preserved, because it appeared to the evangelists that they could not be adequately conveyed to the multitude in writing or in speech... and they saw... what things were to be committed to writing, and how this was to be done, and what was by no means to be written to the multitude, and what was to be expressed in words, and what was not to be so conveyed.

Contra Celsus, VI, 18

So that Clement’s citation of Paul’s words make perfect sense:

Take also the Hellenic books, read the Sibyl, how it is shown that God is one, and how the future is indicated.

CLEMENT, *Stromata*, Book VI, chap. VII

⁷http://www.bibliotecapleyades.net/archivos_pdf/mouravieff3.pdf

God is one, truth is one. It should be clear by now that Titus Flavius Clemen's thought-world (still very similar to St. Paul's) was a far cry from that of Tertullian, Cyprian, Iranaeus, or even Augustine, and that the Latin world's loss of the Alexandrian library was a very symbolic event. Clement seems to have been a point of intersection for an amazing amount of eclectic influence, and it would be very surprising if that were merely a matter of chance.

Posted on 2011-04-15 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2011-04-16 at 11:16 said:

Clement is not arguing at all that Christianity "saved" paganism – that is an Augustinian argument.

Spock on 2011-04-17 at 10:03 said:

Whether completed or saved is splitting hairs. My reference to saving was to the gentiles not to paganism where I used Clement's word "completing." However, salvation and completion you must admit carry an almost identical value.

Logres on 2011-04-17 at 19:35 said:

Spock, they could mean the same thing, but Clement's "mental and spiritual furniture" indicate they don't. Clement does not think that the Gospel "saves" the pagan schools. And it completes them only by essentially being the same thing, **except more so**.

It might be worth while pondering the effect Augustine and his milieu had on the infant Church. Although I might be willing to concede that Saint Paul comes down on the side of "Platonism for the masses" (not my original phrase), at least in general effect, it seems clear that the collapse of the Empire, the persecutions (which annihilated true apostolic succession in a lineal sense), and the general confusion of the Late Roman period combined to form in Saint Augustine a decisive favoring of Latinate "City of God" style religion as opposed to authentic and alternate streams present in the Church, which were still there as late as Boethius. Even the Orthodox want to credit Augustine here, for his insistence (echoed today by V. Lossky, the premier mystical theologian) that there is no such thing as "hidden" wisdom apart from dogma. Clement's position is far more subtle. While he agrees (against the Gnostics) that dogma is inseparable from esoteric truth, he would agree (against Augustine and others) also that esoteric truth

must be maintained to keep dogma intact. This retention of esoteric truth, furthermore, for Clement is not passed down through open writing, or even open proclamation, but the presence within the Church of “those who know”. “Those who know” are educated, or self-educated, by the wisdom available to all those who are receptive to it, an inner truth which is embodied in diverse traditions and schools and wisdoms known today as “paganism”. Clement’s inferred position from this is that a Christianity divorced from such is either no true Christianity, or a Christianity unwilling to accept education in the school of wisdom, and therefore at risk for being superseded in the same manner that the Jews (presumably) were superseded when they arrogated perfection to their exoteric assemblies.

Logres on 2011-04-17 at 19:37 said:

For example, <http://members.ozemail.com.au/~moorea/agapetae.html>

It seems that there was in the first full rush of the Church, an attempt, encouraged by the Apostles, to ‘sublimate’. But the experimenters did not call it that. The energy of the effort was in and towards the crucified and Glorified Redeemer, towards a work of exchange and substitution, a union on earth and in heaven with the love which was now understood to be capable of loving and being loved. In some cases it failed. But we know nothing – most unfortunately – of the cases in which it did not fail, and that there were such cases seems clear from St Pauls quite simple acceptance of the idea. By the time of Cyprian, Bishop of Carthage in the 3rd Century, the ecclesiastical authorities were more doubtful. The women, sub-introductae as they were called – apparently slept with their companions without intercourse; Cyprian does not exactly disbelieve them, but he discourages the practice. And the synod of Elvira (305) and the Council of Nicea (325) forbade it altogether. The great experiment had to be abandoned because of Scandal.

Tolstoy put the crude objection in the *Kreutzer Sonata*, and Cyprian more or less agreed. “But then excuse me, why do they go to bed together?” Both wise men were justified as against a great deal of sentimental lust and sensual hypocrisy. But even Cyprian and Tolstoy did not understand all the methods of the blessed spirit in Christendom. The prohibition was natural. Yet it seems a pity that the Church, which realised once that she was founded on a Scandal, not only to the world, but to the soul, should be so nervously alive to scandals. It was one of the earliest triumphs of “the weaker brethren,” those innocent sheep who by mere volume of imbecility have trampled over many delicate flowers in Christendom. ...

3.2 The Golden Book & Saint Clement

Boris Mouravieff, when teaching on polar-beings in *Gnosis*, references the existence of the Golden Book, an oral (if also incomplete) compilation of Jesus' teachings to the inner circle of disciples. It is only fair to point out that (like the exoteric-esoteric paradox of Christianity itself), the idea of a written compilation of oral teachings is somewhat odd – nevertheless, then, its very incompleteness testifies to its legitimacy, as some teachings must be “discovered”.

Clement of Rome⁸ was involved in the “inner” circle of disciples following Christ's death – the “inner” circle perpetuated itself and thereby endorses the reading of the Gospels in this light: Jesus' parables are given because “they have ears to hear, eyes to see, but cannot...”. A *parable* (as Ea points out in the collected Ur-group writings) is a “carrying with or beside”, and thus less direct than a *symbolon*, which is a “carrying into”.

Clement was a highly educated young man *with a photographic memory*. He was also a member of the powerful Flavian dynasty (and cousin to emperors Vespasian, Titus and Domitian). Though young, he was a man of considerable financial means. He had no background whatsoever in Judaism and would not have come into the circle of Nazoreans in Jerusalem had he not by chance met Barnabas in Rome and followed him to Palestine. Clement's high intellect and great curiosity were not lost on James the Just (Yaakov haZaddik), overseer of the Nazorean Assembly in Jerusalem. He officially assigned Clement to Peter's group of students and commanded Clement to send periodic reports of Peter's activities back. These reports are often mentioned in the book, and are sometimes indistinguishable from Clement's own journal entries.

⁸<http://www.scribd.com/doc/13561289/-The-Authentic-Peter-The-Preaching-of-Simeon-Kefa-from-the-Journal-of-T-Flavius-Clemens-Clement-The-Clementine-Recognitions-Recognitions-of-Cl>

As an unbaptized gentile proselyte, Clement and others were not allowed to eat or sleep with the baptized until judged spiritually and doctrinally fit for immersion.

I am not sure his relation to Clement of Alexandria, a point I raised in a previous essay when using this source. Jackson Snyder appears to confuse the two Clements, unless (perhaps) they were actually related by blood as well as by body of myth and name. Regardless, Clementine literature⁹ portrays him (and Clement of A) as:

the Apostles' means of disseminating their teachings to the Church

I will remark here, two things: the presence of an elite ("highly educated... with a photographic memory") and the doctrine of secret teaching (the "Church" was a cult tolerated by the disciples as a condescension to man's weakness, but a body which was subjected to impulses from an elite to "regulate" its health).

The beginning of the text rings true:

I Clement, who was born in the city of Rome, was from my earliest age a lover of chastity; while the bent of my mind held me bound as with chains of anxiety and sorrow. For a thought that was in me whence originating, I cannot tell constantly led me to think of my condition of mortality, and to discuss such questions as these: Whether there be for me any life after death, or whether I am to be wholly annihilated: whether I did not exist before I was born, and whether there shall be no remembrance of this life after death, and so the boundlessness of time shall consign all things to oblivion and silence; so that not only shall we cease to be, but there shall be no remembrance that we have ever been. This also I revolved in my mind: when the world was made, or what was before it was made, or whether it has existed from eternity. For it

⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pope_Clement_I

seemed certain, that if it had been made, it must be doomed to dissolution; and if it be dissolved, what is to be afterwards? Unless, it may be that all things shall be buried in oblivion and silence, or something shall be, which the mind of man cannot now conceive.

What noble young man, starting upon life, who is not clouded in the fogs of lust, has not felt this yearning? At first, Clement desires to consult a magician who will raise a spirit from the dead to prove the immortality of the soul, but a friend dissuades him, saying that the Elohim set themselves against those who trouble dead souls (here in the idea/reality of General Law).

He defends a visitor to Rome who tries to speak on behalf of the disciples, and invites him to his home. Clement sails to Caesarea, and there is brought to meet Kefa (Peter). Peter has decided to “choose” him as his successor. Peter teaches him the cause of man’s ignorance:

The will and counsel of YHWH has for many reasons been concealed from men; first, indeed, through bad instruction, wicked associations, evil habits, unprofitable conversation, and unrighteous presumptions. On account of all these, I say, first error, then contempt, then infidelity and malice, covetousness also, and vain-boasting, and other such like evils, have filled the whole house of this world, like some enormous smoke, and preventing those who dwell in it from seeing its Founder aright, and from perceiving what things are pleasing to Him. What, then, is fitting for those who are within, excepting with a cry brought forth from their inmost hearts to invoke His aid, who alone is not shut up in the smoke-filled house, that He would approach and open the door of the house, so that the smoke may be dissipated which is within, and the light of the sun which shines without may be admitted...

Peter is saying here, that the Kali Yuga predominates. This poetic metaphor resonates even with Western ecclesiastical¹⁰ history:

¹⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Edwin_of_Northumbria

The present life man, O king, seems to me, in comparison with that time which is unknown to us, like to the swift flight of a sparrow through the room wherein you sit at supper in winter amid your officers and ministers, with a good fire in the midst whilst the storms of rain and snow prevail abroad; the sparrow, I say, flying in at one door and immediately another, whilst he is within is safe from the wintry but after a short space of fair weather he immediately vanishes out of your sight into the dark winter from which he has emerged. So this life of man appears for a short space but of what went before or what is to follow we are ignorant. If, therefore, this new doctrine contains something more certain, it seems justly to deserve to be followed.”

The souls of Edwin and Clement were worthy to receive the Truth, *therefore, it appeared*. Those who think all souls are equal are servants of Satan – all souls are in one sense equally valuable, but there is a reason certain people yearn towards the truth, and others do not. Clement desires very much to know the answers to his questions, enough to humble himself (outwardly and inwardly) – this “creates” a higher Truth for him than his current spiritual state has manifested (the true un-Semitic definition of humility).

Simon Peter prepares for an upcoming controversy with Shimon the Magus, which is delayed, giving them time to discuss things which may come up during the debate. Clement is somewhat saddened, but Peter teaches a truth similar to Boethius’ arguments in *Consolatio*:

He who believes that the world is administered by the providence of YHWH El Shaddai ought not, O Clement, my friend, to take it amiss, in whatever way particular things are done, being assured that of YHWH guides to a favorable and fitting issue even those things which seem superfluous or contrary in any business, and especially towards those who worship Him more intimately; and

therefore he who is assured of these things, as I have said, if anything occur contrary to his expectation, he knows how to drive away grief from his mind on that account, holding it unquestionable in his better judgment, that, by the government of the good YHWH, even what seems contrary may be turned to good.

Peter sees an opportunity to expound oral teaching, which cannot be taught any other way, including *Sola Scriptura*.

for I believe that it has been done by the providence of YHWH, for your advantage; that I may be able, in this interval of seven days, to expound to you the method of our faith without any distraction, and the order continuously, according to the tradition of the Navi Emet, who alone knows time past as it was, the present as it is, and the future as it shall be: which things were indeed plainly spoken by Him, but are not plainly written; *so much so, that when they are read, they cannot be understood without an expounder, on account of the sin which has grown up with men*, as I said before.

This is absolutely true for all except those of whom the mystery of the Just applies, and it still affects them. Peter teaches a truth which resonates with Guenon's work on the Manifest/Unmanifest:

There always was, there is now, and there ever shall be, that by which the first Will begotten from eternity consists; and from the first Will precedes a second Will. After these came the world; and from the world came time: from this, the multitude of men; from the multitude the election of the beloved, from whose oneness of mind the peaceful Malkuth of YHWH is constructed...

In other words, there is something underlying God's manifestation that is unmanifest. The Orthodox still distinguish between God's essence (unknowable) and His energies (manifested and experienced). Peter then

teaches about the “upper waters” which divide heaven and earth. The point here is that Peter is *initiating* Clement. We learn about Nimrod and the worship of fire, as well the adoration of each nation’s *sarim*¹¹ as gods. Here is given the rudiments of a cosmology. The Western tribes drove the middle tribes into the East by means of violent warfare. Abraham the astronomer recognizes the Creator in the stars and is taught by the angel of the Lord, who shows him that his inheritance lies in Palestine (where usurpers dwell). This is connected with the “boundaries of men” set by the *sarim* and General Law. What follows is a summary of the Old Testament. Then comes the Advent. It is worth noting that the 12 disciples and 70 elders mirror the angelic orders, in the intention of Christ, the image of the *Imperium*:

When Elohim had made the world, as Master of the universe, He appointed chiefs over the several creatures, over the trees even, and the mountains, and the fountains, and the rivers, and all things which He had made, as we have told you; for it were too long to mention them one by one. He set, therefore, a malach as chief over the malachim, a spirit over the spirits, a star over the stars, a demon over the demons, a bird over the birds, a beast over the beasts, a serpent over the serpents, a fish over the fishes, and a man over men, who is Moshiach Yeshua. But He is called Moshiach by a certain excellent rite of obedience; for as there are certain names common to melekim, as Ahashwerosh among the Persians, Caesar among the Romans, Pharaoh among the Mitsrayim, so among the Yahudaïm a melek is called Moshiach. And the reason of this appellation is this: Although indeed He is the Son of YHWH, and the beginning of all things, He became as man; Him first YHWH anointed with oil which was taken from the wood of the tree of life: from that anointing therefore He is called Moshiach...

We also learn that the schisms of the Judaic sects were work of the

¹¹<http://www.archangels-and-angels.com/misc/sarim.html>

devil to obscure the truth, and that baptism was a Christian rite because man is “taken from the waters”, as the chosen one is. More teaching is given about the internal disputes of Jewish sects, including Saul and John the Baptist. After James is thrown down the steps of the Temple by Saul, and persecution breaks out, Peter is sent to Caesarea to refute Shimon Magus, who is misleading many of “our people” by pretending to be the Primordial man come again – the Messiah. Peter thus weaves divine history into a personal narrative of why Clement and he are there in the city.

More of Clement and Peter, to come... .

Posted on 2012-08-04 by Logres

3.3 Clement's Initiation: Peter and Shimon Magus debate

This is a continuation of a previous post¹². My source document is here¹³, and I have already noted the problems with dates – it is part of the Clementine literature, involving at least two Clements, but its contents are noteworthy.

Simon Magus is an under-appreciated character, even though modern sensibilities have tried to paint him as someone who fights poverty or performs tricks as good deeds – instead, he is a pivotal figure in the history of the Church.

To continue, Peter (Simon Kefa) is recounting the Apostles' arguments with certain Jews, in which Matthew and Phillip both speak, along with James the Just:

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4533>

¹³<http://www.scribd.com/doc/13561289/-The-Authentic-Peter-The-P-reaching-of-Simeon-Kefa-from-the-Journal-of-T-Flavius-Clemens-Clement-The-Clementine-Recognitions-Recognitions-of-Cl>

Then a certain Prush, hearing this, chided Philippos because he put Yshua on a level with Moshe. To whom Natanyahu bar Talmai, answering, boldly declared that we do not only say that Yshua is equal to Moshe, but that He is greater than he, because Moshe was indeed a navi, as Yshua is also, but that Moshe was not the Moshiach, as Yeshua is, and therefore He is doubtless greater who is both a navi and the Moshiach, than he who is only a navi. After following out this train of argument, he stopped.

Here we see (early on) the Christian claim to primacy which caused such trouble within the religion of Judaism (and in Rome). However, it was also more complex than this, as Peter will explain. James the Just actually argues that Jesus ratifies the angels, rather than the other way around, and Mathias (in place of Judas), claims that (in any case) the Messiah is worthy of great love, no matter what one thinks. Each apostle makes a uniquely personal and uniquely intelligent argument:

After him Yosef bar Naba, who also is called Mattityahu, who was substituted as a Shliach in the place of Yahudah of Keriot, began to exhort the people that they should not regard Yshua with hatred, nor speak evil of Him. For it were far more proper, even for one who might be in ignorance or in doubt concerning Yshua, to love than to hate Him. For YHWH has affixed a reward for loving and a penalty for hating. For the very fact, said he, that He assumed a Yahudai body, and was born among the Yahudaïm, how has not this incited us all to love Him? When he had spoken this, and more to the same effect, he stopped...

The apostles argue that the Messiah is heaven-born, otherwise, John the Baptist would truly be the greatest born of women, and thus Messiah, rather than Jesus. It's a very interesting look inside the "sects" of Judaism at that time. Indeed, Gamaliel is said to secretly be a follower of Christ, who remained within Jewish ranks in order to moderate their fury, which

he does, giving his famously pragmatic speech “If these things be of God...?”. James proceeds, and has almost convinced everyone to receive baptism when Saul intervenes with agitation and violence, and James is cast down the temple steps and left for dead.

Peter says he fled to Jericho, then Caesarea, and intends on going to Rome following the debate with Shimon Magus. No women are present at the debate, and Peter opens by explaining his practice of night-time meditation, which Clement approves of:

I believe, therefore, that you also have acquired the habit of wakefulness, as you state; and you have wished at a fitting time to explain this to us, that we also may not grudge to throw off and dispense with some portion of our sleep, that we maybe able to take in the precepts of the living halakah. For when the food is digested, and the mind is under the influence of the silence of night, those things which are seasonably taught abide in it.

Peter wants to know what character Shimon is, that he might know how to argue without casting pearls before swine. Niceta warns them (he was once a co-worker with Shimon):

but because I well know the impieties of this man, I think of your reputation, and at the same time the inner-beings of the hearers, and above all, the interests of the truth itself. For this magician is vehement towards all things that he wishes, and wicked above measure.

The description sounds like a high ranking initiate:

This Shimons father was Antonius and his mother Rachel. By tribe he is a Shomroni from a village of the Get tones; by profession a magician yet exceedingly well trained in the Greek literature; desirous of glory, and boasting above all the human race,

so that he wishes himself to be believed to be an exalted power, which is above YHWH the Creator, and to be thought to be the Moshiach, and to be called the Standing One. And he uses this name as implying that he can never be dissolved, asserting that his flesh is so compacted by the power of his divinity, that it can endure to eternity. Hence, therefore, he is called the Standing One, as though he cannot fall by any corruption...

Shimon has replaced Dositheus¹⁴ as head of the thirty, and taken Luna as a consort; he also uses the dead spirit of a boy to accomplish his “miracles”. In fact, he even explains to Niceta how it is done, by adjuring Malakim to allow a spirit to come back. Peter is moved to tears, and says that spirit of the boy of air is not what it seems to be:

But, in truth, he is deluded by demons...

Incidentally, Bo Yin Ra claims that “lemurian physical entities of putrefaction” use people’s souls to create illusions of human spirits for their own energetic purposes, in perfect agreement with Peter. Peter answers objections to God’s goodness in exposing man to the Kali Yuga, when almost all men are lead astray – he does so simply by teaching that God permits it to reveal who are truly His. Clement is asked to leave, prior to Shimon’s actual arrival, because he has not yet been baptized, and Peter needs to enter God’s presence for prayer.

Shimon arrives and challenges Peter, refusing *Shalom*. Peter attempts to show what he meant: that the inquiry would be peaceful and quiet, not violent and contentious. Shimon shoves this aside, and says Jesus came to bring a sword, not peace; Peter joins battle and quotes the peace-maker beatitude. The conflict begins in earnest. Peter ends up saying “do not rashly take exception to things you do not understand” quite a lot. Shimon shows his hand, and argues that Christ contradicted himself

¹⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dositheos_%28Samaritan%29

(after it is clear that Peter actually has lived with Jesus long enough to know what he is talking about). They swap rhetorical acrobatics over Jesus' saying about "dividing a house" and Peter comes off as very well-spoken, although not as naturally so as Shimon, who appears to be merely squabbling over rhetorical terms. In a somewhat "modern moment", Peter tells Shimon not to speak of what the learned or unlearned are willing to believe, *but what he Shimon really thinks of the navi*, Christ, whose Gospel Peter is compelled to teach authoritatively. Shimon presents his creed of many elohims, with one above all: "*elohim bagadol of elohim*". Shimon teaches that the Jews were ignorant of him, and Peter insists that the Creator YHWH is indeed this very Elohim of Elohim.

We are in the middle of the birth of Gnosticism, here.

Peter answers by claiming that all *malachim* (godlike angels) are messengers to the tribes of men:

For every tribe has a malach, to whom YHWH has committed the government of that tribe; and when one of these appears, although he be thought and called elohim by those over whom he presides, yet, being asked, he does not give such testimony to himself.

The Bible is not anti-polytheistic, but henotheistic¹⁵. See *Galatians: angels are tutors*. Peter claims that the *malachim* are appointed of God, and sometimes a mortal man is chosen instead, but that the worship that goes to them is carried to God. Of course, Shimon thinks this is a delusion: there is a hidden Elohim that no one knew until now; YHWH is deluded, self-deluded, into thinking He is the true Creator; only the enlightened ones can escape this delusion and go to join the true Elohim. He cleverly quotes Christ – "No man has known the Father, but the Son...". Moses, then, and all the rest, were ignorant of true Elohim. When Peter points out that Shimon doesn't believe in Christ's sayings,

¹⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Henotheism>

and that Moses prophesied of Christ (and therefore, accepted Christ's pre-eminence and was not entirely ignorant of truth as claimed), Shimon points out that "having a Son" involves the Creator in passions. Familiar ground, but freshly done in this exchange. Shimon (like many Gnostics) is very slippery here. Or subtle, depending on your loyalty. The rest of the debate is quite interesting, and very complex, very rhetorically brilliant on both sides (another reason I think the letter is genuine). It prefigures the great Gnostic-Christian divide of those early centuries quite well; this encounter may have symbolically actuated the great divide. Suffice it to say there are many strokes of genius by Peter as well as Shimon; Peter asks why the immortal, invisible New Power does not confer a new sense on men to recognize him, and if He has given it to Shimon, then why not to them? And can Shimon read their thoughts, since he can read God's? Predictably, Shimon argues that he learned from the Bible's own story that the "Creator" cannot be good – He made a manifestly imperfect world. Thus, the Problem of Evil undermines faith in the "Creator". Peter mocks the rejection of Torah on the basis of Torah, but Shimon frames the *Euthyphro* problem brilliantly and classically:

But even if Torah had not given indications from which it might be gathered that the Elohim who made the world is imperfect, it was still possible for me to infer from those evils which are done in this world, and are not corrected, either that its creator is powerless, if he cannot correct what is done amiss; or else, if he does not wish to remove the evils, that he is himself evil; but if he neither can nor will, that he is neither powerful nor good. And from this it cannot but be concluded that there is another *elohim* more excellent and more powerful than all. If you have aught to say to this, say on... .

Peter of course does say on. He not only counters with a very traditional statement about choosing wise instructors:

O Shimon, they are liable to conceive such absurdities against YHWH who do not read Torah with the instruction of masters,

but account themselves teachers, and think that they can understand Torah, though he has not explained it to them who have learned of the Master.

... but uses a *reductio ad absurdum* to show that the Ineffable light lies under the same charge brought against the “Maker” or “Architect”. They are now at the very heart of the matter, metaphysically speaking, and all those who wrestle today¹⁶ between accepting Gnostic doctrine or Christian tradition (or any other) would do well to ponder this collision, so vividly painted in the ancient literature.

We will end this post with Peter’s objection to the Ineffable God, which is one of the strongest I have seen:

Whence that new power of yours is not only found liable to a similar charge, but even to a worse one, if, in addition to all these things, it is believed to be, when it is not. *For He who created the world, His existence is manifest by His very operation in creating the world, as you yourself also confess. But this power which you say that you alone know affords no indication of itself, by which we might perceive, at least, that it is, and subsists.*

More to come later, about the continued journey of Clement with Peter, and the initiation of Clement, which Peter says he did “moved by certain unknown motions of the heart”. Also, the notes of Tomberg on Cyprian the Mage¹⁷ are worth reading — the magic that was being done was not a “joke”.

Posted on 2012-08-11 by Logres

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¹⁶<http://www.scribd.com/doc/57492796/Gnostic-Fragments-by-Nimrod-de-Rosario>

¹⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cyprian_and_Justina

Gabe Ruth on 2012-08-13 at 15:43 said:

Thank you for the posts.

I mentioned it in a recent comment so I hesitate to bring it up again, but have you read *A Voyage To Arcturus*? That is a vividly painted portrait of Gnosticism, and I truly wish I'd never read it.

The question those who wrestle with these options must answer is whether you would give your allegiance (for whatever that's worth) to a good but not all-powerful God if there was a higher power that was not good, and whether it would make a difference if the non-omnipotent good God was your creator. I've never been particularly worried that atheists are right, but the gnostics trouble me, because their answer to the problem of evil seems so reasonable.

This piece also got me to thinking about Voegelin's use of the term gnostic, and a way to unify his meaning with the historical gnostics: they both posit a way of being, a new truth, which is wholly opposed to everything that we see around us and have inherited from our ancestors, in fact casting the old ways as completely evil, the source of the evils that we now experience.

logres on 2012-08-13 at 16:03 said:

I saw your comment on *Arcturus* (I think) because I looked the book up – Lewis uses it for his space trilogy, so I marked it to buy and read, at some point, thank you. The Gnostics trouble me more than atheists, likewise – as an acquaintance pointed out, the lesson of Gnosticism may be “let the dead bury the dead” – sometimes traditional forms have to be resurrected rather than resuscitated (if that's a good analogy?). Which means a lot of hard work. And they can certainly help us in dealing with the current climate (which is actually becoming very Demiurgic, what with the rampant PC and reigning gods of multicult, etc.). If the Gnostics had the courage to go against God, what excuse do we have for not standing against false gods? They certainly have praiseworthy points. I chose the debate because Peter's answers are so good – if the Demiurge really is real, and “revelation” is from him, how does this get the Ineffable off the hook for the problem of evil? It doesn't (it seems to me) – it just pushes the problem back by giving an emotionally charged and short-term satisfying answer (defers the cost). Same as atheism with final causes.

Dominion on 2012-08-14 at 00:14 said:

Professor James Cutsinger provides a good explanation of the role of the exoteric “religion” in his lecture entitled “The Noble Lie”, available on youtube. Taking this viewpoint, it is not so much the religion, be it Christianity or Gnosticism, that matters, so much as it is the potential of its use as a spiritual aid. The doctrine of the Triune God and the creation undergoing apotheosis and the doctrine of the Demiurge and the “true Light” or “laughing Christ” can be taken as conflicting narratives being used to attain the same end, at which point the doctrines themselves (their ‘literal’ truth or untruth not being the point) can be surpassed and salvation or liberation

attained. In that respect, the initiate among the Cathars and the one receiving the Eucharist at Divine Liturgy or Mass can embrace each other as brothers in a sense beyond their fellows in the exoteric faith. That said, Gnosticism's ability to be of much use as a faith on which civilizations can be founded seems limited, precisely because of its ambivalence to matter and the material world.

Also, at what point do you believe that Traditional esoteric doctrines and practices became known among some in the Church? Personally, I have always found it difficult to see how the scant if not nonexistent hard evidence can lead us to be certain that Christ and his Apostles themselves were in fact initiates in the proper sense (they are "esoteric" doctrines, after all), and at best it seems as if no conclusion can be drawn either way.

The appearance of the Euthyphro is certainly a treat.

3.4 Christian Initiation in Clementine Literature

This is a continuation¹⁸ of thoughts from my source¹⁹, as well as a running summary/commentary on the events described. *Please note the tremendous import of one claim made in this treatise: Baptism is a powerful rite because **Christ the Only-Begotten made the waters** (upper & lower).* Peter is initiating Clement (who can be viewed as the alter-ego of Simon Magus: Simon is actually more worthy from the world's point of view, as Clement has only dreamed of attempting what Magus has already done – Clement repents, & follows Peter "because he has the words of life" – this leads Peter to explain the lesser mysteries to Clement – a debate with Simon Magus is the centerpiece). As we've seen, both sides have eloquent rhetoric – Magus is more crafty and dangerous in debate, Peter more solid and sensible, but equally keen.

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4636>

¹⁹<http://www.scribd.com/doc/13561289/-The-Authentic-Peter-The-P-reaching-of-Simeon-Kefa-from-the-Journal-of-T-Flavius-Clemens-Clement-The-Clementine-Recognitions-Recognitions-of-Cl>

Simon has cast doubt on Jesus' veracity by questioning whether He contradicts Himself, and Peter is explaining what "division" of a house, or by the Divine sword of Truth, means in a religion based ostensibly on "uniting the house" or gathering in all the tribes of Israel and nations of men:

But if any one say, How does it seem right for men to be separated from their parents? I will tell you how. Because, if they remained with them in error, they would do no good to them, and they would themselves perish with them. It is therefore right, and very right, that he who will be saved be separated from him who will not. But observe this also, that this separation does not come from those who understand aright; for they wish to be with their relatives, to do them good, and to teach them better things. But it is the vice peculiar to ignorance that it will not bear to have near it the light of truth, which confutes it; and therefore that separation originates with them. For those who receive the knowledge of the truth, because it is full of goodness, desire, if it be possible, to share it with all, as given by YHWH; yea, even with those who hate and persecute them: for they know that ignorance is the cause of their sin.

Peter thus deals with Christian paradox: the Scriptures "speak" in parables after the fashion of men at times, at other times not – only a spiritual man can reconcile seemingly contradictory passages. This point has been made many times by the Patristic fathers and other theologians. Gnosticism is based on an over-simplification, or over literalization of Scripture. For instance, it is not necessary to posit a Demi-Urge Creator God opposed to the Light – one could (for instance) simply accept the old idea of (MouraviEFF's) General Law and the Hierarchies, who tutor men until they are ready. Thus, we might quote Joubert²⁰: "Force and

²⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joseph_Joubert

Right rule the world; Force, till Right is ready". There is no necessary contradiction, but paradox. Gnosticism is thus both intellectually oversimplified, and imaginatively impoverished, while also becoming more cumbersome and complex in these areas to compensate. This is not to deny Gnostic *insights*, but to reject Gnostic theology.

In a tantalizing passage, Peter holds out the idea that all religions are potentially salvific, thus agreeing with Augustine²¹:

it so: you cannot know what Elohim is, but you can very easily know what Elohim is not. For how can any man fail to know that wood, or stone, or brass, or other such matter, is not Elohim? But if you will not give your mind to consider the things which you might easily apprehend, it is certain that you are hindered in the knowledge of Elohim, not by impossibility, but by indolence; for if you had wished it, even from these useless images you might have been set on the way of understanding.

One can't help but think of the Three Trials²² here: Man has to learn to say "this is not me" before he is worthy of Light. In the Christian tradition, there is Purification, Illumination, then Theosis.

The reason why Baptism is a rite, not a "mere" sign, but must be accompanied by initiation/confirmation:

But water was made at first by the Only-begotten... His will: that you be born anew by means of waters, which were the first created... *Wherefore, with prepared minds*, approach as sons to a father, that your sins may be washed away, and it may be proven before Elohim that ignorance was their sole cause...

²¹<http://www.scribd.com/doc/86329463/Augustine-on-True-Religion-De-Vera-Religione>

²²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

Then follow some Jewish teachings on Torah which have some basis in Tradition: rules of chastity, etc. A very good point is made about being “reactive” towards other religions or points of view:

Or shall we be so foolish, that if we see a worshipper of idols to be sober, we shall refuse to be sober, lest we should seem to do the same things as he does who worships idols?

The source of judgement on the Jews:

And truly confusion is our worthy portion, if we have done no more than those who are inferior to us in knowledge...

At the end of the debate, Peter confers the rite on Clement, arranges for a local bishop, orders the Church, and baptizes others:

at the last he ordered me to fast; and after the fast he conferred on me the *mikvah* of ever-flowing water, in the fountains adjoining the sea.

At times, Peter seems almost Platonic:

Or do you not know that friends are always together, and are joined in memory, though they be separated bodily; as, on the other hand, some persons are near to one another in body, but are separate in mind?

Again,

If any man who is a worshiper of Elohim had endured what this man's father has endured, immediately men would assign his belief as the cause of his calamities; but when these things come upon miserable Goyim, they charge their misfortunes upon fate. I call them miserable, because they are both vexed with errors here, and are deprived of future hope; whereas, when the worshippers of YHWH suffer these things, their patient endurance of them contributes to their cleansing from sin...

Providence and Fate, again. Or, the Three Trials.

Then follows a minor miracle, as Peter and Clement go with others (on their tour of the region) to see some vinewood columns and statues of Phidias. Peter is more interested in an old beggar woman, & when he inquires about her state, it transpires that this woman is Clement's long-missing mother; Clement also finds his missing two brothers (who are already in Peter's company as Niceta and Aquila).

Even more Platonism (and emphasis on chastity):

Let us not shrink, then, from suffering along with her, for it is a sin to transgress any commandment. But let us teach our bodily senses, which are our outer senses, to be in subjection to our inner senses; and not compel our inner senses, which savor the things that are of Elohim, to follow the outer senses, which savor the things that are of the flesh.

Baptism is again emphasized:

Therefore, as the order and reason of the mystery demanded, on the following day she was immersed in the sea, and returning to the lodging, was initiated in all the mysteries of truth in their order...

Peter is always kind, compassionate, and "ecumenical" in his approach to other people (but there are specific, doctrinal and spiritual reasons for this):

Since you seem to me to be a learned and compassionate man, inasmuch as you have come to us and wish that to be known to us which you consider to be good, we also wish to expound to you what things we believe to be good and right. And if you do not think them true, you will take in good part our good intentions towards you as we do yours towards us.

Anyone sincerely hungering for Truth is talked to by Peter, kindly – the hunger is the thing, not the outward appearance. It is also interesting from this comment that Peter viewed “avatars” in a complex light (which should be clear from earlier comments):

Those who speak the word of truth, and who enlighten the spirits of men, seem to me to be like the rays of the sun, which, when once they have come forth and appeared to the world, can no longer be concealed or hidden, while they are not so much seen by men, as they afford sight to all. Therefore it was well said by One of the heralds of the truth, Ye are the light of the world, and a city set upon a hill cannot be hid; neither do men light a candle and put it under a bushel, but upon a candlestick, that it may enlighten all who are in the house.

A new debate with an old hermit commences - the old hermit maintains that the gods or God does not rule the world, but only Chance and something he calls “Genesis”. We will continue this next week... What can be learned from these sections? Again we see the influence of Greek thought and learning on “Torah”, almost to the point of verbatim quotes from Plato, as well as certain practices like fasting, chastity, and the performance of rites. We also see that Peter holds to the “many truths” position, *so long as* the one truth holds paramount, and so long as there is a personal hunger for truth.

Posted on 2012-08-17 by Logres

3.5 Petrine Initiation in the “Old World” of Pure Intellect

The debate with the old workman continues, and he assures Peter he is no demagogue:

I am not such a fool in my old age that, understanding what is true, I should deny it for the favor of the rabble.

Niceta proposes that Peter be the master of the debate, which should be between himself and the old man.

But after we have disputed in the Grecian manner, and we have come to that point where no issue appears, then he himself, as filled with the knowledge of Elohim, shall openly and clearly disclose to us the truth on all matters, so that not we only, but also all who are around us as hearers shall learn the way of truth. And therefore now let him sit as umpire; and when either of us shall yield, then let him, taking up the matter, give an unquestionable judgment.

Niceta and Aquila know the doctrines of Epicurus and Pyrrhonists, but the old man says his doctrine is different: he follows "Genesis".

I Clement said to him: Hear, my father: if my brother Niceta bring you to acknowledgement that the world is not governed without the providence of Elohim, I shall be able to answer you in that part which remains concerning *the Genesis*; for I am well acquainted with this doctrine.

A discussion of simplicity or "substance" follows, which ends with a highlighting of mathematics:

For a way is afforded us to intellectual and invisible things from those which we see and handle; as is contained in arithmetical instructions, where, when inquiry is made concerning divine things, we rise from the lower to the higher numbers; but when the method respecting present and visible things is expounded, the order is directed from the higher to the lower numbers. Is it not so?

"Genesis" turns out to be roughly Deism, of some sorts; Niceta objects that prayer, then, is futile, and that on the contrary, Elohim will

destroy the present "clockwork" world and reward those with ageless life who are worthy of inheriting the invisible world to come, which contains the visible world. We are on very Platonic ground – the spirit is even said to *escape* from the body. Matter is made of the four elements, tempered by a certain something of Elohim's action.

For I think that what some have said is vain: that the body of the world is simple, that is, without any conjunction; since it is evident that what is simple can neither be a body, nor can be mixed, or propagated, or dissolved; all of which, we see, the bodies of the world do.

A learned discussion follows, summarizing Greek philosophy:

For the Greek philosophers, inquiring into the beginnings of the world, have gone some in one way and some in another. In short, Pythagoras says that numbers are the elements of its beginnings; Callistratus says qualities; Alcmaeon, contrarities; Anaximander, immensity; Anaxagoras, equalities of parts; Epicurus, atoms; Diodorus, akatonomaston (that is, things in which there are no parts; Asclepius, Ogkoi, which we may call tumors or swellings; the geometricians, ends; Democritus, ideas; Thales, water; Heraclitus, fire; Diogenes, air; Parmenides, earth; Zeno, Empedocles, and Plato, fire, water, air, and earth. Aristotle also introduces a fifth element, which he called akatonomaston; that is, that which cannot be named; without doubt indicating Elohim who made the world, by joining the four elements into one.

Extremely good arguments are made against Epicurus, who is taken as an exemplar of the materialist schools – they seem to make a teleological argument for God.

and that insensible bodies, even if they could by any means concur and be united, could not give forms and measures to bodies, form limbs, or effect qualities, or express quantities; all which, therefore, by their exactness, attest the hand of a Maker, and show the operation of reason, which reason I call the Word, and YHWH

Plato, in the *Timaeus*, is appealed to for belief in a Maker.

Apparently, the speakers shared the medieval and ancient beliefs in the changing of sex (eg., in hyenas) & in spontaneous generation from dung. Again, water has a special place (which reminds me of Lao Tzu²³):

But to prove by facts and examples that nothing is imparted to seeds of the substance of the earth, but that all depends upon the element of water, and the power of the Ruach which is in it... The doctrine of the Green Tablet:

But let us come now, if you please, to our own substance, that is, the substance of man, who is a small world, a microcosm, in the great world; and let us consider with what reason it is compounded: and from this especially you will understand the Hokmah of the Creator... But if it is Reason that is, Logos by which it appears that all things were made, they change the name without purpose, when they make statements concerning the reason of the Creator. If you have anything to say to these things, my father, say on.

In an interlude, Peter emphasizes the need for doctrinal faithfulness:

yet so that you only join the eloquence of your discourse with those things which you have heard from me, and which have been committed to you. But do not speak anything which is your own, and which has not been committed to you, though it may seem to yourselves to be true; but hold forth those things, as I have said, which I myself have received from the Navi Emet, Yshua, and have delivered to you, although they may seem to be less full of authority. For thus men often do who turn away from the truth, while they believe that they have found out, by their own thoughts, a form of truth more true and powerful.

²³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tao_Te_Ching

The old man basically is a modern sceptic who objects to the "Watchmaker Fallacy"²⁴:

Then said the old man:

Behold, we see the bow in the heaven assume a circular shape, completed in all proportion, and have an appearance of reality, which in all probability neither mind could have constructed nor reason described; and yet it is not made by any human mind. Behold, I have set forth the whole in a word: now answer me.

Aquila counters with Augustine's doctrine of seminal Reason²⁵:

But this is similar to that, that in the beginning Elohim created insensible elements that He might use for forming and developing all other things. But even those who form statues first make a mold of clay or wax, and from it the figure of the statue is produced.

It quickly reduces to the Problem of Evil & the Problem of Good:

To this the old man added: I am not able, my son, to say that those things which seem formed by art are made by mind, by reason of other things which we see to be done unjustly and disorderly in the world. If, says Aquila, those things which are done disorderly do not allow you say that they are done by YHWH's providence, why don't those things which are done orderly compel you to say that they are done by YHWH, and that irrational nature cannot produce a rational work? For it is certain, nor do we at all deny, that in this world some things are done orderly, and some disorderly.

Evil falls on all, but redounds to the advantage of the good:

²⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Watchmaker_analogy

²⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rationes_seminales

But for this reason YHWH has decreed a judgment with respect to all men, *because the present life was not such that everyone could be dealt with according to his deserving*. Those things, therefore, which were well and orderly appointed from the beginning, when no causes of evil existed, are not to be judged of from the evils which have befallen the world by reason of the sins of men.

The Seres tribe²⁶ is mentioned as living “without evil”.

Some form of natural religion is endorsed in the sense that Good & Evil are always intertwined, & man's business is to sort them:

But do you, my father, as a wise man, choose from that division the part which preserves order and makes for the belief of providence, and do not only follow that part which runs against order and neutralizes the belief of Providence... To this the old man answered: Show me a way, my son, by which I may establish in my mind one or the other of these two orders, the one of which asserts, and the other denies, providence. Aquila answered, To one having a right judgment the decision is easy. For this very thing that you say, order and disorder, may be produced by a contriver, but not by insensible nature. For let us suppose, by way of illustration, that a great mass were torn from a high rock, and cast down headlong, and when clashed upon the ground were broken into many pieces, could it in any way be that, amongst that multitude of fragments, there should be found even one which should have any perfect figure and shape? The old man answered: It is impossible. But, said Aquila, if there be present a statuary, he can by his skilful hand and reasonable mind form the stone cut from the mountain into whatever figure he pleases. The old man said: That is true. Therefore, says Aquila, when there is not a rational mind, no figure can be formed out of the mass; but when there is a designing mind, there may be both form and deformity: for

²⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Seres>

example, if a workman cuts from the mountain a block to which he wishes to give a form, he must first cut it out unformed and rough; then, by degrees hammering and hewing it by the rule of his art, he expresses the form which he has conceived in his mind. Thus, therefore, from infirmity or deformity, by the hand of the workman form is attained, and both proceed from the workman. In like manner, therefore, the things which are done in the world are accomplished by the providence of a contriver, although they may seem not quite orderly. And therefore, because these two ways have been made known to you, and you have heard the divisions of them, flee from the way of unbelief, lest it lead you to that prince who delights in evils; but follow the way of faith, that you may come to that King who delights in good men.

This is truly Augustine's *De Vera Religione*²⁷. Apparently, some form of predestination also explains the origin of evil – men given to evil and evil rulers or demons were foreseen by God to have chosen them already. That is, the eternal state of individual being explains the transitory manifestation – thus the problem of evil is set free from the normal Western modes of wrestling with it.

And this is the bound assigned, that unless one first do the will of the demons, the demons have no power over him.

Thus, states of Being are self-chosen.

*Deucalion*²⁸ is mentioned in regards to the Flood (this is an old "myth"). The old persists, pushing the argument back to origins:

You have stated it excellently, my son. It now remains only that you tell me whence is the substance of evil. For if it was made by

²⁷<http://www.scribd.com/doc/86329463/Augustine-on-True-Religion-De-Vera-Religione>

²⁸<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Deucalion>

Elohim, the evil fruit shows that the root is at fault; for it appears that it also is of an evil nature. But if this substance was co-ageless with Elohim, how can that which was equally unproduced and co-ageless be subject to the other...

As Boethius would argue a few centuries later, the weight of evidence falls on the power of the rational mind dominated by Logos, to turn the scales and decide this question (along with all others). Please note this argument holds no weight for the irrational and those dominated by passions:

but if a reasonable mind, which has been made by Elohim, do not acquiesce in the Torah of its Creator, and go beyond the bounds of the temperance prescribed to it, how does this reflect on the Creator? Or if there is any reason higher than this, we do not know it; for we cannot know anything perfectly, and especially concerning those things for our ignorance of which we are not to be judged. But those things for which we are to be judged are most easy to be understood, and are dispatched almost in a word. For almost the whole rule of our actions is summed up in this, that what we are unwilling to suffer we should not do to others. For as you would not be killed, you must beware of killing another; and as you would not have your own marriage violated, you must not defile another's bed; you would not be stolen from, neither must you steal; and every matter of men's actions is comprehended within this rule.

The Golden Rule (or the First and Second Commandments) have Ontology and Epistemology behind them – they are not sentimental – one can think of Carlyle's Eternal No²⁹ – man knows (at least) how to begin the journey and *abstain from evil previously chosen*.

²⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Thomas_Carlyle

The old man is unconvinced, because he does not think it within man's power to ultimately choose good over evil as if free from Fate, & Aquila offers to let Clement argue mathematically, since he is better educated in the wisdom of numbers. Simon Peter reminds all of them that they can know nothing of God unless it is revealed, for even with men, we do not know a man's mind until he speaks.

How much more must it be that no one can know the mind or the work of the invisible and incomprehensible Elohim, unless He Himself sends a *navi* to declare His purpose and expound the way of His creation, so far as it is lawful for men to learn it! Hence I think it ridiculous when men judge of the power of Elohim in natural ways, and think that this is possible and that impossible to Him, or this greater and that less, while they are ignorant of everything; who, being unrighteous, judge the righteous YHWH; unskilled, judge the contriver; corrupt, judge the incorruptible; created, judge the Creator...

A Jewish argument, certainly, but one compatible with the tradition of the Emerald Tablet – Man (the microcosm) needs a microcosm of the macrocosm to speak to him. Making it even more explicit, one wonders how “Semiticism” stayed Semitic – this sounds positively Greek – the eternal Logos:

And therefore I advise not only wise men, but indeed all men who have a desire of knowing what is advantageous to them, that they seek after the Navi Emet Yshua; for it is He alone who knoweth all things, and who knoweth what and how every man is seeking. *For He is within the mind of every one of us, but in those who have no desire of the knowledge of Elohim and His zedekah, **He is inoperative**; but He works in those who seek after that which is profitable to their spirits, and kindles in them the light of knowledge.* Wherefore seek Him first of all; and if you do not find Him, do not expect that you shall learn anything from any other. But

He is soon found by those who diligently seek Him through love of the truth, and whose spirits are not taken possession of by wickedness... *For He is present with those who desire Him in the innocence of their spirits, who bear patiently, **and draw sighs from the bottom of their hearts** through love of the truth.*

What else is this but proof that Christianity originated as an esoteric religion (first and foremost) which was then made exoteric, and attempted to draw existing exoteric religions/practices/rites back into the bosom of its own interiority?

Therefore, if any one wishes to learn all things, he must do so little by little, for, being mortal, he shall not be able to comprehend all at once the counsel of Elohim and to scan immensity itself. But if, as we have said, he desires to learn all things, let him seek after the Navi Emet; and when he has found Him, let him not treat with Him by questions and disputations and arguments; but if He has given any response, or pronounced any judgment, it cannot be doubted that this is certain. And therefore, before all things, let the Navi Emet be sought, and His words be laid hold of...

The stony deserts of the wordy are warned against, explicitly, and an argument offered for remembering both Sweetness and Light³⁰:

And for the rest may they be at *shalom*, having received evident knowledge of the truth. For all other things are treated by opinion, in which there can be nothing firm. For what speech is there which may not be contradicted? And what argument is there that may not be overthrown by another argument? And hence it is, that by disputation of this sort men can never come to any end of knowledge and learning, but find the end of their life sooner than the end of their questions...

³⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sweetness_and_light

Hopefully, this gives a better insight into the origins of Christianity... the journal is only two-thirds over... .

Posted on 2012-08-24 by Logres

3.6 More Insight into Christian Initiation

This is a continuation of posts on Clement's Journal, found (in obscurity) in the Ante Nicene Fathers. Peter has been initiating Clement, so we see the "inner workings" of this process, which really amounts to a sort of personal spiritual apprenticeship, which is governed by affectionate command and proud obedience, more than a set rule. They have been debating the doctrine of "Genesis" (Fate) with an old man who is an honest hermit (and will turn out to be Clement's long lost father).

The following may sound like "the Fall", but what is being said (if one can hear) is that the very elements were tainted³¹ by the spiritual worship offered to demons:

But by the freedom of the will, every man, while he is unbelieving in regard to things to come, runs into evils by doing evil deeds. And these are the things in the world which seem to be done contrary to order, which owe their existence to mans rebellion against Torah. Therefore the purpose of YHWH is for man to worship Him, which He granted to men in the beginning. They were walking in the good way of life in order to enjoy incorruptible good things. But when they sinned, they gave birth to evil by sin. And to every good thing evil is joined as by a certain covenant of alliance on the part of sin, since indeed the earth has been polluted with human blood, and altars have been lighted to demons, and they have polluted the very air by the filthy smoke of zebahim; and so at length the elements, being first corrupted, have handed

³¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/One_Power

over to men the fault of their corruption, as roots nourish the branches and the fruit...

Thus, we see, by a divine circle, being brought back to the opening argument of Simon Magus that Christ's words about "divison" and "houses falling" were nonsense, that G-D sent Christ into the world to cleave good and evil asunder – Christ is God's "sword".

Peter offers another good argument as to why unbelief ultimately needs a "First Principle" from Revelation in order to truly begin to deal with Reality:

Hence I think it ridiculous when men judge of the power of Elohim in natural ways, and think that this is possible and that impossible to Him, or this greater and that less, while they are ignorant of everything; who, being unrighteous, judge the righteous YHWH; unskilled, judge the contriver; corrupt, judge the incorruptible; created, judge the Creator...

This makes a deal of sense — we ordinarily let men "speak" for themselves, why not God? Is He worthy of less privilege than a mere man? Reading on, we are told that Jesus' words are "simple, plain, and brief", hence, Platonism for the masses, plus something. Clement tries to summarize:

YHWH by His Son created the world as a double house, separated by the interposition of this firmament, which is called heaven; and appointed malachim to dwell in the higher, and a multitude of men to be born in this visible world, from amongst whom He might choose friends for His Son, with whom He might rejoice, and who might be prepared for Him as a beloved bride for a bridegroom. But even till the time of the marriage, which is the revelation of the world to come, He has appointed a certain power, to choose out and watch over the good ones of those who are born

in this world, and to preserve them for His Son, who is without sin, set apart in a certain place of the world, in which there are already some who are there being prepared, as I said, as a bride adorned for the coming of the bridegroom. For the prince of this world and of the present age is like an adulterer who corrupts and violates the minds of men, and, seducing them from the love of the true bridegroom,allures them to strange lovers...

There is a “certain power” which preserves those in this world who inherit Life — the “leaven of God” we may call it. There is also what might be called “General Law”:

And because He foresaw that the present world could not consist except by variety and inequality, He gave to each mind freedom of motions,according to the diversities of present things, and appointed this prince, through that princes own suggestion of those things which run contrary, that the choice of better things might depend upon the exercise of virtue...

Baptism is explained, again:

For He has given a Torah, thereby aiding the minds of men, that they may the more easily perceive how they ought to act with respect to everything, in what way they may escape evil, and in what way tend to future blessings; and how, being regenerate in water, they may by good works extinguish the fire of their old birth. For our first birth descends through the fire of lust,and therefore, by the divine appointment, this second birth is introduced by water, which may extinguish the nature of fire; and that the spirit enlightened by YHWH is set apart. Spirit may cast away the fear of the first birth, provided, however, it so live for the time to come...

Thus, baptism regenerates, but not infallibly – it is a “sealing”³². The world is a gymnasium, where we learn to exercise the virtues in resisting evil.

For Elohim has given a nature to men by which they may be taught concerning what is good and to resist evil; that is, they may learn arts and to resist vain pleasures, and to set the Torah of Elohim before them in all things. And for this end He has permitted certain contrary powers to wander up and down in the world and to strive against us, for the reasons which have been stated before, that by striving with them the palm of victory and the merit of rewards may accrue to the righteous

Here we see a justification for the liberal arts (profane and sacred). We also see some interesting doctrines on conception and “love”:

From this, therefore, sometimes the result of any persons acting incontinently and being willing not so much to resist as to yield to give harbor to these impulses in themselves by their noxious breath an intemperate, ill-conditioned, and diseased progeny is begotten. For while lust is supposedly gratified but no care is taken in the copulation, undoubtedly a weak generation is affected with the defects and frailties of those demons who instigate these evil deeds. And therefore parents are responsible for their children's defects of this sort, because they have not observed the Torah of association. Though there are also more secret causes, by which spirits are made subject to these evils, which it is not to our present purpose to state, yet it behooves every one to acknowledge the Way of YHWH, that he may learn from it the observance of generation and avoid causes of impurity, that that which is begotten may be pure.

³²[http://www.latrobe.edu.au/eyeoftheheart/assets/issue4/baptism.p
df](http://www.latrobe.edu.au/eyeoftheheart/assets/issue4/baptism.pdf)

Even fear is justified:

But if those who believe in Elohim, and who confess the judgment to come and the penalty of ageless fire, if they do not refrain from sin, it is certain that they do not believe with full faith: for if faith is certain, fear also becomes certain. But if there be any defect in faith, fear also is weakened, and then the contrary powers find opportunity of entering.

Apparently, unrestrained “love” leads to the river Pyriphlegethon. Also, the origin of occultism is explained:

Therefore the astrologers, being ignorant of such mysteries, think that these things come by the courses of the heavenly bodies. Hence also, in their answers to those who go to them to consult them as to future things, they are deceived in very many instances. Nor is it to be wondered at, for they are not *naviim*; but, by long practice, the authors of errors find a sort of refuge in those things by which they were deceived, and introduce certain Climacteric Periods, that they may pretend a knowledge of uncertain things. For they represent these Climacterics as times of danger, in which one sometimes is destroyed, sometimes is not destroyed, not knowing that it is not the course of the stars but the operation of demons that regulates these things.

Revolutionaries may want to consider the following:

This, however, is in general to be noticed, that if any are evil, not so much in their mind as in their doings, and are not borne to sin under the incitement of purpose, upon them punishment is inflicted more speedily, and more in the present life; for everywhere and always Elohim renders to every one according to his deeds as He judges to be expedient. But those who purposely practice wickedness, so that they sometimes even rage against those from

whom they have received benefits, and who take no thought for teshuvah their punishment He defers to the future. For these men do not, like those of whom we spoke before, deserve to end the punishment of their crimes in the present life.

Clement argues nurture against nature:

There are likewise amongst the Bactrians in the Indian countries immense multitudes of Brahmans, who also themselves from the tradition of their ancestors and peaceful customs and laws, neither commit murder nor adultery, nor worship idols, nor have the practice of eating animal food, are never drunk, never do anything maliciously, but always fear Elohim.

So we see a recognition (there) of natural virtue and common religion (provided it is free of demonism). However, the endless “search for Truth” at the expense of all sense is condemned:

If we do not hold by the principles that we have acknowledged and confessed, but if those things which have been defined are always loosened by forgetfulness, we shall seem to be weaving Penelope's web, undoing what we have done. And therefore we ought either not to acquiesce too easily, before we have diligently examined the doctrine propounded; or if we have once acquiesced, and the proposition has been agreed to, then we ought to keep by what has been once determined, that we may go on with our inquiries respecting other matters

I would like to point out that these posts demonstrate the profound comprehensiveness, as well as “exoteric esotericism” of early Christian religion – it's ability to hold its own philosophically with deep insights into the Kali Yuga (eg., the tainting of elements, demonism), the practical wisdom of Peter (a desire to instruct and lay stable foundations), the

sacraments (baptism), and also the open-mindedness and true “Catholicism” of that Faith (eg., praise for Bactrian Brahmas). Additionally, these posts should make clear that more than a “precise way”, we should struggle to uproot modern foundations and lay a firm one of “sane, well-bred, masculinity”, which can then support the superstructure of a particular “initiation”. Thus, the thread runs from the Mediterranean, through Old Europe, to us.

Posted on 2012-08-31 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2012-09-01 at 17:51 said:

Worth reposting (Cologero has cited): For that thing itself, which is now called the Christian religion, used to exist and was not lacking amongst the ancients from the beginning of the human race until Christ himself came in the flesh, from which time the true religion began to be called “Christian.” And after his resurrection and ascension into heaven, the Apostles had begun to proclaim him, and many believed; first in Antioch (as it is written) the disciples were called “Christians.” Therefore I have said: ‘This is the Christian religion in our time,’ not because it did not exist previously, but because it received this name in later times.

<http://www.latrobe.edu.au/eyeoftheheart/assets/issue1/Golgotha.pdf>

A commentary on The Theology of Arithmetic by Iamblicus

4.1 Fortune's Fool by Numbers

But I think about the hebdomads for myself, and I keep these speculations in my memory rather than sharing them with any of those people whose impertinence and insolence permits nothing to be analyzed without joking and laughter. Accordingly, don't be opposed to obscurities stemming from brevity; since they are the faithful guardian of the secret they have this advantage: they speak only to those who are worthy. Therefore, as is the customary practice in mathematics and also in other disciplines, I have first put forward terms and rules, in accordance with which I shall work out all that follows.

Boethius likely had a connection to esoteric doctrine via the Pythagoreans (his mundane connection to neo-Pythagoreanism is considered by scholars to be settled). He was a "classically educated" man, but as Miranda Lundy points out the four sciences of Number, Music, Cosmol-

ogy & Geometry were actually formerly *sacred* sciences, and most definitively not a preparatory or prerequisite curriculum for anything else except sacral or transformative theology or philosophy. Sarah Lassin argues that Boethius' reference to the Egyptian "hebdomads"¹ (which plays an important role within the Neopythagorean literature of Hierocles and Nicomachus of Gerasa²) is highly significant for the discussion of God & creation. In fact, it is not necessary even to mention the Egyptian origins of these terms, since Proclus discusses them³ extensively on Plato, and Plato (and also Herodotus) thought that the Greeks derived much of their mysteries from Egypt. The Egyptian context⁴ makes the connections between philosophy and religion even more apparent:

Hermes tells Tat (XIII), that "the tent" or "tabernacle" of the Earthly body was formed by the circle of the Zodiac (XIII.12 & Ascl.35) and dominated by fate, who's decrees, according to the astrologers, were unbreakable. The seven planets represented the "perfect movements" of the Deities, the unalterable "will of the Gods" as expressed in predictable astral phenomena. Magicians tried to compel this will, while Hermetism did not try to resist fate, but irreversibly. The existence of the Deities was acknowledged (they belonged to the order of creation and were the object of sacrifices and processions and the celestial Powers ruling the

¹http://individual.utoronto.ca/pking/translations/BOETHIUS.0n_the_Hebdomads.pdf

²http://books.google.com/books?id=dCELAAAAIAAJ&pg=PA94&lpg=PA94&dq=nicomachus+hebdomads&source=bl&ots=TnzWHveyQF&sig=ENK2-4LKLAMFDcxMhWkQdBwkqf0&hl=en&ei=wwP0Td6wN8PngQevmLihDA&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=3&ved=0CCoQ6AEwAg#v=onepage&q&f=false

³http://books.google.com/books?id=z-M-AAAAIAAJ&pg=PA316&lpg=PA316&dq=hebdomads+triads&source=bl&ots=7LW956x_Vy&sig=77Nd93YLZNUyh5LvWP3foh-9FME&hl=en&ei=TKXMTZfrFYK4tgfn_u2WBQ&sa=X&oi=book_result&ct=result&resnum=1&ved=0CBYQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=hebdomads%20triads&f=false

⁴http://www.sofiatopia.org/maat/ten_keys.htm

astrological septet). Indeed, the Deities, Hermes and God were situated in the eighth, ninth and tenth sphere (Ogdoad, Ennead and Decad). The “eighth” involved purification, Self-knowledge and the direct “gnostic” experience of the “Nous” as “logos”, whereas in the “ninth” man was deified by assuming God’s attributes, as did the Godman Hermes, in particular His Universal Mind, the Divine Nous, Intellect or “soul of God” (XII.9). The “tenth” or Decad was God Himself for Himself.

And the Egyptians mysteries are linked to Hermes Trismegestus, which context resurfaces during the Renaissance when Greek translators made the Emerald Tablet available in Italy. This Egyptian link might also explain the persistence at Alexandria of a Christian esoteric tradition- Alexandria is also the home of the tragic conflict concerning Hypatia and the library, a conflict that did not occur until the Greek influence had waned in the Church.

Given that Boethius was the schoolmaster of medieval and early modern Europe, one might almost say that these doctrines “sub-created” Europe. Thomas Aquinas discusses⁵ Boethius and the hebdomads in a treatise, & it is instructive to compare the two discussions⁶; by Aquinas’ time, the debate is far more abstract and limited to logical distinctions, as opposed to being “transformative”.

As perennialist studies on Boethius⁷ make clear, his theories of music and number (as found in minor tractates) gives a better background for the dialectic that occurs within the *Consolation of Philosophy*. Boethius was not simply a well-informed “liberal” who opposed barbarian elements at Court — he was a lover of wisdom who was in an intimate

⁵http://individual.utoronto.ca/pking/translations/AQUINAS.Exposition_of_Hebdomads.pdf

⁶http://individual.utoronto.ca/pking/translations/BOETHIUS.On_the_Hebdomads.pdf

⁷http://www.studiesincomparativereligion.com/Public/articles/Boethius_Three_Musicians-by_Joscelyn_Godwin.aspx

and self-converting dialogue with Sophia herself, one who was willing to pay the final price for that which he had found and was finding⁸.

During the Dark Ages in Europe, acquaintance with the works of Plato was at second or even third hand, through the writings of authors such as Macrobius, Martianus Capella, Augustine, Boethius, Calcidius' translation of the *Timaeus*, and John Scotus Erigena. The most important contribution in the vernacular was provided by the late ninth century reworking of Boethius' *De consolazione Philosophiae*.

The Emboldenment of Philosophy became one of the most popular books throughout the Middle Ages. It was translated into Old English by Alfred the Great, into Middle English by Chaucer, and into Elizabethan English by Queen Elizabeth.

As we see from Proclus' statement, the Neo-Platonists emphasized dialectical interchange in their transmutational teaching procedures within the Perennial Tradition—one of the important components of the Wisdom Teachings. However, the first Perennialist teacher who initiated and developed all facets of the Wisdom Teachings was Anicius Manlius Severinus Boethius (480-524 C.E.), including in his teachings and life experience each theme and emphasis we've outlined above.

While in prison awaiting a ghastly death, Boethius had experienced a definite inner dialectical interchange between his soul and Lady Philosophy (the spirit of the love of Wisdom). The narrative account in his *Emboldenment of Philosophy*⁹ discloses how Boethius achieved transformation and self-understanding while communing with Lady Sophia in an inner spiritual domain. Boethius' book combined verse and alternating dialogue between himself and Lady Philosophy, organizing his narrative into different stages of his spiritual healing and transmutation. Lady

⁸http://www.hermes-press.com/philosophy_emboldening0.htm

⁹http://www.hermes-press.com/philosophy_emboldening0.htm

Philosophy communes with Boethius in his inner being, bringing into the dialectical interchange others who were true devotees of philosophy: those who love and seek Wisdom.

The wisdom school of the Pythagoreans was influential enough that Augustine made an appeal to those who “knew” to the effect that the Hebdomads symbolized the perfection which was to become the Church, which was to rely in almost exclusive fashion¹⁰ upon the mystery religions, perhaps even more than on Judaism, for the new doctrines. Christianity began as a conversion of existing elements, rather than a superimposition. Augustine’s appeal is a sincere one.

Given that Boethius’ interests in music and number coincide with Platonist streams of thought in Proclus and Plotinus in the Pythagorean mysteries, it is necessary to think that the esoteric link which created the Middle Ages through Boethius could be located in the harmonics and sacred geometry¹¹ of the celestial “music of the spheres”. In order to understand the Middle Ages, we should “close thy scholastics, and open thy Timaeus”. Boethius’ background and writings, embodied in the *Consolation*, are an excellent place to re-start.

Posted on 2011-05-14 by Logres

* * *

logres on 2011-05-14 at 22:39 said:

This is a good example of impasse between “orthodox” and “gnostics”:

<http://www.interfaith.org/forum/livergoods-esoterism-10888.html>

Trajan’s orders seem reasonable from a political standpoint – the Christian response was muted and in accord with Romans 13. However, it is clear that persecutions of the faith quickly became excessive. This probably gutted much of the leadership. If the Corpus Hermeticum dates from the 3rd century, then it is the obverse of the same coin which Clement was minting.

¹⁰<http://orthodoxnotes.com/wp-content/uploads/downloads/2010/06/Liturgical-Practice-in-the-Fathers.pdf>

¹¹<http://www.sacred-texts.com/eso/sta/sta19.htm>

The chance was missed. And is still being missed. That is why Boethius is so important. In spiritual war, as in physical, it is often the best that are lost. To tie into Cologero's posts, there is still an opportunity perhaps even today to refashion Romanity as a vehicle, in the Catholic Church. If the chance is missed again, we will simply behold a repetition of the pattern, until what is meant to happen, what is already one, is manifest. From the debate linked above, it's clear that Mouravieff's Gnosis is an important tract.

Spock on 2011-05-15 at 09:40 said:

logres, you say there is still a chance to fix the church, well yes, we can say this forever, but the truth is that leading perennialists have had continuing dialogues with the recent popes and it changes absolutely nothing because the church is and will only be a political vehicle which panders to its supporters... none of whom are even remotely interested in gnosis and tradition. What they love are superficial rituals and the joy of submission to authority, because they do not love wisdom, they would rather be told and given things like children rather than do the task themselves. That in itself is contrary to the active gnostic life. If one really wanted to change the church he must first change the people, but that is the impossible task in this the last phase of the kali yuga.

James O'Meara on 2011-05-15 at 10:10 said:

Freke and Gandy quote modern scholarship to show that the persecutions were quite minor, both in time 5 years, total and numbers 10 killed in Alexandria! ; Origen is quoted to the effect that the number of 'martyrs' was 'easily counted'.

<http://tinyurl.com/5v7w5nv>

The "great persecutions" could hardly have 'gutted much of the leadership' although the orthodox literalists did a pretty good job decimating the Gnostics and other 'heretics'.

As always, the primitive Christians seem to specialize in self-serving propaganda and literary fakery the letters of Jesus to Pilate, anyone? . Speaking of which, interestingly, the Gnostics rejected the "pastoral epistles" as spurious, just as modern critics do, while Irenaeus insisted on them, showing his unerring eye for self-serving fakery, and proving that Guenon was wrong to dismiss Biblical criticism as a modernist evil. Even today, listening to radio preachers, it's amazing how much of their bible-thumping comes from Timothy, Titus and Peter, plus a whole heaping helping of Apocalypse. "Modernist criticism" would disarm a lot of the Protestantism Guenon opposed.

logres on 2011-05-16 at 08:58 said:

It wouldn't surprise me to find out the persecutions were exaggerated – however, I can't find footnote 138 (and those next to it), to see which scholars they are citing. The argument doesn't really depend upon who killed whom, but rather upon "elective affinities". Certainly,

it is possible that the Church became exactly what She portrayed Rome as being. Tomberg, Mouravieff, etc. aren't trying to esoterically "capture" the exoteric Church as it has developed (which is splitting up all on its own into fragments) but to reunite those elements which should be (and are) One. So I don't think it matters what the overly visible Church does. At least not for purposes of working in the areas of Form.

However, it certainly matters to set the record straight, if what one means by that is to revisit assumptions which one thinks one knows, and for the purposes of refuting aggressive error. Thanks for drawing attention to this issue.

logres on 2011-05-16 at 09:04 said:

The Church (in other words) is not only the people, and perhaps in a sense not the people at all. A difficult task, I know.

logres on 2011-05-18 at 22:03 said:

B16 speech on Proclus & Pseudo-Dionysius:

<http://www.zenit.org/article-22588?l=english>

Dimitri on 2022-06-30 at 19:18 said:

Though it has been over a decade since his comment was posted, I would still like to correct Mr. O'Meara's many errors (which stem in large part from his relying on the absurdities of the so-called "Christ myth theorists" as a source). In his first point, he claimed the persecutions of early Christians were exaggerated. This is somewhat true to an extent, though they were nowhere near "minor" like he claimed. He gives the impression that there were perhaps a few dozen people killed and that the overall period of persecution was very short, but if only he had done his research he would have seen just how wrong he is. How he arrived at the idea that persecution only lasted for "5 years total" is beyond me, since even if we were to only include imperially ordered persecution, we would still arrive at a total of 13 years of persecution under Decius, Valerian, Diocletian and Galerius. And this is only if we exclude the many local persecutions where Christians were attacked by regular people without any official orders, or were persecuted under various governors whose authority was limited to specific regions of the empire. For the first century or so after the beginning of Christianity, Christians were fairly unpopular with the people and had to avoid the public sphere. But beyond this, O'Meara also greatly downplays the death toll even from the imperial persecutions. The Diocletianic Persecution alone claimed well over 3000 lives, even according to "modern scholarship" (and keep in mind that the number of Christians around then was smaller than it is today). There were many thousands of Christians martyred for their religion throughout the years, his deceptive use of Origen's statements notwithstanding.

As for whether "modernist criticism" would disarm a lot of the Protestantism Guenon

opposed”, perhaps this is true, but it certainly doesn’t replace it with anything worthwhile or meaningful. In fact, it seems to have made the situation worse, since we’re now at a place where regular people (at least in the West, and this is especially true of Americans) see Christianity only through the lense of fundamentalism and mistakenly think that to be Christian they **MUST** believe in a strictly literal interpretation of all Scripture (among other errors) and have therefore forgotten the essence of the religion entirely. Perhaps the reason Guenon opposed it was because these “critics” and “scholars” do not really understand the contents or the implications of what they are supposed to be studying? For example, Cologero recently made a post about a scholar discussing how the Gospels were authored by a Christian elite (which would of course go against the “traditional attribution” to “early eye-witnesses”), and yet from my experience this information would sooner be used in a polemical attack (as O’Meara himself tried to do here) by those who in their ignorance possess a vigorous contempt for what they think is Christianity than it would be to actually learn anything useful.

Dimitri on 2022-06-30 at 21:02 said:

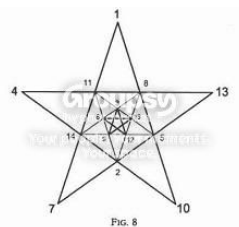
Actually, I realize now I forgot to mention the fact that “modernist criticism” itself only exists because of Protestantism and its nontraditional elements, such as its tendency for secularization and adherence to various profane “philosophies”, and so it could hardly be an antidote to it. So not only does it not replace it with anything meaningful as I said before, but ironically it’s similar to an Ouroboros, in that it’s like a snake consuming itself.

4.2 The Meaning of Numbers

For handy reference, here is a simplistic table¹² that is good to start with.

This is **Iamblichus** on the Hebdomad (7):

The reason for the seventh number being an object of reverence is as follows: the providence of the Creator God wrought all things by basing on the first-born One the source and root of the creation of the universe, which comes to be an impression



¹²http://www.psychic.com/psychic/qbl/comparative_numerology.html

and representation of the highest good, and he located the perfection and fulfillment of completion in the Decad itself, and the Creator God necessarily considered that the Hebdomad was an instrument and His most authoritative limb and has gained the power of creativity. For by nature, and not by our own devices, the Hebdomad is a mean between the monad and the decad, and the means between extremes are in a sense more authoritative than the extremes themselves, because the terms on either side incline towards the means... 7 is the arithmetic mean between the tetrad and the decad (ie, in a sense between two decads, one potential, the other actual, since is half of the sum of both).

This excerpt should give a feel for what the Greek Platonists were doing — they believed that the symmetry and harmony of number was directly revelatory, through Reason (intellectual intuition, which we would term the *noetic faculty*), of the Logos.

In this case, Iamblichus' short essays are worth reading — pick one of them & read the entire argument, mathematics & all, to get the feel for how they thought. Next week, I will present a summary of each of the numbers, although the above list will give you an idea of what it will look like.

For instance, the number Five represents Life: specifically vegetative Life (Six represents animal Life, and Seven, the living Soul of man). It also incarnates and mediates Justice — the proper balance. One immediately thinks of the “star” of Justice, the shire-reeve's badge, five-pointed pentagram.

Here is an extract from **Boris Mouravieff** in *Gnosis*, Book III, pg 98,99

As we have already indicated, the first of the three symbols that can be obtained from the Circle and the polygons is the Pentagram, or five-branched triple star. The study of this symbol-in-movement requires precise indication of the order in which the student's

attention and his pen-point should pass from one to the other of the branch-points of the three stars through the intersections of the lines that form them. This is how our numbered Pentagram is drawn (fig. 8): The Pentagram numbered in this way was revealed by the author during the lectures he gave at the Faculty of Letters in the University of Geneva. It was also published in the Summary of these lectures. We have already said that this symbol, taken as a whole, reflects the real positions of the elements and forces that form the Third Cosmic Octave. The student should apply the meanings of the Major Numbers to the corresponding figures and study them from this point of view. Here, he will come across the first difficulty: that of interpreting the terms characterizing each of the Major Numbers. In order to interpret them, he must specially train himself to think ‘in harmony’ and not ‘in melody’, if we may put it this way. In other words, instead of a chain of reasoning he should form a bundle of ideas, of which each section should present a harmonious chord. Then, and only then – keeping the meaning of the whole continually present in his mind – the succession of the figures as it is shown will enable him to make his thought and attention progress according to a precise order and so reach the desired goal. Except in a few rare cases, as long as the student’s mind has not attained the degree of training needed to enable him to pursue his research in an independent manner, this will require outside help. This is one reason why esoteric teaching has always included an oral Tradition that vivifies the Letter of the written Doctrine.

The Numbers, properly contemplated, or truly contemplated at all, will lead us to God.

Posted on 2012-12-15 by Logres

4.3 Numbers According to Iamblichus

Plato said that no one could be a philosopher who had not studied mathematics.

Undoubtedly, this is partially a reference to the Pythagoreans. Having been a mathematical dunce until college (although not innumerate entirely), this is part of my penance, to work through Iamblichus' treatise.

Luckily, this work supplies a beginner's manual to understanding the significance of number, which plays a role in traditional astrology. Still, there is a lot to wade through here. For instance, John Michael Greer (the so-called Archdruid of North America) has *pointed out that the Christian cross*¹³ *has the proportions of the square root of 2*¹⁴ *and the square root of 5*¹⁵. The¹⁶ cross is an ancient symbol¹⁷, one which Plato was familiar with when he wrote "*the world soul is crucified*". However, it is not necessary (obviously) to be a Christian to discern the Logos inherent in the numbers. In our day, it may help if one is not exoterically Christian to see the significance of the numbers in constituting a pattern of the Logos.

Iamblichus touches on a great deal of this, in how the numbers intertwine, which require a beginner level in numeracy, but patience in working through the various relationships, and a meditative or mystical approach to thinking about them.

1. Any number can be created by adding Ones (even as fractions) or dividing by Ones, or multiplying by Ones. The One is therefore the Source and Sustainer of all things. If $x = 2y$, then x squared is

¹³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sator_Square

¹⁴<http://www.geomancy.org/sacred-geometry/square-root-3/index.php#sacred-geometry/square-root-2/index.php>

¹⁵www.geomancy.org/sacred-geometry/square-root-3/index.php#sacred-geometry/square-root-2/index.php

¹⁶<http://www.keyofsolomon.org/True%20cross.php>

¹⁷<http://www.ccg.org/english/s/p039.html>

four times y squared, which proportion in operation is preserved if one take $1/x$ and $1/y$. There is no change in the nature or operations of the One. It is called the Provider because it has the power of staying the same, regardless of its extensions, and preserving both itself and those extensions. The ancients called it Prometheus or the Artificer of Life.

2. It is called the Hearth, because it is in the middle of things, that which is equal between opposing elements, and it keeps its equilibrium. In the middle of the four elements lies a Monadic fiery cube. It is called Proteus, because it assumes any form, but retains the properties of everything, as the Monad is the factor of each number.
3. It is called Chaos (mixture, obscurity, blending, Darkness), being Hesiod's First Generator, but also called Chariot, Sun, Friend, Life, Happiness, Being, Order, and Concord. The numerical value of the Greek word Monad adds up to 361, the degrees of the circle, plus One. It is disposed to share itself with all things. It is not yet manifesting anything actual, but carries within it the principles conceptual togetherness of all things. It causes things to combine and co-here, and unifies that which is opposite. It is called Androgynous and Intellect, as well, and shares power with the Sun. It is the beginning, middle, and end of all size, quality and quantity.
4. It produces itself out of itself, as well as producing all things, and is therefore "as if it were God or the principle of all things". It maintains everything and forbids anything to change — it resembles Providence, alone of all numbers. It is particularly suited to resemble and reflect God, and it is closest to Him.
5. It is in fact the Form of Forms. As we will see, the Dyad is opposed to Form in a certain sense, and only from the One can the power

come to maintain the Dyad. Because of this intellectual and creative power, it is both Creator and Supreme Intellect.

What else is Iamblichus describing here, but a doctrine of the Logos? This Logos would be taken up and shaped by Christianity, and I would argue that the intention was to preserve “every jot and tittle” of the full-blooded pagan dogma of the Logos, rather than to change it in any respect, except to allow it to be “more itself”.

And it is clear that he thinks that multiplication by One preserves the same number is a truth with an esoteric meaning. Or, division. Mathematics are not, therefore, just mathematics, even the simple operations we don’t even think about. Yet Iamblichus will get into more complicated arrangements as he progresses.

Posted on 2012-12-28 by Logres

4.4 The Dyad

As we enter into the mystery of the One-and-the-Many, things begin to get more complicated. Even from Wikipedia¹⁸, it is obvious (apart from the caveat that Iamblichus did not “introduce” any “notions” at all) that Iamblichus is essentially creating a parallel system that in many ways is similar to Christianity. This is why Julian the Apostate admired him so much, and why Porphyry disagreed with him so vehemently (Porphyry thought that purely notional contemplation ought to suffice for attaining divinization). From his doctrine of the One-and-the-Many, to his insistence that the lower types of men need physical theurgy, to his peopling the cosmos with various divinities and powers that are subject to Number, Iamblichus’ world highly resembles that of the Church Fathers.

He introduces his doctrine of Dyad:

¹⁸<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iamblichus>

So each thing and the universe as a whole is one as regards the natural and constitutive monad, but again each is divisible, in so far as it necessarily partakes of the material dyad as well. Hence the first conjunction of monad and dyad results in the first finite plurality, the element of things, which would be a triangle of quantities and numbers, both corporeal and incorporeal. For just as the sap of a fig tree congeals liquid milk because of its active and productive property, so when the unificatory power of the monad approaches the dyad, which is the fount of flowing and liquidity it instills limit and gives form (ie., number) to the triad. For the triad is the source in actuality of number, which is by definition a system of monads. But in a sense, a dyad is like a monad on account of being like a source.

The Dyad (therefore) is the Feminine Principle; in relation to the Monad, She is passive, as matter is to God. However, in relation to what comes after, by her productive powers, she is the Fount or Center of things, like a Monad, because in her Life originates (and multiplicity is created). This gives a good idea of the sophistication of Iamblichus' thought: "opposition" to the Monad (for him) doesn't mean resistance or lack of submission, but (precisely) submission through being opposite, or complementary – in other contexts (the material realms) it is the Dyad that takes on the characteristics of the Monad: the Queen stands in the place of the King (one can't help but think of this doctrine¹⁹, at this point).

I am not arguing that he is a pseudo-Christian, but rather that both Iamblichus and the Church Fathers were partaking of the same divine pattern, even (and up to) the particular manifestations of it at that time and place in history: see this article (for instance) as to how theosis and henosis²⁰ differ, and how they do not. It might not be going too far to

¹⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Queen_of_Heaven

²⁰<http://web.archive.org/web/20080724183137/http://www.theandros.com>

say that Iamblichus' teachings represent a possible locus for reconciling paganism with Christianity (by purifying paganism and refining Christianity), thus creating the possibility of "*white*" *theurgy*.

These possibilities arise from the subtlety of Iamblichus' method & manner of dealing with the One-And-The-Many, as he unfolds a doctrine of the Dyad ($II - 2$). Rather than posit a merely crude opposition, he shows how the Dyad is both Isis & Ison, Equal and Unequal, Generator and Destroyer.

2, mathematically, is composed of 1s, and is therefore (from arithmetic linear) a Greater or Non-Equal. When viewed as a plane (2 squared), it becomes a Lesser, since 2 itself is less than 4. The undoubted metaphysical conclusion is that the Dyad contains elements of being both Greater and Lesser within it. This is an example of the kind of paradox that Iamblichus is seeking. The number 3 (as we will see) is the first truly diverse equal (1 is equal to itself, but is not diverse): $1+2 = 3$, so that the preceding sequence of numbers added together is equal to the number itself. This is not true when we come to 4: $1+2+3$ does not equal 4 (Iamblichus will draw conclusions from this, as well).

The Dyad has special properties (also) because $2+2 = 4$, which is the same as 2 taken to the plane (2 squared). This is the only number like this. The Dyad is another Monad (being a 1 added to a 1), but the Monad does not generate this truth of equality between arithmetic and plane extension.

Yet in another sense the Dyad cannot create a plane figure, because two angles don't construct a plane figure: so the Triad is anticipated – it alone can create planar figures. The Dyad, on the other hand, can construct infinity, in a sense, because it can create a line running from a point, indefinitely, in two dimensions. This line may, or may not, return to its Origin.

The Dyad, therefore, is not to be mistaken for the original Monad,

despite its functioning in relation to other numbers as a Monad itself. This is because the Monad stands alone – if, therefore, the Monad stands alone as Unity, something else has to take its place as the new principle of Unity to give unity to the other numbers. The Dyad, therefore, becomes “Monadic” towards the other numbers.

Numbers, therefore, inculcate the appreciation of metaphysical truths, such as the interplay between Microcosm and Macrocosm: the Moon or the Queen can become or stand in place of the Original Unity, precisely because of the primal unity of the One. Opposition can not exist, except to reinforce the One.

Posted on 2013-01-04 by Logres

* * *

Logres on 2013-01-05 at 06:17 said:

Cologero points out to me that it is not really a matter of “reconciling” the Church Fathers with Iamblichus, & I agree – more a matter of seeking and finding the deeper unity which should be apparent, but tends not to be, due to modern habitus of thought.

Mihai on 2013-01-05 at 12:38 said:

Thank you for this, Logres

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-05 at 14:21 said:

More people need to read Tomberg if they can't understand what Gornahoor is doing IMO...

... ..

Forgive my ignorance, but is the Dyad the same as the Demiurge in Plato ?

Logres on 2013-01-05 at 22:52 said:

I don't have a good answer re: the Demiurge. Iamblichus is keen to insist that there are not “two Monads” – however, the Dyad is Monadic by virtue of being different than the diverse numbers which follow. The Dyad itself is “two monads” (1+1). In Gnostic mythology, the Demiurge tends to be so powerful that the Monad is effectively relegated to mythology or the afterlife, so it overshadows the whole point, and refutes itself.

4.5 Logos Tomeus

In Robin Waterfield’s translation of Iamblichus²¹, the Theology of Arithmetic²², we are treated to an entire section on the spiritual dimensions of the number 2. Two is a feminine number, the Dyad, a departure from the stability and comprehensiveness and self-sufficiency of the One. As such, it represents Diversity and the possibility of something “Other” than the One, at least in a phase of Form. The Dyad (or we might note the similarity of name, the Dryad²³) is the lunar number that embodies the infinite and endless beauty of matter, infinite and endless because it departs from the self-possessed nature of the One.



Modern thought condemns this account as sexist & oppressive – for them it is part of the ancient baggage we must violently overcome, with Revolution (if need be) against those whose thoughts trend towards the past. Actually, the violence that is directed against “patriarchy” is not a feminine, but masculine characteristic.

Which brings us to an ironic point – the modern world proclaims itself as (partly) the resurgence of the Feminine²⁴, the existence of a valid reality despite the backdrop of Chaos, the *melange des sens* & the search for new frissons, eternally. This is not only to place the Dyad in the position of the Monad, but to misunderstand (deliberately so) that gender symbolism & sex are not the same thing.

²¹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iamblichus>

²²<http://www.scribd.com/doc/48888397/Iamblichus-the-Theology-of-Arithmetic>

²³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dryad>

²⁴<http://www.bu.edu/arion/files/2010/03/Paglia-Great-Mother1.pdf>

They (Pythagoreans) call it “Nature” since it is movement towards being and, as it were, a sort of coming-to-be, and extension from a seed principle, and this is why it is so called, because movement from one thing to another is in the likeness of the Dyad... it is also called deficiency and excess and matter (for which, in fact, another term is the indefinite dyad) because it is in itself devoid of shape and form and any limitation, but is capable of being limited and made definite by reason and skill.

So the Dyad (in other words) possesses Being in that (without it) there is no manifestation or materiality at all, nor any legitimate creation of “novelty” (in the sense that Henri Bergson and Tomberg use this word), yet it is also incomplete, because it needs to reconnect with the primordial Unity, and has to do this through an “Other”. It being “Other”, it requires an “Other”.

One can see that “Otherness” & “Diversity” and such language are (in large part) taken from the nature of Dyad. We are living through a dominantly feminine era, at least in surface ideology. We are told (constantly) that salvation will spring from the fecundity of mingling all things indiscriminately.

Looked at from a Traditional point of view, one might note that the Dyad has here “forgotten” the Monad, and proceeds to work *as if it itself* was the Origin. But this is to actually (from a Traditional view) express a hatred for what is truly feminine. After all, in discussing these symbols, they seem to have forgotten that both men and women have characteristics of each sex mingled within them – gender is being used to elucidate difficult metaphysical truth, rather than as a power play against Women. If anything, the desire to turn the beauty of manifesting Nature into something it is not, and can never be, is violence against Women. What woman in her right mind would ever wish to remake the world in her own image? For that matter (but for different reasons) what man would either?

It's also worth noting that the beauty and order and Logos (Logos Tomeus)²⁵ which was embodied in the traditional medieval Catholic monarchies (and was so reviled or dismissed in the modern era) were actually feminine manifestations of deep materiality, a world order responsive to the celestial hierarchies. So that when the Revolution came, it actually proceeded *in the manner of a rape* against the Feminine-social bodies that constituted the Catholic societies.

Perhaps these dichotomies are best refuted by quoting a passage on the One-and-the Many from the end of the section on the Dyad:

Some people, however, misled by numbers which are already countable and secondary, instruct us to regard the dyad as a system of two monads, with the result that if it is dissolved, it reverts to these same two monads. But if the dyad is a system of monads, then the monads are generated earlier; and if the monad is half the dyad, then the existence of the dyad is necessarily prior. If their mutual relations are to be preserved, then, they necessarily co-exist, because double is double what is half, and half is half what is double, and their are neither prior nor posterior, because they generate and are generated by each other, destroy and are destroyed by each other.

In the classical mind, there was no political or metaphysical conflict in assigning gender values to metaphysical numbers, because the desire was to reach an over-arching vision or Dance (of the the Ten Numbers) which would reconcile all truth, beauty, and goodness in the Order that the Christians would know and inherit as the *Logos Tomeus*.

Posted on 2012-12-07 by Logres

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²⁵<http://www.abu.nb.ca/courses/newtestament/hebrews/4-12-13.htm>

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-07 at 22:42 said:

Logres, yourposts are always so edifying and beautiful in their exposition of order.

Quite a relief from the chaos of the world... ..

David on 2012-12-08 at 01:15 said:

Very interesting entry. Even if he is tainted by rationalism and most of his writings are useless from a Traditionalist point of view, Barth says something along the same line when you speak of the Feminine monarchy : the Church being associated with the «flesh» (feminine receptive) and divine order (logos) / revelation (the Bible) being the «spirit» (masculine giving).

Mihai on 2012-12-08 at 01:57 said:

I haven't yet had the chance to study lamblichos, but I will want to do this in the near future.

The neo-platonic perspective on numbers is reflective of the pythagorean doctrines (arrived to them through Plato) and of great importance for cosmological understanding.

It will be great if you could do a short overview of his exposition on the ten numbers and the principles they symbolize.

Logres on 2012-12-08 at 06:26 said:

Thank you, Jason.

Good point about Barth – all of the great thinkers echo (even in small ways) the truths of Tradition. It points us beyond their shortcomings.

I probably will do this with the rest of lamblichus, Mihai, as it is relatively short and relatively chock full of meditation. I appreciate the feedback. I hear S. Caldecott has a book called "All Things Made New" on Numerology and Revelation (the Book) that is supposed to be superb.

4.6 The Triad

When one refers to the Triad, one must remember that:

The Triad has a special beauty and fairness beyond all numbers, because it is the very first to make actual the potentialities of the Monad – oddness, perfection, proportionality, unification, limit.

We recall that the Dyad is a second Monad, which begins the process of the primordial's manifestation, which process reaches a form of completeness with the Triad; this is because the Triad is the first number to be "odd" ("Odd" here meaning that when divided, one part is greater than the other, or differs from the other). It is the first number to be equal to its predecessors, because $1+2=3$. Recall with the Dyad that all we can say is that it does not succeed the Monad in the same way that the Triad succeeds both Monad and Dyad, because $0+1=1$, not 2; the Dyad is an "as-if" Monad, not a true successor. With the Triad, a true harmony is reached.

In the Christian tradition, the Son does not claim equality with the Father, nor does He retain dominion and lordship at the end of time: rather, He delivers all back up to the Father, or Arche, through power of the Spirit. It is with the Spirit that true balance within the Trinity is reached: The Father generates the Son, and the perfect submission and harmony from the Son to the Father, the perfect Love for the Son from the Father, is so intense it generates a Third Person, and this forms the perichoresis of both inner essence and outer energies of the Divine "Three-in-One". The Son is associated with the Dyad, as is Queen Mary, the Queen of Heaven: Water, the most submissive element (as the Tao teaches) symbolizes the Feminine & the baptism of the Son.

The Triad is unique in that $1+1+1=3$, where the middle term is the same as the two extremes. Also, in $1+2+3$, the middle term is equidistant from the two extremes. So it succeeds (perfectly) two sources, and is the system of the two sources. 3 exists between 2 and 4 in a special way, additionally: 2 is the first double, and sums up the idea of being "greater than" the One ($0+1=1$, less than 2), while 4 is sesquialter, that is, it is less than $1+2+3 (=6)$. 3, as pointed out, is precisely equal and balanced, because $1+2=3$.

So we see the "Son" is highly exalted, although being perfectly submissive. The "Son" (2) is not successive to the number(s) preceding it

(and is therefore less), while He is greater in that He is “more” or actualized, because He “doubles” the Father. This is the way it is expressed in Christian dogma, but Iamblichus is teaching something that is at the common root of this dogma with other traditions, seeing that even in Taoism, there is a Divine Three²⁶. We might say that Christianity is the religion of the Son, externalized, out of the bosom of the Father, but that the Monad retains the power and the glory to sustain, unmanifested and manifested, something else that shares the common root in that Monad. If this makes your head hurt, or sounds too Christian, just concentrate on the Numbers.

The Monad is like a seed in containing within itself the unformed and unarticulated principle of every number, the Dyad is a small advance towards Number, but is not Number outright because it is like a source; but the Triad causes the principle of the Monad to advance into actuality and extension. ‘This’ belongs to Monad, ‘either’ to Dyad, and ‘each/every’ to the Triad.

Iamblichus also uses etymology: Trein means piety, so it is called prudence & wisdom; in the Christian tradition, Divine Sophia (as well as in Gnosticism). Knowledge (true knowledge) follows the Triad. The Triad is also beginning, middle, end. This is why prayers are made three times, in formulas of threes, and why even the Triangle (the first planar figure) has three different types (equilateral, scalene, isocetes). Adding the Triad up we get 6, which is the first perfect Number. It is unyielding and cannot be worn down, because you cannot divide it into two equal parts. There are three Fates, three levels of Creation (sky, land, water), three motions of the stars (summer, winter, ecliptic), and three phases of moon (waning, waxing, full). Giving, receiving, and requital is the pattern of Generation, both divine and human. He even quotes Homer: “all is di-

²⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Three_Pure_Ones

vided into three”, which becomes (with Aristotle) a meditation on virtue being the mean between two extreme vices.

What is crystal clear is that even something as simple as the relations of the very most basic Numbers is revelatory, to the meditative spirit, of the fabric of the universe. And this makes perfect sense, for how could God not be revealed in that which is most humble, the smallest of things, the very pebbles or calculi which we move around in our first attempts at numeracy?

Posted on 2013-01-11 by Logres

4.7 The Tetrad

As we have journeyed through each Number, they appear to us like different states of consciousness: in the 1, I see Unity, in 2, I behold the difference between Being and Non-Being, and with 3, I see the deeper harmony of the One-and-the-Many. Of course, neither Unity, Being, nor Harmony is lacking in any of the Numbers: it is just that each Number is a key with a different dominant tone. One contains all Numbers, Two is another Monad (as well as Privation), and Three reconciles mystery with mystery.

When we reach Tetrad, we find more of the same, but differently. Are these new states of Being, or just changes in Consciousness?

$1+2+3+4 = 10$, so the Tetrad is complete: it contains the Pyramid, the four elements, and the four causes of Aristotle, and the Quadrivium — arithmetic apprehends quantity in general, music apprehends relative quantity, geometry takes in size in general (static), and astronomy apprehends size in motion in the stars. Iamblichus thinks the Quadrivium’s use of Number to apprehend Truth is less liable to error (one supposes, than religion?). He doesn’t seem to have a division between sacred/profane science – there is only Truth. He relates each science of Quadrivium

to a number: Arithmetic (Monad), Harmony/Music (Dyad), Geometry (Triad), and Astronomy (Tetrad). The first and simplest three dimensional figure is the sphere, composed of center, diameter, area, circumference.

Creation proper begins with the Tetrad, as fire is symbolized by the pyramid (4 bases, 4 angles), there are 4 elements, 4 seasons, etc. Iamblichus' use of 4 orderings in Nature is a long one. "Accretion of discrete things cannot be seen without the Tetrad, although plurality appears with the Triad". Those who have died in virtue are not "thrice-blessed", but "four times blessed": they have gone beyond alteration and change.

Squares symbolize stability, and Hermes and Herakles are associated with them. *Tlao* means endure, so we may call it the Tetlad, for a neologism. Since its perimeter and square are equal, it is called Justice. 4 is associated with the ensoulment of Body, thanks to the various harmonic ratios established by the 1,2,3,4 sequence; so 4 (again) represents emergence out of possibility into actual existence.

In the Western tradition, we would say that the number 4 establishes the outflowing of the seminal Ideas of God into the material universe: Four is the entrance of the Triad's energies into the actual harmonies of physical creation. In Platonic terms, matter would now be Over-Souled or given an Anima, so that the world-Soul now exists, and is a living thing. The seeds of Creation or *rationes seminales* (associated with Logos *Spermatikos*) proceed to actually unify Matter and Form into substance, shape, form, & principle. So actual things come into existence, and do not latently exist in conception as Ideas in God's mind only. God desires to save the world, as a husband desires to deliver his bride from the clutches of a dragon. This is the will of heaven, and perhaps Christianity's greatest gift to the other religions, if it is done properly and seen properly.

We should see an analogy here²⁷ with the Hindu tradition, which

²⁷http://www.praxisresearch.net/custpage.cfm/frm/65464/sec_id/654

teaches 1) What is experienced 2) The experiencer 3) A medium of experience. 1 is Archetype (Father) 2 is the Logos, which reflects that which is received (Son) and 3 is the hypostatic union which reconciles Subject/Object. When this inner Trinity is ignited in perichoresis, Creation (4) is the result. Isn't this what it means to experience an Initiation? First one establishes consciousness of Tradition (1), then one learns obedience (primarily of mind or intuition, which alone can rule the psyche – 2), Illumination follows (3) in which one experiences the Lord's will as one's own, and shares the reality "in the Spirit". At this point, the worshiper has been purgated, illumined, and experienced theosis (the term illumination in English slips back and forth between 2&3, but technically, belongs to the hour before dawn, when the worshiper is still in actual darkness, but not formally so). Only at this point, after 3, can the devotee actually begin to "change the world", because their Self is changed: they can now begin to truly live, and affect Creation (4).

If we, with Tomberg, forget about our salvation, and focus on preparing in steps for what is inevitable (from the point of view of vertical energy), then we can avoid short-circuiting the process and falling victim to Counter Initiation. For some, this will come "after death" in the post-mortem state: according to Jesus' parables, these as fully inherit the Kingdom as those who enter the vineyard at dawn.

It is a question of seeking for what we truly want. If like Simon Magus, we desire power Now, we risk falling. If one waits upon the Lord, and trims the lamps, watching and praying, the perfect time shall come, and may come sooner, after all.

Posted on 2013-01-18 by Logres

* * *

David on 2013-01-18 at 22:26 said:
This was a very good series of text. Thank you.

Might I ask if Iamblichus was the only one positing such ideas ? I have not read the original Pythagoreans philosophers much, but I might guess they had some ideas about mathematics and geometry regarding Truth ? If so, on what different or similar levels ?

Logres on 2013-01-19 at 06:26 said:

No, they all held similar views in the sense that they all thought the same way: Number (literal) is an analogy (or more than an analogy) for higher principles. Niocomachus, etc. the whole bunch are named throughout the text and freely drawn upon : they are cited almost as authorities. It's a short text, if you ever have the desire to read it.

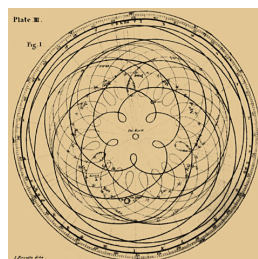
4.8 Pentad

It is worth while reminding the reader that Iamblichus was not merely²⁸ a mathematician and a philosopher, in the idealistic fashion: he was of a princely line, and well-educated, and his caste seems to have been that of Brahmin.

Iamblichus wrote a life of Pythagoras, an autobiography of his great master and teacher.²⁹

For those who claim the Unity, experience the double oath of Heaven to Earth in the Dyad, reaffirm that Unity in the Three, and move into the realm of Creative affects with the Tetrad, they find the Pentad ready to aid their Will.

Venus traces a Pentagram in the sky with her motion through the celestial heavens. The Pentagram is the sign of the Satanists, but then, they only pay attention to one symbol, and ignore the rest, for the Pentagram is integrally related to the Monad and all that comes prior to it. Unlike the Dyad, whose movement is Divinely Feminine (another Monad) but



²⁸http://www.esotericarchives.com/oracle/iambli_t2.htm

²⁹<http://www.platonic-philosophy.org/files/Iamblichus%20-%20The%20Pythagorean%20Life.pdf>

also ambivalent (in that it duplicates the One : for what purpose? – one asks at first), the Pentad is half of the Decad, and is equivalent to the final Completion. The Pentad is 2+3, the first even number (Female) added to the first male number (Male: odd). As such, it is emblematic of Life itself, the pattern of symbiosis and resulting energies from the union of 2 and 3 (which are also, in Christian tradition, the Son and the Spirit, in the Father). 5 mediates the interplay of Life.

5 follows Creation (4), and manifests Justice, which always splits things into an equal and unequal portion (one side 2, one side 3) in order to determine which side requires re-balance. Life results when the rational side of our nature (the smaller, or 2) is given priority or balance as against the appetitive side of our nature (represented in 3). Life is the restoration of balance, or the Circle, in which no value exceeds its place or any other value. Instead of Equality in the modern sense, perhaps modern men should study the Justice and Balance of the Number 5, whose inequality is manifested precisely in order to redress Balance and indicate which is lower, which is higher.

The five pointed star is also (and I add this) quite obviously a picture of man, who has 2 legs, 2 arms, and a head which decides the balance between them as what to do. The proportions of the pentad are based on the Divine Ratio, and generate the number PHI³⁰. (I should mention here that there is some additional symbolism related to man as having an extra appendage, and being symbolized in 666: Man has to seek his polar angel and find salvation in his “lady”, the one who represents the Divine Feminine to him, and mediates Life, since the particular feminine for him is more complete).

The pentad's symbolism can be directly related to the Divine Proportion. And the regeneration of the pentad is related to the value of phi (?). The image of the pentad is found in nature in leaves

³⁰<http://jwilson.coe.uga.edu/EMAT6680Fa06/Hobgood/Pythagoras.html>

and flowers. The Greeks believed each point of the pentad to represent an element: water, earth, air, fire, and idea. Early Christians used the pentad to represent the five wounds of Christ. The symbol, when the point is directed downwards, was later used as a sign for Satan and the Devil.

We will see that the Pentad is in some sense a total completion, as the perfect number (Decad) is simply a repetition of Pentad, just as the Dyad is a repetition of the Monad. 1:2::5:10. Also, $1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 8 + 9 = 45$, divided by $9 = 5$. $5 \times 5 = 25$, $\times 5$ again $= 125$. The third square encompasses itself. It also encompasses two previous squares: $16 + 9 = 25$. The Pentad is a mediator and balance : it is abundant Life, the Star upon the Cross.

So many esotericisms degenerate into chaos because they ignore the Tetrakys, the sequence of all Ten Numbers, 1 through 10, and their inter-relationships. Some emphasize the Monad at the expense of the Upper Waters, Sophia, and the Divine Feminine or the birth of the Logos. Others situate themselves within the Dyad, and ignore how the Dyad can only exist because of primal Unity. The Satanists, as noted, delight in inverting the power of Life in the Pentagram. On the contrary, the true initiate is aware of All Things and All Number, simply because they are fully aware. They do not fixate on one manifestation, but penetrate to the Divine Principles which animate created matter.

For example, the medievals noted that there are five ordinary senses and five wits³¹. The ancients knew that there were five perfect 3-D shapes³²: 4 elements, and one called the aether, which was the “air within the air” (and all the other elements). Could one say that elemental Light is the aether? That the Middle Ages strove to embody the Light of Dionysius in their cathedrals, to begin the ascent from real matter up into the higher worlds?

³¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Five_wits

³²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Platonic_solid

The Pentad is alteration, light, lack of strife; alteration because it changes three dimensionality into the sameness of the sphere, by moving cyclically and engendering light – hence it is light too; and it is lack of strife because it combines everything which was formerly discordant and brings together and reconciles the two kinds of number.

MEGILLUS

Posted on 2013-02-02 by Logres

* * *

Bob on 2013-02-04 at 10:56 said:

I'm not sure if this is the best place to post this, but... How do you reconcile the fact that the Church has a long history of rejecting Iamblichus and the Neoplatonic school in general (even though they crib from it extensively) with the fact that this site seems to want to fuse Neoplatonic and Hermetic teachings with Catholicism and Orthodoxy?

There seems to be a point in the Renaissance when the Church was on the verge of fusing the Hermetic tradition into its theology, but somehow that attempt fizzled into nothing. From that point on, there seems to be an open hostility to Hermeticism.

What does Gornahoor think of such people like Ficino, Mirandola, Bruno, etc? Were these men forces of anti-tradition? These men define the Renaissance in many ways, yet I thought the Renaissance was seen as anti-traditional in nature.

It seems to me that the Church, by rejecting the revival of Hermetic philosophy, made an enemy out of a movement that could have enriched the Church.

The Nominalist/Realist debate is seen as an important point in the decline of the West. But I wonder if the hostility to Hermeticism, thereby turning it into an anti-Catholic force when it might not have been, should be seen as another key point in Western decline.

Cologero on 2013-02-04 at 18:00 said:

Bob, Hermetism is much older than the Renaissance, and we are not saying it is necessary. As for neo-Platonism, it is not really a "fusing", and there is no denying that the Fathers simply regarded the worldview of platonism as basically true. Please refer to *The Church of John*³³ as a starting point for discussion.

³³ ' <http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-church-of-john>

Logres on 2013-02-04 at 20:52 said:

Bob, I have a post on Ficino entitled "Jupiter, Wine, and Gold" on this site. Your questions are cogent from a certain point of view, but speak abstractly while situating yourself in a historical timeline: this is a dead end (I tried it). One can either embrace a historical tradition (in which case, say a Catholic one) one is obligated to work through the theological reservations, or one can simply regard the Ideas as living entities, which are not bound by the fact that the Church had difficulty assimilating or making sense of portions of what it inherited (and I am not suggesting this second approach without some working practice in a historical tradition and its prudential and contingent limitations, which are governed Providentially). But Cologero is correct: the Church Fathers took Platonism as an indubitable starting point for doing theology at all. This is the guiding spirit behind resurrecting portions of text from Iamblichus or even Celsus (one can learn from heretics as well). Hermeticism is open to whomever wants to avail themselves of it, and doesn't depend upon the imprimatur of anything but the Truth, although I think the adversarial relationship between the Church and it to be overstated in many regards. Cologero's work on Tomberg as linked are a great starting point. After some digging, the conflicts acquire a different dimension outside of historical narratives.

4.9 Hexad

The Hexad³⁴ is the first perfect number: it arises, by multiplication (rather than addition) from the Dyad and the Triad, and is hence termed "marriage" (whereas the Pentad is androgynous). That is, the Hexad unifies Male-Female through "blending" and harmony, rather than sticking them together through addition in the Pentad, in which case (because the Pentad is 2:3), one or the other prevails; with the Hexad, there is a perfect mixing.

There are six directions: back and forth, up and down, left and right; so Reality's spatial structure reflects the Hexad. Furthermore, if one divides all number series into Triads, they reflect (in one way or another) the Hexad. $1 + 2 + 3 = 6$, $4 + 5 + 6 = 15$, and $1 + 5 = 6$ again (not to

³⁴<http://www.scribd.com/doc/48888397/6/On-the-Hexad>

mention that the Hexad is a second Triad), $7 + 8 + 9 = 24$ and $2 + 4 = 6$, etc. (Readers who are familiar with traditional astrology will recognize the summing of the individual digits of sums to reduce the number to a simple one).

6 is the sum of it's multiplicative factors, which are all prime ($1 \times 2 \times 3 = 6$).

Here are some of its titles³⁵: Resembling Justice The Thunder-Stone, Amphitrite (Poseidon's wife; a verbal pun: on both sides amphis three trias), Male-Female Marriage, Finest of All In Two Measures, Form of Forms, Peace, Far-Shooting (name of Apollo) Thaleia Kosmos, Possessing Wholeness, Cure-All (panacea), Perfection, Three-Fold Health, Reconciling.

The Pythagorean theory of musical harmonies³⁶ (which is really, as Iamblichus states, no "theory" at all, but rather "the way things actually are") is fairly complex and is also related to Number.

The Pentad is the beginning of Life on the lower planes, *but it is through the Hexad that actual re-integration occurs*. In searching for other insights to this piece, I came across St. Nicholas of Flue³⁷, whose had a vision of "Two Trinities": one was of the "old gods" of the West, and one was the newer, Christian perichoretic Trinity. Tomberg gives the key to interpreting some of this, when he notes that the two triangles of the key of Solomon symbolize the movement of lower Creation upward and the the movement of Spirit downward, integrated through the mediation of the regenerated man. Thus, we can see that the "old gods of the West" are not to be seen as "un-Christian", but are rather, to be baptized and lifted up, through a process of cultural acclimation, in which Western Man is re-integrated into the prime Tradition through participation in Logos. This would (obviously) occur at both an individual and a corporate level,

³⁵<http://www.american-buddha.com/cult.pythagsourcebook.2.32.htm>

³⁶<http://www.american-buddha.com/cult.pythagsourcebook.2.33.htm>

³⁷<http://paulijungunusmundus.eu/rfr/radbilde.htm>

and beautifully illustrates how Christendom was designed to “give the pattern” or archetype to “men of the West”.

Nicholas of Flue³⁸, incidentally, is also credited with preserving peace³⁹ between the Catholic and Protestant cantons of Switzerland through his sanctity, and of being the father of the “state” of Switzerland. The reader can see through this how Iamblichus’ “Numbers” are not mere arithmetic or private meditation only, but are indeed true understandings of how the entire Cosmos functions, at both lower levels and higher ones, physical or spiritual, and by implication, everything in between as well.

Posted on 2013-02-08 by Logres

* * *

David on 2013-02-09 at 10:49 said:

This series about numbers are really interesting. I will have to read more of Iamblichus. Thank you.

Logres on 2013-02-10 at 22:33 said:

Thank you – I found it interesting to (the original text). What is fascinating is the figure of Nicholas of Flue: he seems to have been a mystic of a different color (from even the traditional picture of one). But then again, maybe they all are. I do think the “double Trinity”/Hexad configuration is worth pursuing.

David on 2013-02-10 at 22:43 said:

And it does raise the question to what degree Pythagoras can be linked with all that? He did have a lot to say about mysteries and mathematics.

Logres on 2013-02-11 at 09:06 said:

I think if you read Iamblichus’ *Life of Pythagoras*, you would get a very good idea of how much: Taylor’s translation is supposed to be classic. Iamblichus was contemporary with the Christian revelation, so I am guessing that his exposition (from my perspective) contained a fuller exposition of Tradition than Pythagoras, who had a different task – that of laying the paternal

³⁸[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nicholas_of_FlÃije](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nicholas_of_Fl%C3%A4je)

³⁹<http://www.ewtn.com/library/MARY/NICHFLU.HTM>

foundations and groundwork for the creation of Mediterranean Man (as some have called it). That said, Pythagoras is central to the exposition of both Number and Tradition: whatever can be said about Iamblichus' esoteric teachings, can undoubtedly be said to be at least latent in Pythagoras. I think it's impossible to understate how high a degree of veneration the ancients held him in.

Logres on 2013-02-11 at 13:26 said:

From the article on Flue:

"Anahata, the suksma aspect of the heart, thus forms the center of two opposed triads. The lower three chakras obviously contain the suksma aspect of what I have called the drive triad, i.e., in psychological language that aspect of exploration, sexuality, and aggression that can be experienced in introversion; the three upper chakras contain the renewed upper Trinity of Logos, meditation, and Eros, so that anahata ultimately links the lower and the upper trinities. It follows that the heart chakra also contains the Seal of Solomon (cf. figure 5), the union of the instinctive with the spiritual/psychic Trinity which is found in the human heart. This union of the double triadic symbol with the heart, however, corresponds to the structure of the wheel image."

This seems to fit very well with Tomberg's Meditations on the Tarot.

From physics: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quark_model

Pieter on 2013-02-13 at 23:03 said:

I just stumbled on this site and this post, and although I didn't follow all of your points (e.g. the pentad is the beginning of life on the lower planes) I enjoyed the study. I was curious if you or your audience are familiar with Nassim Haramein's work on the geometry of the "vacuum" (i.e. nature). Nassim posits that the basic geometrical unit of the vacuum is the star tetrahedron. The hexahedron also plays a very important role in nature as it is the most stable shape in terms of vector equilibrium. Hexads keep popping up over and over in nature.

This is the quickest way to become familiar with Nassim's theory:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S1JDMToJDe0>

The best lecture I'd recommend is the 8-hour Rogue Valley Metaphysical Library (you gents seem to have longer attention spans than that of average Americans, so here you go):

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=79_HwQ-92f8

Going back to the pentad being the beginning of life on the lower plane, I wonder what your meaning is? Perhaps something esoteric? Even the structure of cell division (material plane) occurs by multiplication of two.

And spheres (cells) group in 3s. Imagine pushing 2 marbles of equal radius together. Now add a third marble and you have greater equilibrium with a sort of isosceles triangle. When you add a fourth, then you must set this on top of the the triangular base in order to maintain

equilibrium. Otherwise you're forced to make an awkward diamond, which is essentially two isosceles triangles sharing a common center. Spheres group structurally in 3s, not 2s, 4s, 5s, etc. Where does the pentad fit in?

Caleb Cooper on 2013-02-14 at 12:26 said:

Hello Pieter,

A quick (non)answer is your intuition of esotericism is correct. In fact, the practical experience of the esoteric is pretty much the focus of Gornahoor. This isn't to say that looking for links between physics and metaphysics isn't worthwhile, and probably is of interest to some readers here, but it is outside the focus that our host Cologero tries to maintain.

I am sympathetic to the interest in physics though, as it was a gateway for me to Tradition. So hopefully I'll be forgiven by our gracious host for using its profane language as a bridge to try a give a too rough sketch of what's going on here.

My bridge was realizing that Ockham's razor meant supposing a Void (zero) "in the beginning." In quantum mechanics, as space decreases, the production of virtual particles inversely increases, so in a Void where there is no space, there would be an explosion producing an infinite wavestate that would extend above all space and time, containing all possibilities within itself. This could be identified as the monad (1) (the Greeks didn't have zero to work with though, so you can apply a lot of the attributes of the monad to the Void, in which case this is the dyad, 2), or what humans often call God.

A human body is more or less a radio, while the soul is analogous to the music it plays; having its origin outside the radio and best understood in terms of frequencies and wavestates. The material universe we inhabit is created by wavestate collapses from the original infinite wavestate; that is the spirit of God descends, through multiple non-physical realms that correspond to certain frequencies, and the pentad corresponds to the plane we psychically inhabit.

Gornahoor, and Tradition, are especially interested in the opposite movement; attuning our radio to the higher frequencies so we can ascend back to God. Hope this helps.

Logres on 2013-02-14 at 17:41 said:

Caleb, great answer.

Pieter, I wouldn't add much – I am not a physicist, and have only a lettered man's acquaintance with it, although I am interested in it. Any subject can be a window into Tradition (music, mathematics, etc.): we will be doing some posts on this later on (the Trivium and Quadrivium).

I am sure you are familiar with the idea that certain things are so nebulous that to observe them is to alter them. We can even go further than that and say, to discuss them or think about them, is to alter them, because Tradition teaches that thoughts are not arbitrary "things" contained in our heads. Thus, empirical observation and mathematical models based on peering into the Reality fractal can only yield approximated models which are more or less satisfactory

for various purposes (although I think Polkinghorne is right – they have verisimilitude, at their level, and constitute a “real” knowledge). This limitation means that all empirical knowledge whatsoever ultimately cannot tell us about the Absolute, which is experienced by intuition and according to various modes which fit the receptor. A brilliant physicist who was also an esoteric student could, no doubt, relate the two and find his actual knowledge of God enhanced by his studies – I find this to be the case in my own semi-speciality, which is letters (history and literature). All of these studies have a tendency to assume command of the intuitive cognition which makes knowledge actualized, by metaphysically identifying knower, known, and mode of knowing.

As long as this is born in mind, one can approach Physics, and use it to approach Traditional studies. In answer to your question, I will take a stab and say that the Pentagram is the actual commencement of biological arrangement and chemical life. The fact that Hexads are more common in Nature simply means that Nature doesn’t flourish into something more than biological soup (ie., it doesn’t approach beauty and fullness of being) without “6”. There may be traces of this left behind in Nature’s molecular structure, and in fact are (eg., snowflakes). However, I don’t have a concrete empirical answer for why Pentagrams are so absent, because I don’t know enough physics to attempt it – although their absence may be suggestive. Perhaps someone like yourself, if immersed in Tradition, could discover why this is so.

4.10 A Pause at the Hexad

There is a natural pause over the Hexad: it represents, in many ways, a repetition of the Monad, being halfway in between 1 & 10. The Hexad, or Seal of Solomon, reminds us that even the Monad itself is not original, but ab-original, because Iamblichus never deals with the Number Zero. We might wonder if Zero represents Non-Being, something which Greek civilization did not investigate as thoroughly as it did the Circle and its Center as The Beginning. A bright mathematician and philosopher/poet might add to Iamblichus’ meditations by exploring what the East discerned Non-Being to be, and how this might be integrated into Western metaphysics through Iamblichus’ meditative sequence on Number.

Thus, when the Hexad begins the surge of re-integrative Life, we are

reminded that the One or Logos as we know it in the West is itself not God, in a sense, because the chain of progression makes us consider the subtle variations between numbers (as well as Zero). As Jesus said, Why do you call me Good? There is One Good, who is God.” It is no coincidence that Islam arose between East and West, in the wastes of the desert, where men had not forgotten that the scandal of the Incarnation was a fire which might burn those who neglected the study of Non-Being. In fact, the Orthodox argue that Catholic mysticism, over time, degenerated into emotionalism and sentimentality of a sort, which is related to the Western emphasis on the second Chakra (the Logos). As this author points out⁴⁰, this drive lead them to abandon the Supreme Eros (the front Chakra) and also meditation in favor of a degenerated concept of Logos, which leads to Bacon and modern empiricism⁴¹. The alchemical process degenerated into the world of the Machine. Yet even here, there are echoes⁴², intimations of “deprivation” as George Parkin Grant termed them – we learn the existence of Heaven by experiencing Hell. Even raw physics teaches the importance of the Hexad.

In a future essay, we will see how Tolkien himself (the last man to take up arms against the Machine in letters, as a crusade) anticipated this in his myth of the Lost Road⁴³. The world no longer had a straight road “into the West” that rose into the upper air, but became Round. The road to Non-Manifestation and Non-Being was closed to the Western Man.

If we recover a doctrine of the Hexad, we might balance not only the Monad and the end of the cycle in 10, but also see how Zero teaches us even more about Origins. (Please note: in a sense, Iamblichus’ Monad can be said to contain both the 0 and the 1, and so is not incomplete – rather, we say that Iamblichus was more concerned with Manifestation

⁴⁰<http://paulijungunusmundus.eu/rfr/radbilde.htm>

⁴¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3468>

⁴²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quark_model

⁴³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Lost_Road_and_Other_Writings

than Non-Being).

The Hexad is the Seal of Solomon, which the Templars were created to embody. Here was yet another opportunity afforded by the far reach of Heaven to remind the West of what it should already know. Some mystics like Nicholas of Flue realized that there had to be two Trinities, since the lower realms had to be constantly related back to, not only the metaphysical principles of realization in the manifested Trinity, but united in what alchemy was designed to reach – perfect reintegration into the Monad of the Monad. This was to occur in the Heart, where was hid all the secrets of earth and heaven. Even in Islam, which kept the echoes alive, a need was seen by the Sufis to recognize the truth which Christianity held in potential, and the heart remained paramount to exoteric doctrine focused on the One.

The mystery of the Hexad, or double Trinity, teaches man that God is a God of the living, and that even correct dogma or doctrine was not everything – there remained the task of the Heart, which Valentin Tomberg undertook to explicate in his Meditations.

The Hexad re-unites Wood (the mortal Fifth Element) with the true Fifth Element or Quintessence: the “Hearth” (another name for the Monad) is in between Earth and Heaven, just as the Heart mediates the lower 3 chakras with the upper 3. God must swear a double oath – one by Earth, one by Heaven (see the Epistle to the Hebrews). This is one of the true meanings of the Incarnation, which was vouchsafed to the Christians, if they can remember it.

Posted on 2013-02-15 by Logres

* * *

scardanelli on 2013-02-16 at 11:22 said:

I'm eager to read your analysis of Tolkien's Lost Road myth. There's an interesting article here by Joscelyn Godwin discussing the Traditional nature of Tolkien's work:

<http://hermetic.com/godwin/tolkien-and-the-primordial-tradition.html>

I've been thinking lately that perhaps the creation of new storytelling and myths might be the only way to reach much of the Western population; a way of indirectly planting the "seed" of traditionalism without invoking the reaction that the modern world has trained into them. Tolkien could be a model for this work, as he has obviously mastered the genre.

Caleb Cooper on 2013-02-16 at 19:42 said:

I think just as you can say the Dyad is like the Monad to the levels below it, the Monad is also like the Dyad to the Zero. Perhaps there's a general principle in play here that the proper order of things is two-faced; the feminine reflective principle faces towards the superior level before it, while the masculine aspect faces the other way, radiating to the lower levels what has been assimilated from above. We can see examples of this in Jesus' complete submission to the Father; the Church as the bride of Christ, etc...

Logres on 2013-02-17 at 06:34 said:

Caleb – you nailed it: you just articulated what has been lurking in my mind.

Scardanelli – you are also spot on : that was the whole mission of the Inklings, in which they failed (for several reasons), but their instinct was sound, and it might work, in fact stands a good strong chance of doing just that. We'll look at how Tolkien (who came closest in terms of poetic power and natural instinct) started this. I am not sure if Williams had that much esoteric influence (Tolkien certainly had more popular influence); I think Tolkien distrusted his influence over Lewis. Tolkien had more talent, and Barfield had to work, as well as re-invent the wheel, to a degree.

Rui Artur on 2022-08-11 at 11:36 said:

The passage from Zero to One (Beyond Being to Being) is one of the things I read in the Apocalypse verse 'the lamb was slain from the foundation of the world', because Zero cannot create (every number multiplied by it is Zero), and exactly the opposite is the case with One, which multiplied by any number produces that number (the ten thousand things of the Tao Te Ching). So the Zero had to 'go out of himself', had to be 'sacrificed' to produce things outside it.

4.II Hebdomad

Seven is called the Virgin, Guardian, Message, Critical Time, Athena, Chance & Acropolis. It is a mean between the second Monad (ie., the Hexad, issuing into material Creation, since Dyad and Triad belong more properly to the One) and the Decad. It is perfect: it is 3 from 4 and 3 from 10. It is the balance between the end and the beginning, if we are speaking of the confluence of Being issuing in Creation.

Throughout, Iamblichus has drawn on Nicomachus⁴⁴ lost *Theology of Arithmetic*. In considering the Heptad, he has a long section on gestation and the ages of men, which are divided by sevens. This is interesting, but we will focus instead on another idea, suggested by Iamblichus, that there are three layers of the soul (rational, spirited, appetitive) and four virtues (wisdom, justice, fortitude, and moderation).

For anyone familiar with the Liberal Arts, one should immediately think of the Trivium⁴⁵ and the Quadrivium⁴⁶ (also note, that these were considered preparatory to the study of philosophy and theology). So, there were seven planets, and seven “subjects”/”modes” to master before one could come in the light of the Sun. There are seven progressions of musical notes in the infra-scale of music. Here again, once subject of the Quadrivium is Harmony, or Music, and this is not accidental: the roots of the sadly degraded liberal arts lie in the greater and lesser mysteries, and not the study of “relevance” or “contemporary” dialogues between modern political factions.

He who attained to Seven, by necessity was graduating to the last grade – it is a mark of completion and mastery to have entered the final grade. Those familiar with the Ur-Group writings will recognize that some of the essays deal with the evocation of the celestial guardians, which

⁴⁴<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nicomachus>

⁴⁵<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Trivium>

⁴⁶<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quadrivium>

are seven in number.

Seven is perfect also, because it cannot be divided by anything except itself (it's only factors are 1 and 7) – in this sense, it is like 2 and 3, as well as 5.

In Revelation, we are told that there are 7 spirits or archons/angels, represented in the temple candlesticks, which pour out various events upon the earth. Of course, seven is also the number of days in the week, which is not an accident – neither is it accidental that the phases of the moon can be divided into seven week quarters (Iamblichus draws heavily on the phases of moon when discussing seven, and this is proper, because the Moon represents a “fetal Earth in gestation”, whose boundaries mark the limits of the lower powers of the air that govern the soul cages and impose General Law upon mortals – to “jump over the Moon” is to master the astral worlds and to transcend the power of the Lower Guardians: please refer to Boris Mouravieff's work in this regard).

So we see that Seven is actually, properly, a very lucky number.

To return to the Liberal Arts, the number of Seven was critical – 3 portions to match the various layers of man's soul (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and 4 virtues or actual “knowledge bodies” that were mastered (Arithmetic, Number, Harmony, and Celestial Proportion). So it can be seen that the Trivium matches the first three numbers, and constitutes a reflection of the higher waters and Divine Essence, while the Quadrivium matches the last four numbers, and is the issuing forth of Being into Creation as manifested virtues and concrete knowledge. In a future essay we will assay more closely how the Liberal Arts are patterned on the mysteries.

Posted on 2013-02-22 by Logres

4.12 Heaven By Storm on the Number Seven

I have paused, once more, at the Number Seven, for there are seven deadly sins which every mortal must purge themselves from, before the ascent, and there are seven corresponding virtues, four classical ones, and three theological ones, which (no doubt), ingenious readers can correspond in various ways to each of the deadly sins. The seven spirits which guard Heaven, and must be taken by storm, will fall with the aid of the Queen of Revelation, Mary, High Priestess of Heaven, who rules the lower waters and has become the upper ones. I have written several poems to her over the last year, and this one is from a fairy tale I am writing for my children, in which the main character is named Anna May, and who is acting as a symbol of Queen Mary, on behalf of those under her care.

War in Heaven

The angel sang her questions bold,
And Anna answered as of old.
The time was written, and was fitting:
Storm against the gods of old.
For many swarmed about that flood,
The evil, neutral, and the good,
Catching souls for food unholy.
Rulers in thrones and power most crude,
Each of the strong and original seven,
Held blades from world-heart riven,
They held the gap, and sealed the trap,
Which runs from earth to heaven.
Dozens under them, the decan twelve,
Hundreds beneath them, who delve,
Into the secret hearts, and inner parts,
Stubborn as dwarves, angry as elves.

They guard the purity of space,
From all the failure of the doomed race,
And test the ones, who dare the run,
Against the suns, into God's face.
Behold their wrath, how beautiful and strong,
Fashioned of our faults, our sins' song,
Their dreadful shade, from us is made,
They or us must die to free our wrong.
One cometh, shall come, always treading,
She who rules heaven, the wedding
Of the moon and sun, mercy-justice One,
Herald of a brighter Sun unebbing.
Who is this who faces the Seven?
Who is this warlike maid of Heaven?
First falls great Pride, and then Falls his Bride,
Envy who breathes the green fear-raven.
Lightning struck again, the maid grew proud,
Proud of how it must be done and loud
Grew the zeal of her heart, and the sword in art,
Struck through and through wrath's shroud.
Angry then, she sprang against the cherubim
Dark who mock despair of those in Lim:
Froze the fire of sloth with beauty wroth,
The silver fire rolled rippling through the Dim.
Peaceful now in dance she turns,
Calm she clasps the angel and she burns,
Lightning again, against the dun gods of sin,
Waning Greed falls as she yearns.
Two bolts more she snares of angel fire,
Herself she rules complete, a Lyre
She weaves and plays, the arrows ray

The one who makes wine a fire.
The last did fall as one long dead,
She of beauty great, but inward bled,
The terrible one, whose power to stun,
A fire within must quench instead.
Anna flickered fire and stood the queen
Of heaven cold that night, between
The living and the dead in fright,
She whom Sun and Moon made clean.

Posted on 2013-03-01 by Logres

4.13 Octad

The Octad is a short chapter.

Iamblichus continues his march⁴⁷ through numbers noting that all men, without exception, count 1-10. The empiricist says this is because they have 10 fingers, and the Hermeticist says “why do you suppose that is?”. In any case, it is not impossible to conceive attempts to circumvent divine order, such as the reordering of week days⁴⁸ during the French Revolution, so their argument holds little water (which they know – most of the Anglos don’t use metric).

Eight is perfect, in that it is 1+7, neither number which is engendered, as Seven is a “second” Monad, in this meditation. The first two odd numbers (3 and 5) also produce it, making it relate to the process of the Cube (Claims Iamblichus, although he doesn’t specify how this is so).

The pattern four is in the ecliptics of the Zodiac, and the “circles” (tropics and polar), as well as finding expression in Harmonic divisions

⁴⁷<http://www.scribd.com/doc/48888397/Iamblichus-the-Theology-of-Arithmetic>

⁴⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/French_Republican_Calendar

and even the teeth and skulls⁴⁹ (presumably four big plates) of human beings. For instance, birds usually have four claws, and if an insect has more than eight legs, it is usually not exact.

Philolaus teaches that after mathematical magnitude has become three dimensional thanks to the tetrad, there is the quality and ‘color’ of visible Nature in the pentad, and the ensoulment in the hexad, and intelligence and health and what he calls ‘Light’ in the hebdomad, and then next, with the ogdoad, things come by love and friendship and wisdom and creative thought.

So we are looking more now at what is normally understood as “manifestation” or “Creation”. It is safety and foundation, because its root is in 2, and 2 is the leader of Manifestation in the sense of “daring” or “courage” (warrior-qualities).

There is a long section on harmonic relationships which is very involved with terms like sesquitertian, sesquiocave, etc., but I will recommend it to musicians, only noting for the Layman that what he needs to know is that the sesqui interval works as follows. 12 is the sesquialter of 8 (it succeeds 8 by an interval of half, so the “change” is related to the “substance” by law), and the sesquitertian of 9 (it succeeds 9 by an interval of one-third).

There is, of course, the Indian method⁵⁰ of examining the birthday, name, and age of the person in order to use Pythagorean reduction to basic numerals to arrive at spiritual meaning. But these are more personal methods, and less metaphysical, than those which Iamblichus deploys.

8 resembles the infinity symbol, turned at a right angle. Does this mean that it is Infinity, set on its ear? In other words, Infinity set towards a downfall? Iamblichus does seem to indicate that “manifestation” in

⁴⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Human_skull

⁵⁰http://www.sanatansociety.org/vedic_astrology_and_numerology/indian_numerology_8.htm

terms of Bios begins to break forth in 8, interweaving design and matter in actual genesis. We might think of the TV programs we were all indoctrinated on, which always start with some image of algae or lava or star dust, coalescing and shimmering and out-breaking, in order to appreciate the power of 8. The affinities are revealed: sex, division, mutual interdependence, etc.

Just for fun I looked up some modern⁵¹ numerology; Ellis Taylor seems to think that our Arabic numbers (in contradistinction to Latin ones, which are more pure) have been used to program us for failure. Although this sounds like the typical modern conspiracy theory, it may have something of interest, considering that even the Solfeggio⁵² scale has been reset in the modern Era. All changes of this sort ought to be more self-consciously investigated.

Our modern day musical scale is slightly out of sync from the original Solfeggio frequencies and is, consequently, more dissonant as it is based upon what is termed the “Twelve-Tone Equal Temperament.” In ancient times, the musical scale was called “Just Intonation.” And also, our modern music falls within the A 440 hz frequency, which was changed from A 417 hz, around 1914.

In addition, a 7th note was added in the form of a “SI,” or a “TI,” as in the “DO, RE, MI, FA, SO, LA, TI” vocal scale, while the original Solfeggio scale was composed of only six notes: “UT, RE, MI, FA, SO, LA.”

I am not a literal conspiracist, but certainly there was a reason the musical scale was altered: Traditionalists who are mathematicians or musicians ought to look into these things. We recall that Gornahoor has taught that there is an invisible war on a higher pattern, and that changes are never random, even if no discernible pattern can be found.

⁵¹<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Adlw7sRw7cg>

⁵²<http://www.miraclesandinspiration.com/solfeggiofrequencies.html>

Posted on 2013-03-29 by Logres

* * *

George Goerlich on 2013-03-31 at 23:49 said:

Sorry for the ignorance, but are there examples of recorded ancient/traditionalist music?

Logres on 2013-04-01 at 11:13 said:

Plato discusses music (eg., his approval of certain “modes” such as Dorian or Phrygian); I’ve noted the Solfeggio shift that ought to be investigated. The modern mania for “kid’s music” (rock and roll) and other even more degenerate forms (it’s hard not to conclude that jazz is really such a form), even when better is available, is notable. I am not a musician, but a lot of Celtic music is played (I think) in an off mode that is either Dorian or Phrygian – there really aren’t any accidents. Musicians either place us closer to God or closer to the devil; traditionalists can use their souls to verify which is which, even if they don’t have a lot of theory to go on. Augustine, I believe, has a very useful discourse on music. Listen to some of the Templar chants, like *Salve Regina* or *The Stone that the Builders Rejected*.

Arthur on 2013-04-01 at 22:52 said:

Conspiracy or not, here is something about the imposing of the 440 herz pattern:

http://www.medicalveritas.org/MedicalVeritas/Musical_Cult_Contr ol.html

4.14 Ennead

Iamblichus has taken us on a metaphysical tour of the Numbers; is it too much to claim that any metaphysics or religion worthy of the name ought to be measured by the yardstick he has provided? I do not think so. That is, if a supposed “philosophy of Life” or doctrine cannot provide a legitimate and profound account of how it accounts for and accomodates the spiritual value of Number which is revealed in his meditations (which are the sum of centuries of thought upon such in Greece), then it is inherently suspect, and ought to be condemned. The condemnation would rest on the fact that it does not partake of Logos, Measure, or Number.

The Logos is the structure of manifested reality, the pattern of higher things: as the Scripture puts it, it is the “evidence of things not seen”. By faith, guided by Reason, we see that the Numbers are actually markers or seeds and guidelines which reflect the unmanifested One above, as well as the manifested but higher planes of existence which are not so obvious to the the untutored. A great and valid religion should be able to explain its exoteric dogmas in terms of Number(s), so that it demonstrates a correspondence with actual Creation, rather than wish-fulfillment and delusion. The same would hold true for such *ad hoc* philosophies as neopaganism or Nietzsche’s philosophy of the hammer. Where, in most modern worldviews, is there any effort to harmonize with the Logos? Most often, we only see expressed the virulent hatred for other points of view, even if justifiably so in terms of pure intellect. The same would hold for a certain kind of Traditionalism that restricts itself merely to the rejection of what is Modern, thus (in a weird way), acknowledging its opponent to be an anti-Monad which it is rejecting in a Dyadic rebellion.

Corrollaries to this are obvious. Obviously, the Stoical tradition is superior (for instance) to the Epicurean philosophy (a fact acknowledged in the epistles of Saint Paul, who doesn’t mind quoting certain philosophers as against others). In our own day, a similar form of sifting might occur with the many Thoughts we encounter in the “Marketplace of Ideas”. That is, some men are more sane, balanced, and normative than others, and can be taken as sound guides on certain subjects. Isn’t this what Gornahoor has undertaken?

In regards to the *Ennead*, it is so short, that I simply recommend readers to peruse it⁵³. Iamblichus makes the point that Nine is the last of the numbers, since Ten is simply a Monad once Nine is taken away, and so on and so forth. Nine is the cube of 3 (in the sense of $3+3+3$), and so is a kind of natural completion, or ending point, which Iamblichus

⁵³<http://www.scribd.com/doc/48888397/Iamblichus-the-Theology-of-Arithmetic>

again compares to a goal post that is raced up to and turned around to head home. Even its name is a play on words resembling Henad (Hen means One, so a Monad). It is Oceanus, or “horizon”: moderns might say, Event Horizon. It is also called Hyperion, because it is the supremely last manifested Number before the repetition begins (strictly speaking) with the Decad. It also contains all harmonic ratios, as $4+3+2 = 9$ (sesquialter, double, and sesquitercian).

But the chapter is very short, and if you are going to read a chapter of this work, this is a good place to dive in.

I hope it is not necessary to point out that Plotinus wrote *The Enneads*⁵⁴, to readers of Gornahoor.

Posted on 2013-04-05 by Logres

* * *

David on 2013-04-06 at 09:08 said:

I thought some of you would be interested about some numbers hidden in the Gospels. So here it goes :

- In the Gospel of John, in the resurrection part, the 7 disciples appear 7 times in the text. 7 being number of perfection (4 cardinal points + triad)

- Again in John, it is said that there is 153 fish that were collected. Note that it's not written «about». Number 1 to 17 added up in a pythagorean fashion = 153. 17 is composed of 10 (the Multitude, the Totality) and 7 (the Perfection). Thinking about Jesus and the «God made flesh so that flesh could be made God» make the meaning quite interesting.

- There is also a number of small numbers that goes everywhere in the Gospels and are repeated for a structural reason (ex: Peter that deny 3 times Christ, and Christ who asked him 3 times to guide his sheeps, as to absolve him).

- In the genealogy of Matthew in the youth of Christ, he make 3 lists of 14 names (or 6 of 7, again 7). 14 is the numerical number of David (DWD in hebrew) added up : D=6, W=4, D=6; 6+6+4=14. And it is again paired with 3, the Triad. And this is evident for two reasons : Jesus is presented as the son of David (royalty), and David is exactly in the center of the genealogy. Also, Jesus (through Theotokos Mary) is presented as the breaking point of the last name in the

⁵⁴<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Enneads>

serie (the verb used is total passivity to the Divine instead of an active principle like the other): he is therefore the number who add up to make everything complete, to be the last monad that forge the last Triad ($4+3=7$), to forge the last number in the sequence so that everything add up as I explained it. There is a lot more to say about the genealogy, which is full of symbols, but nothing else with numbers.

- In Luke, the number 3 appears for symbolical meaning through his Gospel (3 days mostly), and it's generally a feature only present in Luke⁵⁵.

- In the genealogy of Luke : 77 names; 11 list of 7 names. The 7th name is Enoch, the first to have ascended to Heaven.

I could go on. There is a lot of numbers around the Gospels, a lot more that needs to be unveiled.

Logres on 2013-04-06 at 22:28 said:

Thank you, David. I used to dismiss "Bible code", but there is certainly something encrypted, although I would hesitate to say that it is paramount in the sense that it could over-ride the results of meditation. However, they should operate in a parallel fashion, no?

David on 2013-04-06 at 23:26 said:

I think they do. And I think they convey both different message. Trying to tell people that Jesus is son of David through numerical alchemy is not meant (I think so) to meditate on the «way» rather than on the message in itself. I think it's supposed to give motivation, to answer to human concerns, to develop exoterism (a lot of the numerical things answer to either greek socio-historical concerns or «jewish» ones). I think we should keep in mind that some of the things in the Bible, for us, being in Kali Yuga in the second millenium are motivation and esthetics : a lot of it is either veiled or forgotten, or just not meant for us. Tradition always adapted to its own historical context, and the Bible is not (for me) apart from this. Jesus is the revelation, not the book.

Logres on 2013-04-07 at 06:17 said:

That makes sense: this is sort of how I've treated it in my own mind, since obviously the code is so complicated and the meaning somewhat lost, however, it undoubtedly was meant to enhance the meditation for some readers and/or confirm the exoteric religion for others. But your answer helps clarify this.

⁵⁵For those of you who wants to read the Gospels other than meditatively, you should try to read them in parallels : that way, you'll unveil difference of message and therefore meaning between the Gospels. They do not want to teach us the same face of Christ. Do not say "I've already read this!", or you'll miss sometimes big details.

David on 2013-04-10 at 18:02 said:

<http://glory2godforallthings.com/2013/04/08/reading-in-community/>

This text is very thoughtful on the subject of reading the Bible. Sorry to have digressed with numbers and Iamblichus to the Scriptures.

The Labors of Hercules

5.1 The Labors of Hercules, Part One

Hercules¹ is a picture of the strong man, who binds: in Christ's parables, he uses the image to refer to Satan, who always imitates God in a perverse manner. Esoterically, we might say that for most people (excluding Tomberg's mysterious "just man"), "Satan makes the first move in the chess game. A greater than Satan has to come to bind the strong man, and so Hercules is also a picture of "the Lord" or the "true Self". Since we live "in Middle Earth" & find ourselves "in media res" (in the middle of things), there is work to do. Power comes, not necessarily all at once, but in a series of revelations. As the Western Tradition teaches, God "respects" free will – we have to side with Him, or else the Asuras will bind us in service to Anti-Christ, under the dominion of a sunken Lucifer and an exalted Ahriman, the unholy Trinity.

This teaching even enters the popular imagination, in unexpected ways: in *Star Wars*, the line is given – "No... there is another." This is

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Labours_of_Hercules

Luke's "sister" (who, of course, seems more like a bride, at first), with whom the Force is strong. The Self has "another Self", & also serves the "Self Beyond the Self".

Hercules is given tasks – he has to attain heaven by storm. Yes, he is already Hercules, who as an infant, strangled the serpents in his crib. Yet, still, there is combat, storm, warfare. As Isaac Watts penned in the hymn, "shall we look to go to heaven, on flowery beds of ease?". However, it may be closer than we think, if we ride the storm.

His first task is to slay the Nemean Lion². King David had to slay a lion, it is worthy to note.

The Fathers mention, in the *Philokalia*, several means of slaying demons. Some of the demons can be scorned or ridiculed, & cannot bear focused attention on themselves, & so the basic posture of "awareness", even letting the mind wander, to see where it goes, can bring fire upon their heads & cause them to flee.

Which demon are we dealing with, here? The demon can change into a wounded damsel in distress, luring men into her cave, & then devouring them. Since most men's sins revolve around sexual desire, we should naturally begin to examine this area of our lives? How & why & when are we tempted? In what manner?

The Biblical writers start the sequence with "the lust of the flesh (and the pride of life)" – and this is the first temptation of the wilderness, to desire earthly food rather than God's Word. Women, for men, represent an appetite and a need, & it is not too much to say that, for most men, they could not live without woman, and that much if not all of their Ego is bound up in psycho-sexual desire for the woman.

Even in popular culture, it is apparent³ that the "outsider" status & rough wanderings in the wilderness produces, not the Alpha Male,

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nemean_lion

³<http://alphagameplan.blogspot.com/2011/03/socio-sexual-hierarchy.html>

but the Sigma male, who is capable of attracting a beautiful consort, but in many senses, does not “need” or “use” her. This freedom from the woman, inner and outer, is a necessary prelude to true spiritual potency. Hence the medieval ideal of celibacy. If this appetite can be mastered, then one can engage the Nemean Lion. (Note, I am not endorsing, absolutely, these categories, but pointing out primarily that the rigid worship of “Alpha” status by males is misplaced, even as I acknowledge that their virtues are necessary, & could be redeemed. It is they who “set the tone” of society, & they are likely to be of a latent warrior class, who are “masterless samurais”).

Scupoli advises the seeker to treat the lower chakra as a “burning fire” and to flee even the physical proximity of beautiful women, even women who are “family” or “friends”. Since this is all but impossible today, the initiate must be even stronger. He must know, with absolute certitude, that the gravitational pull of beautiful women is a reflection of an inner illusion which must be absolutely put down, with all the ruthlessness of the Roman generals who sowed Carthage with salt. *Carthago delenda est*, was the founding of the “Pax Romana”.

This does not disparage woman. Rather, it creates true freedom. What real man & father would ever experience real temptation toward their own flesh and blood? None, if the man is healthy. Even so, the healthy initiate, in spirit, must view all woman, even the most desirable, as someone he must sweep the veil of sexual illusion from, in order to see properly, at all. Paradoxically, this will make him more more attractive to woman, & invite further assault, for which he must be prepared, as a most cunning general. In ancient Christian tradition, the “necessary lie” was even advocated (eg., I am sick, I am mourning, etc.). Part of what drives the Kali Yuga is the misplaced sexual turmoil of alpha & beta males (and to a lesser degree, everyone else’s failure to not see through the illusion).

I would encourage all the men who read these articles to do whatever it takes to master the tiger of lust, absolutely. It will look differently, in

various types and conditions. Chaste marriage to one woman is a form of celibacy, if exalted and properly nurtured. It absolutely constrains the sexual desire *in all but one area*, & eventually, in modified form, even that area. The details & circumstances will vary.

The mingling of races and flesh is inevitable in some ways, to some degrees, but in our time, it is actually the new Ideal. The initiate who comes to slay the Lion can take no part in this delusion, regardless of the consequences, personally. He has come to slay the Lion, not to sleep with the Demon. St. Benedict threw himself into thorns and brambles in order to master his lust. What have you done?

The power of the Holy Spirit that resides in the sexual chakra is typically the last center to be mastered by the initiate. It often remains, undisciplined, to the final breath. Along with pride, it is perhaps the most dangerous weakness of men (or women, for that matter). Man's creative organic power that resides there was meant to issue in the mouth in a word of power that commands and creates a new world (the mouth is the lower third of the head, and corresponds to the waist). It cannot do this if a man gives himself up to Lust, under the guise of "riding the Tiger", not perceiving that the meaning is twisted.

The foundation of asceticism is a denial of the need to quench our thirst for the female in anything other than God's sanction and God's time (which may be after our deaths, and not in the literal "physical way"). It also cannot be accomplished without an invocation to Zeus (made explicit in the story of the Nemean lion, in which a sacrifice to Zeus is involved in the bargain). A higher desire is required to cast out the lower one, to make room for the action of God.

This is the foundation of power. This is Rome, who resisted "Eastern luxury", Phoenician materialism, & the violent turbulence of the unprepared Northern tribes.. Rome, in the power of Ahriman (at that time, not overly exalted), held the line and upheld the true *virtus*. Hercules is a warrior and a priest, at once.

Issac the Syrian actually explains how this process of “mortifying the flesh” works:

The effect of the cross is twofold; the duality of its nature divides it into two parts, **One consists in enduring sorrows of the flesh which are brought about by the action of the excitable part of the soul, and this part is called activity.** The *other part lies in the finer workings of the mind and in divine meditation, as well as in attending to prayer, etc.; it is accomplished by means of the desiring part of the soul and is called contemplation. The part of the soul by dint of its zeal, while the second part is the activity of soulful love, in other words, natural desire, which enlightens the rational part of the soul.* Every man who, before perfectly mastering the first part, switches to the second, attracted out of weakness—to say nothing of laziness, is overtaken by God’s wrath because he did not first mortify his members which are upon the earth (Col. 3:5). In other words, he did not cure his thoughts of infirmities by patiently bearing the cross, but rather dared in his mind to envision the glory of the cross.

Word 55

It is evident from these words of Isaac the Syrian that what we call prelest proper exists when a man starts trying to live above his capabilities. Without having cleansed himself of passions, he strives for a life of contemplation and dreams of the delights of spiritual grace. Thus the wrath of God befalls a man; because he thinks too highly of himself, God’s grace is withdrawn from him and he falls under the influence of the evil one who actively begins to tickle his vainglory with lofty contemplation and spiritual delights...⁴

⁴Source: <http://www.roca.org/0A/66-68/66n.htm>

St Theophan offers even more detail:

In the soul we find three powers: the intellect, the will, the heart, or, as the Holy Fathers say, the intellectual, desiring and incensive powers. Each of them is assigned particular curative exercises by the holy ascetics. These related exercises are both receptive and conducive to grace. They need not be contrived according to some theory, but rather chosen from tested ascetic labors particularly suited to a given power.

ST. THEOPHAN THE RECLUSE, *The Path To Salvation*

Our wayward, random thoughts are “women” which attract the identification of Self: we chase them, they then transform into a demon, and “slay” us, by drawing us into illusions. It can be a long time before Hercules ever makes it out of the cave.

Posted on 2013-08-09 by Logres

* * *

August on 2013-08-10 at 07:31 said:

A good article Logres.

Regarding the management of sexual energy, where it is not a question of controlled release through marriage or similar, there are diverse methods. Some involve exercises that open up the sexual centres, in a process that changes the normal polarity of sexual energy, turning it inward and harnessing its power to generate and sustain one's inner self, and this is not mere 'sublimation' in the Freudian sense. Normally the energy seeks to flow outward and drive animal reproduction, or otherwise dissipate. Such processes can be rather dangerous for the untrained practitioner; consider how the ego is tossed around by normal levels of sexual stimulation, and imagine the strength required to resist very concentrated and strong charges of the same, directed inward. But these methods are very effective if mastered, they act even on the physical level.

Other ways involve blocking off or abandoning the lower centres, and this probably occurs in ascesis that begins on the psychological plane and tries to find a way beyond, ignoring and

mortifying the flesh to silence its impulses. Sometimes the psychophysical substratum is ordered, sometimes merely restrained, with greater or lesser success.

A particular set of crises that might emerge on the path of sexual abstinence are the emotional complexes, particularly acute in the feminised men of today, many of whom are penetrated by obscure wounds that manifest as excessively sentimental and intimate tendencies, coupled with lack of inner form, which will begin to fester after the conscious mind decides to restrain its sexuality, even though, or perhaps because, the aspirant is affirming virility and strength through such an action. Most of this confusion originates in the mess of today's chaotic collective psychic and social atmosphere, which influences the formation of the individual. In any case, how one fares against these attacks is an important test, and the comments of Isaac the Syrian that you've quoted above are pertinent.

It must also be said that before the integration of the ego is accomplished, (good, quality) sex is important. It is one of the most potent activities that man can experience, and in those with proper capacity, it should bring to the surface elements of being that are deeper and more substantial than his unintegrated individuality, thus activating the need to be and prove oneself. This is the 'rupture of levels' that Evola discusses in RTT, in this same context. It tends to occur somewhere beyond the crossfire of today's opposing sexual factions; those distorters who see nothing beyond the 'animal ideal' and coarse physicality, and the sad reactions of that new caste of slovenly tattooed barbarian, the champion of ugliness.

The real man, who has laboured and attained more or less complete freedom from sexuality, may either set aside sex, or indulge as he sees fit.

Ash on 2013-08-11 at 03:32 said:

The question is, what do we mean by "freedom from sexuality"? Allowing for variance between the castes, Traditional teaching appears to dictate that this means being able to enjoy the legitimate union (say, a man and his lover) to its fullest extent without becoming enslaved or addicted to it. I read in a Muslim work on the matter of temptation, the title of which I forget, that it is considered as sinful to reject any pleasure given by God as it is to indulge what is haram. Evola writes in *Revolt* that the work of Tradition is to create channels for our chaotic currents to flow in the right direction, rather than the total elimination of those currents.

Writing from the Shia tradition, the Iranian Ali Shariati states it thus: "However, with man being the battlefield, God and Satan are at war with each other. Thus, unlike former religions, the duality in Islam consists of worshiping two deities which exist in the constitution of man rather than in nature. Nature has a single deity and is under the dominance of only one God. This is why in Islam Satan is not standing against God but against the divine half of man. And since man is a two-dimensional creature who is kneaded of mud and God, he is in need of both. His ideology, religion, life, and civilization must all be capable of satisfying both of these dimensions. The tragedy is that history does not bear witness to this fact."

Having struggled with this aspect of self-mastery, I would recommend that the tactic of laughing at the demon may be the one to pursue. The power of the sexual drive is difficult enough to master without us multiplying its strength by allowing it to weigh upon us like a milestone. Reflecting on childhood, it is far more effective to mock the ridiculous state of being controlled by it than to amplify its power by giving it the attraction of forbidden pleasure.

Cologero on 2013-08-11 at 10:18 said:

August, regarding the “real man” that you mention, who presumably has transcended desire and is ruled by his intellect: under what circumstances, do you suppose, would he “see fit” to “indulge”?

Gabriel on 2013-08-11 at 16:27 said:

Step 15 of the Ladder of Divine Ascent by St. John Climacus is relevant.

“We have heard from that raving mistress gluttony, who has just spoken, that her offspring is war against bodily chastity. And this is not surprising, since our ancient forefather Adam teaches us this too. For if he had not been overcome by his stomach, he would not have known what a wife was (2). This is why those who keep the first commandment do not fall into the second transgression. And they continue to be children of Adam without knowing what Adam was. But they are made a little lower than the angels (in being subject to death.) And this is to prevent evil from becoming immortal.”

(2) i.e. he would have lived with her as with a sister.

“He is pure who expels love with love and who has extinguished the material fire by the immaterial fire.” 15:2

“He who fights this adversary (lust) by bodily hardship and sweat is like one who has tied his foe with a string. But he who opposes him by temperance, sleeplessness, and vigil is like one who puts on a yoke on him. He who opposes him by humility, freedom from irritability, and thirst is like one who has killed his enemy and hidden him in the sand. And by sand, I mean humility, because it produces no fodder for the passions, but is mere earth and ashes.” 15:12

“A fox pretends to be asleep, and the body and demons pretend to be chaste; the former in order to deceive a bird, and the latter in order to destroy a soul.” 15:16

“He who has resolved to contend with his flesh and conquer it himself struggles in vain. For unless the Lord destroys the house of the flesh and builds the house of the soul, the person who wants to destroy it watches and fasts in vain.” 15:25

“And our merciless foe, the teacher of fornication, says that our man-befriending God is very merciful towards this passion, since it is a natural one. But if we observe the guile of the demons, we shall find that, after sin has been committed, they say that God is a just and inexorable Judge.” They said the former in order to lead us into sin, and now the latter to drown us in despair.”

"All demons try to darken our mind, and then they suggest what they like. For as long as the mind does not shut its eyes, we shall not be robbed of our treasure. But the demon of fornication tries to do this much more than all the rest. Often, after darkening out mind which governs us, it urges and disposes us in the presence of people to do what only those who are out of their mind do. Then later, when the mind becomes sober, we are ashamed of our unholy acts, words, and gestures, not only before those who saw us but also before ourselves, and we are amazed at our previous blindness. Often as a result of reflection, men has desisted this evil." 15:83

Gabriel on 2013-08-11 at 21:43 said:

Since Adam and Eve married and had sexual relations after the fall, wouldn't the highest path still be to live as chaste, without marriage? Isn't this the path for the those "not of this world". Cologero wrote of this website "We write for those who are both able and willing to abandon the contemporary world." I see the contemporary world as the world after the fall.

The Apostle Paul says in I Corinthians "He that is unmarried careth for the things that belong to the Lord, how he may please the Lord: But he that is married careth for the things that are of the world, how he may please his wife. There is difference also between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman careth for the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit: but she that is married careth for the things of the world, how she may please her husband" (7:32-34). Marriage seems to be the lesser path, but acceptable. Earlier in the same chapter St. Paul writes "For I would that all men were even as I myself. But every man hath his proper gift of God, one after this manner, and another after that. I say therefore to the unmarried and widows, It is good for them if they abide even as I. But if they cannot contain, let them marry: for it is better to marry than to burn" (7:7-9).

Any ideas on what an "exalted and properly nurtured" chaste marriage would like? Fasting during fasts, raising children, not departing, etc? It seems like a fine line, how do you discern not having lust for your own wife, who is one in flesh with you? Even for those married or unmarried, how do you discern whether you chastely looking and conversing with a woman and lusting after a woman? How do you discern whether you are in this boat: "Women, for men, represent an appetite and a need, & it is not too much to say that, for most men, they could not live without woman, and that much if not all of their Ego is bound up in psycho-sexual desire for the woman." Could not even chastity be done out of pride for the sake of women?

One last point. Many Church Fathers bring up that if there would have been no fall, God would have populated the earth in a way different than sexual reproduction. Elder Thaddeus brings this up in *Our Thoughts Determine Our Lives*, Pg 126

"We live in families with out parents, brothers, and sisters and yet we are unsatisfied, we feel lonely and each one of us is burdened with his own cares. We want to leave our families and be with someone else; we long to cleave to that other person and spend our lives with him or her. God, when He created Adam, said that it is not good for man to be alone, and so He

created a companion for him. Adam and Eve were one in the eyes of God.

But everything went wrong after the Fall. The Lord said “Be fruitful and multiply, and replenish the earth (Gen 1:28). We do not know how reproduction would have taken place if man had not fallen. The earth was to have been filled with people (1).”

(1) According to St. Athanasius the Great (commentary on the Psalms 50:5), Gregory of Nyssa (On the Making of Man 17), John Chrysostom (On Virginity 14-15), Maximus Confessor (Ambiguum 41), John Damascene (Exact Exposition on the Orthodox Faith 4.24) and Symeon of Thessaloniki (On the Sacraments 38), if man had not fallen, God would have employed a means of increasing the human race other than sexual reproduction.

Logres on 2013-08-12 at 06:35 said:

Gabriel, it can be a process, for most people: first of all, I agree that focusing on chastity can actually be a means of undermining it (which is why St Paul sanctioned marriage). “It is better, etc., etc.”. If one lives with one’s wife as if she was the “polar being”, then (some have said), in some way, this will be given to you in eternity – here is a possible means of avoiding the “hell” of Dante’s lovers, but it runs by the edge of hell? It is clear, that in sex “usually”, the man “loses to the woman”. If (however) the marriage is consecrated, & the woman is submissive (as the KJV term is used), then, because of the “one flesh”, the man has a chance to not lose spiritually – therefore, it could be said that he loses, but it will be returned to him – he will find himself again. I think this requires great love and holiness on both sides (although it might exist at first in a germinal form). Marriage, then, was a holy gamble. One way might be to realize it as a “loss”, but to focus on the love that lays down its life – in this way, at least, the male can de-identify with the lower urges, both by higher charity, & marshalling of energy to sustain or undergo the “loss”. The point would be to avoid the usual “casual” or pleasure-aspect of sex being uppermost, which is the default, and at least not to lie to one’s self.

August on 2013-08-12 at 09:25 said:

Cologero, I say it depends upon the man and the extent of his realisation.

Though not being subject to inherent desire, he might meet a woman whose privation seeks to make of him an axis, and if the conditions for deep attraction are sufficiently met, he could assume the role of male and consummate the bond. The woman would have brought desire into his presence, and he wills its assumption instead of letting it, and her, pass on. Such an act should not affect his deepest centre, which ought to remain steady if it is truly integral, and the dissolutive power of real women can be a great test of the extent to which this centre is established and capable of exercising control over peripheral elements of the man.

A properly qualified woman could also benefit in such a case, though I’m not sure she’d want to.

At the point where all relevant peripheral elements are totally disciplined and under spiritual control vis-a-vis sex, there is perhaps no longer anything for the man to gain from coupling; even the finest woman seems too coarse and clunky in comparison with the internal feminine. Except of course for social/family purposes, where appropriate.

Gabriel on 2013-08-12 at 12:05 said:

Thank you for the answer Logres, that did bring clarity to me.

What you are proposing seems to be walking a very thin line August. I will stick with St. John Climacus for now.

"Let us, by every means in our power, avoid either seeing or hearing of that fruit which we have vowed not to taste. For it is absurd to think ourselves stronger than the Prophet David; that is impossible." 15:65 (2 Kgs. 11)

August on 2013-08-12 at 21:33 said:

Yes, Gabriel, as thin as a razor's edge.

Logres on 2013-08-13 at 15:05 said:

The Christian attitude to sex (at its best – that is, in the meditation of those who truly know love/Love), has nothing to do with fear of the female or disgust at bodily functions : it has a great deal to do with distrust of thoughts "as they appear" to us, and are taken by the Ego. There are different methods or techniques, not to mention sacraments (eg., marriage), that have been articulated to sublimate and transform these thoughts. If Christianity has been uniquely (although not solely) responsible for sacralizing marriage, how is it that one can admit freely and without reserve the thought that it is repressive towards sex? Marriage was designed to affirm the naturalness of heterosexual relations, and also affirm chastity within that bond, not to mention providing for the attainment of "polarity", both through the intensity of the bond, and its "eternal" nature in this life. Indeed, in previous ages, people attained a species of moral exaltation in honoring vows which were unwisely taken. It was "affirmation through negation", which is a hallmark of Christian spirituality, generally. Don't confuse the corruption of the Ideal (indeed, what Ideal cannot be corrupted?), with its real perfection.

"I am not me." The narrow way is the broad path. That is the power of Hercules. I speak not here of other powers or other ways, which lead through this cave, as well, in the end. What is "to master sex" other than to achieve exactly what the sacrament of marriage achieves? I do not see the difficulty. Some will walk a different path, but (almost by definition), it cannot be the Ideal, except in a very special sense that does not translate well to other individuals. If I affirm that HO & August are right, or can be in the path of the Spirit's wind (which I am inclined to do), does it follow that the lessons of the cave of Hercules (which the Desert Fathers set out to map & master) are not the High Path? I am firmly convicted that the true romance of the

path of Christ has been sung as of yet, in but bits and pieces : the mountain of the martyrs is surrounded by swords of paradise, and is crowned with a flame.

Logres on 2013-08-13 at 15:50 said:

If you want to use Game-speak to phrase the task of counter-revolutionaries in our time, you might say that the Sigma male embodies some of the transformative possibilities available for young men in our time, in that the Sigma is capable of transforming himself and the world, rather than being conformed (which even, in our time) the Alpha most definitely is. The goal of a just order would be to ruled and guided by transformative Alphas, rather than degenerate ones. The stars turn.

Paulo on 2013-08-15 at 21:00 said:

In the opinion of all of you, which type of expectations should we have toward women? I still don't have clear in my mind, what can I expect from them! And how about misogyny, are you all free from she?

Logres on 2013-08-16 at 10:44 said:

You should expect, from one particular woman, that she will be your "Other Self" that symbolizes and makes real the "Self Beyond the Self" : whether she is literally so, or not (and this One does exist), if you treat her as such, she will become so virtually, & will serve the purposes of reunion with this One. Other women, a handful, are compatible, or suitable, but are not this One, & are meant more as sister-figures. The rest of women, you should be dead to, & their allure is nothing more than biology masquerading as an illusion. Transcendent woman embodies the divine to man. Mouravieff calls this your "polar being". She is associated with the guardian angel that you have.

Paulo on 2013-08-16 at 13:13 said:

Logres

And how about discovering the inner women who gonna complete me? Don't you think this is one possibility? So you really believe in "twin souls", is that it? Is not polygamy the rule for us men, or this is just some modern western conditioning? And my final and most important question is, which type of psychological trait should I have, to be successful with women, dispassionate, gentle, fearful ect? Please answer me all these questions?

kid on 2013-08-16 at 17:06 said:

man, logres that all sounds pretty mushy. you don't think marriage is best as a political or economic arrangement between estates or something, rather than some perfect union of two souls or whatever? I always imagined the latter idea of love to be something created in the last

few hundred years where before people just got together with their neighbor at 15 and stuck with them forever because they had to.

Logres on 2013-08-16 at 21:41 said:

Marriage can be karma yoga – which is why Cologero spoke about the “son of duty” : you can’t advance on your way, until you train (& this often means fathering and raising) your replacement. So, yes, it’s not necessary to dig too deeply into a practical marriage, and it can yield particularly bad results, when subverted (witness the modern ideal of “romance”, pornographized by both males & females, in their own way). Which of course produces a reaction, also very bad. I am speaking about what the Church aimed at in sacralizing it, not what it often happens or has to be; there are many “practical” marriages that were turned into romances by adherence to simple duty, over the years, which is a different story. We are assuming someone is already “prepared” to seek their other.

Paulo, it’s difficult to give advice that is this personal. What do you mean by “successful”? I would think benevolent detachment towards women is probably ideal, although this can be the WORST attitude if it falls into currying favor with females as some kind of religion. I think in older days, people were just more honest – if you had to visit a house of ill-repute, you chalked it up to your own weakness, and went on. Today, men & women play a big game, in which the Ego becomes attached. If a man wants a drink of water & needs it, he takes it; the problem is, it is more complicated when the drink is another human being (St. Paul said “they are one flesh”). It’s not biological repulsion that guided the Church thinking on the subject, but a knowledge that connections were set up between individuals when they shared this together. Do you want to share karma with a total stranger you find hot? Many men do, & you are also connected to them. So that is why detachment is useful – how can you see what is happening if you buy into the game? BTW, not buying into the game (understood properly) seems to make you more attractive to women, not less. An unexpected side benefit, I suppose.

Paulo on 2013-08-16 at 22:46 said:

What i mean by successful is to be THE MAN of the relationship,being able to control one self and to control the women in the most hard situations.What do you mean by”I would think benevolent detachment towards women is probably ideal, although this can be the WORST attitude if it falls into currying favor with females as some kind of religion.”?And”not buying into the game (understood properly).”?

Logres on 2013-08-16 at 23:22 said:

Paulo, we shall continue on (your) thread in the Forum, so that we don’t clutter the comments, and can have a more lengthy discussion...

5.2 Labors of Hercules, Part 2

The story continues⁵: Hercules has an adversary, Eurystheus, who is the current king and holds regnum over Hercules' territory. Now, in the esoteric Christian tradition, Satan is not our "enemy", but our "adversary" – there is a subtle, but distinct difference (Alain Benoist has come to the conclusion that the USA is an adversary, but not an enemy of Europe – I'll let you draw your own conclusions). The adversary wishes to joust with Hercules, & so he assigns him twelve labors. Hercules, having conquered his passions and mastered his thoughts, now becomes a serious contender. He, further, draws the ire of Hera, that champion of the eternal Feminine, who will test all men, & who fashions the Hydra specifically to destroy the Hero. The adversaries are many of the spiritual combatant. Demons will lay specific traps, not for men in general, but for YOU specifically. They know your weaknesses, perhaps better than yourself. This is why the first adversary is the man's Ego or mind – detaching himself from his "stream of consciousness", he begins to examine thoughts. Who am I, really? I am not Me.

Hercules will be tempted to play to his Alpha strength – sheer power. The power of the man, the virile, masculine, war-making instinct, which levies eternal defiance to heaven and earth, if need be. As that old Scottish reaver⁶ told Queen Elizabeth, "What is there, that a man will not dare?" Indeed, the power of man is great: witness the captive English hero who was invited to duel to the death in front of the Spanish court. Hercules, like the Englishmen amid his foes, will have to choose wisely⁷: Peeke ended up killing one Spaniard, gravely wounding a third, and driving his

⁵http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lernaean_Hydra

⁶http://books.google.com/books?id=JZYLAQAAIAAJ&pg=PA555&lpg=PA555&dq=redcloak+ballad&source=bl&ots=cCnQdzDt7h&sig=TVjb42Epzx_JHuQIg9SBeHccTqo&hl=en&sa=X&ei=N9oKUsWiCMa02gWdi4DYBA&ved=0CCKQ6AEwADgK#v=onepage&q=redcloak%20ballad&f=false

⁷http://ejmas.com/jwma/articles/2001/jwmaart_docherty_0501.htm

rapier-wielding Alpha foes from the ring. He was set free, with honors. Or, as Robert Jordan wrote:

Hammar moved to stand beside Galad, still groaning on the ground and trying to push himself up. The warder raised his voice to shout, "Who was the greatest blademaster of all time?" From the throats of dozens of students came a massed bellow. "Jearom, Gaidin!" "Yes!" Hammar shouted, turning to make sure all heard. "During his lifetime, Jearom fought over ten thousand times, in battle and single combat. He was defeated once. By a farmer with a quarterstaff! Remember that. Remember what you just saw. During his lifetime, the greatest blademaster fought over ten thousand times, in battle and single combat. He was defeated once. By a farmer with a quarterstaff! Remember that."

In this combat, Satan can be viewed as an honorable but cunning adversary – the test can be passed, if wisdom is added to power. Since Hercules will need wisdom, his kinsman Ioalus will provide it (or the gods themselves).

Hercules covers his mouth and nose, symbolically giving precedence to the eyes. He is no one-eyed monster who cannot distinguish good versus evil, but watchful and alert. He approaches the den of the Hydra, and awakens it with flaming arrows, which show that the hero is aware that he will need to draw the beast forth, rather than climbing down into its hole, like Beowulf, after the dragon.

Like a true man, he begins combat, but finds that for every head of the Hydra he severs, two grow back. This shows that fasting, prayer, and mortification of any kind are inferior to watchfulness. They only awaken the passions: they draw it forth. A man who has fasted learns that he is made of carbon, water, and other base materials. If he relies solely upon his own strength, his combat will fail.

His kinsman has the idea of supporting his combat by burning the heads. The aid of other men in spiritual combat is great, indeed. While

Hercules concentrates on destroying each head, Ioalus sears the stumps. In an alternate telling, Hercules uses the blood of the Hydra to sear the stumps. This is why the innocent who refuse to undertake combat are inferior to the man who fights – only he who fights can take the blood of demons and use them to cauterize the wounds of the monster. Additionally, further “shocks” are necessary than individual effort – by the law of Three (discussed in Gurdjieff/Ousepensky’s systems), man requires the aid of group and cultural effort to sustain him over the natural gaps in his own line of spiritual effort. They fill in the critical gap (see Psalm 73⁸), allowing the awe and wonder of external comradeship carry a man over the desert of his own failure, which is innate. Even Hercules requires this help. Even Hercules has to have a town to defend, or ruined temples to haunt, or just assistance. Lone voices only attract wolves, unless a man is born in the mystery of the just, in which case, he will find himself constituting both a Church, a Culture, and a State. This is not a self-elected position – others will confirm this for you. Until that time, it’s safe to assume otherwise (if you’re wrong, angels will show up to reason with your modesty).

After his hard-won victory over the multitude of the Passions (Satan’s deputies to handle his petty work), Hercules buries the head of the Hydra in a sacred place on the royal road, dedicated to Zeus. The victorious soldier gives credit to St. Michael & the host (or whatever name they assume in your mythology). This is additionally a good idea, because this enemy is not the last that Hercules will undertake – it always helps to have the odds and the gods on your side, or better, that you are on theirs.

The assault on hell (and the storming of heaven) is not the work of a moment, nor that of the drifting cowboy. It also entails the risk of making enemies which may succeed in turning you into a martyr: if you are constitutionally opposed to self-sacrifice in all instants, then you are not

⁸<http://www.bartleby.com/108/19/73.html>

ready to be recruited for the Legion⁹, & it will be difficult to rise (although it does sometimes happen). Even outsiders have to have a “meteoric rise” if they come in & eclipse the “regulars”. In this sense, the Christian path is not “one path of many”, but indeed the only way such things could happen, in any case. How else can God overturn Hell, but from the inside out? Will there not be casualties? Dangers? Risks? Of course there must be. Christ came as a lamb, because He knew this was the way to become the Lion.

At the level of the Church, the Hydra is heresy and error, which leads to apostasy. At the level of Society, the Hydra is ideology or ersatz religion, which always threatens to whelm organic growth. One might say, the “anti-State”, in our day. The Hydra is a cancer, and it devours all that it feasts upon. Passions, heresy (Hyper-Calvinism tweaked)¹⁰, the mega-State... ..they offer us, at first, escape from our individuality and personhood, our discipline. They offer to initiate us in the multiplicity of delusion.

A prophecy¹¹ of the era of “new men without chests”:

Almost as a postscript to the heavenly warning issued at Fatima in 1917, Saint Maximilian Kolbe, two years later, reviewed the three Great Evils of the latter times, noting: “In 1517, the Protestants rebelled against the Church; in 1717, the Freemasons rebelled against Christ; and, in 1917, the Communists rebelled against God.” In a single sentence the Polish martyr had exposed common origin and natural succession of each of these Apocalyptic nightmares.

There is a story about Clement Maria Hofbauer, how he went into a bar to beg for money for his orphans, & a clientele spit into his face.

⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iron_Guard

¹⁰<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2007/06/ultracalvinist-hypothesis-in.html>

¹¹<http://www.catholicism.org/clement-maria-hofbauer.html>

He said to all there, “That was for me. Now what about for my boys?” Needless to say, a man like this leaves the bar with the money he came to find. I doubt if he spoke with any fear, lack of dignity, or craven Semitic bearing. And somewhere, in heaven, his angels slew several legions of demons, in honor of his conduct. Is this really degenerate spirituality? You want that man heading the Church, or someone very much like him.

Now I would ask those who are consciously “not-Christian” (many for very sound reasons) to please consider this appeal carefully. Obviously, you cannot acquiesce in what is without honor, that is true. So the appeal is to honor – where is the assault falling today? **Even if Christianity is the “vehicle” for the Kali Yuga, & destined to be transformed into something else, the rear guard is where the fighting is at:** over the fallen altars, at the throne. Sure, martyrdom is a possibility, physical or otherwise, yet, isn’t this what the path of honor smiles upon? The new age will be determined by the blood spilled at the crux of combat: regardless of Christianity, it is spiritual blood that will seed the future. Sacrifice is a Christian-Semitic principle only in the sense that it was given high-articulation within those vehicles. The Ideal is true. It may need altering, or qualification, or balancing, but Christianity apprehended something in Tradition that was true, *regardless*.

When the Franks where whelmed at the mountain passes, Roland¹² was given the honor of leading the stubborn & doomed rear-guard action. Today, the clueless conservatives¹³ are leading an ineffectual rear-guard action, and there is no intellectual order. *What else do we need today other than the men who are not welcome in the Church to insist upon being in it?* It is not only an option to request service in the rear-guard, *but is in fact a high honor*, almost a duty to request a post there (even if denied). Chivalry, Western high culture, was merely the high and strong and noble

¹²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Song_of_Roland

¹³http://www.chiltonwilliamson.com/articles/wwtw_leftist_rage_conservative_hate.html

apprehension of Truth, accentuated by the vehicles used to attain it, colored by the nationalities and souls involved, articulated in the languages and thoughts of those who served.

It is this Truth that we serve, all of it, no one part at the expense of the other, and I cannot forget what happened in the deserts of Thebaid, when the passions were tamed by the wild monastic fathers, & the fruit was grown and reaped in the great “Romance” that swept over the barbarian tribes.

Posted on 2013-08-16 by Logres

* * *

Michael on 2013-08-17 at 20:08 said:

Powerful post Logres. It doesn't take too much discernment to see that the assault is falling primarily on Christianity. When is the last time you heard a New Atheist attack Islam? And it is one Christian communion in particular that bears the brunt of the attack – the Catholic Church – and I don't mean the SSPX.

I know that many readers here don't think there is enough of tradition left in the Catholic Church to be worth joining and defending her. But the forces of the counter-initiation seem to think differently.

John Curley on 2013-08-18 at 02:03 said:

Probably one of the most compelling arguments I've ever read for the conversion to Traditional Christianity.

Doug on 2013-08-18 at 11:53 said:

It is indeed an excellent post. We should remember that “Assuredly, I say to you, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a little child will by no means enter it.” The ascetic discipline of choosing(or being chosen by it in sphynx-like fashion-see Coomaraswamy) the path will go far to aid the aspirant if he is capable of slaying the several heads of the Hydra (the illusion of separate paths). That Orthodox Christianity is the current example of the Fullness of Truth(that is, every viable path is contained within it) should be apparent by the specific and focused attacks of the Adversary who recognizes a legitimate target when he sees it. The path of honor is clear. Those who are willfully negligent through a polemical view of pseudo-Christianity

given to them by a Radical Secular culture are guilty, as I was at one time, of a rejection of a hard truth that is not in accord with second-function life.

David on 2013-08-18 at 11:56 said:

I will present some observation on the subject of Herakles that may or may not be in direct link with what you already wrote. I had written those observations down to take them up eventually to write an article. As Logres already did (and did it well), I will only expose some of the information here.

Herakles is a «mute» character; that is, he doesn't partake in a major form of greek writing by himself (that is, tragedy, comedy, etc.). For this reason, he was genuinely taken up by the philosophers, the warriors, the Christians, etc. as a representation of positive value. Beyond comparison (which are very interesting) between Thor and Herakles, or Gilgamesh and Herakles, there is some interesting feature to shed light on, as Evola already did.

One of the main themes that are associated with Herakles, especially in the Christian world is that of his meditation on the fight between Virtue and Desire. As Logres already explored, there is an ascetic form displayed by the various fights of Herakles reminiscent of a more ancient Tradition.

As hinted by Logres and developed in other texts, Christianity can be seen as a warrior religion. It is not to diminish Christianity to a purely warrior religion, but rather to see in Jesus Christ a Royal Principle that both transcends the priestly and warrior class. At moments, he embodies both of them perfectly. There is even some comparison that could be drawn between the figure of Herakles and Jesus Christ. Also, the use of exterior (godly) help by Herakles is a theme dear to Christians : we cannot do everything by ourselves, we need Divine Love/Help.

Dumézil pointed out that Herakles was a foundation and representation of the second indo-european function, that is, the warrior. In his passing of his weapons, he made sure that there was a line, a tradition per se of the warrior ethos and spirit.

To Evola, Herakles is a pure principle of the warrior class. He links to several other interesting ideas linked with Herakles or heroes in general :

- The Female (as mystical power of life married or conquered) as the source of regal power (i.e. Heracles and the Tree); see also the tree of the World in general linked with heroes of Order
- The Hero representing cosmic principle of Order winning over the Chaos (on which I will return shortly when discussing the twelve labors) sometimes for the gods, sometimes even with the gods.
- The Hero as founding figure of a tradition (mysteries, initiatic order)
- Rig Veda states that the sacrifice/rite was performed by a «virile hero». The ascetic and the Hero (Warrior) as representation of spiritual virility.
- Hyperborea hidden from the earth (only opened to heroes such as Herakles)
- Heroes may attain a state similar to that of the Primordial Age

The twelve labors are twelve civilizing labors. They bear witness of the primordial principle of Order against Chaos. The hero, that is Herakles, becomes the channel through which the Order can unite itself with the world to sanctify it. The Indo-Europeans in general were a civilizing people, bringing social order with them (class/caste). It is therefore fitting that one of the most recognizable hero of the Greco-Roman mythology is civilization in itself. There is an ambiguity in Herakles reminiscent of the very principle of civilization and warriorship : there is a facinans and a tremendum, a fascination and a fear toward Herakles. He is able to chain Chaos and bring Order, yet at the same time, he channels both of them in himself and finally he transcends both of them (i.e. his ascension to godhood).

To the stoic, Herakles was one of the first of them. His acting through detachment, for the greater good of the cosmos, through sheer will and representation of the Will was for them a clear exposition of the doctrine. As we already spoke of the Virtue contra Desire theme, we will not return on it, but it is quite fitting. He was also seen by some as a proto-philosopher (as in Socrates description of the philosopher).

There is also a possibility of more profound meditation on Herakles journey through greek mythology and philosophy. First of all, there is a human part in Herakles (that is, an animal part) that makes him demi-human (touched by eros and thumos) : in eros he rapes Aule, indulge in gluttonery, etc. and in thumos he kill his teacher out of rage, commit act of violence, etc. Yet at the same time, those things do not control his life; they are subordinated to the Self. In this he regain his demi-God part, performing deeds fitting a warrior-philosopher, ultimately that of a King (being divinized), in killing lawless monsters, founding cities, civilizing (through execution of religious rites), etc.

As he is a human-god, he is also a god-human, that is, a divine being. We already hinted to this in his participation of the Principle of Order and his acting as a warrior-philosopher-king. But more than that, he is, in some version of the story, elevated as a god himself, and married to Hebe, goddess of youth: therefore Orderly Power is linked with Life and Youth.

There would also be some important things to look between the link existing with Herakles and the initiatic mysteries of Elysium. But that will be for someone else to think about and work upon. Evola talked a bit about the resurrection and afterlife of Heroes in «Revolt» p.49-50.

michel on 2013-08-21 at 13:13 said:

"You got the sharks on the left and the snakes on the right, and anything you do they wanna get a little bite, it really doesn't matter if you're wrong or if you're right coz, once they get their teeth in, NOTHING REALLY FIGHTS!"

5.3 The Labors of Hercules, Part 3

The Third Test, The Ceryneian Hind For the third labor¹⁴, Hercules was given a retrieval task instead of a slaying to accomplish. Since Hercules could not be overcome with guile & brute force, it was hoped that he could be made to trespass against a god, & have divine fury invoked upon him. Specifically, Eurystheus hoped that this labor would infuriate Artemis, who would presumably give him the terrible fate that Pentheus¹⁵ met with on the Holy Mountain. The hind, additionally, traveled faster than an arrow. How was it to be supposed that Hercules could conquer both the speed of flight & the jealousy of the female Huntress?

Since deer did not inhabit Greece, this myth carries an echo of Northern Lands. The white or golden stag is not merely a supernatural symbol, but a regal one. Hercules sees the deers antlers' glinting very far off, & begins the chase, which lasts (some say) an entire year, possibly in the Hyperborean north. At last, either by a ruse or skill of the arrow (possibly shooting one between its legs to trip it, or by using a net) or by direct permission of Artemis herself (who sides with the rugged and manly hero), Hercules comes into possession of the golden deer, *on the promise that he will return it to Artemis when he is done*.

When he brings it to Eurystheus, who intends to keep the deer, Hercules wisely lets the deer go seconds before delivering it up – the deer slips away, & the mighty Herc shrugs it off: “You aren’t fast enough.”

Hercules proves himself a man of honor in this task, as he does not slay or injure the deer, but returns it as promised to its rightful owner. Here we should note that, in esoteric action, as in any other portion of Life, there are laws that obtain. Although those who travel in the astral realm encounter far fewer laws than we do, there are strictures that (for all that) may be even more indurate than gravity. One of these, according

¹⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ceryneian_Hind

¹⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pentheus>

to *Gnosis* (Mouravieff) is that a man cannot advance in practice unless he trains or leaves behind a replacement. Karma is another law that obtains; repentance can mitigate or erase it, but still, there is something that holds true & fast – in this case, another bears your sins. Or who did you think paid your trespass?

I say this to encourage readers to not set up a dichotomy in their mind between royal liberation and the lesser mysteries. Not until one is set free from Time & Space itself does one become “free of all Law”, not even if one is “awakened” fully into the etheric, astral, and spiritual realms. Besides, the dichotomy itself is deadening. If one is truly free, is one not silent? Hercules is careful to observe piety and honor; it is not forced, out of fear: he speaks and converses with Artemis almost as an equal, as a better, but someone he may speak before, and she grants him favor in her eyes. There is one equal to, and worthy of, capturing the devoted and precious hind. It is the pious warrior, who nevertheless speaks with “Frankness” before the very gods. St. Paul spoke of this when he said, “all things are lawful, not all things are useful”.

Hercules is wise enough to insult and belittle his enemy; after all, if one doesn’t add a little salt to the wound, who is going to arrange the rest of the tests? Such a jibe befits the warrior. It is the jibe of the Russian general Kutuzov to the French prisoners of Napoleon’s army, after he has magnanimously spoken of forgiveness. Rallying his own troops, he says to them: “But after all, who asked them to come here, anyway?”. It is Frederick the Great shouting out to his fleeing men, “*Ihr wolt, ewige leben?!*” It is Brennus before the conquered Romans, speaking very simply back to them something that would become their own watchword-*Vae Victis*. Forgiveness and detachment are the rocks on which the raging sea breaks, and falls, dashing those who ride it. There should be a kind of sacrosanct danger about sinning against a truly pious man; when defers his own judgement and wrath, the wicked should tremble. Archangel Michael, no doubt in a very great wroth and sorely tempted to pass his

bounds, declared to Satan's impudence, "May the Lord judge between us!". The wrath of the righteous, the fury of the hero¹⁶, the anger of the good man¹⁷ pushed too far, should resolve into that ritual and controlled resistance, a detached willingness to see it through bitterly, without bitterness, which heaps coals of fire upon the head of those who take the part of Satan. This is how the enigma of forgiveness & resistance is resolved – in the action of the hero, who must understand both. Could he not forgive, he could not formalize his actions and discipline them to undergo a trial, but would simply "rage out" and go for the throat of his persecutor. Could he not resist, he would forever remain under their feet. This tension drives the warrior, like a bow drives the arrow. To those who cannot see the union of this, they are either not warriors, or do not see that "the insanity of God is greater than the wisdom of man" (Plato).

Guided by the wisdom of a Solomon, forgiveness and power are inseparable. Are not detachment and passion reconciled by the warrior? When someone loses their temper and lashes out in anger and injustice against you, the ability to bear the stroke without retributive ire in the same manner is actually an esoteric technique for transferring the energy they are losing to yourself. This is the secret meaning of "heaping coals of fire" upon their head – a person who gives in to the "wrath of man" loses enormous reserves of spiritual energy : especially if some physical scapegoating occurs, those energies often go to the victim, rightfully. Received in the right frame of mind, they become available as a "lost talent". This is why God invites the "poor" of the world to his banquet : the rich folk turned him down. Their loss, our gain. If Christianity is the religion of the Kali Yuga, do not therefore conceive that it is bound to share its inadequacies: it is made to triumph over the greatest enemy, the last enemy, to devour it inside out.

If it wasn't the Kali Yuga, we wouldn't be here, reading and talking

¹⁶<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ggFKLxAQBbc>

¹⁷<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9C1CMR58LV8>

to each other to determine the fate of the new world. Other, better men would be leading. “The better man” in the end is just the one who does more things that are difficult for him – if that is the test, it is a blessed time to be alive. He who plants a garden in the Kali Yuga, against all odds, stands above he who conquers worlds, with some odds in his favor.

“The last shall be first — greater are those who have not seen, yet believed.”

Hercules triumphs by his ruse, his skill, his polity, his innate dignity as a true man, before man, beast, or gods. He is not to be deterred or thwarted. Nor will he stoop, except to make a well-earned jibe to further incite his opponent to useful wrath.

He doesn’t show off the street and demand to be Hercules. He IS Hercules, by virtue and dint of a long process, created in heaven, ratified in the mud of earth. He has conquered mental fog and the physical passions. He has risen above those things which men almost never even begin to subdue. He is already heads and shoulders above all men, and even though, as a god, he could use his liberty and peerage, he does not. “Not counting himself to be equal to God, he humbled himself...” Hercules prefigures the gracious and valiant and terrible true knight Jesus, who is far from the lamentable and tragic figure some neo-pagans think him to be. Hercules is the new Sun¹⁸. So, in this third test which seems not so deadly because it was so successful, Hercules wins the affection and protection of Artemis; he is effectively adopted. The gods themselves are beginning to take sides. Heaven is being moved by earth. Hercules has swayed an eternal-feminine power to his side, and a mighty one at that, Artemis-Diana of the Hunt. It is a wild and primeval power that is now declared for the hero, who has presumed nothing, but has simply stood as a man ought to stand. As Hercules’ divinity grows more obvious, the divinities who favor him, and yet remain worshiped and honored by him, begin to light up. It is as if they are lights which come alive and

¹⁸<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gEaa9oAwT5U>

shine upon the hero, cutting his contours out of the dark, healing and supporting him. He grows greater, as he makes the gods greater than he. Further, he grows greater than the gods. In the eternal moment at the end of time, when Christ delivers the kingdom of God back to the hands of the Father, the eternal warrior announces the end of all things and annihilates the worlds with the breath of the Father. This is how the warrior becomes God: with the gesture of the true man, who yields fealty, forever indominant, to the rightful and original Lord. This makes Him the destroyer of worlds, for it is this act which is the deeper magic. Our world does not understand or accept this: that is why “the wisdom of the world is foolishness with God”. If Evil cannot stand in the days of mercy, how shall it stand in the hour of judgement, which comes? What will Eurystheus do? He is running out of labors. Hercules is proving a difficult adversary. Satan himself may have to enter the lists, as there is a “man worth killing”¹⁹.

Illustration:

Berlin, Neues Museum Herkules besiegt die goldbekrönte Hirschkuh (Herkules fängt die Hirschkuh von Ceryneia) Maler: Adolf Schmidt

Posted on 2013-08-24 by Logres

* * *

Michel on 2013-08-25 at 12:38 said:

“We swim against the rising waves, and crash against the shore, your body bends until it breaks, the early morning sings no more.

So rest your head its time to sleep, and dream of what’s in store, your body bends until it breaks, and sings again no more, coz time has torn the flesh away, the early morning sings no more.”

¹⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ELoFRrUrcYQ>

5.4 Labors of Hercules, Part 4

The Erymanthian Boar²⁰

Hercules had been given the (originally) ten labors as a penance for letting Hera drive him to wrath, in which he slew his six sons. So don't let anyone tell you that penance is a "Catholic" thing. All of the labors center around a primordial world of monsters that will be rededicated to the sun-God Apollo, or to Zeus, from whom the power to cleanse & purify this region of the world comes.

Hercules originally received the wrath of Hera because he was the illegitimate son of Zeus and Alcmene. He is half-born, a godling, immortal by birth right, but not in actuality. Hera is one of the daughters of Chronos, but also a wife to Zeus. Hera represents an older form of matriarchal worship connected with earth rites and the underworld (like Demeter) that is incorporated into the male & solar spirit of the "new gods" of Greece. Her typical function is rage against Zeus' consorts and love affairs. We can view Hera as a suppressed kind of female power that tends to take vengeance on the half-god offspring of Zeus' spirit mingling (like the wind) with mere mortals. Not only is he creating a race that is superior to those who worship Hera, the warrior and martial ethos threatens the earlier balance. As such, Hera is ambiguous. She is both a reminder that the Greeks "breathed their truth through lies" in the new myths (a fact Clement of Alexandria alludes to), and also a principle of retardation: there is no "going back" to the earlier stage.

We have to view this evolution from a solar perspective. On the one hand, the revolt of the warriors against the priests heralded a new Dark Age. On the other, man never rises except by suffering. As the ancients would say "he suffers into Truth". Hera is fighting a lost cause. The forces of chaos have penetrated the ancient ordering of the castes, turning each against the others. Corruption begins with the priests, who compromise

²⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Erymanthian_Boar

(out of fear) with the warrior caste, which is ascendent. *The priests should suffer like Prometheus to bring them into a proper order.* They lash out with curses and penances, after the betrayal of their compromise, which they should never have agreed to (we see the underground Occult engaged in such a struggle today). An analogous event occurred in the West, in which the Frankish nobility went over to the Revolution through decadence and compromise, with the priests like Abbe Sieyes courting natural nobles such as Mirabeau, who of course caters to the third estate, who will later flirt with the masses. Garibaldi and his ilk (natural *aristoi*) become leaders of “Revolution”. *As Cologero has written, we can see in these modern events Time greatly sped up, during the Kali Yuga, for our own edification, if we could but read aright. It is no accident that the natural dramatic flair of the French was interested in Classical themes!*

Some men, like Hercules, will rise to the challenge, and prove themselves, redeeming the turbulence of the purely horizontal swirl of the world-snake Ourobous into a vertical ascent. Evolution always operates: the snake writhes and awaits the champion to bend it to a will. Even today, our genetic structures are engaged in such programming²¹; they await men capable of rising, like eagles on a vertical lift of heated wind, up into the heavens. This ascension has to involve Christian “ideas” (not necessarily formally) *as it is only through sacrifice of some sort that the necessary purity is invoked. Even in Hercules’ time, penance is necessary.* That is why Hera is still important – the solar spirit embraces Fate, suffers into Truth, and guides it upward. The true man sees in the Modern World an immense potential opportunity, and begins the ascent, without for all that, endorsing the degeneracy he finds around him. Hera represents the Karma of past sins, in this case, “sins of the Father”.

Hera is “the adversary”: not an enemy per se, but someone (who for the strong man) is fulfilling a purpose & role. Without the consent of

²¹<http://www.koanicsoul.com/blog/2013/06/16/edward-snowden-a-tru-e-neanderthal-shivs-the-melonhead-nwo/>

Hera, Hercules cannot be deified (as we shall see). It is her job to test the hero, and although she is insufficient to initiate solar truth, she has the power to test it.

The great boar is tracked through the snow, driven over the mountain ranges by Hercules, who descends upon it relentlessly, driving it before him. Chiron the centaur had advised him to track it in the snow. Hercules is now succeeding more easily in his labors, and the boar proves “easy” to track down. The hero is gaining more power.

What is interesting is the tale of the centaurs. While visiting Pholus during the hunt, Hercules desires wine, and convinces Pholus to open the one vessel he has, a gift from Dionysius. The centaurs do not know how to drink moderately, and end up becoming drunk and attacking Hercules, who drives them off with arrows. Chiron is hit, and the pain it causes this immortal makes him volunteer to replace Prometheus on the mountain, being tortured by the eagle. Hercules shoots the eagle, to deliver Chiron. This teaches us that Hercules is receiving the immortality which Chiron was unable to utilize properly. The drunken man-beast who tragically frees Prometheus is imbuing the rising hero with his powers.

Hercules has already conquered the passions, so he is worthy to drink of Dionysius’ wine, and can easily disperse the dangers arising thereby. His arrows, dipped in the Hydra’s blood, are more than equal to chastening the centaurs, who are wise up to a point, but unruly.

There is only so much immortality floating around at one point of time. Those who misuse this gift (their talents) will have it given to someone else more worthy. This should be an encouragement to everyone who is a spiritual seeker. When you see the powerful and ignorant, or the mighty and the evil, squandering their gifts, you should know that these will become available to you, if they continue to defy the deathless and immortal source of these divine blessings. “The meek inherit the earth”. This is taught explicitly in the Psalms, and endorsed in the Beatitudes and apostolic teaching. “Run the race, as if to win”. When someone re-

leases their anger unjustly upon you, a right response will not only help them, it will put their lost energy at your disposal. Behind the “meekness” of the Christian tradition is hidden an ancient teaching concerning the accumulation of power. When Saint Peter crosses himself in the presence of the emperor Nero, causing Simon Magus to fall from the sky (Magus was demonstrating the power of his magic), the lost energy will go to Saint Peter. This happens with Cyprian the Mage & Justiana²², as well (cited by Tomberg in *Meditations*).

Since we are discussing magic at Gornahoor, it would be helpful to meditate on how to make it as powerful as possible: counter-intuitively, it would seem that purity is that which renders it deeper and whiter magic. This purity takes different guises, but purity it is, nonetheless, & necessary to avoid the trap indicated by Dante, who places Simon Magus in hell. “To whom much is given, much is required.”

The tale ends humorously: the Greeks loved to depict the scene in which Hercules presents the boar to the tyrant, only to have him hide inside of a large vase. These endings are further vindication of Hercules’ divine authority and power, and an important “unmasking” of the powers-that-be: they are unequal to even receive the gift of Hercules, which they asked for.

The legend of Hercules remains a beautiful re-telling of what was good in the pre-Olympian world, a transmuting of it through the might of Hercules into something even higher and even better. Something similar occurred in the West, and one can discern the operations of Christianity on the classical ideals in much the same manner. In each case, the essence or import is preserved, but the eagle makes another turn in the gyre of the circle, and achieves greater altitude. Like the hero, it rises, on steady wings and a strong upward draft. For an instance of this, see Matthew Arnold’s essay on Maurice du Guerin’s tale of the centaurs²³.

²²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cyprian_and_Justina

²³<https://books.google.com/books?id=B0Y-AAAAIAAJ&pg=PA64&lpg=PA64>

Hercules represents the new warrior, the best of that breed, who dare to will a union of warrior-priest, in order to achieve immortality. One might say that a warrior is potentially an aspirant priest: if he succeeds, if he navigates the divine-demonic world successfully, he discharges his penance (against which and with which he fights), achieving the essence of immortality. Later on, in the West, this baptized chivalric ideal would be made more explicit in the body of the king²⁴. The loss of the primordial world, its descent into chaos, has to be *redeemed*, through the storming of heaven. If Christianity had not existed, it would have had to be invented. For those willing to undertake a similar labor, modern Christianity has its primordial monsters and jealous and offended goddesses which are willing to oblige you, in standing the test.

Posted on 2013-08-30 by Logres

* * *

William on 2013-09-30 at 08:08 said:

"When someone releases their anger unjustly upon you, a right response will not only help them, it will put their lost energy at your disposal." Is there anyplace where one can read further about the idea of transmuting negative energy directed at oneself? (As opposed to simply withstanding it.) Thanx!

scardanelli on 2013-09-30 at 09:33 said:

William,

Mouravieff discusses this in his Gnosis series, and I assume that Ouspensky and Gurdjieff do as well, though I have never read the later. I think it's mentioned in the third Gnosis book, though I don't have them in front of me. Logres can probably go into more detail, but from my

&dq=centaurs+matthew+arnold+guerin&source=bl&ots=y2r8ffCQmx&sig=xp9Sua44p905PKqht9IeYGycVW8&hl=en&sa=X&ei=gqcgUpmnKam_sATF24GgCg&ved=0CCwQ6AEwAA#v=onepage&q=centaurs%20matthew%20arnold%20guerin&f=false

²⁴<http://www.libraryofsocialscience.com/ideologies/docs/the-kings-two-bodies/index.html>

understanding, when one remains conscious and aware and doesn't react to negative emotions but stays firmly within the realm of silence (or magnetic center in Mouravieff's terms), one doesn't expend energy in mechanical reaction but absorbs the other's output of energy in a feeling of freedom and love. It has been a little while since I read Mouravieff though, so perhaps others could correct any of my misunderstandings.

5.5 Hercules' Sixth Task: The Stympthalian Birds

Hercules now advances²⁵ to the sphere of war. Openly, now, following the altruistic stooping to help the needy and the "folk", Hercules comes bearing arms against the wicked. It is almost as if Hercules has doubly earned the right to tilt in combat, through having served as a squire to the filthy stables.

Mastering physical nature, he now is capable of turning his hands to subtle enemies, the enemies and spirits of the aether. He is being anointed to wage war against the very worst and most violent of such enemies. Having conquered the "birds" inside of him through humility and ingenuity and sheer sense, they are now available "outside" of him, clearly differentiated, as "enemies". The earlier labors were against the "adversary", whose job is to be the primary enemy and "train" the hero. The lion and the hydra were more primal threats to Hercules, roaring monsters who reflected the devouring urges of the Ego, expressed through sex and innumerable physical wants. These birds are exteriorized as "lesser" demons, but have less obvious uses for the hero. They are more like parasites, and so are more pestilential. They have no "sacred" use. They are simply a scourge, by their sheer numbers and vicious actions. If the lion and the hydra represented focused spiritual dangers close to the heart of the hero, these birds obviously incarnate the "*asuras*" — the "birds

²⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stymphalian_Birds

of the air” that pick up seeds that might otherwise sprout and flower in the hearts of the people. They are what most people think of when they speak the word “demon”. They are on no account easily confused with the “daemon”: by contrast, a lion or hydra or boar might be mistaken, in a state of spiritual confusion, for one’s own daemon, or guiding angel.

Hercules brings war against the *asuras* — the man of Tradition does not mistake Lucifer for Satan, or Satan for the lesser imps. He sees chaos, and recognizes it for what it is. Likewise, he is clear-sighted enough to see that these creatures will not provide him with anything other than war and sport. He is the falcon, they are the quarry. *There will be no “cloak” or “blood” that he obtains from contact with these beings, who are simply negative energy that needs to be banished from the “center” (I say the center, because all creatures have a “place”).* A great part of the confusion, even in the ranks of Tradition, stems from being unable to differentiate a bird from a lion. Indulging in drugs, practicing sex magic with random partners, and vociferously attacking the outer world indiscriminately with Leftist rage is a state that results from not having commenced in the proper order, and subdued the “inner lion” and the many-headed snake inside of one’s self, first.

It is the chronic condition of the basic, inner, true Leftist. They are simply incapable of recognizing their own faults and basic condition, often on any level. When they do attempt this, they reduce every human being (presumably excluding themselves) to a cynical level of animal drives and primal urges. This is because they experience their own Self at this level, and so are incapable of imagining the existence of anything else in another being. This is the “lowest common denominator”, by which they shift responsibility for their faults on to some kind of Deistic clock-work Creator, who made everyone equally worthless and mechanical/animal. The New Right runs afoul of this when they think that making everything more “white” would protect the West. It would, in an imaginary Leftist universe; unfortunately, the “lion” in the camp is actually a white

lion, since the spearhead of anti-Tradition has a white face. Far better to work for a restoration of noble bloodlines and families, regardless of their “color”, regardless of political “status”. The longer this is put off, the less white such an inevitable Restoration would be. The answer is to stop thinking about skin color *per se*, and to seek spiritual excellence in conformity with antique European Tradition, whose roots lie in Classicism, Egypt, and older worlds still. This would be the political equivalent of the First Labor.

By the Sixth Labor, we see the emergence of a new balance²⁶: Life, properly itself, and manifest properly in Justice, emerges, as a perfect blending out of a perfect blending ($2+3 = 5$, but $2 \times 3 = 6$).. There is, in this Labor, as in the Hexad, something totally perfect and complete. The Sixth Labor shows the hero as he finally will be — easily defeating dreadful adversaries, who are really no more than really obnoxious and odious predators, swiftly falling and fleeing before the “Strong Man”. In the labor of the Pentad, Hercules attains perfection by uniting the two numbers that “are not 1”, through addition: this leads to “Life” – the folk hero willing to clean the stables, who has ample strength and pluck to easily fix a huge, stinking mess. In the labor of Hexad, this is multiplied and amplified into the spiritual sphere — because he is “Robin Hood”, therefore, he can also be the “one true Englishman” to the crown. He can defeat the imps.

The Sixth Labor is associated with Sagittarius in the Zodiac. After conquering Sin in Scorpio, the hero must master the power of right action and thought. He passes from triumph over the serpent, to mastery of insight. Thus, Hercules sees an easy and swift way to achieve victory over the birds, rather than killing each one laboriously. He sounds the cymbals, and drives them in droves and flocks to the air, killing many directly or indirectly. The rest flee.

²⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5808>

These fly against those who come to hunt them, wounding and killing them with their beaks. All armor of bronze or iron that men wear is pierced by the birds; but if they weave a garment of thick cork, the beaks of the Stymphalian birds are caught in the cork garment... These birds are of the size of a crane, and are like the ibis, but their beaks are more powerful, and not crooked like that of the ibis.

PAUSANIAS, *Description of Greece*, 8.22.5

In Scripture, wild birds living in desolate places symbolize the *asuras* – the lesser demons and imps. Hercules is coming into his own, like an invincible hero who runs the course of the Sun. After defeating internal enemies, he is fit to “manifest” in the physical world as Life/Justice, then Perfection/Beauty, in this labor and the last.

Hercules, like the falcon of the tower or the hawk of the fist, has been trained in partnership as an “equal” to the gods, and is now set loose upon his quarry²⁷. His instincts are purified, and he now wages war.

Posted on 2013-09-27 by Logres

5.6 Hercules' Seventh Triumph

As I have argued, Hercules has decisively “come into his own”: he has achieved the unstated goal of the classical *polis*, which was to become an *Aristotelian unequal*. He is not yet equal to gods, but he no longer lives under mortal law, because he has suffered its stroke, and lived (which is the only way to transcend it). He has passed through the difficult time of his hero saga. In any heroic legend, there are moments, particularly early on, when the hero is set upon by all seemingly legitimate forces. In

²⁷<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hdo0VnsJSxo>

doing so, these forces either illegitimate themselves, or show themselves to have been (in fact) illegitimate from the beginning anyway: they “fall away” before the great individuality.

Traditionalists should never forget that King Arthur, King Alfred²⁸, Robin Hood, and any other number of folk heroes, saints, and strong men were initially persecuted, not merely or even especially by the wicked, but by their “own”. They are inevitably portrayed as a “wolf’s head”, painted as demons or villains, and an attempt is made to exterminate them in the name of all that is sacred. Often, this attempt actually succeeds, and gives us legends of martyrs (at best) or legends of villains (at worst). Thus, the entire nation of Germany (for example) occupies the dubious position of being an arch-villain in the modern narrative, in which Kaisers and Barons and tool mechanics from the Wehrmacht fare no better than Hitler himself. The modern world has spent enormous spiritual energy probing the “dark side” of the nobility of Old Europe.

How many movies²⁹ have given us the stereotypical aristocrat who is bent on murdering and pillaging and oppressing those unlucky enough to fall under his aegis? Until an equivalent effort is made to diagnose and bring to light the even more hideous brutalities of the mob during the modern era (does anyone even count the number of automobile accidents on the roads against the “age of the Machine”?) we will not be remotely out of the woods. And there is a disadvantage — the educated classical liberals were well-equipped spiritually and intellectually to critique their predecessors, whereas we are much less able to critique the enormities that have emerged in the modern age of the Mass.

So Traditionalists should expect to encounter massive reserves of energy that will attempt to blindly preserve their grip on power. This is one of the reasons I warned in one of my posts against violating General Law in an indiscriminate way: the mindset of an era represents a spiritual en-

²⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alfred_the_Great

²⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QpDEMKuzixc>

ergy (however degenerate and blind) which is guaranteed to activate and suppress dissidence of any kind. We should be more adept at “reading the times and seasons”, and knowing what can be accomplished, and how it should be done. A great many people will make the mistake of becoming Don Quixotes, and end up being battered by windmills. It will not be easy, quick, or safe to extricate mankind from the spiritual darkness it has fallen into, over two centuries or more, in the West. Hercules started out as an underdog, with the gods against him, the nobility of the time actively seeking his death, and the common people (no doubt) simply channeling their basic desire to “witch-hunt” into the approved mode³⁰. Interested readers might wish to consult the subject of Ponerology³¹ for a closer look at this dynamic. In any case, in order to be a hero, you have to be willing to be painted (if the need arises) as a villain, perhaps even by those closest to you, not for the sake of the black hat, but out of a clear apprehension of what is right. Read King David’s Psalms, for instance, for more examples.

You must be willing to stand against the world, like Athanasius, if you wish to overcome it. Indeed, how could it be otherwise? In our time, the one position that is guaranteed to be a challenge to “all-comers” is the position of antique Europeanism, in the chivalric Christian tradition. It will infuriate almost anyone, for (indeed), we have all been very subtly programmed against it, given antidotes and immunization shots to prevent “catching it”, and taught in the very bosoms of our Churches that such a world should have never existed (at best) or even did not exist (at worst). Go and stand in some of the older Churches³² of Europe or North America. The pictures of the monks or founders or patrons tell a

³⁰<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2013/09/technology-communism-and-brown-scare.html>

³¹<http://www.amazon.com/Political-Ponerology-Science-Adjusted-Purposes/dp/1897244258>

³²<http://www.urlaube.info/en/Wien/Kirchen.html>

very different story from the bleak world we are taught that they inhabited. Read an older and sympathetic novel or biography of that period – something irrevocable has been publicly lost from that period. The clear look, the firm jaw, the clean heart – they are gone from our consciousness. They are submerged.

It is to restore such that Hercules comes. Not to achieve immortality directly, but to right what is wrong, and to spill sweat, tears, toil, and blood. Will he come unopposed and welcomed as a hero? He comes tasked with labors, and against the “odds and the gods”, against heaven and earth. Not everyone has to be a public Hercules, but everyone has a dragon or two in his circle that needs a-killin’. Rest assured, the dragon knows your name, and will exploit this. How else can evil exist, except to stay in the dark, and how else can evil have union, except in the dark? And who does not have dark within them? This will be an arduous progression.

For the seventh labor, Hercules is sent against the Cretan Bull. It is tearing up vineyards and terrorizing the island. When Martin Luther reared his head in the wolds of Germany, the pope noticed and said “a wild boar is loose in God’s vineyard”. We do not know all of what Luther had to reckon with, only that his coming marked the end of a unified Western world³³. When the Reformation was finished, the age of Atheism and Liberalism began³⁴. It may seem harsh to say this, and there are no doubt many things to salvage from Northern European spirituality, but Luther left Europe in rags and flames.

Interestingly enough, Hercules submits the bull of Crete in a stranglehold, refusing to kill it, instead sending it back to his royal tormentor, who wishes to offer it to Hera as a sacrifice. Hera declines to do this, and is offended, so the bull is shipped off somewhere else, and ends up being

³³<http://www.amazon.com/Three-Reformers-Luther-Descartes-Rousseau/dp/0804610800>

³⁴<http://www.righthandpath.org/the-church-and-the-common-mind/>

sacrificed to Athena and Apollo. Hercules has restored the natural order of things, the Logos, since Athena (wisdom) and Apollo (war/arts) are higher divinities than the jealous Hera, who is obsessed eternally (much like a feminist) with ancient and perceived wrongs and injustices that can never possibly be “righted” except by making more suffering *now*.

The bull is associated with animal-instincts and drives. Not only was Crete known in Biblical times as a lustful and lazy island, but the bull itself wreaked a moral havoc on the order of the island:

Minos himself, in order to prove his claim to the throne, had promised the sea-god Poseidon that he would sacrifice whatever the god sent him from the sea. Poseidon sent a bull, but Minos thought it was too beautiful to kill, and so he sacrificed another bull. Poseidon was furious with Minos for breaking his promise. In his anger, he made the bull rampage all over Crete, and caused Minos' wife Pasiphae to fall in love with the animal. As a result, Pasiphae gave birth to the Minotaur, a monster with the head of a bull and the body of a man. Minos had to shut up this beast in the Labyrinth, a huge maze underneath the palace, and every year he fed it prisoners from Athens.

The broken promises and moral decay had birthed the Minotaur, a beast which would also have to be slain by another hero. But that is another story. And here is a goodly lesson — it is better not to vow, than to vow, and not pay. If we fight with monsters, the only way to not become one is to keep one's vows. This relates not merely to not using the dark arts (for one is already pledged to what is noble and high) but also to wisely watching one's actions, not thinking more highly of Self than one ought. Some monsters are other people's property — it is their destiny to slay them, and they are chosen to do so. If you wish to aid, aid them — do not usurp their rightful place as slayer of the beast. Slay your own beasts. The restoration of a proper moral Order in the thoughts and hearts of those who oppose the modern temper and spirit is the *sine qua non* of

Victory, since the Victory comes from above, vertically, just as initiation does.

Becoming Captain Ahab or Don Quixote will not do anyone much good. We should be looking around for the chosen ones, all the while, doing all we can to make sure we can hear the still, small voice ourselves, for God will surely call each of us to some labor of Hercules, big or small. In short, the restoration of Order will come in a divine web or hierarchy of spiritual intervention, with the sacred hero-priest-king as the focal point. Squabbling and in-fighting are trademarks of the Left, what thieves and criminals do when they have despoiled someone and are dividing the loot. A man of the Right stands for the invisible and absolute order which he alone discerns, and suffers to make visible. The unveiling of this invisible web, through each one of us, will annihilate the plots of darkness, but it has to be (as the old preacher used to put it) “all of grace” or “of God”. Here we see that Christianity still has a mission for the “New Right” – until something greater than it is found (and how could that happen, without victory?), victory will require a re-harmonization between Christian Tradition and the remnants of the West. *This will be resisted on all sides, and itself proves that it is the salient point.*

It is entirely possible that Hercules could have died or failed, in which case, he would be portrayed as a massive freak and fraud. This risk will have to be born up under, but born up under wisely, and strongly, and with the best possible chance of success. This is the path of the strong — not to fight invincibly and surely, but to triumph over a multitude of doubts and anguish and sins within, and to win through (if God wills) against a greater multitude of such externally, to a doubtful and dark destiny, under the shade of the laurel and the oak and perhaps the cypress. Invincibility is coming, but for now, is not yet.

One of the greatest strengths and services and preparations for this is to read the exploits of the past and to “right the wrong” of the ances-

tors. Look at the Iron Guard³⁵, for example, and their fate. How could they have failed? Most men are simply unwilling to risk a similar fate, or even honor their memory, and so they conform in their thoughts. The man of the Right pays respect and honor to his ancestors, which means learning their stories and “righting the wrong” in his heart, both by avoiding their mistakes and faults, but also by re-baptizing their memory and burnishing it till it shines brightly. Only thus, in the path of the Past, can we expect to find blessing for the dangerous Future, and strength for the present. This will be unappealing to the immense majority of men, who are depressed by such efforts, and cling to a hope for a brighter future through democracy, chemistry, and modern organization. They are often more decent, more intelligent, and more accomplished than many who see the beauty of the Past for today. There are many emoluments, amenities, graces, and goods that accrue to those who forsake this fight, however reluctantly and with whatever good intentions. Others will mock the futility of the “martyrs”, and use it as an occasion to desert the men of honor from the past.

Nevertheless, after all, Zeus will be vindicated, and He is not mocked. Who will wear his laurel leaves? He who struggles to the end.

There are compensations. After each labor, you get to see Eurystheus hiding in his *piloi*, and hear Hera cackling with rankled and wounded pride. Zeus will send his compliments, secretly. Those who have suffered will acclaim you as their local hero. You will be allowed the noble and theatrical gesture of *noblesse oblige*³⁶. After all, who asked them to anoint themselves as god of this world? Who asked them to invade the past and obliterate it?

But the Consul's³⁷ brow was sad, and the Consul's
speech was low,

³⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Iron_Guard

³⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Noblesse_oblige

³⁷http://ancienthistory.about.com/library/bl/bl_horatiuspoem.htm

And darkly looked he at the wall, and darkly at the
foe.

“Their van will be upon us before the bridge goes
down;
And if they once might win the bridge, what hope
to save the town?”

Then out spoke brave Horatius³⁸, the Captain of the
Gate:

“To every man upon this earth, death cometh soon
or late;
And how can man die better than facing fearful odds,

For the ashes of his fathers, and the temples of his
Gods,

And for the tender mother who dandled him to rest,

And for the wife who nurses his baby at her breast,
And for the holy maidens who feed the eternal flame,

To save them from false Sextus, that wrought the
deed of shame?

A man like that might make a difference, no matter what may come. That is why creating a spiritual *elite* (nobility) is the first task of the Counter-Revolution. Those who wish for adventure, to see brave deeds and to truly live, will be drawn to their course, and will uncover the stone of their destiny, which may be dark or bright, victorious or defeated, but which will be uniquely their own, with their own name written upon it³⁹.

³⁸<http://ancienthistory.about.com/od/romanfamousfigures/g/Horatius.htm>

³⁹<http://biblehub.com/revelation/2-17.htm>

And this stone is part of the final victorious Temple, so that the death of a Byrhtnoth⁴⁰ is still triumphant.

Let me sum it up to be crystal clear — the Hero will fight wisely, not beating the air, with the best chance of success, but he will also fight nobly, not avoiding an inevitable or symbolic death if the situation calls for such. God is able to equally deliver him, in either way, either before or after his physical demise or failure.

Hercules' seventh triumph is a public act of wrestling the immorality and violence of an entire island to its knees, and sending the trophy as a taunt and a gift to his persecutors. The death of the bull, sacrificed to two war gods of wisdom and the fine arts, founds an era of moral stability, which the slayer of the Minotaur will lengthen and perpetuate. He is almost invincible, and is now acting almost openly on behalf of Zeus.

Could a determined alliance between a remnant Church and honorable pagans (who understand the divine mission of Christianity) wrestle the bull to its knees, in the tradition of Mithras, and of the Christ of Revelation? If enough men advance through the Labors, it will be a real possibility. Perhaps there is a man out there, reading this, who has within him both the Church and Valhalla, and will embody this possibility.

Posted on 2013-10-18 by Logres

* * *

William on 2013-10-19 at 12:06 said:

"One of the greatest strengths and services and preparations for this is to read the exploits of the past ..."

Can you suggest a resource or three? Thanx!

JA on 2013-10-19 at 12:45 said:

I am ready.

⁴⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Battle_of_Maldon

Logres on 2013-10-19 at 18:04 said:

William, part of the problem is “teaching too soon, learning too late” (Rosenstock-Huessy). This is a huge problem in Western modern education, generally speaking, and has lead to the current difficulty with “elites” who are only functionally so, in a shallow sense. Practically any good biography of a “man of Tradition” (or an auto-biography) from the last century or two will provide fodder for the young or old man who is attempting to advance. One thing it does it help us “go back” to the cross-roads and take the right path. Or, failing that, realize what was missed, and therefore, what extra labor must be undergone now to compensate for it. That is, there are some lessons of wisdom that have to be passed in the proper order to make spiritual advance, and studying the lives of the past helps fill in the blanks in modern psychology, deepening and widening and raising the standard. It also falls into the category of “honoring your ancestors”. So we have to bring “soul” back into the endeavor. In the past, Plutarch’s “Lives” was the standard place to start. Or, read someone’s letters (such as Tolkien’s or Coomaraswamy’s, as Cologero has suggested). Evola’s autobiography is “Path of Cinnabar”. Tomberg’s Meditations is a spiritual autobiography in a disguised form. Even when I was ignorant of Traditionalism, Martyn-Lloyd Jones (a Welsh preacher) had a good biography from Banner of Truth, which helped me. You can also read Epictetus’ maxims, or perhaps Aurelius’ Meditations. There is no “going wrong” if you choose carefully and with enough mindfulness. The goal is to enter into their Mind, which is Logos (more or less). Of course, the biography of Christ is contained in the Gospels, and is argued to be also “auto-biographical” (God’s account of his earthly Incarnation).

William on 2013-10-20 at 10:42 said:

Thanks for the suggestions, Logres. I’ve already read about 1/3 of your suggestions. For what it’s worth, I make part of my living as a composer, and lately I have been powerfully drawn to J.S.Bach – not to imitate his style of composition or to have his music playing all day, but he was powerfully committed to the sacred craft of music – more so than anyone else I know. What was his mindset? Etc. Trying to ‘get under his skin’ a little has been very enlightening. Plutarch’s Lives has been on my list of ‘I need to read this someday’ but per your suggestion I’m thinking ‘someday’ needs to be ‘order it now!’ :-)

JA on 2013-10-20 at 13:41 said:

I’d suggest, for practical purposes, if a man wants to be of the elite of the west, to really have the knowledge that an truly educated westerner did have in the past, he should begin by learning Latin. It’s nice to read authors in translation but our ancestors only read Roman authors in the original. I’m working on Latin right now; Latin was the common language of Eternal pagan and Catholic Rome. afterwards he can try Greek.... I’d say in reading, stay away from modern (post-1800 or so) literature, immerse yourself in the classics of Greece, Rome and the Middle Ages.

and... ..at the same time we need to train our bodies. I'm trying to find or devise an entirely western based programme of martial arts for myself, based on chivalry. most of us cant do training on horseback but there should be enough resources to get our bodies fit for the fight.

Thorsten on 2013-10-20 at 14:12 said:

JA,

If you haven't heard of them already ARMA (<http://www.youtube.com/user/theARMAonline>) has made great strides in reconstructing renaissance-era and late medieval martial arts. Most of it is limited to armed combat though, with lesser attention to unarmed Kampfringen ("combat grappling"). There are one or two Polish groups (E.G. Fechtschule Gdansk <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H7aXtzf7-Lk>) that appear to be pretty earnest. Russian Sambo and Systema would be more much more applicable to modernity, but as I understand it it is unclear how much of these martial arts are truly European in origin. However as the reconstructors of historical European martial arts have made clear there are only so many ways to disarm, throw, or kill a man so the most comprehensive fighting arts always end up closely resembling one another no matter where they originate.

Logres on 2013-10-20 at 20:20 said:

William, don't leave out Nicholas Gomez Davila:

<http://don-colacho.blogspot.com/>

Easily scanned, as if Nietzsche had been a Christian. He has the rare talent of summarizing complex ideas in aphorisms, as if he was a Frenchman.

I haven't read Plutarch's Lives, but I have made a habit of repairing to antique texts as antidotes, and things are considerably safer when experimenting with a known quantity that the medievals and ancients also appreciated. Hard to see going wrong, on that one.

I would also suggest the study of falconry as something appropriate for the warrior class – since that question was broached before about a year and a half ago. If you want something now, start planting seeds that will be NOW one day. Hector Paulus Mair is a big name in Western martial arts, in the ARMA revival. The quarterstaff, by the way, is an often overlooked "martial arts" weapon.

Logres on 2013-10-20 at 20:21 said:

William, what (as a composer) do you think of Brahms?

kid on 2013-11-13 at 10:00 said:

this series of articles is really excellent.

kid on 2013-11-20 at 10:42 said:

there is western tradition found in any wrestling or boxing club. fencing too but thats probably out of the reach of most, myself included. besides these, judo and jiu jitsu are just jacketed wrestling with a little extra pomp and circumstance. sambo is pretty russian, but yah, borrowed a lot from judo. and it was created in the typical soviet way of doing things. that is, in a lab basically.

kid on 2013-11-20 at 10:44 said:

savate as well!

5.7 The Eighth Victory of Hercules Over the Mares of Diomedes

Hercules is sent against another tyrant, Diomedes, who owns man-eating horses in barbarous Thrace, as king of the warlike Bistonians, descended from Mars. Since the myth teaches us that these horses to be fetched are mares, we can identify them as the female psychological side of the male, that is to say, the region of the subconscious psyche, where the Anima dwells, unawakened, and therefore unable to unify with the male psyche and heal its division. Diomedes is the apex of this condition, and represents the false Ego, which is oh-so-certain that it can control the subconscious forces of the mind, riding them to tyranny, and feeding their inordinate passion on the flesh of the innocent.

This condition represents a wide awake nightmare⁴¹, and the visual embodiment of such can be pictured here. Moderns are fond today of reinstating The Matriarchy. This represents a re-descent into the group, collective trajectory of mankind. It is of no more use to return to Matriarchy, and perhaps a great deal less, than it would be to reinstitute earlier phases of what is called “the Patriarchy”: the Patriarchy was actually a

⁴¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Nightmare

step up in the struggle of man, and created the preconditions for the Age of Courtly Love, for it is only in eternal and infinite Love that man and woman can find qualitative equality. It was Love that summoned Abraham out of the tribes of Chaldea, that built the limes and roads of ancient Roma which lead to the sacred seven hills, and that raised the towers of the Gothic arches over Europe. Christ Himself said He came to earth not to bring peace, but a sword. To quote an old Internet acquaintance, when the man puts on his hat, and comes around, there is conflict. It is a difficult truth to face, but wars, plagues, devastation, and human suffering (the four horsemen of the Apocalypse), are servants to the Living Word of God, who is brighter than the Sun and has a sword coming out of His mouth. This is not the Jesus that the Episcopal Church in America (our unofficial national liberal denomination along with Zionism) likes to paint from the pulpit every Sunday.

Because mankind is “behind the level of the Times” (unequal to the Cosmic Law’s progression), there are periodic upheavals and convulsions on the earth. This is why Jesus comforted His followers: “Fear not, for greater am I that are in you, than He that is in the world”. The prince of this world is Satan, and he is a deputy of Cosmic Law, fulfilling a very specific role in the economy of the fallen and fractured universe, ruling man with fear, hunger, and libido dominandi. It is he that will drag man, willy-nilly, collectively toward a final confrontation with the truth about human nature. Do not mistake this Zeitgeist for the Holy Spirit.

Unintegrated man cannot reassimilate to God and overcome the fractured condition of the Fall because he has lost his sleeping queen. He cannot respond in freedom towards God – he is alienated, not just from God, but from the truth, from his true self, and from Reality. He is a thrall to Satan. Every single one of his one-sided reactions flow out of this fundamental aversion to coming to grips with Love. This is expressed poetically in Francis Thompson’s *The Hound of Heaven*⁴²:

⁴²<http://www.maryhillmuseum.org/2013/wp-content/uploads/2013/03/h>

Come then, ye other children, Nature's—share
With me' (said I) 'your delicate fellowship;
Let me greet you lip to lip,
Let me twine with you caresses,
Wantoning With our Lady-Mother's vagrant tresses,

Banqueting With her in her wind-walled palace,
Underneath her azured daïs,
Quaffing, as your taintless way is,
From a chalice
Lucent-weeping out of the dayspring.'
So it was done:

I in their delicate fellowship was one—
Drew the bolt of Nature's secrecies.
I knew all the swift importings
On the wilful face of skies;
I knew how the clouds arise
Spumèd of the wild sea-snortings;
All that's born or dies
Rose and drooped with; made them shapers
Of mine own moods, or wailful or divine;
With them joyed and was bereaven.
I was heavy with the even,
When she lit her glimmering tapers
Round the day's dead sanctities.
I laughed in the morning's eyes.
I triumphed and I saddened with all weather,
Heaven and I wept together,
And its sweet tears were salt with mortal mine;
Against the red throb of its sunset-heart
I laid my own to beat,
And share commingling heat;

But not by that, by that, was eased my human smart.

In vain my tears were wet on Heaven's gray cheek.
 For ah! we know not what each other says,
 These things and I; in sound I speak—
 Their sound is but their stir, they speak by silences.
 Nature, poor stepdame, cannot slake my drouth;
 Let her, if she would owe me,
 Drop yon blue bosom-veil of sky, and show me
 The breasts o' her tenderness:
 Never did any milk of hers once bless
 My thirsting mouth.

If you were told that every single one of “the world’s problems” has its ugly root in the darkest recesses of your own soul, would you give it serious energy and investigation? Or would you flee into deeper projections of your shadow? Some have even decided to join the shadow, and meld themselves as much as possible into that projection, to deepen the illusion past repair in this life, saving the extraordinary grace of God.”

“You are as spiritual as you desire to be, that is all.” They were somewhat annoyed at the abruptness of his words, and turned away. At once he spoke to them in a loving tone. “My dear children, I said your spirituality was what you wish it to be so that you would understand that your spirituality is entirely in proportion to your good will. Then enter into yourselves: don’t ask other about your progress. Examine your good will, and from that alone you will discover the measure of your spirituality.”

JOHN RUYSBROECK, speaking to pilgrims, in *European Mystics*,
 by Rudolf Steiner, p44.

It doesn’t matter what happens to the world, if you lose your own soul. This Anima is asleep deep within, the pearl of great price, an analogy for the Kingdom of Heaven, which is within you. It is Hercules, the

deputy of the true self from the human aspect and the true self from the aspect of his immortal descent, who must tame the Mares of Diomedes. He and only he can bring them to heel. This is part of the process of purification proceeding illumination and theosis. The personal unconscious has to be overcome before the subconscious can be reintegrated, and Hercules embodies a more or less purified consciousness who can face the subconscious.

Do not be deceived. The Mares of Diomedes do not feed on other horses. They feed on human flesh, and Hercules will turn them against the Satanic ego that is so hubristic as to think that they can wield them as a weapon against others. This motif, for those who are too modern for Greek myths, can be found in the *Game of Thrones*⁴³ as well. One way or the other, as we will see below, the un-purified personal consciousness will be unable to tame, or even keep locked up, the forces of the subconscious. Carl Jung remarked that men over 40 are either religious, or they are neurotic. Confucius gave the age of 40 as important, holding out hope for anyone that was straying, until they reached at least that age. A man ought to have a few things figured out by then. There is an old African proverb as well: "After the age of forty, a man is responsible for his own face". But for those who do make the choice of some higher path, and attain personal results, and embark on the labors, there is great reward and consolation for their struggle and sacrifice. They are able to begin the real work. We shouldn't think it is just a matter of "getting saved", or "getting our act together philosophically". There is a point beyond the point.

The Mares submit to Hercules (naturally), but he (for the time being) leaves them in the hands of his companion Abderis. One cannot try to tame the subconscious, or face it, or even behold it, with anything less than the highest sum of all that is true, beautiful, and best in one's self (the Soul), and so this leads to the death of his companion. The lesson here is

⁴³<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2tuLYG9sv68>

that nothing can be held back, that full commitment is necessary, in order to journey into the shadow realm. Hercules turns back to face Diomedes, and his companion dies. One could also say that the old personality has to “die” in order for the Soul to complete the Labor.

Hercules is always getting sidetracked, albeit in an understandable and sympathetic way. There is an inevitable human sanguinity about him, whether using a river to wash out the stables, or going berserk and killing everyone he can get his hands on. We have seen this several times in the myths. People get hurt when this happens. Inevitably. Perhaps the best lesson one could draw from this is to not get sidetracked. Have you considered that wavering on the goal, although perhaps not fatal to yourself in the long run, may very well prove fatal to important parts of yourself, and incur karmic debt? Or to other, important people in your life story? Hercules will have to found a town in honor of his friend, which is another sidetrack, of a more forgivable kind. Although he is always “in the right” and “doing something good”, it is not always, in every exactitude, the *unum necessarium*. Be careful about pursuing sideline goals, and postponing your spiritual journey.

It is as if the entire story of Creation, all of written and unwritten human history, stretching back the flickering fire light of caves or even the time of proto-genesis, is a progressive tightening of focus around the ever-more-definable question of *What does it mean to be Human?* In the fullest sense of that word, Man must encompass all of Creation: its lowest depths as surely as its highest heights. But the moral movement is upward. Without the upward moral and spiritual movement, all is chaos, an analogy for what will be more defined in Hades, which takes its meaning precisely from that upward moral movement. Without an upward movement, there is no “Down” either.

Modern man has at his beck and call all the primordial tradition of the past, scattered about like the body of Osiris, in the form of vast potential knowledge and development in many sciences which were not

available to the ancient world in total form. What use are we making of those resources? And yet, Cologero has noted that ancient man (enviable in many ways compared to the modern version) was nonetheless degenerate⁴⁴, that they were circumscribed by Fate just as we are. Everywhere and at all times, “History is a crime” (Nicholas Berdyaev). Those times of ignorance have past. The guardians and tutors have withdrawn, and the winter of the world has come, for there is a spiritual evolutionary test being administered, to see who can stand (in popular parlance, we might call this the “Matrix”). Since “now is the day of salvation”, this time period was the best time for you to appear.

And the times of this ignorance God winked at; but now commandeth all men every where to repent: Because he hath appointed a day, in the which he will judge the world in righteousness by that man whom he hath ordained; whereof he hath given assurance unto all men, in that he hath raised him from the dead.

ACTS 17:30-31

There are “cracks in the great wall”, as one author puts it.⁴⁵ For those who can read the signs of the Times, the Reign of Quantity⁴⁶ symbolizes both the “best of times” and the “worst of times”. Man will have to make progress, individually most of all, *but he will be forced to it by the heavenly and the infernal powers, all the same, in an outer sense*. That is why Darwin, Marx, and Freud were given domination over the Modern Era. The motto of Freud⁴⁷ was *flectere si nequeo superos, Acheronta movebo*: ‘If I cannot bend the will of Heaven, I shall move Hell.’

⁴⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=2577>

⁴⁵<https://www.amazon.com/Cracks-Great-Wall-Traditional-Metaphysics/dp/1597310247>

⁴⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Reign_of_Quantity_and_the_Signs_of_the_Times

⁴⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Acheron>

This is why we inhabit, simultaneously, the most important of times (the present is always the scene of the struggle), and the least enviable of times (karmic debts have mounted). The Scriptures promise that God would not destroy the world with water again; the day of judgement will be a day of Fire. This Fire will either be experienced as Love, or as terrible Fire, depending upon the spiritual condition.

The Lord is not slow about his promise as some count slowness, but is forbearing toward you, a not wishing that any should perish, but that all should reach repentance. But the day of the Lord will come like a thief, and then the heavens will pass away with a loud noise, and the elements will be dissolved with fire, and the earth and the works that are upon it will be burned up. Since all these things are thus to be dissolved, what sort of persons ought you to be in lives of holiness and godliness.

2 PETER 3:9-11

We have behind us birth and baptism (Water) and in front of us Fire (the energetic state of Love that is destiny, and also the consequences for falling short). The entire metaphysics of Jacob Boehme⁴⁸ explain the workings of the four elements in man and in Creation, which are combining to create and purify the spirit of Man, and they can be related to these ideas and patterns of God allowing (in the fallen state), Nature to urge and constrain itself to find a way out “further in”. This perfect and theotic state⁴⁹ will not come without struggle and effort, and we will continue to see this conflict waged in the projected, externalized world, which groans for redemption. This is why Kukai⁵⁰ could say, “The Mind and the World Co-Arise”.

⁴⁸<http://www.jacobboehmeonline.com/>

⁴⁹N Berdyaev (http://www.krotov.info/library/02_b/berdyaev/1941_038_0_eng.htm) terms man a “theocosm” and not just a “microcosm”.

⁵⁰<https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kukai/>

Hercules will have more labors to accomplish. Defeating one enemy, and completing one labor, is not enough. He must work through the entire Zodiac circle⁵¹, for this is the Cosmic Law. But in the process, He will be refined, until the day when “heaven and earth kiss”, when the double oath of God, on earth as it is in heaven, is complete. Every time, every age, starts afresh in a sense – God has set eternity in our hearts. The answer will not be found in one outer battle or triumph, which may just turn out to be a diversion or distraction. Do not foolishly ask “why is this time so much worse than other times?” The good old ways, the paths of the Lord, are found within you, for it is in the lines of the human heart that the meaning, the purpose, and the answer will be found. Along that path will you find the answers to all the other questions. Seek first the Kingdom of God, and His Righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you. It is a matter of winning the Greater War and the Inner Struggle. It always was. And it always will be, until it is done. Beware of seeking your true self – you might find God. Beware of seeking God – it may be that you will find your true self. This was vividly illustrated in the story of a Catholic martyr⁵² during WWII, when the self and God no longer had need even for the Scriptures or outer forms.

She said that Jochmann entered Jägerstätter’s cell the night before the execution. He was the priest who said the prisoner refused to sign the document that could have spared his life. He said Jägerstätter had already received the last sacraments in the afternoon. Jochmann offered to bring Jägerstätter devotional reading material but the prisoner declined and he also declined to hear readings from scripture. According to the priest, Jägerstätter explained, “I am completely bound in inner union with the Lord, and any reading would only interrupt my communication with my God.”

⁵¹<http://www.bailey.it/files/Labours-of-Hercules.pdf>

⁵²http://www.natcath.org/NCR_Online/archives2/2007d/110907/110907a.htm

The labors of Hercules contain the keys to unlocking the fairy tale, and awakening the sleeping beauty, transforming Cinderella, or winning the favor of the Valkyries. This eighth labor is particularly notable for the devouring presence of the unintegrated parts of consciousness (the “mares” of the Anima⁵³), because “hell hath no fury like a woman scorned”. The overt tyrant or stereotypical, over-compensated “male” will not be able to control these forces, and in fact, not even a plain “good man” can control them either, hence the death of Hercules’ companion. Only the presence of the true man on the quest can hope to quell and tame these forces, which later go on to serve usefully as bloodlines for great steeds for Alexander the Great.

To quote Cologero⁵⁴:

Man is self-sufficient, since in him the anima is the passive element. To give birth to the True Self, the anima must be pacified so that it can receive the imprint of a higher source. That is why Jung says that a physical woman is not absolutely necessary for the individuation process. Rather, she is a privation, so the energy of the anima exists in the man and can be claimed in an act of self-possession.

You may also notice that Hercules is not a sage or an intellectual: he is a warrior and an ascetic. We live in an era dominated by the Lunar influence of Intellect, and under its thrall. The age to come will not be one of Philosophy, Religion, or Science, but of Art, the Fourth Age, which is the unity of the preceding three. This is symbolized in John’s Gospel, the fourth Gospel, which speaks the entire and full truth of the divinity of the Logos. But of the three kinds of men (natural, religious, and intellectual), it is the religious “knights” who will be most needed and called upon to undertake the artful transformation and balancing of man into the higher

⁵³<https://www.blogger.com/null>

⁵⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7351>

form. Natural or pagan man has no “path”, and intellectuals today think only with their tongues. The men of “heart” cannot consent to either path, and are forced into transformation. You can find more teaching on this in Mouravieff’s Gnosis⁵⁵, which is part of the basis of the Gornahoor web seminars started by Cologero.

Knowing things with the mind will help clear cobwebs away, but it isn’t the same thing as beginning the journey. And it is interesting that Alice Bailey places the “Eighth” labor of Hercules, by rotation of the Zodiac, in the place of the First Labor. We could relate this to the First Arcanum of the Tarot, the Magician, which is the foundation for practicing the others. This would make sense, given that experientially knowing the Anima places a “knight” in a position of potency and power for accomplishing all of the subsequent Labors.

Follow your clues and commence the Quest.

Posted on 2018-05-29 by Logres

5.8 Hercules’ Ninth – The Girdle of Hippolyta

Thucydides the Athenian notes that of pre-history, he is obliged to accept what the poets say, although certainly this is unsatisfactory, and the poets are not to be trusted. Since Thucydides was an Athenian, he presumably shared in the general blase attitude which they took towards the rites and rituals. The Spartans would postpone invasions if the auguries were inauspicious, whereas the Athenians did not hesitate to tear down temples dedicated to the gods and fortify them as watch towers. The Spartans consulted the Delphic oracle before waging war, and the Athenians held a democratic (or oligarchic) debate. So we see that the rationalizing outlook is nothing new, for the Athenians defended themselves from charges of impiety by using the excuse that they were compelled by war’s

⁵⁵https://www.bibliotecapleyades.net/esp_autor_mouravieff.htm

necessity, which was a general law of nature, and that the gods would understand this. They didn't reject the gods, they merely re-interpreted them, since occasionally a philosopher could offend even their sensibility enough to run the risk of impiety charges. In fact, with their maritime Empire, democracy, riches, and political expediencies (see the Melian dialogue⁶), the Athenians seem to be a very "modern" people indeed.

Those who struggle to undertake Hercules' labors should take heart that these trends and currents against which they swim are in no way a novelty. Did I mention that Athens lost the Peloponnesian War against Sparta? It was the hubris of their Sicilian Expedition which did them in. Hubris is always present when the gods are disrespected. *Those whom the gods wish to destroy, they first make mad.* Immersing yourself in Tradition is one way of "not going mad"; the ancients knew that poetry, myth, legend, and religion were important ways of practicing waking up before one was even fully awake. At least if one goes "mad" during the epicycle of Tradition, there is a cure available within the cycle, since it is "all of a piece". As we see with Hercules, making human detours or mortal mistakes do not derail him on his path. This is not merely because God "favors" him, but because Hercules is acting a part – that is, he is "acting" above himself, rather than mimicking that which is below him. He is rising to his true Self, doing the opposite of what a play actor does. If you tell a man, "God is Light", that still requires either a) an epiphany on his part, or b) more explanation. But if you tell him, that in order to go to heaven, he has to pass the three headed dog and travel by the path that borders hell, in the shadow of the dark forest, and save the maiden who waits for him, then he can begin to understand.

In this episode, our hero does quite a bit of killing. As I've tried to explain to some liberal friends, if it's worth dying for, it's probably worth killing for in some way, as well. Although I don't fully understand what Christ meant by "those who live by the sword, die by the sword", there

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Melian_dialogue

are other Bible proof texts, as long as people are asking.

Do not think that I have come to bring peace to the earth; I have not come to bring peace but a sword⁵⁷.

MATTHEW 10:34⁵⁸

I came to bring fire to the earth and how I wish it were already kindled! Do you think that I have come to bring peace to the earth? No, I tell you, but rather division.

LUKE 12:49-51⁵⁹

And he said unto them, When I sent you without purse, and scrip, and shoes, lacked ye any thing? And they said, Nothing. Then said he unto them, But now, he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise his scrip: and he that hath no sword, let him sell his garment, and buy one⁶⁰. For I say unto you, that this that is written must yet be accomplished in me, And he was reckoned among the transgressors: for the things concerning me have an end. And they said, Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said unto them, It is enough.

LUKE 22:35-38⁶¹

Hercules will end up adventuring among the Amazons; Hera comes down, and stirs up their ire, as it would appear that Hercules' power and charm (by itself) would have overcome them. Only Hippolyta is

⁵⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/But_to_bring_a_sword

⁵⁸<http://bibref.hebtools.com/?book=%20Matthew&verse=10:34&src=%21>

⁵⁹<http://bibref.hebtools.com/?book=%20Luke&verse=12:49-51&src=%21>

⁶⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sell_your_cloak_and_buy_a_sword

⁶¹<http://bibref.hebtools.com/?book=%20Luke&verse=22:35-38&src=%21>

untouched, but she is doomed in her act of going to Hercules to aid him. Did Hera's rage affect our hero, as well? We think that a touch of it did cloud him, here.

Diodorus Siculus⁶²⁶³ enlists nine Amazons who challenged Hercules to single combat during his quest for Hippolyta's girdle and died against him one by one: Aella⁶⁴, Philippos, Prothoe, Eriboea, Celaeno⁶⁵, Eurybia, Phoebe⁶⁶, Deianeira, Asteria⁶⁷, Marpe, Tecmessa, Alcippe. After Alcippe's death, a group attack followed.

In another version, Hercules' takes Melinippe (Hippolyta's sister) captive, and successfully exchanges the girdle in return for her life.

For most versions, after the mob attack on Hercules (which fails), Hippolyta storms to his rescue, but Hercules thinks she has betrayed him, and strikes at her with the inevitable result.

The Amazons are connected with the city of Troy, & came to its defense during the siege. Coupling this with the episode of Dido⁶⁸ & Aeneas (in which Aeneas inadvertently kills Dido and her love by leaving), we can say that the Amazon theme has a strong association with the trajectory and rise of the hero. They come after the affliction, & before the exultation and triumph. The rise of Roma is under the occult name of Love.

Hera is clearly a retarded element in the myth, but the Amazons are not. The girdle had been given by Ares to the queen, and represents feminine power to stand as a man against men. When Hippolyta exchanges

⁶²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Diodorus_Siculus

⁶³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Amazons#cite_note-29

⁶⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aella_%28Amazon%29

⁶⁵<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Celaeno>

⁶⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phoebe_%28mythology%29

⁶⁷<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Asteria>

⁶⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dido_%28Queen_of_Carthage%29

the girdle for her sister, she is returned to the world of sisterly and feminine existence. She is tempered and made flexible. Hercules' death blow may or may not be literal: there is an exchange between them which destroys Hippolyta's warlike status & leads to Hercules' obtaining of the girdle.

We have to note that Hercules is not seeking the girdle out of hatred for the Amazons. It is part of the given quest, & Hercules isn't going to boast about it or even wear it. Hercules' adventures were the subject of a good deal of contemplation during the Middle Ages⁶⁹. The allegorization of Hercules was not restricted to Christian thinkers, & there were even Tarot cards which used the Hercules motif⁷⁰. In general, we may fairly say that Hercules has by right always been understood as symbolizing the strong man of the real self, who overcomes the lower self and even its own self. Indeed, the theme remained popular through the Baroque era, up until very modern times⁷¹.

Why make much of the "true Self" and "false Self"? Well, for one thing, we don't see Hercules sleeping his way through the adventures by bedding a bunch of females. At the most, we reach any hint of that in this story, and only a hint. We don't find him killing indiscriminately or widely (during this adventure, he does kill some men, but desists when kinsmen of the king are offered in exchange for his fallen comrades, and the Amazon battle is self-preservation). He is not "tempted" in any conventional way, with delights or ease. So the medieval and pre-medieval interpretation is legitimate: Hercules is not a masterless man.

⁶⁹<http://books.google.com/books?id=H5g08PMrkjgC&pg=PT161&lpg=PT161&dq=hercules+labors+christ&source=bl&ots=pgN0IWGurz&sig=W39hnmhIerqtKjEUo4W4eY763-Xk&hl=en&sa=X&ei=0GF8UtWoM0zIsASgvYLGbw&ved=0CFwQ6AEwCQ#v=onepage&q=hercules%20labors%20christ&f=false>

⁷⁰<http://pre-gebelin.blogspot.com/2008/04/prodicus-allegory-of-virtue-and-vice.html>

⁷¹<http://www.ourcivilisation.com/smartboard/shop/fowlerjh/chap1.htm>

Alice Bailey drew parallels⁷² with the Zodiac & the meaning of Virgo, one of the oldest signs. What comes after his death-blow to Hippolyta is instructive:

Hippolyte is the Queen of the Amazons, a great race of women warriors, to whom Venus, the Queen of Love, has given a girdle, the symbol of unity, motherhood and the sacred Child, achieved through struggle. Traveling to the shores of her kingdom, Hercules fights Hippolyte and kills her for the girdle. Too late, he realizes that Hippolyte had not put up any struggle but offered the girdle to Hercules freely, under instruction from God. In a state of shock, Hercules sets forth to redeem this failure. While journeying back to the shores of the sea, he hears the screams of the beautiful Hesione being attacked and then swallowed by a sea monster. Hercules swims furiously out to sea to rescue her and, as the monster turns on him, opening its mouth to roar, Hercules rushes down the red tunnel of its throat, grasps Hesione and hews his way out of the serpent's belly. Thus, after slaughtering the feminine principle that gave him what he needed, Hercules makes amends by rescuing that which also needed him.

What is being uncovered here is the falseness of the corrupt feminine principle (Hera and the mob Amazons) and the new Woman called into being by the progress of the Hero: the man is acquiring firmness without brutality, and the woman is acquiring docility and flexibility without dishonor. Man becomes divine, Woman becomes eternal, together, but in a different way.

Hippolyta is a perfect Dido, and is moreover the perfect woman (although belatedly). Hercules responds by essentially becoming a Christian knight. With this adventure, we have entered the world of the Middle Ages and their romances, deliberately satirized in *Don Quixote*. But

⁷²<http://www.souledout.org/hercules/herculesvirgo/hercvirgo.html>

rather than becoming Orlando Furioso⁷³, Hercules acts directly. In literary words, Hercules takes the path of Dante rather than the path of Faust; he is open to vertical change, and avoids meandering and wallowing in self-pity, regret, manipulation of Nature, or stasis.

In the liberal world, we are offered a “God Without Thunder⁷⁴”. In this world, God must act according to our preconceptions. Thus, YHWH is guilty of genocide and the worst forms of ancient prejudice and violence, and is a veritable demon, whereas Jesus becomes a prophet-sage who aimed at freeing man from all darkness with the news that “God is Light”. This is the new civil religion for our time. It delights in opposing false anti-theses, in order to develop facetious syntheses. The opposite of this is to peer deeper into the mysteries of existence, & this is done, not through rationalization, but (for most people) legend, myth, history, poetry, and religion. These traditional forms are analogue and temporary substitutes for Right or Pure Reason: they are “practice”, like children playing at sword-sticks – it is also deadly serious, but a form of play. The first card of the Tarot enjoins us to turn “work into play”.

For Hercules the warrior knows there are monsters at large, not least of all in his own heart, & that they must all be conquered, slain, or transformed, as may be. Evil exists, & there is really no way to get God off the hook, rationally speaking. Either one begins the path by piety, submission, and respect for the higher power which tasks you (in which case these higher powers differentiate themselves into Hera/adversary and Zeus/protector, and the end of which is apotheosis and divinization, in which the hero is united to the separated divine) or else you try clever and abstract mental gymnastics. The liberal worldview has chosen the latter, & it is far easier to simply rewrite, ignore, or ridicule Tradition than to take up the cross, and follow the path of the hero-turning-knight. Is

⁷³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Orlando_Furioso

⁷⁴<http://spider.georgetowncollege.edu/htallant/border/bs7/kennedy.htm>

there a third way? I do not believe that there is. You can only see more deeply into what is already true, what is already old, what is already there. There is no revolutionary resolution or higher truth that preserves the profundity of Tradition, while somehow transcending the thunder of the Gods which offend our sensibilities. One will devour the other, and this itself shocks the sensibilities!

The temptation here is to mental passion and pride, which is why Gornahoor for Lent last year recommended a “mind fast” rather than a food fast. The myth clearly walks the initiate through the cycle of the Zodiac, and includes not only detours and failures, but also conspiracies and meta-conspiracies, as well as a varied array of monsters. It is, in other words, psychologically and spiritually both replete and complete. It can stand alone as its own veritable natural Gospel, were the coming of Christ hundreds of years off, because it is the primordial Truth in the first place.

When Hercules walks away with the girdle, but then goes and saves the maiden on his way home, & then surrenders the war-relic to his adversary as proof of passing the tests, he has “learned justice and mercy” by triumphing over the passions of vengeance and lust and the temptation to use the rod of iron in the cause of human wrath or personal gain. In each labor, he proves that he has deeply assimilated the implications of each previous lesson learned, even as he stumbles.

The point is not to avoid failure, but to get back up. That was always the point to begin with. The quest doesn't end, until Hercules is done acting on each lesson learned. Fate is now weaving itself around the hero, rather than weaving the hero around Itself. *Ducunt volentem Fata, nolentem trahunt*. Hercules, exposed warts and all⁷⁵, is now ta'veren⁷⁶. His deeds are increasingly judged only by his own conscience, & by God. The shallow and base will call out (as they do against God) “you have waded

⁷⁵<http://www.theguardian.com/artanddesign/2013/nov/08/cromwell-portraitist-samuel-cooper-exhibition>

⁷⁶<http://wot.wikia.com/wiki/Ta%27veren>

through slaughter to a throne!” But Zeus & Hercules & Hippolyta know that he is becoming a parfait and gentle⁷⁷ knight.

What does it mean? As late as the last adventure, we saw the growing conspiracy, which comes out into the open now, using an arm of humanity (the mob feminists of the day) against the hero in a berserk manner. Hercules stays focused on learning personal lessons, and will not allow himself to be cowed or bullied either inside or out. He stays focused on the lesson, even when failing it. And because of that, he cannot fail.

Is this not the hidden meaning of “all things work to the good of them who love the Lord”?

Posted on 2013-11-15 by Logres

* * *

IA on 2013-11-18 at 08:59 said:

Hi,

As Ezra Pound said, culture is what's left over after you forgot what you tried to learn. Culture is instinct but learned instinct. Art and myth reconnect us to something we can only glimpse in the corner of our eye. When we look directly at it, it disappears. Humans need mystery, evidently.

Religion and high culture satisfy this craving for mystery. And, let's face it, the world is a pretty strange place. But, in an impious age images and gestures can only signify emptiness and irony, with no storytelling. High priests of modernism mystify and baffle with abstraction, discontinuity and strange words that allow secret knowledge to initiates. I think its gnosticism.

Anyway, thanks.

5.9 Call Down the Sun – Hercules X

⁷⁷<http://www.luminarium.org/medlit/knightport.htm>

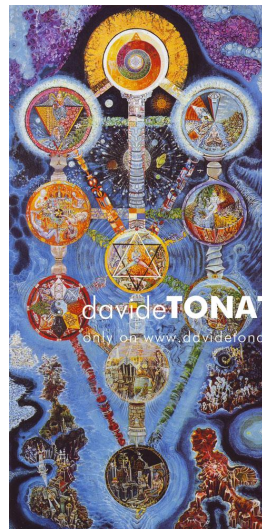
Now things are getting more interesting, in even a conventional sense. Hercules sets out upon his tenth labor⁷⁸. Up until now, we have issued many cautions about ascribing to the hero anything in a merely or even a primarily external sense. But when the hero calls down the power of the sun by launching an arrow against it to quench its heat, it behooves us to say that now, Hercules is beginning to openly and weirdly channel the very elements and supernal powers themselves, and in a casually deliberate way.

He seeks the cattle of Geryon, a very great giant, grandson of Medusa, who dwells on a far western island, Erythreia.

First, our man passes through the burning wastes of Libya. The sun is terribly hot – so hot, in fact, that even the hero grows weary and smitten. Herakles draws his bow, and hurls an arrow aloft against the empyrean to defy the sun, branding it as a gadfly. What follows is arresting.

Almost immediately, Heracles realized his mistake and apologized profusely, in turn and equally courteous, Helios granted Heracles the golden cup which he used to sail across the sea every night, from the west to the east because he found Heracles' actions immensely bold.

The clue to this meaning may be in the names of Helios or Apollo: he is called *Hekatebolos*, the “far-shooter”, with the rays of the sun considered as arrows. In effect, Hercules transformed himself into the sun, & then apologized so that it wasn't *hubris*. It's unclear whether the apology was added later (for form's sake). Let us content ourselves with regarding it



⁷⁸<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Geryon>

as an exoteric truth: the inward truth was that Hercules somehow defied the Sun, without dishonoring it.

We “know” today that the sun is a burning ball of gas, far out into space, whose light takes seven minutes to reach us. To question this today would be re-invoke the fate of the proto-scientist Anaxagoras⁷⁹, who was almost executed for postulating the physical nature of the sun, except today it would mean a straightjacket. Yet the Scriptures place an angel in the center of the sun, and in the Clementine Recognitions, we read *Nos ad honorem invisibilis dei imagines visibiles adoramus*.

We honor give to the Invisible God when we adore visible images.

A further step which exotericism makes in developing is the art of theurgy. The Christian religion took this step after the iconoclast controversy.

One point to make about the conventional theory of Light is that of quantum-entanglement⁸⁰. If the speed of light is absolute, then why do atoms which have interacted once, then been separated, demonstrate simultaneous “action-at-a-distance”, thus proving that they do not require the medium of Light which moves at a slower speed in order to share information? I fully accept that there is a physical dimension to everything which is seen (and very likely, also for almost all of that which is not). Yet there is apparently detectable in the physical order, with physical means, certain anomalies which not only are not “currently understood”, but which are demonstrably incapable of being understood on any physical grounds. What can be more absolute to the modern man than the speed of Light? Yet it is not the final limit. So the sun is not merely a burning ball of gas, and Helios can curse or bless as he sees fit. In this case, the sun admires the hero for his daring, as well as his manners: he honors Herakles’ core impulse, which is what is magnetically attracting support from divine powers, folk peoples, and even adversaries, including women.

⁷⁹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Anaxagoras>

⁸⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quantum_entanglement

Herakles is becoming, like the Sun, Sol Invictus.

Again, note the indirection. He is not deliberately attacking the Sun – rather, his magnetic core is being drawn to it, and as deep answers deep, the Sun to him. He is not yet presuming to call himself divine. The warrior’s passionate struggle⁸¹ with his passions is coercing the passion of the Sun. Perhaps this is why the passions have to be overcome. If the supernatural powers and elements themselves possess it, then they would not bend their will to one who had not conquered it within.

The Forms, in heroic action, undergo a greater or lesser inflection in accordance with the intensity of the Rhythms that make them jump, by encroaching on them, replacing them, fringing them, so to say, with an imprecision that makes them more indefinable, while the Warrior himself is dragged, aware only of the sanctify of his sacrifice, in an always more overwhelming turmoil that is crowned, while filling up with death.

But for him who conquers, since they do not, they must bend, though they are “mightier” than we. As the Scriptures put it:

Who, subsisting in the form of God, did not esteem it an object of rapine to be on an equality with God (Phillipians 2:6).

This is much like Hercules’ use of power and warfare – it is always indirect, incidental, not the thing-itself, but rather, something that transpires in the course of adventure. Likewise, the passions remain subordinated, even when they are given free reign.

When he makes landfall, he dispatches three enemies in short order: two-headed canine Orthrus falls with a club blow, Eurytion is smashed to death, and the monster Geryon (advancing to the “rescue”), is shot with an arrow poisoned with Hydra-blood; his head falls over to one side

⁸¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6036>

and spills blood like a flower drooping and shedding petals in the winds. As the US military would say, “one shot, one kill”. Hercules is in full possession of his previous conquests; he has not forgotten to use skillful means, but like a cunning warrior, knows that the lessons from his past are there for a very fine reason. Knowing this brings death to his enemies. Greater and greater Forms are at his disposal.

The point, I think, is, if you really want to go *Iliad* on your enemies, then don’t worry about it directly: pursue goals, remember lessons, burn a pinch of incense to the gods, and cultivate your inner garden. Because your enemy is just an outer symbol of something inside you – conquer it first – then your enemy is superfluous. That much is clear, for the warrior caste, to whom Hercules undoubtedly belongs.

The Decad represented for Iamblichus⁸² the full cycle from 1 through the numbers to a repetition of the *Logos Tomeus* pattern (of course, for him, all numbers are a repetition of One). Nevertheless, the Decad is the successful completion of the first full cycle, the moment when the repetition should become bleedingly obvious. In this adventure, Hercules attains the status of honorary sun of the Sol Invictus, strikes three blows with three kills, and captures the cattle, which are driven home (after some wanderings induced by Hera). Ironically, the cattle are sacrificed to Hera. And there is a further lesson for the warrior, here: the path is as much pilgrimage as fighting, even after the battle is won. And the final sacrifice is made to the goddess Hera.

One obeys “General Law” in fulfilling the quests, but the manner in which the quests are fulfilled leads to a transcending of that Law. Remember that all of the Labors were assigned to Hercules as penance for his madness and impious deeds which flowed from that madness or Fall. The hero finds a way out of the iron prison⁸³; although the cattle are burnt as

⁸²<http://www.scribd.com/doc/48888397/Iamblichus-the-Theology-of-Arithmetic>

⁸³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/VALIS>

hecatombs to the goddess, it is clear that Hera is both placated and also spurned. Did she even wish the sacrifice? She has to accept it. If Satan is your adversary, that is the way to vanquish him. Burn a pinch of incense to Caesar. And render unto God the things that are God's. Rasputin, it was said, claimed that the Soul belonged to God, but the Body, to man. I believe that he was mistaken, & that in fact, it is the Body that belongs to the gods, the Soul to God, and the spirit (in the end) remains with the Self. The hero has traveled through mortality to the core of his being, which will be immortality – his real Self.

How did Christianity and "Paganism" unify in the accretion that was the Roman Catholic Church? They did so because all "live under the Sun", because Christ is the New Sun & because the pagans saw this in the old sun. It is said that Socrates once stood for a full day, staring at the sun, and urged everyone else to look, for he was seeing it for the first time, in his soul. This piety is evident in his writings⁸⁴. As the Empire crumbled, men more and more looked to the emperor and the Sun. The Sun is the the "tenth" or tithe of the invisible God, quite literally. To see the Decans or planetary rulers in the Sun, Moon, & Stars is to have honored the other numbers, through the number Ten.

To understand that the planetary rulers (10) are mightier than God (1), is to understand the Fall. To journey back to 1 is to understand that God is greater. By which quest, both forward and backwards, one becomes aware of "Self", something more precious to both soul and body, still. He who does so, may have a chance of meeting the Self Beyond the Self, of turning Time backwards, of seeing how Love turns the stars, & of making servants of the demons, equals of the angels, and a friend of God.

This swiftly takes him to the island, and the in the blink of an eye, Hercules has drawn forth the power of the sun in a relic.

Posted on 2013-11-29 by Logres

⁸⁴<http://www.jstor.org/discover/10.2307/3292257?uid=3739536&uid=2129&uid=2&uid=70&uid=4&uid=3739256&sid=21103013398217>

* * *

Michel on 2013-11-29 at 13:50 said:

"Floating down, as colors fill the light, we look up from the ground, in fields of paper-white. And floating up, you pass us in the night, a future gazing out, a past to overwrite.

So come down, far below, we've been waiting to collecting the things you Know, come down, far below, we've been waiting to collect what you've let go.

Come Down Oh!"

The vertical initiation, independent of the various liabilities currently inherent in existent Western Esoteric schools joined via a successive initiation would do the man of honor great. An ascetic cleansing is required however, a conscious upsurging of the 'natural current' through an exuberant Will power, that attracts the Spiritual influence rightly due to one. Yet this is a very dangerous thing.

John Fitzgerald on 2021-02-21 at 16:00 said:

With regards to the deep nature and identity of the Sun, CS Lewis puts it nicely in Chapter 14 of *The Voyage of the Dawn Treader*. Ramandu, the retired star, is explaining his situation:

'Aren't you a star any longer?' asked Lucy.

'I am a star at rest, my daughter,' answered Ramandu. 'When I set for the last time, decrepit and old beyond all that you can reckon, I was carried to this island. I am not so old now as I was then. Every morning a bird brings me a fire-berry from the valleys in the Sun, and each fire-berry takes away a little of my age. And when I have become as young as the child that was born yesterday, then I shall take my rising again (for we are at earth's eastern rim) and once more tread the great dance.'

'In our world,' said Eustace, 'a star is a huge ball of flaming gas.'

'Even in your world, my son, that is not what a star is but only what it is made of ...'

Some really deep lore here.

5.10 The Apples of the Hesperides – Hercules' Eleventh Labor

We are nearing the end of the *Dodekathalon*. We have seen how each of the Labors presupposes a certain internal struggle that is foundational to

the soul, like a childbirth, since the Western path differs from archaic spirituality (eg., Vedic) in that it seeks to sublimate the material, rather than withdrawing away from it (although it is more accurate to state that the withdrawal becomes a foundational step that is transcended by the fullness of God' will which irradiates from the human heart, outward, and shines through matter). That is, a man must struggle with his passions, because they are bound up in an initial false self. We have seen Hercules pass through the stages inevitable to the reluctant hero: he has become popular with the masses as an outlaw-protector, he has made several mistakes (and recovered from them) which recapitulate the initial madness and sin which induced his quest, and he has discovered that enemies (eg., Hippolyta) are being converted to his side. He has begun to receive overt notice and aid from the celestial beings.

Johannes Trimemius⁸⁵ writes that “Study generates knowledge (cognition); knowledge prepares love; love, similarity; similarity, communion; communion, virtue; virtue, dignity; dignity, power; and power performs the miracle.” This is the Christian sequence of Incarnational or natural magic. It is magic because God has ratified His oath from heaven in the Advent of the Son. It is natural, both because it was known through the *Logos Tomeus* prior to historical event, and because, since the blessed Advent, Supernature is now overtly intervening and transforming, or uplifting, Nature. Einstein reminds us that “Theory determines what we can observe”, so this is not a novel doctrine, but the re-discovery and energizing of what lay potential in Nature as seeds or signs of Logos, from the foundations of the Cosmos. Christianity is a religion of self-consciousness : that is, the Truth had always been there, but perceiving it clearly (with Calvin's spectacles) induces a change in the object of apperception, since Heaven and Earth began to ratify one another's oaths. This is the “love-story” of the Gospel.

Hercules' story is written in the stars, in the constellations, quite liter-

⁸⁵<http://www.renaissanceastrology.com/trithemius.html>

ally, but also symbolically, as each Labor corresponds to a progression of the Zodiac in the world of the cross. It is human, in that the figure is a warrior, an appropriate caste for the age of the Kali Yuga, in which man must struggle back and fight forward to bring about again the Age of Gold. It is also humane, in that Hercules stands for the classical Mediterranean World, the world of Man which gave birth to the Medieval Everyman, but which has roots in the Age of the Gods. The fact that this world decayed into that of animals (with the rise of Empiricism and Nominalism and Science) and that of machines (the Modern Era) and even that which is sub-human (our own time) should not dismay us: the subtle still rules the dense. Good has to interpenetrate that which is lowest. For even Evil cannot be created without first perverting that which is Good. So we see that, in the words of Mencius Moldbug, *the Past is not a province of the Present, rather, the Present is a mere tiny slice and province (at best) of the Past*. So Evil (then) is merely a slice or province or truncated world of what is Good, what is God.

So we stand at a unique time: we have to “go back” to the antique past, because having collapsed into indeterminate quantum and sub-atomic spiritual conditions in the present, there is no way of emerging from this Chaos without re-instating a Traditional Order, and the only one that exists (and it still, physically even, exists) is in the past. To appeal to the Middle Ages is be novel in two senses: firstly, no one imagines it can be done, so that should be unique and interesting, and secondly, it is nearest to us, or “newest”, in the sequence of Ages. The future exists indeterminately, within our collapsed state, and it is a privilege and rare opportunity to be of those who will “create” the Future by invoking the pattern of the Past. We are the keepers of the secret Fire, and the bearers of the apple seeds from the Hesperides, out of the deluge, into the Garden.

Hercules lived in such a time. Hera had come, and degeneracy reigned, because men had forgotten the reason for the sacrifices and mysteries. They performed them in ignorance, or as compromises with lower pow-

ers, since the process of entropy invariably proceeds by the dichotomy of a “Two” which does not understand the “One” that provides it birth and Order. Look at how men think today. Do they not invariably pose false dichotomies, and then flatten out all meaning and nuance in order to make the supposed synthesis plausible? This is because the power that opposes man’s true destiny, and which feeds off of it (we can call It and Them “Moriarty” if we like) and requires man’s ignorance in order to continue to drag out its existence, has access to men’s Mind (collective and individual) through the disorder of passion and the perversion of Reason to slave to that Passion. And this is why Hercules is “at war”, taking heaven by storm, within and without. Hercules fights, initially, at times and places not of his own choosing, although even there we see a tiny sliver of man’s free will which allows some significant freedom and decision-making (after all, he did strangle a serpent in his crib), but as the process matures magically, Hercules begins to enjoy the fruits of conquest, and to make war at times and places more of his own choosing.

Man is growing up. We see this in this episode, because it is virtually an entire twelve labors, in and of itself. Hercules doesn’t even know where the Apples are, and has to wrestle the Old-Man-of-the-Sea, who keeps changing shapes while being held. Certainly, this has something to do with achieving a meditative state of mind, with stilling the flux, until the image emerges in the still pool, as Tomberg readers will recognize. He then has to slay Antaeus, by holding him aloft so that he does not touch the earth, and crushing him. Again, this can be related to asceticism, which involves severing the “natural” drive of desire from its magnetized source in the passions, to make it serve something not purely of this world. Journeying to Egypt, he is imprisoned by a king (again we see conspiracy and political conflict), who desires to sacrifice Hercules himself for the yearly offering. Indeed, this is done routinely in the Brave New World. It is the liberal version of “Knockout Game”, in which some endangered species of latent heretic is dragged out of his abode and thrashed around

for vicarious thrill and for the pure pleasure of witch-hunting⁸⁶. Have you tried this lately? It's lots of fun. And you don't even have to have any real courage, because, after all, the people you are attacking have no actual power to hit back. Plus, you can feel like the Pharisees did when they tried to stone the woman they had committed adultery with. But, really, it's just a species of perverted and ignorant dark magic, because the *faux Liberaux* deep down just think that every witch they burn will help ensure the pleasure of the Multi-Cult Gods. Don't burn too many: one or two a year will do. After all, who will do the work around this insane asylum?

After this hold up, Hercules manages to break through. We don't hear of too many accidental killings this time around. Hercules is just thinking about those apples, and apparently, even his enemies are becoming less inclined to use open violence against him. When he arrives at the Hesperides, he finds that he himself cannot pick the Apples. In an interesting twist, which is of worthy note, he tricks Atlas first into doing it for him (while he holds up the world on his back) & then lies to Atlas that he needs to retrieve his cloak to make things easier for holding the globe, will Atlas hold it up momentarily?

The Lesson here is that, apparently, the hero is no longer bound by a conventional code of honor. Like Odysseus, the cunning one of many stratagems, Hercules is allowed (apparently) to use help (this was disqualified, as you remember, in the case of the Augean Stables and the Hydra), and to use it dishonestly. Apparently, the Apples are a prize which does not require perfect virtue or honor to retrieve.

As a Christian, I would like to re-interpret this passage, if it were permissible, but honesty forbids it. Here we reach into the mystery of Good & Evil, where the law or ban of the true sovereign reaches a point that places that entity beyond what is commonly conceived as right and

⁸⁶<http://unqualified-reservations.blogspot.com/2013/09/technology-communism-and-brown-scare.html>

wrong. To attain some perspective, and try to square the Circle, we will note that even the decent, salt-of-the-earth common man lives in some degree of tension and hypocrisy⁸⁷, when you scratch him deep enough. After all, we all shop at Wal-Mart.

In this instance, I will say that Hercules returned at a later date, building the pillars of Hercules, belatedly, thus liberating Atlas much as he freed Prometheus. But he still lied. Indeed, it was a lie extorted in bad faith by Atlas, as the apples would do Hercules little good, were he to stand there forever hoisting the world orb. Mouravieff deals with some of this in *Gnosis*. The lie can never be to the Self, although Life forces many lies upon us, in many contexts, in which (at the least) we allow people to see what we perceive them to be mis-perceiving, without correcting them, because to “always tell the truth” in a bald manner at all times would ensure that we spent our lives much like Don Quixote spent his. I might also add, that the spiritual laws of Fairie Land, where the Apples grow, are not like unto the laws of Middle Earth, where the common code of the Hobbit must tend to prevail. Cunning is always a quality heavily valued in the Fairy Tale; we have to learn, as humans, that we are not always speaking to another person, but to an archetype, especially in a quest.

And what of “let your Yes be Yes, and your No, No”? As a Christian, I say that I am not yet the Son of God, and furthermore, will never be so in the same way that Christ succeeded in being so, as He never knew sin. The religion of the apostles is slightly different in modulation and form from the religion practiced by Christ Himself. This “gap” is not a proof that one is not understanding the Logos, but rather, a testimony to the innately flawed and tragic situation man has cognized, and seeks to transcend. Christ, after the Resurrection, was not the same Christ Who was laid in the tomb. If we see the Church after Christ’s Advent, the promise is made to reconcile even those who are in Purgatory, those who

⁸⁷http://www.atimes.com/atimes/Front_Page/GA19Aa02.html

are *idiotes* or imperfect, those who dimly cling to the shreds of Christ's garment, can find salvation in the precincts of the outer Temple. This was the truth which Luther really could not quite come to terms with, and which rejection, incidentally, still marks his spiritual children in the modern world. For them, a single imperfection invalidates the entire corpus. This ensures that one will gravitate towards Alfred Jarry's dictum: *Until we've destroyed everything, we've done nothing*. The Perfect becomes the Enemy of the Good.

The Christian path recognizes the Evil and the hypocrisy, but (as noted), the goal is not withdrawal from matter, but rather a shining through and sublimation of that matter, however, imperfectly, which transforms even Evil into Good. This is a delicate position, as it can come perilously close to "Do Evil that Good may come" or the doctrine of Progressivism that any broken eggs are worth the omelette. What I am trying to say here is something capable of distortion. It is rather that within us, it sometimes happens, when the hero is pushed to the white-hot extremities of contradiction during his quest, he will sometimes find himself acting (unconsciously perhaps, or consciously, bearing the guilt truly) with elements of his being that are not perfectly devoted to God. To give a concrete example, suppose I am awakened in the middle of the night by the noise of strangers entering my home. Now, as a good Christian, my first thought should be to ensure the safety, not only of my family, but even of those who have knocked in the door, if possible. Indeed, a pure and true Christian could square the circle, with the help of angels, by reading their thoughts, speaking words of wisdom, or even laying down his life to save both family and foe. However, what would most likely happen (because I know myself, especially at two o'clock in the morning) would be that a weapon would be procured and used. My greatest fear (being imperfect) would not be to fail to be a perfect Christian, since that is a given, but to allow harm to come to my family through personal cowardice or weakness or hesitation. *In such a situation, it is likely that*

violence would occur.

This is the mystery of the temple of Rimmon. It is analogous to the Earps deciding to clean up Tombstone themselves, rather than allow Sheriff Beehan to arrest them for disorderly conduct in the middle of a flagrant murdering spree perpetrated by those who own the Sheriff. In fact, almost every human being has experienced a situation, on some scale, of the same kind, in which to “do right” is actually to commit an even graver sin. What is wrong with modern Liberalism is not their recognition (they do this too) that sometimes you have to go against your kin in order to be Just to the stranger and the alien, but rather, the fact that they literally worship these strangers and outcasts as God Himself. And the fact that they do not allow such niceness of conscience or subtlety of distinction to be used by anyone else but those who also, like them, worship at the altar of Revolution and Degeneracy.

In this case, Hercules knows he has to seize the apples, and they are his provided he is willing to answer for the consequences – he can return later and redeem his pledge. Hasn't he committed worse sins than this, and been forgiven? What is worse than slaughtering your wife and children in a fit of madness, or a woman who loves you as she brings your prized object? We see that Hercules is simply “unequal” to ordinary standards of right and wrong. This is completely different (as far as I can tell) from the Nietzschean idea that one must go beyond them entirely. In a word, Hercules is a gentleman, but with a bit of a rogue left in him. Indeed, anyone who seeks individual salvation will find that they become a gentleman, with a bit of something else streaked through, which remains (even in the redeemed state, in Heaven) as something like the silver lining of a storm cloud.

Like Cromwell⁸⁸, if you are willing to stand tall before God and answer for the blood on your gauntlets, then “you may proceed”. *Take what you want, and pay God for it.* But, had Cromwell subdued himself more

⁸⁸<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dRfrXGKyjhM>

thoroughly, and acted more in accordance with his caste, had he seen himself caught in the currents and dragged by Fate as a slave to the rising order of Revolution, would he have acted so?

With the ancients, we affirm that no man consciously would will Evil (at least before he was thoroughly corrupted, as this Life is a second chance, and perhaps not even then). Which is why it is the duty of every man of Order to subdue himself, that when he creates, he may create according to the whole Eye of Light, perceiving the Logos not through a glass darkly, but almost face-to-face.

Posted on 2013-12-21 by Logres

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magicalcharms on 2013-12-26 at 12:22 said:
thought-provoking, helpful and instructive thank you.

5.II The Twelfth and Final Labor

We have finally arrived at the last leg of the journey in the Dodekathalon. Hercules is given a final test, as he “cheated” on two of the earlier ones, and this one is meant, not to test his mettle, but to ruin and destroy him. There is a chance, if he truly goes to Hades, that he may not return, as even the godling Herakles is one of the “living” who may not be allowed to enter, and then just waltz out of hell. Hell is meant to keep the dead and the living separate; you don’t keep an outhouse inside the bedroom, and you don’t allow the living and the dead worlds to become indiscriminately intermingled.

In the ancient world, such sages as Pythagoras or Socrates were said to have been accompanied and guided by their daemon, who instructed

them in their journey toward the truth. Of a truth, we could say that Hercules has been guided by a kind of warrior-appropriate daemon, in that he wars through his passions (as Guido De Giorgio⁸⁹ has written) “on his own”, without the conscious guide of a familiar spirit or guardian angel. The warrior has to perform the self-guiding function on his own by conquering passions and his body. We note⁹⁰, however, that even the warrior has occasional need of the mysteries: Hercules goes for instruction to Eleusis.

It is said by Iamblichus (in his biography⁹¹ of Pythagoras) that he imposed the most careful methods of scrutiny and tests on those of his auditors who were judged progressively worthy to receive his teachings. He received his teachings from Egypt, a land which was under the dominion of Mercury, but he passed into Italy, as this was a land renowned for its upright morality (Pythagoras was “drawn” by affinity towards the simple, basic, and rare quality of morality). There is a link, here, too, to Hercules, because he came to Crotona⁹² and taught them, a city founded by Hercules during his travels. No one was treated “equally” by Pythagoras – although most had to endure apprenticeships and tests, Abaris⁹³ the Hyperborean who came to the city was judged by him immediately worthy of his highest discourses, and they exchanged knowledge and gifts, Abaris giving him a dart with which Pythagoras threw out the diseases from Laecadomonia, and Pythagoras showing him his golden thigh, proof that

⁸⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6036>

⁹⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Labours_of_Hercules#Twelfth_Labor:_Cerberus

⁹¹http://archive.org/stream/IamblichusPythagoreanLifetaylor/Iamblichus-PythagoreanLife_djvu.txt

⁹²http://books.google.com/books?id=pavWAAAAMAAJ&pg=PA15&lpg=PA15&dq=crotona+hercules+labors&source=bl&ots=sEfUAs4J9f&sig=dNeWlKpP0gK_JyXdGEsllzAIYZM&hl=en&sa=X&ei=4XbiUtTcLIuhsQS9k4H4DQ&ved=0CDoQ6AEwAw#v=onepage&q=crotona%20hercules%20labors&f=false

⁹³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Abaris_the_Hyperborean

he was attended by Apollo and was a hero or demi-god.

From such caste of brahmin, at Eleusis (or those trained or descended spiritually from them), Hercules can hope to learn much. Indeed, he finds an entrance into the underworld, as well as advice about how to safely return. But here, in the Underworld, Hercules is first and foremost a suppliant. He must take and receive permission from Hades to attempt to wrestle Cerebus back to the surface. The warrior, even the demi-god, doesn't exalt himself in the presence of the ruler of the Dead, whose task is inexorable, but rather consults with him and presents a petition or craves a boon. Hades grants the wish, on condition that no weapon is used.

Incidentally, Hercules rescues one hero from hell, & fails to rescue the other, whose desire to have a god's wife for his own was so insulting that nothing could transport the man out of hell. The gravity of karma in the afterlife has certain laws that even a demigod can't bend. This is why Scripture tells us not to fear those who rend the body, but the One Who can chain you in Hell. Don't be so heavy in the afterlife that even a god can't haul you out of prison. All of this indicates that the laws of Heaven and Hell (and, in between, Middle Earth) are more important and complex than even some of the tales of the demigods. Hercules' story itself is a foreshadowing of greater deeds to come, when Hell will be broken open and harrowed in truth. This does not detract from Hercules, but rather adds luster and glory to the daring deed, which might otherwise be without absolute significance.

Naturally, Hercules brings down the big dog Cerebus, and wrests him from his hellish lair up to the sweet light of the sun. Just as inevitably, Eurystheus flees back into this pithos at the sight of this still unexpected victory. Can we begin to suspect, although the legends do not say so, that Hercules (like Socrates) possessed a daemon that guided him in his wrestling and fighting, instructing him minutely and instantly upon what to do? In any case, he answers to a "higher power" either within or partially without him.

Alice Bailey has some reasonable thoughts⁹⁴ on Capricorn and the twelfth labor, specifically the idea that the initiate has to go through a personal hell before he can instruct others (which involves traversing objective Hell). If you can't be pure in your own circle, you cannot purify the world either. This is a strong argument for the emphasis on Law which Gornahoor has made. That is (for example) why would America "save" the world when her own streets are in chaos and disorder? We have seen that Boris Mouravieff in Gnosis implicitly endorses Order over Chaos as a necessary prerequisite to any gnosis itself, when he stated that in some conditions politically the chaos becomes too great for any "work". St. Paul endorses Law in Romans 13 and other passages — pray for a peaceable life of quiet godliness. Pythagoras endorsed the Romanity of the Latins by emigrating to Crotona from turbulent Samos, when the revolution arrived, and he taught his initiates to favor those of Law and to be unfriendly to those who advocated Revolution. Or, as the German folk used to say, work first, then play or relaxation.

A lot of the New Age followers, or modern people interested in initiation are short circuiting the process and cheating themselves (not to mention defiling the memory of their ancestors) by holding to political doctrines that are simply incompatible with "decency and good order". Far better to be apolitical in the fashion of Ernst Junger, in order to achieve interiority, or better still, give your reason to the meditation of Order. Even Hercules did this, in coming hat in hand to Hades, in consulting the Eleusian brahmins/priests. Christ Himself, God Himself, did not consider Equality a thing to be grasped! But rather humbled himself as a servant, and said that not one jot or tittle of the General Law would be cheated, but rather that He intended to sacrifice His flesh and soul and humble His divine origin in order to carve a way out through His own flesh and interiority. It is said that Satan does not hate man, but

⁹⁴<http://www.souledout.org/hercules/herculescapricorn/herccap.htm>

simply has no faith in human nature, and that this is why he “opposes” arrogant man, tempting him. “Every man is tempted out of his own flesh”. The deities and powers that exist take note of those, especially in a dark time, who observe the remnants of the Law and do not bow the knee to man-made Baal. The Creator, the Archetype, is not mocked, especially by those who think that they can take a short cut away from Law in favor of Chaos, which is Non-Being. Sow the wind, reap the whirlwind. Or, like Gandalf, place your faith in the little things and aid those who bear the ring faithfully.

The Pythagoreans believed that Number was the motion of the Gods, or perhaps the essence of the Gods themselves (Number as the Intelligible: number as sensible would be the tracing of their steps), so their philosophy excluded Chaos and Revolution as non-Being, since Being was orderly, numerate. Here we see that all initiates of Truth agree in rejecting anti-Order; indeed, a great Reformation thinker like van Prinsterer demonstrated⁹⁵ that the Revolution was anything but natural, inevitable, or (therefore) “orderly” — rather, it was an attempt to (as Pythagoras would have said) ignore the Creator and pay attention to sublunary magistrates in the place of the Creator. This is unseemly, with predictable eventual results.

If Christ opened the path to the heavens, *recollecting* the content of this gift, in meditating the ancient mysteries and the old paths that are to be walked in, is the surest way available to understand a gift which otherwise is easily misinterpreted as just another gigantic Revolution or shortcut to cheat the Lord of Lords. Christ did not come to create a new world, but to re-create the Old.

I don’t endorse everything *Civilizing the Beast*⁹⁶ writes, but he is

⁹⁵http://www.reformationalpublishingproject.com/pdf_books/Scanned_Books_PDF/UnbeliefinReligionandPoliticsUnbeliefandRevolutionLectures_VIII_IX.pdf

⁹⁶<http://civilizingthebeast.blogspot.com/2013/06/ordered-evoluti>

right to seek a way out of the Left's empty insistence that "man as he is" (or is understood right now) can be enshrined in a Constitution as a secular demi-god, or the new Right's unintentional reversion to exoteric forms of the Past which no longer have spirit or life left within them. If Christ is holding exoteric/esoteric worlds together with the cross, this means that the Dreamtime⁹⁷ will become the wide awake truth of the Future, which always was to begin with, through the Man. It means that man will become God, as the Fathers taught. It means that history is becoming more intricately complex and subtle every day, as the Spirit weaves where it wills. Instituting the ruins of man and his revolution as "Law" is the besetting hubris of classical liberalism, since man is not merely his discursive Reason.

If you want to get to heaven, you've got to raise a little hell⁹⁸. Start, and end, with yourself. Run the race, as if to win. But do not neglect the "little things", as each adventure of the twelve labors encapsulates the whole, and even the mighty Hercules began with a "little labor".

Posted on 2014-01-25 by Logres

* * *

Paulo on 2014-01-26 at 02:15 said:

Were are the men to be found to accomplish this task? They will be seen when the separation of the wheat the chaff start to occurs? Those who have eyes will see!

Teuton on 2014-02-01 at 23:03 said:

This isn't directly related to this post, but I wonder, is there any means by which readers could contact the authors of this blog to discuss various issues or questions they might have regarding various aspects of Tradition or the content of the posts here? I know there used to be a forum here, but that seems gone.

on-rather-than-ordered.html

⁹⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dreamtime>

⁹⁸<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kYv0snhV6ZY&list=PL5DACA82DCA49E11B>

I wonder simply because I have questions that I think authors here might be able to answer, and I see this website as producing higher quality and more informed articles and insights than one finds elsewhere. In other words, I respect the content here.

Just for an example, I have some questions about the concept of initiation and how necessary it is for a valid spiritual path for someone who seeks gnosis. It seems Guenon and others highly stress its importance, but what of people who have had authentic experience of transcendence? If someone, by God's grace, had an authentic transcendent mystical experience, is such an experience equivalent to or akin to initiation? Thus having experienced a "glimpse" of Truth or the ultimate goal, could one proceed along a path that might not have an esoteric initiatory chain, say like traditional Roman Catholicism (I am still unsure if the sacraments are initiatory in the Guenonian sense or not.) I wonder because I am not really interested in losing my Western heritage by going East, even as far east as the Eastern Orthodox world, but like all true seekers I wish to find the Way. It seems modern Catholicism has a plethora of problems (but then which tradition doesn't in our dark age?), likely necessitating a Sedevacantist positioning in regards to the modern Popes, exoteric though that concern may be. Then again, it seems that, degenerated though Catholicism is, it is a valid path since it produced figures like Eckhart and Ruysbroeck historically, and even if by pursuing these lofty aims one might be a complete minority or lone wolf in relation to ones brothers in faith.

Thanks.

Logres on 2014-02-04 at 12:15 said:

Good questions, Teuton. I tend to agree that even Orthodox is too far East for my soul. Celtic Orthodoxy has a certain amount of interest as well.

Teuton on 2014-02-08 at 12:27 said:

Well, perhaps either you or Cologero could either comment on or point me in the direction of a better understanding of initiation. Again, I wonder if someone actually had a true experience of transcendence/verticality, an experience of timelessness/spacelessness and of a supra-personal reality beyond all concepts, etc. whether or not such an experience would be the equivalent to initiation. If such a one were unable to transmit that experience to another initiate, I'd presume not, but one wonders if such an experience would function as a valid "seed" toward the fruit of gnosis and how it ultimate would relate to initiation if, again, it were a true transcendent experience.

Logres on 2014-02-09 at 00:50 said:

Teuton, I can't speak for Cologero, although he has addressed this question in many and several various places, both in comments and essays. There are several issues at stake.

1. People have experiences all the time – because they aren't prepared, they don't go far enough, and they often cannot interpret them. So the real issue is preparation, whether this life or after death (post mortem). I think Cologero has said this, and BTW, all of what I know I owe to him, on these subjects, indirectly at the least.

2. The initiation from above, especially in our age (a spiritual winter, or Kali Yuga, when the sun withdraws from the earth, and things coagulate in the cold), is often transmitted in unlooked for places. Think of winter, with Christmas at its heart.

3. Mystical experience and initiation are qualitatively different, so Cologero may point out other things that apply specifically to initiation.

4. There is big debate over whether Christian sacraments are a form of initiation: Guenon says no, Schuon said yes – a French order was “put into sleep” over the debate, so as not to induce schism. Cologero has commented on some weaknesses in Guenon, but doesn't comment much on Schuon. Evola has an even different take.

You are doing the right thing, asking the right question. Just keep sharpening it. You can't get the right answers to the wrong questions. I recommend Cologero's comments recently on Guenon, over the last several months, as very enlightening, as they represent an adjunct or commentary (final thoughts) on someone he regards as the “Master of Tradition”. I hope this helps.

X on 2014-02-09 at 07:59 said:

“Mystical experience and initiation are qualitatively different”

Logres, can you please define the difference between “mystical experience” and “initiation” here? Did you mean the former as the synonym of Mysticism?

Logres on 2014-02-09 at 10:24 said:

That's right.

Teuton on 2014-02-09 at 12:37 said:

Thanks for the reply. I ask because I had a spontaneous experience around 7 years ago which changed me from an ambivalent atheist (someone who just didn't care for these subjects) to a spiritual seeker with gnosis as my ultimate goal in life overnight. I didn't know what happened to me, but I did know that it was sacred and qualitatively different from anything one can experience in the mundane world of day-to-day experience, i.e. that it was certainly transcendent in the real sense.

In order to discover what happened to me I began to research various topics, and once I read the Upanishads I felt the sages were discussing the reality I had a “glimpse” of, whereas for them it was a permanent attainment. Later I discovered Evola and most of what he said (aside

from his overly critical attitude toward Christianity in my opinion) struck a deep chord within me.

My only issue, as described earlier, is that I don't hate my race, ethnicity, or heritage and would like to retain my Western identity. Beyond that, I am skeptical about how healthy the Eastern traditions are in any case. My concern was, having an experiential reference point, whether initiation is an absolute requirement to become a "jivanmukta" as the Hindus say, since it seems it is often portrayed that way.

That said, I will certainly look over the material by Cologero you suggested.

Logres on 2014-02-09 at 17:51 said:

<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5578>

I need to reread this one, by Mercurius. <http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5116>

Cologero put this up, by Coomaraswamy. <http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=5605>

On preparation being paramount... <http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6930>

Example of his meditations on Guenon

I think there are more, and I seem to remember one being particularly good I can't find right now. You are doing the first step: trying to remember what your experience was, by clarifying it, without vitiating it, so that you can make the best use of it. It's a wise start! Glad to hear people still have such experiences. While I was in college, during a particular low point, while walking and praying, and having some agnostic intellectual problems that were devouring my faith, I saw something come out of a graveyard that convinced me that the invisible world was very tangible and real. After that, I never had any intellectual doubts about God's existence. But had I not been reading philosophy, I might have taken a very New Age turn.

scardanelli on 2014-02-11 at 08:19 said:

Teuton,

I came across this and thought it might be helpful for you. My understanding, and that which I take as truth, is the initiation of the Second Birth in which Christ is the only initiator. This initiation happens individually and not necessarily as a part of an established group or order. One finds this idea expressed in a certain "school" of writers, notably Tomberg and many of those mentioned by him in MOTT. In "History and Doctrines of the Rose-Croix" Sedir states that :

"Nowadays, whatever their leaders say, secret societies or perhaps orders, initiatory organizations, etc are in their dotage, at least in our country; and people in general are slowly being transformed in their collective organisms and little by little, are becoming capable of establishing communication with the invisible in their consciousness, in broad daylight. These developments are destined to grow incessantly, until the blessed dawn when the name of the Father shall be hallowed on Earth as it is in Heaven."

As Logres suggested, read through the archives here and at <http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com>. If you look carefully you will find a golden thread woven throughout. It is perhaps better to find on your own than to simply have all of your questions answered.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-12 at 12:41 said:

Great article with so many elucidating insights, I will have to re-read it few more times. This one and few others written by Cologero helped me a lot to crystallize thoughts and ideas that were haunting me for years. Namely, how to harmonize my Christian and certain pre Christian parts of my belief. Answer seems so simple now – Traditional Christianity is not just a continuation of one and true Tradition, but it is a religion of our Age, Kali yuga or Wolf age.

I've always felt that Christianity represents a crystalization of pagan tradition, of entire human history and existence up to that point. It's the last myth, Christ on Earth, Logos incarnated and descended to Middle Earth to prepare and transfer humanity into a new and last age of our cycle. Who would know it would be so dark?

Maybe Heracles was a Christ of his Age? Son of God, Solar principle and 'miracle worker' who died only to reach apotheosis? As he paved a path of Olympians through pure virility, out of the decadent chaotic matriarchy, humanity progressed and become ready for another, final transformation in the midst of the darkest night. This is a Hyperborean path, ultimately. And speaking of Hyperborea, I'm glad you also mentioned Abaris. I always wanted to know about this mysterious figure and priest of Apollo.

Both Apollo and Heracles, while 'young', killed a serpent. I'm fascinated by this motif of a solar warrior slaying a chthonic serpent/dragon. When I was very young, an old hag living next door forced me to kill a snake in her garden. I used a pitchfork she gave me. I remember regretting it very much, because everyone told me it's bad to kill a snake. I relate that now to a symbolism of solar vs chthonic struggle. It's good to mythologize your own childhood sometimes. Or enchant our life and world around. Still, images of chthonic nature surf out of my subconsciousness and reveal themselves for a moment. Images of titanic serpents trying to swallow me, abysmal caverns and disturbing saurian and insectoid presence. I interpret it as it's just my subconsciousness emerging to the surface. I think that often my subconsciousness comes dangerously near the surface. Especially when i'm in the contact with water. No wonder I drowned 3 times although I'm a good swimmer.

On the other hand, Solar Olympian imagery induces a trance like state and I feel elevated in spirit. Reading Evola has an erotic character for me. Same goes for Plato or even Novalis. I remember reading **Revolt Against the Modern world** for the first time, vivid visions of columns and Olympian temples and symmetric, archetypal Aryan architecture on snowy high mountain peaks danced in front of me as I felt ecstatic. It is my metaphysical exile, as Cioran would say.

If this life is a test, and it has to be, I fear that most people do not even realize it. They keep walking, not even trying to win the race. My mind is constantly aware of it and it feels very scary

sometimes. I can not turn it off anymore, seeing myself as an image in an abstract dimension. Are people on the street even aware of life? My life presented me very fine Heraklian labors and I am in front of another big one. With the new strength and knowledge, thanks to this site as well, I feel more prepared for new challenges. Time seems to speed up and chaos is growing each day. Jesus Prayer brings tears no matter how hard I try to stop it. Truly dark times are ahead of us.

Persian Traditions in Spain

6.1 McClain in his own Words

What follows are selections from “Persian Traditions in Spain” by Michael McClain

People who know me very well say that I have a mentality which is medieval and not modern, rural and not urban, that I am an “incurable romantic and idealist”, and that I have a “peasant mindset”. To all of the above I plead guilty, and as the Spanish say, *y a mucha honra*, in other words, I am proud of it.

* * *

The virtual world of computer technology is exactly the kind of environment in which tradition cannot flourish. The virtual world has no value in itself; it is merely a second-hand world that is used, in Kant’s language, as a regulative paradigm, in terms of instrumental reason. The virtual world exhibits rationality without life; without the organic component that provides the background for the special relationship between

man and the Sacred. Tradition, is treated as something authentic in Nasr's work and not as something that is considered historic, ancient, or of merely anthropological interest. Tradition, in that sense, is not merely treated as belonging in a museum or as a tourist attraction. It is understood as something living, unitary, and organic. It provides space for man and God to meet. The traditional landscape cannot, of course, be recovered. But authentic tradition can be rejuvenated in such a way that tradition is, once again, placed in the center of man's action. Tradition, at this point, is not the old-fashioned sentimental *Biedermeier Romantik* that tried to negate the oncoming industrial development, especially in Germany and also, in North America, the antebellum South of the U.S.A. Tradition in Nasr's terms means those aspects, elements, and practices that have preserved eternal values, in the face of hard won historical experience. And that includes the transcendent Unity of Being in the context of the Divine. Some of the masters of tradition, such as **Rene Guenon**, **A.K. Coomaraswamy**, **Titus Burckhardt**, **Frithjof Schuon**, or **Martin Lings**, have influenced Nasr's work on tradition.

I am not an egalitarian; there are those who proclaim themselves to be egalitarians, but they always end by setting up a hierarchy more odious than the one they clamored against and replaced; the hierarchy of wealth was far more odious than the aristocracy which it replaced, and was utterly detestable, while the socialist totalitarian techno-bureaucracy which replaced the hierarchy of wealth was even more odious and detestable than the bourgeois-plutocratic hierarchy which, in some places, it replaced. Both "the odious hierarchy of wealth" and the totalitarian, socialist techno-bureaucracy which in some places replaced it are manifestations of what Rene Guenon called "the reign of quantity". In Spanish the word for "bureaucrat" is *burocrata* while the word for "jackass" is *burro*. Thus, Spaniards often add an extra "R" to the word *burocrata*, giving *burrocrata*.

How I loathe and detest this "reign of quantity"!

I never adhered to such a vulgar, naïve, counterintuitive, pernicious, malignant and dangerous superstition as “Progress with a capital “P”. Edgar Allen Poe, William Blake, Robert Burns, G.K. Chesterton, Hilaire Belloc, Rene Guenon, The Spanish Carlists, William Butler Yeats, Lord Northbourne, Frithjof Schuon, Alain Danielou, Feodor Dostoyevsky and the Russian Slavophiles, Alexis Carrel, Corneliu Codreanu, Mircea Eliade, Seyyed Hossein Nasr, Martin Heidegger, Leonid Ouspensky, Vladimir Lossky, Fr. Seraphim Rose, Arthur Machen, Jose Ortega y Gasset, Dylan Thomas, Vernon Watkins, T.S. Eliot, Alexandr Solzhenitsyn, Kathleen Raine, the Southern Agrarians, Charles A. Coulombe, Henry Corbin, J.R.R. Tolkien, Pope John Paul II, Allamah Tabataba’i, Swami Ramdas, and, perhaps most recently, Christopher I. Beckwith, among many others, have thoroughly skewered the vulgar superstition of “Progress with a capital “P”. For someone to refer to himself as a “Progressive” is as absurd as to refer to oneself as a “Unicornist”. Though I do not believe in unicorns, I find it easier to believe in them than to believe in “Progress with a capital “P”. As I said above, how anyone familiar with the history of the Western World in the two centuries spanning the period between the French Revolution and the downfall of the Soviet Union can believe in the vulgar, counterintuitive and pernicious superstition known as “Progress” is beyond me.

I utterly reject the godless *Kali Yuga*, the dehumanized, techno-bureaucratic, totalitarian nightmare, a cultural desert and moral sewer to which “Progress with a capital P” leads and aspires.

Posted on 2016-07-25 by Michael McClain

* * *

K on 2016-08-01 at 06:11 said:

His words of being against virtual world are read and known by people in the virtual world, this is the state of people in the age of virtual world.

Logres on 2016-08-03 at 00:21 said:

Yes but do they understand them?

6.2 Preface to Persian Traditions

First let me introduce myself. People who know me very well say that I have a mentality which is medieval and not modern, rural and not urban, that I am an “incurable romantic and idealist”, and that I have a “peasant mindset”. To all of the above I plead guilty, and as the Spanish say, *y a mucha honra*, in other words, I am proud of it.

When one speaks of relations between Spain and Persia or of Persian influences in Spain, most people immediately think of elements which entered the Iberian Peninsula during the long period of Muslim dominance. This theme has been subject of many studies, by Hussein Munis and E. Levi-Provençal among others. For the above reasons, in the present study I am devoting much space to relations or influences which either predate the Muslim Conquest of Spain, which entered independently of said conquest, or, though they may have first entered with the Crescent of Islam, remained long after said Crescent had waned and set. To do a really complete and thorough study of this topic would require a great deal more time and money than I at present have at my disposal. In particular, it would require a long journey through Portugal, Aragon, Catalunya and Valencia, not to mention Iran. I have chosen to devote much time to Toledo, which was capital of Spain in Visigothic times and which is really a synthesis of all cultures, religions and artistic styles which form the threads of the multicolored fabric, part Celtic tartan, part Oriental carpet, which is the history of Spain.

I have also concentrated to a great degree on Asturias and Galicia.

These regions were perhaps the least affected of all by the Muslim Conquest. Indeed, were it not for historical records there would be nothing to indicate that said conquest even took place in this Northwest corner of Spain. Yet, in the fields of art and architecture Sassanian influences were very strong indeed. Old Castile and Leon, lacerated for so long by endless border wars and border raids (of the men of Leon and Old Castile one might say what Sir Walter Scott said of the Vikings: "They had a breast-plate for a cradle and were fed from a blade.") were unable to develop their own artistic and architectural styles. The art and architecture of Leon and Old Castile in the Middle Ages is simply one aspect of the European Romanesque and Gothic styles, lightly touched by Mozarab, Muslim and Mudejar influences. In the field of literature, I have concentrated on epic poetry simply because in the field of lyric verse it is practically impossible to determine what may be of Persian derivation and what is of Celtic and/or Provencal inspiration. Nevertheless, as we shall see, I have not completely neglected the lyric.

The Arabic language has no epic tradition, and therefore neither the Arabs nor their language could be considered as likely intermediaries between the epic traditions of Iran and Old Castile. I hope to demonstrate that one is really on quite firm ground when speaking of Iranian elements in the Castilian epic tradition. Although here one encounters the problem of how to distinguish between what is the result of Iranian influences and what proceeds from the strong Celtic substratum of Old Castile, I believe that it can be shown that there are a number of elements which the Castilian Epic shares only and exclusively with the Persian Epic.

I wish to thank all my friends in Galicia, Asturias, Andalusia, Extremadura, Old Castile and Leon for all the help and kindness which I received, and also to thank the Illustrious Mozarabic Community of Toledo for the kindness and hospitality which I received during the 1st International Congress of Mozarabic Studies, during which I was able to obtain photos of Toledo and its environs which help to illustrate this

study. I also wish to thank the Southwestern College of Business of Middletown, Ohio and the Middletown Branch of Miami University (Ohio) for their kindness in allowing me to use their personal computers.

I also wish to dedicate this book to the memory of the late Walter Havighurst, my professor of creative writing at the University of Miami of Ohio. It was Professor Havighurst who really taught me the art of composition in English. In particular, it was Professor Havighurst's favorite motto, ***Do not tell, show***, which has guided me in my compositions, both fiction and non-fiction, as I recall several times in the present work.

Posted on 2020-03-13 by Michael McClain

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Michael on 2020-03-17 at 09:37 said:

Looking forward to this, thank you for publishing this online. Will attempt to actively follow along.

Rostam on 2020-03-27 at 23:44 said:

Amazing! As an Iranian who is well read in European history, I was completely unaware of such influence. Looking forward to reading this book.

6.3 John of the Cross, the Rumi of Spain

Thus it is perfectly clear how near is **St. John of the Cross** in his mystical vocabulary (allowing for language differences, of course) and poetic style, i.e., imagery, metaphors, symbolism, even to some extent versification techniques, to the Persian Sufis. One may easily imagine the works of St. John of the Cross without the influence of ibn Abbad, since such influence is found only in *Dark Night of the Soul* and its prose commentary of the same title; however, take away all which so forcefully calls to mind Suhrawardi and the great Persian Sufi poets and St. John of the Cross

would be reduced to a spiritual counselor in the tradition of **Dionysius the Pseudo-Areopagite**, **St. Gregory of Nyssa** and **Gregory Palamas** as well as a minor poet, his uniqueness and greatness as poet and thinker gone.

In summary, Persian Sufis and Dervishes came to the Kingdom of Granada, particularly in the 13th and 14th Centuries, and their influence there was very considerable, combining with the Sufi and esoteric traditions of al-Andalus. Later this influence passed to St. John of the Cross by way of the Moriscos and perhaps other means as well. Spain and Safavi Persia were both mortal enemies of the Ottoman Turks; during this time Spaniards did visit Persia, and did learn the Persian language while there. St. John of the Cross may have been in direct or indirect contact with said ambassadors. While there is no documentary proof of this, the thing itself is perfectly possible.

The observations of Fr. Asin relative to the evident influence of ibn Abbad do not weaken one whit the thesis that St. John of the Cross owed a great deal to the Persian Sufis; rather they strengthen it, being yet another proof that St. John of the Cross was in contact with the Moriscos and from them learned much. Nor does all this detract from the genius of St. John of the Cross as a poet and mystic. Of the many millions who have read the verse of the Persian Sufi poets (and St. John of the Cross knew this verse only indirectly), how many have been able to compose such works of genius as are the poems of St. John of the Cross?

The fact that St. John of the Cross was so open to said influence is a proof of the fact that **he was an initiate in the esoteric path** and of the ecumenism typical of all true mystics. If **Rumi** is the St. John of the Cross of Persia, then St. John of the Cross is the Rumi of Spain.

Posted on 2016-07-23 by Michael McClain

* * *

Allahu Haqq on 2016-07-28 at 22:38 said:
Where can I get this book?

Cologero on 2020-07-23 at 07:45 said:

The text is rambling and needs editing. The author is a technophobe, so the formatting and fonts in the Word document are inconsistent. It needs a lot of work for publication, but the author is uncooperative.

I may just convert everything – as is – to PDF files.

Michael M on 2020-07-23 at 08:25 said:

If of interest I would be willing to work on the formatting, of course that would take the author being cooperative. PDF as is would be useful anyway for those of us reading.

6.4 Karbala

These extracts from the longer work *Persian Traditions in Spain*¹ by **Michael McClain** were originally published in the *International Journal of Shi'i Studies*, Volume V, No. 1, 2007, under the title “Affinities Between Catholicism and Shi’ism”.

The special affinity² between traditional Catholicism and Shi‘ism has been noted by many, indeed since the time of the Crusades. In the twelfth century, the Crusader Archbishop William of Tyre wrote: “Muhammad’s son-in-law ‘Ali (Ibn Abi Talib) was the best knight, braver and more valiant than any of the other caliphs had been... The Shi’a is not so far from the true Christian faith as is the Sunna.”³ Far more recently, the same sentiments were echoed in *Roman Catholics and Shi‘i Muslims*, by James A. Bill and John Alden Williams (Chapel Hill, North Carolina, 2002).

¹https://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=11751

²Excerpted from *Persian Traditions in Spain* by Michael McClain.

³Zoe Oldenbourg, *The Crusades* (New York, 1966), p. 492.

As we shall see below, the great Spanish Catholic poet and mystic **St. John of the Cross** could in a very real sense be considered a spiritual master in the line of Hassan, the second Shi'a Imam and the son of 'Ali Ibn Abi Talib.

The above is confirmed by the fact that these feelings are very much mutual. Says **Mahmoud Ayoub**, a Lebanese Shi'a:

The problem of human freedom and divine sovereignty and will is as complex a theological issue in Islam as it is in Christianity. While both the broad emphasis and the more basic theological orientation are quite different in the two traditions, the Shi'i view is closer to the Christian position than it is to the strict Sunni Islamic view. God wills, knows and decrees; yet man is still responsible for his choice, a choice which confronts him at every moment, as the earth would never be void of a proof or witness (hujjah) of God over His servants both to judge and to redeem them. The proximity of the Shi'i view to that of Christianity is perhaps due to the fact that both accept a mediator between man and God, one whose essential being and place in human history plays a determining role in the divine plan for creation, revelation and salvation. Thus we must agree with Henry Corbin that Shi'i imamology is a kind of "Islamic Christology". In Christian piety, (Jesus) Christ is the eternal Logos, the divine Word; the agent of creation on one hand, and on the other hand the slain lamb standing before the throne of majesty both to save and to judge. The Imams, likewise, are at one and the same time the pivot of creation and reason for its subsistence, and the blood-stained martyrs whose death is a point of contention between God and their persecutors.

MAHMOUD AYOUB, *Redemptive Suffering in Islam: A Study of the Devotional Aspects of Ashura in Twelver Shi'ism*, The Hague, 1978, p. 199.

Sayyid Musa al-Sadr, the Iranian-born former spiritual leader of the Lebanese Shi'as, illustrates this. He sometimes preached in Catholic churches, and showed himself a past master in touching Catholic hearts and evoking Catholic spirituality, very often moving the congregation to tears, as in his famous Lenten homily of February 19, 1975 in the Cathedrale Saint-Louis des Capucins in Beirut.⁴ Though Sayyid Musa al-Sadr was certainly a brilliant man, this above-mentioned mastery, much greater than that of most Catholic priests who have studied for years at a Catholic seminary and have long experience in the Catholic priesthood, would be inconceivable if his training at Shi'ite centers in Qum and Najaf had not somehow prepared him to touch Catholic hearts and evoke Catholic spirituality.

Traditional Catholics are much closer to traditional Shi'as than they are to either Protestants or "modernist," "progressive" and "post-Vatican II" Catholics. The Catholic thinker Hilaire Belloc considered Protestantism to be the fountainhead of modernity, and therefore something very near to "the source of all evils." However, he had considerable respect for Islam, and left no doubt that he believed Islam to be far closer to Catholicism than is Protestantism.⁵

Both traditional (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox) Christianity and traditional Islam affirm that God is both immanent and transcendent. To deny either God's transcendence or His immanence is to put limitations and conditions on God. Besides the general affinity between traditional Catholicism and Shi'ism, Spanish Catholicism and Iranian Shi'ism have so many particular characteristics in common that the resemblance between them is often uncanny. We will give only a few examples. The resemblance between Ashura, the anniversary of the martyrdom of Imam

⁴See FOUAD AJAMI, *The Vanished Imam* (Ithaca, New York, 1987), pp. 133-135. MAJED HALAWI, *A Lebanon Defied: Musa al-Sadr and the Shi'a Community* (Oxford, England, 1992), pp. 192-195.

⁵Hilaire Belloc, *The Crisis of Civilization*, New York, 1937.

Hussayn as celebrated in Iran, and Holy Week as celebrated in most of Spain has been noted by many. Of course, the Church very strongly disapproves of deliberately doing bodily harm to oneself. However, anyone who has heard the heart-wrenching “sactas” of a Spanish Holy Week and seen the processions with the images of Christ being scourged at the pillar and carrying the Cross will readily grasp what we are talking about. During Holy Week in Spain, I have heard keening and seen weeping. I have seen people prostrate themselves, carry or drag heavy weights long distances or hobble long distances on their knees. In some places in Spain, notably in Lorca in the province of Murcia, dramatic representations of the events leading to the Crucifixion are part of the Holy Week ceremonies, demonstrating a striking parallel to the *taziye*h of Ashura celebrated in Iran...

Below is a poem by the Persian poet **Ansari** on the martyrdom of **Imam Hussayn**:

O breeze of morning, take to 'Ali these words of the poet

Ansari:

Say: Hussayn is fallen. Rise, then, go and see.

To Karbala from Najaf where you lie,

His body in a hundred pieces pierced by the lance, the dagger, the sword.

See who was once the light of your eyes,

Now the enemy around him like eyelashes around the eye;

And here you lie, in pleasant repose with Adam and Noah,
at rest

While Hussayn has as his resting place the burning sands of
Karbala!

Although you were made stranger to yourself by the stroke
of the sword,

Around you were both stranger and kin, with refreshments
and sweets;

While the body of your (son) Hussayn is rent the whole
length with wounds.
And would you know the number of those wounds?
They are as many as the stars!
Wherever you turned your gaze, there stood a friend to see,
While Hussayn's eye falls only on the enemy.
'Ali, when you gave your life your family was there beside
you,
But there on a desert plain far from daughter or sister Hus-
sayn dies.
Faithful Spirit, Gabriel, brought a shroud from Heaven,
But Hussayn fell there on the earth without ablution, with-
out shroud!
'Ali, since Hussayn in the last hour took your head on his
lap to lie,
As kindness in return, then, lay his head on your lap till he
dies.

LYNDA CLARK, *Elegy (Marthiya) on Hussein:*
Arabic and Persian, Al-Serat, Spring & Autumn
(London 1986), pp. 24-25.

According to Ibn Abbas, after the battle of Siffin, 'Ali Ibn Abi Talib, the First Imam, told him:

Jesus one day passed with his disciples through Karbala and on that spot they saw a group of gazelles gathered together weeping. Jesus and his disciples sat and wept with them, without the disciples knowing the reason for that lamentation. Jesus finally told them that this was a spot on which was to be killed the young descendant of the Apostle Ahmad (Muhammad), and child of the

pure, unblemished virgin Fatima, who is like unto my mother (the Virgin Mary). He (Hussayn) shall be buried on this spot whose soil is more fragrant than musk. For it is the burial place of the martyr (Hussayn). Such is the soil containing the bodies of prophets and descendants of prophets.

AYOUB, op. cit., pp. 237-238.

Some will say that ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, the First Imam, was trying to express a difficult truth by way of allegory and parable, as Jesus often did. However, at this point, there is something I wish to note. In Arabic, the New Testament or the Gospel is called *Injil*, which is not pure Arabic, but rather it is derived from the Greek *Euangelion*, meaning, roughly, “good news” or “a good message”. Like the word “angel,” the Greek *Euangelion* is remotely derived from the Avestan word for “messenger,” the *Eu* being a prefix which means “good”. From the Greek *Euangelion* comes the Medieval Latin *Evangelium*, from which in turn are derived so many words in English and various Romance languages...

We shall deal later with traditions connecting Imam Hussayn and **St. John the Baptist**. For the moment, we continue to refer to the tragedy of Karbala and the martyrdom of Imam Hussayn. Below is part of a meditation on the month of Muharram, which marks the anniversary of the tragedy of Karbala. This one is particularly interesting, because it includes a brief account of the tragedy written by **Ja’far al-Sadiq**, the Sixth Imam and great-grandson of the Imam Hussayn, the martyr of Karbala.

Muharram is one of the four months declared sacred by Allah in the Holy Qur’an. The other three holy months are Rajab, Dhu Qi’da, and Dhu Hijja. “There is no god save Allah.” If someone claims to be a god or has faith in others’ godhead, other than Allah, Allah does not make a compromise to take anyone as god,

although He gives a free hand even to such false pretenders, because: "There is no compulsion in religion" (Qur'an: 2:156).

In verse 59 of Sura al-Nissa, Allah says: "O you who believe! Obey Allah, and obey the Messenger and the *Ulil Amr* (those who are authorized to command) from among you." The believers always obey Allah, His messenger, and the *Ulil Amr* appointed by Him. It is an open invitation. There is no compulsion. Those who are not believers can do what they wish. Likewise the prophets and messengers sent down by Allah to guide and warn people never accepted anyone else as a prophet or messenger, whatever the circumstances, although they did not stop claimants of this kind, or opponents, with the application of force or repression.

In the same manner, Imam 'Ali Ibn Abi Talib did not recognize anyone else as *Ulil Amr*. His elder son Hassan, like his grandfather, the Holy Prophet (with the treaty of Hdaybiah), let Mua'wiyah become the ruler, but he did not give up his rights as *Ulil Amr*, which he was at that time.

When Yazid became the ruler, he threw to the wind the earlier policy of the rulers not to demand the *bay'a* (oath of obedience) from the children of the Holy Prophet, and he began to exercise pressure upon the Imam Hussayn to swear fealty and acknowledge him as the *Ulil Amr*, which the Holy Imam rightly refused to do. Another aspect of the whole affair is that Yazid was the vilest tyrant of the worst type, but even if he had been an ordinary ruler Imam Hussayn could not swear fealty to him as the *Ulil Amr*. So he did not. In the month of Rajab, in year 68 A.H., he left Medina and went to Mecca. From Mecca, before performing the Hajj, he took his family with him, and with some friends and companions, he began the journey toward Iraq, with the expressed intention to cross the boundaries of the empire under the rule of Yazid, and settle down in some other country, Iran or India, because he wanted to make it clear to Yazid that he could not swear obedience to a non-*Ulil Amr*, as he himself was an *Ulil Amr*.

It was not to be. A large army in service of Yazid under the command

of ‘Umar Ibn Saad surrounded the caravan of the Imam Hussayn when he reached Karbala on the second of Muharram, 61 A.H.

There are several aspects of human relationship and behavior in the events of Karbala that took place in the 10 days of Muharram, culminating in the Martyrdom of the Imam Hussayn and his 72 friends and relatives, which come into sharp focus as we recount every minute, during the religious gatherings each year, but above all, the ultimate reason remains the same: the impossibility of swearing an “oath of loyalty” (*bay‘a*) by an *Ulil Amr* to obey a non-*Ulil Amr*.

After the Imam Hussayn, all his successors to “the office of *Ulil Amr*,” our Holy Imams, refused to obey “non-*Ulil Amrs*,” and every ruler held each of them prisoner, used every trick, applied force, and in the end killed every Imam, exactly as Yazid did.

Muharram is a month of mourning for the lovers and followers of the family of Muhammad. On the tenth day of this month in 61 A.H., the Imam Hussayn, the grandson of the Holy Prophet and the younger son of ‘Ali and Fatima, together with his family and friends, in all 72 men, were slain on the sands of the desert of Karbala. Since then, each year the true followers of the Holy Prophet, through grief, sorrow and tears, keep alive the message, cause and purpose of the greatest martyrdom in human history.

No doubt Muharram is a holy and sacred month. The believing men and women, in this month, suspend the application of good effects of days and dates and avoid rejoicing even if happy events come to pass. The friends and followers of the family of Muhammad hold meetings; they have been doing so for the last 1,300 years, in the name of the Imam Hussayn, during the months of Muharram and Safar, particularly in the last ten days of Muharram, to give new life to the Divine Message of “There is no god but God.”... Each year at the advent of Muharram, Islam turns over a new leaf. In fact, it is on account of the Imam Hussayn’s remembrance every year that we know who the Holy Prophet, ‘Ali Ibn

Abi Talib, and Bibi Fatima Zahra are, and what their true substance, style and wisdom were. It is because of the Imam Hussayn's memory that we call to mind each year the original Islam, and it becomes clearly visible from behind the smoke screen of the dust of delusion thrown into the eyes of Muslims in the name of Muslim rule... .

Ja'far al-Saddiq, the Sixth Imam, recounts:

A large army in the service of Yazid, under the command of 'Umar Ibn Saad, surrounded the Imam Hussayn, his family and friends, on all sides on the ninth of Muharram, shouting for joy and uttering songs of triumph, in view of the presence of countless soldiers armed with swords, lances, arrows, and sling stones, all this against a handful of 72, among whom were 90-year-old men and a six-month old child. The Imam Hussayn at that time received no support from any quarter. He was forsaken in this dire situation.

On the night of Ashura, the Holy Imam had invited his companions and relatives to sit together, after evening prayers, and hear his last address. As soon as the prayers came to an end, they sat around him.

He said: "Brothers! It is a misjudgment if, in one's heart of hearts, anyone expects to witness my victory in tomorrow's battle and gather the fruit of conquest. I tell you, in clear words, that the enemy will slay me, beyond the shadow of a doubt, and in a manner that will make your blood run cold. 'Abbas, my brother, his hands both cut off, shall be killed on the slope of the shore of the River Euphrates, running along the river. A lance will pass through the heart of my son, 'Ali Akbar. The hooves of the enemy's cavalry will crush the wounded body of my brother's son, Qasim. Likewise, whoever stays with me, be he a kinsman or a friend, will be killed in cold blood. I tell you, beforehand, that an arrow, deliberately and purposefully aimed with premeditated malice, shall hit the throat of my six-month old son, 'Ali Asghar.

He shall die on the spot in my arms. My son, ‘Ali, who now suffers from a high fever, alone shall weather the storm, and bear in the aftermath the worst and meanest abuse, along with the womenfolk of Muhammad’s family.

“Friends! Do not let your heart break nor have qualms on account of obligation of loyalty to me and my cause, concerning which you have sworn an oath. I, willingly, set you free from the sworn pledge. Leave me alone to that which lies in wait for me tomorrow. They will be after me and no other. The night is dark. You can escape and vanish unseen in the darkness.”

The Holy Imam asked his brother ‘Abbas to put out the candles, to let the deserters show their heels and save their necks. In the darkness many escaped. The lamps again were lit and a final group of 72 was sitting there calm and quiet, willingly prepared to meet certain death the next morning when the “great sacrifice” (*dhibh ‘azeem*), as promised by the Almighty, would become a fact.

“And We (Allah) ransomed him (Ismail) with a great sacrifice” (Qur’an, 37:107). It was a dark, dismal and deadly night. The chosen group of godly men and women passed the whole night reciting the Holy Qur’an, worshipping Allah, performing Sal?t, and their guide, the Imam Hussayn, was with them at all times.

It is a proof of sincere devotion to Allah if we, his followers, also spend this night in the worship of Allah. Whoever spends this night awake, until the daybreak, worshipping Allah, near the grave of the Imam Hussayn, Allah will raise him or her on the Day of Judgment, along with the martyrs of Karbala...

Today is the Day of Ashura, the day of Martyrdom of Imam Hussayn. Today, in the year 61 A.H., the Imam the S?ra al-S?ff?t: “And We (Allah) ransomed him (Ismail) with a great sacrifice.”

It was the third day since the water supply to the Imam’s camp had been disconnected. At dawn the small devoted group performed “Tayam-

mum” and assembled to perform the Fajr Sal?t behind the Imam Hussayn. The first swarming flight of arrows shot by the enemy archers hit the Holy Imam and his devotees while they were saying the Sal?m. Thirty persons were killed on the spot. With “whatever is left,” the Imam came onto the battlefield and before attacking the enemy soldiers, addressed them to make known his rights and status with reference to the Holy Prophet and the Book of Allah. He warned them not to kill him as it would bring upon them destruction in this world and everlasting punishment on the Day of Judgment. The Holy Imam again and again tried to make them understand the consequences of the events that would take place if they did not listen to him. He once again proposed that they let him, together with his family and friends, go away and settle down in some far-off land, far from the jurisdiction of the Muslim Empire. They listened to what he had to say, but declared: “We shall kill you if you do not agree to recognize Yazid’s overlordship by swearing loyalty to him.”

Despite the hunger, thirst, and wounds, one by one the devotees of Imam Hussayn went to fight against the hordes of demons in human shape, displayed rare acts of bravery and courage, and gave their lives in the cause of Allah. On every occasion the Holy Imam, together with his brother and son, dispersed the “blood hounds,” carried away the dead bodies, and lay down on the ground under a tent, now known as “Ganj-i-Shaheedan”.

The sun had crossed the meridian. The time for the Zuhr prayers had begun. The renegades refused any sort of truce. The Imam therefore prayed Zuhr Sal?t as “Namaz of Khawf”.

After the companions and friends of the Holy Prophet, the Imam Ali, and the Imam Hussayn had given their lives, as he had foretold in his “Shab-i-Ashura” speech, it was the turn of his relatives. The two sons of Bibi Zaynab (Awn, 10, and Muhammad, 9), Qasim, the son of Imam Hassan, 14, ‘Abbas, the standard bearer, the backbone of the Imam, ‘Ali Akbar, the Imam’s 18 year old son, the other sons of ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, and

the grandsons of ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, one and all, gave their lives in order to bring to life the message “there is no god but God” and for keeping alive their Imam, *Ulil Amr*.

Then our beloved Imam stood alone. Bruised, slashed, cut, gashed, thirsty, soaked in his own blood and in the blood of his sons, brothers, nephews and devoted friends, he went into the tent of his sister, Bibi Zaynab. His six-month old son, ‘Ali Asghar, was in her lap, dying of thirst and hunger. He took him in his arms and slowly walked up to the warlike array of heartless Muslims.

He lifted the child up on his hands. This sad, sensitive, eloquent spectacle made even the devil’s disciples curse the devil. With tears in their eyes they cried in deep anguish. Afraid of a revolt in the ranks, Ibn Saad looked at Hurmalah, who, reading the message in his commander’s eyes, took aim and shot the fatal arrow which, passing through the Imam’s hand, went into the child’s neck. ‘Ali Asghar stared at his father’s face, smiled, and rested in peace. The Imam dug a small grave and buried his son.

Then the Holy Imam paid his last visit to his kinfolk in the tents and went forth mounted on his horse Zuljenah, wearing his grandfather’s garments, and holding “Zulfiqar” (the sword of ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib), in his hand.

On the battlefield he pronounced his last call: “Is there a helper?” There was no response. A fierce battle ensued. Then Zuljenah sat on the ground. The Holy Imam, every pore of his body a bleeding wound, slid over the burning sands of Karbala. It was the time for the ‘As?r prayers. He bent over and rested his forehead on the ground in prostration. Swords, arrows, spears, daggers, lances, and stones hit him from all directions. The sacred blood of Muhammad, ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, and Fatima Zahra flowed in a stream over the sandy soil.

The Imam Hussayn, our master, and master of every living being, thereupon whispered to his Creator: “O merciful Lord of the worlds!

Hussayn, your servant, has given up everything which you had granted him according to your holy will. Accept the humble sacrifice of your servant Hussayn. If I, the grandson of your Messenger, had more, I would have surrendered it to you willingly... .”

The eternally cursed Shimr came close and severed the sacred head of the Holy Imam from his blessed body. The heavens and the earth sank low into a pit of gloom. A dreary, dismal darkness spread out everywhere. A cosmic cry of agony echoed in every nook and cranny of the universe. Animals stopped in their tracks, birds swerved in their flight, and a shiver ran through trees, water, valleys, plains and mountains.

The demons, in devilish frenzy, trampled the bodies of the devoted martyrs under the hooves of their horses, plundered, looted, and set fire to the tents. The bewildered children and tearful women ran to Bibi Zaynab, the daughter of “Asadullah,” and gathered around her.

From the first of Muharram to the ninth we discuss the philosophy of Hussayn’s martyrdom, we look into and make clear every aspect of true Islam, we carefully identify the role and merits of the Holy Prophet, the Imam ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, Bibi Fatima Zahra, we make known and expound upon the real meanings of the “Word of Allah,” the Holy Qur’an, on the strength of the wisdom and knowledge of Muhammad and the Family of Muhammad, we recount all the facets of the character of the Imam Hussayn which achieves much toward making available to mankind the vision and the ideal of making efforts to establish a society free from submission to idols and false gods – in whatever form, idea or institution they try to enslave mankind – and obedient to Allah and His laws.

But today we the friends and followers of the Imam Hussayn, who love him and belong to him, and through him to his father, mother and grandfather, and through them belong to their Lord, the Lord of the worlds (1) pray the Fajr Sal?t. After the Fajr Sal?t we carry out the A‘m?l Ashura. (2) We do not drink water, nor eat food. (3) Barefoot, bareheaded, attired in black, we come out from the shade and shelter of our homes,

in the open, under the sky. (4) Together, disciplined, row after row, we recite moment to moment the events that took place in Karbala, until evening. (5) We pray the Zuhr and 'As?r Sal?t at their fixed times. (6) Tears come to our eyes as the dry yellow leaves fall to the ground in autumn. It is an instinctive reaction; we weep, mourn and cry; in the height of our love for the Holy Imam some of us scrape and cut ourselves (not others) to feel the pain and hurt that the martyrs of Karbala suffered on the tenth of Muharram, 61 A.H. In no way is there any hint of self-torture or exhibitionism, just as Uways Qarane? broke all his teeth when he heard the news that in the battle of Uhad his "beloved", the Holy Prophet had lost a couple of teeth. It is the domain of love and passionate attachment, deep and abounding devotion, like the leap which the prophet Ibrahim took into the blazing fire. (7) We invoke Allah to lay a curse upon the killers of the Imam Hussayn, his family and friends."⁶

Posted on 2016-08-30 by Michael McClain

* * *

Akira Kalashnikov on 2016-09-02 at 19:23 said:

Fascinating post.

(Okay this is probably going to go straight to the spam bin, but here goes...)

Some further reading:

On the Alawites, the most mysterious of the Shiites, and the closest of all to Christianity:
The Asian Mystery

<https://books.google.com/books?id=FBZdAAAAcAAJ&dq=inauthor%3A%22Samuel%20Lyde%22&pg=PR3#v=onepage&q&f=false>

The Ansyreeh and Ismaeleeh: A Visit to the Secret Sects of Northern Syria

<https://books.google.com/books?id=olMBAAAAQAAJ&dq=secret%20sects%20of%20syria&pg=PR1#v=onepage&q&f=false>

SECRET SECTS OF SYRIA

https://archive.org/stream/secretsectsofsyr032392mbp/secretsectsofsyr032392mbp_djvu.txt

⁶Abbas Qummi, *Supplications, Prayers & Ziyarats* (Iran 2005), pp. 182-195.

On the sharing of Shrines between Christians and Muslims:

<https://archive.org/details/Hasluck1929ChristianityIslam01>

<https://archive.org/details/Hasluck1929ChristianityIslam02>

'On Some Parallels Between Anatolian and Balkan Islamic Heterodox Traditions and the Problem of their Co-Existence and Interchange with Popular Christianity'

<https://books.google.com/books?id=i9E29RZgHDIC&lpg=PA75&ots=FCr4bVvh4C&dq=parallels%20between%20anatolian%20balkan%20heterodox%20islamic%20and%20christian&pg=PA75#v=onepage&q&f=false>

Cologero on 2016-10-09 at 08:29 said:

It seems that Mr. McClain may have been years ahead of his time as this piece *Shiite Catholic*⁷, by a Cistercian monk, shows.

The *Vienna-Qom Circle for Catholic-Shi'a Dialogue*⁸ has been established (it includes Russian Orthodox members) to discuss Religion, Philosophy and Political Theory.

Daniel on 2016-11-04 at 21:14 said:

The Persian poet Ansari (Ansari of Herat) was not a Shi'i. He was a Sunni jurist of the Hanbali madhhab and a Sufi disciple of the famous master Abu'l Hasan Kharraqani.

There is some degree of affinity between Shi'ism and Catholicism, but there is a greater affinity between Catholicism and Sufism, as a study of Louis Massignon would show.

6.5 Ridwan and Malik

Christians, particularly Christian monks or other holy men, often play a considerable role in the traditions concerning the martyrdom of the Imam Hussayn, usually acting as a rebuke to put to shame nominal Muslims who betrayed the Imam Hussayn. Here is a sample.

Hussayn's head, according to popular tradition, was sent to Damascus with a large company of bodyguards to make sure it got to Yazid. On the way, the caravan stopped for a night below a hermitage where a Christian monk lived, spending his life in solitary

⁷<https://sancrucensis.wordpress.com/2016/09/30/shiite-catholic/>

⁸<https://viqocircle.org/>

worship. As they sat down for dinner, a hand wrote on the wall with letters of blood: "Would a community that killed Hussayn hope for the intercession of his grandfather (Muhammad) on the day of Reckoning?" The monk looked down and saw the writing on the wall and the head of the Imam Hussayn surrounded by an aura of bright light. He offered Ibn Saad ten thousand dinars to keep the head for a night. He took the head and, with it pressed to his bosom, spent the night weeping.⁹

The special place which St. Peter holds in the Catholic Tradition is well known. He is called "Prince of the Apostles" and the "keeper of the keys of the Kingdom." The popes are considered the successors of St. Peter. In this respect the Shi'ite tradition is also very interesting. Mahmoud Ayoub says:

Ridwan (the keeper of paradise) and Malik (the keeper of hell) will come to the Prophet (Muhammad) and deliver into his hands the keys of paradise and hell. The Prophet will give them (the keys) to 'Ali, who will then permit whomsoever he wishes to enter paradise and whomsoever he wishes to enter the fire (of hell). In this mood of exultation, the tradition concludes, "And hell shall be on that day more obedient to 'Ali than a young servant would be to his master." The intercessory character of this tradition is obvious. It is, however, interesting to note the similarity in this tradition between 'Ali, the viceregent and successor of Muhammad, and Simon (St.) Peter, the prince of the apostles and keeper of the keys of the Kingdom. In the Shi'i doctrine of the Imamate-succession, St. Peter (*Shamun al-Safa*) is declared to be a prophet.¹⁰

Thus, not only is the role of 'Ali Ibn Abi Talib in the Shi'a tradition very similar to that of St. Peter in the Catholic tradition, but in the Shi'a

⁹Ayoub, op. cit., p. 133.

¹⁰Ibid., p. 203.

tradition as well as the Catholic tradition St. Peter is accorded a position superior to that of the other apostles of Jesus.

It would be very wrong to say that the role of Fatima al-Zahra (the Radiant), daughter of the prophet Muhammad, wife of ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, the First Imam, and mother of the Imams Hassan and Hussayn, is identical to the role of the Virgin Mary, mother of Jesus Christ, in the Catholic and Orthodox Churches. The expression “Mother of God” (Greek: *Theotokos*, Latin: *Mater Dei*) is simply unthinkable in an Islamic context. Nevertheless, there are parallels between the role of the Virgin Mary in the Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Churches on the one hand and the role of Fatima Zahra in Shi‘a Islam on the other...

Jacob of Serug, known as “flute of the Holy Spirit and harp of the faithful church,” was born in 451 AD and died in 519 AD. Though born at Curtem on the Euphrates, he became Bishop of Serug, also in Syria. He is best known for his Syriac homilies on the Virgin Mary, such as this extract from one of his homilies:

*The story of Mary stirs in me, to show itself in wonder; you, wisely,
prepare your minds!*

*The Holy Virgin calls me today to speak of her; let us purge our
bearing for her luminous tale, lest it be dishonored.*

*Blessed of women, by whom the curse of the land was eradicated,
and the sentence henceforth has come to an end.*

*Modest, chaste and filled with beauties of holiness, so that my mouth
is inadequate to speak a word concerning her.*

*Second Eve who generated life among mortals, and paid and rent
asunder the bill of Eve her mother.*

*Virgin who without marital union marvelously became a mother,
a mother who remained without change in her virginity.*

*The image of her beauty is more glorious and exalted than my com-
position; I do not dare let my mind depict the form of her image.*

It is easier to depict the sun with its light and its heat than to tell the story of Mary in its splendor.

Perhaps the rays of the sphere can be captured in pigments, but the tale concerning her is not completely told by those who preach...

She is virgin and mother and wife of a husband yet unmated; how may I speak if I say that she is incomprehensible?

Then He sent a Watcher (angel) from the Heavenly legions, that he might bring the good tidings to the blessed one, most fair.

Gabriel, the great chief of the hosts, descended; he went down to her as he had been sent from God.

Because she alone was worthy of the great mystery which was rich in divine revelations.

With prayers and in limpidity and in simplicity, Mary received that spiritual revelation.

She being holy and standing in wonder in God's presence, her heart was poured forth with love in prayer before Him.

She was in prayer, as also Daniel was in prayer, when this same Watcher of light descended to him.

The Watcher had descended while Mary was standing in prayer; he gave her the greeting which was sent to her from the Most High...

"Hail Mary, our Lord is with you," he was saying to her, "you will conceive and bear a son in your virginity."

She said to him: "How will this be as you say, since I am a virgin and there is no fruit of virgins?"...

The Watcher told her that she would conceive the Son of God, but she did not accept it until she was well informed...

She asked the Watcher: "How will what you tell me take place?" He began explaining the way of the Son and His descent within her:

"The Holy Spirit will come to you with solemnity, and the Power of the Most High will overshadow you, O most blessed one."

Here all speech of the tongue is superfluous; one does not speak except with the wonder of faith...

In this way, the Watcher announced to her that he had come from the house of the Father: "The Spirit will come and then the Power of the Most High will descend."

Indeed, the Holy Spirit came to Mary, to let loose from her the former sentence of Eve and Adam.

He sanctified her, purified her and made her blessed among women; He freed her from the curse of sufferings on account of Eve her mother.

The Spirit freed her from that debt that she might be beyond transgression when He solemnly dwelt in her.

He purified the Mother by the Holy Spirit while dwelling in her, that He might take from her a pure body without sin...

Mary appeared to us as a sealed letter in which were hidden the mysteries of the Son and His depth.

She gave her body as a clean sheet; the Word wrote His essence on it, corporeally.

She was the letter, not because she was sealed after she was inscribed, but the Divinity sealed her and then wrote on her... .

With her the Father sent us tidings full of good things, and through her, forgiveness to all condemned for their bonds of sin.

By her, emancipation was sent to Adam who had been enslaved; he became an heir and came in among the sons, as he had been.

Because of her, confusion was lifted from womanhood; the reproach of all women passed away from the nations.

*Because of her, the way to Eden, which had been blocked, was opened;
the serpent fled and men passed along it to God.*

*Because of her, the Cherub had removed his lance that he might no
longer guard the Tree of Life which offered itself to those who ate it.*

*She gave us a sweet fruit, full of life, that we might eat from it and
live forever with God.*

JACOB OF SERUG, *On the Mother of God*, translated from the
Syriac by Mary Hansbury, introduction by Sebastian Brock
(Crestwood, New York, 1998), pp. 18-42.

Perhaps the most widespread hymn in the Eastern Orthodox Church is the seventh century Byzantine hymn usually known by its Greek name *Akathist* (or *Akafist* in Church Slavonic). The hymn is very long and deals with various topics. Here is a strophe which deals with the Virgin Mary:

Rejoice, through you joy rings out again.

Rejoice, through you sorrow is put to flight.

Rejoice, O resurrection of fallen Adam.

Rejoice, O redemption of the tears of Eve.

Rejoice, O sublime peak of human intellect.

Rejoice, O profound abyss even for Angel eyes.

Rejoice, for in you the King's throne was elevated.

Rejoice, for you bear the One Who sustains everything.

Rejoice, O star that goes before the Sun.

Rejoice, O womb of the Incarnate God.

Rejoice, for through you all creation is renewed.

Rejoice, for through you the Creator became a baby.

Rejoice, O Virgin and Brid

In the eleventh century the Clunic monks composed one of the most widely known of Catholic hymns, generally known by its Latin title “*Salve Regina*”. I do not have the original Latin at hand, but here is a translation:

Hail Holy Queen, Mother of mercy!

Hail, our life, our sweetness and our hope.

To thee do we cry,

Poor banished children of Eve.

To thee do we send up our sighs,

Mourning and weeping in this valley of tears.

Turn then, most gracious advocate,

Thine eyes of mercy toward us.

And after this our exile

Show unto us the blessed fruit of thy womb, Jesus.

O clement, o loving, o sweet Virgin Mary!

The expression “Mother of God,” or *Theotokos*, is simply inconceivable and unthinkable in an Islamic context, as we have noted above. However, there are certain similarities between the role of the Virgin Mary in Catholicism, particularly in Spain and Ireland, and that of Fatima, the daughter of Muhammad, called *al-Zahra*, “the Radiant,” mother of the martyred Imams Hassan and Hussayn, the second and third Holy Shi‘a Imams. Fatima al-Zahra appears as the *Mater Dolorosa* (Sorrowful

Mother), weeping for her martyred sons.¹¹ It is said that Fatima's tears in Paradise for her martyred son the Imam Hussayn transformed the celestial abode of bliss into a house of mourning.¹² The following poem was composed by Sa'id Ibn al-Nili (died 1169) for a *ta'ziyeh majalis* (commemorative service for the martyrdom of Imam Hussayn). The words in the poem are supposedly spoken by Fatima Zahra:

*How great is my grief for you, o my child, you are who are the one
lost of friends and family.*

*Again I say how great is my sorrow, o my child, for after you I shall
desert sleep and even sleeplessness. Woe is me, who took care of his
shrouding, who beheld his face, throat and eyes.*

Woe, woe is me, who did wash him and walk behind his bier.

Woe, woe is me, who did pray over him and lay him in his grave.

AYOUB, op. cit., p. 179.

Another source says:

... for truly Fatima continues to weep for him (Imam Hussayn), sobbing so loudly that hell would utter such a loud cry, which, had its keepers (the angels) not been ready for it, ... its smoke and fire would have escaped and burned all that is on the face of the earth.

¹¹ Abu Muhammad Ordoni, *Fatima the Glorious* (Qum, Iran, 1992); Nasser Makorem Chirazi, *La Dame La Plus Prestigieuse de Monde: "Fatima – Zahra"* (Qum, Iran, undated); Henry Corbin, *Face de Dieu, Face de l'Homme* (Paris, 1983), pp. 149, 154-155; Moojan Momen, *An Introduction to Shi'i Islam* (New Haven, Connecticut, 1985), pp. 235, 236.

¹² *Shi'ism: Doctrines, Thought and Spirituality*, edited by Seyyed Hosein Nasr, Hamid Dabashi and Seyyed Vali Reza Nasr, Article: "Redemptive Suffering in Islam: A Study of the Devotional Aspects of Ashura in Twelver Shi'ism" (Albany, New York, 1988), p. 315.

Thus they contain Hell as long as Fatima continues to weep. ... for Hell would not calm down until her loud weeping had quieted.¹³

In *Jannat al-Khulud*, Mullah Muhammad Reza Imami says that the Shi'a jinn are the "holy jinn." In Iran, the pure Persian word *peri* or *pari* (plural: *paryan*), often translated as "fairy," is often used to refer to "good jinn." The Arab *jinn*, in reality, are radically different from the Persian *paryan*. In his *Rawdat al-Shuhada*, Kashifi says that the jinn and the houris consoled and comforted Fatima and wept with her when her son the Imam Hussayn was martyred at Karbala. No doubt these were Shi'a jinn, i.e., Shi'a *paryan*.

Compare the above to any of many Catholic and Eastern Orthodox songs, poems, and prayers relating to "The Seven Sorrows of the Virgin Mary." Below are two examples, translations of traditional Irish-Gaelic songs dealing with the sorrows of the Virgin Mary. They are one of the many things which prompted even the irreverent non-Catholic George Bernard Shaw to exclaim: "Holy and beautiful is the soul of Catholic Ireland."¹⁴ The songs evoke both the Spanish "saeta" and the Urdu *marsiya*, of which we shall speak in the next chapter.

Seacht n-Dolais na Maighdine

(The Seven Sorrows of The Virgin)

The first sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

*When He was born in the stable without clothes under Him nor
about Him.*

(Chorus): *Och ochon, Jesus, You are my child.*

Och ochon, Jesus, You are the bright king of the Heavens.

¹³Ibid., pp. 144-145.

¹⁴Excerpt from George Bernard Shaw, "John Bull's Other Island" in *An Anthology of Irish Literature*, edited by David B. Greene (New York, 1954), p. 419.

The second sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When she got news from Egypt that their child would be taken from them.

(Chorus)

The third sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When He was stripped of His garments and fury was put on the fair day.

(Chorus)

The fourth sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When the crown (of thorns) was pressed on Him with spite until the blood came in a stream.

(Chorus)

The fifth sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When He was put on the cross of torment and sharp nails binding Him.

(Chorus)

The sixth sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When He was taken down from the cross of torment to her own bosom and He dead.

(Chorus)

The seventh sorrow that was on the Virgin and she looking on her child,

When He was put into the earth cold and lifeless and He dead.

(Chorus)¹⁵

Caoineadh Mhuire (Mary's Keen)

Peter, Apostle, have you seen my love so bright?

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

I saw him with his enemies – a harrowing sight!

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

Who is that just man upon the Passion Tree?

It is your Son, dear Mother, know you not me?

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

Is that the wee babe I bore nine months in my womb

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

That was born in a stable when no house would give us room?

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

Mother, be quiet, let not your heart be torn

M'ochon agus m'ochon o!

My keening (Irish) women, mother, are yet to be born!

*M'ochon agus m'ochon o!*¹⁶

In Catholic and Eastern Orthodox iconography, the “Seven Sorrows of the Virgin” are symbolized by an image or icon of the Virgin Mary showing her heart pierced with seven swords.

¹⁵Song “*Seacht n-Dolais na Maighdine*” (*The Seven Sorrows of the Virgin Mary*), LP disk Sorchá ní Ghuairim Sings Traditional Irish (Gaelic) Songs, Folkways Records Album No. FW 861. Traditional Gaelic lyrics (words of song) transcribed by Francis P. O’Connell, and also translated by him into English. New York, 1957.

¹⁶“*Caoineadh na Maighdine*”: *The Virgin’s Lament*, compact disk, Noirín ní Riain and the monks of Glenstal Abbey, translations from Irish Gaelic by Gabriel Rosenstock, Glenstal Abbey, County Limerick, Ireland and Sounds True, Boulder, Colorado, 1996.

A tradition related by many sources, including the highly respected historian al-Tabari, reports the following:

Khadija, wife of the Prophet Muhammad and mother of Fatima Zahra, reported that when she was about to give birth to Fatima Zahra, the Quraishi women of Mecca, who were still pagans, refused to help her because she was the wife of Muhammad. However, the Virgin Mary, mother of Jesus Christ, called “the prophet Isa” by Muslims, appeared as an incredibly beautiful woman whose head was surrounded by a halo, identified herself, and proceeded to act as midwife for the delivery of Fatima Zahra.¹⁷

Below are two examples of tributes to Fatima Zahra in Shi’a literature:

Peace be with you, O you who were afflicted with trials by the One who created you. When He tested you, He found you to be patient under affliction... .

Peace be with you, O mistress of the women of the worlds. Peace be with you, O mother of the vindicators of humankind in argument. Peace be with you, O you who were wronged, you who were deprived of that to which you were entitled by right... .

God’s blessings on the immaculate virgin, the truthful, the sinless, the pious, the unstained, the one who is pleasing to God and acceptable, the guiltless, the rightly guided, the one who was wronged, the one who was unjustly overpowered and dispossessed by force of that to which she was entitled, the one who was kept from her lawful inheritance, she whose ribs were broken, whose husband was wronged, whose son was slain, Fatima, daughter of your Prophet (Muhammad), O God, flesh of his flesh, innermost heart of his heart... mistress of women, proclaimer of God’s

¹⁷Abu Muhammad Ordoni, *op. cit.*, pp. 44-45; Nasser Makarem Chirazi, *op. cit.*, pp. 17-18; Yousuf N. Lalljee, *Know Your Islam* (Qum, Iran, undated), pp. 94-95.

friends, ally of piety and asceticism, apple of Paradise and Eternity... You, O God, drew forth from her the light of the Imams.¹⁸

He showed them a Being, adorned with a myriad of glittering lights of various colors, who sat on a throne, a crown on her head, rings in her ears, a drawn sword by her side. The radiance streaming forth from her illumined the whole garden. When the first humans asked, "Who is this?", the following answer was given to them: "This is the form of Fatima Zahra, as she appears in Paradise. Her crown is Muhammad, her earrings are Hassan and Hussayn, and her sword is 'Ali (Ibn Abi Talib).

LOUIS MASSIGNON, *Eranos Jahrbuch, Die Ursprünge und die Bedeutung des Gnostizismus im Islam* (Zurich, 1938), pp. 64-65.

Cited in *Horse of Karbala* by David Pinault, op. cit., p. 65.

In *Al-Kafi*, his monumental collection of the sayings of the Shi'a Imams, al-Kulayni cites the Imam Hussayn as commenting thusly on the "Light Verse" of the Qur'an:

Abu 'Abdullah (Imam Hussayn) said, concerning the words of Allah the Sublime: "Allah is the light of the heavens and the earth. The likeness of His light is as a niche (Fatima Zahra), wherein is a lamp (al-Hassan), the lamp in a glass (al-Hussayn), the glass as it were a glittering star (Fatima Zahra, glittering star among the women of the world), kindled from a blessed tree (Ibrahim), an olive that is neither of the East nor of the West (neither of Judaism nor of Christianity), whose oil would shine (knowledge would burst out of it), even if no fire touched it. Light upon Light (Imam after Imam from the tree); Allah guides to His Light whom He wills; Allah strikes similitudes for men."

¹⁸ABBAS QUMMI, *Mafatih al-Jinan* (Tehran, 1964), pp. 100-101, 539-540, 574. Cited by David Pinault in *Horse of Karbala* (New York, 2001), p. 63.

AL-KULAYNI, *Al-Kafi*: volume one: *Al-Usul*, part two: "The Book of Divine Proof," I (Tehran, 1981), pp. 82-83.

Commenting on the above, David Pinault says:

In accordance with the Shi'a tradition of viewing the Imams as the believer's means of access to God, al-Kulayni here takes the Qur'anic vocabulary of radiance and applies it to Hassan and Hussayn and their descendants. In this exegesis, the lamp-niche is allegorized as Fatima, within whom repose her sons Hassan and Hussayn, "the lamp" and "the glass". In this womb metaphor she is described as the birthplace and source of the light of the Imams.

Al-Kulayni takes this exegesis further, describing Fatima as a celestial being, foremost of the women of this lower world, linked in a kind of mystical genealogy with her spiritual forefather Abraham: starfire kindled from olivewood. Fatima the Radiant (*zabira*), conveyer of illumination to her future offspring, unites celestial hierarchies, light upon light, with their earth-origins from the Abrahamic past.

PINAULT, *Horse of Karbala*, p. 65.

The Shi'a scholar S. V. Mir Ahmed 'Ali gives a summary of the role of Fatima Zahra in Shi'ism:

The Holy Prophet Muhammad had two sons and a daughter, but sons he did not need, for his apostleship had to conclude with his ministry, and if any son of the Holy Prophet had survived, it would have given the chance to the people to hail the son of the Prophet also to be another prophet of God, whereas there was no prophet to come after him. It may be said that this was the reason of the male issues of the Holy Apostle leaving this world in their very infancy. But the Holy Prophet needed a daughter of his own purity of spirit and body to reflect the divine light

of guidance in her ideal character and to present the authentic model of the correct Islamic womanhood to the world. Hence Fatima, the Lady of Light, was born to the Holy Prophet, who, for her godly qualities, is known in the Islamic World by the following epithets: (1) az-Zahra – the Shining (or the Radiant), (2) al-Batul – the Liberator of Sinners, (3) al-Azra – the Clean, the Pure, (4) Sayyadat an-Nisa – the Chief of Women, (5) Afzal an-Nisa – the Most Virtuous of Women, (6) Khair an-Nisa – the Best of Women, (7) Mariam al-Kubra – the Supreme Mary. Mary, the mother of Jesus, was the mother of only one heavenly guide to the children of the House of Israel, whereas Lady Fatima besides being the daughter of the Holy Apostle of God, was the mother of the Eleven Divinely Commissioned Guides, (i.e., the Holy Imams)... (8) al-Mubaraka – the Blessed One of God, (9) as-Sadiqa – the Truthful, (10) Al-Muhaddisa – the one who talked to another from the womb of her mother even prior to her birth. (If God could make Jesus talk from the cradle when He was born, there should not be any wonder if the Almighty caused another one blessed by Him to act in a similar manner.) In the Qur'an it states that Jesus spoke from the womb.

There are several other epithets of this great heavenly being who is the Lady of Light. Naturally Hussayn, the King of Martyrs, could not have been born of any ordinary woman other than the one like Lady Fatima with the divine attributes she was exclusively blessed with. It has already been said that one of the unique distinctions of the family of the Holy Prophet Muhammad is that from the Holy Prophet down to the Eleventh Imam, including Lady Fatima, all the Holy Thirteen were martyrs.

S. V. MIR AHMED 'ALI, *Husain The Savior of Islam* (Elmhurst, New York, undated), pp. 40-41.

In the third paragraph of the *Dawazdeh Imam* (Doxology of the Twelve Imams) by the twelfth century Persian Shi'a philosopher Nasir

al-Din Tusi, he says:

O my God! Honor and greeting, abundance and blessings be upon the glorious lady (Fatima), the beautiful, the most pure, the oppressed, the generous, the noble, who suffered so many afflictions in the course of her brief life, the queen of women, she of the great black eyes, the mother of the holy Imams, the daughter of the best of the prophets, the immaculate virgin, the most pious. Honor and salvation be upon you and your descendants, O Fatima the radiant, O daughter of Muhammad the Messenger of God, O witness of God before His creatures. O our Lady and our Sovereign, intercede for us before God.

HENRY CORBIN, *En Islam Iranien*, Tome I (Paris, 1971), p. 71.

Here we are reminded of the Latin prayer “*Ave Maria*” or “Hail Mary”:

Ave Maria, gratia plena, benedicta tu in mulieribus, et benedictus fructus ventre tui Jesus. Sancta Maria, Mater Dei, ora pro nobis peccatoribus, nunc et hora mortis nostrae. Amen.

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of thy womb Jesus. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

Below is a treatise on Fatima Zahra by **Henry Corbin**. As Henry Corbin makes clear, the reader is advised that what is said below is typical of the Shaikhi School of Shi‘a Islam, whose views are not necessarily applicable to nor representative of Shi‘ism as a whole. The reader will also note the influence on the Shaikhi School of the great Hispano-Muslim Sufi Ibn ‘Arabi al-Mursi and of the founder of the Illuminationist School

Suhrawardi. We have noted earlier the influence of both Ibn 'Arabi al-Mursi and Suhrawardi on St. John of the Cross as well. Henry Corbin's treatise proceeds as follows:

Perhaps we can appreciate today, even more than in the last century, philosophies that did not confuse the Imaginary, or rather the Reality corresponding to imaginative perception, with the unreal. Between a universe constituted by a pure physics and a subjectivity which inflicts isolation on itself, we foresee the need of an intermediate world to join the one with the other, something in the nature of a spiritual realm of subtle bodies. Such an intermediate world was ceaselessly meditated, particularly in Islamic Iran, by the masters of Sufism, by the adepts of the Suhrawardian philosophy of light, and by the adepts of Shaikhism. This intermediate world is no longer only the center of *the world*, like Eran-Vej, but the center of *the worlds*.

The world of the imaginable, of imaginative Reality, the world of archetypes-images, is established as mediator between the world of the pure, intelligible essences and the sensory universe. This world is the *eighth* keshvar, the eighth climate: the "earth of the emerald cities," the mystical Earth of Hurqalya...

This is not all. When we again find Suhrawardi using the name Isfandarmuz, the Angel of the Earth and the Sophia of Mazdaism, we have no difficulty in recognizing her features, since even the characteristic name of her function has been carried over from the Mazdean liturgy into the Islamic, Neoplatonic context of Suhrawardi. But it may happen that her name is no longer pronounced, that a Figure with an entirely different name appears in an entirely different context, and that nevertheless we can still identify the same features, the same *Gestalt*... It is the feminine Archangel of a *upper celestial* Earth, assuming the rank and privilege of the Divine Sophia (or *Daena*), that it is suggested that we may perceive, on the level of the world of the *labut*, the eternal reality of the dazzling Fatima, daughter of the Prophet, as she is

meditated in Shi'ite gnosis, or, more exactly, in that of the Shaikhi School...

The Shaikhi School, which flourished at the end of the 18th century under the stimulus of the lofty and strong spiritual personality of Shaikh Ahmad Ahsai (d. 1826), marked an extraordinary revival of primitive Shi'ite gnosis. Its literature is enormous, for the most part still in manuscript. Here we cannot even outline all the doctrines, but in the course of the following pages we shall see how and why the theme of Hurqalya is one of its essential themes. In it, the meaning of Imamology has been closely examined in great depth. The twelve Imams who assumed the initiatic function subsequent to the prophet, his person, and the person of his daughter Fatima, from whom the line of the Imams originated, form the pleroma of the "Fourteen Very-Pure," who are understood and meditated upon not only as regards the ephemeral appearance on earth of their respective persons, but in the reality of their precosmic eternal entities. Their persons are essentially theophanic; they are the Names and the divine Attributes, that which alone can be known of the divinity; they are the organs of the divinity; they are its "operant operations". From a structural point of view, in Shi'ite theology, Imamology plays the same role as Christology in Christian theology. That is why whoever has known only Sunni Islam, is confronted in Iran by something unexpected, and becomes involved in a dialogue the richness and consequences of which are unforeseeable.

Thus, the twelve Imams, in their theophanic persons, together with the Prophet and the resplendent Fatima, form the pleroma of the "Fourteen Very-Pure"; when meditated in their substance and their preeternal person, they assume a mode of being and a position analogous to the *Aeons* of the pleroma in Valentinian gnosis. As regards the subject of our concern here, namely, the theme of the celestial Earth, the position and role of Fatima in the pleroma now take on a predominant significance. In the aforementioned

schema of Suhrawardian “Oriental Theosophy”, we were shown how our Earth and its feminine Angel, Isfandarmuz, ranked in the world of archetypes, the world of the Soul or *Malakut*. Thus, we had a threefold universe: the earthly human world, which is the object of sensory perception; the world of the Soul or *Malakut*, which is, properly speaking, the world of imaginative perception; and the world of pure Cherubic Intelligences, the *Jabarut*, which is the object of intelligible knowledge.

In the Shi‘ite theosophy of Shaikhism, another universe (as in Ibn ‘Arabi al-Mursi) is superimposed on the above three universes: the universe of the *labut*, the sphere of the deity. But the characteristic of Shi‘ism and Shaikhism is to conceive this *labut* explicitly as constituting the pleroma of the “Fourteen Very-Pure”

In order to understand the structure of the pleroma of Shi‘ite theosophy and the role played in it by Fatima, one must be guided by the basic idea... that all the universes symbolize with one another. Here again we meet the Heavens and an Earth, but these are not the Heavens and the Earth of our world, nor those of the *Malakut*, nor those of the *Jabarut*, but the Heavens and Earth of that *hypercosmos* which is the sphere of the Deity, the *labut*. The rhythm that determines its architectonic structure is then developed in the dimension of terrestrial time. To discover in this historic dimension itself a structure which makes it possible to see the succession as homologous to the structure of the pleroma – this will be essentially the esoteric hermeneutic, the *ta’wil* – it will be a discovery of the true and hidden meaning, the spiritual history that becomes visible through the recital of external events. It will mean to “see things in Hurqalya”.

This question is, indeed, the key to the mystery of the primordial theophany, the revelation of the Divine Being who can only be revealed to Himself in *another* self, but is unable to recognize Himself as *other* or to recognize that other as Himself, except in that he *Himself* is the other’s God. The fact that the beings of

the supreme pleroma appeared in an order of ontological precedence corresponding to the order in which they answered the primordial interrogation is a way, for the imaginative perception, of deciphering the structure of the pleroma as the place of the primordial theophany. Just as the visible Heavens are created by the contemplative acts of cherubinic Intelligences emanating one from another, so the “heavens of the pleroma”, in the sphere of the *lahut*, are brought about by theophanic acts.

These theophonic acts coincide with the progressive differentiation of the drops of the primordial ocean of being, that is, of being given its imperative by the creative *Esto*. The *vis formative*, immanent in each drop, enables it to give the answer that concludes the divine preeternal pact. Since the order of ontological succession of the answers determines the structure of the pleroma of the *lahut*, the result is that the hierarchy of the Fourteen Supreme Spiritual Entities will have its epiphany on earth, at the time of the cycle of Muhammadan prophecy, in the succession of the persons who typify it, the “Fourteen Very-Pure”: the Prophet Muhammad, Fatima, his daughter, and the twelve Imams.

The first of the spiritual entities to answer is the first of the beings, the “inchoate being,” he who will have his sensory manifestation on earth in the person of the Prophet Muhammad. This is why he is the supreme Heaven of the Pleroma, and the one whose homologue in the astronomical Heavens is the Sphere of Spheres, the Throne (*‘arsh*), or Empyrean. After him the second of the eternal spiritual entities to answer is the one who will be manifested on earth in the person of Hazrat Amir (i.e., the First Imam, ‘Ali Ibn Abi Talib, a cousin of the Prophet and the husband of Fatima); his homologue in the astronomical heavens is the Eighth Heaven, the Heaven containing the “fortresses” or constellations of the Zodiac, the Heaven of the Fixed Stars (*Kursi*), the firmament...

Finally there comes the response of Hazrat Fatima (Zahra) to complete the pleroma of the *lahut* and give it both its plenitude and its foundation. Thus, she is the *Earth* of the supreme pleroma, and this is why it can be said that on this ontological plane she is more than the Celestial Earth, she is the *Supracelestial Earth*. In other words the Heavens and the Earth of the pleroma of the *lahut* are related to the Heavens and the Earth of Hurqalya... in the same way as the Heavens and the Earth of Hurqalya are related to the Heavens and the Earth of the sensory world. Or again, the pleromatic person of Fatima is to the Celestial Earth of Hurqalya as Spenta Armaiti is the the Mazdean Earth haloed by the light of the *Xvarnah*.

From this height, we reach a perspective in which the *Sophiology* of Shaikhism will be developed. On this earth, Fatima, the daughter of the Prophet, was the wife of 'Ali Ibn Abi Talib, himself the Prophet's cousin. Their exemplary union is the manifestation of the eternal syzygy originating in the eternity of the pleroma of the *lahut*. The First Imam and Fatima are related to each other in the same reciprocal way as the first two hypostases, 'Aql and Nafs, Intelligence and Soul, or in terms more familiar to us (because they go back to Philo Judaeus of Alexandria): *Logos* and *Sophia*.

The couple 'Ali-Fatima is the exemplification, the epiphany on earth, of the eternal couple *Logos-Sophia*. Hence, we can foresee the implications of their respective persons. The Logos ('aql), in Shaikhi doctrine is the hidden substance of every being and of every thing; it is the suprasensory calling for visible Form in order to be manifested. It is like the wood in which the form of the statue will appear. Better still, it is like the archetypal body, the inner astral mass of the sun, invisible to human perception, in relation to the visible Form, which is its *aura*, brilliance and splendor. The *maqam* (state, rank, degree, plane, also the pitch of a note in music) – the *maqam* of Fatima corresponds exactly

to this visible form of the sun, without which there would be neither radiance nor heat. And this is why Fatima has been called by a solar name: *Fatima al-Zahra*, the brilliant, resplendent Fatima. The totality of the universe consists of this light of Fatima, the splendor of each sun illuminating every conceivable universe.

So one could also speak here of a cosmic Sophianity, having its source in the eternal person of Fatima-Sophia. As such, she assumes a threefold rank, a threefold dignity and function. For she is the manifested Form, i.e., the very soul (*nafs*, *anima*) of the Imams; she is the threshold (*bab*) through which the Imams effuse the gift of their light. Just as the light of the sun is effused by the form of the sun – which is its brilliant splendor – not by the invisible substance of its “archetype-body”. Thus, in the second place, she is all thinkable reality, the pleroma of meanings (*ma’ani*) of all the universes, because nothing of what *is* can be without qualification. Qualification and meaning are on the same level of being as the Soul, for it is Soul-Sophia that confers qualification and meaning. That is why the whole universe of the soul and the secret of the meanings given by the Soul is the very universe and secret of Hazrat Fatima. She is Sophia, which is to say divine wisdom and power, embracing all the universes. That, lastly, is why her eternal Person, which is the secret of the world of the Soul, is also its manifestation (*bayan*), without which the creative Principle of the world would remain unknown and unknowable, forever hidden... .

Fatima-Sophia is in fact the Soul: the Soul of creation, the Soul of each creature, i.e., the constitutive part of the human being that appears essentially to the imaginative consciousness in the form of a feminine being, *anima*. She is the eternally feminine in man, and that is why she is the archetype of the heavenly Earth; she is both paradise and initiation into it, for it is she who manifests the divine names and attributes revealed in the theophanic persons of the Imams, i.e., in the Heavens of the Pleroma of the

lahut...

Her functions *symbolize* with each other, from one universe to the other: in the pleroma of the *lahut*, as the supracesterial Earth which is its foundation; on the terrestrial Earth, as the daughter and Soul of the Prophet and as the one from whom issue those who in their turn are the Soul of the Prophet, the lineage of the Twelve Imams. She is *the* theophany and she is the Initiation; she is the *majma alnurayn*, the confluence of two lights, the light of Prophecy and the light of Initiation. Through her, creation, from the beginning, is Sophianic in nature, and through her the Imams are invested with the Sophianity that they transmit to their adepts, because she is its *soul*. From this pleromic height we can distinguish the fundamental sound emerging from the depths: namely, that which Mazdean Sophiology formulated in the idea of *spendar matikih*, the Sophianity with which Spenta Armaiti, the feminine Angel of the Earth invested the faithful believer.

HENRY CORBIN, *Spiritual Body and Celestial Earth*, translated by Nancy Pearson (Princeton, New Jersey, 1977), pp. 50-73.

Posted on 2016-09-06 by Michael McClain

* * *

Matt on 2016-09-06 at 23:52 said:

The way theology is done in Shia Islam also has an affinity with the Catholic Church. Philosophical theology has an important place: a notable example of this is seen with *Ijtihad* (independent reasoning), which is used a lot in jurisprudence among *marja* and lower-level Shia clerics.

6.6 The White Dove

Says Abdallah al-Bahrani: “A white dove entered Fatima’s garment at the house of Umm Salamah before her meeting with the prophet Muham-

mad.”¹⁹ As is well known, in traditional Christian (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox) iconography, the white dove is a symbol of the Holy Spirit. In traditional Christian iconography, the Virgin Mary is shown in the presence of a white dove at the time of the Miraculous Conception of Jesus, and at the time of the Annunciation. Because of its connection with the beautiful *Magnificat* prayer, the Annunciation is a common motif of Catholic and Eastern Orthodox iconography. In all icons of the Annunciation, the white dove is shown in the presence of the Virgin Mary. The white dove appeared at the Baptism of Jesus. In all Catholic and Eastern Orthodox icons of the Baptism of Jesus, the white dove is shown hovering over the head of Jesus. In the Gospel According to St. John, it is stated: “And John (the Baptist) gave testimony saying: ‘I saw the (Holy) Spirit coming down as a dove from Heaven, and he (the dove) remained upon him (Jesus)’ ” (John 1:32).

The early Church Fathers wrote a good deal concerning the symbolism of the white dove. White, of course, is symbolic of purity, but there is more; why a white dove and not a white owl or white sea gull? Tertullian wrote: “The Holy Spirit came in the form of a dove in order that the nature of the Holy Spirit might be made plain by means of a creature of utter simplicity and innocence. For the dove’s body has no gall.”²⁰

With his customary eloquence, St. John Chrysostom said:

But why in the form of a dove? The dove is a gentle and pure creature. Since then the (Holy) Spirit, too, is “a Spirit of gentleness,” he appears in the form of a dove, reminding us of Noah, to whom, when once a common disaster had overtaken the whole world and humanity was in danger of perishing, the dove appeared as a sign of deliverance from the tempest and, nearing an olive branch,

¹⁹Ayoub, op. cit., p. 72, citing *Maqatal al-Awalim*, volume XVI of *Awalim al-‘Ulum* (Tabriz, Iran, undated), p. 4.

²⁰*Ancient Christian Commentary on Scripture: New Testament II; Mark*, edited by Thomas C. Oden & Christopher A. Hall, (Downers Grove, Illinois, 1998), p. 13.

published the good tidings of a serene presence over the whole world.²¹

Here is a selection on Fatima from a discourse attributed to the Prophet Muhammad: “She (Fatima) shall find herself humiliated after being loved and well treated during the lifetime of her father. Then God will console her with angels who will address her with the words He addressed to Mary, daughter of Imran (Biblical Joachim). They will say to her, ‘O Fatima, God has chosen thee and purified thee; He has chosen thee above all women.’”

Note the close parallel of this with the Catholic Latin prayer “Ave Maria,” or “Hail Mary”:

Ave Maria, gratia plena, Dominus tecum; benedicta tu in mulieribus, et benedictus fructus ventri tui Jesus. Sancta Maria, Mater Dei, ora pro nobis peccatoribus nunc et in hora mortis nostrae. Amen.

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee; blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

The above Catholic prayer “Ave Maria” (Hail Mary) is based on the Gospel according to St. Luke: “And the Angel, having come in, said to her: ‘Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee: Blessed art thou among women’” (Luke 1:28). In the Qur’an, it is similarly stated: “And the angels said: ‘O Mary! Truly, God has chosen you and purified you and chosen you above the women of the worlds’” (Qur’an 3:42).

The Prophet Muhammad continues:

As for my daughter, Fatima, she is the mistress of the women of the worlds, those that were and those that are to come, and she

²¹Idem.

is part of me. She is the human *hourî* who when she enters her prayer chamber before God, exalted be He, her light shines to the angels of Heaven as the stars shine to the inhabitants of the earth. Thus when I saw her, I recalled what will be done to her after me. I could see how humiliation shall enter her home, her sanctity shall be violated, her rights usurped, her inheritance denied and her troubles multiplied. She shall lose her child (through miscarriage), all the while crying out, "Oh my Muhammad," but no one will come to her aid. After me she will remain sorrowful and grieved and weeping, at times recalling the cessation of revelation from her house, at other times my departure from her. When night comes upon her, she shall feel lonely, missing my voice, which she was accustomed to hearing as I recited the Qur'an by night. She shall find herself humiliated after being loved and well treated during the lifetime of her father. Then God will console her with angels, who will address her with the words He addressed to Mary, daughter of Imran. They will say to her, "O Fatima... God has chosen you, and purified you; He has chosen you above all women. (Fatima)... be obedient to your Lord, prostrating and bowing before Him."

Then her pains will commence and she will fall, and Mary daughter of Imran will come to her to nurse and console her in her sickness. She shall then say, "O Lord, I truly despise this life and have become troubled with the people of this world; let me therefore depart to my father." Thus she will be the first to come to me from my family. She will come to me sorrowful and heavy with grief, persecuted and martyred. Then will I say, "O God, curse those who wronged her, punish those who persecuted her, humiliate those who humiliated her, and consign eternally into Your fire him who hit her side so that she lost her child." Then the angels will reply: "Amen." ... A Bedouin of one of the tribes in the neighborhood of Medina came to the Prophet (Muhammad) who was sitting with his companions, reviling him and calling

him a magician and a liar. He had hidden in his sleeve a small lizard, which he had caught in the desert. He let the animal go and the Prophet called it to him, asking it, "Do you know who I am?" The animal answered, "You are Muhammad, the Apostle of God." In astonishment and recognition of the Prophet's claims and forbearance, the Bedouin embraced Islam. But he was poor and hungry and none of the companions had anything to give him to eat. Confident of Fatima's generosity and compassion, the Prophet sent Salman, the Persian, to her seeking food for the hungry man. She had nothing but her own clothes, so she sent her cloak to be pawned with Simon the Jew for a bushel of barley and a tray of dates. She baked the barley, after grinding it with her own hands, and sent the bread and dates to feed the new Muslim. With joy the Prophet came to her, but found her pale with hunger and her two children, Hassan and Hussayn, asleep, trembling like slaughtered birds from hunger as no one in the house of 'Ali (Ibn Abi Talib) had tasted anything for three days. The Prophet saw this, and his eyes were filled with tears, and he did not know what to do.

Fatima then entered her chamber and prayed a few *rak'ahs* (daily prayer cycles), after which she invoked God saying, "O Lord, send to us a banquet (*ma'idah*) from Heaven as You have sent it to the children of Israel. They disbelieved it, yet we will be believers in it. As she finished her prayer, a banquet was sent from Heaven and they all ate. The Prophet, with joy and gratitude, exclaimed, "Thanks be to God Who has granted me a child like Mary who, ... whenever Zechariah went in to her in the Sanctuary, he found her provisioned. "Mary," he said, "How does this come to you?" "From God", she said."

JA'FAR MUHAMMAD IBN BABAWAY AL-QUMMI, *Al-Amali wa al-Majlis* (Qum, Iran, 1951), p. 70. Cited in Ayoub, op. cit., pp. 238-240. 31

Though generally denounced as idolatry in Sunni Islam as well as Protestantism, intercession (Arabic *shafa'a*, Persian; *miyanji gari*) is practiced in Shi'ism as well as Catholicism.

Catholics pray to the Virgin Mary and the saints, and Shi'ahs pray to the Imams and the saints. Ayatollah Murtaza Mutahhari says:

In the ziyarats which we all recite and which we regard as part of Shi'ah doctrine, we say: "I testify that you see where I stand; you hear what I say and return my salutation." It is to be noted that we address that to an Imam who is dead. From our point of view in this respect there is no difference between a dead and a living Imam. It is not that we say so to a dead Imam only. We say: "Peace on you (Imam) 'Ali Ibn Musa al-Riza (8th Imam). I admit and testify that you hear my salutation and return it.

AYATOLLAH MURTAZA MUTAHHARI, *Man and Universe*
(Karachi, Pakistan, 1991), p. 463.

Indeed, Ayatullah Murtaza Mutahhari says that denial of intercession and of the immortality of the soul is materialism, and thus very near to pure atheism.²² In effect, Ayatullah Mutahhari is saying that any Shi'a who denies intercession is not only a heretic but very near to being an atheist, the very worst sort of unbeliever.

The Sixth Imam, Ja'far al-Sadiq said: "He (the Imam Hussayn) sees the one who weeps for him, and so he seeks God's forgiveness for him out of compassion, and asks his fathers ('Ali and Muhmmad) to seek pardon for his sins."²³ D. K. Crow explains: "While Hussayn was killed, he nevertheless is alive in Heaven, where alongside the other members of

²²Ayatullah Murtaza Mutahhari, *Fundamentals of Islamic Thought* (Berkeley, California, 1985), pp. 108-111.

²³Ibn Qawlawayhi, *Kamil al-Zitadi*, cited in Douglas Karim Crow "The Death of al-Husayn and the Imamate," *Al-Serat* (London, July 1984), p. 93.

his family, he hears and responds to the prayers of his shi'a, and mediates remission of sins."²⁴

In *al-Mizan*, his monumental commentary on the Qur'an, Allamah Tabataba'i devotes many pages to a defense of the doctrine of intercession.²⁵ As one might expect, the defense of the doctrine of intercession by Ayatollah Mutahhari and Allamah Tabataba'i closely resembles the defense of the same concept by Catholic theologians against attacks against it by Protestants, Modernists and secularists.

The concept of intercession is beautifully expressed by the nineteenth century Persian poet Qa'ani in reference to the Imam Hussayn:

*How was it with him? He fell a martyr! Where? In the Plain of
Karbala!*

When? On the tenth of Muharram! Secretly? No, in public!...

Was not the dagger ashamed to cut his throat?

It was! Why then did it do so? Destiny would not excuse it!

*Wherefore? In order that he (Hussayn) might become an intercessor
for mankind!*

*What is the condition of his intercession? Lamentation and weep-
ing!*

EDWARD G. BROWNE, *Literary History of Persia*, Volume IV
(Cambridge, England, 1959), pp. 178-181.

Intercession is attributed to the Prophet Muhammad and the Ahl al-Bait by the fourth Shi'a Imam, Imam Zain al-Abidin 'Ali Ibn Husayn, himself son of the Martyr of Karbala and therefore a member of

²⁴Ibid., p. 109.

²⁵ALLAMAH MUHAMMAD HUSAYN TABATABA'I, *Al-Mizan, An Exegesis of the Qur'an*, Volume I (Tehran, 1983), pp. 221-262.

the Ahl al-Bait in his own right.²⁶ This demonstrates that the concept of intercession appears very early indeed in the history of Shi'ism.

Intercession is also attributed to Fatima al-Zahra, the *Mater Dolorosa* (Sorrowful Mother) of the martyred Imam Hussayn.²⁷ The texts concerning this are far too long and numerous to quote here.

The village of Fatima in Portugal, where the Virgin Mary appeared to shepherd children, is well-known. That the Virgin Mary should appear in a village named for Fatima bint Muhammad Al-Zahra is so astounding a "coincidence" that many see in it the hand of Divine Providence, and it is difficult to disagree. Of course, Protestants denounce what they call "worship of Mary": as G. K. Chesterton said in his poem "Don Juan de Austria": "And Christian (Protestant) hateth Mary, whom God kissed in Galilee."

If anyone doubts that Shi'a Islam, and perhaps Sunni Islam, is closer to traditional (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox) Christianity than is Protestantism, compare the attitude of the Shi'as – and to a lesser extent the Sunnis – towards Fatima and the Virgin Mary to the Protestant complaint about "worship of Mary," which shows not only the Nestorian basis of Protestantism, but also the Manichaeian base.

Moojan Momen states:

Whereas in Sunni Islam there is a direct relationship between the believer and God as revealed in the religion of Islam, in Shi'i Islam there is something of a triangular relationship. While for some things, such as the daily obligatory prayers, the individual is in direct relationship to God, in other matters he looks (usually through the mediation of the local mulla) to the *marja' at-taqlid*,

²⁶Zayn al-Abidin 'Ali ibn Husayn, *The Psalms of Islam: Al-Sahifat al-Kamilat al-Sajjadiyya*, edited and translated by William C. Chittick (London, 1988), pp. 22, 89, 189, 228-229, 250.

²⁷Ordoni, op. cit., pp. 268-288; Tabataba'i, Al-Mizan, *An Exegesis of the Qur'an*, volume I, op. cit., pp. 256-257.

who is regarded as being in a more direct relationship with God. Indeed, in the minds of many of the less educated, the ‘ulama and the marja’ are intermediaries between them and God, and the relationship is not so much triangular as hierarchical.

MOOJAN MOMEN, *An Introduction to Shi’i Islam* (New Haven, Connecticut, 1985), p. 235.

The parallel with the relationship of the Catholic or Eastern Orthodox layman to his Church hierarchy and that between the Shi’a layman and the Shi’a hierarchy is obvious. It is sometimes said, erroneously, that Islam has no sacraments. However, it is true that there is nothing in Islam which corresponds exactly with the Catholic and Eastern Orthodox sacraments of Confession and Communion, or Eucharist. However, even this difference is not so great as some imagine, since the concept of doing penance for one’s sins is very much a part of Islam. The Protestant principle of *sola fide*, i.e., “justification by faith alone,” or “faith without works,” is alien and repugnant to Islam. For example, the Qur’an states: “Truly those who believe and do good works and humble themselves before their Lord, these are the dwellers of Paradise, and they will abide therein forever” (Qur’an 11:23).

I have heard Protestants speak of the Virgin Mary in terms not far removed from those in the *Talmud*, *Sanhedrin 51A*, in which the Virgin Mary is referred to as a whore for the Roman Army. Thus the Irish Catholic joke:

A man climbs to the top of a tall building and yells: “I am going to jump, I am going to commit suicide.” Someone calls the police, and an Irish policeman is sent to handle the emergency.

“For the love of your father, don’t jump”, says the Irish policeman.

“I don’t have a father”, says the potential suicide.

“For the love of your mother, don’t jump”, says the Irish policeman.

“I don’t have a mother either, I am an orphan”, says the potential suicide.

“For the love of the Blessed Virgin don’t jump”, says the Irish policeman.

“Who the hell is the Blessed Virgin?”, says the potential suicide.

“Go ahead and jump, you Protestant bastard”, says the Irish policeman.

In the Qur’an, the Virgin Mary has a whole Sura named for her. In the Qur’an the Virgin Mary is mentioned 34 times, more than in the gospels. Here are three representative references to the Virgin Mary in the Qur’an: “And recall, O Our Apostle Muhammad, when the angels said: ‘O Mary! Truly, God has chosen you and purified you and chosen you above the women of the worlds’” (Qur’an 30:42). “O Our Apostle Muhammad, remember Mary, who guarded her chastity. We breathed into her Our Spirit, and we made her a sign to all peoples” (Qur’an 21:91). “And Mary the daughter of Imran, who guarded her chastity; we breathed into her body Our Spirit, and she testified to the truth of the words of her Lord and His Scriptures, and she was of the obedient ones” (Qur’an 66:12).

The Shi’a, in particular, have a special reverence for the Virgin Mary, which is linked to their reverence for Fatima, “the younger Mary.” If the Virgin Mary is indeed the very touchstone and hallmark of traditional Catholic and Eastern Orthodox truth, there can be no doubt that Shi’a Islam is far closer to traditional Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Christianity than is Protestantism.

In another place we noted that the philosopher Mortimer J. Adler, born into a Jewish family, converted to Christianity because, of the three Abrahamic faiths, i.e., Judaism, Christianity, and Islam, only Christianity affirms God’s immanence as well as His transcendence. We also noted

that in this Mr. Adler is mistaken, because Islam, save certain aberrant sects, such as Wahhabism and the Taliban, vigorously affirms God's immanence as well as His transcendence.

The Christian monuments of Bethlehem, including the Church of the Nativity, as well as the tomb of St. John the Baptist in Damascus and two places in Jerusalem sacred to the memory of the Virgin Mary, are considered *Ziarats* (places of pilgrimage) by the Shi'as.²⁸ Christian pilgrims to Bethlehem should not be surprised to find themselves joined by Shi'a Muslims.

Nearly everyone has heard of Blaise Pascal (1623 – 1662), great scientist and Catholic thinker. Particularly famous is “Pascal's wager”: If one accepts the Catholic faith and is right, then he gains everything, but if he is wrong and the atheists are right, he loses nothing; on the contrary, if one chooses atheism, and is wrong, then he loses everything, but if right he gains nothing.²⁹ Pascal had a forerunner who lived nearly one thousand years before him in the figure of Ja'far al-Sadiq, the Sixth Shi'a Imam (702 – 765). Here is the story: Once during the Hajj in Mecca, the atheist Ibn Abi al-Awja asked Imam al-Sadiq: “How long will these oxen (Muslims) continue to plow this desert (religion)?” The Imam responded by citing the Qur'anic verse prohibiting disputatious arguments during the hajj. After the hajj season, the Imam al-Sadiq came to Ibn Awja and said: “Let me answer with your own style of logic. If there is no God, and everything is absurd, then Muslim worshippers lose nothing by their worship; but if there is a God and Muhammad is His messenger, then woe to you on Judgment Day.”³⁰

Change the word “Muslim” to “Catholic”, and the Imam al-Sadiq

²⁸Yousuf N. Lalljee, *Know Your Islam* (Qum, Iran, undated), pp. 214-216.

²⁹Blaise Pascal, *Pensees*, Introduction and notes by Charles-Marc des Granges (Paris, 1961), Pensee no. 233, pp. 134-138.

³⁰Michael M. J. Fischer and Mehdi Abedi, *Debating Muslims* (Madison, Wisconsin, 1990), p. 500, note 7. Fischer and Abedi do not give a source.

is repeating “Pascal’s wager” virtually word for word, though nearly one thousand years before the time of Pascal. It is most unlikely, very nearly impossible, that Pascal could have known of the words of the Imam al-Sadiq. Coincidence? Or, perhaps, another example of the affinity between Shi‘ism and traditional Catholicism?

All Muslims, whether Sunni or Shi‘a, have a great reverence for Jesus, as anyone knows who has read the Qur’an. However, Shi‘ites seem to have a particular reverence for Jesus, and, compared to the Sunnis, for St. John the Baptist. Jesus, along with the Twelfth Imam, is called “the Alive and Awaited.”³¹

Among the Shi‘as (particularly Iranian Shi‘as), Jesus holds a place far superior to that of all the other prophets before Muhammad, as is clearly expressed here:

Seven and a quarter centuries before (Jesus) Christ, Rome was founded, and in the succeeding centuries extended her rule far and wide. Not long after Rome’s foundation, Zoroaster arose in Iran and substituted for the magic of Magianism a rational and moral relationship between man and the God of Good in the eternal battle against Evil (i.e., Ahriman or Satan). In almost the same century Confucius and Lao-Tse in China and Gautama the Buddha in India laid the basis of the philosophy which was developed by Socrates, Plato and Aristotle in Greece during the succeeding century. All this found consummation in the birth and life of Jesus Christ, Who proclaimed the call to reform human society, to rescue mankind from the pollutions of Judaistic materialism, to extirpate corruption and internecine combat, and to raise humanity towards ethical and spiritual purification.

SAYID MUJTABA RUKNI MUSAWI LARI, *Western Civilization Through Muslim Eyes* (Qum, Iran, undated), p. 3.

³¹*The Holy Qur’an*, Text, Translation and Commentary by S. V. Mir. Ahmed ‘Ali, Introduction by Agha Haji Mirza Mahdi Pooya Yazdi, op. cit., p. 153a.

Here Jesus is seen as superior to all prophets before Him, and as heir to Zoroaster as well as Abraham. As we shall see, both the Christian and Zoroastrian traditions affirm this. This is indicated in the accounts in the Gospel According to St. Matthew of the Wise Men, or “Magi”. The very earliest sources identify the Wise Men as Persians and Zoroastrians. These sources include early apochryphal accounts of the childhood of Jesus, which are considered authoritative and reliable, but are not included in the New Testament Canon because they are incomplete and fragmentary and have little theological importance. These very early accounts leave no doubt as to the Persian and Zoroastrian identity of the Wise Men.

It should be noted that nowhere are the magi given names, nor is it said that they were three in number. The number three is derived from the number of gifts which they brought to the infant Jesus, i.e., gold, frankincense and myrrh. Indeed, the Syrian and Armenian traditions claim that the magi were twelve in number.³² The Armenian tradition is particularly significant in this respect, because Armenia was always under strong Persian cultural influence. The Arsacid Dynasty, which long ruled Armenia, was of Parthian origin, and for a long time there were many Zoroastrians in Armenia.

It is from these extra-canonical accounts that it is known that the parents of the Virgin Mary were St. Joachim (the Qur’anic *Imran*) and Ste. Anne. The First Gospel on the Infancy of Jesus Christ is certainly of great antiquity, as the earliest references to it so far discovered are from the early Second Century. Various Church Fathers accepted the reliability of this Gospel, including St. Athanasius and St. John Chrysostom.³³ It was not included among the canonical gospels because, dealing only with the

³²*Oxford Dictionary of Byzantium*, Alexander P. Kashdan, editor-in-chief, essay “Adoration of the Magi” (Oxford, England, 1991), vol. 1, p. 22.

³³*The Lost Books of the Bible* (New York, 1979), p. 38. “Lost” is an unfortunate adjective in this case, because the books in this particular anthology, though not included in the New Testament Canon, were never “lost”. There are several collections of New Testament Apocrypha and/or non-canonical gospels available.

infancy of Jesus, it is fragmentary and has little of theological importance. Here is what it has to say concerning the Wise Men:

And it came to pass, when Lord Jesus was born at Bethlehem, a city of Judaea, in the time of Herod the King; the wise men came from the East to Jerusalem, according to the prophecy of Zoroaster, and brought with them offerings: namely, gold, frankincense and myrrh, and worshipped him, and offered him their gifts... And having, according to the custom of their country, made a fire, they worshipped it.

Ibid., p. 40.

According to legend, no doubt of Zoroastrian origin, the Island of Kuh-i-Khwaja in Lake Helmand in Eastern Iran, called *Daryacheh-ye-Sistan*, is the site of the castle which was the home of the Wise Men.³⁴

Christian tradition from earliest times has always portrayed the Wise Men in Persian garb. So the Christian Tradition has always affirmed that Jesus was heir to Zoroaster as well as to the Old Testament prophets. In Iran much is made of this by Christians, Zoroastrians and Muslims. Remember, according to Islam, Muhammad was the last in a line of prophets which includes Jesus. So, if Jesus was heir of Zoroaster as well as the Old Testament prophets, so, by extension, was Muhammad. Among Muslims, Shi'ahs make much more of this than do Sunnis, in part because Shi'ahs revere Jesus and the Virgin Mary even more than do Sunnis, and because the Imam Hussayn was married to Shahrbanu, a Persian princess born a Zoroastrian. Shahrbanu was therefore the female ancestor of nine of the twelve Imams. In Iran, Zoroastrians call the Imam Hussayn "son-in-law," which is *damad* in Persian, or *damad-emahbub*, "beloved son-in-law". Since *damad* simply means "in-law" or "relative by marriage," a

³⁴Richard N. Frye, *The Heritage of Persia* (Cleveland, Ohio, 1963), p. 178.

more formal and precise way of expressing it would be *mard ke shauhar-e-dokhtar-e-man ast*, i.e., “the man who is the husband of our daughter” or *mard ke shauhar-e-dokhtar-e-man mahbub ast*, i.e., “the man who is the beloved husband of our daughter.”

The implications of Jesus being the heir of Zoroaster as well as the Old Testament prophets are enormous, and it is strange that, outside of Iran, not much has been made of it. The above certainly affects the whole concept of the “Chosen People” and the idea that “salvation is (exclusively) from the Jews.” Iranians are not only not Jewish, they are not even Semites, being Indo-Europeans or Aryans. Note that the name “Iran” comes from the same Indo-European or Sanskrit root as “Arya” or “Aryan,” and the Old Gaelic “Erinn,” Modern Gaelic “Erin,” the native Celtic name of Ireland.

Shi‘as also have a particular reverence for St. John the Baptist. Many Shi‘a traditions speak reverently of St. John the Baptist, such as this account:

When asked about the inner meaning of the letters used, it was said that God willed Gabriel to make Zachariah (father of St. John the Baptist) know the sacred names of the Holy Prophet (Muhammad) along with those of the Ahl al-Bait (the House of Muhammad, in other words, Fatima and the Twelve Imams). When Gabriel mentioned the names, Muhammad, ‘Ali, Fatima and Hussayn, Zachariah felt a great joy and consolation, but with the mention of the name Hussayn, he was filled with grief and sorrow. When he asked the angels about the uncontrollable sorrow he felt, Gabriel informed him of the heart-rending tragedy of Karbala, for the experiences of Hussayn are quite similar to what Yahya (St. John the Baptist) faced. Zachariah was informed of the story of the untold miseries and tortures which Hussayn would suffer and the brutal massacre he would meet. It is said that in conveying the tidings about the tragedy of Karbala, the letter symbols used in the start of this chapter were: (۱.) “Kaf” for

Karbala, where Hussayn was martyred along with the band of his faithful devotees. (2.) “Ha”, for *halakat*, the annihilation of the Holy Family. (3.) “Ya” for “Yazid,” the son of Mu’awiya, who caused the heartless massacre. (4.) “‘Ain” for *‘atash*, the killing thirst (along with hunger) which Hussayn and his followers suffered before they were butchered. (5.) “Saad” for *sabr*, the marvelous patience with which Hussayn and his comrades suffered torture before they drank the cup of martyrdom.

The events connected with the life of the Third Imam Hussayn, the second son of ‘Ali and Fatima, the second grandson of the Holy prophet, are identical with those of the apostle Yahya (St. John the Baptist). Hussayn, during his journey to Karbala, frequently remembered the apostle Yahya. Like Yahya, Hussayn was also born in six months. Hussayn’s name was also peculiar to him as was the name of Yahya (i.e., refers to first use of said names). Hussayn was martyred for opposing the brute Yazid’s devilish life as was Yahya for declaring that what the king did was wrong. With the glad tidings of getting a son, Zachariah was informed of what the name of the son was to be. No one before him had been given the name Yahya (John), derived from *hayat*, i.e., life. It is said that the name Yahya was given to him because he was born of a barren woman who, for never being productive and also for having crossed the age of fertility, was virtually dead to womanhood. The issue or the son promised was Yahya (St. John the Baptist), the forerunner of Jesus... .

The statement “We did not make anyone like him” means that Yahya was made such that he neither sinned nor had he any inclination towards any sin. He was not even inclined to marry any woman, and he also did not marry. Secondly, no one else was born of a barren woman who was at the advanced age of about eighty years. God’s Almighty will manifested once in bringing forth a child (Jesus) from a virgin (Mary) and once in bringing forth a child (St. John the Baptist) from a barren woman at the

advanced age of eighty. And never did the heavens mourn for anyone else as much as for Yahya and the Third Imam Hussayn Ibn 'Ali, the King of Martyrs.

The Sixth Imam, Ja'far Ibn Muhammad Al-Sadiq, says that the cases of Yahya and Hussayn are similar because: (1) No one had his name before, save Yahya and Hussayn. (2) For no one else did the heavens weep for forty days save Yahya and Hussayn. (3) The murderers of both Yahya and Hussayn were of illegitimate birth. (4) Sufyan Ibn A'seneh narrates from 'Ali Ibn Zaid, who got it from his father 'Ali Ibn al-Hussayn, that he said, "When we set out with Hussayn for Kufa, we did not halt at any place but Hussayn mentioned Yahya Ibn Zachariah. One day he said: 'The proof of the worthlessness of this world in the view of God is that the head of Yahya Ibn Zachariah was presented to one of the prostitutes of the Israelites.'"

Similarly, Hussayn's head was presented to the sons of the prostitutes. He set out from Medina knowing well the fate that awaited him and his family. His aim was that his sacrifice should not take place unnoticed and go to waste ineffective, and he succeeded in his divinely planned mission in laying down his all for the sake of truth in such a way that it shook the very throne of the Tyrant and the heart of every Muslim in particular and humanity in general.³⁵

In *Al-Mizan*, his monumental commentary on the Qur'an, Allamah Tabataba'i says:

Allah gave him (Zachariah) a son, Yahya, the prophet most similar to Isa (Jesus) (peace be on both). He was given all the qualities of perfection and excellence which Isa and his truthful mother, Maryam (the Virgin Mary) were granted. It was for this reason that Allah named him Yahya and sent him to verify a word from

³⁵Commentary at bottom of pages of *The Holy Qur'an: Text, Translation and Commentary* by S. V. Mir Ahmed Ali, op. cit., pp. 942 – 954.

Allah, and made him honorable and chaste as well as a prophet, from among the good ones. It was the nearest that any man could resemble Maryam and her son Isa, peace be on them all... Yahya was made to resemble Isa as completely and perfectly as was possible. Yet Isa had precedence over Yahya because his creation and birth were firmly decreed long before the prayer of Zakariyya for Yahya was accepted. That is why Isa was given superiority over Yahya, and made an *ulu l-azam* apostle, bringing a new shari‘ah (law) and a new book (the Gospel). Apart from some necessary dissimilarities, Yahya and Isa resembled each other to the maximum extent possible.

ALLAMAH SAYYID MUHAMMAD HUSAYN TABATABA’I,
Al-Mizan (Tehran, 1973), volume 5, pp. 261-262.

Posted on 2016-09-13 by Michael McClain

* * *

Ulysses on 2016-09-14 at 14:22 said:
Is this opinion about the infancy gospel common among catholics?

Cologero on 2016-09-14 at 16:38 said:
Ulysses, this is what Pope Benedict XVI wrote about it:
*Revelation to the Wise*³⁶.

Mark Citadel on 2016-09-15 at 07:48 said:
Fascinating read, in all three parts. I always love stuff involving symbology in particular. My article on Shia geopolitics may provide further interest for those wanting to learn how they apply their religious history to contemporary foreign affairs.

<http://www.socialmatter.net/2016/09/06/shia-geopolitics-fortress-state/>

³⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7776>

6.7 Ashura

The parallels between Iranian Shi'ism, on the one hand, and Spanish Catholicism and to a slightly lesser degree Irish Catholicism, on the other, is a topic too vast to fully treat here. The resemblance between them is indeed uncanny. As we have said earlier, at least since the twelfth century, it has been noted repeatedly that Shi'a Islam has many special affinities with traditional Catholicism and Eastern Orthodox Christianity.

Spanish Catholicism has particular characteristics which give it a special rapport with Shi'ism above and beyond the general Shi'a-Catholic affinities. This is easily explained historically, as we have said throughout this chapter.

The Russian Orthodox Church also has particular characteristics which give it a special rapport with Shi'ism above and beyond the general Shi'a-Eastern Orthodox affinities. It is for this reason that I have devoted so much space in this book to Russia and Ukraine and to the Russian Orthodox Church.

It is also evident that, when speaking of Muslim-Christian dialogue, the ideal spokesman from the Christian side would be either a mystically oriented Spanish Catholic or a mystically oriented Russian Orthodox believer, while from the Muslim side the ideal spokesman would be a Sufi oriented Shi'a.

In a personal communication, my friend Seyyed Hossein Nasr told me: "You are completely right in emphasizing the unique rapport between Shi'ism and Sufism on the one hand and certain elements of Spanish Catholicism and Russian Orthodoxy on the other." Since Spanish Catholicism and Russian Orthodoxy have particular characteristics which give them special affinities with Shi'ism, one may ask if they have special affinities among themselves. This is a potentially large topic which would require much research, so we will touch on it only briefly... .

At this point I can do no better than quotes the words of Sarah Hob-

son, speaking of her visit to Qum:

I wanted to stay in Qum to participate further in this (Iranian Shi'a) religious life, and to learn more about Islam. I felt I had touched only the surface, even though that surface seemed misleadingly smooth, misleadingly simple. So many of the rules, the recommendations, the beliefs of Shi'a Islam seemed clear and easy to grasp. Yet I felt that below there was something far more complex, more intricate, of philosophies and theological arguments which were beyond my understanding. Perhaps, if I could have more time here (in Qum), I would manage to go deeper, to understand the mystical undertones of Islam, its esoterics, its thought patterns. Perhaps I would just understand, for I felt here in Qum that the religious leaders and teachers were closer to knowledge of truth than I had encountered in people elsewhere.

SARAH HOBSON, *Through Iran in Disguise* (Chicago, 1982), p. 68.

My time in India convinced me that books are no substitute for a living Pir. I, too, should like to spend time in Qum, to learn of Shi'a Islam in depth, of its mysticism and esoterism. In Delhi I gave a talk on Muslim Spain at the tomb of Shaykh Nizamuddin. I remember my audience was composed mostly of very saintly looking men with white beards. Afterwards I was decorated with a leis of marigolds.

The journalist Robin Wright tells of her visit to Qum:

In stark contrast to the simplicity of (Ayatollah) Khomeini's barren home was a second religious landmark in Qum. The bustling new computer center at the Golpaygani Seminary (is) an impressively yellow brick building with blue tiled trim... The computer center (in Qum) was the brainchild of Ayatollah 'Ali Korani, a gentle cleric with a white beard and a white turban who had not even known how to type when he decided, about the time of Ayatollah Khomeini's death in 1989, that (Shi'a) Islam

had to meet modernity in the form of computers. The idea grew out of his own rather unusual research. "Since I was a child I have loved Imam Mahdi, our Twelfth Imam who disappeared," he (Ayatollah Korani) told me when I called on him at the computer center, where he and a young cleric were engrossed in a new software program. "Some of us believe from reading Islamic sources that he (Imam Mahdi) will come back at the same time as Jesus. The coming of the Mahdi is certain because the Prophet Muhammad said it would happen. He will come first and go to Quds (Jerusalem). Then Jesus will appear from Heaven and they will pray in Quds together. And then there will be unity between Christians and Muslims," Korani explained."³⁷

In Spain, mysticism is the lifeblood of religion, whether Muslim or Christian, and no doubt it was the lifeblood of Druidism in Spain in pre-Roman, pre-Christian times. This fact is of crucial importance, because nearly all the population of al-Andalus was composed either of Spanish Catholics, i.e., the Mozarabs, or of descendants of Spanish Catholics converted to Islam. In this last category must be included Ibn Hazm of Cordoba, Ibn 'Arabi al-Mursi, Ibn 'Abbad of Ronda, and the poets Ibn Quzman (pronounced "Guzman" in Spain) and Abu Bakr Ibn al-Qutiyya. The list could go on and on and on. In fact, nearly all the great figures of the history of al-Andalus as well as nearly all the general population either were Mozarabs or were descendants of Mozarabs converted to Islam. Even the Caliphs of Cordoba are included in this category, because far more Iberian, Celtic and Visigothic blood flowed in their veins than did Arab blood. Did the Caliphs of Cordoba themselves feel a twinge of "Shi'a tendencies," ironically helping to provoke the fear of Fatimid subversion?

There is another fact which seems to indicate Shi'ism, open or clandestine, or at the very least strong Shi'a tendencies among the population of al-Andalus and, perhaps, even in the case of the great Caliph 'Abd al-

³⁷ Robin Wright, *The Last Great Revolution* (New York, 2000), p. 236.

Rahman III. I refer to the prevalence of the feminine name *Zahra*, usually pronounced “Zahara” or “Zahira” among Hispano-Muslims. The title “Zahra” for Fatima, daughter of the Prophet Muhammad, is extremely common among Shi‘as. I would not go so far as to say that said title is unknown or never used among Sunnis, though I have never heard it said by a Sunni nor have I read it in Sunni literature. At the very least, the title “Zahra” for Fatima, daughter of the Prophet Muhammad, is very rarely or never used by Sunnis. Usually in the form of the transcriptions of Hispano-Muslim vocalizations “Zahara” or “Zahira,” the title “Zahra” is found to this day as a feminine personal name and in place names in Southern Spain. We have already mentioned the caliphal city near Cordoba, “Medina al-Zahara,” which is “Madinat al-Zahra” in correct, classical Arabic, built by the Caliph ‘Abd al-Rahman III. I also recall visiting the picturesque present day village called “Zahara,” not far from Ronda.

Over the main gate of the Caliphal residence in Medina al-Zahara was a statue of a woman, said to have been that of a “favorite” of the Caliph named “Zahara.” (156) Did this statue really represent a “favorite” of the Caliph or did it represent Fatima Zahra? Should this be the case, it would indicate that the Caliph ‘Abd ar-Rahman III was himself a clandestine Shi‘a. This is all the more credible when we recall that said residence was within the caliphal city called “Madinat al-Zahara.” Would the great Caliph ‘Abd al-Rahman III really have named a city, and perhaps some villages and small towns, after a “favorite,” and adorned the main gate to the caliphal residence in Madinat al-Zahara with a statue of said favorite?

It is also said that in Cordoba in Muslim times there was a statue of the Virgin Mary above that gate of the city called “Bab al-Qantara,” which led to the bridge over the Guadalquivir, and another such statue over the principal gate of Pechina, near Almeria.³⁸ We have already mentioned the many connections between the Virgin Mary and Fatima Zahra. Did these statues in cities of Muslim Spain really represent the Virgin Mary or did

³⁸ Henri Peres, *Esplendor de al-Andalus* (Madrid, 1983), p. 333.

they represent Fatima Zahra, or, perhaps, had the two become fused in the popular imagination? I have never heard of any statues of Muslim holy men in Muslim Spain.

As is evident from what we have said above, al-Andalus was a land of Sufism, being second only to Persia and perhaps Muslim India in this respect. Sufism saturated the very air of al-Andalus. Indeed it was Sufism which won the bulk of the population of al-Andalus to Islam... .

It has been noted that some Shi'a mullahs have been violently anti-Sufi, particularly during the Safavid period, and this apparent fact has been used to "prove" that there is no intrinsic relation between Shi'ism and Sufism, though of course many Shi'as are Sufis and many Sufis are Shi'as. However, by this standard Ibn 'Arabi al-Mursi was also anti-Sufi, since he strongly condemned some of the beliefs and practices of certain Sufis.³⁹ This is a bit like saying that the Pope is anti-Catholic because he disapproves of some of the beliefs and practices of certain people who call themselves Catholics.

The truth is that, whether called *Batin*, *Hikmat* or *Irfan*, Sufism is an absolutely vital, organic, and indispensable part of Shi'a doctrine, theology, philosophy and spirituality.⁴⁰ The same cannot be said of Sunni Islam, though, as we have said, it is most certainly true that there are Sunnis as well as Shi'as who are Sufis. To summarize, a Sunni Muslim may

³⁹Ibn Arabi, *Risalat al-Quds*, translated as *Vidas de Santones Andaluces* by Miguel Asin Palacios (Madrid, 1981), pp. 121-122.

⁴⁰See *The Heritage of Sufism, Volume I: Classical Persian Sufism from its Origins to Rumi (700-1300)*, edited by Leonard Lewisohn (Oxford, 1999), essay by John Cooper, "Rumi and Hikmat: Towards a Reading of Sabziwari's Commentary on the Mathnawi," pp. 409-435. *The Heritage of Sufism, Volume II: The Legacy of Medieval Persian Sufism (1150-1500)*, edited by Leonard Lewisohn (Oxford, 1999), essay by Leonard Lewisohn, "Overview: Iranian Islam and Persianate Sufism," p. 19. *The Heritage of Sufism, Volume III: Late Classical Persianate Sufism (1501-1750)* essays by Seyyed Hossein Nasr, "The Place of the School of Isfahan in Islamic Philosophy and Sufism," pp. 3-19, and Leonard Lewisohn, "Sufism and the School of Isfahan: Tasawwuf and Irfan in Late Safavid Iran," pp. 63-135.

be a complete non-Sufi, having no connection whatever with Sufism in any way, shape or form. However, this is not possible for a Shi'a, who by virtue of being a Shi'a is a Sufi in some degree or another, though this degree varies greatly in individual cases. Conversely, a Sufi, though he may confessionally be a Sunni, by the fact of being a Sufi has certain "Shi'a tendencies."... We have already mentioned the parallels between Holy Week in Spain and the Shi'a Ashura. During my years in Granada I heard of celebrations of Good Friday which included auto flagellation and representations of the Crucifixion which were a bit too realistic, leading to serious injury or even death. I was not able to confirm the veracity of these tales. Apparently all this occurred in remote and inaccessible areas of the provinces of Granada, Malaga and Almeria, always areas with a strong Morisco background. Shi'ism would have certainly had different nuances among the Mudejares and most especially the Moriscos than among the Hispano-Muslims. The fact of living in an overwhelmingly Catholic environment would have certainly strengthened any Shi'a tendencies among the Moriscos for reasons given above, though in an unconscious manner and with no intention on anyone's part. One can readily imagine a Morisco or even a Mudejar participating in Good Friday celebrations, saying to himself: "I do not believe that the Prophet Isa (Jesus Christ), on Whom be peace, was crucified, but Imam Hussayn, on Whom be peace, was most certainly cruelly martyred, and both the Prophet Isa and Imam Hussayn are alive and awaited, to return on the Day of Judgment, so in my heart I celebrate the martyrdom of Imam Hussayn, and with all sincerity I have great reverence for the Prophet Isa."

In remote Morisco villages where even the parish priest might have been a Morisco, one can readily imagine practices typical of Ashura being used during the Good Friday celebrations. It may be that some of the typically Spanish customs connected with Good Friday and Holy Saturday celebrations may have been inspired by Shi'a influence by way of Mudejares and Moriscos. The history of the Franciscans in what is now

the southwestern United States is an epic of heroism and sanctity, with an abundant harvest of martyrs. During the colonial period the Church in New Mexico was under the jurisdiction of the Bishop of Durango in Mexico. In practice New Mexico was a Franciscan province, because between Durango and New Mexico was 1500 miles of very rugged terrain full of Apaches. The Franciscans were in charge of the missions among the Amerindians as well as the spiritual well-being of the white colonists. A large proportion of the white males of New Mexico were Franciscan Lay Brothers.

The Mexican Period is not favorably remembered in New Mexico. So unpopular was the Mexican government that there were two uprisings against it in New Mexico. In 1828 the Mexican Government expelled all clergy of Spanish birth and secularized the mission lands. This meant that New Mexico was left almost without priests. While the Amerindians in many cases returned to pagan practices, something surprising occurred among the white population. Quite suddenly there appeared the brotherhoods of the Brothers of the Light and the Brothers of the Blood. During Holy Week these brotherhoods did things which the Franciscans would never have permitted, such as auto flagellation until the blood flowed and severely realistic representations of the Crucifixion. The popular name of these brotherhoods was, and is, *Los Penitentes*.

In 1942 the Penitentes promised to cease and desist from the most extreme of their practices, and were accepted by the Church. Today in New Mexico about 2,500 men belong to the Penitente Brotherhoods. During Holy Week the Penitentes dress in white shorts and black hoods. To the sound of a *pitero*, or small flute, they bear heavy crosses to the tops of the hills. They lie down on thorns and cactus spines. They flagellate themselves with yucca whips, at times lacerating the flesh until reaching the bone. They cut themselves with knives of obsidian or volcanic glass. On Good Friday the Crucifixion is represented, with a volunteer tied to a cross. At times the volunteer loses consciousness. There are stories of

men being nailed to crosses and even dying as a result of a representation a bit too realistic.⁴¹

Julio Puyol says that auto flagellation became part of Holy Week celebrations in Spain only in the first third of the Sixteenth Century. In 1565-66 the Valencia Provincial Council mentions the Thursday and Good Friday abuses (i.e., auto flagellation) of the penitentes.⁴² This is extremely interesting, because until a series of decrees around the year 1500, the Mudejares of Spain were openly Muslims. In other words, the above indicates that auto flagellation and similar Holy Week practices became common in Spain precisely at the time when the former Mudejares, now “Moriscos” or at least nominal Christians, would have become participants in said Holy Week ceremonies. Also note that Valencia, together with Granada, was the region with the highest density of Morisco population. All this points to a Muslim origin for many Spanish Holy Week customs, including auto flagellation. Among Muslims, these practices are typical only of Shi‘as.

The Iranian writer Roy Mottahedeh has also noted the close parallels between the Holy Week celebrations of the Penitentes of New Mexico and the Ashura celebrations of the Shi‘as of Iran. He says:

Flagellation survives in Spain and in many parts of the Hispanic world. It survives, in fact, in the United States in New Mexico, where, in spite of a century of horrified disapproval of Protestants and non-Hispanic Catholics, the Brotherhoods of Penitentes commemorate the Passion of Jesus by flagellation, by the carrying of heavy wooden crosses, and many other forms of discipline, physical and spiritual. The resem-

⁴¹David Lavender, *The Southwest* (New York, 1980), p. 128; Robert L. Casey, *Journey to the High Southwest* (Seattle, 1985), pp. 272-273, 276; New Mexico, various authors, pp. 123-124; Mason Sutherland & Justin Locke, “Adobe New Mexico,” *National Geographic Magazine*, December, 1949, pp. 823-824.

⁴²Marta Weigle, *Brothers of Light, Brothers of Blood, The Penitentes of the Southwest* (Santa Fe, New Mexico, 1976), p. 32, citing Julio Puyol, *Platica de Disciplinantes* (Madrid, 1927), p. 245.

blance of the form of Penitente religiosity to (Iranian) Shiah practices extends to tableaux from the life of Jesus and even to the drama of a simulated crucifixion.

The resemblance in psychological content is even more striking: both the (Iranian) Shiah and the New Mexican Penitentes are using violation of physical self-integrity as a means to enter an altered state of awareness in which ordinary restraints of prudence are removed and the Penitente loses not only his sense of self-protection but also his sense of separateness. By sharing his “discipline” the Penitente has broken the boundary between himself and his fellow Penitentes and even — to some extent — between himself and the spiritual model he seeks to imitate; as the Penitentes say, the “Brothers of Blood” become “Brothers of Light.” At bottom, both are forms of folk mysticism.⁴³

The last paragraph hits the nail on the head. What the Penitentes of New Mexico really represent is Shi‘ite religiosity expressed in Christian terms. Note also that Penitente religiosity suddenly appeared full-blown at the moment in which the Church in New Mexico was passing through a very difficult period, and returned to clandestinity or semi-clandestinity when an energetic group of French and Spanish priests under Bishop Lamy restored the Church in New Mexico. This indicates a long history and a long experience of clandestinity and *taqiyya*, or dissimulation. In Muslim Spain, the Shi‘ites usually had to practice at least a semi-clandestinity, as in Persia and other Middle Eastern countries under dynasties of Turkish origin. Under the kings of Castile, the Church suppressed any attempts to use the more extreme practices of Ashura in the Holy Week celebrations, except, perhaps, in some very remote and inaccessible places, but through clandestinity something survived. With the passage of so many generations between 1492 (the year that the last Nazirid king surrendered Granada to Fernando of Aragon and Isabel of Castile) and 1828 the Imam Hussayn was forgotten and Jesus Christ

⁴³Roy Mottahedeh, *The Mantle of the Prophet* (New York, 1985), pp. 175-176.

took his place, but this change was purely nominal, the religiosity itself remaining the same.

Posted on 2016-09-20 by Michael McClain

* * *

James K. Polk on 2016-09-27 at 01:54 said:

Superb! Your website continues to contain some of the most substantive writings on the Internet. Keep up the good work and I will gladly continue reading!

6.8 Persian Traditions Chap I – General, part a

Many people have noted the parallels and similarities between Persia and Spain. Wilfrid Blunt (1) says that the Persians are the Spaniards of the Middle East and that both Spaniards and Persians are proud, hospitable and procrastinating. Sr. Eugenio Montes, in an article in the Madrid newspaper ABC in honor of the 2500th anniversary of the founding of the Persian Empire, says: “Persia is the Spain of Asia, Spain is the Persia of the West.” Reading this, one friend commented that it is no coincidence that Eugenio Montes is a Gallego, i.e., from Galicia. We will have more to say of this later.

What, one may ask, would cause such distinguished gentlemen as Mr. Blunt and Sr. Montes to affirm such close relations between two countries so distant one from the other? There are many reasons, some of which neither of these two distinguished men of letters seem to be aware.

The geographical similarities between the Iberian Peninsula and the Iranian Plateau are obvious, though of course the Iranian Plateau is on a much larger scale. Both are very largely cut off from the continents

of which they form a part by high, rugged mountain ranges; both have a high, cold and somewhat barren central plateau, broken in places by mountains. In the province of Mazanderan one has the Iranian equivalent of the lush, green Cantabrian Coast (even the typical barns of Mazanderan resemble those of Asturias and Santander) in Persian Azerbaijan the equivalent of the wheat plains of Leon. In the Persian Gulf Coast, one has the equivalent of the Southern Mediterranean Coast of Spain. The resemblances are not purely geographical; there are also profound ethnic and historical parallels and similarities.

Spain has a very strong Celtic heritage. At one time or another the Celts penetrated the entire Peninsula and strongly occupied its Western 75 per cent. The Celts were of course never expelled and in spite of Roman, Germanic and Semitic superstrata left a rich heritage to their descendants. In Spain Celtic influences are visible in physical types (particularly in Asturias, Leon and Old Castile), music, artistic and literary forms, festivals, folklore, spiritual values, temperament and general character traits. As we shall see, in Medieval Spain, both Christian and Muslim, poets composed verse using versification forms of Celtic origin, though writing in Latin, Romance (by "Romance" I refer to the language called in Arabic *Lisan al-Ajjam*, i.e., "the non-Arabic Language"), Classical Arabic, Vulgar Arabic, Hebrew, Catalan, Gallego-Portuguese, Aragonese and Castilian, and sang them to melodies based on Celtic musical modes. No one who has any knowledge of Celtic Studies has the slightest doubt as to the truth of what I am saying, not anyone who has any first-hand knowledge of Spain on the one hand and Celtic countries such as Ireland, Scotland, Wales and Brittany on the other. Celtic elements are present in the phonetics, grammar and vocabulary of all the Romance languages of the Peninsula. So powerful is the Celtic element in Spain that many Spaniards of my acquaintance feel that Spain should be considered as one of the Celtic countries along with Ireland, Scotland, Wales and Brittany, arguing that a Spaniard does not cease to be a Celt because he speaks a

Romance language any more than an Irishman ceases to be a Celt because he speaks English. It should never be forgotten that Spain is a land of heather as well as olive trees, a land of bagpipes as well as guitars, and that this is true of Muslim Spain as well as Christian Spain.

Before we go any further, some things need to be clarified. In this work I will use the term “Aryan” with a certain frequency, so let us define our terms, Firstly, remember your Aristotle; all Aryans are Indo-Europeans, but not all Indo-Europeans are Aryans. The term “Aryan” in reality can be accurately applied to three, and only three Indo-European peoples, i.e., the Indo-Aryans, the Iranians, and the Celts. The word *Arya* or *Aryan* is Sanskrit. The name *Iran* means “Land of the Aryans”, as does *Erinn*, the native Celtic word for “Ireland” (the name *Ireland* is a Viking word), and name “Aryan” is found in numerous ancient Celtic place names and tribal names, as we shall demonstrate. Finally, as we shall also demonstrate, the Indo-Aryans, Iranians and Celts have so many special affinities in common to warrant lumping them together as a sub-grouping within the larger Indo-European context. When I use the word or name “Aryan”, I refer *only* to the Indo-Aryans, Iranians and Celts, *never* to the Germanic peoples. The ancient Germanic peoples did not know the name or word “Aryan”, and never called themselves by this name.

Hitler was both an ignoramus and a congenital liar, who claimed that the Germanic peoples are “pure Aryans”, when, in reality, they are not Aryans at all; the Germanic peoples are no more “pure Aryans” than they are “pure Albanians” (Albanians are Indo-Europeans, but not Aryans). Many people who proclaim themselves to be “intellectuals” use the word “Aryan” as a synonym for the Germanic peoples, as did Hitler; in this they are showing themselves to be “pseudo-intellectuals”. Immediately some of these pseudo-intellectuals will try to defend themselves by saying that they are not knowledgeable in Indo-European studies, that it is not their field. Now, there is a word for people who try to pontificate on that of

which they know nothing: that word is “fool”. There is a Cajun expression for people of this sort: “alligators”. Why? Because an alligator has an enormous mouth and a very tiny brain. Finally, as we shall see, the living language closest to the original Indo-European language is Lithuanian, while the country with the largest percentage of natural blondes is Lithuania; but the Lithuanians are not Germanic. So, from every possible point of view, Hitler’s claim that the Germanic peoples are “pure Aryans”, or even “Aryans” at all, is arrant nonsense, the ravings of a liar and an ignorant fool.

Those self-proclaimed “intellectuals” who continue to use the word “Aryan” in the sense in which it was used by Hitler not only show themselves to be ignorant louts, but also give Hitler credit for an intellectual acumen which he totally lacked. Perhaps this is not surprising.

Hitler was very much a “progressive”, a man of the extreme left, a true son of the so-called “Enlightenment”. One could hardly find a more “leftist” or “progressive” name than “National Socialist German Workers’ Party”. Yes, Hitler was very much a socialist; he repeatedly said “I am a fanatical socialist”, and praised the advantages of a command economy in contrast to private enterprise. Hitler was also anti-Catholic, anti-aristocratic, anti-monarchist, and was very big indeed on “separation of church and state”. By at least indirectly attributing to Hitler an intellectual acumen of which he was totally lacking, these “progressive” pseudo-intellectuals also reveal their secret love and admiration for Hitler.

In summary, whenever I use the word “Aryan”, I refer *only* to the Indo-Aryans, the Iranians and the Celts, *never* to the Germanic peoples.

There is a song about Ireland, commercial, not traditional, whose last strophe says:

So they (the angels) sprinkled it with stardust
Just to make the shamrocks grow
‘Tis the only place you’ll find them
No matter where you go

Then they sprinkled it with silver
Just to make the lakes so grand
And when they had it finished
Sure they called it Ireland.

Now, as we said above, the native Celtic name of Ireland is *Erinn*, more modern Gaelic *Érin*, while the name “Ireland” is a Viking word. Now, to a true Aryan, Celtic son of the ancient Erinn, the idea that the angels would give a Viking name to the Holy Emerald Isle is simply intolerable, as is anything which could conceivably seem to suggest that the Vikings were angels. So, the above song should be boycotted by all sons of the ancient Erinn, as well as all Celts and those sympathetic to the Celts, who consider themselves to be at least partly Celtic by blood and heritage, which includes the majority of the Spanish and Portuguese, as well as a great many Frenchmen. The angels are not Vikings, nor would they give a Viking name to the ancient Erinn, the Land of the Aryans. And the Vikings, being Germanic, were NOT Aryans.

One of the great enigmas of Indo-European studies is the precise nature of the relation between the Celts and the Indo-Iranian peoples. Specialists in the fields of religion, art, customs and literary forms tend to consider the Celts as an Eastern Aryan people migrated to the West, while those whose specialty is more strictly linguistic tend to affirm that the Celts are a Western people akin to the Italic peoples. There are excellent reasons to question this.

For many years it has been generally believed in scholarly circles that the Celtic languages are most closely related to the Italic languages. This has now been put into grave doubt, in fact it now appears to be almost certainly in error. We shall deal with this at some length, as it is of crucial importance to our study.

Crucial to our thesis are the Illyrians, who, together with the Thracians and Dacians, form the “bedrock” of the population of the northern part of the Balkan Peninsula and present-day Romania.

Says Hans Krahe:

The Illyrian languages, which at one time were spoken in a vast area from the Baltic Sea to the Mediterranean and from Western Europe to Asia Minor, something which has been proven by a study of place names. The Illyrian languages achieved such a vast extension thanks to a great movement which began in the 13th century BC, and which is commonly referred to as the “Aegean migration”, and whose principal impulse was that of the Illyrians themselves. The linguistic remains of the Illyrian language which have come down to us are meagre, compared with that which one might expect from its ancient diffusion. Of the two Illyrian dialects spoken in the Appenine Peninsula (Italy), i.e., Mesapian in Apulia and Calabria and Veneto in northeastern Italy (from whence comes the name Venezia, i.e., “Venice”), several hundred inscriptions of each have come down to us. To these must be added one brief inscription, the only example of the Illyrian language spoken in the (northwestern) Balkan Peninsula. In addition, there survive a great many place names and personal names, and numerous glosses. (2)

Some affirm that the present-day Romanian language, though a Romance language with a Slavic admixture, contains many elements from the Illyrian language and also Dacian or Thracian. Some also believe that the Bulgarian language, though most certainly Slavic – indeed, Old Bulgarian is the basis of Church Slavonic, the most prestigious of all Slavic languages, see Chapter 8 – contains Thracian elements. After all, the Illyrians and Dacians or Thracians are the genetic bedrock of the peoples of the northern part of the Balkan Peninsula and present day Romania.

Posted on 2020-03-28 by Michael McClain